# Volume limits from planar tangles

## Circle packings, long twists, and ordered tangle trees

Finite knot invariants, hyperbolic filling, and the preferred cusp shape

1 November 2026

# Abstract

We prove volume limits for several specified classes of knots constructed from planar tangle diagrams. The first starts with a simple triangulation of the sphere and a perfect matching of its dual graph. These data specify an augmented link in the three-sphere. An explicit finite decoration by even stacks of terminal tangles makes a shared circle-packing inequality strict. Independently sufficiently long signed fillings of every original and added crossing circle then give

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\langle K\rangle_N| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K),$$

where $\langle K\rangle_N$ is the reduced Kashaev invariant with unknot value one. The limit includes both parities and composite levels. The decoration preserves the chosen endpoint pairing but can change the knot.

For an unchanged matched sphere, the same volume conclusion holds whenever the complete packing satisfies an explicit weak balance condition. Equality is allowed in its local inequalities. A common perturbation of the coefficient weights gives a linear entropy gain while increasing the stationary complete action only quadratically. This proves a strict bound for all complementary terms. A quantitative version permits small balance defects. The condition is sufficient and is not asserted for every packing.

A specified triangular sum also preserves full shared-weight certificates. This permits any fixed finite number of certified pieces. An explicit sequence starts with a seventeen-region rational certificate and adds tetrahedral pieces; its marked diagrams retain a balance failure but still satisfy the full volume limit after sufficiently long fixed signed fillings.

Certified pieces can also be inserted along ordinary triangular faces, where all three boundary curvatures are positive. Two boundary curvatures must be sufficiently small relative to the third at the chosen coefficient witnesses. Explicit even chains produce such faces for any fixed finite list of inputs. The proof minimizes the disk action with its boundary weights fixed and then transports the strict complementary estimates with their original coefficient demands.

A further class consists of specified ordered constructions from two-string tangles. A recursive class admits independently sufficiently long signed twists. For a finite ordered tree with at least one edge and a crossing-circle operator at every vertex, write $d_v$ for the vertex degree and $n_v$ for the signed half-twist power. Each of the following is a sufficient condition for hyperbolicity and the volume limit:

$$\sum_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \le 2^{-25}, \qquad \text{or} \qquad d_v \ge 2^{28} \text{ or } |n_v| \ge 2^{27} \quad \text{at every vertex.}$$

The alternatives in the second test may differ between vertices. A more flexible directed

criterion assigns separate decay bounds to the polynomials obtained by evaluating subtrees. In particular, the uniform twist bound is independent of the number of tangles, while the degree alternative allows prescribed short or zero powers. Every diagram and every twist power is fixed before $N$ tends to infinity. The original strand connections must form one knot without an internally closed extra main component.

The proofs start with the finite matrices defining the invariant and retain the derivative data at repeated spectral roots. Signed complementary terms are bounded before the oscillatory filling sum is evaluated. The leading Fourier contribution is nonzero, with every remaining charge and contour boundary term controlled. On the geometric side, labeled cuts reconstruct the original augmented exterior. For circle trees the cut supplies two octahedra per edge. Positive deformations and the actual primitive peripheral periods give smooth fillings and identify the selected action with the volume of the original knot complement. The main cusp remains complete.

For the covered tree classes, the same source calculation gives a uniform microscopic meridian profile of the zero-framed reduced Akutsu–Deguchi–Ohtsuki invariant, with its exact crossing and framing factors. The summed and directed criteria also give the preferred-cusp correction. The full expansion and a geometric longitude identity imply that the selected geometric factor divides the first nonzero classical symbol of any nonzero fixed operator annihilating the actual reduced sequence at all sufficiently large levels. This is an implication for an existing annihilator; it does not assert equality with the entire A-polynomial or recurrence ideal.

Two further results retain narrower conclusions. For unchanged diagrams specified by a simple matched sphere, the geometric contribution to the original exact invariant has a nonzero long-filling asymptotic with the actual volume rate. No general bound on its complementary contribution is asserted. A separate finite theorem bounds the filling functionals independently of the level. The weak-balance theorem supplies the additional remainder estimate for its stated class. For a general unchanged diagram, the geometric-contribution theorem retains its smaller conclusion.

# Contents


**1 The knots, the theorems, and their proofs** **1**
1.1 What the theorem compares . . . 1
1.2 The statements proved in this manuscript . . . 2
1.3 A planar construction beyond tangle trees . . . 3
1.4 When no added tangles are needed . . . 3
1.5 Joining diagrams whose source estimates are known . . . 4
1.6 Building the diagrams from four-ended tangles . . . 4
1.7 Which compositions are included . . . 6
1.8 The long-twist theorem . . . 7
1.9 An explicit criterion for circle trees . . . 7
1.10 The preferred longitude and the classical recurrence . . . 8
1.11 A guide to the proof and its terminology . . . 9
1.12 Background and the arguments used here . . . 10
1.13 Conventions and verification . . . 11

**2 Evaluating the invariant in a finite polynomial algebra** **12**
2.1 Crossings and the one-cut normalization . . . 12
2.2 The full pair algebra . . . 14
2.3 The actual turn and the Newton basis . . . 14
2.4 Positive multiplication with every normal retained . . . 15
2.5 The literal crossing circle and its colors . . . 16
2.6 Half twists and exact filling . . . 17

**3 From the finite sum to an angle maximization problem** **19**
3.1 Following the allowed indices through the construction . . . 19
3.2 Strict output types . . . 20
3.3 The primitive integer lattice . . . 21
3.4 The action and its uniform finite approximation . . . 21
3.5 Tetrahedral concavity and the boundary barrier . . . 22
3.6 Boundary parameters and the leaf interval . . . 23

**4 Constructing the complete augmented hyperbolic metric** **25**
4.1 Why the local volume identity is not enough . . . 25
4.2 The leaf pyramid . . . 25
4.3 The multiplication prism . . . 26
4.4 Stationarity matches whole ordered faces . . . 27

4.5 Convex assembly and the closed cut . . . 28
4.6 Complete cusps and half-twist partners . . . 29
4.7 A constructive knot choice . . . 29

**5 Controlling the signed complementary color terms 31**
5.1 Coefficient envelopes on the true support . . . 31
5.2 Why a block estimate is needed . . . 32
5.3 A leaf attached to an arbitrary completed child . . . 33
5.4 The whole-tree induction . . . 34

**6 A holomorphic asymptotic near the complete maximum 36**
6.1 A finite holomorphic object . . . 36
6.2 The selected local action . . . 37
6.3 Offsets, powers of the level, and the Gaussian . . . 37
6.4 An exact three-leaf calibration . . . 39

**7 Peripheral curves and the volume after filling 40**
7.1 From a metric modulus to peripheral coordinates . . . 40
7.2 Geometric completion for long primitive slopes . . . 41

**8 Evaluating the complete oscillatory filling sum 43**
8.1 Replacing the color sum by its controlled local part . . . 43
8.2 An exact Fourier bound away from zero frequency . . . 44
8.3 The total derivative and the zero-charge cancellation . . . 44
8.4 Uniform charge tails and their endpoint currents . . . 45
8.5 The central Fourier packet . . . 46
8.6 Local charges for independently signed slopes . . . 46
8.7 Noncancellation and the final action . . . 47

**9 An explicit volume theorem for ordered trees of crossing circles 49**
9.1 The knot construction . . . 49
9.2 The quantitative theorem . . . 50
9.3 Why the original exterior has the required geometric pieces . . . 51
9.4 Positive cells and primitive filling periods . . . 53
9.5 The action and the invariant have the same normalization . . . 54
9.6 A geometric form of the numerical condition . . . 55
9.7 The preferred cusp and the first correction . . . 55
9.8 The pointed quantum A-period . . . 57

**10 A local filling condition from subtree polynomials 58**
10.1 The local volume theorem . . . 58
10.2 What a subtree leaves on its boundary . . . 59
10.3 Why the normalization is local . . . 60
10.4 From a local saddle to the full finite trace . . . 61
10.5 A separate vertexwise metric criterion . . . 62
10.6 The original volume and the two sufficient tests . . . 62

**11 A sharper degree and twist condition** **64**
11.1 An explicit sufficient condition . . . 64
11.2 Why the last vertex has a different condition . . . 65
11.3 The conditional estimate and the proof of the theorem . . . 66
11.4 Keeping an arbitrary fixed collection of short-twist pieces . . . 66
11.5 A finite criterion beyond the simple bounds . . . 67

**12 The geometric longitude selected by the finite source** **69**
12.1 The marked equations and their geometric branch . . . 69
12.2 Why the equations describe the original exterior . . . 70
12.3 From the peripheral differential to an exact identity . . . 71
12.4 Product junctions without crossing circles . . . 72
12.5 The resulting factor of a genuine quantum recurrence . . . 74
12.6 Transfer under an ordered reduction of the presentation . . . 75

**13 Balanced decorations of simple white spheres** **76**
13.1 The diagrams and the result . . . 76
13.2 A circle packing from the finite combinatorics . . . 77
13.3 How two fans produce the needed inequality . . . 78
13.4 The full finite source and the filled metric . . . 79

**14 All orders of the directed meridian profile** **81**
14.1 The expansion and its geometric consequences . . . 81
14.2 Why the actual source has every order . . . 82
14.3 The polynomial filtration and the preferred cusp . . . 83
14.4 The factor forced in a genuine classical symbol . . . 84

**15 Proof inputs and reproduction** **86**
15.1 The implication that finishes a volume proof . . . 86
15.2 The scope of the dependency argument . . . 87
15.3 Finite steps checked in Lean . . . 88
15.4 Three different kinds of evidence . . . 89
15.5 Replaying the exact certificates . . . 90
15.6 Checking the quantitative tree formulas . . . 90
15.7 The planar terminal decoration . . . 91
15.8 The directed criterion and unmarked junctions . . . 91
15.9 Building the manuscript and illustrated guide . . . 91
15.10 The scope of the conclusions . . . 92
15.11 The geometric longitude calculation . . . 93
15.12 Uniform bounds for inserting twists . . . 93

**A Finite algebra and normalization identities** **94**
A.1 The crossing comparison and enhancement . . . 94
A.2 The block polynomial and the physical Newton turn . . . 95
A.3 Circle coefficients and the signed alias . . . 96
A.4 Fourier–Hermite interpolation of an arbitrary twist . . . 98

**B Detailed estimates for the color sums and filling contours 99**
B.1 The exact local recurrence and its holomorphic asymptotic . . . 99
B.1.1 Canonical factorials and the literal mixed coefficient . . . 99
B.1.2 Deriving the recurrence, including its endpoint . . . 101
B.1.3 The selected analytic root and a source-exact continued fraction . . . 102
B.1.4 First transport correction and absolute amplitude normalization . . . 103
B.1.5 Exponential interpolation before an oscillatory saddle . . . 104
B.1.6 Keeping the quadratic phase and determining the signed action . . . 105
B.1.7 An exact source action identity and its Hessian . . . 106
B.1.8 The exact finite wire window and its lattice saddle . . . 107
B.1.9 Returning from the local sum to the original evaluation . . . 109
B.2 A global coefficient bound, including repeated recurrence roots . . . 110
B.2.1 Normalization and the finite upper endpoint . . . 110
B.2.2 The spectral ellipse . . . 111
B.2.3 Frozen blocks and the singular lower endpoint . . . 112
B.2.4 The actual coefficient envelopes and the macroscopic color loss . . . 113
B.3 Nonlocal filling charges and local contour connectors . . . 115

**C The exact certificate arithmetic 117**
C.1 A finite proof object . . . 117
C.2 Outward rational intervals . . . 118
C.3 The integrated sine product . . . 118
C.4 Gradients and coverage . . . 119
C.5 What execution establishes . . . 119

**D Face maps, peripheral markings, and the absolute volume 120**
D.1 Two global incidence checks for the complete anchor . . . 120
D.2 The selected color action and the complete face-pairing maps . . . 121
D.3 Primitive logs, the absolute regulator, and filling . . . 123
D.4 Smooth completion on the actual primitive filled topology . . . 124
D.4.1 An actual positive metric on the core and its ends . . . 124
D.4.2 The logarithmic link and its primitive angular period . . . 125
D.4.3 The source saddle and its absolute knot-complement volume . . . 127

**E The quantitative finite-sum estimate 128**
E.1 Polynomial coordinates and the finite sum . . . 128
E.2 Finite sums under the degree and twist criterion . . . 130
E.2.1 Assertion and scope . . . 130
E.2.2 Finite identities and the four uses of long twists . . . 131
E.2.3 A graph-independent discarded-source gap . . . 131
E.2.4 Exact edge action . . . 132
E.2.5 An available complex packet and nonlinear bounds . . . 133
E.2.6 A uniform raw angular Gaussian . . . 133
E.2.7 Critical branches without reciprocal-slope smallness . . . 134
E.2.8 Infinite tails and connectors . . . 135
E.2.9 The actual analytic conclusion . . . 136

E.2.10 Explicit analytic nonvacuity . . . 136
E.2.11 Identification with the knot volume . . . 137
E.2.12 Reproducing the edge calculations . . . 138
E.3 Uniform Newton bounds with explicit constants . . . 138
E.3.1 A uniform loss outside the retained interval . . . 138
E.3.2 An elementary Gaussian bound on the complex angular strip . . . 139
E.3.3 The explicit action of one edge . . . 140

**F The ordered octahedral geometry and the filled cusp 141**
F.1 The ordered octahedral decomposition . . . 141
F.1.1 The actual ordered object and the statement . . . 142
F.1.2 How endpoint pairings determine the cut . . . 143
F.1.3 One terminal insertion is exactly one octahedron . . . 144
F.1.4 Why this covers every ordered tree . . . 145
F.1.5 Retained half twists and reversed disk frames . . . 145
F.1.6 Exact primitive peripheral concatenation . . . 146
F.1.7 From the cut to the geometric filling . . . 147
F.2 Positive angular coordinates on each edge block . . . 147
F.2.1 The actual two-leaf model . . . 148
F.2.2 Solving in the two angular longitude variables . . . 148
F.2.3 Uniform positive tetrahedra on an explicit complex bidisk . . . 149
F.2.4 The two disk-side pants depend only on their longitude . . . 150
F.2.5 Local logarithmic increments and the edge action . . . 151
F.2.6 Assembly in the original ordered exterior . . . 151
F.3 Completing the actual fillings and calibrating volume . . . 152
F.3.1 Exact topological and local inputs . . . 152
F.3.2 The analytic path and the actual peripheral formulas . . . 153
F.3.3 Positive metric on the cut-and-glued exterior . . . 154
F.3.4 The periods throughout the charge path . . . 155
F.3.5 Cone completion and the smooth endpoint . . . 155
F.3.6 Absolute action and the primitive normalization . . . 156
F.3.7 Scope of the completion . . . 158
F.4 The preferred cusp along the filling path . . . 158
F.4.1 Statement . . . 158
F.4.2 Why actual representations can be compared near zero . . . 159
F.4.3 Identification of the retained wire coordinates . . . 160
F.4.4 Holomorphic continuation of the actual main translation . . . 161
F.4.5 The preferred longitude after the actual fillings . . . 162

**G Exact subtree polynomials and local filling estimates 163**
G.1 The full finite kernel and exact recursion . . . 163
G.2 Two full-kernel bounds . . . 164
G.3 A closed class of boundary phases . . . 165
G.4 The exact finite-message induction . . . 166
G.5 Conditional trace tails and connectors . . . 168
G.6 Root assembly and the original filled action . . . 170

G.7 A vertexwise geometric criterion . . . 170
G.7.1 Exact derivatives of the nonlinear error . . . 171
G.7.2 A contraction independent of the size of the tree . . . 171
G.7.3 Actual metric and absolute volume . . . 172
G.7.4 A finite criterion with different radii at different vertices . . . 173

**H A classical characteristic selected by the microscopic meridian state 175**
H.1 Exact finite inputs and the meridian action . . . 176
H.2 Fixed translated charts away from the resonances . . . 177
H.3 All-order canonical interpolation . . . 178
H.4 The filtered action theorem . . . 179
H.4.1 All orders for the local tree criterion . . . 180
H.5 Exact operator compatibility on the shifted charts . . . 181
H.6 Diagonal extraction forces a classical characteristic germ . . . 182
H.6.1 Reciprocity of the selected factor . . . 183
H.7 Peripheral equations and their geometric interpretation . . . 183
H.7.1 A finite rational peripheral map for the new action . . . 183
H.7.2 Explicit equations for an all-circle tree . . . 185
H.7.3 Scope of the geometric identification . . . 186

**I The geometric longitude of a tree of crossing circles 188**
I.1 The diagram and the longitude identity . . . 188
I.2 The local face maps . . . 190
I.2.1 The parameters and the actual faces . . . 190
I.2.2 The auxiliary longitude equations and the local gluing locus . . . 191
I.2.3 The wire coordinate is determined by the actual meridian . . . 192
I.2.4 The full disk-side seam, including its main punctures . . . 193
I.3 A regular character chart for the same piece . . . 193
I.3.1 A four-puncture character and its explicit matrices . . . 194
I.3.2 Auxiliary transport matrices with the actual source ratios . . . 195
I.3.3 The main commutator gives the source longitude factor . . . 196
I.3.4 Comparison with the explicit native pure block . . . 197
I.4 Ordered pages and the half-twist collar . . . 200
I.4.1 An arbitrary finite pure page tree . . . 200
I.4.2 Positive main meridians and their flags . . . 201
I.4.3 The reference map at a parabolic main meridian . . . 202
I.4.4 A regular matrix implementing the actual positive braid collar . . . 202
I.4.5 The full ordered boundary groups in the actual edge chart . . . 203
I.4.6 The opposite-eigenflag qualification . . . 204
I.4.7 Representation gluing followed by global decoration . . . 204
I.5 The complete anchor and the primitive filling equations . . . 205
I.5.1 Local rigidity on the retained augmented triangulation . . . 206
I.6 Boundary isotropy and the edge differential . . . 208
I.6.1 The edge equation and a closed differential . . . 208
I.6.2 The actual boundary pairing . . . 209
I.7 The constant field of the source equations . . . 210

I.7.1 Why the discrepancy is rational in the main meridian . . . 210
I.8 Regular reconstruction at every nonzero main value . . . 210
I.8.1 A uniform algebraic open set in every fiber . . . 210
I.8.2 The actual character matrices remain regular . . . 211
I.8.3 Sewing finitely many blocks uses a rational finite atlas . . . 213
I.8.4 The exceptional-looking main parameters . . . 214
I.8.5 A regular nonzero main eigenvalue ratio . . . 214
I.8.6 Local sections and the integral total family . . . 215
I.9 Determining the monomial and the preferred framing . . . 215
I.10 The determinant-one sign at the complete filled knot . . . 218
I.10.1 A frame calculation on a once-bordered surface . . . 218
I.10.2 Application to a complete hyperbolic knot cusp . . . 218
I.10.3 Compatibility with the original augmented representation . . . 219
I.10.4 Fixing a holomorphic squared longitude identity . . . 220
I.11 The geometric factor of an actual quantum recurrence . . . 220
I.11.1 The source hypotheses and the factor statement . . . 220
I.11.2 The exact reduced/full conversion . . . 221
I.11.3 All orders, shifted charts and the geometric branch . . . 222
I.11.4 The irreducible factor and its field of definition . . . 224

**J The geometric longitude for strict Conway trees 225**
J.1 The theorem and its geometric conventions . . . 225
J.2 The literal insertion . . . 226
J.3 A unique regular zero-power angular saddle . . . 228
J.4 Exact elimination of the angular action . . . 229
J.5 The actual added longitude in the old prism geometry . . . 230
J.6 What the edge equations see at the complete bare representation . . . 232
J.6.1 The marked zero-crossing collar . . . 232
J.7 Stationary elimination at a nonparabolic main meridian . . . 234
J.8 The geometric factor selected by the actual recurrence . . . 235
J.8.1 Proof and normalization . . . 236
J.9 Transfer to presentations with net twists and arbitrary closures . . . 237

**K Volume limits from the degree and twist at each circle 239**
K.1 The directed criterion . . . 240
K.2 An actual conditional kernel on a rectangle . . . 241
K.3 The exact recursion may be rooted anywhere . . . 243
K.4 The phase class and the variable envelopes . . . 244
K.5 Actual trace tails with the directed budgets . . . 245
K.6 Regenerating the outgoing real bound . . . 247
K.7 Original action, geometry, and scope . . . 247
K.8 A uniform twist corollary, with no degree sampling . . . 248
K.9 A star beyond both previous quantitative tests . . . 251
K.10 Reproducing the finite arithmetic and pairings . . . 252

**L Proof of balanced terminal decoration 253**
L.1 The theorem and its quantifiers . . . 253
L.2 A simple sphere supplies the actual metric . . . 254
L.2.1 A combinatorial starting hypothesis . . . 254
L.3 The original link and a knot parity . . . 256
L.3.1 From a matched sphere to an actual knot diagram . . . 256
L.4 The explicit two-sided fan construction . . . 256
L.4.1 Why any finite sequence of insertions remains convex . . . 256
L.4.2 Input and the local geometric operation . . . 257
L.4.3 Exact fan recurrence and even counts . . . 258
L.4.4 An exact integral for the source-normalized triangle action . . . 259
L.4.5 Strict balance at the retained crossing circle . . . 259
L.4.6 Every added crossing circle already balances . . . 260
L.5 The full finite source at both level parities . . . 260
L.5.1 The literal insertion . . . 260
L.5.2 Endpoint support and the new coefficient target . . . 261
L.5.3 The physical mark, measure and normals . . . 263
L.5.4 The original signed Fourier/Hermite period . . . 264
L.6 The calibrated complete action and all-central packet . . . 264
L.6.1 The central local packet and global spectral gap . . . 265
L.7 The finite first charge contributes . . . 267
L.7.1 Finite-N filling saddles for independent signed twists . . . 268
L.7.2 Deformation of the actual restricted real contour . . . 268
L.7.3 Relative asymptotic and its nonzero coefficient . . . 269
L.7.4 Enlargement to the finite local charge sector . . . 270
L.8 Every other Fourier charge is controlled . . . 271
L.8.1 Basic bounds, endpoint identities, and parameter choices . . . 271
L.8.2 The infinite far-charge union is exponentially small . . . 272
L.8.3 The finite charges outside the local scaled box . . . 273
L.8.4 Finite local charges and the actual unit contribution . . . 274
L.9 Restoring the full invariant under balance . . . 274
L.9.1 Every sector containing a one-sided crossing circle has a global spectral gap . . . 275
L.9.2 Entire original Fourier remainder and the full invariant . . . 276
L.10 The original primitive geometric action . . . 276
L.10.1 Primitive geometry on the refined Morse diagram . . . 276
L.11 Completing the actual filled metric . . . 278
L.11.1 The precise metric completion theorem used after filling . . . 278
L.12 Exact reproduction and limits . . . 279

**M All orders of the meridian profile under the directed criterion 280**
M.1 Fixed data and statement . . . 280
M.2 The strict margins that the higher-order proof uses . . . 281
M.3 The same margins on fixed translated charts . . . 282
M.3.1 The paired turn factors . . . 283
M.3.2 The actual fixed-power trace and its normal channels . . . 283

M.3.3 Grid translations, endpoint currents and tails . . . 284
M.4 Arbitrary-order edge and conditional saddle expansions . . . 284
M.5 All-order normalized message induction . . . 286
M.6 Why the coefficients have the required degree filtration . . . 287
M.7 The actual marked geometric germ for the new certificates . . . 288
M.7.1 The preferred-cusp first correction . . . 289
M.8 Consequence for every genuine all-level annihilator . . . 290
M.9 Proof dependencies and scope . . . 292

**N Uniform bounds for inserting twist powers 294**
N.1 The exact source and its normalization . . . 295
N.2 Why the polynomial reduction is well defined . . . 296
N.3 Repeated roots, the odd simple root, and the midpoint identity . . . 297
N.4 An elementary exact derivative inequality . . . 299
N.5 Full and vanishing-node bounds . . . 299
N.6 Shared polynomials and the unsplit complementary source . . . 300
N.7 What the norm theorem does and does not supply . . . 300
N.8 The estimate needed for long fillings . . . 301

**O The geometric contribution for matched spherical diagrams 303**
O.1 The geometric contribution and all Fourier charges . . . 303
O.1.1 Exact assumptions and statement . . . 303
O.1.2 The graph facts replacing a flat-plat assumption . . . 305
O.1.3 Local analytic inputs, including the odd normal . . . 306
O.1.4 The local asymptotic from the actual face torus . . . 307
O.1.5 The gap on the entire spectral cube . . . 308
O.1.6 The first packet, its phase, and charge comparison . . . 308
O.1.7 Whole-domain currents and every other charge . . . 310
O.1.8 The geometric interface and the precise remaining problem . . . 311
O.1.9 Proof dependencies and scope . . . 311
O.2 The original complement and its geometric contribution . . . 312
O.2.1 Precise diagram and filling scope . . . 313
O.2.2 Why the manifold and its complete anchor are the original ones . . . 314
O.2.3 The exact source and the phases which remain outside the action . . . 315
O.2.4 One marked circle pattern on the whole sphere . . . 316
O.2.5 Full group relations and the original primitive peripheral words . . . 317
O.2.6 Absolute action and the first-charge filling equations . . . 318
O.2.7 Completing the specified hyperbolic filling . . . 319
O.2.8 Analytic interface and the remaining full-source problem . . . 321
O.2.9 The nonzero asymptotic with its finite normalization . . . 321

**P Weak balance in the complete circle packing 324**
P.1 The unchanged diagram and the volume statement . . . 324
P.2 Triangle entropy, its Hessian, and the complete action . . . 325
P.3 Changing the common weights . . . 326
P.4 A quantitative criterion and the full complementary sum . . . 327

P.5 The original filling and the actual hyperbolic volume . . . . . 328

**Q Protected triangular sums of certified diagrams 331**
Q.1 The diagrams, local envelopes, and exact certificate hypothesis . . . . . 331
Q.2 The oriented protected triangular sum . . . . . 333
Q.3 The complete action and the original target correction . . . . . 334
Q.4 Every genuine sector at the merged crossing . . . . . 335
Q.5 The full finite source and the volume limit . . . . . 336
Q.6 Arbitrarily many blocks and weak balance as an input . . . . . 337
Q.7 Arbitrarily large certified marked diagrams outside weak balance . . . . . 338
Q.8 Scope and related constructions . . . . . 340
Q.9 Reproduction and formal scope . . . . . 340

**R Certified insertion at ordinary triangular boundaries 342**
R.1 The original source and the disk action . . . . . 343
R.2 Existence for every positive boundary triple . . . . . 344
R.3 Development and proof of the fixed-boundary identity . . . . . 345
R.4 Two zero boundary weights: coercivity, uniqueness and the limit . . . . . 346
R.5 Oriented sewing and exact target allocation . . . . . 347
R.6 From protected certificates to a full source estimate . . . . . 349
R.7 Original primitive fillings and the actual volume conclusion . . . . . 350
R.8 Explicit cores with arbitrarily thin ordinary faces . . . . . 351
R.8.1 Separation from protected sums and weak balance . . . . . 353
R.8.2 A fully specified infinite sequence . . . . . 354
R.9 What is used from the earlier volume theorems . . . . . 355

# Chapter 1

# The knots, the theorems, and their proofs

## 1.1 What the theorem compares

The volume conjecture asks whether the growth of a sequence of finite knot invariants recovers hyperbolic volume. For each integer $N \geq 2$, set $q_N = e^{\pi \mathrm{i}/N}$. Write $\langle K \rangle_N$ for the reduced Kashaev invariant of a knot $K$ at this level, normalized to equal one on the unknot. For a hyperbolic knot, the complement carries a complete finite-volume hyperbolic metric. The proposed comparison is

$$\frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\langle K \rangle_N| \longrightarrow \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K).$$

Chapter 2 specifies its crossing matrices, traces and framing convention. Kashaev constructed the triangulated-link invariant in [7], gave its $R$-matrix formulation in [8], and proposed the volume comparison in [9]. Its relation with the root-of-unity colored Jones polynomial is described in [13].

The first theorem proves this limit for the recursive family of knot diagrams constructed below, once every designated twist region has sufficiently many twists. The family permits arbitrary finite branching and nesting, subject to its precise construction rule. Chapters 9, 10 and 11 treat ordered trees with one crossing-circle operator at every junction. They give explicit sufficient conditions involving degrees and signed crossing powers, both summed over vertices and imposed locally. The strongest simple local bound allows each vertex to have either sufficiently large degree or sufficiently many twists. We first explain the geometric operations and then state the construction scopes. Every construction records an actual diagram, including the order of its pieces and the positions where they are joined.

All these theorems take the same quantum limit. Choose a finite construction and signed integer twist numbers satisfying the applicable hypothesis, and hold them fixed. Then let $N$ tend to infinity. Neither the diagram nor its twist numbers grow with $N$. In the first theorem the individual twists can have different signs and arbitrarily different large magnitudes. In the quantitative theorems their sizes and junction degrees enter the sum in Theorem 9.1, the maximum in Theorem 10.1, or the directed conditions in Theorem 11.1.

## 1.2 The statements proved in this manuscript

The paper contains completed arguments, including results whose conclusion is weaker than the volume conjecture for a general knot. Each result retains its own construction and hypotheses. The following distinctions are useful when reading the later chapters.

| Result | Conclusion and restriction | Proof location |
|---|---|---|
| Recursive tangle construction | The full invariant has the knot-volume limit for the stated grammar and sufficiently long fixed signed twists. | Chapters 2–8; Appendices A–D. |
| Ordered circle trees | The full invariant has the volume limit under the stated summed, local, or directed degree-and-twist condition. | Chapters 9–11; Appendices E–G and K. |
| Decorated planar diagrams | The full invariant has the volume limit after the specified finite decoration and sufficiently long fillings of all original and added circles. The decoration can change the knot. | Chapter 13; Appendix L. |
| Unchanged diagrams under weak balance | The full invariant has the volume limit if the complete packing satisfies the explicit non-strict inequalities. A quantified variant allows small defects. | Appendix P. |
| Protected triangular sums | A finite assembly of diagrams with certificates covering all locally allowed noncentral sectors has the full volume limit after sufficiently long fixed fillings. | Appendix Q. |
| Ordinary triangular insertions | Certified pieces may be inserted at ordinary faces whose two smaller boundary weights are sufficiently small at all chosen core witnesses. Explicit cores meet this condition for any fixed finite list of pieces. | Appendix R. |
| Preferred longitude and recurrence | For the covered strict-tree and circle-tree classes, the preferred-longitude identity and full meridian expansion force one geometric factor in any existing all-level annihilator. No recurrence-ideal equality is asserted. | Chapter 12; Appendices H–J and M. |
| Finite filling functionals | A level-independent norm bound for inserting each fixed twist power. This is a finite estimate, not a source-volume theorem. | Appendix N. |
| Undecorated matched spheres | The specified geometric contribution has a nonzero asymptotic with the actual filled volume. No general estimate for its complementary contribution is asserted. | Appendix O. |

The finite filling estimate and the geometric-contribution theorem are included for their stated conclusions. They are not used as substitutes for the full-source estimates in the knot-volume theorems. Exploratory transport constructions, unsuccessful face assignments, and unresolved general comparisons are kept in the illustrated research guide. Finite computations supplement the arguments or verify the explicitly stated rational certificates; a numerical agreement is never used as a proof of a limit.

## 1.3 A planar construction beyond tangle trees

Chapter 13 starts from a finite simple triangulation of the sphere with at least four vertices. Pair adjacent triangles so that every triangle belongs to exactly one pair; equivalently choose a perfect matching in the cubic dual graph. The paired triangles specify crossing-circle boxes, and the remaining edges specify their strand connections. This constructs an augmented link in the three-sphere with its actual disk framings. The proof also gives a half-twist pattern for which the main strands form a knot.

The construction adds an even number of terminal tangles on each side of each original crossing circle. Every added tangle has odd crossing parity. The required numbers are chosen by an explicit recurrence in the complete packing curvatures: the curvature of a finite packing circle is the reciprocal of its radius, while the two protected lines have curvature zero. After these finitely many additions, all original and added twist regions may be filled independently with sufficiently long signed powers. The resulting knot is hyperbolic and has the volume limit above. The threshold depends on the fixed decorated diagram. No tree decomposition, common sign, or comparison of twist magnitudes is required.

The added tangles preserve the chosen endpoint pairing but generally change the knot type. Thus this result constructs new covered knots from arbitrary cores in the stated combinatorial class; it does not assert the equality for the unchanged core. Its proof controls the full finite coefficient and all Fourier charges. Appendix L includes the circle-packing construction, the exact source after insertion, the nonzero leading contribution, and the primitive metric completion. The earlier chapters develop the tree methods and their explicit bounds separately.

## 1.4 When no added tangles are needed

The decoration theorem constructs diagrams satisfying a useful packing condition. Appendix P instead starts with the unchanged matched sphere and assumes that condition in its non-strict form. At each matching edge, the sum of the two adjacent triangle potentials must be at least the logarithm of either positive opposite curvature. The appendix defines the potential by a maximization over three nonnegative angles, gives its explicit derivatives, and states the inequalities before proving the volume conclusion.

Equality in these inequalities is allowed. To handle it, the proof changes the positive weights used in Cauchy's coefficient estimate from $w_f$ to $w_f^{1-t}$, for a small fixed $t > 0$. The protected weights remain zero. The loss in every noncentral contribution is linear in $t$, with a positive coefficient given by a triangle entropy. The complete action is stationary, so its increase is at most a constant times $t^2$. A sufficiently small $t$ therefore produces a strict exponential gap for the entire complementary polynomial. The finite filling estimate and the geometric-contribution theorem then give the full invariant and the volume of the original knot complement.

This is a sufficient condition on an unchanged diagram of arbitrary finite size. The proof neither assumes a tree decomposition nor claims that every packing satisfies the condition. In particular, the theorem must be used with its packing hypothesis; the general geometric-contribution theorem by itself has the smaller conclusion recorded in the table above.

## 1.5 Joining diagrams whose source estimates are known

Appendix Q gives a different way to construct covered diagrams. Each input has a strict shared-weight certificate for every locally allowed noncentral source sector. Remove one triangle incident to its protected edge from each of two input spheres, identify the triangular boundaries with opposite orientations, and pair the two former partners. The result is another matched sphere. The proof preserves the source gap by comparing the three local sectors and accounting for the single ordinary target at the joining face.

Any fixed finite number of such pieces may be joined. Their own knot-producing half-twist pattern and sufficiently long fixed signed fillings give the volume limit for the assembled knot complement. A worked sequence starts from a seventeen-region rational certificate and attaches tetrahedral pieces. After $r$ attachments it has $17 + r$ crossing regions and still fails weak balance at the retained mark. The coefficient estimates nevertheless remain strict. This is a construction from certified inputs, not an assertion that every possible tangle composition has such a certificate.

Appendix R permits attachment at an ordinary triangular face, away from the protected edge. Write $(u, v, b)$ for its three positive circle curvatures. A certified piece can be inserted when $u/b$ and $v/b$ are sufficiently small at the complete core vector and at each coefficient witness used by the core. The proof first minimizes the inserted disk's action with these three weights fixed. The result is the old triangle potential plus the piece's protected complete action. For the remaining terms, a comparison using the entire inserted piece preserves the strict gap and accounts for each old boundary target once.

Even chains inside an octahedral face have an explicit curvature recurrence making both boundary ratios tend to zero. They provide cores for any prescribed finite list of certified pieces. All final crossing powers are then chosen sufficiently long and held fixed before taking the quantum limit. This construction includes marked diagrams with a balance failure which are not nontrivial protected triangular sums at their recorded mark. It does not classify all presentations of the resulting knots.

## 1.6 Building the diagrams from four-ended tangles

A *two-string tangle* is a pair of arcs in a ball whose four endpoints are fixed on its boundary. We draw its ball as a box, with two endpoints at the bottom and two at the top. Closed curves may also be present inside a box. In the augmented diagrams used in the proof, some of those curves are distinguished auxiliary circles. Composition can create further closed main components, so the eventual requirement that the filled diagram be a knot must be checked rather than assumed.

Label the boundary points in their cyclic order by

$$0 = \text{bottom left}, \quad 1 = \text{bottom right}, \quad 2 = \text{top right}, \quad 3 = \text{top left}.$$

We use three operations, all performed on the drawn tangles with these boundary positions retained.

**Vertical stacking.** Place a box $F$ below a box $G$. Join the two top endpoints of $F$ to the two bottom endpoints of $G$ by short, uncrossed arcs: $F_2$ joins $G_1$ and $F_3$ joins $G_0$. Denote

the resulting box by $FG$. Its exposed endpoints, in the order just defined, are $(F_0, F_1, G_2, G_3)$. Changing parentheses only changes the heights of boxes; it does not interchange their order.

**Quarter-turn.** Rotate the entire box clockwise through 90 degrees in the diagram plane, carrying every strand and auxiliary circle with it. Write $\mathsf{T}F$ for the result. In terms of the old endpoints, its new ordered boundary is $(F_1, F_2, F_3, F_0)$. The algebraic evaluation implements this operation with the ordinary cup and cap matrices. It is not an arbitrary permutation of matrix entries.

**Cylindrical closure.** Join the exposed bottom-left endpoint to the top-left endpoint outside the box, and do the same on the right, without adding crossings. Write $C(F)$ for this closed diagram. Thus the closing pairs are 0–3 and 1–2. In $C(FG)$ the two connections between $F$ and $G$ and the two exterior return arcs are all part of the definition. This closure differs from joining the two top endpoints together and the two bottom endpoints together, which we call a *cap closure*.

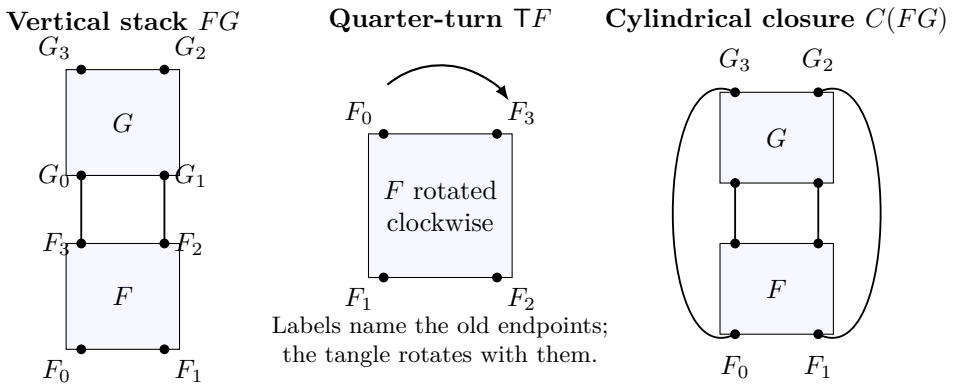



Figure 1.1: The actual connections defining the construction. Each box contains an arbitrary tangle; its interior is suppressed so that the boundary order is visible. The quarter-turn carries the tangle with the box. The exterior arcs in the last panel are the cylindrical closure.

The elementary augmented box has two through strands and a small auxiliary circle surrounding them. The circle bounds a disk pierced once by each strand; this disk fixes the framing used for surgery. Denote the box by $L$, and denote its quarter-turn by $h = \mathsf{T}L$. Every occurrence of $h$ in a construction is a separate copy with its own auxiliary circle. We call such an occurrence an *elementary piece*; later, when discussing its position in a construction tree, we also call it a *leaf*.

To obtain the final knot, replace each auxiliary circle by twists of the strands passing through its disk. Let $R$ be one positive half twist of the two through strands; $R^{-1}$ is the negative crossing. An integer power $R^n$ is a stack of $|n|$ such crossings with the indicated sign. At elementary piece $\ell$ we retain $\varepsilon_\ell \in \{0, 1, -1\}$ half twists and perform the disk-framed integral filling with parameter $p_\ell$. The filled piece is exactly

$$\mathsf{T}(R^{\varepsilon_\ell - 2p_\ell}). \tag{1.1}$$

A full twist contains two crossings, which accounts for the factor two. This formula fixes the sign convention for $p_\ell$ throughout the proof. After every auxiliary circle is filled, the remaining closed diagram has no auxiliary components. The main component is never filled; its complement is the manifold whose volume occurs in the theorem.

## 1.7 Which compositions are included

Start by stacking two elementary pieces. From an already constructed box, one may take a quarter-turn, stack it with another already constructed box, or attach one new elementary piece at its bottom or top. Repeat these operations any finite number of times. We call a box obtained in this way *completed*. This is a name for the construction rule, not an assertion that a hyperbolic metric has already been constructed. In particular, a single elementary piece is not completed.

**Definition 1.1** (The recursive construction class)**.** The symbol $E$ ranges over the completed boxes just described. Their concise recursive description is

$$E ::= hh \;\mid\; \mathsf{T}(E) \;\mid\; E_1E_2 \;\mid\; hE \;\mid\; Eh. \tag{1.2}$$

Here ::= means "can be built by one of the following operations," and the vertical bars separate the alternatives. Each written $h$ denotes a distinct elementary piece. A closed diagram in the main theorem is $C(FG)$ with both $F$ and $G$ completed. Retain the original order of all endpoints, the crossing-disk framings, and one marked point on the main component for evaluating the reduced invariant.

For example, $C((hh)(hh))$ uses four elementary pieces, with two in each of the final boxes. A longer allowed construction is $C((h\mathsf{T}(hh))(hh))$: first build the two-piece box $hh$, turn it, attach one elementary piece, and close it against another two-piece box. Repeating $E_{r+1} = h\mathsf{T}(E_r)$ from $E_0 = hh$ gives arbitrarily long nested constructions. Branching is equally allowed, since any two completed boxes can be stacked. Starting instead with any stack $h^s$, $s \geq 2$, gives the same class.

The last condition in Definition 1.1 is important: both boxes joined by the final cylindrical closure must be completed. The proof uses it to place every stationary leaf parameter strictly above $1/4$, as shown in Lemma 3.5. Chapters 2–8 retain this condition. The different class in Chapter 9 has its own finite-source estimates and geometric completion; it is not inserted into this recursive proof by changing the meaning of "completed."

The filled elementary pieces in (1.1) are rational tangles; see [10] for their classification and fraction conventions. Our endpoint and crossing conventions are fixed above. Ordered stacking and quarter-turns of rational tangles produce Conway algebraic, or arborescent, links. Thus the construction gives a specified family within that class; it is not a classification of all arborescent knots. The choice of $\varepsilon$ must make the final diagram one component and create no closed main component inside a box. Section 4.7 gives a finite endpoint-pairing test and proves that a suitable choice exists for every allowed construction. Changing $p_\ell$ adds full twists and therefore does not change this component test.

## 1.8 The long-twist theorem

**Theorem 1.2** (Long-twist volume limit)**.** *Fix a finite expression $C(FG)$ as in Definition 1.1 and a half-twist pattern $\varepsilon$ giving a knot. There is a finite number $P(F,G,\varepsilon)$ such that, for every independently chosen tuple of signed integers $\mathbf{p}=(p_\ell)$ with $|p_\ell|>P(F,G,\varepsilon)$, the resulting knot $K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})$ is hyperbolic and*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty}\frac{2\pi}{N}\log\left|\langle K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})\rangle_N\right|=\mathrm{Vol}\big(S^3\setminus K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})\big). \tag{1.3}$$

*The level tends to infinity through all integers, including even and composite levels. The expression, signs and twists are fixed before that limit. The threshold depends on the fixed expression and sign pattern, but not on a comparison between the magnitudes or signs of the individual sufficiently long twists.*

In concrete terms, one first chooses the entire finite arrangement of boxes and the parity of the crossings in each elementary piece. The theorem then supplies one threshold for that arrangement. Each filling integer may independently be positive or negative and exceed that threshold in absolute value. No ratio between different filling integers is bounded. Once these integers have been chosen, the conclusion concerns the single resulting knot and the sequence of its invariants as $N$ grows.

The reduced invariant $\langle\cdot\rangle_N$ has unknot value one. Chapter 2 also compares it with the full modified one-cut normalization: that normalization adds the single factor $\mathrm{i}^{N+3}/N$ and a unit framing character, so the exponential limit is unchanged. This factor belongs only to the marked main component. The auxiliary circles are evaluated by ordinary traces.

The isolated closures $C(h^s)$, $s\geq 3$, form a separate inherited family; Section 6.4 works out $C(h^3)$ explicitly. The isolated $C(hh)$ is excluded from this proof: its pure complete-color source vanishes at even levels, and its odd-level support lies on a flat boundary. This is a statement about that source, not about the invariant of a filled knot. General closures with a single elementary piece on one side, such as $C(hE)$, are also outside Theorem 1.2. For instance, $C(h\mathsf{T}(h^s))$ places the inner complete leaf parameters at $1/4$, outside the interval used in the first proof. Such a circle-tree presentation can instead fall under Theorem 9.1 when its explicit degree and twist condition holds. The exclusions in this paragraph concern Theorem 1.2.

## 1.9 An explicit criterion for circle trees

The second construction uses the same actual stacking, quarter-turn and closing operations. At each vertex of a finite ordered tree with at least one edge put one crossing box with signed power $n_v$; its augmented version retains that box's crossing circle. Each tree edge is a quarter-turn of a child tangle. There are no unmarked product junctions, and terminal crossing circles are vertices of degree one. The cyclic order and the position of the crossing box among its children remain part of the diagram. Section 9.1 gives the full recursion.

If $d_v$ is the degree of vertex $v$, Theorem 9.1 proves hyperbolicity and the same volume limit under the explicit condition

$$\sum_v\frac{d_v}{d_v^2+n_v^2}\leq 2^{-25},$$

provided the original endpoint pairing gives a knot. The angle feasibility required by the proof is automatic for this literal tree construction. Every $|n_v| \geq 8192\sqrt{E}$ suffices when the tree has $E$ edges, but individual powers may be short or zero at vertices of sufficiently large degree. Adding an identity braid at an unmarked junction also gives an application when the sum bound holds; its added crossing circle contributes $1/d_v$, rather than zero.

The quantitative theorem uses a direct cut of the actual augmented exterior into two octahedra per tree edge. Its positive geometric path keeps track of the original primitive slopes even when their accumulated logarithms are not small. The finite invariant has a uniform main-meridian profile, with its exact scalar retained; the first correction is the preferred cusp shape of the resulting knot complement. The size of the tree and every crossing power remain fixed as $N$ grows.

Theorem 10.1 gives another sufficient condition for this same literal class:

$$\max_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \leq 2^{-120}.$$

Its proof evaluates each subtree as a polynomial in its remaining boundary variable and normalizes that polynomial by its exact value at zero. The next trace spends only the change of action at its current vertex. This gives a numerical bound independent of the number of vertices, although error constants and starting levels may depend on the fixed diagram. The separate geometric condition $\sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \geq 630$ constructs the positive metric without either quantum condition; it alone does not assert a volume limit.

Chapter 11 strengthens the local argument. Theorem 11.1 proves the volume identity if $d_v \geq 2^{28}$ or $|n_v| \geq 2^{27}$ at each vertex, with the alternative chosen independently at each vertex. Its full criterion uses a separate decay constant for each outgoing subtree polynomial and places no outgoing requirement on the vertex evaluated last. This also constructs knots with arbitrary fixed short-twist cores by adding even stacks of long terminal pieces. The additions preserve the knot-component test but generally change the knot.

## 1.10 The preferred longitude and the classical recurrence

For the covered strict Conway constructions, Chapter 12 identifies more than the volume and cusp shape. It constructs the deformation of the original knot representation as the main meridian eigenvalue $M$ varies, and proves an explicit formula for the preferred longitude $L$. The original order of the tangles and the changes of puncture paths under each half twist are retained in this construction.

The proof separates two issues. The boundary pairing determines the longitude up to a function of $M$. An algebraic argument then shows that this function is rational, and regular representations over every nonzero value of $M$ exclude all zeros and poles. The remaining monomial is fixed by the preferred framing; a Seifert surface fixes the determinant-one sign at the complete cusp.

Appendix H uses the full asymptotic expansion of the actual invariant to constrain a quantum recurrence. Here an *all-level annihilator* is a fixed nonzero operator

$$P(q, M, T) = \sum_{j=0}^{r} a_j(q, M) T^j, \qquad a_j \in \mathbb{C}(q, M), \qquad (TF)(M) = F(qM),$$

which annihilates the actual zero-framed reduced state at every sufficiently large level $q = q_N$. After clearing denominators and removing the common order of vanishing at $q = 1$, its first nonzero specialization is the *classical symbol*, with the shift $T$ replaced by a commuting longitude variable. The theorem assumes such an annihilator; it does not construct one.

Combining the source expansion with the preferred-longitude identity shows that this symbol is divisible by the irreducible factor of the selected geometric meridian–longitude curve. The selected curve is the component containing the oriented discrete-faithful knot representation, with the preferred longitude lift fixed in Chapter 12. Appendix I gives the circle-tree representation and algebraic proofs. Appendix J treats unmarked product junctions and transfers the intrinsic result through the stated net-twist and closure reductions. Chapter 14 and Appendix M supply the required expansion for every directed certificate. The result identifies one factor, not the entire A-polynomial or recurrence ideal, and it does not extend the volume limits to arbitrary short twists.

## 1.11 A guide to the proof and its terminology

The long-twist proof first studies the augmented diagram, in which the auxiliary circles are still present, and then performs their fillings by an exact finite identity. A *color* is the integer label specifying the representation assigned to an auxiliary circle. At level $N$ these labels range from 1 to $N$. Before filling, the evaluation therefore depends on a tuple of colors. We call this finite, color-dependent evaluation the *source*. The *complete-color source* means that every auxiliary color equals $N$; the term is distinct from completeness of a hyperbolic metric.

The algebra used to calculate a source has repeated roots. At a double root, both a polynomial's value and its derivative matter. We refer to the derivative data as the *first normal data*, in the elementary algebraic sense of the coefficient of $z - c$ modulo $(z - c)^2$. Keeping these data is essential at both parities of $N$.

Expanding each elementary piece in a polynomial basis gives a finite sum. An admissible assignment of integer indices to that sum is a *state*. An internal *wire* is an index shared by two factors; it is not an additional physical strand. A *product gate* is the coefficient for one stacking operation with two input indices and one output index. After scaling indices by $N$, these coefficients have exponential growth described by a real function, the *action*. A state is *strict* when all its nonforced angle inequalities are strict. The maximizer of the complete-color action determines explicit ideal hyperbolic cells. The cells have quadrilateral faces along which they are glued. The order of the four vertices specifies the face map; Chapter 4 explains how these auxiliary gluing faces reconstruct the actual closed link diagram.

For colors other than $N$, the exact elementary evaluation splits into a principal part and a signed complementary part. We call them the *core* and the *alias*; the identities defining them appear in (2.17)–(2.18). Chapter 5 proves that every term containing an alias is exponentially smaller than the leading complete action, even after arbitrary allowed composition. This is where the finite rational certificates enter the proof.

Near the remaining strict maximum, the finite sum has a holomorphic asymptotic of the form $N^{3/2}a(\chi)e^{N\Phi(\chi)}$, with $a$ nonzero. We call this local analytic contribution the *packet*. The word includes a specified finite sum and a controlled error; it does not mean a formal stationary-phase expression. The complex color parameters $\chi$ are also the parameters of a marked deformation of the augmented hyperbolic structure. Identifying their peripheral

holonomies fixes the absolute volume, not just its differential.

Finally, the filling identity sums the source over all colors with oscillatory coefficients. We analyze the whole sum, including the boundary integrals created when contours move and every integer Fourier mode. These modes are called *charges*. The leading charges add without cancellation, and their critical action equals the volume after filling. This last step is necessary because that volume is smaller than the complete augmented volume; an estimate obtained by taking absolute values of the filling coefficients would not recover it.

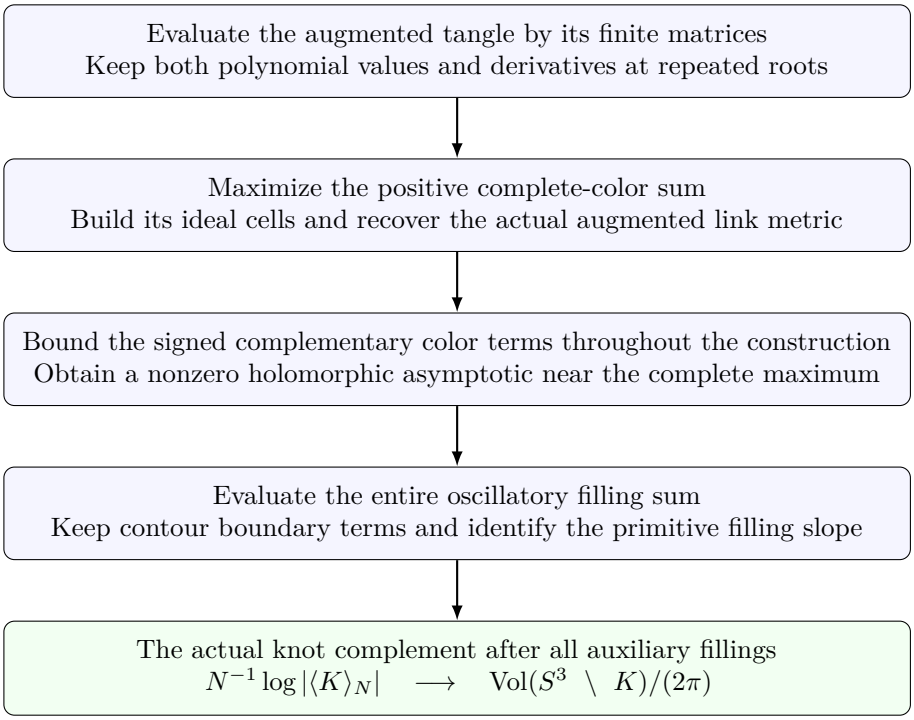



Figure 1.2: The four comparisons in the proof. The last comparison analyzes the full oscillatory filling sum and identifies its critical action with the volume of the resulting knot complement.

## 1.12 Background and the arguments used here

The variational geometry belongs to the Casson–Rivin approach. Rivin's volume methods appear in [16]; the precise critical-point criterion for positive angle structures on an orientable ideal triangulation with torus boundary is stated in [4, Theorem 1.2]. In this paper the actual cells, face maps, peripheral curves, and end completion are constructed. Concavity alone is not used to identify a manifold or to prove noncancellation in a signed quantum sum.

The peripheral volume potential and its logarithmic conventions have their standard setting in [15]. Extended logarithmic regulator data are developed in [14]. Our comparison retains the primitive curves and fixes the additive constant at the complete structure. The metric arguments in the appendices identify the resulting volume with that of the original filled complement.

The classical peripheral eigenvalue curve is defined in [3]. Recurrence existence is a distinct

question: multisum elimination has the general background [18], colored-Jones q-holonomicity is treated in [5], and the ADO family in [2]. The latter comparison keeps a framing and variable substitution. The recurrence statements here retain the specified state, initial data, and singular-step derivatives. The selected-factor conclusion follows from the full source expansion and its geometric longitude; no equality of complete recurrence ideals is imported from these references.

Local Gaussian and stationary-phase estimates have standard analytic background [6]. The arguments below additionally specify the original finite lattice and measure, deform the actual contours with their boundary terms, and control every Fourier charge. These are the source-specific steps needed to turn a local critical point into the asymptotic of the original invariant. The references provide context and precise antecedents; the displayed estimates and geometric identifications used in the theorems are proved in the chapters and appendices indicated above.

## 1.13 Conventions and verification

All logarithms on a positive real interval are real. Complex logarithms and square roots continue those values on the explicitly chosen neighborhoods. We use $\operatorname{arccot} X \in (0, \pi)$ for real $X$ and $\mathrm{i}^2 = -1$. Constants may depend on the fixed construction, its selected strict stationary point and a fixed analytic neighborhood, but not on $N$. A polynomial factor means a bound by $N^C$ with such a fixed exponent.

The appendices give the finite identities and detailed analytic estimates for the long-twist argument. Chapter 9 states the summed quantitative theorem; Appendices E and F give its complete finite-sum, ordered-cut and geometric completion proofs. The local and directed extensions are proved in Appendices G and K. The certificate files contain rational candidate points and exact domain subdivisions; the verifier proves their supporting inequalities using outward rational bounds. Numerical optimization is not part of verification. Chapter 15 explains which claims are analytic proofs, which depend on these finite certificates, and which are merely checked by optional experiments.

# Chapter 2

# Evaluating the invariant in a finite polynomial algebra

We now turn the tangle operations of Chapter 1 into finite matrix calculations. A strand carries a finite-dimensional vector space, a crossing acts on the two corresponding factors, and joining endpoints means contracting the appropriate indices. Closing an auxiliary circle takes a trace. Leaving one marked main strand open until the final contraction gives the reduced normalization.

The purpose of the polynomial algebra introduced below is to make these contractions compositional. Every two-strand operator that occurs here is a polynomial in one matrix, the pair Casimir $\Omega$. Stacking becomes multiplication of polynomials, while the quarter-turn has a particularly simple action in the Newton basis. The last section then expresses an arbitrary filling power in the basis of colored auxiliary-circle operators. All of these statements are finite identities at each level; asymptotics begin only in Chapter 3.

## 2.1 Crossings and the one-cut normalization

Fix $N \geq 2$, and set

$$d = N - 1, \qquad q = e^{\pi \mathrm{i}/N}, \qquad Q = q^2, \qquad x = q^d, \qquad \kappa = q^{d^2/2}, \qquad \rho = q - q^{-1}. \tag{2.1}$$

There is no restriction to prime or odd $N$. The main strands carry the $N$-dimensional vector space $V_N$; this is what "complete color" means at this stage. The operators $H, K, E, F$ encode its quantum-group action. They are concrete matrices, which we specify so that the crossing convention can be checked. One convenient choice of basis is $v_0, \dots, v_d$ and

$$Hv_j = (d - 2j)v_j, \quad K = q^H, \quad Ev_j = [j]_q^2 v_{j-1}, \quad Fv_j = v_{j+1}, \qquad [j]_q = \frac{q^j - q^{-j}}{q - q^{-1}}.$$

Missing endpoint vectors are zero. For $k \geq 0$, the quantum factorial is $[k]_q! = \prod_{r=1}^{k} [r]_q$, with $[0]_q! = 1$. The finite universal crossing, including its Cartan factor, is

$$\mathscr{R} = q^{H \otimes H/2} \sum_{k=0}^{d} \frac{q^{k(k-1)/2} \rho^k}{[k]_q!} E^k \otimes F^k. \tag{2.2}$$

Every denominator is nonzero. The physical braided crossing is obtained with the fixed exchange and transpose convention; the inverse is the actual matrix inverse. The framing and enhancement are part of the definition, not an unspecified factor appended to an asymptotic formula.

For calculations in the polynomial algebra it is useful to change basis on this same space. We call the new coordinates balanced; they do not define a different invariant. In this basis the operators are

$$\mathcal{E}|a\rangle = (Q^{-a} - 1)|a-1\rangle, \quad \mathcal{F}|a\rangle = (1 - Q^{a+1})|a+1\rangle, \quad K|a\rangle = xQ^{-a}|a\rangle. \tag{2.3}$$

The ordinary cup and cap, and the one marked cap, have entries

$$p_{ab} = Nx^{-b}\delta_{a+b,d}, \qquad \ell_{ab} = \frac{x^a}{N}\delta_{a+b,d}, \qquad m_{ab} = \frac{x^b}{N^2}. \tag{2.4}$$

The cup creates two endpoints and the cap joins them. Their two snake identities say that a bend followed by the opposite bend evaluates to a straight strand. The different marked cap implements the reduced invariant and satisfies $mp = 1$. The diagonal operator $g = K^{1-N} = (-1)^d K$ is the *pivot*, the correction inserted when an ordinary strand is closed by a trace. For a two-strand operator $A$ commuting with the pair quantum-group action, the original cylindrical evaluation is

$$\phi(A) = \frac{1}{N}\,\mathrm{Tr}_{V_N \otimes V_N}\big[(I \otimes g)A\big]. \tag{2.5}$$

The factor $1/N$ in this expression is the single cut average. It is not repeated at the auxiliary circles.

**Proposition 2.1** (Normalization)**.** *Let $A_{\mathrm{raw}}$ be the scalar obtained from the original crossings, turns, ordinary auxiliary traces and the single mark. In the enhanced reduced Kashaev convention,*

$$|\langle L\rangle_N| = |A_{\mathrm{raw}}(L)|.$$

*In the full modified one-cut convention the modulus is $N^{-1}|A_{\mathrm{raw}}(L)|$. The changes of recorded component framing contribute only unit phases at the complete color.*

*Proof.* The exact Fourier comparison is recorded in Appendix A.1. It is a simultaneous similarity of every adjacent braid generator and its inverse, together with an exact equality of enhancements. The factorial changes of basis cancel on every internal or traced wire. On the one remaining head the partial trace is scalar: it commutes with $E, F, K$, whose distinct weights and nonzero adjacent coefficients force scalarity. Hence the open-factor similarity cancels as well.

For clarity, the complete modified dimension is evaluated as a whole meridian germ. With the original meridian $M = -qq^{\alpha} = e^{u}$,

$$d_N(\alpha) = -q^{N(1-N)/2}\frac{q^{\alpha+1} - q^{-\alpha-1}}{q^{N\alpha} - q^{-N\alpha}} = \mathrm{i}^{N+3}\frac{\sinh u}{\sinh Nu}.$$

Its removable value at $u = 0$ is $\mathrm{i}^{N+3}/N$. Exactly one component receives this factor. The twist at completeness is $q^{-d^2/2} = \kappa^{-1}$, of modulus one. These facts prove the asserted absolute normalization without estimating any large change-of-basis matrix. □

## 2.2 The full pair algebra

An operator on two strands must commute with the joint action of the quantum-group generators if it is to represent one of our invariant tangle boxes. The formulas below specify that joint action. The subsequent lemma identifies all such commuting operators; this is the meaning of the term *commutant*. The balanced pair generators and Casimir are

$$\mathcal{E}_{12} = \mathcal{E}_1 K_2 + \mathcal{E}_2, \quad \mathcal{F}_{12} = \mathcal{F}_1 + K_1^{-1}\mathcal{F}_2, \quad K_{12} = K_1 K_2, \quad \Omega = \mathcal{F}_{12}\mathcal{E}_{12} + qK_{12} + q^{-1}K_{12}^{-1}. \tag{2.6}$$

Let $\mathsf{C}_n(z) = 2T_n(z/2)$, where $T_n$ is the usual Chebyshev polynomial. Thus $\mathsf{C}_0 = 2$, $\mathsf{C}_1 = z$ and $\mathsf{C}_{n+1} = z\mathsf{C}_n - \mathsf{C}_{n-1}$. Define

$$P_N(z) = \mathsf{C}_N(z) + 2 = \prod_{j=0}^{d}(z - c_j), \qquad c_j = q^{2j+1} + q^{-2j-1}, \qquad \mathcal{H}_N = \mathbb{C}[z]/(P_N). \tag{2.7}$$

The list of roots includes multiplicity. Since $c_{d-j} = c_j$, all distinct roots are double except the simple root $-2$ at odd $N$.

**Lemma 2.2** (Full commutant)**.** *The endomorphisms of $V_N \otimes V_N$ commuting with the three pair generators are exactly $\mathbb{C}[\Omega] \simeq \mathcal{H}_N$.*

*Proof.* Let $W_T$ be the span of $|a, T - a\rangle$. The $K_{12}$ eigenvalue one occurs only on $W_d$. The matrices $\mathcal{E}_{12} : W_{T+1} \to W_T$ for $T < d$, and $\mathcal{F}_{12} : W_T \to W_{T+1}$ for $T \geq d$, have triangular maximal minors with nonzero diagonals. Consequently the entire pair is generated from $W_d$ by these raising and lowering operators.

On $W_d$, the Casimir is a symmetric tridiagonal matrix with adjacent entries $-(1-Q^{a+1})^2 \neq 0$. Its first basis vector is cyclic: the $k$th power has last possible coordinate $k$, with coefficient equal to the nonzero product of the first $k$ adjacent entries. An operator commuting with this block is therefore a unique polynomial of degree below $N$ in that block. Subtracting the same polynomial in $\Omega$ from a pair intertwiner gives zero on $W_d$, hence zero everywhere by generation.

The elementary quantum-shift product gives $P_N(\Omega) = 0$. The cyclic block has minimal polynomial of degree $N$; its continuant, or the generic highest-weight decomposition followed by regular specialization, gives precisely (2.7). This proves the claim with all first normal directions intact. □

At a double root $c$, reduction modulo $(z - c)^2$ leaves

$$f(z) = f(c) + f'(c)(z - c) \pmod{(z - c)^2}.$$

Thus both the value and its first derivative are independent coordinates of the operator. Throughout the paper, retaining the "full algebra" or the "normal data" means retaining this derivative as well. A polynomial can vanish at every distinct root and still define a nonzero operator in $\mathcal{H}_N$. Evaluating only at roots would therefore lose part of the invariant.

## 2.3 The actual turn and the Newton basis

We choose a polynomial basis adapted to successive Casimir roots, including their multiplicities. Its normalization is designed so that turning a physical box reverses the basis index exactly.

The same basis makes the final closure a coefficient extraction. These are the two facts that will allow us to follow every internal summation index through a large construction. Put

$$s_r = \prod_{u=1}^{r} 2\sin\frac{\pi u}{N}, \quad s_0 = 1, \qquad B_r(z) = \prod_{j=0}^{r-1}(c_j - z), \qquad \widehat{B}_r(z) = \frac{B_r(z)}{s_r^2}, \quad 0 \le r \le d. \tag{2.8}$$

The quarter-turn is the literal contraction

$$\mathsf{T}(A) = (I^{\otimes 2} \otimes \ell)(I \otimes A \otimes I)(p \otimes I^{\otimes 2}).$$

Its entries in the recorded all-primal chart are

$$\mathsf{T}(A)_{(a,b);(c,e)} = x^{a-e} A_{(b,d-e);(d-a,c)}.$$

The cups and caps are those of (2.4). A different source-normalized rotation can carry an additional power of $x$; throughout this manuscript $\mathsf{T}$ is the unscaled genuine turn.

**Proposition 2.3** (Newton turn and closure)**.** *In the full algebra,*

$$\mathsf{T}\widehat{B}_r = \widehat{B}_{d-r}, \qquad \phi\left(\sum_{r=0}^{d} \alpha_r \widehat{B}_r\right) = \alpha_d, \qquad \phi(\widehat{B}_i \widehat{B}_j) = \delta_{i+j,d}. \tag{2.9}$$

The finite verification is given in Appendix A.2. It uses the physical turn, its nonzero adjacent charge-block entries and the finite quantum-binomial recurrence. In particular, (2.9) is not a generic-$q$ continuation of a formula checked only on distinct root values. The turn is linear and involutive in this basis, but is not multiplicative.

The same closure can be displayed directly in Hermite coordinates:

$$\phi(f) = (-1)^d \sum_{c \text{ double}} \big((4-c^2)f'(c) - cf(c)\big) + \mathbf{1}_{N \text{ odd}} f(-2). \tag{2.10}$$

Equivalently,

$$\phi(f) = (-1)^d N^2 [z^d](f \bmod P_N). \tag{2.11}$$

For example, at a double root $c$, writing $Q_c = P_N/(z-c)^2$ gives $Q_c(c) = N^2/(4-c^2)$ and $Q_c'(c)/Q_c(c) = c/(4-c^2)$ from the Chebyshev differential equation. The residue of $f/P_N$ is exactly the corresponding term of (2.10) after multiplication by $(-1)^d N^2$. Summing residues proves (2.11); the simple odd root has $P_N'(-2) = N^2$. The sole shortest tridiagonal path from the first to the last coordinate has product $(-1)^d N^2$, which also identifies this scalar with the original endpoint matrix element.

## 2.4 Positive multiplication with every normal retained

Suppose two stacked boxes contribute basis indices $i$ and $j$. Their product is a linear combination of output indices $r$. The following coefficient formula gives both the allowed triples $(i, j, r)$ and their weights. Calling this local operation a *gate* is only shorthand for this one multiplication; the geometric operation remains the vertical stack.

**Theorem 2.4** (Multiplication law)**.** *If $i+j<N$, then*

$$\widehat{B}_i\widehat{B}_j=\sum_{r=\max(i,j)}^{i+j}\mu_{ijr}\widehat{B}_r,\qquad \mu_{ijr}=\frac{s_{i+j}s_r}{s_is_js_{r-i}s_{r-j}s_{i+j-r}}>0. \tag{2.12}$$

*If $i+j\geq N$, the product is zero in the full algebra. In particular, a product gate has precisely the integer support*

$$i+j\leq d,\qquad \max(i,j)\leq r\leq i+j. \tag{2.13}$$

*Proof.* At a generic parameter $\zeta$, put $t=-(\zeta-\zeta^{-1})^2$. The unnormalized coefficients are

$$B_iB_j=\sum_r t^{i+j-r}\frac{[i]![j]![i+j]!}{[r]![r-i]![r-j]![i+j-r]!}\,B_r.$$

Multiplication by $c_i-z$ and the identity $(c_i-z)B_r=B_{r+1}+(c_i-c_r)B_r$, with $c_i-c_r=t[r+i+1][r-i]$, reduce induction to

$$[i+1][i+j+1]=[r][r-j]+[r+i+1][i+j+1-r].$$

This follows by expanding the four powers of $\zeta$. Endpoint coefficients follow from the same zero factors. At the principal root, all factorial indices in the case $i+j<N$ are below $N$. Since $[u]!=s_u/(2\sin(\pi/N))^u$, normalization by $s_i^2s_j^2/s_r^2$ gives (2.12).

For $i+j\geq N$, use the exact polynomial identity $B_N/B_j=B_{N-j}$, a consequence of $c_{d-u}=c_u$. Then $B_iB_j$ is divisible by $B_N=(-1)^NP_N$ with multiplicities. This proves the zero assertion without dropping the first normal directions. □

## 2.5 The literal crossing circle and its colors

A color $j$ on an auxiliary circle means that the circle carries a $j$-dimensional representation. The main strands still carry $V_N$. We must compute the resulting operator on those two main strands, including the trace around the auxiliary circle, before replacing that circle by twists. The answer is a Chebyshev polynomial in $\Omega$, with the sign fixed by the pivot. For $1\leq j\leq N$, the auxiliary module is the ordinary $j$-dimensional highest-weight module. Its loop is the actual block-braiding word $[2,1,1,2]$, with the intermediate strand dimensions retained, followed by its ordinary pivot $K_j^{1-N}$. There is no auxiliary $1/j$ or $1/N$.

**Proposition 2.5** (Circle identity)**.** *The resulting two-head operator is*

$$L_j=(-1)^{j-1}U_{j-1}(\Omega/2). \tag{2.14}$$

*Here $U_0=1$, $U_1(z/2)=z$, and $U_{n+1}(z/2)=zU_n(z/2)-U_{n-1}(z/2)$.*

*Proof.* At generic $q$, evaluate the closed monodromy on a target highest vector of weight $n$. In one direction the positive raising terms annihilate that vector; in the return direction a positive lowering term cannot return to its highest coefficient. The two Cartan factors and the auxiliary pivot give

$$\sum_{a=0}^{j-1}q^{(n+1)(j-1-2a)}=U_{j-1}((q^{n+1}+q^{-n-1})/2).$$

The generic pair highest vectors have distinct Casimirs and descendants of total dimension $N^2$, so this proves the full matrix identity. All finite crossing denominators have indices below $N$, and the identity specializes regularly. Finally $K_j^{1-N} = (-1)^{j-1}K_j$ at the root, proving (2.14), including its nilpotent coefficients. □

In particular $L_N = (-1)^d P_N'(\Omega)/N$. The trace identity

$$\phi(L_N f) = N \sum_{j=0}^{d} f(c_j) \tag{2.15}$$

counts the repeated roots. It follows first by Lagrange interpolation for a polynomial with distinct roots and then by polynomial continuation in its coefficients. At even levels $L_N^2 = 0$; at odd levels $L_N^2 = N^2 E_{-2}$, with the simple-node projector $E_{-2}$. Thus complete color alone cannot be inverted to reconstruct a filling.

Let $M = \lfloor d/2 \rfloor$ and $h_j = \mathsf{T} L_j$. The complete leaf has the exact positive expansion

$$h_N = \sum_{v=0}^{M} a_{N,v} \widehat{B}_v, \qquad a_{N,v} = \frac{N^2 s_{2v}}{s_v^4} > 0. \tag{2.16}$$

For $0 \le h \le M$, with $h_0 = 0$, the full color decomposition is

$$h_{N-h} = \sum_{v=h}^{M} \frac{N^2 s_{2v}}{s_v^2 s_{v-h} s_{v+h}} \widehat{B}_v + (-1)^N h_h. \tag{2.17}$$

For $1 \le h \le \lfloor N/2 \rfloor$,

$$h_h = \sum_{r=0}^{h-1} (-1)^{h-1+r} \frac{s_r^2 s_{h+r}}{s_{2r+1} s_{h-r-1}} \widehat{B}_{d-r}. \tag{2.18}$$

These identities separate two different ranges of Newton indices. The first term in (2.17), called the *core*, has positive coefficients before a half twist and occupies the lower indices. The second term, called the *alias*, is an exact signed contribution from the complementary color; formula (2.18) puts it in the higher Newton indices. An alias is therefore part of the finite invariant, not an error introduced by approximation. Appendix A.3 derives both formulas from the finite Chebyshev generating function. Chapter 5 will prove when the contribution of aliases is exponentially smaller after the complete tangle is assembled.

## 2.6 Half twists and exact filling

The preceding formulas describe a circle with no retained crossing. We next insert one positive or negative crossing in its original disk framing. This changes both the coefficients and their phases. We then expand a full integer twist power in the circle basis. Keeping these two steps separate ensures that the physical power is exactly $R^{\varepsilon-2p}$, with the retained half twist counted once. A retained half twist acts on a turned leaf by $\mathsf{T}_\varepsilon(f) = \mathsf{T}(R^\varepsilon \mathsf{T} f)$, for $\varepsilon = \pm 1$. Its exact transport is

$$\mathsf{T}_\varepsilon \widehat{B}_v = \kappa^\varepsilon (-1)^v \sum_{r=0}^{v} q^{\varepsilon v(r+1)} \frac{s_v}{s_r s_{v-r}} \widehat{B}_r. \tag{2.19}$$

The triangular formula retains the full Cartan phase and all normals. Its derivation uses the finite continuant expansion and root factorial reflection; the two signs are coefficient conjugates in the real Newton basis. A half-twisted alias may occupy every Newton coordinate, so the pure alias support cannot be reused after (2.19).

The $N$ circle polynomials $L_1, \dots, L_N$ form a basis of $\mathcal{H}_N$. The full crossing has a Hermite polynomial $R = \kappa r_N(\Omega)$ with

$$r_N(c_k) = (-1)^k q^{k(k+1)}, \qquad \frac{r'_N(c_k)}{r_N(c_k)} = -\frac{d-2k}{2(q^{2k+1} - q^{-2k-1})}$$

at each double node, and the stated value at the odd simple node. Fourier–Hermite interpolation therefore gives, for every integer $p$,

$$R^{-2p} = \kappa^{-2p} \sum_{j=1}^{N} \beta_{j-1}^{-p} L_j, \qquad \sum_{j=1}^{N} |\beta_{j-1}^{-p}| \le 2N(1 + |p|). \tag{2.20}$$

The notation $\beta_{j-1}^{-p}$ denotes the full interpolation coefficient, not a power of a scalar eigenvalue. Its value and derivative data are specified in Appendix A.4.

Insert (2.20) at every original auxiliary disk, tensoring with the spectators before taking the unchanged closure. If $\mathcal{A}_N(\mathbf{h})$ is the actual mixed source with colors $N - h_\ell$, then

$$\langle K(\mathbf{p}) \rangle_N = \chi_N \kappa^{-2\sum p_\ell} \sum_{j_1, \dots, j_H = 1}^{N} \left( \prod_{\ell} \beta_{j_\ell - 1}^{-p_\ell} \right) \mathcal{A}_N(N - j_1, \dots, N - j_H). \tag{2.21}$$

Here $|\chi_N| = 1$ in the reduced convention. This is an all-input finite identity. The remainder of the proof analyzes this complete sum, rather than replacing it by the complete-color term.

# Chapter 3

# From the finite sum to an angle maximization problem

We first study the pure complete-color source, before inserting retained half twists or performing the auxiliary fillings. Its elementary and multiplication coefficients are positive on their admissible supports. This positivity lets us determine the source's exponential growth by maximizing the growth rate of an individual summand. It does not assert positivity of the signed invariant after filling. This chapter makes the positive-source argument precise in three steps: determine the exact allowed integer indices, pass to their scaled compact polytope, and prove that the resulting action has a unique maximum away from every nonforced boundary. The same functions will then be recognized as hyperbolic volumes.

The distinction between an exact integer constraint and its limiting inequality matters here. We use $d = N - 1$ in every finite relation. The replacement by a continuous variable is made only after those relations have been solved, so no parity condition or half-lattice factor is lost.

## 3.1 Following the allowed indices through the construction

Expand an expression into its individual leaves, turns and binary products. A leaf has the positive support $[0, M] \cap \mathbb{Z}$. A turn replaces an index $r$ by $d - r$. A product is governed by (2.13). Thus the source is a finite sum over a fixed tree of integer labels, with a positive coefficient at every admissible state in the complete pure case. The closure selects output $d$.

The finite support can be computed without evaluating any transcendental number. If a positive expression has interval support $[l, u] \cap \mathbb{Z}$, its turn has support $[d - u, d - l] \cap \mathbb{Z}$. If two children have supports $[l_1, u_1]$ and $[l_2, u_2]$, their product is zero when $l_1 + l_2 > d$. Otherwise its support is

$$[\max(l_1, l_2),\ \min(d, u_1 + u_2)] \cap \mathbb{Z}. \tag{3.1}$$

To verify that no integer in this interval is missing, fix such an output $r$. Choose $i \le r$ and $j \le r$ in the two intervals with $r \le i + j \le d$. Starting at the smallest permitted inputs and increasing them one at a time produces every intermediate sum up to $\min(d, u_1 + u_2)$. The lower bound $r \ge \max(l_1, l_2)$ ensures that both individual caps $i, j \le r$ leave enough room. The coefficient is then positive by Theorem 2.4.

At a cylindrical closing product, $i + j = d$ is forced and $\mu_{ij,d} = 1$. Delete this gate only after retaining that exact relation. It is the unique forced flat gate in the completed-root construction.

## 3.2 Strict output types

The word *strict* means that a state lies in the interior of every support inequality that has not been forced by closure. It is useful to classify a box by the possible values of its scaled output index. The letters in the following table name intervals, not new kinds of physical tangles. The table is a concise way of checking that the recursive construction leaves room for positive angles at every step. The limiting support inequalities for a retained product are

$$x > 0, \quad y > 0, \quad \max(x, y) < z < x + y < 1. \tag{3.2}$$

A strict leaf has $0 < x < 1/2$. A turn has output $1 - x$. For arbitrary syntax made from $h$, turn and product, the possible strict output intervals are

$$L = (0, 1/2), \qquad H = (1/2, 1), \qquad A = (0, 1), \qquad \varnothing.$$

Turn exchanges $L$ and $H$ and fixes $A$. Product has the following table; an empty child makes the product empty.

| | $L$ | $H$ | $A$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| $L$ | $A$ | $H$ | $A$ |
| $H$ | $H$ | $\varnothing$ | $H$ |
| $A$ | $A$ | $H$ | $A$ |

For example, a high child forces the output above $1/2$, and two high inputs violate $x + y < 1$. For two low inputs and any prescribed $z \in (0, 1)$, choose both in $(z/2, \min(z, 1/2))$. The other entries follow by the same interval choices. At closure a strict reduced state exists exactly when the two intervals meet after reflection $y \mapsto 1 - y$.

**Lemma 3.1** (Strict feasibility)**.** *Every completed expression has a strict state at every output $b \in (0, 1)$. Every completed/completed cylindrical closure has a strict reduced state.*

*Proof.* For $hh$, choose equal leaves $a \in (b/2, \min(b, 1/2))$. For a completed product choose its two outputs in the same interval and use induction in each child. For $hE$ or $Eh$, use that number for the bare leaf and for the completed child's output. A turn uses the child's strict state at $1 - b$. At the closing product prescribe $1/2, 1/2$ and remove its forced gate. All remaining inequalities are strict. □

The distinction between strict support and every boundary coordinate is useful. At even $N$, $hh$ has top support $2M = d - 1$, not $d$. This missing boundary coordinate does not affect the strict rounding argument below. Conversely, an empty strict interval does not imply a zero source at every level: $\mathsf{T}h\,\mathsf{T}h$ is zero at even levels but has a boundary-only odd contribution.

## 3.3 The primitive integer lattice

A lattice is called primitive here when the remaining free indices range over the ordinary integer lattice, with no hidden congruence restriction. We prove this by solving the closing relation with coefficient one. This gives both the correct number of summation variables and an admissible integer state near any fixed strict real state at every large level. Suppose there are $H$ leaves. The uncontracted tree has $H-1$ product gates. Remove the final forced gate and contract every turn by $r \mapsto d-r$. There are then $H$ leaf outputs and $H-2$ retained product outputs, with one closing relation. Solving that relation for one output in one of the two disjoint root subtrees leaves

$$K = 2H - 3 \tag{3.3}$$

free integer coordinates. Every other index is an integer affine function of these coordinates with bounded, tree-dependent coefficients. No relation $2r = d$ is introduced.

Choose a strict reduced state and round its $d$-scaled free coordinates to integers. Reconstruct the eliminated indices exactly. The errors are bounded, whereas every strict inequality has a fixed positive slack times $d$. Therefore all constraints hold for every sufficiently large $N$, with either parity. For an open prescribed output, first fix $r_N/d$ in its actual strict interval and use a continuous strict state at that output; then round the remaining coordinates. This gives a genuine all-level lower sequence. It does not rely on a subsequence whose denominator happens to divide $d$.

## 3.4 The action and its uniform finite approximation

The factorials in the finite coefficients are products of sines. Their logarithms are Riemann sums for a single integrable function. We use its integral $J$ to express the exponential rates of an elementary piece and a stacking operation. The word *action* below means this logarithmic growth function, with the normalization fixed by the finite coefficients. Define

$$J(t) = \int_0^t \log(2\sin \pi u)\,\mathrm{d}u, \qquad 0 \le t \le 1, \tag{3.4}$$

with its continuous endpoint values. Reflection gives $J(1-t) = -J(t)$ and $J(1/2) = 0$. The leaf and gate actions are

$$g(x) = -2J(x) - 2J(1/2 - x) = J(2x) - 4J(x), \tag{3.5}$$

$$\begin{aligned} m(x,y,z) = {} & J(x+y) + J(z) - J(x) - J(y) \\ & - J(z-x) - J(z-y) - J(x+y-z). \end{aligned} \tag{3.6}$$

Let $\mathcal{A}_E$ be the sum of these terms over the leaves and retained gates, on the compact polytope defined by the non-strict support inequalities, the turn relations and the closing relation.

**Lemma 3.2** (Uniform factorial estimate)**.** *Uniformly for $0 \le r < N$,*

$$\log s_r = NJ(r/N) + O(\log N).$$

*For a fixed tree, every nonzero complete state of scaled labels $\mathbf{r}/d$ has weight*

$$\log w_N(\mathbf{r}) = N\mathcal{A}_E(\mathbf{r}/d) + O_E(\log N). \tag{3.7}$$

*Proof.* Away from the endpoints, compare the sum of $\log(2\sin\pi u)$ with its integral on consecutive mesh cells. Near zero and one, subtract $\log u$ or $\log(1-u)$; the remaining function has bounded derivative, and the logarithmic part is controlled by factorials. The total discrepancy is $O(\log N)$, uniformly in the stopping index. Apply this estimate to (2.12) and (2.16). The shifts between $r/N$ and $r/d$, and between $M/N$ and $1/2$, change $NJ$ by at most $O(\log N)$ because $J$ has modulus of continuity $O(\delta|\log\delta|)$. There are a fixed number of factors. □

There are at most $N^K$ states. The upper bound from (3.7), together with strict-state rounding at the maximizing state once strictness is proved, will give the complete-source limit.

## 3.5 Tetrahedral concavity and the boundary barrier

The geometric content of the action appears in its second derivatives and in its boundary behavior. Each local term is a sum of ideal-tetrahedron volumes. Their concavity will give uniqueness; their infinite one-sided derivative at a nontrivial flat angle will prevent a maximum from escaping to the boundary. We check both points because concavity alone would allow a boundary maximum. For $a+b+c=1$, $a,b,c\ge 0$, put

$$V(a,b,c) = -\pi\big(J(a)+J(b)+J(c)\big).$$

For positive angles this is the volume of the ideal tetrahedron with dihedral angles $\pi a, \pi b, \pi c$. It extends continuously by zero to the boundary. Its Hessian on the positive angle simplex is negative definite. This can be checked directly from $J''(t) = \pi\cot\pi t$: after eliminating $c$, the determinant is positive by the cotangent identity for three angles summing to $\pi$, while both diagonal entries of the volume Hessian are negative.

For a product write

$$p = z-x, \quad q = z-y, \quad r = x+y-z, \quad w = 1-x-y, \qquad p+q+2r+w = 1.$$

Substitution and reflection of $J$ give

$$\pi g(x) = 2V(x, 1/2-x, 1/2), \tag{3.8}$$

$$\pi m(x,y,z) = V(y,x,w) + V(p,q,2r+w) + V(p+q,r,r+w). \tag{3.9}$$

Every triple in these expressions sums to one. Thus the entire action is concave on its original shared-label polytope.

**Proposition 3.3** (Unique strict maximum)**.** *After deleting the forced closing gate, the complete action has a unique strict maximizer. Its Hessian on the primitive coordinates is negative definite. The fixed-output profile $f_E(b) = \max \mathcal{A}_E$ is real analytic on $0<b<1$ for every completed expression.*

*Proof.* Move from any boundary point toward the strict state of Lemma 3.1. A tetrahedron of type $(0,a,1-a)$, $0<a<1$, has derivative $+\infty$ in this direction, since $-J(t) = -t\log t + O(t)$ near zero. A vertex-flat tetrahedron $(0,0,1)$ has a finite derivative: its two logarithmic singularities cancel. A positive tetrahedron also has a finite derivative. Hence no atom contributes a negative infinite term.

An endpoint wire descends through turns and products to a nonvertex-flat atom. At output zero both product inputs are zero; at output one they sum to one, giving $(y, x, 0)$ unless an endpoint child permits further descent. A finite descent terminates at a leaf with atom $(0, 1/2, 1/2)$. Once all proper wires are interior, each remaining product boundary $p = 0$, $q = 0$, $r = 0$ or $w = 0$ exposes a nonvertex-flat atom in (3.9). A leaf at $1/2$ does the same. Thus every nonforced boundary point has a direction of positive infinite derivative and cannot maximize.

At a strict point the sum of the tetrahedral Hessians is strictly negative on every nonzero reduced tangent. Indeed, annihilating all leaf angle maps and all three product angle maps annihilates every leaf and product wire; turns then annihilate their wires. The only removed gate was already determined by its two children and the closing relation. Strict concavity gives uniqueness, and the implicit-function theorem on each fixed-output slice gives analyticity. □

**Corollary 3.4** (Complete source limit)**.** *For the positive complete scalar $Z_{E,N}$,*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N} \log Z_{E,N} = F_0, \qquad F_0 = \max \mathcal{A}_E.$$

*Proof.* The number of states is polynomial, so Lemma 3.2 gives the upper bound. Round the strict maximizer in the primitive lattice. Its positive state weight gives the matching lower bound at every sufficiently large level. □

## 3.6 Boundary parameters and the leaf interval

For an open completed box, fix its output parameter $b$ and maximize over all its other indices. The resulting function is the profile $f_E(b)$. Its derivative measures how the optimum changes when the output is varied. We package that derivative and $b$ into three positive-branch coordinates $(B, X, Y)$. Chapter 4 identifies their ratio with the shape of an ordered quadrilateral attachment face. For now they provide an efficient exact recursion for locating the stationary leaf parameters. The ordered output metric will be described in Chapter 4. Its useful algebraic coordinates are

$$B = \cot \pi b, \quad \varkappa = e^{-f_E'(b)}, \quad X = \sqrt{\frac{1 + B^2}{1 + \varkappa}}, \quad Y = \sqrt{\varkappa}\, X. \tag{3.10}$$

They satisfy $X^2 + Y^2 - B^2 = 1$. A leaf has $(B, X, Y) = (X, X, 1)$. At a stationary product, the two children share $X$, and direct differentiation of (3.6) gives

$$B_o = \frac{B_1 B_2 + X^2 - 1}{B_1 + B_2}, \qquad Y_o = \frac{Y_1 Y_2}{B_1 + B_2}, \qquad B_1 + B_2 > 0. \tag{3.11}$$

A turn sends $(B, X, Y)$ to $(-B, Y, X)$.

**Lemma 3.5** (Bounds on the boundary parameters)**.** *The boundary parameters of every completed box satisfy $-Y < B < X$. In a completed/completed closure every completed descendant has $0 < X, Y < 1$, and every leaf satisfies*

$$\frac{1}{2} < X_\ell = \cot \pi a_\ell < 1, \qquad \frac{1}{4} < a_\ell < \frac{\arctan 2}{\pi}. \tag{3.12}$$

*Proof.* The base $hh$ has $B = X - 1/(2X)$ and $Y = 1/(2X)$. Turns preserve the claimed inequality. For a single attachment, (3.11) becomes

$$B_o = X - \frac{1}{X+B}, \qquad Y_o = \frac{Y}{X+B}.$$

For $X \geq 1$, the child inequality forces $B > \sqrt{X^2-1}$ and the result follows. For $X < 1$, let $h_0 = \sqrt{1-X^2}$ and $\alpha = \arccos X$. Express a child as $(B, Y) = (h_0 \cot\beta, h_0 \csc\beta)$. A bare leaf has $\beta = \alpha$, a completed child has $\beta > \alpha$, and product adds the angles, with their sum below $\pi$. This proves the strict upper bound and the lower bound $B_o + Y_o = h_0 \cot((\beta_1+\beta_2)/2) > 0$. It also proves the completed/completed step when $X < 1$. When $X \geq 1$, both completed children satisfy $\sqrt{X^2-1} < B_i < X$. Hence $0 < X - B_i < X - \sqrt{X^2-1} \leq 1$, so $(X-B_1)(X-B_2) < 1$. Formula (3.11) then gives $B_o < X$, while $B_o > 0$ proves the lower bound.

At closure the boundary triples of the two boxes are $(B, X, Y)$ and $(-B, X, Y)$. Applying both inequalities gives $|B| < \min(X, Y)$; the hyperboloid relation implies $X, Y < 1$. In the angle chart, parent $Y < 1$ puts the sum of child angles below $\pi - \alpha$, while each child angle is at least $\alpha$. Every completed child therefore has $Y < 1$, and turns exchange the bounds. Finally, at a single attachment $Y_o < 1$ gives $1 < 2X(X+B) < 4X^2$. At an $hh$ base it gives $1/(2X) < 1$. Thus every leaf has $X > 1/2$, proving (3.12). □

For a fixed tree the inequalities give a compact neighborhood of every selected leaf inside $(1/4, 1/2)$. This is the precise input needed for the complex source analysis. It is not a uniform bound over an unbounded family of trees.

# Chapter 4

# Constructing the complete augmented hyperbolic metric

An ideal hyperbolic polyhedron has its vertices on the sphere at infinity. Truncating such a vertex by a horosphere gives a Euclidean polygon; after the face pairings, these polygons form the cross sections of the cusp ends. We shall build one polyhedron from the stationary angles and use two copies of it to recover the complement of the actual augmented diagram.

There are three separate verifications. The cells must fit isometrically along their ordered faces. Their labeled face identifications must recover the original link exterior. Finally, the Euclidean cusp polygons must glue without dilation, so that the metric is complete. A numerical agreement of volumes, or an agreement of face counts alone, would not establish these facts.

## 4.1 Why the local volume identity is not enough

The angle identity (3.9) proves concavity, but an abstract sum of tetrahedral volumes is not yet the volume of a link complement. We construct the cells, identify the ordered input maps, and then compare the closed colored boundary with the literal projection cut. This supplies both the topology and the degree of the geometric realization. The construction does not require a polyhedron existence theorem; Rivin's variational approach [16] provides useful context, but is not a premise of this explicit argument.

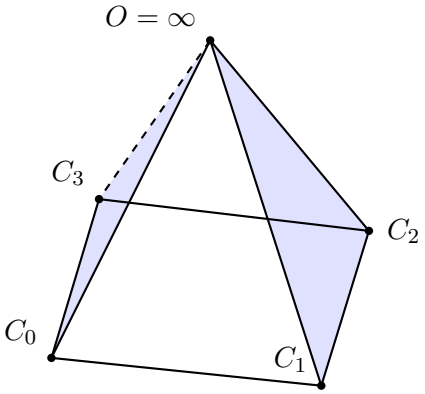
## 4.2 The leaf pyramid

We use the upper-half-space model of hyperbolic three-space, with boundary $\mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$. An elementary piece will contribute an ideal pyramid. Its two shaded faces correspond to the two sides of a half crossing disk; the white faces come from regions of the projection sphere. These colors record different kinds of face pairings. The remaining quadrilateral is a gluing face used while the construction is still open. Its four ideal vertices are ordered: that order determines which vertex must be sent to which when two faces are identified. In upper half-space, place the apex at $O = \infty$ and the ordered vertices of the gluing face at

$$(C_0, C_1, C_2, C_3) = (1, e^{2\pi i a}, -1, -e^{2\pi i a}), \qquad 0 < a < 1/2. \tag{4.1}$$

Their convex hull is an ideal quadrangular pyramid. Its four apex edges are right angled. The base edge angles alternate $\pi a$ and $\pi(1/2 - a)$. A diagonal of the base gives the two tetrahedra of (3.8), so its volume is $\pi g(a)$. Color the side triangles $(O, C_1, C_2)$ and $(O, C_3, C_0)$ shaded; the other two side triangles are white. The base is the output gluing face.

Call edges $01, 23$ of an output gluing face *free*, and edges $12, 30$ *cap*. A leaf has free angles $\pi a$ and cap angles $\pi(1/2 - a)$. A completed cell will have free angles $\pi b$ and cap angles $\pi(1 - b)$.




quadrilateral gluing face

Ideal hyperbolic pyramid.

All five vertices are ideal. The shaded triangular faces are $(O, C_1, C_2)$ and $(O, C_3, C_0)$.

In the boundary plane: $C_0 = 1$, $C_1 = e^{2\pi i a}$, $C_2 = -1$, $C_3 = -e^{2\pi i a}$.

Figure 4.1: The ideal hyperbolic pyramid associated with a twist-region leaf. The shaded triangles $(O, C_1, C_2)$ and $(O, C_3, C_0)$ correspond to the two sides of a half crossing disk. The quadrilateral $(C_0, C_1, C_2, C_3)$ is the gluing face. Its edges $01, 23$ have dihedral angle $\pi a$, and its edges $12, 30$ have dihedral angle $\pi(1/2 - a)$.

## 4.3 The multiplication prism

For a strict product define $p, q, r, w$ as in Chapter 3. In the boundary plane set

$$v_0 = 1, \quad v_1 = e^{2\pi i p}, \quad v_2 = e^{2\pi i (p+r)}, \quad v_3 = e^{2\pi i (p+r+q)}. \tag{4.2}$$

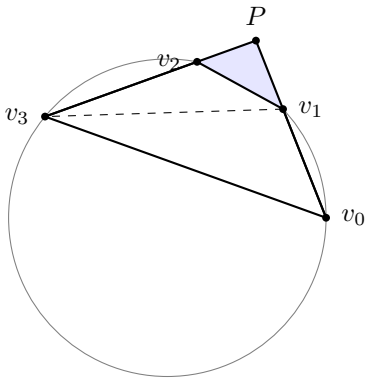
The consecutive half-arcs are $p, r, q, r + w$. Let $P$ be the intersection of the lines $(v_0, v_1)$ and $(v_2, v_3)$. The Euclidean triangle $(P, v_1, v_2)$ has positive angles $\pi y, \pi x, \pi w$, and the sine rule gives

$$P = v_1 + \frac{\sin \pi x \sin \pi r}{\sin \pi w \sin \pi p}(v_1 - v_0) = v_2 + \frac{\sin \pi y \sin \pi r}{\sin \pi w \sin \pi q}(v_2 - v_3). \tag{4.3}$$

In particular $|P| > 1$. Attach the tetrahedron $(\infty, P, v_1, v_2)$ to the quadrangular pyramid $(\infty, v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3)$, on opposite sides of their common face. The two coplanar face pairs merge. The result is a convex ideal triangular prism with white triangular faces $(P, v_1, v_2)$ and $(\infty, v_0, v_3)$ and three quadrilateral gluing faces, with the indicated vertex orders

$$F_x = (\infty, v_0, v_1, P), \quad F_y = (\infty, v_3, v_2, P), \quad F_z = (v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3). \tag{4.4}$$

Its edge angles, divided by $\pi$, are




Boundary-plane construction.
$P = (v_0v_1) \cap (v_2v_3)$ lies outside the unit circle.
The sixth ideal vertex is $\infty$.
The three quadrilateral gluing faces have ordered vertices $(\infty, v_0, v_1, P)$, $(\infty, v_3, v_2, P)$ and $(v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3)$.

$p = .12, \quad r = .10, \quad q = .17, \quad w = .51$

Figure 4.2: The exact boundary-plane construction of a strict prism at one rational angle tuple. The lines and circle are the defining support data; the drawing is not a perspective view of the three-dimensional hyperbolic cell.

| Edges | Angle |
|---|---|
| $Pv_1,\ \infty v_0$ | $x$ |
| $Pv_2,\ \infty v_3$ | $y$ |
| $v_1v_2,\ v_0v_3$ | $1 - z$ |
| $P\infty$ | $w$ |
| $v_0v_1$ | $p$ |
| $v_2v_3$ | $q$ |

The support half-spaces are the three vertical planes over the lines through $P$ and over $(v_3, v_0)$, and the hemispheres through the two remaining face circles. Formula (4.3) places the two attached pieces on the required sides. Equivalently, their seam is locally convex because its boundary angle sums are at most $\pi$. The volume is $\pi m(x, y, z)$: triangulate the pyramid across $v_0v_2$ and cancel the complementary intermediate Lobachevsky terms; the attached tetrahedron supplies $V(y, x, w)$.

## 4.4 Stationarity matches whole ordered faces

For cyclically ordered points on a circle or line, define

$$\varkappa(a, b, c, d) = \frac{(a - b)(c - d)}{(a - d)(b - c)} > 0.$$

Three ordered vertices can be sent to $(\infty, 0, 1)$, so this number determines the ordered ideal quadrilateral. A cyclic shift or the relevant reversal replaces it by its reciprocal. Direct

substitution gives

$$\varkappa(F_x) = \frac{\sin \pi x \sin \pi r}{\sin \pi w \sin \pi p}, \qquad \varkappa(F_y) = \frac{\sin \pi y \sin \pi r}{\sin \pi w \sin \pi q},$$
$$\varkappa(F_z) = \frac{\sin \pi p \sin \pi q}{\sin \pi z \sin \pi r}. \tag{4.5}$$

These are $e^{-m_x}$, $e^{-m_y}$ and $e^{-m_z}$, respectively. The leaf metric is $\tan^2 \pi a = e^{-g'(a)}$.

The lower and upper stack maps are exactly

$$(C_0, C_1, C_2, C_3) \mapsto (v_0, v_1, P, \infty), \qquad (C_0, C_1, C_2, C_3) \mapsto (\infty, P, v_2, v_3). \tag{4.6}$$

Both invert the shape parameter of the gluing face. At each internal wire, stationarity says that the child output derivative and parent input derivative sum to zero. Hence $\varkappa_{\text{child}}\varkappa_{\text{parent}} = 1$, precisely the isometry condition for (4.6). This verifies the full face map, rather than only an edge-product equation.

## 4.5 Convex assembly and the closed cut

Attach child cells to the two prism inputs on opposite supported sides. A leaf cap edge meets a prism edge with total angle $\pi/2$; a completed cap edge gives $\pi$ and merges two white faces. The common input edge has angle $\pi(w + x + y) = \pi$. The two free output seams have angles $\pi(p + x) = \pi z$ and $\pi(q + y) = \pi z$, while the cap output angles are $\pi(1 - z)$.

These inequalities prove local convexity at each finite seam. To justify global convexity directly, a length-minimizing sequence between two finite points of the union stays in a compact hyperbolic ball. A shortest path exists. Local convexity makes it an ambient geodesic at every finite point, so it is the unique ambient segment and lies in the union. The argument concerns finite points. To control the ideal boundary as well, observe that a strict quadrilateral gluing face is a maximal supported face. Cells attached on opposite sides can have no extra ideal intersection away from its supporting circle. An extra vertex on that circle would enlarge the supported face across one of its strictly nonflat edges. This is excluded by the strict output angles. Appendix D gives the corresponding incidence argument in detail.

There is also a combinatorial issue: repeated identifications must not collapse two corners of one leaf. At every open stage the four exposed corners are still unpaired original endpoints. A product consumes two disjoint pairs and never exposes those endpoints again; a turn only permutes the four remaining endpoints. Thus each consumed pair is permanent, and later gluing cannot extend it into a chain of identifications. The root pairs endpoints from the two disjoint final boxes. Each leaf therefore retains four distinct corners and its original apex. Together these geometric and combinatorial checks show that every completed box gives the claimed convex ideal cell, with right-angled edges outside the gluing face and two distinct shaded triangles per elementary piece.

At the final closure, the outputs are $b$ and $1 - b$. Stationarity gives equal shape parameters for their ordered gluing faces. The gluing is

$$F : C_j \longmapsto G : C_{3-j} \qquad (j \bmod 4). \tag{4.7}$$

It implements both the stack interface and the two outside closing wires. Free and cap angles each sum to $\pi$ for two completed children. After merging flat white seams, the result is a

convex right-angled ideal polyhedron $P_E$. It has $2H$ shaded triangles, $H+2$ white faces, $3H$ ideal vertices and $6H$ edges. These counts are checks, not the proof of topology.

For topology, cut the literal augmented diagram along its projection sphere and the recorded half crossing disks. In each projection ball the auxiliary semicircles are boundary-parallel along those half disks. Drilling them and then cutting returns a ball. A disk contributes precisely the two shaded triangles $(O, C_1, C_2)$ and $(O, C_3, C_0)$. The remaining regions are white. The original stack identifies lower corners $2, 3$ with upper corners $1, 0$ and preserves the exposed order $(F_0, F_1, G_2, G_3)$. Turns rotate that order, and the final closure pairs 0 with 3 and 1 with 2. These rules determine every oriented white facial walk. They are exactly the rules induced by (4.6) and (4.7). The labeled sphere cellulation therefore agrees with the projection cut; its identification extends over each ball. Reversing the cuts gives the stated link exterior with degree one.

## 4.6 Complete cusps and half-twist partners

The polyhedron is only one of the two balls obtained by cutting along the projection sphere. We now describe how the two balls are reassembled. A complete cusp requires more than a total angle of $2\pi$: the face maps must return pointwise around every edge, and their restrictions to the horospheres must have no dilation. The following pairing and length checks establish those conditions on the original labeled diagram. Take two oppositely oriented copies of $P_E$. Pair white faces between copies by their projection labels. In a pure leaf, pair its two shaded triangles within each copy, fixing $O$ and sending $C_1 \mapsto C_0$, $C_2 \mapsto C_3$. The edge words alternate white and shaded gluings, contain four right angles, and return pointwise: the copied white maps and the inverse triangle maps cancel. Thus there is no translation along an edge hidden by an angle count.

At each ideal vertex, a horosphere cuts a Euclidean rectangle. Scale it so that its two opposite shaded sides have length one. Every shaded triangle then has the same canonical corner horocycles. All shaded and white pairings preserve the decoration. Uniform shrinking makes the horospheres disjoint. The links glue without dilation to the actual compact cusp tori, while their complement is compact. The resulting metric is complete and has volume

$$\operatorname{Vol}(Y_E^0) = 2\operatorname{Vol}(P_E) = 2\pi F_0. \tag{4.8}$$

A half twist rotates one side of the twice-punctured disk by $\pi$, exchanging both punctures and the upper/lower half disks. Hence the shaded maps become

$$S_0^+ \to S_1^- : \ (O, C_1, C_2) \mapsto (O, C_3, C_0), \qquad S_1^+ \to S_0^- : \ (O, C_3, C_0) \mapsto (O, C_1, C_2).$$

They go across the two copies, not within one copy. White maps are unchanged. The explicit edge matrices in Chapter 7 show pointwise cancellation of all three odd edge words. The length-one triangle decorations are also preserved, so every fixed half-twist pattern has the same complete volume $2\pi F_0$. The two half-twist signs have the same unmarked pairing but different collar paths; those paths are kept for filling.

## 4.7 A constructive knot choice

The hyperbolic construction initially keeps all main components. To obtain a knot after the auxiliary fillings, we must choose the retained half twists so that the final main diagram is

connected. This can be checked without any geometry. A box connects its four boundary points in one of three pairings; the table below follows the two actual identity arcs of a stack. It also records the only way stacking creates a closed internal main component. For the four tangle endpoints $(0, 1, 2, 3)$ in cyclic order, write

$$I = (0, 3)(1, 2), \qquad U = (0, 1)(2, 3), \qquad X = (0, 2)(1, 3).$$

A pure leaf gives $U$ and an odd leaf gives $X$. Turn exchanges $I, U$ and fixes $X$. Tracing the two stack wires gives

| lower/upper | $I$ | $U$ | $X$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| $I$ | $I$ | $U$ | $X$ |
| $U$ | $U$ | $U$ plus an internal circle | $U$ |
| $X$ | $X$ | $U$ | $I$ |

Only $U \cdot U$ creates an internal component. The base $hh$ offers $\{I, U\}$ without such a component. Every product of two feasible two-element subsets of $\{I, U, X\}$, after deleting the forbidden choice, still offers at least two elements; the same holds when one child is the leaf set $\{U, X\}$. Turn permutes the choices. Induction gives at least two loop-free choices for every completed expression. At the root choose $U$ or $X$, whose cylindrical closure is one component, and backtrack the finite choices. Either sign realizes an odd leaf. Full twists have even endpoint permutation, so all subsequent auxiliary fillings preserve the one main component.

# Chapter 5

# Controlling the signed complementary color terms

The positive complete-color calculation does not by itself estimate the invariant after filling, because the exact filling formula uses every auxiliary color. For those colors an elementary piece contains the core and alias terms defined in Chapter 2. After a retained crossing, their coefficients can oscillate. We need a bound on the entire contribution of every selection containing at least one alias.

The bound is obtained by comparing logarithmic coefficient rates with tangent planes at the complete stationary state. Internal tangent terms cancel when boxes are stacked. A positive loss left at one elementary piece or one small block then survives all later compositions. The reason for treating blocks is that an individual alias need not lie below its leaf tangent throughout the permitted interval.

## 5.1 Coefficient envelopes on the true support

Let $C_j^{\varepsilon}$ and $A_j^{\varepsilon}$ denote, respectively, the core polynomial and the alias polynomial of an elementary piece of color $j$ with retained half-twist sign $\varepsilon$. For a polynomial $P$, the notation $[\widehat{B}_r]P$ means its coefficient in the Newton basis, not an evaluation at a root. Write each colored elementary piece as core plus alias, using (2.17) and then applying (2.19) when required. A low physical color has no core. A high physical color has the displayed positive core before its half twist. The resulting signed arrays are always propagated through the full Newton multiplication law.

The endpoint-uniform factorial estimates and the selected complete half-twist recurrence give the following coefficient bounds, uniformly in every physical color and Newton index:

$$\begin{aligned} &|[\widehat{B}_r]C_j^{\varepsilon}| \le \exp\{N[\widetilde{g}(r/N) + e_N]\}, && 0 \le r \le M, \\ &|[\widehat{B}_r]A_j^{\varepsilon}| \le N^C e^{Nk(r/N)}, && 0 \le r \le d, \\ &\quad \widetilde{g}(u) = g(\max(u, 1/4)), \qquad k(u) = -2J(u/2). \end{aligned} \tag{5.1}$$

Here $e_N \to 0$ uniformly over colors and indices. No polynomial prefactor is asserted for the core through spectral collisions. Zero coefficients satisfy the same bounds. The first profile is constant below $1/4$ and agrees with $g$ above it; its derivative joins continuously at zero.

The second follows directly from the triangular transport: the logarithmic rate of a term with upper index $v/N = w$ is

$$J(w) - J(u) - J(w-u), \qquad w \geq \max(u, 1/2).$$

Its maximum is at $w = (1+u)/2$. Reflection and duplication of $J$ reduce that value to $-2J(u/2)$. The untransformed alias coefficients in (2.18) are bounded by $N/2$, so they have no additional exponential cost. The detailed finite derivation and the core recurrence estimate are in Appendix B.1.

The gate domain is the entire tetrahedron

$$D = \{(u, v, w) : u, v \geq 0,\ \max(u, v) \leq w \leq u + v \leq 1\}. \tag{5.2}$$

In particular, an aliased input can exceed $1/2$. All three functions $\widetilde{g}$, $k$ and $m$ are concave on their stated domains. For $k$, this is $k''(u) = -(\pi/2)\cot(\pi u/2) < 0$; for $m$, it follows from (3.9). This global concavity is what makes a finite supporting-plane certificate possible.

## 5.2 Why a block estimate is needed

At a pure leaf $a$, the tangent deficit against an alias is

$$I(a) = \min_{0 \leq u \leq 1} \{g(a) + g'(a)(u - a) - k(u)\}.$$

It can be negative in part of the interval allowed by (3.12). Thus an induction that assigns a positive loss to every individual leaf would fail. The multiplication gate provides a compensating contribution. We first treat an entire $hh$ seed, then a new leaf together with the gate attaching it to a completed child.

**Lemma 5.1** (Two-leaf block)**.** *At the pure stationary hh block, write*

$$X = \cot \pi a, \quad \cot \pi b = X - \frac{1}{2X}, \quad F_2(b) = 2g(a) + m(a, a, b), \quad \lambda = 2\log(2X^2).$$

*For $1/2 \leq X \leq 1$, each of the two alias dual envelopes satisfies*

$$\max_{D,\ v \leq 1/2} \{k(u) + \widetilde{g}(v) + m(u, v, w) - \lambda w\} \leq F_2(b) - \lambda b - \frac{1}{100}, \tag{5.3}$$

$$\max_{D} \{k(u) + k(v) + m(u, v, w) - \lambda w\} \leq F_2(b) - \lambda b - \frac{1}{100}. \tag{5.4}$$

*Proof.* Let $P(\lambda)$ be the pure dual maximum with both inputs at most $1/2$. At $(a, a, b)$, $m_u = m_v = -2\log X$, $m_w = 2\log(2X^2)$ and $g'(a) = 2\log X$. Concavity therefore gives $P(\lambda) = F_2(b) - \lambda b$.

Choose a rational feasible pure point $p$ and a rational strict point $v$ for an alias action $H$. The pure value bounds $P$ below; concavity gives the global upper tangent $H(w) \leq H(v) + \nabla H(v) \cdot (w - v)$. The vertices of $D$ are

$$(0, 0, 0),\ (1, 0, 1),\ (0, 1, 1),\ (1/2, 1/2, 1/2).$$

Cutting by the core condition $v \le 1/2$ gives instead

$$(0,0,0),\ (1,0,1),\ (1/2,1/2,1/2),\ (0,1/2,1/2),\ (1/2,1/2,1).$$

Partition $\lambda/\log 2 \in [-2,2]$ into sixteen intervals of length $1/4$. The certificate supplies one pure point and two alias tangent points on each interval. For every vertex and both interval endpoints it verifies

$$A(p) - \lambda p_w - H(v) - \nabla H(v)\cdot(w-v) + \lambda w_w > \frac{1}{100}.$$

The expression is affine in the slope and in $w$, so these checks cover the whole interval and polytope. There are 288 rationally enclosed inequalities. Their least certified lower bound is

$$\frac{21000210290230963809378576600597934432 9}{50000000000000000000000000000000000000000000} > \frac{1}{25}.$$

Appendix C proves the enclosure rules and specifies the finite data and replay. No optimizer, sampled covering, or assertion about the alias maximizer is used in verification. □

## 5.3 A leaf attached to an arbitrary completed child

Suppose the new elementary piece is stacked with a box that has already been constructed. We retain all the internal structure of that box through its profile $f_E$ and its output tangent. The comparison below therefore has one leaf variable, one output variable for the existing box, and the output of their stack. It is not an estimate for two bare leaves. Let $(B,X,Y)$ be the selected boundary triple of the child and $(B_p,X,Y_p)$ the boundary triple of the parent. Put

$$\begin{aligned} a = \operatorname{arccot} X/\pi, \quad b = \operatorname{arccot} B/\pi, \quad c = \operatorname{arccot} B_p/\pi, \qquad B_p = X - \frac{1}{X+B}, \\ \mu = f_E'(b) = 2\log(X/Y), \qquad \lambda = f_{hE}'(c) = \mu + 2\log(X+B). \end{aligned} \tag{5.5}$$

The bounds of Lemma 3.5 give $1/2 < X < 1$ and $1/(2X) - X < B < X$. Define

$$P(\mu,\lambda) = \max_{D,\ u\le 1/2} \{g(u) + m(u,v,w) + \mu v - \lambda w\}, \tag{5.6}$$

$$Q(\mu,\lambda) = \max_{D} \{k(u) + m(u,v,w) + \mu v - \lambda w\}. \tag{5.7}$$

Only the new leaf is restricted below half in $P$. The child variable $v$ retains its whole interval; it is represented by its output tangent, not by a second bare leaf.

**Lemma 5.2** (Attachment gap)**.** *At every proper attachment in the completed-root grammar,*

$$P(\mu,\lambda) - Q(\mu,\lambda) \ge \frac{1}{2500}. \tag{5.8}$$

*The pure maximum in* (5.6) *is attained at* $(a,b,c)$ *from* (5.5)*.*

*Proof.* The three derivatives there are $m_u = -2\log X$, $m_v = -\mu$, $m_w = \lambda$. Thus the pure objective is stationary, and concavity gives its global maximum. The same is true with $\widetilde{g}$ replacing $g$, because $a > 1/4$ and the two functions agree near $a$.

For $1/2 < X \le 2/3$, both slopes belong to $[-2\log 2, 0]$. Indeed, either child or parent has $Y < 1$, so $2\log(X/Y) > 2\log X > -2\log 2$, while $Y^2 \ge 1 - X^2 > X^2$ gives the upper bound zero. On this entire square an exact certificate proves $P - Q > 1/1000$. It uses 55 dyadic rectangles, a rational pure point and a global alias tangent on each rectangle. For the four slope corners and four vertices of $D$, it checks

$$g(p_1) + m(p) - \{H(v) + \nabla H(v) \cdot (w - v)\} \\ + \mu(p_2 - w_2) - \lambda(p_3 - w_3) > \frac{1}{1000}, \qquad H = k + m. \quad (5.9)$$

The 880 inequalities and exact recursive square coverage imply the global assertion. The least lower bound is

$$\frac{5543719176001987489251797268402076337 3}{10^{40}} > \frac{1}{1000}.$$

This uses the same outward rational engine as the block certificate.

For $X \ge 2/3$, the elementary one-leaf estimate is

$$k(u) \le g(a) + g'(a)(u - a) - \frac{1}{2500}, \qquad 0 \le u \le 1. \quad (5.10)$$

Here is a direct proof of its endpoint margin. For $a \ge \arctan\sqrt{2}/\pi$, the minimum deficit occurs at $u = 1$, and it equals

$$g(a) + (1 - a)g'(a) = \frac{2}{\pi}\,\mathrm{Ti}_2(X) + \log X, \quad \mathrm{Ti}_2(X) = \int_0^X \frac{\arctan t}{t}\,\mathrm{d}t.$$

It decreases with $a$. At $X = 2/3$, four alternating terms give $\mathrm{Ti}_2(2/3) > 1708762/2679075$; the logarithm series gives $\log(3/2) \le 177391/437500$. With $\pi < 22/7$, the difference is greater than $57269/136687500 > 1/2500$. For $1/4 \le a \le \arctan\sqrt{2}/\pi$, the interior minimizing alias index is $u = (2/\pi)\arcsin(\tan^2(\pi a)/2) > a$, so the deficit decreases with $a$ and its endpoint is larger than the same bound. The exact rational checks are included in the reproduction suite.

Finally add the tangent of the concave gate and the child linear term. The three variable coefficients cancel by stationarity, proving (5.8). □

## 5.4 The whole-tree induction

For a fixed choice of which elementary pieces contribute aliases, evaluate that contribution through the original construction tree. Such a choice is called an *alias subset*, or sector. There are only finitely many subsets because the construction is fixed. We first bound each subset separately, retaining an affine tangent in the open output index; only at the final closure are those output terms canceled. For every completed subtree at its selected output $b_E$, write $\lambda_E = f'_E(b_E)$. We prove, uniformly over all colors and all output indices,

$$|[\widehat{B}_r]E_S| \le \exp(N\,[f_E(b_E) + \lambda_E(r/N - b_E) - \delta_S + e_N])\,, \quad e_N \to 0, \quad (5.11)$$

where $S$ is a specified alias subset, $\delta_\varnothing = 0$, and $\delta_S > 0$ when $S \ne \varnothing$. Lemma 5.1 supplies the base. A turn reverses the index, negates the slope, and adds only the fixed affine correction

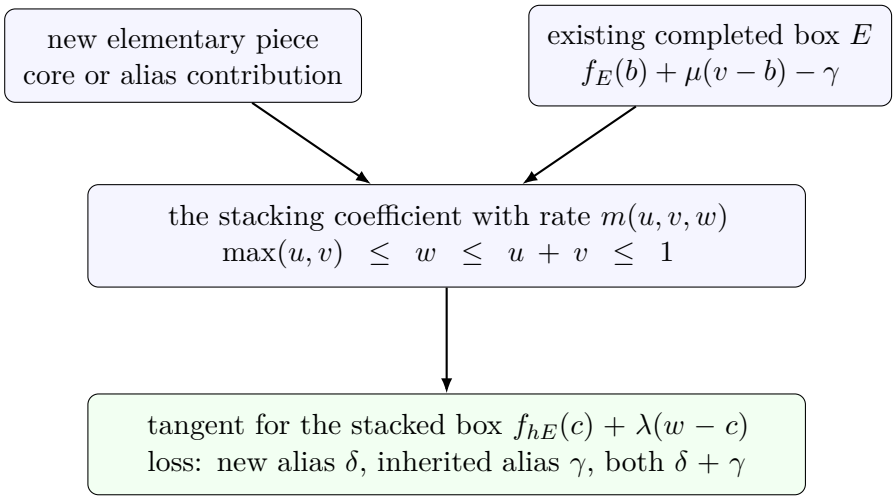



Figure 5.1: The child retains its output tangent and its original index. The new estimate is a leaf–gate comparison; it does not substitute a leaf for the child.

from $d/N = 1 - 1/N$. A completed/completed product adds both child tangents and the gate tangent. The internal derivatives cancel, while any inherited loss remains.

For $hE$, the exact split is

$$C_{hE} = C_h \star C_E, \qquad A_{hE} = A_h \star C_E + C_h \star A_E + A_h \star A_E,$$

where $\star$ is (2.12) with $i + j \le d$. A new alias loses at least $1/2500$ by Lemma 5.2; a child alias carries its old loss; when both occur the losses add. A core leaf uses the tangent of $\widetilde{g}$ with zero new loss. Thus the parent may take the minimum of its child loss and $1/2500$. The order $Eh$ has the same algebraic bound without moving a coupon through a turn.

At the root, the two output tangents cancel on $i + j = d$. The finite affine shifts contribute $O(1)$ to the exponent. There are only polynomially many wire states and finitely many alias subsets for a fixed tree. We obtain constants $\gamma > 0$ and $C$ such that the total aliased source satisfies

$$|\mathcal{A}_N - \mathcal{A}_N^{\mathrm{core}}| \le N^C e^{N(F_0 - \gamma)} \tag{5.12}$$

uniformly over all physical colors.

The all-core majorant also has a unique maximum at the complete strict state. On its high-index neighborhood it agrees with the strictly concave complete action. If another global maximum existed, concavity would make the segment joining it to the strict maximum constant, contradicting the negative Hessian near that maximum. Compactness therefore gives a fixed loss outside a fixed state window. Inside the window, the exact local core bound has a strict loss when any complementary color $h_\ell$ is at least a fixed positive multiple of $N$. Combining the two alternatives yields

$$\max_\ell h_\ell \ge \delta N \quad \Longrightarrow \quad |\mathcal{A}_N(\mathbf{h})| \le N^C e^{N(F_0 - \gamma_\delta)}. \tag{5.13}$$

The uniform global envelope and the strict color estimate are proved in Appendix B.2. Equations (5.12) and (5.13) are the global estimates required for filling. They concern the entire physical color range, not only a formal small-color series.

# Chapter 6

# A holomorphic asymptotic near the complete maximum

The preceding chapter removes the alias terms and the states far from the complete maximum with an exponential error. What remains is a finite sum over a fixed neighborhood of that maximum. We now continue its color parameters to complex values and compute its leading term. This finite holomorphic function is the *packet* used later in the filling integral.

The order of the construction matters. We first define the finite function by continuing the exact elementary coefficients, with their original phases. We then compare it with analytic index interpolants to exponential accuracy and apply a lattice saddle argument. An error of order $N^{-1}$ on the real grid would not suffice: after an oscillatory filling transform, such an error could be larger than the desired leading answer.

## 6.1 A finite holomorphic object

Let $\mathbf{k} \in \mathbb{Z}^K$ be the primitive wire coordinates from (3.3). Every other wire has the exact form

$$r_w = N\ell_w(\mathbf{x}) + \delta_w, \qquad \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{k}/N, \tag{6.1}$$

with an integral affine function $\ell_w$ and a fixed integer $\delta_w$. In particular, each use of $d = N - 1$ contributes to the offsets. Choose a closed rectangular box about the strict complete maximizer, lying wholly inside the retained support. By Lemma 3.5, every leaf lies in a fixed compact subinterval of $(1/4, 1/2)$.

For pure leaves, the exact color coefficient on this box is

$$\frac{N^2 s_{2r}}{s_r^2 s_{r-h} s_{r+h}}, \qquad t = h/N.$$

Use the canonical factorial continuation for the paired arguments $r - h, r + h$. For a piece with a retained crossing, use its finite continuant sum, meaning the solution of the displayed second-order recurrence fixed by the finite upper endpoint. Retain the continuous quadratic phase $q^{h^2}$, often called a chirp, and the recurrence branch selected by that exact sum. The precise construction, including the endpoint source anchor and exponential interpolation error, is proved in Appendix B.1. In particular, no interpolation is chosen merely because it agrees to order $N^{-1}$ on the real grid.

Define $C_N(\mathbf{t})$ by the *finite* rectangular wire sum of the exact continued-color leaf factors and the original integer gate coefficients. At each fixed integer wire index, only the color is continued: the signed leaf remains its finite source sum with the canonical chirp. Index interpolants are introduced afterward as a proof device and replace this exact window only with exponentially small error. This is the definition in (B.42). It is holomorphic on a fixed complex polydisk and separately even in every $t_\ell$. It agrees with the original source in the small physical color corridor up to the exponentially small errors established in Chapter 5 and the local interpolation proof.

## 6.2 The selected local action

The pure action depends on a scaled Newton index $x$ and a scaled color deficit $t$. A retained half twist changes the relation between this pure parameter and the complex parameter $\chi$ that will become a peripheral coordinate. The following implicit change of variables describes that relation. Its branch is fixed by the finite recurrence, so both its derivative and its additive constant are determined. For a pure leaf the action is

$$g(x,t) = J(2x) - 2J(x) - J(x-t) - J(x+t). \tag{6.2}$$

For a signed half twist, the selected action $f_\varepsilon$ is an analytic shear of this action. Put

$$\chi = t - \frac{\varepsilon g_t(x,t)}{2\pi\mathrm{i}}, \qquad f_\varepsilon(x,\chi) = g(x,t) - \frac{\varepsilon g_t(x,t)^2}{4\pi\mathrm{i}}, \qquad \varepsilon \in \{0,\pm 1\}. \tag{6.3}$$

For $\varepsilon = 0$ this is the identity. For $\varepsilon \neq 0$, the implicit map is nonsingular near the selected complete leaf. The finite recurrence selects this branch and fixes its additive constant; the relation is not used to choose an arbitrary solution after taking a semiclassical limit.

Let $F_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x},\boldsymbol{\chi})$ be the sum of the $f_{\varepsilon_\ell}$ and the unchanged gate actions. The implicit-function theorem gives a unique nearby stationary point $\mathbf{x}_*(\boldsymbol{\chi})$, and define

$$\Phi_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi}) = F_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}_*(\boldsymbol{\chi}),\boldsymbol{\chi}).$$

The same relation holds after eliminating all internal wires:

$$\chi_\ell = t_\ell - \frac{\varepsilon_\ell \partial_{t_\ell}\Phi_0}{2\pi\mathrm{i}}, \qquad \Phi_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi}) = \Phi_0(\mathbf{t}) - \sum_\ell \frac{\varepsilon_\ell(\partial_{t_\ell}\Phi_0)^2}{4\pi\mathrm{i}}.$$

At fixed $\chi$, differentiation of (6.3) gives $(f_\varepsilon)_x = g_x$ and $(f_\varepsilon)_\chi = g_t$. Thus the wire stationary equations are the pure equations evaluated at the implicitly changed colors. This proves the global shear by the envelope theorem, with the complete value $F_0$ as its anchor.

## 6.3 Offsets, powers of the level, and the Gaussian

The exponential action alone is not enough to prove noncancellation. We also need a nonzero leading coefficient and its exact power of $N$. Integer shifts such as $d = N - 1$ affect that coefficient even though they disappear from the limiting action. We keep these shifts before

applying the Gaussian integral in the free lattice coordinates. On a compact complex strict window, the factorial expansion is

$$G_N(N\alpha + c) = \sqrt{2N \sin \pi\alpha}\, e^{NJ(\alpha)} (2 \sin \pi\alpha)^c (1 + O(N^{-1})). \tag{6.4}$$

The square roots and logarithms continue from positive real arguments. The integer shift $c$ is essential. For a signed leaf the corresponding offset factor is $e^{\delta \partial_x f_\varepsilon}$, evaluated at the changed critical point, not at the complete point or with $g$ in place of $f_\varepsilon$.

Each leaf has prefactor $N^{1/2}$; each of the $H-2$ retained gates has prefactor $N^{-3/2}$. Hence the summand has $N^{3-H}$. A $K = 2H-3$ dimensional lattice Gaussian contributes $N^{K/2}$, leaving $N^{3/2}$. More explicitly, if

$$I_N(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\chi}) = N^{3-H} b_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\chi}) e^{N F_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\chi})} (1 + O(N^{-1})),$$

then the leading packet amplitude is

$$a_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi}) = \frac{(2\pi)^{K/2} b_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}_*(\boldsymbol{\chi}), \boldsymbol{\chi})}{\sqrt{\det[-\partial_{\mathbf{x}}^2 F_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}_*, \boldsymbol{\chi})]}}. \tag{6.5}$$

Every factor in $b_\varepsilon$ is specified by (6.4), the finite signed recurrence, and the offsets (6.1).

**Theorem 6.1** (Exact corridor packet)**.** *For the fixed completed-root expression there are a fixed complex polydisk, a nonzero holomorphic $a_\varepsilon$, and a separately even holomorphic $\Phi_\varepsilon$ such that*

$$C_N(\boldsymbol{\chi}) = N^{3/2} a_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi}) e^{N\Phi_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi})} (1 + O(N^{-1})) \tag{6.6}$$

*uniformly there. The physical source has the comparison*

$$|\mathcal{A}_N(\mathbf{h}) - \eta_N C_N(\mathbf{h}/N)| \le N^C e^{N(F_0 - \gamma)}, \qquad 0 \le h_\ell \le \delta N, \tag{6.7}$$

*where $\eta_N = \exp(\mathrm{i}\pi d \sum_\ell \varepsilon_\ell/4)$ is the retained unit phase. At zero,*

$$\Phi_\varepsilon(0) = F_0, \qquad \partial_{\chi_\ell} \partial_{\chi_j} \Phi_\varepsilon(0) = -\frac{2\pi X_\ell}{1 - \varepsilon_\ell \mathrm{i} X_\ell} \delta_{\ell j}. \tag{6.8}$$

*The statement holds at both parities and all sufficiently large levels.*

*Proof.* The local finite interpolation and its exponentially small error are proved in Appendix B.1. Apply the finite complex lattice Laplace lemma of Appendix B.1.8 to the full rectangular window. That lemma uses exact cotangent residues, bounds every vertical side and nonconstant cotangent mode, and translates the ordinary integral to the unique complex critical point. It gives (6.6) and (6.5).

At completeness, the signed multiplier relative to the positive amplitude is

$$\prod_{\varepsilon_\ell \neq 0} \sqrt{\sin \pi a_\ell} \exp(-\mathrm{i}\varepsilon_\ell \pi a_\ell/2),$$

which is nonzero. The positive amplitude is positive by the strict Gaussian. For pure colors, separate evenness makes the mixed wire–color derivative vanish at zero, and direct differentiation of (6.2) gives $-2\pi X_\ell$. The shear transforms it to (6.8). Its real part is strictly negative. The source estimates of Chapter 5, together with the finite-window local error, prove (6.7). All lattice offsets are fixed integers and no parity-dependent lattice density occurs. □

After shrinking the polydisk, this implies a source-specific Gaussian upper bound

$$|C_N(\mathbf{x}+\mathrm{i}\mathbf{y})| \le N^C \exp N\{F_0 - a_0\|\mathbf{x}\|^2 + B_0\|\mathbf{y}\|^2\}, \qquad a_0 > 0. \tag{6.9}$$

This bound is needed for the finite Fourier contours. A pointwise asymptotic on the physical grid would not imply it.

## 6.4 An exact three-leaf calibration

For $C(h^3)$ choose the three leaf indices $i, j, k$ as free coordinates. The surviving gate output is $d-k$, so its limiting output is $1-x_3$ with integer offset $-1$. The complete phase is

$$F(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{\ell=1}^{3} g(x_\ell) + m(x_1, x_2, 1-x_3).$$

Its stationary point is $x_\ell = a = \arctan 2/\pi$. The negative Hessian is

$$A = \frac{25\pi}{4}(I_3 + \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^T), \qquad \sqrt{\det A} = \frac{125\pi^{3/2}}{4}.$$

The three unshifted leaf amplitudes are $\sqrt{10}/8$, the unshifted gate amplitude is $5\sqrt{10}/16$, and the gate offset is $e^{-m_z} = 4$ at completeness. Thus $b = 125/512$ and $a_0 = \sqrt{2}/64$. The complete rate is $F_0 = 2v_8/\pi$, so the augmented volume is $4v_8$. At a changed color the offset is $e^{-m_z}$ evaluated at the changed critical point; it is not the constant four.

The alias proof for this isolated case uses the exact symmetric kernel

$$\phi(\widehat{B}_i\widehat{B}_j\widehat{B}_k) = \frac{s_{i+j}s_{i+k}s_{j+k}}{N s_i s_j s_k s_{i+j+k-d}}$$

on $i+j, i+k, j+k \le d$ and $i+j+k \ge d$, and zero elsewhere. It follows from (2.12) and $s_r s_{d-r} = N$. For one or two aliases, algebraic reassociation groups the aliased leaves into a two-leaf block and uses Lemma 5.1 at $X = 1/2$; the remaining core tangent cancels the output slope, with only $\log 4/N$ from the closing shift. For three aliases, $k \le v_3/\pi$ and $m \le 3v_3/\pi$, while $6v_3 < 2v_8$. The exact rational margin and its elementary bounds are included in the reproduction suite. This is a source identity, not a tangle move. The one-leaf cap seam in the geometric closure is $\pi/2$, as in Chapter 4. These observations supply the same packet and filling argument for the isolated three-leaf case.

# Chapter 7

# Peripheral curves and the volume after filling

We now identify the complex action from Chapter 6 with a deformation of the actual augmented link complement. A cusp cross section is a torus. A small loop going around the corresponding link component is its meridian, and the original crossing disk specifies the longitude used in the surgery convention. These curves must be primitive: together they form an integral basis, rather than nontrivial multiples of a basis.

A *marked deformation* keeps those curves, their orientations, and the continuously selected holonomy logarithms. The complex-valued function $G$ below is a volume primitive: its derivative records the peripheral holonomies, and an explicit boundary correction recovers the volume of the representation. The complete metric fixes its additive constant. This information is what connects the critical point of the filling integral to the knot complement with the intended surgery slopes.

## 7.1 From a metric modulus to peripheral coordinates

The real boundary shape parameter $e^{-f'_E(b)}$ describes an ordered ideal quadrilateral. To identify the filling action with volume, one must also construct the nearby representation on the same link exterior, specify the two auxiliary peripheral curves, and fix the additive constant of its regulator. Matching only a Hessian or an unmarked cusp shape would not suffice.

Appendix D gives the local rational face maps and their compositions. The construction starts at the complete metric of Chapter 4. It continues the leaf apex flags and the prism coordinates in the selected source variables. The input and output maps obey the nine local prism compatibility identities, so the white-face map is independent of the sequence of glued cells. The pure and signed shaded pairings give pointwise edge relations. The main cusps stay parabolic. The resulting framed representation is holomorphic on the same sufficiently small parameter neighborhood used by the packet.

**Proposition 7.1** (Marked source primitive)**.** *For the completed-root source, with the original disk framings and half-twist signs, the selected deformation has centered primitive auxiliary logarithms*

$$U_\ell = -2\pi\mathrm{i}\chi_\ell, \qquad V_\ell = -2\partial_{\chi_\ell}\Phi_\varepsilon. \tag{7.1}$$

*Its absolute complex volume primitive can be chosen as*

$$G = 2\pi\mathrm{i}\Phi_\varepsilon, \qquad dG = \frac{1}{2}\sum_\ell V_\ell\, dU_\ell, \qquad \Im G(0) = \mathrm{Vol}(Y_E^\varepsilon) = 2\pi F_0. \tag{7.2}$$

*The half-twist contribution is the specified quadratic correction $-\varepsilon_\ell V_\ell^2/8$ in $G$. The physical filling power is $\varepsilon_\ell - 2p_\ell$.*

*Proof.* The local rational identities and original peripheral paths are proved in Appendix D. Differentiating the shear (6.3) gives the same boundary covectors as the pure source after the primitive meridian shear. Across each paired quadrilateral gluing face the two internal covectors cancel, leaving only the auxiliary boundary terms. Thus the differential is (7.2). The complete polyhedron fixes its imaginary constant, so no arbitrary additive volume normalization remains. The sign of the meridian shear is determined by the original collar path, not merely by the unmarked half-twist pairing. □

For perspective, in the leaf coordinate $E = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}a}$ the complete disk longitude has translation $-2(E+1)$. The two signed meridian collar paths have translations $-2$ and $2E$, differing by that longitude. Each pair spans the area of the two cusp rectangles and is primitive. Their relation to the quantum sign is checked with the recorded crossing convention. This explains why the two signs can have the same complete volume but different filling equations.

## 7.2 Geometric completion for long primitive slopes

Solving a matrix equation that kills a peripheral element does not alone construct a smooth filled metric. We need to show that the geometric end closes around a solid-torus axis with angular period exactly $2\pi$. The marked curves and small logarithms make that check possible. We first solve the equations near the complete structure and then use the explicit end construction in Appendix D. The local deformation is a representation of the actual augmented-link group near its oriented complete holonomy, with a bounded finite collection of framed vertices and face maps. The strict complete shapes remain nondegenerate in a small neighborhood. The primitive equations

$$U_\ell + p_\ell V_\ell = -2\pi\mathrm{i} \tag{7.3}$$

have a unique nearby solution for all independently sufficiently large signed $p_\ell$. One can see the local existence by writing $1/p_\ell$ as independent small parameters and applying the implicit-function theorem to the cusp equations. The sign and the integer on the right side are fixed by the primitive collar, not chosen after solving a formal equation.

The geometric completion argument in Appendix D constructs a smooth solid-torus completion at each filled cusp on this branch. The remaining main cusp stays complete. It applies on one fixed neighborhood, hence requires only a lower bound on each $|p_\ell|$, with no comparison between them. The resulting complete metric is on the topology obtained by the specified auxiliary disk fillings. After the knot pairing choice and all such fillings, that topology is $S^3 \setminus K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})$.

Set

$$S_{\varepsilon,\mathbf{p}}(\boldsymbol{\chi}) = \Phi_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\chi}) + \frac{\pi\mathrm{i}}{2}\sum_\ell \frac{(\chi_\ell - 1)^2}{p_\ell}. \tag{7.4}$$

Its critical equations are exactly (7.3), by (7.1). The regulator with the solid-torus correction gives

$$2\pi\Re S_{\varepsilon,\mathbf{p}}(\boldsymbol{\chi}_*) = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})). \tag{7.5}$$

This is an equality on the selected, correctly marked branch. Chapter 8 proves that the full finite invariant has a nonzero leading contribution with precisely this action.

# Chapter 8

# Evaluating the complete oscillatory filling sum

The geometric saddle has now been identified, but the invariant is still the full finite sum over auxiliary colors in (2.21). This chapter proves that the saddle actually contributes to that sum with a nonzero coefficient, and that all other contributions are smaller. In particular, we do not infer the knot volume from the complete-color growth rate.

We convert the exact Hermite interpolation coefficients into a Fourier expansion. Its integer indices are called charges. The zero charge vanishes by an exact boundary identity; the charges with absolute value one give the leading term. To justify that conclusion, we control both the infinite charge tails and the boundary integrals introduced by moving contours. The latter are the *endpoint currents* mentioned below.

## 8.1 Replacing the color sum by its controlled local part

For the fixed diagram, Chapters 5 and 6 give a global physical-color gap, an exponentially accurate separately even corridor packet, and a uniform holomorphic asymptotic. In this chapter write $b = H$ for the number of filled circles, $\varphi = \Phi_\varepsilon$, and

$$\varphi''(0) = 2\pi\mathrm{i}\,\mathrm{diag}(\tau_1, \dots, \tau_b), \qquad \tau_\ell = \frac{\mathrm{i}X_\ell}{1 - \varepsilon_\ell \mathrm{i}X_\ell}, \qquad \Im\tau_\ell > 0.$$

The different cusps need not have equal $\tau_\ell$. The packet exponent is $\mu = 3/2$.

The coefficient mass bound in (2.20) shows that the global source error and the corridor comparison error cost only a polynomial in $N$ for fixed twists. They remain exponentially below $e^{NF_0}$. This removal takes place before folding colors: an alias need not be even and is not artificially made so. It remains to analyze the exact even corridor.

Let $H_N = \lfloor \delta N \rfloor$, and define its finite Fourier polynomial

$$\mathcal{F}_N(\mathbf{z}) = \sum_{|h_\ell| \le H_N} C_N(\mathbf{h}/N) e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}\mathbf{h}\cdot\mathbf{z}}. \tag{8.1}$$

This is an entire, one-periodic function in each variable and is separately even. It is finite at every $N$; no infinite-lattice extension has been made.

## 8.2 An exact Fourier bound away from zero frequency

We record the finite contour estimate that controls the physical endpoints. In one coordinate suppose

$$|C_N(x+\mathrm{i}y)| \le N^C e^{N(F-ax^2+By^2)}$$

on a fixed tube. For a fixed $\phi_0 > 0$ and fixed nonnegative integer $r$,

$$\left|\sum_{h=-H_N}^{H_N} h^r C_N(h/N) e^{\mathrm{i}\phi h}\right| \le N^{C_r} e^{N(F-g)}, \qquad \operatorname{dist}(\phi, 2\pi\mathbb{Z}) \ge \phi_0, \tag{8.2}$$

for some $g > 0$.

To prove it, reduce $\phi$ to $[\phi_0, 2\pi - \phi_0]$ and use the rectangle in the unscaled variable $z$ with real sides $\pm(H_N + 1/2)$ and imaginary sides $\pm\sigma N$. The exact residue formula is

$$\frac{1}{2\pi\mathrm{i}} \oint z^r C_N(z/N) e^{\mathrm{i}\phi z} (\pi \cot \pi z - \mathrm{i}\pi)\, \mathrm{d}z.$$

The kernel equals $2\pi\mathrm{i}/(e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}z} - 1)$. On the upper and lower horizontal sides the products with $e^{\mathrm{i}\phi z}$ are bounded by $4\pi e^{-\phi\sigma N}$ and $4\pi e^{-(2\pi-\phi)\sigma N}$. On a vertical half-integer side the bound is $2\pi e^{-\phi_0|\Im z|}$. Choose $\sigma$ first so that $B\sigma^2$ is smaller than both half the horizontal loss and half the real boundary loss. All four sides then have a strict exponential gap. This proves (8.2); fixed derivatives are treated by the factor $h^r$. The argument is uniform in the other real colors and in a smaller complex neighborhood of any remaining parameters.

## 8.3 The total derivative and the zero-charge cancellation

The derivative terms in Hermite interpolation are especially important at this step. Together with the values at the roots, they combine into one total derivative on a finite midpoint grid. This exact identity determines the endpoint behavior and removes the zero Fourier mode. It is proved before any stationary-phase approximation is made. The exact Fourier–Hermite interpolation of Appendix A.4 has a useful combined form. In one color, for the normalized power $r_N^{2P}$, put

$$U_N(z) = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}PNz^2} \sinh(2\pi\mathrm{i}z) \mathcal{F}_N(z), \qquad z_k = (k + 1/2)/N - 1/2.$$

Then the folded color pairing is exactly

$$\sum_{h=0}^{H_N} \beta_{N-h-1}^P C_N(h/N) = \frac{(-1)^d \kappa^{-P}}{2\pi\mathrm{i}N^2} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} U_N'(z_k). \tag{8.3}$$

The derivative contains both the $h$ term and the linear normal term from the Hermite data. Removing either would change this identity.

The endpoint values satisfy

$$U_N(1/2) = U_N(-1/2) = 0, \qquad U_N'(1/2) = U_N'(-1/2).$$

The periodic extension of $U'_N$ is continuous and piecewise smooth. Two integrations by parts give an absolutely summable Fourier series at each fixed $N$. Midpoint Fourier selection followed by one integration by parts gives

$$(-1)^d\kappa^{-P}\sum_{m\neq 0}(-1)^{md}m\int_{-1/2}^{1/2}e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}N(Pz^2-mz)}\sinh(2\pi\mathrm{i}z)\mathcal{F}_N(z)\,\mathrm{d}z. \tag{8.4}$$

There is no zero charge: it vanishes from the two exact endpoint zeros. For an even source the terms at $m$ and $-m$ are equal, because both $m$ and the hyperbolic sine change sign. This equality precedes any saddle approximation.

Taking $P_\ell = -p_\ell$ in every color and restoring the Cartan factors gives the full corridor expression

$$\chi_N\eta_N(-1)^{bd}\kappa^{-\sum p_\ell}\sum_{\mathbf{m}\in(\mathbb{Z}\setminus\{0\})^b}(-1)^{d\sum m_\ell}\prod_\ell m_\ell \times\int_{[-1/2,1/2]^b}e^{-2\pi\mathrm{i}N\sum_\ell(p_\ell z_\ell^2+m_\ell z_\ell)}\prod_\ell\sinh(2\pi\mathrm{i}z_\ell)\mathcal{F}_N(\mathbf{z})\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{z}. \tag{8.5}$$

This is a sum of commuting color-register functionals. No physical box is commuted through another box.

## 8.4 Uniform charge tails and their endpoint currents

A Fourier series can converge for each $N$ without having a tail estimate uniform enough for an exponential limit. We therefore bound the tails directly. Moving the interval downward or upward adds two vertical boundary segments. Their difference vanishes to second order at height zero; this cancellation produces a summable power of the charge. We retain the pair together rather than discard either boundary segment. Absolute convergence at each $N$ is not a uniform exponential tail estimate. We prove the latter before using a Gaussian approximation. By (8.2), $\mathcal{F}_N$ and its first few derivatives are exponentially small on fixed complex strips based at $z=\pm 1/2$. Fix a small strip height $\sigma$ using only this source estimate.

For $m>0$, shift the one-dimensional Fourier integral down by $\sigma$. On the horizontal side the source's physical support gives a bound with exponent

$$F_0 - 2\pi\sigma(m-|P|-\delta).$$

The two vertical sides must be paired. Their common Fourier endpoint phase is $(-1)^{mN}$, and their difference is

$$V_N(v) = U_N(1/2-\mathrm{i}v) - U_N(-1/2-\mathrm{i}v), \qquad 0\le v\le\sigma.$$

Periodicity of the finite Fourier polynomial and the exact endpoint relations give $V_N(0) = V'_N(0) = 0$. Keeping the chirp's height-dependent cost, rather than bounding it at the top of the strip, gives

$$|V_N(v)| \le \mathrm{poly}(N,P)v^2e^{N(F_0-g_1)+2\pi|P|Nv}.$$

Therefore

$$\left|m\int_0^\sigma e^{-2\pi mNv}V_N(v)\,\mathrm{d}v\right| \le \frac{\mathrm{poly}(N,P)m}{N^3(m-|P|)^3}e^{N(F_0-g_1)}, \qquad m>|P|. \tag{8.6}$$

This is summable for $m > 2|P| + 2\delta + 2$. The upper shift treats negative $m$. Neither vertical current has been set to zero.

In several variables, remove tails one at a time while all other chirps remain on real grids or finite real integrals. If $D_i$ is the exact sampled derivative functional and $D_i^{\mathrm{lo}}$ its finite-charge restriction, use the exact identity

$$\prod_i D_i - \prod_i D_i^{\mathrm{lo}} = \sum_i \left( \prod_{j<i} D_j^{\mathrm{lo}} \right) (D_i - D_i^{\mathrm{lo}}) \left( \prod_{j>i} D_j \right).$$

The low-charge functionals have finite supremum norm; the sampled ones and their fixed derivatives cost powers of $N$ and the fixed slopes. All spectator chirps have modulus one. Thus each term has the exponential gap of (8.6), without a factor $e^{N|p_j|}$ from a different cusp. This is the point that permits independently unequal long slopes.

## 8.5 The central Fourier packet

The implicit-function theorem defines $\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z})$ by

$$\nabla\varphi(\boldsymbol{\xi}) + 2\pi\mathrm{i}\mathbf{z} = 0.$$

Set

$$\Psi(\mathbf{z}) = \varphi(\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z})) + 2\pi\mathrm{i}\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z}) \cdot \mathbf{z}, \qquad B(\mathbf{z}) = \frac{(2\pi)^{b/2} a_\varepsilon(\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z}))}{\sqrt{\det[-\varphi''(\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z}))]}}. \tag{8.7}$$

Both functions are separately even, $B(0) \neq 0$, and

$$\Psi(\mathbf{z}) = F_0 - \pi\mathrm{i} \sum_\ell \frac{z_\ell^2}{\tau_\ell} + O(\|\mathbf{z}\|^4). \tag{8.8}$$

Exact half-grid cotangent rectangles applied to (8.1) turn it into $N^b$ times its finite real integral, with exponentially small boundary and nonconstant-mode errors. Translate that integral to the parallel real contour through $\boldsymbol{\xi}(\mathbf{z})$. The strict complex Gaussian estimate controls the connectors. Gaussian integration gives, uniformly on a fixed complex polydisk,

$$\mathcal{F}_N(\mathbf{z}) = N^{\mu+b/2} B(\mathbf{z}) e^{N\Psi(\mathbf{z})} (1 + O(N^{-1})). \tag{8.9}$$

This argument applies to the exact $C_N$, not to a pointwise real-grid approximation whose error might have uncontrolled Fourier behavior.

## 8.6 Local charges for independently signed slopes

After the tail estimate, only finitely many charges remain for the fixed filling tuple. Their saddles must be compared uniformly when the filling integers have different signs and magnitudes. We use the reciprocal slopes $1/p_\ell$ and the ratios $m_\ell/p_\ell$ as independent parameters. This gives one neighborhood in which the saddle equations and the charge comparison are valid, instead of assuming the slopes are comparable. For a nonzero integer vector $\mathbf{m}$, define

$$T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{z}) = \Psi(\mathbf{z}) - 2\pi\mathrm{i} \sum_\ell (p_\ell z_\ell^2 + m_\ell z_\ell).$$

Write $e_\ell = 1/p_\ell$ and $t_\ell = m_\ell/p_\ell$. The saddle equations are

$$z_\ell = -\frac{t_\ell}{2} + \frac{e_\ell \Psi_\ell(\mathbf{z})}{4\pi \mathrm{i}}. \tag{8.10}$$

At $\mathbf{e} = 0$ their derivative in $\mathbf{z}$ is the identity, so one fixed polydisk in $(\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{e})$ has a unique holomorphic solution. Completing the square yields

$$T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{z}(\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{e})) = \frac{\pi \mathrm{i}}{2} \sum_\ell \frac{t_\ell^2}{e_\ell} + \widehat{B}(t_1^2, \dots, t_b^2, \mathbf{e}), \tag{8.11}$$

where the remainder is holomorphic even at $e_\ell = 0$. For real parameters the first term is purely imaginary. Put $b_\ell = \pi \Im \tau_\ell / |\tau_\ell|^2 > 0$. Equation (8.8) gives

$$\partial_{t_\ell^2} \Re \widehat{B}(0, 0) = -b_\ell/4.$$

On one smaller fixed real box these derivatives are at most $-b_\ell/8$. Integrating along the squared coordinates proves

$$\Re T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{z}_{\mathbf{m}}) \le \Re T_{\mathbf{1}}(\mathbf{z}_*) - \sum_\ell \frac{b_\ell}{8} \frac{m_\ell^2 - 1}{p_\ell^2} \tag{8.12}$$

for all local nonzero charges. The strict loss holds unless every $|m_\ell| = 1$. This is an exact analytic inequality on a fixed parameter box, not a conclusion from a truncated expansion with comparable slopes.

Separate evenness writes $\Psi_\ell = z_\ell Q_\ell(z_1^2, \dots, z_b^2)$. Thus

$$z_\ell = -\frac{t_\ell}{2(1 - e_\ell Q_\ell/(4\pi \mathrm{i}))}.$$

For a nonzero charge, $z_\ell \neq 0$; on the small neighborhood $\sinh(2\pi \mathrm{i} z_\ell) \neq 0$. The real part of the translated-contour Hessian stays negative definite. Hence the local Gaussian coefficient is nonzero for negative as well as positive slopes.

There are finitely many charges left after the tails were removed. A charge outside the local ratio box has some $|m_i/p_i| \ge t_0$. Split its real interval at $|z_i| = t_0/4$. Outside, the source Fourier bound has a fixed loss. Inside, $|m_i + 2p_i z_i| \ge |p_i| t_0/2$; a small imaginary displacement of the appropriate sign decreases the filling phase. The displacement can be chosen within the fixed source tube, and its joining segments are estimated with the same nonstationary inequality and the endpoint Fourier loss. Spectator coordinates are still real. This supplies a fixed exponential loss for every such nonlocal charge. For local saddles, the connector height is $O(|p_i|^{-1} |m_i/p_i|)$ by the displayed factorization, which keeps their boundary losses below the selected saddle. These estimates are detailed in Appendix B.3.

## 8.7 Noncancellation and the final action

The $2^b$ charges with $|m_\ell| = 1$ have identical complex critical action. Under $(m_\ell, z_\ell) \mapsto (-m_\ell, -z_\ell)$, the product $m_\ell \sinh(2\pi \mathrm{i} z_\ell)$, the parity character and the integral are unchanged. They add exactly. For these charges the factor $(-1)^{bd+d\sum m_\ell}$ in (8.5) is one.

Combining (8.9) with the $b$-dimensional Gaussian gives

$$\langle K(\mathbf{p})\rangle_N = \chi_N \eta_N \kappa^{-\sum p_\ell} N^{3/2} D(\mathbf{p}) e^{NT_{\mathbf{1}}(\mathbf{z}_*)}(1 + O_{\mathbf{p}}(N^{-1})), \tag{8.13}$$

where

$$D(\mathbf{p}) = \frac{2^b(2\pi)^{b/2} B(\mathbf{z}_*) \prod_\ell \sinh(2\pi \mathrm{i} z_{*,\ell})}{\sqrt{\det[-T_{\mathbf{1}}''(\mathbf{z}_*)]}} \neq 0. \tag{8.14}$$

The Gaussian branches are fixed by the translated original real contours. The selected real action tends to $F_0$ as all $1/p_\ell \to 0$. Enlarge the fixed slope threshold so that it lies above every source, endpoint, nonlocal-charge and interpolation error level. Equation (8.13) then holds for the whole source, not only for the corridor.

Finally $\Psi_\ell = 2\pi \mathrm{i} \xi_\ell$ and the charge-one saddle equation give $\xi_\ell = 1 + 2p_\ell z_{*,\ell}$. Substitution into the Legendre expression shows

$$T_{\mathbf{1}}(\mathbf{z}_*) = \varphi(\boldsymbol{\xi}) + \frac{\pi \mathrm{i}}{2} \sum_\ell \frac{(\xi_\ell - 1)^2}{p_\ell} = S_{\varepsilon,\mathbf{p}}(\boldsymbol{\xi}).$$

Equations (7.5), (8.13) and Proposition 2.1 prove Theorem 1.2. The construction fills precisely the auxiliary cusps. The surviving cusp is the knot cusp, so the right side is the knot complement volume.

# Chapter 9

# An explicit volume theorem for ordered trees of crossing circles

The number of twists at a region is not the only quantity that can make filling controllable. In the construction below, a crossing circle of large degree meets many geometric pieces. Its complete cusp makes even a small integer twist correspond to a long normalized filling slope. This gives a numerical sufficient condition for the volume conjecture in which some twist coefficients may be short or zero.

## 9.1 The knot construction

A two-string tangle is drawn in a ball with four ordered boundary points: lower left, lower right, upper right, upper left. A product places one ball above another and joins their two adjacent endpoints by uncrossed arcs. The order of the factors is retained. The operation $T$ rotates an entire ball through the specified quarter-turn in the diagram plane. Cylindrical closure joins lower left to upper left and lower right to upper right outside the final ball.

Fix a finite tree $\mathcal{T}$ with at least one edge, together with the cyclic order of the edges and the tangle frame at each vertex. There is one original crossing circle at every vertex, including the terminal vertices. There is no unmarked product junction. Each edge represents an actual quarter-turn of a child tangle, rather than a crossing of two drawn edges.

Here is a precise recursive way to specify the diagrams. Choose a terminal vertex as root. At a nonroot vertex $v$, put the integer braid $R^{n_v}$ between the two ordered lists of its child tangles:

$$W_v = \left( \prod_{w \in I_v^-} T(W_w) \right) R^{n_v} \left( \prod_{w \in I_v^+} T(W_w) \right). \tag{9.1}$$

The lists $I_v^-$ and $I_v^+$ specify the position of the crossing box in the original cyclic order. Empty lists are allowed. If $w$ is the root's unique neighbor, close $R^{n_0} T(W_w)$ cylindrically. This is an actual link diagram, not a tensor network considered only up to scalar identities. Other choices of cutting section are related by the physical closed-collar moves, with their induced rotations and reversals of factor order retained.

The augmented diagram replaces each $R^{n_v}$ by its crossing circle and a retained half twist $\epsilon_v \in \{0, \pm 1\}$, where $n_v \equiv \epsilon_v \pmod 2$. Filling that circle on its original disk-framed slope

$\mu_v + p_v\lambda_v$, with

$$n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v, \tag{9.2}$$

restores exactly the indicated integer braid. Here $\mu_v$ goes once around the auxiliary circle and $\lambda_v$ follows its punctured disk. The main strands are not filled.

We require that the closed main strands form one knot $K$. This includes excluding a closed main component created inside an intermediate box. The test uses only the strand pairings and the parities of the $n_v$; large magnitudes alone do not guarantee it. Write $d_v$ for the degree of $v$ in the circle tree and $E = |E(\mathcal{T})|$. This graph degree is unrelated to the quantum level $N$.

## 9.2 The quantitative theorem

Let $F_N(M)$ be the zero-framed reduced Akutsu–Deguchi–Ohtsuki (ADO) invariant of the actual knot, normalized to one on the unknot. Its marked meridian coordinate is $M$, and at $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$ its complete value is the reduced Kashaev invariant $K_N(K) = F_N(1)$. Moving the meridian on the scale considered here means setting $M = q_N^s$, with $s$ in a fixed complex disk. Define

$$\mathfrak{S}(\mathcal{T}, \mathbf{n}) = \sum_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2}, \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin(\pi s)}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, \quad H_N(0) = 1. \tag{9.3}$$

Let $w(D)$ be the oriented writhe of the actual filled diagram, using the same positive checked-crossing convention as $R$. The exact framing and crossing factor is

$$A_N(s) = q_N^{a(D)s^2/2}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v. \tag{9.4}$$

The power uses the fixed logarithm $\log q_N = \pi i/N$. All crossing and strand-turn factors are included in (9.4); it is not a chosen normalizing phase.

**Theorem 9.1** (A degree and twist criterion)**.** *Fix the ordered tree, its diagram frames, and its signed integer powers before letting $N$ tend to infinity. Suppose the main strands form a knot and*

$$\mathfrak{S}(\mathcal{T}, \mathbf{n}) \le 2^{-25}. \tag{9.5}$$

*Then the knot complement is hyperbolic, and*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K). \tag{9.6}$$

*For every fixed $R < 1$, the stronger statements*

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)A_N(s)H_N(s)} = 1 + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-1}), \qquad |s| \le R, \tag{9.7}$$

*and*

$$\frac{2\pi}{N} \log |F_N(q_N^s)| \longrightarrow \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K) \tag{9.8}$$

*hold uniformly on that disk. In particular these values are nonzero there for all sufficiently large levels. Both level parities and composite levels are included. The tree, its degrees, its twist numbers and the radius $R$ do not grow with $N$.*

The constant in (9.5) is conservative. It makes the condition explicit; no optimality is asserted. There is no additional strict-angle hypothesis for this literal class. Indeed an unturned elementary circle has attainable output interval $(1/2, 1)$, and a turned subtree has interval $(0, 1/2)$. The exact product interval shows that one upper-interval factor together with any number of lower-interval factors again has the full upper interval, in any fixed association. The turn changes it to the lower interval. At the terminal root the two complementary intervals give a strict closing pair. This inductive construction supplies the strict augmented geometry used by the finite-source proof. In the two-circle case the excluded two-odd pattern is not a knot; the knot test retains the necessary even, or pure, leaf.

Two consequences make the range of (9.5) concrete.

- For a tree with $E$ edges, every tuple satisfying $|n_v| \geq 8192\sqrt{E}$ satisfies (9.5), because $\sum_v d_v = 2E$.
- Start with any ordered tree on $m$ vertices, with arbitrary fixed powers at those vertices. Attach $B$ new terminal circles at each vertex and give each added circle a power of magnitude at least $B$. The resulting sum is strictly less than $2m/B$. Hence $B \geq 2^{26}m$ suffices, with the original powers still arbitrary, including zero. The knot/parity test remains necessary.

An unmarked product junction can also be included by inserting the literal identity braid $R^0$ at its prescribed position in the ordered stack. Add a crossing circle there in the augmented diagram and fill it with $\epsilon = p = n = 0$. The filled diagram is unchanged. The augmented exterior is different, and the added degree-$d$ circle contributes $1/d$ to (9.3). This gives a direct application to constructions with sufficiently large-degree unmarked junctions when the same total bound holds. It does not treat such junctions as free or assert that a low-degree unmarked junction satisfies (9.5).

All these are finite constructions. Their potentially large size is fixed before the quantum limit. Related results use several invariant and root conventions; the coverage discussion records their precise scopes.

## 9.3 Why the original exterior has the required geometric pieces

Cut the augmented diagram along the projection sphere and the original crossing disks. The two resulting balls carry white projection faces and shaded disk triangles. At a leaf with half-segments $(v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3)$, the shaded triangles are $(O_v, v_1, v_2)$ and $(O_v, v_3, v_0)$, where $O_v$ is the auxiliary-circle end. The literal strand matching fixes every cyclic vertex order and hence every white face boundary.

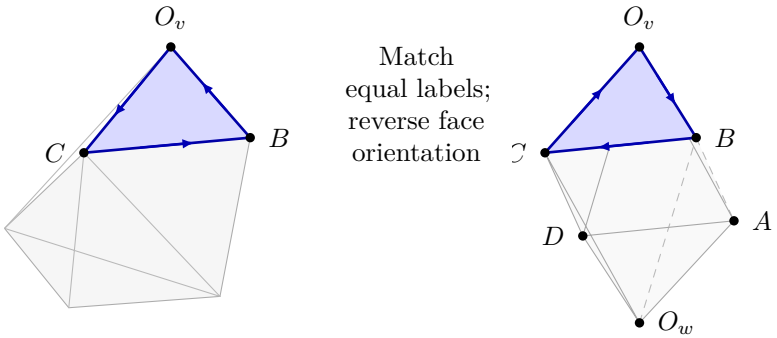
Adding one terminal child supplies an explicit local cell attachment. Let $h_v$ denote the quarter-turned crossing-circle tangle. Write its parent's unturned box as $P_v = T^{-1}h_v$, so its exposed tuple is $(v_3, v_0, v_1, v_2)$. If the old downstream matches are $v_1 - x_1$ and $v_2 - x_2$, insertion of $h_w$ immediately after $P_v$ replaces them by

$$v_1 - w_1, \quad v_2 - w_0, \quad w_2 - x_1, \quad w_3 - x_2. \tag{9.9}$$

Set $C = (v_1, x_1)$, $B = (v_2, x_2)$, $D = (v_1, w_1)$, and $A = (v_2, w_0)$. An octahedron with opposite vertices $O_v, O_w$ and equator $A, B, C, D$ has shaded faces

$$(O_v, B, C), \quad (O_v, D, A), \quad (O_w, D, C), \quad (O_w, B, A). \tag{9.10}$$

Glue its first face to the old face $(O_v, C, B)$, with the opposite boundary orientation. The other three faces are precisely the new shaded faces prescribed by (9.9). The adjacent white sectors also concatenate in the literal strand order. Thus this is an attachment in the original cut, not a recognition based on equal volumes.




Existing projection ball
shaded face $(O_v, C, B)$

New octahedron
for edge $vw$
shaded face $(O_v, B, C)$

The glued triangle becomes internal. The three other shaded faces of the octahedron retain the circle $v$ and introduce the circle $w$.

Figure 9.1: Attaching one octahedron in a projection half of the actual augmented tangle diagram. Equal labels are identified, and the blue faces have opposite boundary orientations. The triangle becomes internal; the other three shaded disk faces retain the parent circle and introduce the child circle, as listed in (9.10). Only the attachment faces are blue. The labels $O_v, O_w$ belong to the original auxiliary crossing circles. The same attachment is made in the other projection half.

The left-insertion version attaches along the other parent triangle. It allows the parent box to remain at its specified position among its children. Start from one tree edge and insert the remaining children in the appropriate left and right order, carrying each rotated child ball with its frame. Each projection half is a tree of $E$ octahedra attached along $E - 1$ triangles. Its remaining shaded faces are exactly the original two per circle.

The internal interfaces give the additional disk pages. At a circle of degree $d_v$, the $d_v$ incident blocks occur in the original cyclic order. One distinguished seam retains the original half twist; the other seams are the untwisted insertion maps. In particular the construction does not put one copy of the retained crossing on every incident edge. It also retains the actual half-turn produced when a turn is moved across the closing sphere. Restoring the labeled faces recovers the original augmented link and its primitive disk paths. The ordered decomposition proof gives the full half-segment and face-word calculation.

## 9.4 Positive cells and primitive filling periods

For an edge with endpoint angular variables $t, u$, the finite quantum sum has the following analytic phase. Its derivatives determine the geometric logarithms below:

$$\begin{aligned} \psi(t,u) &= \operatorname*{stat}_x [b(x,t) + b(x,u)], \\ b(x,t) &= \int_0^x \log(2\cos 2\pi v + 2\cos t)\, dv - 2J(x), \\ J(x) &= \int_0^x \log(2\sin \pi v)\, dv. \end{aligned} \tag{9.11}$$

Branches continue $x = 1/4, t = u = 0$. In particular

$$\tan^2(\pi x) = \frac{1}{1 + \tan^2(t/2) + \tan^2(u/2)}, \qquad \psi_t = -\frac{1}{\pi}\operatorname{arsinh}(\tan(t/2)\cos(u/2)). \tag{9.12}$$

Let $\Psi = \sum_{vw} \psi(\tau_v, \tau_w)$. The first Fourier term of the exact crossing traces has phase

$$\Psi(\boldsymbol{\tau}) + \frac{i}{4\pi}\sum_v n_v \tau_v^2 - i\sum_v \tau_v. \tag{9.13}$$

To locate its geometric branch, vary its last coefficient continuously from zero to one. For $0 \le c \le 1$ solve

$$\Psi_{\tau_v} + \frac{i n_v}{2\pi}\tau_v = ic, \qquad \boldsymbol{\tau}(0) = 0. \tag{9.14}$$

The quantitative estimate (9.5) gives a unique branch with

$$|\tau_v(c)| \le \frac{2\pi c}{(1 - 1/50)\sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2}} < 0.00111, \qquad \Im\tau_v(c) < 0 \quad (c > 0). \tag{9.15}$$

This is a bound on each local angular parameter. It is not a bound requiring the total primitive meridian logarithm to stay near zero.

Each edge block admits eight positively oriented ideal tetrahedra whenever both angular parameters have modulus at most 0.01. Their complete shapes are $i$, and their deformed shapes stay within distance 0.4 of $i$. On a disk page put $Q = e^{i\tau_v}$. The three complex ratios on its incoming edges are $(-Q^{-1}, -Q, -Q^{-1})$; the outgoing ratios are their inverses. These ratios keep both angle and shear, and depend only on this circle's parameter. Consequently adjacent blocks fit even if their other endpoints have different parameters. At the distinguished odd seam the original cross-copy disk maps exchange the prescribed punctures. Their full matrix edge words are identities. Positivity and continuation fix every interior edge angle at $2\pi$.

The actual meridian crosses the consecutive disk-page sectors once. A pure edge contributes $-2\pi\psi_{\tau_v}$; the single retained half twist contributes $-i\epsilon_v\tau_v$. The original primitive logarithms are therefore

$$U_v = -2\pi\Psi_{\tau_v} - i\epsilon_v\tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v, \qquad U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i c. \tag{9.16}$$

These are continued logarithms of actual paths. Their last identity cannot be obtained by reducing $U_v$ to a principal logarithm.

For completeness, the link of an auxiliary ideal vertex is a torus with a nonsingular similarity structure. Since $\Re V_v > 0$, its holonomy has a second fixed point $q_v$ after the marked point has been sent to infinity. The developing image avoids $q_v$: a zero of the invariant vector field $(z - q_v)\partial_z$ has positive index, whereas a torus has total index zero. Hence $\log(z - q_v)$ develops a complete Euclidean torus. Near $c = 0$, $q_v$ tends to infinity and the periods on the fixed original paths tend to zero. Their difference from (9.16) is a continuous integer multiple of $2\pi i$, and is therefore zero along the whole path.

The slope in (9.16) has cone angle $2\pi c$. Its independent longitude has positive real period, so it bounds a punctured metric tube with a positive core length. At $c = 1$, attaching the core produces a smooth solid torus on precisely the original primitive slope. The main cusp stays a complete parabolic cusp. This constructs a complete finite-volume hyperbolic metric on the original knot complement, including the short coefficients permitted by (9.5). The local angular cells give the explicit vertex and face formulas, and the geometric completion proof retains the original odd seams and logarithmic periods throughout this path.

## 9.5 The action and the invariant have the same normalization

The same actual cells fix the additive constant of the complex action. With $V_v = 2i\tau_v$, set

$$G = 2\pi i \left( \Psi - \sum_v \tau_v \Psi_{\tau_v} \right) + \frac{1}{2} \sum_v \epsilon_v \tau_v^2. \tag{9.17}$$

Then $dG = \frac{1}{2} \sum_v V_v \, dU_v$. At zero, its imaginary part is the volume of the original complete augmented link. The marked boundary formula is

$$\mathrm{Vol} = \Im G - \frac{1}{2} \sum_v \Re U_v \Im V_v. \tag{9.18}$$

Let $\mathcal{C}(c)$ be (9.13) with the last term multiplied by $c$, evaluated at (9.14). Substitution of the original filling relation in (9.17)–(9.18) gives

$$\mathrm{Vol}_c = 2\pi \Re \mathcal{C}(c). \tag{9.19}$$

At $c = 1$, the right side is thus the volume of the knot complement just constructed.

The finite invariant selects this action without an assumption about saddle dominance. The polynomial expansion of the finite invariant assigns an integer label $0 \le k < N$ to every internal edge. Its normalized label is $x = k/N$; the high range is $k > \lfloor (N - 1)/2 \rfloor$. The complete contribution of an edge is maximized at $x = 1/4$. Outside $[1/5, 3/10]$, that edge loses a fixed exponential amount; a high index loses a fixed amount as well. The total discarded source has an absolute gap $\pi/200$, independently of graph size, although its polynomial prefactor can depend on the fixed tree and powers. The exact finite angular sum has a Gaussian bound weighted by the vertex degrees. Its real decay constant can be taken as $1/400$ and its imaginary growth constant as 70.

Preconditioning (9.14) by $(d_v - in_v)/(2\pi)$ gives a contraction with constant at most $1/25$. The same estimates compare every retained nonzero Fourier charge with charge one, with a strict loss unless every charge has magnitude one. The exact crossing-trace identity has already paired the reflected positive and negative modes, and the resulting coefficient of the

first charge is exactly one. Exact contour identities bound the omitted charge tails and their joining segments by an absolute exponential error. The possible drop of the first action is at most $\pi(2550/2401)\mathfrak{S}$, which (9.5) places below half the available error gap. Thus the selected term is nonzero for both parities of $N$.

The physical closing trace contributes exactly $H_N$, and all remaining crossing, changes of tensor order and zero-framing factors combine into the exact $A_N$ in (9.4). The bounded insertion on each retained edge is $1 + O(N^{-1})$; the conditioned saddle evaluation therefore gives (9.7). The full constant and the scalar are retained when passing to (9.6)–(9.8). Neither the volume of a comparison diagram nor the complete augmented volume replaces the filled knot volume. The quantitative finite-sum proof contains the uniform contraction, Fourier-tail and joining-contour estimates; the elementary Newton bounds give an independent derivation of the graph-independent decay constants. The exact scalar proof retains the physical strand orientations and framing in (9.4).

## 9.6 A geometric form of the numerical condition

At the complete auxiliary cusp the primitive shape is $2ic_v/(1 - i\epsilon_v c_v)$, where $c_v = 1/d_v$. The normalized length of a slope means its Euclidean length divided by the square root of the cusp area. For the actual primitive filling slope this gives

$$\mathcal{L}_v^2 = \frac{d_v^2 + n_v^2}{2d_v}, \qquad \mathfrak{S} = \frac{1}{2}\sum_v \mathcal{L}_v^{-2}. \tag{9.20}$$

Thus (9.5) is equivalently $\sum_v \mathcal{L}_v^{-2} \le 2^{-24}$. This identity explains why high degree can compensate for a small crossing power. The proof above establishes the completion for these particular ordered exteriors; it does not import an unrelated normalized-length criterion or classify all short fillings.

## 9.7 The preferred cusp and the first correction

The remaining cusp belongs to the knot itself. Normalize its meridian translation to one. Its preferred longitude, which has linking number zero with the knot, then translates by a complex number $\tau_K$, the preferred cusp shape. This geometric normalization is needed to interpret the first correction in the quantum profile.

Let $x_e^*$ be the branch in (9.12) evaluated at $\boldsymbol{\tau}(1)$. The finite edge-insertion calculation retains one further term:

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)A_N(s)H_N(s)} = 1 - \frac{\pi s^2}{N}\sum_e \cot(\pi x_e^*) + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-2}). \tag{9.21}$$

The finite insertion calculation, derived in Sections 5–6 and 8 of the joint wire calculation, has an integrand independent of $s$, multiplied by $1 - \pi s^2 \sum_e \cot(\pi x_e)/N + O(N^{-2})$, uniformly with derivatives. At the nondegenerate joint saddle, the normalized expectation of this coefficient differs from its critical value by $O(N^{-1})$. Its explicit factor $1/N$ makes that an $O(N^{-2})$ error. The common saddle corrections cancel in the ratio, and the other charges and contour terms are exponentially smaller by the quantitative estimate. This proves the remainder in (9.21) under the present summed criterion.

The geometric translation calculation gives, on the same filled branch,

$$\tau_K = a(D) + 2i \sum_e \cot(\pi x_e^*). \tag{9.22}$$

This identification follows from the actual preferred longitude; it is not a definition of the cusp shape from (9.21).

Let $\lambda_{\mathrm{aug}}$ be the preferred main longitude in the augmented exterior and $\mu_K$ its meridian. For the fixed filling integers retain the boundary word $\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}} = \lambda_{\mathrm{aug}} \mu_K^{\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2}$, where $\ell_v$ is the actual linking number with crossing circle $v$. Before the endpoint this is simply a fixed curve on the unfilled main boundary. At $c = 1$, surgery homology identifies it with the preferred longitude of the smooth filled knot complement.

Here is why its translation formula applies beyond the initial small-deformation neighborhood. The edge blocks form a positive ideal triangulation of the original augmented exterior. Near completeness, prescribing the main meridian logarithm and the primitive auxiliary longitude logarithms determines its marked shape germ uniquely. The marked multicusp gluing theorem, Sections 2–3 and 5, proves precisely these mixed peripheral coordinates and the corresponding decorated representation statement. Its logarithmic gluing Jacobian has the form $A + B\,\mathrm{diag}(1/(z_j - 1))$. The edge and peripheral rows are Lagrangian, whereas positivity of the shapes gives $\Im(1/(z_j - 1)) < 0$; pairing a supposed kernel vector with its complex conjugate proves that the Jacobian is invertible.

Developing this triangulation with the earlier marked representation and its actual cusp flags therefore identifies the two representation germs. The exact circle-variable elimination identifies their retained physical-edge labels by (9.12), before any edge is eliminated. The preferred-longitude face-word calculation then supplies the translation $a(D) + 2i \sum_e \cot(\pi x_e)$ for this fixed boundary word near completeness. Both sides continue holomorphically on the small angular chart: the main meridian remains a nonidentity parabolic, so the commuting longitude has a uniquely defined translation in its unit-meridian frame. This ratio has no logarithmic integer ambiguity. Their equality thus continues along the whole positive charge path. At the smooth endpoint the fixed word is the preferred longitude, giving (9.22). The same original surgery homology gives exactly the integer $a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v$, with no unrecorded framing shear.

Put $z = 2\pi i s$ and

$$\mathcal{H}_N(z) = \frac{\sinh(z/2)}{N \sinh(z/(2N))}, \qquad \mathcal{H}_N(0) = 1. \tag{9.23}$$

Combining the exact factor (9.4), the expansion (9.21), and the geometric identity (9.22) gives

$$\frac{F_N(e^{z/(2N)})}{F_N(1)\mathcal{H}_N(z)} = 1 + \frac{\tau_K z^2}{8\pi i N} + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-2}), \qquad |z| \le 2\pi R < 2\pi. \tag{9.24}$$

All fixed derivatives have the corresponding limits on smaller disks. The shape in this formula belongs to the filled knot complement, not the complete augmented link. The exact scalar in (9.4) remains part of the statement; its quadratic expansion is the integer contribution to the preferred cusp in (9.24).

## 9.8 The pointed quantum A-period

Fix a genuine all-level quantum A-operator $P$ annihilating the knot's reduced ADO family. The finite initial vector $c_0$ of ordinary-color polynomials selects its solution. The pointed operator construction, Sections 2–3, gives an ordered recurrence row $r_N(q)$ with

$$\mathscr{P}_N(P, c_0) = \mathrm{CT}_{t=0}\big[r_N(q_N(1+t))c_0(q_N(1+t))\big] = K_N(K). \tag{9.25}$$

The constant Laurent coefficient is taken after multiplying the whole row by the initial vector. This retains cancellations at singular recurrence steps and the required derivatives of the fixed initial data.

**Corollary 9.2.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 9.1,*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log|\mathscr{P}_N(P, c_0)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K). \tag{9.26}$$

*Proof.* The exact reconstruction (9.25) holds at every sufficiently large level. Substitute it in (9.6). □

This is a limit for the operator with its specified initial data. Identifying the selected geometric factor of its classical symbol remains a separate problem and is not used in this corollary.

# Chapter 10

# A local filling condition from subtree polynomials

The summed condition in Chapter 9 compares an error for the complete augmented diagram with the total change of action caused by filling. That comparison is useful when the sum of the changes is small. A tree also permits a different calculation. Evaluate a terminal subtree first, keep its value at zero exactly, and estimate the polynomial left on its one boundary. The next trace then needs to absorb only its own change of action. This chapter proves that this procedure gives a sufficient condition at each vertex, with no sum over the vertices.

We keep exactly the ordered tangle construction of Section 9.1. There is one crossing circle at every vertex of a finite tree, including its terminal vertices. The cyclic orders, positions of the crossing boxes, quarter-turns, disk framings and retained half twists are part of the diagram. Each tree edge is an actual quarter-turn. Write $d_v \geq 1$ for a vertex degree and $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$ for its signed crossing power. The component test must give one main knot, including no closed main component inside an intermediate tangle.

## 10.1 The local volume theorem

The reduced invariant, the root of unity, and the exact scalar factors have the same normalization as before:

$$\begin{aligned} q_N &= e^{\pi i/N}, & K_N(K) &= F_N(1), \\ H_N(s) &= \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, & A_N(s) &= q_N^{a(D)s^2/2}, \\ a(D) &= -w(D) - \sum_v n_v. \end{aligned} \tag{10.1}$$

The removable value of $H_N$ at zero is one. The exponent $a(D)$ uses the oriented writhe of the actual filled diagram and its original checked-crossing convention.

**Theorem 10.1** (A local degree and twist condition)**.** *Fix the ordered tree, its strand frames, its knot parity pattern, and all its signed integer powers. Suppose*

$$\kappa = \max_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \leq 2^{-120}. \tag{10.2}$$

*Then the actual filled knot complement is hyperbolic. For every fixed* $0 \le R < 1$,

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)A_N(s)H_N(s)} = 1 + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-1}), \qquad |s| \le R, \tag{10.3}$$

*and*

$$\frac{2\pi}{N}\log|F_N(q_N^s)| \longrightarrow \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K) \tag{10.4}$$

*uniformly on that disk. These values are nonzero for all sufficiently large levels. The limit includes both parities and composite levels. The tree, the powers and the disk are fixed before* $N$ *tends to infinity.*

The numerical test is independent of the number of vertices. Polynomial prefactors, error constants and starting levels can depend on the entire fixed tree and its powers. Thus the theorem does not assert a limit for a sequence of diagrams growing with $N$. The knot condition also retains the two-circle qualification from Chapter 9: the two-odd pattern is not a knot, so an admissible two-circle knot has a pure leaf.

The constants in the summed and local tests are different. Neither test is being used as an optimal characterization. Both remain sufficient results. A simple consequence of the local test is

$$\frac{d}{d^2+n^2} \le \frac{1}{2|n|} \quad (n \ne 0): \qquad |n_v| \ge 2^{119} \text{ for every } v \quad \Longrightarrow \quad (10.2).$$

This bound no longer grows with the number of edges. A zero power is permitted if its degree is at least $2^{120}$, provided the other vertices satisfy their own inequalities and the diagram is a knot. These large constants make the scope explicit; they are not estimates of the smallest admissible twists. Chapter 11 improves this sufficient bound to $2^{27}$ by proving a larger conditional domain and using a separate decay constant for each outgoing polynomial.

## 10.2 What a subtree leaves on its boundary

Choose a terminal root. A nonroot vertex has one edge toward its parent and a finite ordered list of child subtrees. After evaluating all the crossings and internal edges in those child subtrees, each child leaves a polynomial in the one variable at its boundary. Writing that variable as $-2\cos t$ is convenient for the exact root-of-unity trace. We denote the polynomial value by $M_{w,N}(t)$. It is even and periodic as a function of the angle $t$.

The fixed Newton polynomials $e_k$ and their full pairing are defined in Section E.1. The full edge kernel is

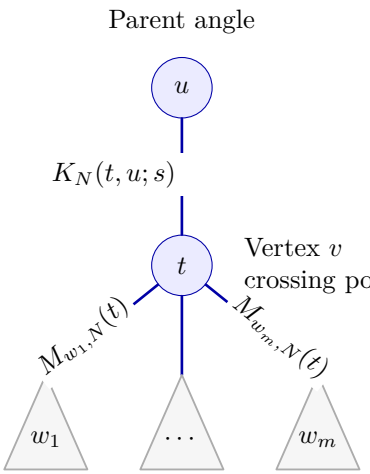
$$K_N(t,u;s) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t)e_k(-2\cos u)\frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}. \tag{10.5}$$

Every Newton index is included. In particular the boundary polynomial is not obtained by discarding high indices before the subtree has been evaluated.

Let $\mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_v,\sigma_v,N}$ be the actual trace after multiplication by the full crossing power at $v$. It acts in $-2\cos t$, takes the remainder in the prescribed Casimir quotient, and retains values and first derivatives at repeated roots. The orientation type determines $\sigma_v \in \{0, s, -s\}$. The edge orientation scalar $\gamma_{e_v}$ belongs to that edge once. The exact outgoing polynomial is

$$M_{v,N}(u) = \gamma_{e_v}(s)\,\mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_v,\sigma_v,N}\left[K_N(t,u;s)\prod_{w \text{ child of } v} M_{w,N}(t)\right]. \tag{10.6}$$

Only $K_N$ depends on $u$. Hence $M_{v,N}(u)$ has trigonometric degree at most $N-1$, independently of the size or depth of the subtree. The trace may receive a polynomial of much larger degree in $-2\cos t$; its quotient operation handles that degree without changing the outgoing degree bound.




The edge keeps every index $0 \le k < N$:

$$K_N(t,u;s) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t)e_k(-2\cos u)\frac{H_N}{W_k}.$$

The trace at $v$ acts only in $t$:

$$M_{v,N}(u) = \gamma_{e_v}\,\mathcal{D}_v^{(t)}\left[K_N(t,u;s)\prod_{j=1}^{m} M_{w_j,N}(t)\right].$$

Trigonometric degree in $u$: at most $N-1$.

Factor out the exact value at zero:

$$\widehat{M}_{v,N}(u) = \frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)}.$$

Its local phase and its real decay control the next trace. The denominator includes all crossing and orientation factors from this subtree.

Figure 10.1: Evaluating a subtree of the original finite contraction. The blue edge retains the full Newton kernel. Each lower triangle denotes a child subtree with its existing polynomial boundary value. The trace at $v$ acts only on $t$, leaving an even trigonometric polynomial in the parent angle $u$. Its value at zero is factored out exactly before estimating the next trace.

The last root trace acts on the product of its child polynomials. The original closing and framing factors, reference factors and one reduced cut factor are then restored. This is a change in the order of a finite tensor contraction. It does not commute tangles or change any physical quarter-turn.

## 10.3 Why the normalization is local

The induction proves that $M_{v,N}(0)$ is nonzero and that, near the origin,

$$\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)} = \frac{\alpha_v(u)}{\alpha_v(0)}e^{Nh_v(u)}(1+O(N^{-1})). \tag{10.7}$$

Here $\alpha_v$ is holomorphic and nonzero, $h_v(0) = h_v'(0) = 0$, and $h_v$ is even. The important uniform property is its curvature:

$$\left|h_v''(u) + \frac{1}{2\pi}\right| \le \frac{1}{40\pi}, \qquad |u| \le 2^{-12}. \tag{10.8}$$

It depends on the single edge joining the subtree to its parent. It does not grow with the number of vertices already evaluated.

To see why this is possible, let $\psi(t,u)$ be the exact edge action of (E.16)–(E.19). The conditional action at a vertex is

$$A_v(t,u) = \psi(t,u) + \sum_w h_w(t).$$

Its $t$ curvature is close to $-d_v/(2\pi)$. After including the crossing chirp and the first Fourier charge, the stationary equation has the form

$$\left(\frac{d_v - in_v}{2\pi}\right) t = -i + E_{v,t}(t,u), \qquad |E_{v,tt}| \le \frac{d_v}{40\pi}.$$

The stationary value, with its value at $u=0$ subtracted, is the new phase $h_v$. Differentiating a stationary value gives a Schur complement:

$$h_v'' = \psi_{uu} - \frac{\psi_{ut}^2}{A_{v,tt} + in_v/(2\pi)}.$$

The denominator grows with $d_v$ and $|n_v|$, whereas the two derivatives in the numerator come from one edge. The explicit edge bounds therefore preserve (10.8).

The exact denominator in (10.7) is essential. On a smaller zero-free disk,

$$\frac{1}{N}\log\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)} = h_v(u) + \frac{1}{N}\log\frac{\alpha_v(u)}{\alpha_v(0)} + O(N^{-2}).$$

The next trace retains this entire expression. Its error changes an analytic amplitude; it does not add the difference between a subtree's complete and filled actions to each of its ancestors.

## 10.4 From a local saddle to the full finite trace

A local expansion alone cannot exclude a larger contribution far from the origin. The induction also proves a real angular envelope for the exact polynomial,

$$\left|\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)}\right| \le CN^A e^{-N2^{-18}(1-\cos u)}, \qquad u \in [-\pi,\pi].$$

The degree bound following (10.6) converts this to a linear bound on complex strips by the subharmonic maximum principle. Near the origin the phase curvature gives a quadratic bound instead. Combining the two proves one fixed complex-strip estimate for every subtree.

The exact crossing trace is then treated on its translated root grid. Its Fourier coefficients retain the Chebyshev factors $U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma_v)$, the parity signs and all endpoint currents. The first coefficient is exactly one. The conditional critical values are strictly ordered with the charge, and all large charges and contour connectors have a fixed conditional loss. Condition (10.2) makes the current vertex's first-charge action drop smaller than that loss. It does not compare this loss with a sum over descendants.

Finally the real envelope is proved afresh from the actual trace: the full polynomial norm of a fixed crossing power, multiplication, quotient reduction and the closing functional cost only a polynomial in $N$. The edge kernel supplies angular decay at the outgoing variable. Dividing by the newly proved nonzero value at zero spends only the same local action drop. This closes the induction. Appendix G gives all constants, finite contours, collision limits and normalizations.

## 10.5 A separate vertexwise metric criterion

The geometric completion requires less than the local quantum condition. The following result is useful independently.

**Theorem 10.2** (Positive completion from vertexwise data)**.** *For the same actual ordered construction, suppose*

$$L_v = \sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \geq 630 \qquad \text{for every } v. \tag{10.9}$$

*Then the charge equations*

$$\Psi_v(\boldsymbol{\tau}) + \frac{in_v}{2\pi}\tau_v = ic, \qquad \Psi = \sum_{vw} \psi(\tau_v, \tau_w), \qquad 0 \leq c \leq 1 \tag{10.10}$$

*have a unique solution in $|\tau_v| \leq 10^{-2}$. It is holomorphic in $c$ near the closed unit disk and satisfies*

$$|\tau_v(c)| \leq \frac{2\pi c}{L_v - d_v/39000}, \qquad \Im\tau_v(c) < 0 \quad (c > 0). \tag{10.11}$$

*The actual cells complete to cone solid tori of angle $2\pi c$, and to smooth solid tori at $c = 1$. The main cusp remains complete. When the component test gives a knot, the endpoint is its complete finite-volume hyperbolic complement.*

The sign in (10.11) is proved, rather than inferred from the smallness of the parameters. Put

$$F(t, u) = 2\,\mathrm{arsinh}(\tan(t/2)\cos(u/2)), \qquad E = F - t.$$

On the radius $10^{-2}$ bidisk, the explicit derivatives give $|E_t|, |E_u| < 1/39000$. Since $E(0, u) = 0$, write $E = tH$ with $H$ holomorphic and $|H| < 1/39000$. The charge equation is

$$\left(d_v - in_v + \sum_{w\sim v} H(\tau_v, \tau_w)\right)\tau_v = -2\pi ic.$$

Its denominator has strictly positive real part. This gives the sign and a contraction whose row bound is $2/39000$, independent of the tree size. The proof, including a finite variant with different radii at different vertices, is in Section G.7.

The original primitive periods are

$$U_v = -2\pi\Psi_v - i\epsilon_v\tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v, \qquad U_v + p_vV_v = -2\pi ic. \tag{10.12}$$

Appendix F proves that these are actual logarithmic periods along a positive path. At the initial cusp their integral ambiguities vanish; continuity preserves that choice. At $c = 1$ the primitive filling slope therefore makes one full turn. The conclusion concerns the original marked exterior, even if a total meridian logarithm has moved far from zero.

## 10.6 The original volume and the two sufficient tests

Back-substitution of the subtree stationary points gives the simultaneous equations (10.10) at $c = 1$. The constants in the subtree phases cancel exactly, leaving

$$\mathcal{C}(c) = \operatorname*{stat}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \left[\Psi + \frac{i}{4\pi}\sum_v n_v\tau_v^2 - ic\sum_v \tau_v\right].$$

The primitive-period calibration in Section F.3.6 gives $\mathrm{Vol}_c = 2\pi\Re\mathcal{C}(c)$. This identifies the action selected by the finite trace with the volume of the actual filled complement. It is the geometric step in Theorem 10.1.

Each edge sum contributes $N^{-3/2}$, and each circle trace contributes $N^2$ times a nondegenerate one-dimensional Gaussian. A tree has one more vertex than edge, so the full leading power is $N^{3/2}$. Its amplitude is nonzero. The exact first Fourier coefficient, the one reduced cut factor and the original scalar ledger then give (10.3) and (10.4).

The geometric criterion (10.9) by itself does not prove a quantum volume limit. It can hold when neither the summed quantum condition nor the local quantum condition does. For example, on arbitrarily long paths with powers chosen from 630 and 631, it holds at every vertex while the sum $\sum_v d_v/(d_v^2 + n_v^2)$ grows with the number of vertices. The appropriate knot parity still has to be selected. Theorem 10.1 supplies a separate analytic criterion. The earlier summed criterion in Theorem 9.1 remains useful, often with much smaller powers on a particular finite diagram.

# Chapter 11

# A sharper degree and twist condition

The preceding chapter estimates a subtree by the polynomial that it leaves on its attaching edge. Two changes improve the resulting numerical condition. First, the conditional kernel estimate is proved on a larger rectangle of complex angles. Second, each attaching edge is allowed its own decay constant, and the vertex evaluated last is not required to produce a further boundary polynomial. These changes give an explicit twist bound independent of the number of tangles. They also allow arbitrarily many prescribed short-twist pieces, provided enough long-twist terminal pieces are attached to them.

Throughout this chapter, the diagram is the ordered circle-tree construction of Section 9.1. A vertex represents a crossing box with its original crossing circle; an edge is an actual quarter-turn attachment. The order of the tangles and their strand frames are part of the construction. Write $d_v$ for the degree of a vertex and $n_v$ for its signed crossing power, measured in the half-twist convention of the finite source. The tree has at least one edge. Following the actual strands, including any components closed inside an intermediate tangle, must give one knot.

## 11.1 An explicit sufficient condition

**Theorem 11.1** (Degree or twist length)**.** *Fix the diagram and all its integer powers. Suppose that at every vertex at least one of the following inequalities holds:*

$$d_v \geq 2^{28} \qquad or \qquad |n_v| \geq 2^{27}. \tag{11.1}$$

*Different vertices may satisfy different alternatives. Then the knot complement is hyperbolic and*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K). \tag{11.2}$$

*For the same reduced meridian state and exact scalar factors as in (10.1), every fixed $R < 1$ also satisfies*

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)A_N(s)H_N(s)} = 1 + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-1}), \qquad |s| \leq R. \tag{11.3}$$

*The values in this disk are nonzero for all sufficiently large $N$. The limits include both parities and composite levels.*

In particular, $|n_v| \geq 2^{27}$ at every vertex suffices for every fixed finite tree in this construction. The bound has no dependence on the tree's size or depth. This quantifier concerns the sufficient bound: the starting quantum level and the constants in the error may depend on the entire fixed diagram. It does not allow the diagram to grow with $N$.

The degree alternative permits any fixed signed power, including zero, at vertices of sufficiently large degree. The number $2^{28}$ is a conservative sufficient bound, not a proposed geometric transition. For smaller diagrams the summed condition of Theorem 9.1 can be more useful. The finite criterion below gives further choices that satisfy neither of these two simple tests.

## 11.2 Why the last vertex has a different condition

Choose any vertex as the final vertex of the calculation and direct the edges toward it. This only reorders a finite tensor contraction; it does not rotate the physical diagram or change its framing. A nonfinal vertex sends its parent the exact polynomial $M_{v,N}(u)$ of (10.6). Its value at $u = 0$ is kept as a scalar, and the quotient is estimated on the full real angle interval.

Let $k_0 = 2^{-16}$ and $r_0 = 1/16$. For each nonfinal vertex choose a number $0 < c_v < k_0$. The required outgoing estimate has the form

$$\left| \frac{M_{v,N}(t)}{M_{v,N}(0)} \right| \leq C N^A \exp\{-N c_v (1 - \cos t)\}.$$

The constant $c_v$ records how much decay remains after the trace at that vertex. It is an explicit variable in a finite sufficient test; it is not a quantity to be estimated from unknown invariant values.

The proof in Appendix K defines two positive numbers at each vertex. The first,

$$\beta_v = \frac{210}{361} \frac{d_v/(2\pi)}{|(d_v - i n_v)/(2\pi)|^2},$$

bounds the loss in real action between the conditional phase at zero and its first Fourier critical value. The second, $\eta_v$, is the smallest of four losses for the discarded parts of that vertex's trace. Those four parts are the large Fourier indices, the original endpoints of the angle interval, the part outside a central interval, and the short vertical segments used to move the central interval through its critical point.

At every vertex the test requires $\beta_v < \eta_v/2$ and a fixed lower bound on $|(d_v - i n_v)/(2\pi)|$. At a nonfinal vertex it also requires

$$\beta_v < (k_0 - c_v)(1 - \cos r_0).$$

This last inequality regenerates the outgoing real estimate after division by $M_{v,N}(0)$. The final vertex sends no polynomial onward, so it does not need this last inequality. This distinction permits some short-twist configurations that fail every uniform outgoing bound.

## 11.3 The conditional estimate and the proof of the theorem

The proof uses the same full kernel as the preceding chapter:

$$K_N(t,u;s)=\sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t)e_k(-2\cos u)\frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}.$$

All its indices and the derivative data at repeated spectral roots remain present. The new estimate is uniform for $|\Re u|\le 1/8$, $|\Im u|\le 2^{-11}$ and $|y|\le 2^{-11}$:

$$|K_N(t+iy,u;s)|\le C_R N^{A_R}\exp N\{\Re\psi(0,u)-k_0(1-\cos t)+16y^2\}.$$

The reference value is the actual conditional phase $\psi(0,u)$. Using only an upper bound at the complete augmented diagram would lose the gain from normalizing each subtree by its own value.

For indices in the fixed interval $1/5\le k/N\le 3/10$, the finite product is positive at real $u$ and its second logarithmic derivative has an explicit bound. An imaginary displacement therefore costs a quadratic exponential factor. The complementary indices retain the full kernel's fixed exponential gap. Near the critical point the original holomorphic edge expansion applies. These three facts prove the displayed estimate on the entire rectangle.

The induction now keeps each child scalar exactly, proves a nonzero first Fourier term at the next vertex, and compares every other term with that same conditional action. The exact first Fourier coefficient is one for both level parities. The finite trace's endpoint terms are included in $\eta_v$; their omission would not be justified by a local stationary-phase argument. Since the tree is fixed, the relative $O(N^{-1})$ corrections in normalized children alter the next amplitude without consuming an additional exponential loss.

Choose $c_v=k_0/2$ at every nonfinal vertex. Elementary inequalities then prove all the finite conditions under (11.1), simultaneously for every degree. The proof uses

$$1-\cos(1/16)\ge 2^{-9}\frac{3071}{3072},\qquad \frac{d}{d^2+n^2}\le\frac{1}{2|n|}\quad (n\neq 0),$$

together with the rational comparisons written in the appendix. It requires no scan over possible degrees.

Finally, restoring the exact child scalars gives the original joint critical equations. Back-substitution keeps every selected angle in the uniqueness region of the geometric filling theorem. The finite conditions imply

$$\sqrt{d_v^2+n_v^2}\ge 2\pi\,2^{15}>630,$$

so Theorem 10.2, with the uniqueness estimates of Section G.7, applies. The ordered octahedral construction and primitive filling periods of Appendix F identify this branch with the actual knot complement. Its calibrated action is the volume in (11.2). This is where the geometric theorem enters: the quantum calculation alone supplies a critical value, not its geometric interpretation. The restored crossing and framing factors give (11.3).

## 11.4 Keeping an arbitrary fixed collection of short-twist pieces

The degree alternative has a useful constructive consequence. Begin with any fixed ordered circle-tree diagram whose strand pairing gives one knot, with no internal closed component. Its powers may be short, zero or of either sign. Keep all of them.

At each original vertex choose a specific product slot beside its crossing box. Insert there a consecutive stack of an even number $B \geq 2^{28}$ of new terminal pieces. Give every new piece a fixed odd power of absolute value at least $2^{27}+1$, and use the actual quarter-turn attachment. The original vertex now has degree at least $2^{28}$, while every added vertex satisfies the twist alternative.

The knot condition survives for an elementary reason. Number the four boundary points lower left, lower right, upper right, upper left by $0,1,2,3$. An odd braid has the pairing $\{\{0,2\},\{1,3\}\}$, and its quarter-turn has the same pairing. An even stack of these pieces consists of two through strands with pairing $\{\{0,3\},\{1,2\}\}$ and has no internal circle. It therefore preserves the original local pairing in the chosen slot. Applying this at every original vertex preserves the one-component test. At the original closing vertex the insertion is made inside its fixed local ball. If a new terminal piece is chosen as the recursive root, the closed-collar move retains its induced endpoint frame and factor order.

**Corollary 11.2.** *The resulting knot has a hyperbolic complement and satisfies* (11.2) *and* (11.3). *The initial tree, all original powers, all inserted pieces and their powers are fixed before* $N$ *tends to infinity.*

This construction preserves the short-twist pieces and their endpoint connections; it generally changes the knot. The corollary therefore constructs a larger family of knots satisfying the volume identity. It does not assert the identity for every unchanged short-twist diagram from which the construction starts.

## 11.5 A finite criterion beyond the simple bounds

The choice of final vertex matters even with equal $c_v$. Consider a star with 30,000,001 terminal vertices. Give the center power 2 and each terminal vertex power $2^{60}+1$, and evaluate the center last. The original strand calculation gives one knot. For the center, exact rational bounds imply

$$\frac{\beta_o}{\eta_o/2} < 0.9.$$

Its value of $\beta_o$ exceeds $k_0(1-\cos r_0)$, so it cannot satisfy an outgoing condition for any positive $c_o$. It need not do so because it is evaluated last. The terminal vertices satisfy all their own conditions.

The summed test also fails for this example:

$$\sum_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2+n_v^2} \geq \frac{30{,}000{,}001}{30{,}000{,}001^2+4} > 2^{-25}.$$

The example shows a precise benefit of the directed criterion. Its size is deliberately conservative; no claim of a smallest such example is needed. Appendix K gives the endpoint pairing calculation and the exact rational inequalities, with a single reproduction command in Chapter 15.

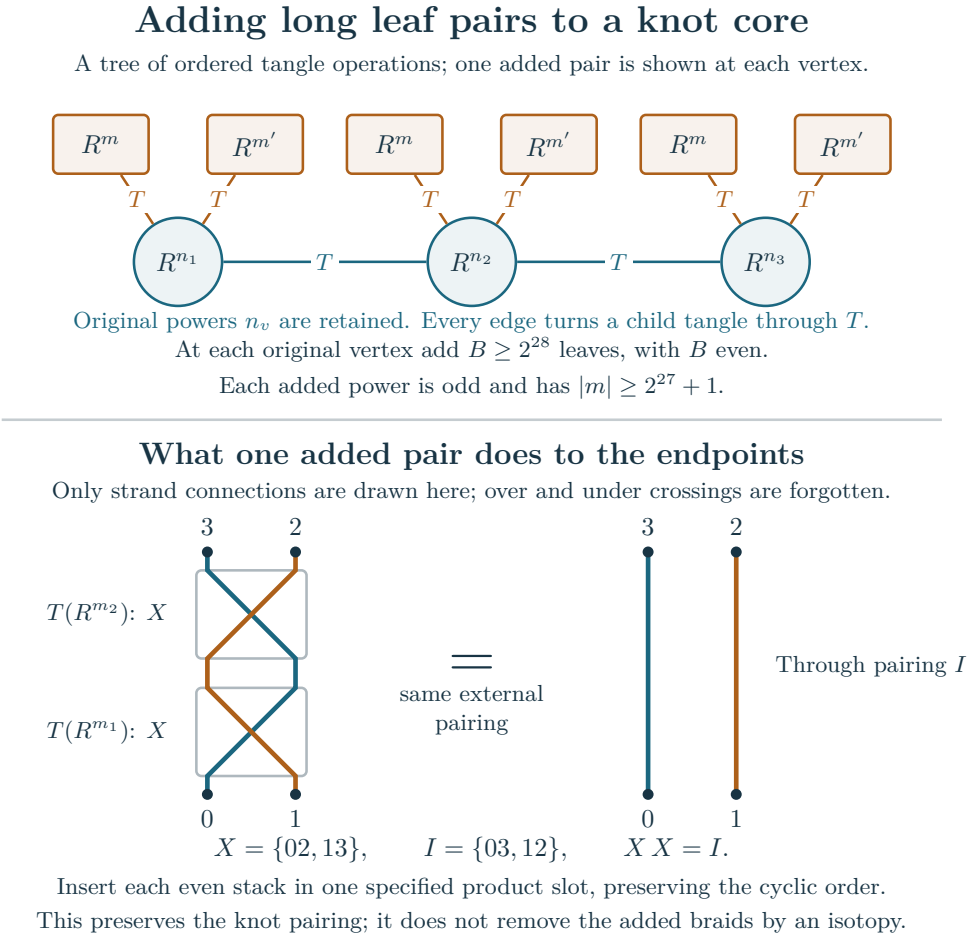



Figure 11.1: Adding terminal pieces in pairs. The upper diagram records the tangle operations; only one of the required pairs is shown at each original vertex. Below, following the strands through two odd pieces gives two through connections. The endpoint pairing is preserved, while the knot type can change.

# Chapter 12

# The geometric longitude selected by the finite source

The meridian profile contains more information than its first cusp correction. For every covered fixed strict Conway tree with independently sufficiently long signed twists, the classical curve selected by its full meridian expansion is the preferred-longitude germ of the original knot complement. Product junctions may have arbitrary valence and may be adjacent. Ordered trees carrying a crossing circle at every junction also retain their separate quantitative filling criteria.

We first establish the identity for the circle trees. Inserting a circle around a zero-crossing box then supplies the geometric extension to a bare product junction. Eliminating its angular variable recovers the original stationary action with its constant, while the ordered boundary paths recover the original knot group. The consequence for a quantum recurrence uses the separate all-order source theorem; the geometric statement alone supplies no new asymptotic estimate for short fillings.

## 12.1 The marked equations and their geometric branch

Keep the literal construction of Section 9.1: one original crossing circle at every vertex of a fixed finite ordered tree, at least one edge, and an actual quarter-turn on every edge. The main strands must form one knot, with no additional component closed inside a tangle. All disk framings, endpoint orders and signed powers $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$ are retained.

Write $\mathcal{E}$ for the edge set. For an edge $e = vw$, let $E_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$ be its complex wire parameter, and put $Q_v = e^{i\tau_v}$ at a crossing circle. These variables describe the original cells, rather than a new diagram obtained by changing the products. Let $M$ be the main meridian parameter. The selected source flag has meridian eigenvalue $M^{-1}$; throughout this chapter $L$ is the inverse eigenvalue of the preferred longitude on that same flag. Equivalently, $(M, L)$ is the eigenvalue pair on the other line of the determinant-one peripheral representation.

The finite source gives the rational equations

$$\begin{aligned}(E_e + Q_v)(E_e + Q_v^{-1})(E_e + Q_w)(E_e + Q_w^{-1}) \\ = (E_e - 1)^2(1 - E_e M^2)(1 - E_e/M^2),\end{aligned} \tag{12.1}$$

$$\prod_{e\ni v}\rho_{v,e}=Q_v^{n_v},\qquad \rho_{v,e}=\frac{Q_v+E_e}{1+Q_vE_e}. \tag{12.2}$$

We use the chart on which these denominators are nonzero and the selected critical point is nondegenerate, meaning that its Hessian is invertible. Exponentiation alone does not specify that point. To retain its logarithmic branch, put

$$b(x,\tau)=\int_0^x \log(2\cos(2\pi r)+2\cos\tau)\,dr-2J(x),\qquad J'(x)=\log(2\sin\pi x),$$

with the original continued logarithms. The angular equations are

$$\sum_{e\ni v} b_\tau(x_e,\tau_v)+\frac{in_v\tau_v}{2\pi}-i=0. \tag{12.3}$$

The term $-i$ is the first Fourier charge of the actual crossing trace. The positive charge path of the preceding geometric completion starts at the complete augmented structure and ends at this filled point. It identifies the source critical point with the actual complete knot representation. The implicit-function theorem then selects its continuation as $M$ varies near one.

**Theorem 12.1** (The preferred eigenvalue on the regular branch)**.** *Fix the construction above and a regular geometric branch through an actual complete hyperbolic filling, with the logarithms selected by* (12.3)*. On its continued germ,*

$$\boxed{L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M)=-M^{a(D)}\prod_{e\in\mathcal{E}}\frac{M^2-E_e(M)}{1-M^2E_e(M)},\qquad a(D)=-w(D)-\sum_v n_v.} \tag{12.4}$$

*Here $w(D)$ is the oriented writhe of the original filled diagram. The longitude is its preferred zero-linking longitude, and the representation is that of the original knot complement.*

This theorem concerns a regular geometric branch. The long-filling and quantitative hypotheses in the preceding chapters provide such branches, with their stated knot and parity qualifications. They remain the hypotheses for the corresponding volume limits; the identification (12.4) does not enlarge those analytic claims.

## 12.2 Why the equations describe the original exterior

The attachment in Figure 9.1 is the topological starting point. Each original tree edge supplies two octahedra. Their disk faces are sewn in the original cyclic order, retaining the distinguished odd seam at each circle. For a nonparabolic main meridian, both projection copies and their white-face maps must deform. Keeping the old parabolic white maps would give the wrong representation.

The resulting marked edge block satisfies (12.1). Its primitive auxiliary longitude has similarity $Q_v^2$, and its meridian contribution is $\rho_{v,e}$. The pure page identifications match both puncture generators. At a positive half twist the actual ordered pair changes by $(a,b)\mapsto(a^{-1}ba,a)$, preserving $ba$. The invertible matrix $(ba)^{-1}-I$ realizes that conjugacy near the geometric chart. The accompanying puncture flags must also be transported: the

two native ideal flags can select opposite eigenvalues. The full generator matching, including this exchange, is what permits gluing the actual collar.

Consequently the original primitive logarithms are

$$U_v = \sum_{e \ni v} \log \rho_{v,e} - \epsilon_v \log Q_v, \qquad V_v = 2 \log Q_v, \qquad U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i. \tag{12.5}$$

The last equality follows from the marked equation (12.3), since $\exp(-2\pi b_\tau) = \rho_{v,e}$. It retains the primitive period which disappears from (12.2). The same ordered face and collar relations therefore construct representations of the original augmented exterior. At the selected filled point, $\operatorname{Im} \tau_v < 0$, so $Q_v^2 \neq 1$. The auxiliary longitude is noncentral and semisimple. Its commuting filling word has eigenvalue ratio one by (12.2), and is therefore projectively the identity. This proves descent to the prescribed filled knot group, also on a sufficiently small nearby germ. At $Q_v = \pm 1$, an exponentiated slope equation alone would not exclude a nontrivial parabolic filling word.

## 12.3 From the peripheral differential to an exact identity

There is a useful algebraic way to determine the entire longitude without inferring it from a tangent. Put $u = \log M$, $q_v = \log Q_v$, and $f_e = (M^2 - E_e)/(1 - M^2 E_e)$. Differentiating the single edge equation gives

$$du \wedge d \log f_e + \frac{1}{2} d \log \rho_{v,e} \wedge dq_v + \frac{1}{2} d \log \rho_{w,e} \wedge dq_w = 0. \tag{12.6}$$

The actual representation has the same boundary pairing:

$$du \wedge d \log L_{\mathrm{aug}} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_v dU_v \wedge dq_v = 0.$$

Here $L_{\mathrm{aug}}$ uses the preferred augmented longitude. This identity follows by pairing two infinitesimal representation cocycles with the invariant trace form and evaluating their cup product on the boundary of the exterior. The cochain Stokes identity makes the total boundary evaluation zero. The factor $1/2$ records that $U_v$ is a logarithm of an eigenvalue ratio. Subtracting (12.6) over all edges removes the auxiliary terms in (12.5).

It follows that the rational squared discrepancy

$$R = \frac{L_{\mathrm{aug}}^2}{\prod_e f_e^2} \tag{12.7}$$

has no infinitesimal dependence on the auxiliary variables. Two further facts turn that differential statement into an exact formula. First, the generic source field has no extra algebraic constants over $\mathbb{C}(M)$. Indeed its edge squareclasses are

$$(Q_v - 1)^2 (Q_w - 1)^2 - 4(M + M^{-1})^2 Q_v Q_w.$$

Each is an irreducible prime involving its own pair of vertex variables. Their prime valuations make the squareclasses independent, even after algebraically closing $\mathbb{C}(M)$. Thus $R \in \mathbb{C}(M)$.

Second, at every fixed $M_0 \neq 0$ the group matrices and their inverses admit a regular reconstruction for generic auxiliary variables. This includes $M_0 = \pm i$, where a particular ideal

subdivision degenerates but the character matrices remain regular. The peripheral eigenvalue ratio and every $f_e$ are nonzero there. Hence $R$ has neither a zero nor a pole on $\mathbb{C}^*$, and therefore

$$R = cM^k \tag{12.8}$$

for a nonzero constant $c$ and an integer $k$. This regularity step is essential: a differential identity and a single cusp derivative would not exclude a general rational factor of $M$.

At the complete main cusp, $R(1) = 1$. The already marked cusp formula fixes $k = 2a_{\mathrm{aug}}$, where $a_{\mathrm{aug}} = -\sum_v \epsilon_v - w_\epsilon$. The original surgery homology changes the preferred longitude by $\mu_K^{\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2}$, with $\ell_v \in \{0, \pm 2\}$ the original circle linking numbers. Its exponent is

$$a_{\mathrm{aug}} + \sum_v p_v \ell_v^2 = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v = a(D).$$

This proves the square of (12.4).

The remaining sign has a topological determination. A spin cover is the double cover of oriented frames in which a full $2\pi$ rotation changes the lift's sign. On a Seifert surface with one boundary component, a boundary-adapted tangent frame winds $1-2g$ times relative to a global tangent frame. The spin cover of that global frame has trivial boundary monodromy, because the boundary is nullhomologous on the surface. Thus the adapted frame lifts antiperiodically. At the straight preferred cusp longitude it is the translation-invariant horospherical frame; its positive unipotent lift therefore differs from the actual longitude lift by a minus sign. So $L_{\mathrm{geom}}(1) = -1$ at the complete filled point. The two-valued holomorphic ambiguity in the squared identity is constant, proving (12.4). Appendix I gives the marked matrices, regularity argument and frame proof in full.

## 12.4 Product junctions without crossing circles

A bare junction is a maximal consecutive product that contains no crossing-circle operator. A binary association used to calculate its kernel introduces hidden labels, but adds no physical quarter-turns. The strict construction retains the original ordered products, turns and cylindrical closure. Its real angle domain contains a point at which every original leaf angle lies in $(0, 1/2)$ and every retained binary gate obeys

$$\max(u, v) < w < u + v < 1.$$

The original endpoint test must give one knot, including any circles closed inside a tangle. The two-leaf pure-leaf qualification and all original parity conditions remain in force.

Let $\mathcal{E}_T$ denote the physical turn edges of the reduced junction tree. Their covariant index $x_e$ is shared by the two ends after lowering the trace pairing. When an incidence is exposed as the ordinary output of its rooted branch, that output angle is $1 - x_e$. Put $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$; this is the variable denoted $E_e$ in the preceding circle-tree formulas.

**Theorem 12.2** (The longitude for a strict Conway tree)**.** *Fix such a strict ordered knot presentation and independently sufficiently long signed powers, with the diagram and all its powers fixed before the level varies. Its original complete hyperbolic filled knot has a regular*

*geometric main-meridian germ on which*

$$L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M) = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_i n_i. \tag{12.9}$$

*The $x_e(M)$ are selected by the original strict-tree action continued with the physical-edge insertion*

$$\Phi_t = \Phi + \sum_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \{2J(x_e) - J(x_e + t) - J(x_e - t)\} + \frac{\pi i a(D)}{2} t^2, \qquad M = e^{\pi i t}. \tag{12.10}$$

*The preferred peripheral curves and the filled complement are those of the original knot.*

The proof begins with the framed collar in Figure J.1. Insert the literal identity $R^0 = I$ immediately before the ordered child product at each bare junction, and encircle its two straight strands. Filling that new circle along its primitive meridian restores the same framed tangle. This operation creates no turn edge, crossing power or preferred-longitude shear. It therefore leaves both $\mathcal{E}_T$ and $a(D)$ unchanged.

There is a unique regular angular variable for each new circle. If $x_1, \dots, x_m$ are its incident covariant labels at the complete strict optimizer, then $0 < x_j \le 1/2$, at most one label equals $1/2$, and $\sum_j x_j > 1$. With $k = \tanh(y/2)$, its zero-power first-charge equation is

$$\sum_j \arctan(k \tan \pi x_j) = \pi, \qquad \tau = -iy, \quad Q = e^y > 1. \tag{12.11}$$

A half label contributes $\pi/2$. The left side increases strictly from zero or $\pi/2$ to $\pi \sum_j x_j$, so the solution exists, is unique, and has a nonzero angular Hessian.

Let $V_m(\mathbf{x})$ be the whole product action, after its original hidden binary labels have been optimized. The exact elimination identity is

$$V_m(\mathbf{x}) = \operatorname*{stat}_{\tau} \left[ \sum_j b(x_j, \tau) - i\tau \right]. \tag{12.12}$$

Both sides evaluate the same complete polynomial trace: one uses the positive binary product, the other its first Fourier charge. The constrained Laurent-coefficient calculation in Appendix J proves the identity with its absolute constant. It continues holomorphically through the possible half label.

The group marking requires a separate argument. In the fixed product collar, the two based puncture loops satisfy $a_{\mathrm{out}} = a_{\mathrm{in}}$ and $b_{\mathrm{out}} = b_{\mathrm{in}}$, with disk-boundary word $ba$. The complete old white-face maps identify the added primitive longitude as $W_1^{-1} W_3$, up to its recorded orientation. Its determinant-one normalization has trace $-(Q + Q^{-1})$, with the same $Q > 1$ as in (12.11). Pulling the old holonomy back through the literal meridian-filling quotient keeps both puncture generators and their paths. The resulting ordered page conjugacies are the native all-circle conjugacies. Their puncture pairs are irreducible, so the page intertwiners are unique in the projective group. This identifies representations, including the original odd seams, rather than matching only their traces.

At an internal half edge, $X_e = -1$ may be a double root of the edge quadratic. The normalized character matrices remain regular. One therefore retains the joint stationary

system. The new angular Hessian block is invertible; its Schur complement is exactly the old strict reduced Hessian by (12.12). The full system is nondegenerate without inverting an individual edge quadratic. Its rational longitude identity consequently extends through this fold.

The selected added longitude remains semisimple near $Q > 1$. Its commuting meridian of eigenvalue ratio one is therefore projectively identity, which removes the potential unipotent ambiguity. The old marked deformation and sufficiently long fillings identify the resulting main-meridian germ with that of the original complete filled knot. Applying the all-circle identity, and the same filled-knot Seifert sign, proves (12.9). No quantum estimate for the newly drilled diagram is required; all quantum estimates remain those of the original strict presentation.

## 12.5 The resulting factor of a genuine quantum recurrence

Now impose the all-order source hypotheses as well. They hold for all the fixed strict Conway presentations in Theorem 12.2 under independently sufficiently long signed powers. For circle trees they also hold under the summed condition $\sum_v d_v/(d_v^2+n_v^2) \le 2^{-25}$, or the local condition $\max_v d_v/(d_v^2+n_v^2) \le 2^{-120}$. Chapter 14 extends these all-order hypotheses to every directed certificate in Chapter 11. All original qualifications remain, and no data grow with the level.

Let $F_N(M)$ be the actual zero-framed reduced ADO state. A genuine all-level annihilator means a fixed nonzero operator

$$P(q,M,T)=\sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q,M)T^j, \qquad TM=qMT, \qquad P(q_N,M,T)F_N(M)=0 \tag{12.13}$$

at every sufficiently large level, where $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$ and $T$ shifts $M$ to $q_N M$. The coefficients $a_j$ belong to $\mathbb{C}(q,M)$. Clear its fixed rational denominators and remove the common $q-1$ order. Setting $q=1$ and replacing the shift by a commuting variable $L$ gives its first nonzero classical symbol $P_0(M,L)$.

The all-order theorem in Appendix H uses the actual source on the translated microscopic charts $s, s+1, \dots, s+d$, away from ordinary resonances. Its filtered logarithm selects the critical-value germ $L_{\mathrm{eff}} = -e^{\mathcal{S}'(\log M)}$. The exact edge insertion gives the right side of (12.9), with the original physical edge set. The marked first-charge branch and the zero-circle elimination fix the same filled representation. Theorems 12.1 and 12.2 therefore identify $L_{\mathrm{eff}}$ with $L_{\mathrm{geom}}$ in their respective source classes.

The reduced/full conversion retains its meridian factor: before formal-domain cancellation the classical equation is

$$(M-M^{-1})^d P_0(M, L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M)) = 0. \tag{12.14}$$

It follows that $P_0$ vanishes on the geometric germ. Let $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}$ be the irreducible Laurent polynomial defining the smallest complex algebraic curve containing this geometric eigenvalue germ. Then

$$A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}} \mid P_0. \tag{12.15}$$

If $a_j \in \mathbb{Q}(q,M)$, one instead contracts the prime of that germ to $\mathbb{Q}[M^{\pm1}, L^{\pm1}]$; the chosen complex component need not itself be defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

This is a selected geometric factor of every specified annihilator under the source hypotheses. It does not identify the whole classical symbol, the full A-polynomial, or the entire annihilator ideal. Nor does it give a fixed-$M \neq 1$ quantum asymptotic by substituting $s$ of order $N$. The full geometric germ is obtained from all orders on fixed microscopic charts and the separate marked representation argument above.

## 12.6 Transfer under an ordered reduction of the presentation

The reduced ADO function and the preferred eigenvalue germ belong to the marked, zero-framed knot. Suppose the existing ordered net-twist reduction gives an ambient isotopy from the input to a covered strict presentation. The isotopy carries the knot orientation, positive meridian, preferred zero-linking longitude and cut mark. After correcting the transported ribbon framing to zero, the full function $F_N(M)$ agrees at every level, as does its rational continuation. Any genuine annihilator of that intrinsic family therefore has the factor in (12.15). Presentation-specific recurrence formulas need not agree.

The same conclusion applies to an arbitrary-closure reduction when it produces one covered strict knot factor and only unknot factors. Under the reduction theorem's long surviving-factor hypotheses, a hyperbolic knot input has precisely that form. Removing the exhibited unknot summands is an ambient isotopy, and its exterior map carries the preferred peripheral pair. No assertion about quantum-growth multiplicativity for connected sums is used here.

For a fixed original expression there are finitely many reduction and parity branches. Taking the maximum of their strict source and geometric thresholds gives a uniform sufficient threshold for the surviving signed net powers. Large powers that cancel to a short net power do not satisfy this condition. The integer $a(D)$ and the edge factors are computed on the covered strict diagram; only their preferred-longitude product and the selected geometric factor are transferred intrinsically. The full proof and precise reduction references are in Section J.9.

# Chapter 13

# Balanced decorations of simple white spheres

The tree constructions are not the only diagrams whose full invariant can be controlled. This chapter starts with an arbitrary connected marked augmented diagram whose white faces form a simple triangulated sphere. The diagram may have cyclic couplings in its finite source. We add finitely many terminal tangles near each crossing circle and prove the volume limit for the resulting knots after independently sufficiently long fixed fillings.

The construction has a geometric purpose. It leaves every old circle in the complete packing fixed and adds disks in its triangular gaps. By choosing the numbers of insertions on the two sides separately, one obtains a strict inequality at the same complete packing for every crossing circle. This bounds the one-sided terms of the full spectral numerator below the geometric contribution. The knot being evaluated is the decorated knot, with all its original and added circles filled; it need not be isotopic to the initial core knot.

## 13.1 The diagrams and the result

Cut an augmented diagram along its projection regions and its twice-punctured crossing disks. The pieces of the projection regions are called white faces. Each crossing disk contributes two shaded triangles, paired with one another. The dual description has one vertex for each white region and one triangle for each shaded face. The side shared by a paired pair of triangles is its matching edge. These are incidence data of the given diagram, including its cyclic orders, rather than a graph selected afterward to model its source.

Require this white cellulation to be a simple triangulated sphere with at least four vertices. Thus every triangular cell has three distinct vertices, and there are no loops or repeated edges. A strand edge is a side not used in the matching. Keep one original strand edge for the reduced mark; its endpoints are the two protected faces in the finite coefficient formula. The diagram can be a general Morse diagram: ordinary cups and caps are allowed between its crossing boxes.

**Theorem 13.1** (Balanced terminal decoration)**.** *Fix such a diagram, its crossing-disk frames, and a parity pattern whose main strands form one knot. There is a finite decoration by terminal crossing-circle tangles, with an even number added on each side of every original crossing box,*

*with the following property. For the resulting fixed augmented diagram $\widehat{D}$ there is a threshold $P(\widehat{D})$ such that every fixed independently signed integer filling vector with $|p_e| \geq P(\widehat{D})$ gives*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K_{\mathbf{p}})| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\mathbf{p}}). \tag{13.1}$$

*The physical crossing powers are $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$ in their recorded disk frames. Each added terminal has odd parity. The endpoint pairing remains a knot, the filled complement is hyperbolic, and the limit includes both parities and composite levels.*

The decorations and all the powers are fixed before $N$ tends to infinity. The threshold depends on the final diagram; it imposes no ratio bound on the different powers. In particular the original boxes are also filled sufficiently long. This is not a statement about arbitrary short fillings or about the invariant of the undecorated core. It concerns the complete main color, without a new moving main-meridian or operator conclusion.

There is also a wholly combinatorial way to supply starting diagrams. Take any finite oriented simple triangulated sphere with at least four vertices and a chosen perfect matching of its cubic dual. Each matched pair is a disk with four distinct boundary vertices. Place the standard crossing-circle box there and join its four terminals along the remaining embedded dual edges. This constructs a link in $S^3$ with the stated cut. A spanning tree in the incidence graph of its untwisted main circles specifies odd boxes that merge those circles into one knot. The signs at these odd boxes may be chosen independently. Theorem 13.1 then applies after the terminal decoration.

## 13.2 A circle packing from the finite combinatorics

No additional positive polyhedron is an unverified input. Remove one triangle of the white sphere and prescribe three positive boundary circle radii. The remaining disk has a strictly positive angle assignment with demand $2\pi$ at each interior vertex and total boundary demand $\pi$. The proof is a finite Hall count: every proper interior subset touches strictly more triangle supply than its demand, and the same holds for a subset containing the pooled boundary. Separating triangles are allowed.

The strictly concave triangle entropy has an interior maximum on this angle polytope. Its multipliers give radii and Euclidean triangles with side lengths $r_f + r_g$. Their interior angle sums are $2\pi$, so their development is locally Euclidean. The boundary goes once around the prescribed convex triangle. The winding-number argument makes the development an embedding. The disk sectors stop strictly before the opposite center edge in every triangle, which excludes unintended circle contacts. The contact circles of the triangular gaps supply all shaded supporting planes. Together with the white planes they bound the labeled convex ideal right-angled polyhedron.

The original projection and disk-face maps glue two copies into the actual augmented exterior. Canonical cusp decorations make every right-angle edge cycle and cusp complete. Sending the marked strand-edge contact to infinity gives two parallel marked white lines and positive finite curvatures at all other white faces. Appendix L proves this construction, including the support inequalities and the primitive marking.

## 13.3 How two fans produce the needed inequality

At one crossing circle let the paired triangles have white curvatures $(x, b, y)$ and $(x, c, y)$, with matching edge $xy$. Put

$$A = x + y > 0, \qquad P = xy, \qquad \rho = P/A^2 \in [0, 1/4]. \tag{13.2}$$

Inserting one terminal tangle in the first triangular gap introduces the circle of curvature

$$b_1 = A + b + 2\sqrt{Ab + P}.$$

The old matching edge $xy$ remains; its first middle face is now $b_1$. The new matching edge is $bb_1$. Every old circle stays fixed.

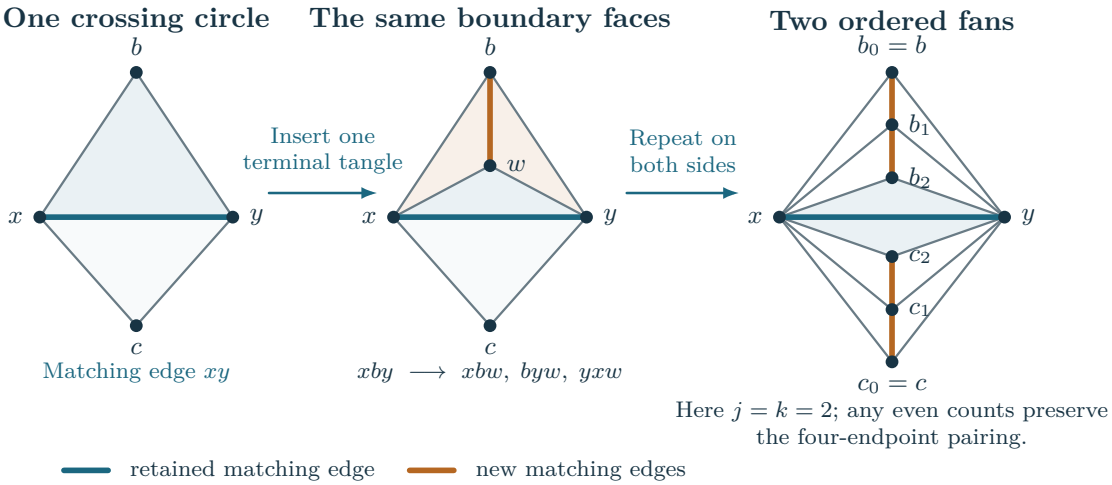



Figure 13.1: A terminal insertion in the white-face triangulation and its repetition on both sides of one crossing circle. The retained matching edge is $xy$; the added matching edge is $bw$. The cyclic order of the new four-sided region is $(b, y, w, x)$, so the new source factor is $H_g(b, y, x, w)$. The drawing records the inherited cut and matching. Here $j = k = 2$; any even counts preserve the four-endpoint pairing.

The convexity of this insertion can be checked in a single explicit model. Normalize the old white circles to two parallel lines at heights zero and two and a unit disk centered at $i$. The right interstice receives the unit disk centered at $2 + i$. Its three new shaded disks are $|z - 1| < 1$, $|z - (1 + 2i)| < 1$, and $\Re z > 2$, all contained in the old shaded halfplane $\Re z > 0$. The other old supporting inequalities therefore remain strict at new nonincident contacts. Repeating the construction gives nested gaps without intersections, including when the global marked faces are lines.

The recurrence is exactly solvable:

$$\sqrt{Ab_j + P} = \sqrt{Ab + P} + jA. \tag{13.3}$$

Choose even nonnegative counts $j, k$ so that

$$U = \sqrt{b/A + \rho} + j \geq 4, \qquad V = \sqrt{c/A + \rho} + k \geq 4, \qquad |U - V| \leq 1.$$

This is possible by rounding the difference to an even integer and then adding the same sufficiently large even integer to both counts.

Let $F(x, b, y)$ be the source-normalized complete triangle action. Its entropy formula fixes the constant in the useful identity

$$\begin{aligned} F(x, b, y) &= \tfrac{1}{2} \log b + R(b), \\ R(b) &= \frac{1}{\pi} \int_b^\infty \arctan \frac{\sqrt{At + P}}{t} \, \frac{dt}{t}. \end{aligned} \tag{13.4}$$

For $b_j = A(U^2 - \rho)$ and $c_k = A(V^2 - \rho)$, elementary estimates of this positive remainder give

$$F(x, b_j, y) + F(x, c_k, y) - \max(\log b_j, \log c_k) > \frac{3347}{27720 \min(U, V)} > 0. \tag{13.5}$$

Every new crossing circle satisfies the simpler algebraic balance test already at its creation: its outer sum is $b + b_1 \geq x + y$ and its two middle curvatures are $x, y$. Later insertions do not alter it. Thus finitely many two-sided fans settle every original and added crossing circle on one shared complete packing.

## 13.4 The full finite source and the filled metric

The diagram after insertion has additional intermediate cups and caps. They must be evaluated in their inherited frames. For a first-side insertion the two exact homogeneous factors are

$$H_f(x, w, c, y) H_g(b, y, x, w). \tag{13.6}$$

The face-winding identity preserves every old coefficient target and gives the new ordinary target $N - 1$. At even levels the new face has the same parity clock as $b$. The extra factor $N^{-1}$ from its coupon is cancelled by its new primitive face grid; the original unrestricted mark is restricted only after whole-source conservation. Consequently the full spectral numerator, including Casimir normals, is the original marked coefficient on the refined diagram.

The part whose local cofactor paths cross the middle index has a nonzero local geometric packet and a global spectral gap. These arguments use the simple sphere, local cofactor estimates and shared Cauchy torus, with no flat-plat sweep. Inequality (13.5) bounds every sector containing a one-sided term by a strictly smaller exponential rate at those same radii. The original whole-domain Fourier/Hermite filling formula retains its sine endpoints, parity signs and second-derivative endpoint currents. Its first charge survives and the remaining charges are smaller for independently long fixed powers. This proves a nonzero asymptotic for the full invariant.

The geometric conclusion has a separate metric step. The common deformed circle pattern and its full ordered collar maps give the actual representation, with primitive logarithms

$$U_e = -\log R_{0,e} - \epsilon_e \log(-J_e), \qquad V_e = 2 \log(-J_e), \qquad U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i.$$

For sufficiently long fixed powers it lies in a fixed neighborhood of the complete framed representation. A positive equivariant developing map on the compact core and a complete logarithmic cusp link identify these logarithms with the actual periods. The primitive $2\pi$ angular period completes the end to a smooth solid torus on the specified slope. The main cusp remains complete. The regulator's boundary term then cancels the filling phase and identifies the nonzero exponential rate with the volume of this actual filled knot complement. The full construction and estimates are given in Appendix L.

The new tangles retain the correlations around cycles. On the graph obtained by collapsing the source's physical cycles, one insertion adds a loop. The proof controls those channels through the full shared coefficient and its strict balance; it does not replace the invariant by a scalar tree contraction.

# Chapter 14

# All orders of the directed meridian profile

The directed criterion gives an expansion of the actual meridian state to every finite order. Its coefficients satisfy a degree bound that links the exact quantum recurrence to the preferred geometric longitude. This extends the geometric-factor conclusion to all the new directed cases, including the short-power examples permitted by large degree. The first correction is the cusp shape of the same filled knot complement.

Throughout this chapter the ordered tree, its signed powers, endpoint frames, peripheral markings and directed certificate are fixed before the level tends to infinity. There is at least one edge. The original strand test must give one knot, with no component closed inside a tangle. Both level parities are retained. The full proof, including the translated parameter regions and the uniform remainders, is in Appendix M.

## 14.1 The expansion and its geometric consequences

Let the tree satisfy the finite directed inequalities of Appendix K. This includes the vertexwise sufficient condition

$$d_v \geq 2^{28} \quad \text{or} \quad |n_v| \geq 2^{27} \qquad \text{at every vertex.} \tag{14.1}$$

The choice can differ from vertex to vertex. More general directed certificates, with different subtree budgets and a freely chosen final vertex, remain included.

Write the actual zero-framed reduced state as

$$q_N = e^{\pi i/N}, \qquad M = -q_N x = q_N^s, \qquad K_N = F_N(1), \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}. \tag{14.2}$$

Here $x$ is the original highest-weight parameter. The normalized full state is $\mathcal{Z}_N(s) = F_N(q_N^s)/(K_N H_N(s))$. The one factor $H_N$ is fixed by the reduced cut and modified trace; it is not an adjustable normalization.

**Theorem 14.1** (All orders for a directed certificate)**.** *For every fixed compact $K$ in the open upper half-plane and every finite $L$,*

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) = \sum_{r=1}^{L} N^{-r} p_r(s) + O_{K,L}(N^{-L-1}), \qquad \deg p_r \leq r+1. \tag{14.3}$$

*The same polynomials give the expansion on every fixed disk $|s| \le R < 1$. Fixed derivatives are controlled on smaller compacts. The logarithm is the branch tending to zero. Lower amplitudes may be organized separately by level parity; the selected leading action and its top polynomial degrees are the same.*

*Let $\tau_K$ be the preferred cusp shape of the actual filled knot. Then*

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{K_N H_N(s)} = 1 + \frac{\pi i \tau_K s^2}{2N} + O_K(N^{-2}). \tag{14.4}$$

*For every genuine fixed all-level reduced annihilator, its first nonzero classical symbol is divisible by the selected complex geometric meridian–longitude factor.*

The constants and starting levels in the expansion may depend on the fixed tree, certificate, compact and requested order. The numerical directed criterion is unchanged. The volume already identified by that criterion is the volume of the original filled knot complement; no auxiliary comparison manifold replaces it here.

## 14.2 Why the actual source has every order

After lowering the physical trace pairing, every original turn edge carries its exact paired weight. The full edge kernel is

$$\mathscr{K}_N(t,u;s) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t) e_k(-2\cos u) \frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}, \tag{14.5}$$

where $e_k$ is the fixed complete Newton polynomial and

$$W_k(s) = \prod_{r=1}^{k} \left(1 - \frac{\sin^2(\pi s/N)}{\sin^2(\pi r/N)}\right).$$

The original six-type edge scalar is retained outside the kernel. Each exact subtree output is an even trigonometric polynomial of degree at most $N-1$ in its remaining angle. Choosing the last vertex changes the order of finite contractions, not the physical cut or the framing.

The directed proof normalizes every child by its exact value at angle zero. It supplies a nonzero conditional first Fourier saddle, a holomorphic nonzero leading amplitude, and strict exponential bounds for the remaining charges and all endpoint currents. The outgoing real and strip estimates are estimates of the exact polynomial, including its high indices and repeated-node normals.

These facts permit an induction to any prescribed finite order. At a local saddle, expand the canonical factorials and amplitude, integrate the finite Gaussian Taylor expansion, and divide by the corresponding expansion at parent angle zero. The integral of the absolute local Gaussian is bounded by a fixed multiple of the absolute leading integral. A uniform relative input remainder therefore remains a relative remainder of the same order. The constant can depend on the fixed subtree; no uniform condition number over all diagrams is asserted.

Outside the local saddle, retain the exact child polynomials and their original real and strip bounds. A truncated expansion is not used there. The strict directed margins make the charge tails, original endpoints and connector terms smaller than every inverse power of $N$.

Restoring all exact child constants recovers the original joint action and its nonzero amplitude. This proves higher orders from the finite source, rather than by differentiating its first-order estimate.

An operator of fixed order $r_P$ needs $s, s+1, \dots, s+r_P$, so the proof must also cover translated regions. Euler's product expresses $W_k$ as a subset product of $1-s^2/m^2$ over distinct nonzero integers $m$. On a fixed nonreal compact both the product and its inverse are bounded uniformly in $k, N$. The full fixed-power crossing polynomial has the same polynomial norm bound there. Its common Cartan scalar and mixed reference factors remain in the exact scalar calculation. The constant opposite-color channel retains its separate full-normal limit.

The translated grids move their endpoints by $O(N^{-1})$. The original endpoint currents and any wrapped grid entries are kept; the crossing chirp is not declared periodic. The exact charge coefficient is

$$(-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)} U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma), \qquad \sigma = s, -s, 0,$$

whose first value is one. Its fixed-compact growth in $\ell$ is absorbed by the existing geometric tail. Thus the same conditional proof works on every required translated compact, with the same exponential margins. It asserts no uniform continuation across an ordinary-color resonance.

## 14.3 The polynomial filtration and the preferred cusp

The degree bound in (14.3) comes from an exact insertion. Let $G_N$ be the canonical sine-factorial interpolation, with $G_N(k) = \prod_{r=1}^{k} 2\sin(\pi r/N)$ and its fixed reflection normalization. On an original wire $x_e = k/N$,

$$\frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)} = \frac{G_N(k)^2}{G_N(k-s)G_N(k+s)}. \tag{14.6}$$

No periodic interpolation factor is allowed. The midpoint offsets from $N-1$ and the original integer wire offsets remain in its expansion.

Let $\Phi(X)$ be the original joint first-charge phase, with $X$ collecting the physical wire and circle-angle variables. Put

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{K}(x,t) &= 2J(x) - J(x+t) - J(x-t), \qquad J'(x) = \log(2\sin \pi x), \\ \Phi_t(X) &= \Phi(X) + \sum_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \mathcal{K}(x_e,t) + \frac{\pi i a(D)}{2} t^2, \\ a(D) &= -w(D) - \sum_v n_v, \qquad S(t) = \Phi_t(X_*(t)). \end{aligned} \tag{14.7}$$

Here $\mathcal{E}_T$ is the original physical turn-edge set. The critical point $X_*(t)$ is the analytic branch through the filled first-charge point. The Hessian is invertible because each original wire Hessian and each conditional angular Schur complement is invertible.

The finite Stirling expansion of $G_N$, to arbitrary requested order, gives holomorphic functions $C_j$ with

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) \sim N\{S(s/N) - S(0)\} + \sum_{j\ge 0} N^{-j}\{C_j(s/N) - C_j(0)\}. \tag{14.8}$$

This is proved using a local auxiliary family with independent $t$, then substituting $t = s/N$. It makes no physical asymptotic claim for $s$ of order $N$. At order $N^{-r}$ the phase contributes degree at most $r+1$ in $s$, while the lower amplitudes contribute degree at most $r$. This proves the filtration and identifies its top diagonal.

Both the phase and the canonically interpolated amplitude are even in $t$. Normalization removes a constant at order $N^{-1}$ and evenness removes a possible linear term from $C_0$. Therefore $p_1(s) = S''(0)s^2/2$.

The geometric identification uses the actual filled branch, not this derivative alone. The directed certificate places every restored angle in the common positive charge-path chart. Its primitive equations remain $U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i$ with $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$. The reconstructed representation is the complete filled-knot representation, and its nondegenerate meridian continuation is the geometric germ. The preferred longitude theorem gives

$$L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M) = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e \in \mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)}, \qquad X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}. \tag{14.9}$$

All factors refer to the original diagram and preferred framing. The negative lift is fixed at the actual complete filled knot.

With $u = \log M$ and $\mathcal{S}(u) = \pi i\{S(u/(\pi i)) - S(0)\}$, (14.7) and the exact sine identity give $-e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)} = L_{\mathrm{geom}}(e^u)$. It follows that $S''(0) = \pi i \tau_K$, proving (14.4) with the exact framing restored.

## 14.4 The factor forced in a genuine classical symbol

Let $r_P$ be a fixed operator order, independent of $N$, and let $P = \sum_{j=0}^{r_P} a_j(q, M) T^j$, with $TM = qMT$, be a specified nonzero fixed rational-coefficient operator annihilating the whole reduced function $F_N(M)$ at every sufficiently large level. Clear fixed denominators and the common $q-1$ valuation, and denote its first nonzero classical symbol by $P_0(M, L)$. This is an all-level identity, not a recurrence fitted to complete values.

The modified dimension is

$$d_N(M) = i^{N+3} \frac{M - M^{-1}}{M^N - M^{-N}}, \qquad \frac{d_N(q_N^s)}{d_N(1)} = H_N(s)^{-1}.$$

For $f(M) = M - M^{-1}$, the normalized full state obeys the exact gauge

$$\widetilde{P} = \sum_{j=0}^{r_P} a_j(q, M)(-1)^j \frac{f(M)}{f(q^j M)} T^j. \tag{14.10}$$

Clearing these additional denominators retains the first symbol $f(M)^{r_P} P_0(M, -L)$.

Set $h = \log q$ and regrade by $u = hs$. The degree filtration gives $h^{-1}\mathcal{S}(u) + \sum_{j \geq 0} h^j A_j(u)$ for the logarithm. A $j$-fold shift has formal leading ratio $e^{j\mathcal{S}'(u)}$. The exact equation and the expansions on all translated disks imply

$$f(e^u)^{r_P} P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{14.11}$$

The substitution $u \mapsto hs$ is injective on the formal two-variable series ring. Its domain property permits cancellation of the nonzero series $f(e^u)^{r_P}$ in this proved identity. The meridian factor has therefore been recorded before cancellation.

Evaluation on the geometric germ defines a nonzero height-one prime of $\mathbb{C}[M^{\pm 1}, L^{\pm 1}]$. Its irreducible generator $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}$ divides $P_0$. Over $\mathbb{Q}(q, M)$, the conclusion is instead stated using the contraction of that prime to the rational Laurent ring; its complex factorization may include conjugate components. No chosen complex component is asserted to be defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

The conclusion determines a selected factor, not its multiplicity, the full A-polynomial or an equality of operator ideals. It adds no moving-main theorem for cyclic Morse sources and no fixed-meridian WKB limit. Those questions require additional source estimates.

# Chapter 15

# Proof inputs and reproduction

The volume theorems combine written analytic and geometric arguments with finite checks of different kinds. The long-twist proof reduces two local inequalities to exact rational certificates supplied with the paper. The quantitative circle-tree proof establishes its uniform bounds analytically; separate finite checks verify its edge formulas, face identifications and peripheral identities. This chapter distinguishes those roles and records the scope of each theorem.

## 15.1 The implication that finishes a volume proof

It is useful to separate three questions. Does the exact invariant contain the contribution computed by stationary phase, with the stated scalar normalization? Is the sum of all its other contributions smaller at the exponential scale? Is the real part of the selected action the volume of the intended knot complement? An affirmative answer to one of these questions does not answer the other two.

The final analytic step has the following precise form. Its hypotheses refer to the entire remainder, including all other charges and contour terms. Throughout this statement, the diagram and every filling integer are fixed. We use $\log 0 = -\infty$ in an upper bound for a remainder.

**Proposition 15.1** (Transfer from a contribution to the invariant)**.** *Suppose that for all sufficiently large integers $N$ the exact invariant has the decomposition*

$$K_N = u_N(G_N + E_N), \qquad G_N = a_N e^{N\mathcal{A}},$$

*where $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{C}$ is independent of $N$, and $u_N, a_N$ are nonzero with*

$$\frac{1}{N}\log|u_N| \longrightarrow 0, \qquad \frac{1}{N}\log|a_N| \longrightarrow 0.$$

*Assume there are real numbers $\Phi$ and $\gamma > 0$ such that*

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N}\log|E_N| \le \Phi - \gamma, \qquad \Re\mathcal{A} > \Phi - \gamma.$$

*Then $K_N$ is nonzero for all sufficiently large $N$, and*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N}\log|K_N| = \Re\mathcal{A}.$$

*If a separate geometric argument proves* $2\pi\Re\mathcal{A} = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K)$ *for this same knot, the volume conjecture follows for* $K$*.*

*Proof.* Put $\Delta = \Re\mathcal{A} - (\Phi - \gamma) > 0$ and choose $0 < \eta < \Delta/3$. The remainder bound and the limit for $a_N$ give, for all sufficiently large $N$,

$$|E_N| \le e^{N(\Phi-\gamma+\eta)}, \qquad |G_N| \ge e^{N(\Re\mathcal{A}-\eta)}.$$

Consequently $|E_N/G_N| \le e^{-N(\Delta-2\eta)}$. In particular this ratio is eventually smaller than $1/2$. The triangle and reverse triangle inequalities bound $|1 + E_N/G_N|$ between $1 - e^{-N(\Delta-2\eta)}$ and $1 + e^{-N(\Delta-2\eta)}$. It is nonzero and its logarithm divided by $N$ tends to zero. Taking absolute values and logarithms in $K_N = u_N a_N e^{N\mathcal{A}}(1 + E_N/G_N)$ proves the assertion. The last conclusion uses the stated geometric identity, which is not an assumption needed for the preceding analytic limit. □

A relative correction such as $1+O(N^{-1})$ to the first saddle belongs to $a_N$. It is not put into $E_N$: such a correction has the same exponential rate as the first saddle. The strict remainder bound is reserved for the other contributions.

The location of each hypothesis matters. For the recursive tangle theorem, Chapter 2 gives the exact invariant and its normalization. Chapter 5 bounds the complementary color terms. Chapter 6 and Appendix B.1 construct the local holomorphic approximation. Chapter 8 and Section B.3 control the rest of the Fourier period, prove that the leading coefficient is nonzero, and compare the charge actions. Chapter 7 and Appendix D identify that action with the volume of the original primitive filling. The local approximation alone supplies neither the global remainder bound nor the metric identification.

For weak balance, write the exact shared spectral polynomial as $S_N = C_N + D_N$, where $C_N$ uses the central contribution at every crossing region. Equation (P.15) bounds the supremum norm of $D_N$ on the full real spectral cube. Appendix N then bounds its image under the actual filling functional by

$$|E_N| \le \prod_e (1 + |n_e|/2)\, \|D_N\|_{[-2,2]^R}.$$

The product is independent of $N$. Appendix O gives the nonzero asymptotic of the filled central contribution and its geometric action. Only after these two independent estimates have been established do we increase the fixed twist threshold so that the drop from $\Phi$ to $\Re\mathcal{A}$ is smaller than the remainder gap. Proposition 15.1 then applies.

There is no circular use of the planar decoration theorem here. Appendix O uses the complete packing construction and finite Morse source from Appendix L; it does not assume that appendix's full-invariant volume conclusion. The complementary-source estimate under weak balance is proved separately in Appendix P. For a general unchanged matched sphere that estimate remains an additional requirement.

## 15.2 The scope of the dependency argument

For the weak-balance and protected-sum results, the order of the quantifiers is

$$\text{fix an admissible diagram and half twists;} \qquad \exists T\ \forall \boldsymbol{p},$$
$$\min_e |p_e| > T \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}).$$

The diagram must satisfy the particular theorem's packing or certificate hypothesis, and its strand connections must give one knot. Each tuple $\boldsymbol{p}$ is fixed inside the limit. In the protected-sum theorem the number of pieces is also fixed before $T$ is chosen. The assertion does not supply one threshold for every diagram or allow the diagram or filling integers to vary with $N$.

The dependency map in `repro/manuscript_logic.json` records the interfaces used by Appendices N–R. Each full-volume conclusion must name its exact invariant, nonzero contribution, full remainder bound, specified completed metric, absolute action-volume identity, and final rate-transfer argument. The general unchanged-sphere route retains its unresolved remainder requirement. It is separate from the completed weak-balance, protected-sum and ordinary-boundary routes.

The following command checks that the recorded premises have the right roles, retain their assumptions and level scope, refer to existing statements, and contain no circular dependency:

```
python3 repro/check_manuscript_logic.py \
  --output repro/results/manuscript-logic
```

It also deliberately introduces nine defects and checks that each is rejected. These include removing the remainder premise, replacing it by the central contribution, importing an open estimate, and using an odd-level estimate in an all-level conclusion. The map is supplied by the author; its consistency is not a proof of the mathematics at its vertices. The recorded source hashes identify the texts used by the check. Internal analytic and geometric lemmas still require their written proofs.

For ordinary-boundary insertion, the map additionally records the conditional disk minimum and the small-boundary certificate hypothesis. The scalar comparison in Appendix R has a Lean proof. It distinguishes a wholly central inserted block from a block with a central attaching label but noncentral terms elsewhere. The duplicated target is twice the boundary logarithm in the doubled Lean normalization; it is not twice the removed triangle potential. The conditional packing and the existence of the shared witnesses remain separate written inputs to those declarations.

## 15.3 Finite steps checked in Lean

The directory `formal/` contains a small formalization using Lean's standard library. It checks the exact even- and odd-level degree cutoffs, polynomial divided differences without division at a spectral root, the double-root Hermite identity after clearing denominators, and the finite tensor-product subtraction used when node values vanish. The formalization also constructs synthetic division on coefficient lists and the remainder modulo a split monic polynomial $p(X) = \prod_i (X - r_i)$. It proves the reconstruction identity coefficient by coefficient, the degree bound on the remainder, and the formula for its top coefficient as an iterated divided difference. Repeated nodes are allowed; no inverse of $r_i - r_j$ is introduced. The constructed remainder and functional are also proved linear over the coefficient ring. Coefficient-equivalent input lists, including arbitrary trailing zeros, give the same output. Adding a multiple of the constructed monic polynomial leaves the remainder and functional unchanged. These statements establish independence of the polynomial representative; they do not yet identify the functional with the original crossing matrix. The product module constructs multiplication of the coefficient lists

and proves that reducing either factor leaves the final remainder and functional unchanged. It derives associative reduced multiplication, reduction after every step of a finite product, and the product rule for the value and first derivative at a repeated root. Proposition N.2 states these facts in polynomial notation. In particular the multiplication is proved compatible with reduction; that compatibility is not a formal hypothesis. The next module proves uniqueness of the remainder among all representatives of the required degree, allowing arbitrary trailing zeros in the coefficient lists. It then proves invariance under every permutation of the root list, including repeated roots, and gives a characterization of the coefficient functional by additivity, annihilation of monic multiples, and normalization in degree below the modulus. Proposition N.1 gives the corresponding mathematical statement and proof. To apply that characterization to a proposed crossing functional, its hypotheses must still be established for the actual operator. The protected-sum module constructs the three central/left/right rate functions and their map to the two input sectors. It proves the local comparison, cancels the duplicated joining-face target, and preserves the smaller input gap. Appendix Q proves that the diagrams and their shared witnesses supply these formal hypotheses. The triangulations, analytic estimates, and volume identity themselves are not formalized. The formal regrading module checks the coefficient substitution $u = hs$ used in Appendix M. It recovers every coefficient from its new pair of exponents and proves injectivity. It also proves that agreement through order $h^L$ recovers exactly the coefficients of total degree at most $L$. The all-orders expansion, its uniform analytic remainder, and the identification of the longitude remain separate inputs. It also checks the scalar inequalities that compare the entropy gain with its quadratic cost and preserve a remainder gap after a small decrease in the action. From the repository root, run

```
python3 repro/check_proof_logic.py --output repro/results/proof-logic
```

The project pins its Lean version. The runner compiles the declarations and then separately inspects every theorem's logical assumptions. The accepted foundational axioms are propositional extensionality, classical choice and quotient soundness; an admitted proof step is rejected.

These are formal proofs of the stated finite implications. Their applications still require the hypotheses proved in the manuscript. For example, the scalar entropy comparison does not prove the Hessian formula, and the divided-difference identity does not identify the original knot operator. The monic-remainder calculation does not prove the Chebyshev factorization or its root multiplicities; these data must still be supplied for the actual spectral polynomial. The exact diagram adapter, uniform analytic estimates, geometric realization, primitive completion and Proposition 15.1 remain written proofs. The file `repro/MANUSCRIPT_AUDIT.md` records the current proof checks and the boundaries of this initial formalization.

## 15.4 Three different kinds of evidence

The manuscript contains analytic proofs, exact finite certificates, and optional finite checks. They have different logical roles. The matrix identities, support and strictness arguments, geometric incidence, complex estimates and filling analysis are proved in the text. The rational certificates are finite parts of the proof: the continuum inequalities reduce to their exact feasibility, coverage and supporting-plane checks. Finite matrix computations and numerical

asymptotic comparisons provide independent checks of formulas and normalizations, but do not establish a theorem by extrapolation.

The chapters and appendices give the proofs with their named dependencies on earlier finite-source and geometric lemmas. References to those technical companions remain proof inputs; the PDF does not reproduce every calculation in the research library. The repository also supplies the exact certificate data and verification programs. Those programs check the finite inequalities described below; they do not formally verify the analytic or geometric arguments.

## 15.5 Replaying the exact certificates

From the repository root, run

```
python3 repro/verify.py --output repro/results
```

The serial runner uses the standard Python library. It replays the two-leaf block certificate, the attachment square certificate and the optional endpoint certificate, compares their exact results with the recorded data, and checks the elementary rational leaf and isolated-three-leaf margins. Its report records the source and data hashes. Candidate generation and numerical optimization are not run by verification.

The principal proof files are

| Certificate | Mathematical coverage |
|---|---|
| `verify_conway_two_leaf_block_alias_certificate.py` | Sixteen slope intervals; both alias types; 288 corner/vertex inequalities. |
| `verify_conway_single_leaf_attachment_certificate.py` | Exact 55-rectangle cover; 880 corner/vertex inequalities on the full child/parent slope square. |
| Endpoint certificate in the runner's manifest | Optional stronger margin at the monotone-response endpoint; not needed for the main theorem. |

All paths are resolved relative to the repository or script directory, rather than an author's temporary working directory. The runner's proof-input guide lists the written dependencies separately from executable checks.

## 15.6 Checking the quantitative tree formulas

The elementary edge equations and complex-strip estimates used by Chapter 9 have a portable reproduction command:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py curvature-fillings
```

The runner checks exact symbolic edge identities, finite samples of the stated complex inequality, labeled octahedral attachments and the full signed peripheral matrix words. Its output separates those computations from the uniform analytic and geometric proofs. Appendix E gives the full quantitative finite-sum proof, including both uniform Newton estimates, the weighted contraction and the charge-tail bounds. Appendix F gives the complete ordered attachment, positive angular charts, primitive-period completion, volume calibration and preferred-cusp

argument. The technical notes provide separately readable copies of those proofs. Such finite checks can detect sign or indexing errors; they do not replace the written proofs.

The local subtree proof and its separate geometric criterion have the following finite checks:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py local-tree-fillings
```

They verify exact rational constant inequalities and compare the full finite subtree recurrence with independently evaluated contractions. Appendix G proves the estimates at every level and the uniform induction on a fixed tree. A finite set of levels does not establish that induction.

## 15.7 The planar terminal decoration

The finite identities for Chapter 13 have one command:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py balanced-terminal-fans
```

The script uses exact integer and rational arithmetic. It checks the closed fan recurrence, the rational balance margin, the oriented triangle subdivision and its new ordered quadrilateral, the matching and even-level face parity, and the endpoint pairing of even stacks of odd terminal tangles. It does not infer an asymptotic theorem from sampled quantum values. Appendix L proves the geometric realization, full finite source, uniform Fourier estimates and primitive completion.

## 15.8 The directed criterion and unmarked junctions

The exact rational comparisons for Chapter 11 have one command:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py directed-tree-fillings
```

This program uses only Python's standard library. It verifies the constant inequalities for the uniform twist bound and the star with central power two, using rational enclosures of all quantities. The uniform conditional kernel estimate, induction over arbitrary fixed trees, noncancellation and geometric interpretation are written proofs in Appendix K.

For the local algebra of the unmarked-junction extension, run

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py strict-tree-geometry
```

This program requires SymPy. It checks the white-map normalizations, primitive disk-longitude trace, incident radius formulas and the half-angle fold identity. Appendix J proves the based boundary-map comparison, stationary elimination and full representation assembly. Those global statements are not deduced from the finite matrix checks.

## 15.9 Building the manuscript and illustrated guide

The TeX source is in `manuscript/`; its native illustrations are in `manuscript/figures/`. A TeX Live or MacTeX installation with `latexmk` builds the paper:

```
python3 tools/build_manuscript.py
```

The output is `manuscript/build/main.pdf`. The build manifest records the hashes of all TeX and bibliography inputs and the generated PDF. It is a typesetting record, not a mathematical certificate.

The illustrated guide is built separately:

```
python3 tools/build_book.py
python3 tools/check_book.py
```

It is written to `docs/` and links the same authored PDF. Documentation builds do not execute research scripts. The guide includes the theorem statements, a notation chapter and a lecture-note account of the methods, including approaches that do not give a general theorem. Its links distinguish proved estimates from open comparisons. The manuscript retains the completed arguments and their stated consequences.

## 15.10 The scope of the conclusions

Every volume theorem fixes the diagram, its endpoint order, disk framings, parity pattern and integer powers before $N$ tends to infinity. The limit includes both parity sequences and composite levels. Only auxiliary crossing circles are filled; the main knot cusp remains complete. The component test must give one knot without an internally closed extra main component.

Theorem 1.2 applies to the completed expressions of Definition 1.1. Each signed filling integer must exceed a construction-dependent threshold in absolute value; there is no restriction on ratios between the large integers. The circle-tree results use their own sufficient conditions: the summed inequality of Theorem 9.1, the local inequality of Theorem 10.1, or the directed certificate of Chapter 11. The mixed condition $d_v \geq 2^{28}$ or $|n_v| \geq 2^{27}$ at each vertex is a consequence of the last certificate. These are separate proofs, not relaxations of the completed-box hypothesis inside the first proof.

The planar theorem of Chapter 13 applies a specified finite decoration to a simple matched sphere before performing its independently long signed fillings. The decoration preserves the chosen endpoint pairing and can change the knot. It does not give the full volume theorem for every unchanged sphere. For unchanged diagrams, Appendix O proves a narrower statement: the specified geometric contribution of the original exact invariant has a nonzero asymptotic at the actual filled volume rate. This contribution is not a separate topological invariant, and the theorem does not bound the remaining signed contribution.

The meridian-profile and preferred-longitude results retain their stated source classes. Chapter 14 proves the full expansion required for the selected-factor conclusion for every directed certificate. That conclusion is an implication for an existing nonzero fixed all-level annihilator; it neither proves recurrence existence nor identifies the entire A-polynomial or recurrence ideal. Appendix N proves a finite functional estimate. Its application to an additional volume class requires a separate exponential source estimate.

None of these sufficient conditions is a classification of all arborescent knots or all short fillings. Broader net-twist and closure statements in the linked companions keep their own reduction and long-surviving-weight hypotheses. The geometric arguments retain the original manifold: scalar equalities in $\mathcal{H}_N$ are not used as tangle isotopies, and the continued main boundary word becomes the preferred longitude of the smooth filled knot at the endpoint of the specified geometric path.

## 15.11 The geometric longitude calculation

The symbolic identities in the geometric characteristic chapter have one reproduction command:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py geometric-characteristic
```

This group requires SymPy. It verifies the nonparabolic face maps, character matrices, half-twist line transports, and the differential and discriminant formulas. The topological gluing, boundary pairing, algebraic constants and regularity arguments remain the written proofs of Appendices H and I.

## 15.12 Uniform bounds for inserting twists

Appendix N proves a level-independent bound for each original filling functional, measured against the supremum of the shared spectral polynomial. Its finite identities can be checked with one command:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py filling-supremum
```

This group requires SymPy and NumPy. It checks the derivative interpolation and Chebyshev residues exactly, then compares the functional with independently constructed signed crossing matrices over finite fields. The shared exponential estimate remains a separate hypothesis; these checks add no new volume class.

# Appendix A

# Finite algebra and normalization identities

This appendix proves the finite identities on which the asymptotic argument rests. The first calculation compares the chosen crossing matrices and reduced trace with the conventional invariant. The next two calculations establish the Newton basis, its genuine geometric turn, and the exact color decomposition. The last calculation expands an arbitrary twist power while keeping derivatives at repeated roots. No limiting argument is used in these identities.

## A.1 The crossing comparison and enhancement

This section supplies the finite normalization calculation used in Proposition 2.1. Put $\omega = Q$ and

$$p_j = \prod_{h=1}^{j}(1-\omega^h), \qquad \bar{p}_j = \prod_{h=1}^{j}(1-\omega^{-h}), \qquad p_0 = 1.$$

Kashaev's unbraided four-index matrix may be written by introducing nonnegative residues

$$u = [j-i-1], \quad v = [i-l], \quad t = [l-k], \quad h = [k-j].$$

Its support conditions are equivalent to $u+v+t+h = N-1$, and on that support

$$R^{o}_{(i,j);(k,l)} = \frac{N\omega^{1-(t+h)(u+h)}}{p_u \bar{p}_v p_t \bar{p}_h}. \tag{A.1}$$

One free $j$ and such a composition specify one entry. Let $F_{ij} = \omega^{ij}/\sqrt{N}$. Its full Fourier transform has only the ordinary-integer-conserving entries

$$((F^{-1}\otimes F^{-1})R^{o}(F\otimes F))_{(a-k,b+k);(a,b)} = \omega^{1+(a-k)(b+1)}\frac{p_a p_{b+k}}{p_{a-k}p_b p_k}, \tag{A.2}$$

for $0 \le k \le \min(a, N-1-b)$.

Here is the finite summation. Define

$$S_m(X) = \sum_{j=0}^{m}\frac{X^j}{p_j \bar{p}_{m-j}} = \frac{\prod_{j=1}^{m}(X-\omega^j)}{p_m}.$$

The equality follows by induction from $\bar{p}_m = (-1)^m \omega^{-m(m+1)/2} p_m$ and $(1-\omega^m)S_m = (X - \omega^m)S_{m-1}$. The free Fourier index imposes conservation modulo $N$. The two remaining factors are $S_{N-1-z}(\omega^{c-z})S_z(\omega^{z-a})$; their zeros force $c \le z \le a$. With $m = a - c$, the residual sum is

$$\omega^{1+c(b+1)} \frac{p_a}{p_c} \sum_{j=0}^{m} \frac{(-1)^j \omega^{j(j-1)/2} \omega^{(b+1)j}}{p_j p_{m-j}} = \omega^{1+c(b+1)} \frac{p_a}{p_c} \frac{(\omega^{b+1};\omega)_m}{p_m}.$$

If $b + m \ge N$, the product contains $1 - \omega^N$ and vanishes. Otherwise it is $p_{b+m}/p_b$, proving (A.2) with integer, rather than merely residue, conservation.

Set $G_j = p_j/(1-\omega)^j = q^{j(j-1)/2}[j]_q!$, $D_j = (-q)^j$, and $\gamma = \omega q^{-d^2/2}$. Substitution into (2.2) gives exactly

$$(F^{-1} \otimes F^{-1}) R^o (F \otimes F) = \gamma (DG \otimes G) \mathscr{R} (G^{-1} \otimes G^{-1} D^{-1}).$$

For the enhanced braid conventions take

$$B_K = P(R^o)^T, \quad \mu_K = -qS, \quad \alpha_K = -q, \qquad B_q = P\mathscr{R}^T, \quad \mu_q = K^{-1}, \quad \alpha_q = q^{(N^2-1)/2},$$

where $Sv_j = v_{j+1 \bmod N}$. On $b$ strands, the single similarity

$$U_b = F^{-\otimes b} \bigotimes_{j=1}^{b} (G^{-1} D^{j-1})$$

works for every adjacent generator because the quantum crossing conserves integer weight and commutes with $D \otimes D$. It also sends $\mu_q^{\otimes b}$ to $\mu_K^{\otimes b}$, and $\gamma\alpha_q = \alpha_K$. The writhe characters cancel exactly. The partial traces commute with the remaining module generators; distinct $K$ weights and nonzero $F$ arrows imply scalarity. Thus every internal similarity cancels, including the one open factor of a reduced cut. This proves the finite enhanced comparison used in Chapter 2. Large factorial gauges are never estimated by their norms.

The primal/dual change of basis is $Bv_j = (-1)^j q^{j(j-N)} v_{d-j}$. Direct generator substitution conjugates $K^{-1}$ to the primal pivot and the crossing to the recorded primal convention. At completeness $g_{\mathrm{ADO}} = (-1)^d K$ and the twist has the corresponding sign. A $b$-strand closure of writhe $w$ and $c$ components has $w \equiv b - c \pmod 2$, so the remaining enhancement ratio is $(-1)^{d(c-1)}$. Its modulus is one, and for a knot it is one in this convention.

## A.2 The block polynomial and the physical Newton turn

For completeness we justify the block minimal polynomial used in Lemma 2.2. Before specialization, the ordinary highest-weight module of highest weight $d$ has weights $d - 2a$. In the pair, a highest vector of total degree $j$ is obtained by solving the bidiagonal raising equation. If its coefficient at $|a, j-a\rangle$ is $u_a$, the equation at $|a, j-a-1\rangle$ determines $u_{a+1}/u_a$ as the negative ratio of the two nonzero raising entries. Thus for generic $q$ there is one such vector in each degree $j = 0, \dots, d$. Its highest weight is $2d - 2j$, its Casimir is $q^{2d-2j+1} + q^{-2d+2j-1}$, and its successive lowering vectors are nonzero through the usual length. The dimensions $2d - 2j + 1$ sum to $N^2$. Distinct generic Casimirs make these submodules independent.

In degree $T \le d$, precisely the highest vectors $j \le T$ contribute one descendant each. Their eigenvalues give the block characteristic polynomial. At $q = e^{\pi \mathrm{i}/N}$ it becomes

$$\prod_{j=0}^{T}(z - c_j), \qquad c_j = q^{2j+1} + q^{-2j-1}.$$

All physical matrix entries specialize regularly. The nonzero adjacent entries of the tridiagonal block make a boundary vector cyclic, so this characteristic polynomial is also minimal even when roots coincide. At $T = d$ it is $P_N$. The elementary identity

$$\prod_{j=0}^{N-1}(z - q^{2j+1} - q^{-2j-1}) = 2T_N(z/2) + 2$$

can also be checked by putting $z = w + w^{-1}$: the roots correspond to $w^N = -1$, and the monic degree and leading coefficient agree. The generating property of $W_d$ propagates its vanishing to the full pair.

Now $B_r(\Omega)$ annihilates every degree block $W_T$ with $T < r$, with multiplicities, and has first-color bandwidth at most $r$. In the turned matrix its first-color displacement is $d - (a + b)$, so $\mathsf{T}B_r$ annihilates every $W_T$ with $T < d - r$. Its representing polynomial is therefore divisible by $B_{d-r}$.

For the reverse degree bound, its first middle-block column is

$$(\mathsf{T}B_r)_{a0} = x^{a-d}(B_r(\Omega))_{(d-a,0);(d-a,0)},$$

which vanishes for $a > d - r$. A polynomial of degree $k < N$ in the cyclic tridiagonal middle block has a nonzero $k$th coordinate on the first basis vector, from its unique outermost path. Thus $\deg \mathsf{T}B_r \le d - r$, proving $\mathsf{T}B_r = C_r B_{d-r}$.

Use the physical entry from $(d - r, 0)$ to $(0, d - r)$. On the turned side it is the unique $r$-step path in the high-degree block, whose factors are

$$Q^{j-r}(1 - Q^{r-j})(1 - Q^{j+1}), \qquad 0 \le j < r.$$

Including the leading coefficient $(-1)^r$ gives $s_r^2$. The corresponding path for $B_{d-r}$ in the low block gives $s_{d-r}^2$. All turn monomials in this entry equal one. Hence

$$\mathsf{T}B_r = \frac{s_r^2}{s_{d-r}^2} B_{d-r}, \qquad \mathsf{T}\widehat{B}_r = \widehat{B}_{d-r}.$$

Finally $s_r s_{d-r} = N$ and (2.11) give $\phi(\widehat{B}_i \widehat{B}_j) = \delta_{i+j,d}$: use degree below $d$, leading coefficient at $d$, and full divisibility by $P_N$ above it. This proves Proposition 2.3 by physical support and exact paths.

## A.3 Circle coefficients and the signed alias

We derive the coefficient formulas rather than infer them from values at the distinct Casimir roots. That distinction is necessary because the quotient algebra also contains first derivatives at double roots. The generating-function calculation first gives a polynomial identity at a

generic parameter; regular specialization then retains all those derivatives automatically. The generic Chebyshev–Newton identity is

$$U_{j-1}(z/2) = \sum_{r=0}^{j-1} (-1)^r \begin{bmatrix} j+r \\ 2r+1 \end{bmatrix}_q B_r(z). \tag{A.3}$$

To prove it, successively divide $1 - zt + t^2 = (1 - c_r t + t^2) + t(c_r - z)$. The formal identity is

$$\frac{1}{1 - zt + t^2} = \sum_{r \geq 0} \frac{(-t)^r B_r(z)}{\prod_{i=0}^{r} (1 - c_i t + t^2)}.$$

After $r$ steps the remainder is divisible by $t^{r+1}$. The denominator factors as a consecutive $q$-string, and the Gaussian Pascal recurrence gives its reciprocal coefficient. Taking the coefficient of $t^{j-1}$ gives (A.3). For $j \leq \lfloor N/2 \rfloor$, every factorial index is below $N$; specializing and turning proves (2.18).

For higher colors use the polynomial identity

$$U_{N-h-1} = \tfrac{1}{2}(\mathsf{C}_h U_{N-1} - \mathsf{C}_N U_{h-1}).$$

Since $\mathsf{C}_N = -2$ in the full algebra,

$$L_{N-h} = (-1)^h \tfrac{1}{2} \mathsf{C}_h L_N + (-1)^N L_h.$$

The $v$th turned coefficient of the first term is $(-1)^h N \sum_{k=0}^{d} \cos(h(2k+1)\pi/N) \widehat{B}_v(c_k)$. This finite sum can be evaluated without a zero denominator. Put $z = w + w^{-1}$. The factorization of $B_v$ is the consecutive string

$$B_v(w + w^{-1}) = (-1)^v w^{-v} \prod_{j=0}^{2v-1} \left( w - q^{-(2v-1)+2j} \right).$$

For $0 \leq v, h \leq M$, all its Fourier exponents after multiplication by $w^{\pm h}$ have absolute value below $N$. Summing at $w = q^{2k+1}$ extracts only the constant coefficient. The finite Gaussian product gives that coefficient as zero for $v < h$, and as $(-1)^h s_{2v}/(s_{v-h} s_{v+h})$ for $v \geq h$. Dividing by $s_v^2$ and multiplying the two factors of $N$ proves (2.17), including $h = 0$ and both parities.

For the half twist, multiplication by $z$ in Newton coordinates is the lower bidiagonal matrix $Z$ with $Z_{rr} = c_r$ and $Z_{r+1,r} = -4 \sin^2((r+1)\pi/N)$. The one-crossing matrix is

$$(R(Z))_{ij} = \kappa (-1)^i q^{i(j+1)} \frac{s_i}{s_j s_{i-j}}, \qquad i \geq j.$$

Its first column is the finite Newton expansion of the crossing. Substituting the two neighboring ratios shows that it commutes with $Z$; since the first coordinate is cyclic, this determines the full matrix. Reversal on both sides gives (2.19). Coefficient conjugation gives the inverse crossing because its full Hermite values and logarithmic derivatives are conjugate. This argument retains all normal directions.

## A.4 Fourier–Hermite interpolation of an arbitrary twist

Ordinary interpolation prescribes values. Hermite interpolation also prescribes derivatives at a repeated node. Here the crossing power supplies both data, and the change of variable $z = w + w^{-1}$ turns the interpolation problem into a finite Fourier calculation. The two Fourier equations below solve simultaneously for the coefficients that ordinary value interpolation would fail to distinguish. For an integer $\ell$, let $f_{N,\ell}$ be the degree-below-$N$ remainder of $r_N^\ell$ modulo $P_N$. Negative powers exist because all its nodal values are nonzero. At $w_k = q^{2k+1}$ define

$$h_k = \big((-1)^k q^{k(k+1)}\big)^\ell, \qquad d_k = -\frac{\ell}{2}(d-2k)h_k.$$

At a double node, $d_k = (w_k - w_k^{-1}) f'_{N,\ell}(c_k)$; at the odd simple node both sides of the logarithmic derivative condition vanish without prescribing an extra derivative. Put

$$H_n = \frac{1}{N}\sum_k h_k w_k^{-n}, \qquad D_n = \frac{1}{N}\sum_k d_k w_k^{-n}, \qquad 0 \le n < N.$$

Then

$$f_{N,\ell}(z) = a_0 + \sum_{n=1}^{d} a_n \mathsf{C}_n(z), \qquad a_0 = H_0, \quad a_n = \frac{D_n + (N-n)H_n}{N}. \tag{A.4}$$

Indeed the Laurent polynomial $f(w + w^{-1})$ has symmetric coefficients $a_n$ at $w^{\pm n}$. At $w_k^N = -1$ its values and logarithmic derivatives have aliases

$$H_n = a_n - a_{N-n}, \qquad D_n = n a_n + (N-n) a_{N-n}.$$

Solving gives (A.4). At the even middle index $H_{N/2} = 0$ and the derivative equation still determines the coefficient. Paired nodes give the required compatibility, and the odd simple root imposes exactly one condition. Thus no root or normal is omitted.

Set $a_N = a_{N+1} = 0$ and

$$\beta_j^{\ell/2} = (-1)^j (a_j - a_{j+2}), \qquad 0 \le j < N.$$

The identity $\mathsf{C}_n = U_n - U_{n-2}$ gives the circle expansion. Since $|h_k| = 1$ and $|d_k| \le |\ell| N/2$, one has $|a_0| \le 1$, $|a_n| \le 1 + |\ell|/2$, and

$$\sum_j |\beta_j^{\ell/2}| \le 2N(1 + |\ell|/2).$$

For $\ell = 2P$, these are the coefficients used in (8.3). To obtain that formula directly, substitute the two finite Fourier sums into $a_j - a_{j+2}$, set $j = N - h - 1$, and pair $h$ with $-h$ in an even corridor. The difference of the two exponentials gives $\sinh(2\pi \mathrm{i} z_k)$; the differentiated data give the linear factor $2PNz_k + h$, and differentiating the hyperbolic sine gives its cosine. Their sum is precisely $U'_N(z_k)/(2\pi\mathrm{i})$. The constant phase is $(-1)^d \kappa^{-P}$ and the two averaging factors give $N^{-2}$. This verifies (8.3) with both normal terms and both parity conventions.

# Appendix B

# Detailed estimates for the color sums and filling contours

The local and global estimates have different purposes. Section B.1 constructs an exponentially accurate holomorphic approximation on the strict neighborhood used for the saddle. Section B.2 bounds every remaining core coefficient, including parameters where the recurrence eigenvalues meet. The last section treats the joining contours for the filling integral. Keeping these estimates separate prevents a local asymptotic expansion from being applied outside its proven domain.

## B.1 The exact local recurrence and its holomorphic asymptotic

This section proves the local source estimate used in the completed-root theorem. Its hypothesis is a fixed compact interval

$$I = [\tau_0, \tau_1] \subset (1/4, 1/2) \tag{B.1}$$

for every retained complete leaf coordinate. All constants may depend on this interval and the fixed source tree. The color neighborhood and every complex index neighborhood below are fixed independently of the level. We work with the actual finite low core and its specified factorial continuation. No homogeneous solution of a recurrence is substituted for that source. In particular, an inverse-power approximation on the real index grid will not be used as if it were an exponentially accurate complex interpolation.

### B.1.1 Canonical factorials and the literal mixed coefficient

To move a color parameter off the integer grid, we must specify a function that agrees with the finite coefficient and preserves its phase. The Gamma product below supplies that function for the sine factorials. Its exact shift identity will then allow the finite recurrence to remain valid at complex colors; agreement only in a leading asymptotic term would not be sufficient.

Retain

$$d = N - 1, \quad M = \lfloor d/2 \rfloor, \quad q = e^{\pi \mathrm{i}/N}, \quad Q = q^2, \quad \kappa = q^{d^2/2}, \quad F_r = (Q;Q)_r.$$

In this section $x$ denotes a scaled Newton index, rather than the physical-frame scalar $q^d$. The sine factorial has the exact continuation

$$G_N(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{N}\right)^z \Gamma(z+1) \prod_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{\Gamma(Nk+z+1)}{\Gamma(Nk-z)(Nk)^{2z+1}}, \qquad -1 < \Re z < N. \tag{B.2}$$

All positive-base powers use their real logarithms. The logarithm of the $k$th factor is $O_K(k^{-2})$ on compact subsets of the strip: in the Gamma-ratio expansion its $k^{-1}$ term cancels. Thus the product is holomorphic and zero-free there. Gamma's functional equation and the convergent sine product give

$$\frac{G_N(z+1)}{G_N(z)} = 2\sin\frac{\pi(z+1)}{N}, \qquad G_N(0) = 1, \qquad G_N(r) = s_r \quad (0 \le r < N). \tag{B.3}$$

The marked quantum factorial is

$$\widehat{F}_N(z) = e^{\pi \mathrm{i} z(z+1)/(2N) - \pi \mathrm{i} z/2} G_N(z). \tag{B.4}$$

Consequently

$$\widehat{F}_N(z+1) = (1 - Q^{z+1})\widehat{F}_N(z), \qquad \widehat{F}_N(r) = F_r, \qquad Q^z = e^{2\pi \mathrm{i} z/N}.$$

These identities fix the continuation and its phase, not just its asymptotic expansion. On a compact subset of $0 < \Re z < 1$, direct Stirling expansion of (B.2) gives

$$\begin{aligned} \log G_N(Nz) &= NJ(z) + \frac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log}(2N\sin\pi z) + \frac{\pi\cot\pi z}{12N} + O(N^{-3}), \\ J(z) &= \int_0^z \operatorname{Log}(2\sin\pi u)\,\mathrm{d}u. \end{aligned} \tag{B.5}$$

Here the logarithm continues the real positive factorial branch. One way to verify the uniform remainder is to expand the $k$th Gamma ratio: its error is $O_K(N^{-3}k^{-3})$. These errors are summable; the leading and half-log terms sum by the sine product. The first correction sums by

$$z^{-1} + \sum_{k\ge 1}\bigl((k+z)^{-1} - (k-z)^{-1}\bigr) = \pi\cot\pi z.$$

Cauchy's estimate supplies the corresponding derivative bounds on smaller compact sets.

Let $h$ be a physical color deficit and put $t = h/N$. At an integer index $r > h$ the pure core coefficient is the literal factorial expression

$$A_N(r,t) = \frac{N^2 s_{2r}}{s_r^2 G_N(r-Nt)G_N(r+Nt)}. \tag{B.6}$$

For a retained half-twist sign $\varepsilon \in \{1,-1\}$, the exact triangular Newton transport gives

$$d_N^{\varepsilon}(r,t) = \kappa^{\varepsilon}\sum_{v=r}^{M}(-1)^v q^{\varepsilon v(r+1)}\frac{s_v}{s_r s_{v-r}}A_N(v,t), \qquad d_N^0(r,t) = A_N(r,t). \tag{B.7}$$

For complex $t$ in a sufficiently small fixed disk, only the two color-shifted factorials are continued. All their arguments remain in regular strips. Equation (B.7) is then an exact finite,

even holomorphic function. At every physical integer $h < r$ it is the original transported core, including all first normal directions.

The cancellation inside this finite sum is encoded by

$$A_{h,r} = \sum_{v=r}^{M} \frac{Q^{-vr} F_{2v}}{F_v \widehat{F}_N(v-h) \widehat{F}_N(v+h) F_{v-r}}, \tag{B.8}$$

$$D_{h,r} = \frac{Q^{-r^2} F_{2r}}{F_r \widehat{F}_N(r-h) \widehat{F}_N(r+h)}, \qquad U_{h,r} = A_{h,r}/D_{h,r}. \tag{B.9}$$

The sum starts at $r$ in the present corridor. For physical $r < h$ its lower endpoint would be $h$; those low indices belong to the separate global envelope, not to the interpolation asserted here. The terminal source in (B.9) is exactly $U_{h,M} = 1$.

### B.1.2 Deriving the recurrence, including its endpoint

The identity traditionally called a Ward equation here is simply a second-order recurrence obtained by telescoping the actual finite sum. A recurrence has many solutions, so we include its upper endpoint condition in the derivation. That condition is what selects the coefficient occurring in the invariant.

Put $H = Q^h = e^{2\pi i t}$, $T_h = H + H^{-1}$ and $Y = Q^r$. The literal finite sum satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} QY^2(1 - Q^2Y)A_{h,r+2} + Y(T_h Q^3 Y^2 + Q + 1)A_{h,r+1} \\ - Q(QY+1)(QY^2-1)A_{h,r} = 0, \qquad A_{h,M+1} = 0. \end{aligned} \tag{B.10}$$

Here and below an absent term beyond the finite upper support is zero. We give the summation certificate, since the endpoint fixes which solution of this second-order equation is the physical one.

For the summand of (B.8), write $z = Q^v$. Its ratio under $v \mapsto v+1$ is

$$\frac{Y^{-1}(1 - Qz^2)(1 + Qz)}{(1 - Qz/H)(1 - QHz)(1 - Qz/Y)}.$$

Use the rational certificate

$$g_h(z) = \frac{(1 - z/H)(1 - Hz)(1 - z/Y)}{z^2}.$$

The telescoping difference, divided by the original summand, is

$$\left(\frac{1}{YQ^2} - 1\right) z^{-2} + \left(\frac{1}{YQ} + H + H^{-1} + \frac{1}{Y}\right) z^{-1} - \frac{1}{YQ} - 1 - \frac{H + H^{-1}}{Y}. \tag{B.11}$$

The lower endpoint has $z = Y$ and hence vanishes. The upper endpoint contains $F_{2M+2} = 0$. The ratio for the shift $r \mapsto r+1$ is $z^{-1} - Y^{-1}$. Expressing the first two $z^{-1}$ moments in terms of $A_{h,r+1}$ and $A_{h,r+2}$ in (B.11) gives (B.10) by multiplication of its displayed denominators. This argument remains exact for complex $h = Nt$: the shifted factorial equations are exact and the lower zero is still $z = Y$. It does not use interpolation from finitely many colors.

Normalize by the actual $D_{h,r}$ and set

$$\mathrm{den}_r = (1 - QY/H)(1 - QYH).$$

Then

$$U_r = p_N(r,t)U_{r+1} + q_N(r,t)U_{r+2}, \tag{B.12}$$

where the exact rational coefficients are

$$p_N = -\frac{Q^{-2}Y^{-1}(T_hQ^3Y^2 + Q + 1)}{\mathrm{den}_r}, \tag{B.13}$$

$$q_N = -\frac{Q^{-4}Y^{-2}(1-Q^2Y)(1-Q^3Y^2)(1+Q^2Y)}{\mathrm{den}_r\,\mathrm{den}_{r+1}}. \tag{B.14}$$

All these denominators are bounded away from zero on the corridor used below. At the last recurrence row one has the exact wall

$$q_N(M-1,t) = 0, \qquad U_{M-1} = p_N(M-1,t), \qquad U_M = 1. \tag{B.15}$$

For odd $N = 2m+1$, $M = m$ and the factor $1-Q^3Y^2$ vanishes. For even $N = 2m$, $M = m-1$ and $1+Q^2Y$ vanishes. The zero is independent of $H$. In particular no nonexistent $D_{h,M+1}$ is divided out and no arbitrary terminal ratio is imposed.

### B.1.3 The selected analytic root and a source-exact continued fraction

We solve the recurrence backwards from its finite upper endpoint. On the strict high-index interval, one characteristic root dominates the other. The resulting contraction permits a holomorphic continued fraction. Crucially, an exact zero in the last recurrence row erases the artificial tail of this continued fraction, so it agrees with the original finite solution on the integer grid.

Regard (B.13)–(B.14) as holomorphic functions $p(x,t,\varepsilon_N)$ and $q_c(x,t,\varepsilon_N)$, where $\varepsilon_N = N^{-1}$, $Y = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}x}$ and $Q = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}\varepsilon_N}$. At $\varepsilon_N = 0$, put

$$\begin{aligned} D_t &= (1-Y/H)(1-YH), \\ p_0 &= -Y^{-1}\frac{(H+H^{-1})Y^2+2}{D_t}, \qquad q_0 = -Y^{-2}\frac{(1-Y^2)^2}{D_t^2}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.16}$$

The two roots of $\mu^2 - p_0\mu - q_0 = 0$ at $t = 0$ are

$$\mu_s(x,0) = -Y^{-1}, \qquad \mu_f(x,0) = Y^{-1}\cot^2(\pi x). \tag{B.17}$$

On a compact real interval in $(1/4, 3/4)$ containing $[\tau_0, 1/2]$, the selected branch $\mu = \mu_s$ is nonzero, $\Re\mu > 0$, and $|\mu_f/\mu| < 1$. The same inequalities, with uniform strict constants, hold on a fixed complex neighborhood and a sufficiently small complex $t$ disk. Indeed at $t = 0$ these assertions follow directly from (B.17); nonvanishing and a separated quadratic root persist on a small complex thickening. Write

$$\left|\frac{\mu_f}{\mu}\right| \le k_0 < 1, \qquad \Re\mu \ge m_0 > 0. \tag{B.18}$$

The endpoint $x = 1/2$ is included. Direct substitution gives $\mu(1/2,t) = 1$, while $q_0$ has a double zero there and its first $\varepsilon_N$ derivative also vanishes. The selected root and its normalization are regular at the physical terminal point.

Choose $\sigma_0 > 0$ so small that $[\tau_0 - \sigma_0, 1 - \tau_0 + 4\sigma_0] \subset (1/4, 3/4)$. Use a fixed complex neighborhood of this larger interval on which (B.18) holds, and put

$$\mathcal{L}_N = \lceil (1/2 - \tau_0 + 2\sigma_0)N \rceil, \qquad \mathcal{F}_x(z) = p(x, t, \varepsilon_N) + \frac{q_c(x, t, \varepsilon_N)}{z}.$$

Define the finite continued fraction

$$v_N(x, t) = \mathcal{F}_x \circ \mathcal{F}_{x+\varepsilon_N} \circ \cdots \circ \mathcal{F}_{x+(\mathcal{L}_N-1)\varepsilon_N}(\mu(x + \mathcal{L}_N\varepsilon_N, t)). \tag{B.19}$$

This is defined on a fixed complex neighborhood of $[\tau_0, 1/2]$. For a constant $C$ independent of $N$, the disks of radius $C\varepsilon_N$ around the respective selected roots are invariant under backward iteration. To prove this, note first that

$$\mathcal{F}_x(\mu(x + \varepsilon_N, t)) - \mu(x, t) = O(\varepsilon_N).$$

On those disks the derivative in the continued-fraction argument has modulus at most $k_0 + O(\varepsilon_N)$. Choose $k_1 \in (k_0, 1)$ and then $C$ so that the $O(\varepsilon_N)$ error plus $k_1 C\varepsilon_N$ is at most $C\varepsilon_N$. This proves the invariance inductively. The disks avoid zero, so every iterate is holomorphic, nonzero, and has uniformly bounded inverse. In particular

$$v_N(x, t) = \mu(x, t) + O(N^{-1}) \tag{B.20}$$

uniformly holomorphically on a fixed smaller domain.

At a physical $x = r/N$, the continued fraction reaches the row $M - 1$. By (B.15), that row forgets its entire remaining tail and takes exactly the value $p_N(M - 1, t)$. Backward induction from the literal source $U_M = 1$ therefore proves

$$v_N(r/N, t) = \frac{U_{Nt,r}}{U_{Nt,r+1}}, \qquad \tau_0 N \le r < M. \tag{B.21}$$

This also proves that the displayed physical source values are nonzero. The equality holds uniformly for complex $t$ in the fixed disk. There is no assertion about a nonexistent physical ratio at $r = M$.

Adding one more future step to (B.19) changes the future value by $O(\varepsilon_N)$, and the preceding $\mathcal{L}_N$ contractions reduce that change by $k_1^{\mathcal{L}_N}$. Thus its Riccati defect is exponentially small. This explains why the analytic tail used to define the interpolant cannot hide a macroscopic change of the original source.

### B.1.4 First transport correction and absolute amplitude normalization

Let $p_1 = \partial_\varepsilon p|_{\varepsilon=0}$ and $q_1 = \partial_\varepsilon q_c|_{\varepsilon=0}$, differentiating the explicit rational coefficients. Define

$$\nu = \frac{p_1 + q_1/\mu - q_0\mu_x/\mu^2}{1 + q_0/\mu^2}. \tag{B.22}$$

The denominator is $1 - \mu_f/\mu$, bounded away from zero by (B.18). Substitution of $\mu + \varepsilon_N\nu$ into the one-step Riccati equation gives a residual $O(\varepsilon_N^2)$. The same contracting backward iteration then gives

$$v_N = \mu + N^{-1}\nu + O(N^{-2}) \tag{B.23}$$

on a fixed smaller complex neighborhood. For example, subtract the trial iterate from the exact one at each step. The resulting error is bounded by the geometric sum of its $O(N^{-2})$ local defects and the contracted terminal discrepancy. Cauchy estimates give the corresponding uniform derivative expansions.

Use the logarithm with positive real part in (B.18), continuing from $\mu(1/2,t)=1$, and set

$$\begin{aligned} S(x,t) &= \int_x^{1/2} \operatorname{Log}\mu(u,t)\,\mathrm{d}u, \\ C(x,t) &= \sqrt{\mu(x,t)}\exp\left(\int_x^{1/2}\frac{\nu(u,t)}{\mu(u,t)}\,\mathrm{d}u\right). \end{aligned} \tag{B.24}$$

The square root is one at $1/2$. The integral branches are fixed by the actual selected source; $C$ is holomorphic and nonzero.

Summing logarithms of the exact ratios in (B.21), using (B.23) and the first Euler–Maclaurin endpoint term, gives

$$U_{Nt,r} = C(r/N,t)e^{NS(r/N,t)}[1+O(N^{-1})]. \tag{B.25}$$

The product stops at $M-1$, because $U_M=1$. Replacing the true endpoint $M/N$ by $1/2$ costs only $O(N^{-1})$: the displacement is $O(N^{-1})$ at either parity, and $\operatorname{Log}\mu(1/2,t)=0$. The remaining endpoint terms in the correction are likewise $O(N^{-1})$. In particular there is no free terminal matching constant.

At $t=0$, direct differentiation of (B.13)–(B.14) yields

$$\operatorname{Log}\mu = \pi\mathrm{i} - 2\pi\mathrm{i}x, \qquad \frac{\nu}{\mu} = -\frac{\pi}{2}\cot(\pi x) - \frac{5\pi\mathrm{i}}{2}.$$

Therefore

$$S(x,0) = \pi\mathrm{i}(1/2-x)^2, \qquad C(x,0) = \sqrt{\sin\pi x}\,e^{-3\pi\mathrm{i}(1/2-x)/2}. \tag{B.26}$$

This calculation fixes the absolute amplitude from the finite source, rather than from the value of an unknown closed invariant.

### B.1.5 Exponential interpolation before an oscillatory saddle

Equation (B.25) is not sufficient by itself for a complex wire saddle. Its relative error is only inverse polynomial and could exceed a fixed oscillatory cancellation. The exact ratio (B.21) supplies the needed stronger estimate.

Put $f_N(x,t)=\operatorname{Log}v_N(x,t)$ and $b_N=M/N$. On a fixed larger complex tube the $f_N$ are uniformly bounded and holomorphic. On an inner tube, Cauchy's estimate gives constants $B,a>0$, independent of $N,t$, such that

$$|\partial_x^k f_N(x,t)| \le Bk!a^{-k}. \tag{B.27}$$

For $K_N=\lfloor c_aN\rfloor$, with a sufficiently small fixed $c_a>0$, form the holomorphic expression

$$\begin{aligned} E_N(x,t) = N\int_x^{b_N} f_N(u,t)\,\mathrm{d}u + \frac{f_N(x,t)-f_N(b_N,t)}{2} \\ + \sum_{k=1}^{K_N}\frac{B_{2k}}{(2k)!}N^{1-2k}\big[\partial_x^{2k-1}f_N(b_N,t) - \partial_x^{2k-1}f_N(x,t)\big]. \end{aligned} \tag{B.28}$$

The Bernoulli polynomial bound $|B_{2k}(u)| \le 4(2k)!/(2\pi)^{2k}$ together with (B.27) bounds the Euler–Maclaurin remainder by

$$CN\left(\frac{K_N}{\pi aN}\right)^{2K_N} \le Ce^{-cN}$$

after decreasing $c_a$. This is uniform in the complex color disk and on the physical high grid. Since the product of the exact ratios is precisely $U_r$, it follows that

$$U_{Nt,r} = e^{E_N(r/N,t)}[1 + R_{N,r}(t)], \qquad |R_{N,r}(t)| \le Ce^{-cN}. \tag{B.29}$$

The empty terminal product equals one. The residual is retained as a source term, rather than reinterpreted as a homogeneous solution.

The same explicit expression is holomorphic in the index $x$. Using (B.23) in (B.28), the higher Bernoulli terms sum to $O(N^{-1})$ on an inner fixed tube, and hence

$$e^{E_N(x,t)} = C(x,t)e^{NS(x,t)}[1 + O(N^{-1})] \tag{B.30}$$

uniformly holomorphically. Equations (B.29) and (B.30) have distinct roles: the former is an exponentially accurate comparison with the original finite source, and the latter is a leading expansion of a specified complex function.

### B.1.6 Keeping the quadratic phase and determining the signed action

The half-twist coefficient contains a quadratic exponential in the color. Such a phase is sometimes called a chirp. Its continuation is part of the finite formula, not an arbitrary choice of interpolation. We now combine it with the recurrence solution and the continued factorials; this calculation determines the local action and the nonzero amplitude used in the saddle.

Remove only the known external phase by defining

$$\ell_N^{\varepsilon}(r,t) = e^{-\mathrm{i}\varepsilon\pi d/4}d_N^{\varepsilon}(r,t), \qquad \eta_N = \exp\left(\frac{\mathrm{i}\pi d}{4}\sum_{\ell}\varepsilon_\ell\right).$$

The positive sign is the coefficientwise conjugate of the negative sign on real parameters. Its holomorphic continuation uses Schwarz reflection, not conjugation of a free holomorphic variable.

The original factorial phase gives the exact identity

$$q^{h^2}\frac{D_{h,r}}{D_{0,r}} = \frac{G_N(r)^2}{G_N(r-h)G_N(r+h)}. \tag{B.31}$$

It follows immediately from (B.4); the linear and quadratic exponents in the two shifted arguments must both be kept. Combining (B.7)–(B.9) with (B.31) gives the negative-sign interpolant

$$\begin{aligned} A_N^{\mathrm{hol}}(x,t) &= \frac{N^2G_N(2Nx)}{G_N(Nx)^2G_N(N(x-t))G_N(N(x+t))}, \\ \nu_N(z) &= e^{-\pi\mathrm{i}z+\pi\mathrm{i}z(z+1)/N}, \qquad P_N^{\mathrm{ch}}(x) = \frac{\kappa^{-1}e^{\pi\mathrm{i}d/4}}{\nu_N(Nx)}, \\ I_N^{-}(x,t) &= A_N^{\mathrm{hol}}(x,t)P_N^{\mathrm{ch}}(x)e^{E_N(x,t)}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.32}$$

The superscript on $P_N^{\mathrm{ch}}$ distinguishes this chirp factor from the Casimir polynomial. At every integer $r$, $\nu_N(r) = (-1)^r q^{r(r+1)}$. Its displayed analytic continuation is fixed before any contour deformation. In particular,

$$P_N^{\mathrm{ch}}(x) e^{NS(x,0)} = e^{\pi \mathrm{i}(3/4 - x - 1/(2N))}. \tag{B.33}$$

Changing the continuation of $(-1)^r$ would change a lattice frequency; that change is not permitted. Equation (B.29) proves that $I_N^-(r/N, t)$ agrees with the actual $\ell_N^-(r, t)$ up to a relative exponential residual. For the positive sign set $I_N^+(x,t) = \overline{I_N^-(\bar{x}, \bar{t})}$; for the pure sign use $I_N^0 = A_N^{\mathrm{hol}}$, which agrees exactly on the grid.

Define

$$\begin{aligned} g(x,t) &= J(2x) - 2J(x) - J(x-t) - J(x+t), \\ f_0(x,t) &= g(x,t), \qquad f_-(x,t) = g(x,t) + S(x,t) - S(x,0), \\ f_+(x,t) &= \overline{f_-(\bar{x}, \bar{t})}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.34}$$

The factorial expansion and (B.33) yield

$$I_N^{\varepsilon}(x,t) = N^{1/2} b_{\varepsilon}(x,t) e^{N f_{\varepsilon}(x,t)} [1 + O(N^{-1})], \tag{B.35}$$

uniformly holomorphically on fixed smaller domains, with

$$\begin{aligned} b_0(x,t) &= \frac{\sqrt{\sin(2\pi x)}}{2^{3/2} \sin(\pi x) \sqrt{\sin(\pi(x-t)) \sin(\pi(x+t))}}, \\ b_-(x,t) &= b_0(x,t) e^{\pi \mathrm{i}(3/4 - x)} C(x,t), \qquad b_+(x,t) = \overline{b_-(\bar{x}, \bar{t})}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.36}$$

All square roots continue their positive complete factorial branches. At completeness,

$$\frac{b_{\varepsilon}(x,0)}{b_0(x,0)} = \sqrt{\sin(\pi x)} e^{-\mathrm{i}\varepsilon \pi x/2}, \qquad \varepsilon \in \{-1, 1\}. \tag{B.37}$$

These factors are nonzero. The remaining $e^{-\pi \mathrm{i}/(2N)}$ in (B.33) belongs to the stated inverse-power error; it is not an omitted constant or parity phase.

### B.1.7 An exact source action identity and its Hessian

The action above can also be characterized without integrating the quadratic root. For each physical sign $\varepsilon \in \{0, 1, -1\}$ solve near $s = t = 0$ the equation

$$t = s - \frac{\varepsilon}{2\pi \mathrm{i}} g_s(x,s). \tag{B.38}$$

Its $s$ derivative at zero is $1 - \varepsilon \mathrm{i} \cot(\pi x)$, which is nonzero. Then the source-selected action satisfies

$$f_{\varepsilon}(x,t) = g(x,s) - \frac{\varepsilon}{4\pi \mathrm{i}} g_s(x,s)^2, \qquad (f_{\varepsilon})_x = g_x(x,s), \qquad (f_{\varepsilon})_t = g_s(x,s). \tag{B.39}$$

The derivative identities follow by differentiating (B.38). To identify the value with the actual selected source, consider the negative sign. Put $E = e^{2\pi \mathrm{i} x}$, $H = e^{2\pi \mathrm{i} t}$ and $T = e^{2\pi \mathrm{i} s}$. Exponentiating (B.38) gives

$$H = \frac{T(E-T)}{ET - 1}, \qquad T^2 + E(H-1)T - H = 0, \qquad T = 1 \text{ at } H = 1.$$

For $K = e^{-g_x(x,s)} = -(1 - E/T)(1 - ET)/(1 + E)^2$, elimination of $T$ gives

$$K^2(1 + E)^2 + K[(H + H^{-1})E^2 + 2] + (1 - E)^2 = 0. \tag{B.40}$$

On the other hand (B.34) and the selected quadratic give $e^{-(f_-)_x} = E\mu D_t/(1 + E)^2$, satisfying exactly (B.40). At $H = 1$, both constructions take the branch $K = \tan^2(\pi x)$; their logarithms agree by their complete marks. Hence their $x$ derivatives agree. The possible remaining function of $t$ is zero by the limit $x \to 1/2$: there $S = 0$, $J(1/2 + t) = -J(1/2 - t)$, and the implicit shear has $s = t$, $g_s = 0$. Schwarz reflection proves the positive sign. This fixes the source action, not merely a Hessian with the same entries.

In particular, all local actions are even in $t$, equal $g(x, 0)$ at zero, and

$$(f_\varepsilon)_{tt}(x, 0) = -\frac{2\pi \cot(\pi x)}{1 - \varepsilon \mathrm{i} \cot(\pi x)}, \qquad \varepsilon \in \{0, 1, -1\}. \tag{B.41}$$

Their real parts are strictly negative on the fixed high interval.

### B.1.8 The exact finite wire window and its lattice saddle

We now specify the function to which the complex saddle argument is applied. Let the fixed completed-root expression have $H$ leaves and $K = 2H - 3$ primitive free integer wires. The last forced product is removed using its exact relation $i + j = d$, whose coefficient is one. Every remaining wire has the affine form

$$r_w = NL_w(y) + \delta_w, \qquad y = k/N, \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}^K,$$

where the integer offsets $\delta_w$ are fixed by the original compiler. Take a small fixed rectangular window $B$ about the strict complete optimizer. All leaf coordinates lie in intervals of the form (B.1), and every retained gate inequality is strict on a fixed neighborhood of the closure of $B$.

The exact finite window is

$$\mathcal{C}_N(\mathbf{t}) = \sum_{k/N \in B} \prod_{\ell=1}^{H} \ell_N^{\varepsilon_\ell}(r_\ell, t_\ell) \prod_{g=1}^{H-2} \mu_N(r_{g,1}, r_{g,2}, r_{g,3}). \tag{B.42}$$

Its support is independent of the complex colors. It is a finite, separately even holomorphic function. For all sufficiently large $N$, every state in this window is a true core state at every physical small color deficit. The factors $\mu_N$ are the original positive Newton coefficients, not their leading asymptotic replacements.

Replace each exact local factor by its canonical holomorphic interpolant only after keeping its residual. The gate interpolation is the same seven-factorial expression with $G_N$, and agrees exactly on its integer grid. For the signed leaves, use (B.32). The total error in the finite sum is bounded absolutely by

$$\mathrm{poly}(N) \exp\{N(F_0 + C\|\mathbf{t}\|^2 - c)\} \tag{B.43}$$

for some fixed $c > 0$. Indeed there are polynomially many states, all actions are even analytic perturbations of the common complete real action, and the relative leaf errors in (B.29) are exponentially small. This estimate is made before any oscillatory cancellation. Shrink the fixed color polydisk so that (B.43) is exponentially below the nearby selected critical action.

The interpolated summand has phase

$$\mathcal{F}(y,\mathbf{t}) = \sum_{\ell} f_{\varepsilon_\ell}(L_\ell(y), t_\ell) + \sum_{g} m(L_{g,1}(y), L_{g,2}(y), L_{g,3}(y)). \tag{B.44}$$

At zero color it is the original complete action. Its wire Hessian at the strict optimizer is negative definite. Thus it has one holomorphic critical branch $y_*(\mathbf{t})$, with

$$\Phi(\mathbf{t}) = \mathcal{F}(y_*(\mathbf{t}), \mathbf{t}).$$

The local gate amplitude is

$$b_\mu(x,y,z) = 2^{-3/2}\sqrt{\frac{\sin\pi(x+y)\sin\pi z}{\sin\pi x\sin\pi y\sin\pi(z-x)\sin\pi(z-y)\sin\pi(x+y-z)}}.$$

Multiply all leaf and gate amplitudes by the exact leading offset factor

$$\exp\left[\sum_{\ell}\delta_\ell\partial_x f_{\varepsilon_\ell} + \sum_{g}\nabla m(L_g(y))\cdot\delta_g\right] \tag{B.45}$$

to obtain the nonzero holomorphic density $b_E(y,\mathbf{t})$. The changed $f_\varepsilon$ is used in (B.45), including at nonzero complex color; a pure offset factor would be incorrect. The interpolated summand is

$$N^{3-H} b_E(y,\mathbf{t}) e^{N\mathcal{F}(y,\mathbf{t})}[1+O(N^{-1})].$$

For clarity we give the finite-lattice contour step. Choose the vertical faces of the rectangle at half-grid values. In each coordinate the exact summation kernel is $\pi N\cot(\pi N z)$, with residue one at $z = k/N$. On a vertical half-grid line, $|\cot(\pi N z)| \le 1$. Those faces lie away from the strict real optimizer and retain a fixed phase gap. On a horizontal line of fixed height $a > 0$, the cotangent differs from its constant value $\mp\mathrm{i}$ by $O(e^{-2\pi N a})$. At complete color, the real part of the phase grows under this small imaginary displacement by at most $Ca^2$; the even color perturbation costs at most $C\|\mathbf{t}\|^2$. Choose $a$ so $Ca^2 < \pi a$, and then choose the color polydisk small enough. Every nonconstant kernel term has an exponential gap, including all side connectors. Applying this argument successively in the $K$ primitive coordinates retains the full product contour and its orientations. The constant horizontal terms give $N^K$ times the ordinary integral. Replacing the moving half-grid rectangle by $B$ costs only exponentially small boundary strips.

Translate that integral to the nearby complex critical point. The endpoint connectors remain below its action, and the real tangent Gaussian is uniformly nondegenerate. Extend its local Gaussian range with exponentially small error. The odd first correction integrates to zero, giving a relative $O(N^{-1})$ expansion. Thus

$$\mathcal{C}_N(\mathbf{t}) = N^{3/2} a_E(\mathbf{t}) e^{N\Phi(\mathbf{t})}[1+O(N^{-1})], \qquad a_E(\mathbf{t}) = \frac{(2\pi)^{K/2} b_E(y_*(\mathbf{t}),\mathbf{t})}{\sqrt{\det[-\mathcal{F}_{yy}(y_*(\mathbf{t}),\mathbf{t})]}}. \tag{B.46}$$

The determinant square root is selected from the positive complete Gaussian. The power is $3 - H + K/2 = 3/2$. The exponential grid error (B.43) is smaller than this answer by the prior choice of color disk, and is added back only now. Both level parities have the same primitive density and displayed normalization.

At completeness,

$$\Phi(0) = F_0, \qquad a_E(0) = a_E^{\mathrm{pure}}(0) \prod_{\varepsilon_\ell \neq 0} \sqrt{\sin(\pi x_{\ell,*})} e^{-\mathrm{i}\varepsilon_\ell \pi x_{\ell,*}/2} \neq 0. \tag{B.47}$$

Evenness gives $\mathcal{F}_{yt_\ell}(y,0) = 0$, so the wire Schur correction to the color Hessian vanishes. With $c_\ell = \cot(\pi x_{\ell,*})$, one obtains

$$\partial_{t_\ell}\partial_{t_j}\Phi(0) = -\frac{2\pi c_\ell}{1-\varepsilon_\ell \mathrm{i} c_\ell}\delta_{\ell j} = 2\pi \mathrm{i}\tau_\ell \delta_{\ell j}, \qquad \tau_\ell = \frac{\mathrm{i}c_\ell}{1-\varepsilon_\ell \mathrm{i}c_\ell}, \qquad \Im\tau_\ell > 0. \tag{B.48}$$

On a smaller fixed complex box,

$$|\mathcal{C}_N(u+\mathrm{i}v)| \le \mathrm{poly}(N) e^{N(F_0 - a\|u\|^2 + B\|v\|^2)}, \qquad a > 0. \tag{B.49}$$

This bound is for the exact finite function (B.42), by (B.46), not just its leading formal action.

### B.1.9 Returning from the local sum to the original evaluation

We finish by stating precisely how the independent alias estimates are used. The compositional proof in the main text gives a uniform positive gap for every nonempty alias sector on the entire physical color cube. It also gives a concave all-core majorant with the unique strict complete maximizer used above. The latter uniqueness is global: it agrees with the strict complete action near that point, and a second maximum of a concave function would give a constant segment through that strictly concave neighborhood.

Hence all core states outside the fixed wire window have a fixed gap, uniformly in physical colors. Within that window the actual local far-color recurrence estimate loses a fixed positive amount whenever one physical deficit exceeds a fixed small corridor. Polynomial state counting and the finite number of sectors therefore give constants $\delta, \gamma > 0$ such that the literal mixed scalar $\mathcal{A}_N$ obeys

$$\max_{0 \le h_\ell \le \delta N} |\mathcal{A}_N(\mathbf{h}) - \eta_N \mathcal{C}_N(\mathbf{h}/N)| \le \mathrm{poly}(N) e^{N(F_0 - \gamma)}, \tag{B.50}$$

$$\max_{\exists \ell:\, h_\ell > \delta N} |\mathcal{A}_N(\mathbf{h})| \le \mathrm{poly}(N) e^{N(F_0 - \gamma)}. \tag{B.51}$$

The maximum in the second line is over the entire original physical color cube, not just the low-core band. No alias is folded into the even analytic packet. The external $\eta_N$ is exactly the retained unit phase defined above.

The global coherent-core input here is its uniform exponential-rate envelope, of the form $\exp\{N(\widetilde{g} + o(1))\}$ with the $o(1)$ uniform over all physical indices and colors. It is not a polynomial-prefactor assertion through every spectral collision. To obtain (B.50)–(B.51), first fix the strictly positive variational and far-color margins, then absorb the uniform $o(N)$ errors into, for example, half their minimum. Polynomial counting and the remaining finite prefactors are harmless after that reduction of $\gamma$. The polynomial-prefactor local packet proved above is a separate estimate on its fixed regular high interval.

These estimates preserve the whole-source remainder through the finite filling sum. For each fixed signed filling tuple, the exact Hermite coefficient bound is $\sum_j |\beta_{j-1}^{-p_\ell}| \le 2N(1+|p_\ell|)$. Thus (B.50) and (B.51) incur only a polynomial multiplier in that whole sum. The finite analytic

packet, rather than its pointwise leading approximation, is then used for the Fourier endpoint and charge arguments. Its exact evenness, complex estimate (B.49), nonzero amplitude and Hessian (B.48) are the needed inputs. The retained filling analysis supplies the smaller filled action and a nonzero leading coefficient; the source gap is not itself a replacement for that analysis.

The argument in this section requires (B.1). No continuation through a quarter-index dominance boundary, no additional root-leaf closure, and no theorem for arbitrary tangle syntax is used in the manuscript's completed-root result.

## B.2 A global coefficient bound, including repeated recurrence roots

The local interpolation of Section B.1 is used only on a fixed high-index interval. Here we prove the different estimate needed before restricting to that interval: a uniform exponential-rate bound for every physical color and every core index. The proof retains the other recurrence branch, including its repeated-root colors. Here $C_j^{\varepsilon}$ always denotes the core polynomial of a single physical leaf of color $j$ and half-twist sign $\varepsilon$, as in (2.17); it does not denote the whole analytic packet.

### B.2.1 Normalization and the finite upper endpoint

Use $q, Q, d, M, F_r$ as in Section B.1. For a physical integer $0 \le h \le M$, interpret the finite sum $A_{h,r}$ in (B.8) with lower endpoint $\max(r, h)$. Thus all its factorials have nonnegative arguments. Set

$$V_{h,r} = \frac{q^{h^2} A_{h,r}}{D_{0,r}}, \qquad \chi = \frac{\pi h}{N}, \qquad H = Q^h, \qquad Z = Q^{r+1}.$$

The denominator is the complete diagonal, which is nonzero at every $0 \le r \le M$. The Ward identity, or its polynomial version before cancellation of zero endpoint factors, gives

$$\begin{aligned} V_{h,r} &= p_{h,N}(r) V_{h,r+1} + q_N(r) V_{h,r+2}, \\ p_{h,N}(r) &= -\frac{Z^{-1}[(H + H^{-1})Z^2 + 1 + Q^{-1}]}{(1-Z)^2}, \\ q_N(r) &= -\frac{Q^{-2} Z^{-2}(1 - QZ^2)(1 + QZ)}{(1-Z)^2(1-QZ)}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.52}$$

It holds also when $r < h$: the omitted lower terms of the polynomial Ward telescope have their zero numerator factors, rather than divided negative factorials. More explicitly, the certificate $g_h(z)$ in Section B.1 vanishes at the lower endpoint $z = Q^{\max(r,h)}$: its factor $1 - z/Y$ applies when $r \ge h$, and its factor $1 - z/H$ applies when $r < h$. At $r = M - 1$ one has $q_N(r) = 0$ at both parities. We may therefore set the unused auxiliary value $V_{h,M+1} = 0$. The actual remaining terminal value obeys the exact identity

$$|V_{h,M}| = \frac{s_M^2}{s_{M-h} s_{M+h}} = \begin{cases} 1, & N \text{ odd}, \\ \cos\chi, & N \text{ even}. \end{cases} \tag{B.53}$$

Indeed $s_a s_{N-1-a} = N$. For odd $N = 2M+1$, both products in (B.53) equal $N$. For even $N = 2m$, $M = m-1$, $s_M^2 = N/2$ and $s_{M-h}s_{M+h} = N/(2\cos\chi)$. Thus the source at the wall has modulus at most one uniformly over the entire physical color range.

The finite triangular transport and the marked factorial phases give the following exact modulus in the normalized Newton basis:

$$\left|[\widehat{B}_r]C^{\varepsilon}_{N-h}\right| = \frac{N^2 s_{2r}}{s_r^4}|V_{h,r}|, \qquad 0 \le r \le M, \quad \varepsilon \in \{-1,1\}. \tag{B.54}$$

One can obtain this directly by interchanging the two finite sums in (B.7); the coefficient in the unnormalized basis $B_r$ is $N^2 s_{2r} V_{h,r}/s_r^6$ times a unit phase. Multiplication by $s_r^2$ gives (B.54). The positive sign is the conjugate of the negative sign on the physical grid. Phases have been used only to compute the modulus, not deleted from the finite source.

### B.2.2 The spectral ellipse

The characteristic roots of the limiting two-by-two recurrence matrix control the exponential size of a long matrix product. They may coincide for some colors. We first locate both roots using a quadratic equation and an ellipse in its coefficient plane. The next subsection bounds powers of the matrix directly, so no singular eigenvector basis is required at a collision.

Let $T_N(r)$ be the companion matrix of (B.52). Thus

$$(V_{h,r}, V_{h,r+1})^t = T_N(r)(V_{h,r+1}, V_{h,r+2})^t.$$

Freeze $u = (r+1)\pi/N$ and let $Q \to 1$ while $Z = e^{2\mathrm{i}u}$ and $H = e^{2\mathrm{i}\chi}$ stay fixed. The limiting matrix $T_0(u,\chi)$ has eigenvalues $Z^{-1}v$, where

$$v^2 - bv - c = 0, \qquad c = \cot^2 u, \qquad b = (c-1)\cos^2\chi - 2\mathrm{i}\sqrt{c}\,\sin^2\chi. \tag{B.55}$$

We claim

$$\rho(T_0(u,\chi)) \le \rho_0(u) := \max(1, \cot^2 u), \qquad 0 < u \le \pi/2, \quad 0 \le \chi \le \pi/2. \tag{B.56}$$

For $0 < c < 1$, a root on the unit circle would give $b = v - c/v$. The unit-root locus in the $b$ plane is therefore the ellipse

$$\left(\frac{\Re b}{1-c}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{\Im b}{1+c}\right)^2 = 1.$$

For the value in (B.55), its left side is

$$\cos^4\chi + \frac{4c}{(1+c)^2}\sin^4\chi \le 1,$$

strictly less than one when $\chi > 0$. At $b = 0$ the roots have modulus $\sqrt{c} < 1$. The line segment to an interior point of this ellipse cannot cross the unit-root locus, so both roots remain in the open unit disk. Continuity treats the ellipse boundary. For $c > 1$, apply the same argument to $v/c$, with parameter $1/c$. At $c = 1$ the roots of $v^2 + 2\mathrm{i}\sin^2\chi\, v - 1$ have modulus one. At $c = 0$ they are 0 and $-\cos^2\chi$. This proves (B.56) without selecting an eigenbasis.

In particular, if $\chi_0 > 0$ and $I \subset (\pi/4, \pi/2)$ is a fixed closed interval, then

$$\sup_{\substack{u\in I\\ \chi_0\le\chi\le\pi/2}} \rho(T_0(u,\chi)) \le \theta < 1. \tag{B.57}$$

The endpoint color $\chi = \pi/2$ is included: there the two roots coalesce, but their common modulus is $\sqrt{c} < 1$.

### B.2.3 Frozen blocks and the singular lower endpoint

Over a fixed number of consecutive indices, the exact recurrence matrix changes by $O(N^{-1})$. We compare that short product with a power of one constant matrix. The block length is chosen first and $N$ is then taken large. A separate factorial bound treats the small indices where the coefficients are singular. This order of estimates gives a uniform exponential rate without asserting a polynomial prefactor at every color.

Define

$$E(u) = \begin{cases} \dfrac{2}{\pi}\displaystyle\int_u^{\pi/4} \log\cot v\,\mathrm{d}v, & 0 \le u < \pi/4,\\ 0, & \pi/4 \le u \le \pi/2. \end{cases} \tag{B.58}$$

We prove the two uniform assertions

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty} \max_{0\le h,r\le M} \left\{ N^{-1}\log|V_{h,r}| - E(\pi r/N)\right\} \le 0, \tag{B.59}$$

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty} \max_{\substack{\delta N\le h\le M\\ 0\le r\le \beta N}} \left\{ N^{-1}\log|V_{h,r}| - E(\pi r/N)\right\} \le -\gamma_{\delta,\beta}, \tag{B.60}$$

where $0 < \delta < 1/2$, $0 < \beta < 1/2$, and $\gamma_{\delta,\beta} > 0$. We use $\log 0 = -\infty$.

First fix a lower cutoff $a > 0$. On $a \le u \le \pi/2$ the exact coefficients and their first $u$ derivatives are uniformly bounded, independently of the physical color. The exact normalized matrices $B_N(r) = T_N(r)/\rho_0(u_r)$, $u_r = (r+1)\pi/N$, differ by $O_a(N^{-1})$ from the bounded Lipschitz family $B(u_r,\chi) = T_0(u_r,\chi)/\rho_0(u_r)$.

For any bounded 2 by 2 matrix $B$ whose eigenvalues have modulus at most one, Cayley–Hamilton gives

$$\|B^L\| \le L\|B\| + L - 1 \le C_a L. \tag{B.61}$$

The coefficient of $B$ is $\sum_{j=0}^{L-1}\lambda_1^{L-1-j}\lambda_2^j$, of modulus at most $L$, and the constant coefficient has modulus at most $L-1$. These expressions remain valid at a double root. If both roots instead have modulus at most $\theta < 1$, the same calculation gives $\|B^L\| \le C_a L\theta^{L-1}$.

Choose a fixed block length $L$. Telescoping a product of $L$ adjacent exact normalized matrices against its frozen value gives

$$B_N(r)\cdots B_N(r+L-1) = B(u_r,\chi)^L + O_{a,L}(N^{-1}),$$

uniformly in $\chi$. For a prescribed $\epsilon > 0$, choose $L$ so that $C_a L < e^{\epsilon L}$, and then take $N$ sufficiently large. Partition any propagation product into these blocks. The incomplete end blocks cost a fixed constant, and all ordinary blocks together cost at most $C_{a,\epsilon}e^{2\epsilon N}$.

For the strict estimate, choose $I \subset (\max(\pi\beta, \pi/4), \pi/2)$. Every propagation from the physical wall to $r \le \beta N$ crosses this interval. By (B.57), increase the same fixed $L$ until

each full block in $I$ has norm at most $e^{-\gamma_0 L}$ for some $\gamma_0 > 0$. There are $N|I|/(\pi L) + O(1)$ such blocks. Choose $\epsilon < \gamma_0|I|/(8\pi)$. Their strict negative budget then exceeds the cost of all ordinary blocks.

Only $u = 0$ has a singular coefficient. Directly from (B.52), for $u_r \le a < \pi/8$,

$$\|T_N(r)\| \le C\frac{N^2}{(r+1)^2}. \tag{B.62}$$

Here $|H + H^{-1}| \le 2$, $|1 - Z| \ge 4(r+1)/N$, and the ratio $|1 - QZ^2|/|1 - QZ|$ is bounded by an absolute constant in this range. If $K \le aN/\pi$, the product of the bounds in (B.62) is at most $C^K N^{2K}/(K!)^2$. Hence the entire omitted initial segment costs

$$\exp\{O(Na\log(1/a)) + O(\log N)\},$$

uniformly in its starting index. This cost has rate tending to zero as $a \downarrow 0$.

Finally $\log \rho_0(u)$ is decreasing until it reaches zero, so the right-endpoint Riemann sum satisfies

$$\sum_{j=r}^{M-1} \log \rho_0((j+1)\pi/N) \le NE(\pi r/N). \tag{B.63}$$

Combine this scalar product with (B.53), the frozen blocks, and the endpoint bound. For (B.59), take $N \to \infty$ first and then let $a, \epsilon \downarrow 0$. For (B.60), first fix $I$ and its negative budget, then make $a\log(1/a)$ and $\epsilon$ small compared with that budget, and finally take $N$ large. This proves both estimates with their stated uniformity. There is no adiabatic eigenvector argument and no polynomial bound claimed at a spectral collision.

### B.2.4 The actual coefficient envelopes and the macroscopic color loss

The elementary sine-factorial estimate is uniform up to both endpoints:

$$\log s_j = NJ(j/N) + O(\log N), \qquad 0 \le j < N. \tag{B.64}$$

For example, subtract $\log t + \log(1-t)$ from $\log(2\sin \pi t)$ on $[0,1]$. The remainder is continuously differentiable, so its Riemann-sum error is bounded; the two removed terms are ordinary factorials and have $O(\log N)$ errors by Stirling's inequalities. This also proves the uniform assertion when one of the factorial indices is zero.

The complete prefactor in (B.54) has rate $g(x) = J(2x) - 4J(x)$. Since $g'(x) = 2\log\cot \pi x$,

$$g(x) + E(\pi x) = g(\max(x, 1/4)) = \widetilde{g}(x). \tag{B.65}$$

Consequently (B.59) supplies a sequence $e_N \downarrow 0$ after taking its decreasing upper envelope, such that

$$|[\widehat{B}_r]C^{\varepsilon}_{N-h}| \le \exp\{N[\widetilde{g}(r/N) + e_N]\}, \qquad 0 \le h, r \le M, \quad \varepsilon \in \{-1, 1\}.$$

The same estimate holds for the pure sign. Its coefficient is zero for $r < h$ and otherwise is $N^2 s_{2r}/(s_r^2 s_{r-h} s_{r+h})$. Its rate is $g(x) - \Delta(x,t)$, where

$$\Delta(x,t) = J(x-t) + J(x+t) - 2J(x), \qquad 0 \le t \le x \le 1/2.$$

For $t > 0$ and $x < 1/2$,

$$\partial_t \Delta = \log \frac{\sin \pi(x+t)}{\sin \pi(x-t)} > 0,$$

because the difference of the two sines is $2 \cos \pi x \sin \pi t > 0$. Continuity includes the integrable boundary $t = x$. Thus pure cores have a uniform strict loss when $x$ lies in a fixed compact high interval and $t \geq \delta > 0$. For signed cores the same conclusion follows from (B.60), choosing $\beta$ above that high interval. Both parities, the largest physical color, and all zero coefficients are retained.

For completeness, the alias bound in (5.1) requires no recurrence. We first prove the finite bound on the untransformed alias. Write $\theta = \pi/N$. Its coefficient from (2.18), for $1 \leq j \leq \lfloor N/2 \rfloor$ and $0 \leq r < j$, has modulus

$$b_{j,r} = \frac{s_r^2}{s_{2r+1}} \prod_{u=-r}^{r} 2 \sin((j+u)\theta).$$

As a function of real $j$ in $r < j < N - r$, this positive product is log concave and symmetric about $N/2$, so its maximum is there. Cancelling $(2 \sin u\theta)(2 \cos u\theta) = 2 \sin 2u\theta$ gives the upper bound

$$B_r = 2 \frac{\prod_{u=1}^{r} 2 \sin(2u\theta)}{\prod_{u=0}^{r} 2 \sin((2u+1)\theta)}, \qquad \frac{B_{r+1}}{B_r} = \frac{\sin((2r+2)\theta)}{\sin((2r+3)\theta)}.$$

The ratio is at most one and then at least one, with only one possible switch, at $(4r+5)\theta = \pi$. Therefore the maximum over $0 \leq r \leq \lfloor N/2 \rfloor - 1$ is at an endpoint. The first is $B_0 = \csc \theta$. At the other endpoint, the even and odd sine products give $B_{N/2-1} = N/2$ when $N$ is even; when $N = 2m + 1$, reflection of the sine factors gives $B_{m-1} = \csc \theta$. The even product identities follow by evaluating the factorizations of $z^m - 1$ and $z^m + 1$ at $z = 1$. Finally $\sin(\pi/N) \geq 2/N$. We have proved $b_{j,r} \leq N/2$ at every color and both parities.

A triangular half-twist entry has modulus $s_v/(s_r s_{v-r})$, so (B.64) gives the rate

$$J(w) - J(u) - J(w-u), \qquad u = r/N, \quad w = v/N \geq \max(u, 1/2).$$

For $0 < u < 1$ its derivative in $w$ is $\log[\sin(\pi w)/\sin(\pi(w-u))]$; it changes from positive to negative at $w = (1+u)/2$. Reflection $J(1-z) = -J(z)$ and duplication give the maximum

$$J((1+u)/2) - J(u) - J((1-u)/2) = -2J(u/2) = k(u).$$

The two endpoint cases follow by continuity. All factorial errors are $O(\log N)$, and there are at most $N$ summands. This proves the alias bound with a polynomial prefactor, on its full original index range $0 \leq r \leq d$.

To pass from these leaf estimates to the complete source, first fix the positive compositional alias margins and the compact core-state gap in Chapter 5. Every fixed tree has finitely many leaves and gates and only polynomially many lattice states. Absorb their uniform $e_N$ and the $O(\log N)/N$ gate errors into half the fixed margin. Inside the remaining strict state window, the macroscopic-color loss just proved supplies the other half of the argument. This gives the whole-source bounds (B.50)–(B.51). The result is a uniform exponential-rate envelope at all colors; the polynomial leading packet remains the separate regular local theorem of Section B.1.

## B.3 Nonlocal filling charges and local contour connectors

We give the additional contour details used after the infinite tails have been removed in Chapter 8. All constants below are chosen from one fixed source neighborhood. They do not depend on the relative sizes of different filling slopes.

The exact finite Fourier polynomial and any fixed derivatives have a strict gap when the real part of one Fourier coordinate stays a fixed positive distance from the integers and all other Fourier coordinates are real. We also need this statement in a complex strip. Apply the cotangent rectangle estimate (8.2) with a complex Fourier parameter. Write that coordinate as $z_i = x_i + \mathrm{i}v$, so its Fourier parameter is $\phi + 2\pi\mathrm{i}v$, with $\phi = 2\pi x_i$ reduced to $[\phi_0, 2\pi - \phi_0]$. On the entire unscaled summation rectangle, $|\Re w| \le H_N + 1/2 \le \delta N + 1/2$, and the additional factor satisfies

$$|e^{-2\pi v w}| \le e^{2\pi(\delta N + 1/2)|v|}.$$

Consequently every horizontal, vertical and nonconstant-kernel estimate in the real-parameter proof retains its gap, reduced by at most $2\pi\delta|v| + O(N^{-1}|v|)$. Choose a fixed $v_0 > 0$ small enough that this loss is below half the real gap. The color contours used in this argument remain inside the fixed holomorphic tube of (6.9). Summing the other physical colors costs only a polynomial in $N$, because their Fourier phases remain real and the source Gaussian bound is uniform in those colors. Inserting fixed powers of any color index proves the same assertion for fixed Fourier derivatives. Thus the resulting complex-strip gap is uniform for $|v| \le v_0$ and real spectator Fourier variables, with $v_0$ depending only on the fixed source and the excluded real interval, not on the filling slopes.

Fix a sufficiently small local ratio radius $t_0$. For a finite charge with $|m_i/p_i| \ge t_0$, split the real interval in coordinate $i$ into $|z_i| \le t_0/4$ and its complement. In the first interval,

$$|m_i + 2p_i z_i| \ge |p_i| t_0/2.$$

Choose the sign of the imaginary shift to decrease the real part of $-2\pi\mathrm{i}(p_i z_i^2 + m_i z_i)$. On this interval its derivative in the shift direction is bounded above by $-\pi|p_i|t_0$. The Fourier source grows at most $e^{2\pi\delta N|v|}$, and its analytic local action has bounded derivatives on the fixed tube. For sufficiently long $|p_i|$, the chirp decrease dominates uniformly. A fixed small shift gives a strict gap on the displaced segment.

The two joining segments start at $z_i = \pm t_0/4$, where the real Fourier source already has a fixed loss. Choose their common height small enough that this source loss is preserved. On the remainder of the real interval the source Fourier gap applies directly, so it need not be displaced. This proves a strict nonlocal-charge loss. The other variables remain real at this stage; their chirps have modulus one. The finite number of charges depends on the fixed slopes but is independent of $N$.

For a local charge put $t_i = m_i/p_i$ and $e_i = 1/p_i$. Separate evenness gives $\partial_i \Psi(\mathbf{z}) = z_i Q_i(\mathbf{z})$, where every $Q_i$ is holomorphic on one fixed neighborhood. The critical equation therefore gives the exact factorization

$$z_i = -\frac{t_i}{2\big(1 - e_i Q_i(\mathbf{z})/(4\pi\mathrm{i})\big)}.$$

Choose $C_0 \ge 1$ bounding all $|Q_i|$ on that neighborhood, and increase the common slope

threshold until $|e_i|C_0 \le 2\pi$ for every $i$. Then

$$\left|1 - \frac{e_i Q_i(\mathbf{z})}{4\pi\mathrm{i}}\right| \ge \frac{1}{2}, \qquad z_i + \frac{t_i}{2} = -\frac{e_i t_i Q_i(\mathbf{z})}{8\pi\mathrm{i}(1 - e_i Q_i(\mathbf{z})/(4\pi\mathrm{i}))}.$$

Thus $|z_i + t_i/2| \le C_0|e_i t_i|/(4\pi)$. The coefficients of $Q_i$ need not be real when half twists are retained: boundedness and the displayed denominator estimate suffice. Since $\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{e}$ are real for the actual signed fillings, we obtain

$$|\Im z_i(\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{e})| \le C|e_i||t_i|, \qquad |\Re z_i + t_i/2| \le C|e_i||t_i|.$$

Choose first an outer real box $[-a, a]^b$ whose fixed complex thickening lies inside the Fourier-packet domain and on which $\Re\Psi''$ is negative definite on real tangent vectors. Next choose the local ratio radius $t_0$ sufficiently small compared with $a$, and only then decrease the upper bound on every $|e_i|$. The bounds above give $|\Re z_{*,i}| \le C|t_i|$ and $|\Im z_{*,i}| \le C|e_i t_i|$ for every local charge. The part of the original real cube outside this box has a strict Fourier gap; its chirps have modulus one. Estimate it on the real contour. Translate the box to $\mathbf{z}_*(\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{e}) + [-a, a]^b$, retaining all joining faces. On any such face, with $\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{x} + \mathrm{i}\mathbf{y}$, some $|x_i| \ge a/2$, while $|y_i| \le C|e_i t_i|$. The source bound and the exact real part of the filling phase imply

$$\Re T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{x} + \mathrm{i}\mathbf{y}) \le F_0 - c\|\mathbf{x}\|^2 + C_1\|\mathbf{x}\|\|\mathbf{t}\| + C_2\|\mathbf{t}\|^2 \le F_0 - g_a$$

for a fixed $g_a > 0$, after the stated choice of $t_0$. Indeed $|p_i y_i| \le C|t_i|$ and $|m_i y_i| \le C t_i^2$; no ratio of two different slopes occurs. Constants absorb the fixed dimension and the bounded source Hessian. The same bounds apply to the intermediate faces when the coordinates are translated successively.

On the translated real box, the critical equation removes the linear term and the chirp Hessian has purely imaginary entries. Hence

$$\Re T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{z}_* + \mathbf{u}) \le \Re T_{\mathbf{m}}(\mathbf{z}_*) - c_1\|\mathbf{u}\|^2, \qquad \mathbf{u} \in [-a, a]^b,$$

after shrinking the original source neighborhood. Gaussian integration on this contour gives its local saddle term with a relative $O_{\mathbf{p}}(N^{-1})$ error; the joining faces contribute the separate absolute error $\mathrm{poly}(N, \mathbf{p})e^{N(F_0 - g_a)}$. The holomorphic relative error in (8.9) is carried through the same contours, with its derivatives bounded by Cauchy's estimate on the larger fixed domain. Only the first-charge integral needs a relative asymptotic for the final conclusion. Its real critical value tends to $F_0$ as all reciprocal slopes tend to zero, so increasing the common threshold places it above $F_0 - g_a$. For other local charges, the saddle comparison (8.12) and the same absolute connector error suffice.

These connector estimates are applied only after the tails have been removed by the real-spectator telescoping argument. They therefore introduce no uncontrolled exponential factor from a larger slope at another cusp. Finally, the selected action tends to $F_0$ as all reciprocal slopes tend to zero. A single threshold absorbs the fixed source and contour losses. The proof never exchanges the limit $N \to \infty$ with a slope tending to infinity.

# Appendix C

# The exact certificate arithmetic

The inequalities in Chapter 5 concern continuous domains. Their certificates are finite because concavity bounds each alias action by a tangent plane, while a feasible pure point bounds the pure maximum from below. The remaining difference is affine in the domain variables and slope parameters. It is therefore enough to check finitely many vertices and corners, provided coverage and all transcendental errors are controlled. This appendix supplies those controls.

## C.1 A finite proof object

The two main certificates consist of rational points and exact coverage data. The two-leaf block table has sixteen closed slope intervals, one rational feasible pure point and two strict alias tangent points per interval. The attachment table is a recursively subdivided dyadic cover of $[-2, 0]^2$ with 55 leaves, one pure point and one alias tangent point per leaf. The verifier checks feasibility and coverage before evaluating an inequality. It then checks every slope corner and every vertex of the appropriate product polytope.

The mathematical reason this finite object is sufficient is independent of the way candidate points were found. A feasible pure value is a lower bound for the pure maximum. A tangent to a concave alias action is a global upper bound, including at boundary points and on the core plateau. The difference is affine in the slope parameters and the product-domain point. Corner and vertex checks therefore prove the continuum inequality. An approximate optimizer could produce a poor candidate, but could not create a false verification result.

The exact files are

- `experiments/conway_two_leaf_block_alias_certificate.json`;
- `experiments/conway_single_leaf_attachment_certificate.json`;
- the corresponding `verify_conway_..._certificate.py` programs and recorded result files.

The reproduction runner supplies the complete, unambiguous path list and verifies fresh results against the committed records. The optional endpoint certificate strengthens the attachment margin but is not required by Theorem 1.2.

## C.2 Outward rational intervals

Every interval endpoint is an integer multiple of $10^{-40}$. Addition and subtraction are exact on this grid. Products and quotients use floor and ceiling integer division in the outward directions, with sign cases handled explicitly. A denominator interval must avoid zero. Intersections and monotone range reductions are checked, rather than inferred from floating-point values.

The constant $\pi$ is enclosed by Machin's formula

$$\pi = 16\arctan(1/5) - 4\arctan(1/239).$$

Forty terms of each alternating arctangent series, with the next-term remainder, suffice for the recorded precision. Sine arguments are reflected into $(0, \pi/2]$. The Taylor polynomial through degree 41 has error at most the next degree-43 term there. Cosine is evaluated as the sine of the complementary angle.

For a positive logarithm argument, scale by an explicitly recorded power of two. On the resulting range let $z = (x-1)/(x+1)$, with the verifier checking $0 \le z < 1/2$. Then

$$\log x = 2\sum_{j=0}^{79} \frac{z^{2j+1}}{2j+1} + R, \qquad 0 \le R \le \frac{2z^{161}}{161(1-z^2)}.$$

The same series at $z = 1/3$ encloses $\log 2$. Negative logarithms are handled by reciprocal and sign, with outward intervals preserved.

## C.3 The integrated sine product

For $0 < t < 1/2$, Euler's sine product gives

$$J(t) = t\log(2\pi t) - t - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\zeta(2n)t^{2n+1}}{n(2n+1)}. \tag{C.1}$$

To justify termwise integration, expand $\log(1 - t^2/k^2)$ on compact subintervals below one, where the absolute double series converges; the initial logarithm is integrable at zero. The remaining terms all have the same sign. Use $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$, and for $2 \le n \le 20$ the rational bounds

$$\sum_{k=1}^{64} k^{-2n} \le \zeta(2n) \le \sum_{k=1}^{64} k^{-2n} + \frac{64^{1-2n}}{2n-1}.$$

Since $\zeta(2n) < 2$, the tail after $n = 20$ in (C.1) is bounded by

$$\frac{2t^{43}}{21 \cdot 43(1-t^2)}.$$

The exact identities $J(0) = J(1/2) = J(1) = 0$ and $J(1-t) = -J(t)$ reduce every action argument to this range. Thus every action and derivative used by the certificates has a proved rational enclosure.

## C.4 Gradients and coverage

The derivatives evaluated by the verifier are

$$g'(y) = 2\log\cot\pi y, \qquad k'(x) = -\log(2\sin(\pi x/2)),$$
$$m_x = \log\frac{\sin\pi(x+y)\sin\pi(z-x)}{\sin\pi x\sin\pi(x+y-z)}, \qquad m_y = \log\frac{\sin\pi(x+y)\sin\pi(z-y)}{\sin\pi y\sin\pi(x+y-z)},$$
$$m_z = \log\frac{\sin\pi z\sin\pi(x+y-z)}{\sin\pi(z-x)\sin\pi(z-y)}.$$

Every tangent point is strict, and the core tangent point in the block certificate lies above $1/4$, so these derivatives are finite and select the intended branch. The entire action remains concave even where a maximizer could lie on the boundary; differentiability is needed only at the chosen tangent point.

For the square certificate, each nonterminal rectangle is split into its four dyadic children. The verifier checks equality with these children, their endpoints and their depth. Thus the 55 leaves cover the square exactly. It does not infer coverage from a list of sampled centers or from an approximate total area. The 880 corner/vertex inequalities are then enclosed from below. Their minimum is the rational number printed in Chapter 5; outward error can only weaken the lower bound.

## C.5 What execution establishes

A successful replay establishes the finite supporting inequalities, their exact domains, the recorded rational margins and consistency of the immutable data. It does not numerically establish strict geometry, the complex recurrence asymptotic, or the filling theorem. Those are analytic arguments in the preceding chapters and Appendix B. The optional finite matrix audits check independent instances of the exact identities; their logical role is supplementary, not an extrapolation from tested levels.

# Appendix D

# Face maps, peripheral markings, and the absolute volume

This appendix supplies the complete rational dictionary behind Chapter 7. Its scope is the completed grammar in Definition 1.1, with two completed cylindrical root children. The quadrilateral gluing faces are auxiliary cut data; no physical four-punctured-boundary representation is inferred from their moduli. The original closed cut fixes the link group and every peripheral path. At each crossing circle its two shaded triangles meet at their common ideal apex; their union is the configuration called a bowtie. We retain both triangles and their labels. All matrices below are projective: multiplying a matrix by a nonzero scalar does not change its Möbius transformation. All logarithms continue from the strict complete chamber. An unfilled main cusp remains unfilled after all auxiliary crossing-circle fillings.

## D.1 Two global incidence checks for the complete anchor

The complete cells and ordered stack maps are constructed in Chapter 4. Two points in that construction deserve an explicit check before one uses the group presentation.

First, strict output dihedral angles keep the matching quadrilateral a maximal supported face. Cells on opposite supporting sides intersect only in that face inside hyperbolic space. Their ideal closures can meet only on its supporting circle. An additional ideal vertex on that circle would enlarge the supporting face beyond a quadrilateral edge, contradicting its strictly nonflat angle. Thus there are no unrecorded ideal coincidences.

Second, at every open stage the four output corners are four unpaired original terminal singletons. Product consumes $F_2/G_1$ and $F_3/G_0$ and retains $F_0, F_1, G_2, G_3$; turns only permute these singletons. Consumed pairs never reappear among the exposed vertices of a gluing face. At the root, all four pairs under $C_j^F \mapsto C_{3-j}^G$ join the disjoint root subtrees. Therefore every main vertex is exactly a two-terminal pair, not a chain of identifications, and a leaf's four corners stay distinct. Its two shaded triangles share only their original apex. An edge and its partner in the other shaded triangle are distinct, so the complete four-step cycle contains four distinct edge occurrences. The horospherical links are positive rectangles, and the canonical shaded-side decoration gives the actual complete cusp tori described in Chapter 4.

## D.2 The selected color action and the complete face-pairing maps

Write the pure leaf action and its color derivative as

$$g(x,t) = J(2x) - 2J(x) - J(x-t) - J(x+t), \qquad v = g_t = \operatorname{Log}\frac{\sin\pi(x-t)}{\sin\pi(x+t)}.$$

For physical sign $\varepsilon \in \{0, 1, -1\}$, the source-selected shear is

$$\chi = t - \frac{\varepsilon v}{2\pi\mathrm{i}}, \qquad f_\varepsilon(x,\chi) = g(x,t) - \frac{\varepsilon v^2}{4\pi\mathrm{i}}, \qquad \mathrm{d}f_\varepsilon = g_x\,\mathrm{d}x + v\,\mathrm{d}\chi. \tag{D.1}$$

At completeness its implicit derivative is $1 - \varepsilon\mathrm{i}\cot\pi x \neq 0$. Here $J(u) = \int_0^u \operatorname{Log}(2\sin\pi s)\,\mathrm{d}s$, on the continued complete branch. The finite packet identifies the shear and its constant. An explicit algebraic check is useful: put $E = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}x}$, $H = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}\chi}$, and $K = e^{-\partial_x f_-}$. The selected source quadratic gives

$$K^2(1+E)^2 + K[(H+H^{-1})E^2 + 2] + (1-E)^2 = 0. \tag{D.2}$$

At $H = 1$, it factors as $(K+1)[K(1+E)^2 + (1-E)^2]$, and the source branch is $K = \tan^2(\pi x)$. For the negative shear in (D.1), setting $T = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}t}$ gives

$$H = \frac{T(E-T)}{ET-1}, \qquad T^2 + E(H-1)T - H = 0, \qquad K = \frac{(E-T)(1-ET)}{T(1+E)^2}.$$

Eliminating $T$ gives (D.2) with the same branch. This identifies the $x$ derivative. The remaining $\chi$-dependent constant is zero by the actual endpoint normalization. For fixed small $\chi$, at $x = 1/2$ one has $v = 0$, so the hidden pure color tends to $t = \chi$, not to zero. On the continued branch $J(1) = J(1/2) = 0$ and $J(1/2+t) = -J(1/2-t)$, hence $g(1/2,t) = 0$ and the shear quadratic vanishes. The finite-source action is $g(x,\chi) + S(x,\chi) - S(x,0)$, where $S(x,\chi) = \int_x^{1/2} \operatorname{Log}\mu(u,\chi)\,\mathrm{d}u$. The selected root is regular with $\mu(1/2,\chi) = 1$; both integrals therefore tend to zero. This verifies the fixed-color constant on the same holomorphic branch. Schwarz reflection gives the positive sign. Thus the geometry below does not select a new source solution or discard a quadratic color phase.

Normalize the ordered gluing face of an elementary pyramid to $(0, \infty, 1, R)$, put $E = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}x}$, $T = e^{2\pi\mathrm{i}t}$, and select

$$Z = \frac{1+E}{1+T}, \qquad R = \frac{T(1+E)^2}{E(1+T)^2}, \qquad Z^2 - (1+E)Z + ER = 0.$$

The two projection charts have apices $Z$ and $Z/E$. Their four maps are listed below. A white map pairs pieces coming from the projection sphere. A completion map is the same algebraic expression at an attachment edge where the adjacent prism supplies the actual face. We distinguish these roles before using the maps in a group relation:

$$\begin{aligned} W_0 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & E \end{pmatrix}, & W_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & E-1 \\ 0 & E \end{pmatrix}, \\ W_2 &= \begin{pmatrix} E-R & R(1-E) \\ E-1 & 1-ER \end{pmatrix}, & W_3 &= \begin{pmatrix} R & 0 \\ 1-E & ER \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \tag{D.3}$$

At an elementary pyramid, $W_0, W_2$ are its actual white-face maps. The expressions $W_1, W_3$ become actual maps when the adjacent prism is attached at the edges called cap edges in Chapter 4. All matrix identities here are projective. The pure shaded map and the two odd cross-copy maps are

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -ER \\ 1 & -1-E \end{pmatrix}, \qquad A = \begin{pmatrix} R & -R \\ 1 & ER-1-E \end{pmatrix}, \qquad B = \begin{pmatrix} R/E-1-1/E & R \\ -1 & R \end{pmatrix}.$$

They send the original labeled triangle vertices to their prescribed partners. The apex equation verifies the fourth flag without any unit-modulus assumption.

For a prism, transport all $W_j$ to the coordinates in (4.6). Direct rational substitution gives

$$\begin{aligned} W_{F,1} = W_{G,1} = W_{p,1} = W_{\mathrm{top}}, \qquad & W_{F,3} = W_{G,3} = W_{p,3} = W_{\mathrm{bottom}}, \\ W_{F,2} = W_{G,0}, \qquad & W_{p,0} = W_{F,0}, \quad W_{p,2} = W_{G,2}. \end{aligned} \tag{D.4}$$

Here $p$ denotes the output gluing face, not a filling slope. The nine identifications are identities of entire maps, not just cross ratios. They can be verified without geometric continuation: use independent phase variables $\mathsf{a} = e^{2\pi i p}$, $\mathsf{b} = e^{2\pi i r}$, $\mathsf{c} = e^{2\pi i q}$, and the rational coordinates

$$\begin{aligned} &v_0 = 1, \quad v_1 = \mathsf{a}, \quad v_2 = \mathsf{ab}, \quad v_3 = \mathsf{abc}, \\ &P = 1 + \mathsf{a} - \frac{\mathsf{a}[\mathsf{ab}(1+\mathsf{c}) - 1 - \mathsf{a}]}{\mathsf{a}^2\mathsf{b}^2\mathsf{c} - \mathsf{a}}. \end{aligned}$$

The three wire phases are $\mathsf{bc}, \mathsf{ab}, \mathsf{abc}$. Normalize each ordered quadrilateral gluing face by

$$M_{a,b,c}(z) = \frac{(z-a)(c-b)}{(z-b)(c-a)}, \qquad R = M_{a,b,c}(d).$$

In world coordinates its white map is $\overline{M}^{-1} W_j M$, where the bar replaces $\mathsf{a}, \mathsf{b}, \mathsf{c}$ by their reciprocals, as prescribed by the second chart. Inserting these formulas into (D.4) gives equality entry by entry up to a common scalar. Thus no unit-circle restriction or missing translation is hidden in the identities.

The turn map $T_Q(z) = (R-1)/(z-1)$ and closing map $C_Q(z) = (z-R)/(z-1)$ satisfy

$$T_Q W_{j+1}(E,R) = W_j(E^{-1}, 1-R) T_Q, \qquad C_Q W_j(E^{-1}, R) = W_{2-j}(E,R) C_Q.$$

The identities show that the map on a white face is independent of which constituent cell is used to compute it. Thus every triangular piece of one original white face has the same map, even when its deformed image is not planar. For pure leaves, writing $\overline{S}$ for $S$ with $E$ replaced by $E^{-1}$, the edge words are

$$W_0 S = \overline{S} W_0, \quad W_2 S = \overline{S} W_2, \quad W_3 S = \overline{S} W_1.$$

For odd leaves they are

$$W_0^{-1} B W_2^{-1} A = I, \quad W_2^{-1} B W_0^{-1} A = I, \quad W_1^{-1} B W_3^{-1} A = I.$$

All hold for independent nearby $E, R$. They include translation and dilation, and the reverse words are inverses. The original closed cut therefore supplies a representation of the actual

half-twist partner group: use its dual two-skeleton presentation, with exactly these white-face seams and shaded four-step relations. No representation is inferred from the shape parameters of the gluing faces alone. The second charts depend holomorphically on the source parameters by the reflected-minus convention, rather than by conjugating those parameters.

A main meridian is $W_{j-1}^{-1}W_j$ at the corresponding corner. The two maps fix that corner and have equal derivatives there: $E^{-1}$ at $C_0, C_2$, and $E$ at $C_1, C_3$, using the finite coordinate at infinity. Thus its multiplier is one identically. It is nonidentity at completeness and stays parabolic nearby. Its commuting peripheral partner is consequently a translation as well. Every main cusp remains parabolic.

## D.3 Primitive logs, the absolute regulator, and filling

We next compute the holonomy of the two actual peripheral curves. Their being primitive is a topological statement about the cusp lattice, so we check their complete translations before using their logarithms. The logarithms below are those of similarity multipliers; they are twice eigenvalue logarithms. This convention explains the factors of two in the volume differential and in the filling equation. Put

$$\rho = \frac{Z}{1+E-Z}, \qquad Q = \frac{E-Z}{Z-1}.$$

The original disk longitude is $W_2^{-1}W_0$, with multiplier $Q^2$ in the selected flag-at-infinity frame. The pure meridian is $S^{-1}$, with multiplier $\rho$. The two actual odd meridians are $A^{-1}W_0$ and $W_0^{-1}B$, with multipliers $\rho Q$ and $\rho/Q$. Returning to the original complete leaf coordinate, their translations are $-2$ and $2E$, while the disk longitude is $-2(E+1)$. The two-rectangle lattice fixes their primitive integral marking and orientation. The sign is fixed by the original threading convention: for the negative coupon, the typed loop $[2,1,1,2]$ followed by $R^{-1}$ has auxiliary matrix

$$M_{\mathrm{aux}} = I - \frac{P+I}{1+E}, \qquad \operatorname{Tr} P = -2,$$

where $P$ is the actual disk-product matrix and the preferred projective longitude is $-P$. Its translation ratio is $1+E$, identifying the first path above. Reversing the retained half twist changes the meridian by one disk longitude and gives the second. Thus the physical $R^{-1}$ coupon uses the first path and $R$ the second, with no sign inferred solely from a Hessian. Consequently

$$\rho = e^{-2\pi \mathrm{i} t}, \qquad Q = e^{-v}, \qquad U = -2\pi \mathrm{i} t - \frac{\varepsilon V}{2} = -2\pi \mathrm{i}\chi, \qquad V = -2v.$$

The half-longitude shear is a relation between the two actual primitive cusp markings. It does not assert that half a longitude is an integral loop or replace the actual link by a pure rational filling. The centered similarity multipliers used for $U, V$ are squares of the corresponding eigenvalues. The original lift and pivot character are retained in the finite source; no additional square-root choice changes a peripheral word here.

Let $\Phi_\varepsilon(\chi)$ be the selected stationary action in all free wires. The envelope identity in (D.1) gives

$$U_\ell = -2\pi \mathrm{i}\chi_\ell, \qquad V_\ell = -2\partial_\ell \Phi_\varepsilon, \qquad G = 2\pi \mathrm{i}\Phi_\varepsilon, \qquad \mathrm{d}G = \frac{1}{2}\sum_\ell V_\ell \,\mathrm{d}U_\ell. \tag{D.5}$$

The source primitive includes the local term $-\varepsilon_\ell V_\ell^2/8$. It is retained before taking volume. At the complete point, $\operatorname{Im} G(0) = 2\pi F_0$ is the actual half-twist partner volume from the explicit complete cells and original pairings.

For the nearby framed representation, triangulate the same original cut balls and retain their peripheral decoration. The ideal-tetrahedron variation follows directly from the Bloch–Wigner formula

$$\mathrm{d}D(z) = \log|z|\,\mathrm{d}\arg(1-z) - \log|1-z|\,\mathrm{d}\arg z.$$

In the sum over the original oriented tetrahedra, face terms have equal flags and opposite orientations and cancel. On a peripheral torus, cut along the recorded primitive $\mu, \lambda$ to a parallelogram. The opposite sides cancel except for their two eigenline scale factors; the remaining alternating product is $-2\,\mathcal{M} \wedge \mathcal{L}$, where $\mathcal{M} = e^u, \mathcal{L} = e^v$ and $u = U/2, v = V/2$. Here the sign is the boundary orientation of the truncated original fundamental chain, and the factor two retains both eigenline flags. Applying the displayed differential to that alternating product gives $2(\Re v\,\mathrm{d}\Im u - \Re u\,\mathrm{d}\Im v)$. Different boundary tori have zero mutual intersection, and the parabolic main tori have zero log contribution. Thus

$$\mathrm{d}\operatorname{Vol}(\rho) = \frac{1}{2}\sum_\ell (\operatorname{Re} V_\ell\,\mathrm{d}\operatorname{Im} U_\ell - \operatorname{Re} U_\ell\,\mathrm{d}\operatorname{Im} V_\ell).$$

Using (D.5), this is the differential of $\operatorname{Im} G - \frac{1}{2}\sum \operatorname{Re} U \operatorname{Im} V$. The complete anchor fixes the constant on the same connected marked branch. Therefore the absolute identity is

$$\operatorname{Vol}(\rho_\chi) = \operatorname{Im} G - \frac{1}{2}\sum_\ell \operatorname{Re} U_\ell \operatorname{Im} V_\ell. \tag{D.6}$$

This uses the original relative fundamental chain and its actual nearby representation, not equal differentials on unrelated components.

## D.4 Smooth completion on the actual primitive filled topology

We give the metric argument used here, including its uniformity in the independently chosen slopes. Let $M = Y_E^\varepsilon$ carry the oriented complete metric constructed above, with holonomy $\rho_0$. A nearby *framed* representation consists of the actual face-paired representation $\rho$ and, at each cusp, its selected common fixed flag. In a frame sending that flag to infinity, the two peripheral maps are complex similarities. Their uniquely small multiplier logs are the $U, V$ just computed. We construct one neighborhood of this framed complete point before choosing the filling slopes.

### D.4.1 An actual positive metric on the core and its ends

The first task is to turn nearby holonomy data into local hyperbolic coordinate charts on the same manifold. On a compact truncated part we average small changes of the complete developing map. On each end we use an equivariant affine construction. Both maps are close to the original one on their common compact collar, allowing them to be joined without losing local invertibility. Choose a compact cusp-truncated core with a slightly larger collar, finitely many evenly covered balls, and a smooth partition of unity. Write $\eta_{j,\gamma}$ for its lifts, with one

chosen lift of each ball and $\gamma \in \pi_1(M)$. In the future unit hyperboloid model of hyperbolic space put

$$Y_\rho(x) = \sum_{j,\gamma} \eta_{j,\gamma}(x)\rho(\gamma)\rho_0(\gamma)^{-1}x, \qquad E_\rho(x) = \frac{Y_\rho(x)}{\sqrt{-\langle Y_\rho(x), Y_\rho(x)\rangle}}.$$

Every summand is future timelike; their convex average is future timelike too, so the normalization is defined. Reindexing the sum proves $E_\rho(\rho_0(\delta)x) = \rho(\delta)E_\rho(x)$. Only finitely many terms occur on a compact fundamental part, and at $\rho_0$ the map is the identity. Thus it is $C^1$-close to the identity and is an orientation-preserving local diffeomorphism in one fixed representation neighborhood. This does not assume that the deformed action is already discrete or free.

For one complete cusp write its universal coordinates as $(w, s) \in \mathbb{C}\times[s_0, \infty)$, with translation lattice $\Lambda$, and complete development $(w, e^s)$ in upper half-space. Denote the deformed affine peripheral action by $A_\lambda(z) = a_\lambda z + b_\lambda$. Choose a nonnegative compactly supported smooth $\eta$ with $\sum_{\lambda\in\Lambda} \eta(w - \lambda) = 1$, and define

$$d_\rho(w) = \sum_{\lambda\in\Lambda} \eta(w - \lambda)A_\lambda(w - \lambda).$$

Then $d_\rho(w + \lambda) = A_\lambda d_\rho(w)$. On a fixed closed fundamental parallelogram it is $C^1$-close to $w$, so its real Jacobian is positive; equivariance propagates that fact everywhere. Let $\xi_\rho$ be the real-linear extension of $\lambda \mapsto \log|a_\lambda|$. The map

$$F_\rho(w, s) = \big(d_\rho(w), e^{s+\xi_\rho(w)}\big)$$

is exactly peripheral-equivariant. Its differential has positive determinant $e^{s+\xi_\rho(w)} \det_{\mathbb{R}} Dd_\rho(w)$ for every $s \geq s_0$. Restore the moving flag frame and extend to all cusp lifts by equivariance. Geodesically interpolate $E_\rho$ and $F_\rho$ on the compact collar with an invariant smooth cutoff. There both maps are $C^1$-close to the complete development, so the interpolation remains a positive local diffeomorphism after one further uniform shrink. Pullback of the hyperbolic metric now gives an actual oriented nonsingular metric on the original manifold with its ideal ends deleted.

### D.4.2 The logarithmic link and its primitive angular period

At a filled cusp, the nearby peripheral similarities have two common fixed points. Sending one to infinity and translating the other to zero makes them multiplications. Their logarithms then act by translations on a Euclidean plane. We must show that the translations are exactly the selected small logs $U, V$, with no unnoticed multiple of $2\pi$i. Only after this check may the large integer $p$ be used in the relation $U + pV = -2\pi$i. At a cusp to be filled, the equation $U + pV = -2\pi$i ensures that at least one multiplier differs from one. Commuting affine maps then have a common finite fixed point $q$, in addition to infinity. For either generator with $a \neq 1$, $q = b/(1 - a)$. Its numerator stays away from zero near completeness, whereas both generator multipliers tend to one; hence $|q| \to \infty$ uniformly, even if one multiplier equals one. The developed fundamental parallelogram and fixed generator paths have uniformly bounded images and lengths. After shrinking the neighborhood they miss $q$, and equivariance implies that the entire development misses $q$.

On the simply connected link cover choose $f = \operatorname{Log}(d_\rho - q)$. Its differential is invertible as a real map and is invariant under deck transformations. Consequently $|\mathrm{d}f|^2$ descends to a nonsingular Euclidean metric on the compact torus, hence is complete. Lifting Euclidean segments proves that its developing local isometry $f$ covers $\mathbb{C}$; because the plane is simply connected, this is a global isometry. Its periods form an injective real rank-two lattice. A fixed generator path of developed length at most $L$, contained in $|d_\rho| \le R$, satisfies

$$|\Delta f| \le \frac{L}{|q| - R} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Exponentiating its increment gives the corresponding similarity multiplier. The increment and its prescribed small log therefore differ by an integer multiple of $2\pi\mathrm{i}$ which is exactly zero near completeness. Thus the actual two log-link periods are $U, V$, before they are multiplied by any large slope. This is why the same representation neighborhood works for all slopes.

Translate $q$ to zero. On the compact link quotient the function $e^{s_0+\xi_\rho(w)}/|d_\rho(w) - q|$ is bounded above. The explicit end therefore contains an entire equivariant epigraph $y > A|d_\rho - q|$. With

$$r = \frac{y}{|d_\rho - q|}, \qquad R = \operatorname{arsinh}(1/r), \qquad \theta = \Im f, \qquad X = \Re f + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(1 + r^2),$$

direct substitution into the upper-half-space metric gives

$$\mathrm{d}s^2 = \mathrm{d}R^2 + \cosh^2 R\,\mathrm{d}X^2 + \sinh^2 R\,\mathrm{d}\theta^2. \tag{D.7}$$

The epigraph contains a whole punctured tube $0 < R < R_0$. A log period $L$ acts by $(X, \theta) \mapsto (X + \Re L, \theta + \Im L)$. The actual primitive curve $\mu + p\lambda$ has period $-2\pi\mathrm{i}$, exactly one angular turn. Its complementary primitive period can be taken to be $V$, which has nonzero real part since $U, V$ are real-linearly independent. Adding the axis $R = 0$ in (D.7) is therefore a smooth hyperbolic solid torus, whose meridian is exactly $\mu + p\lambda$. Its affine holonomy is the identity, since it fixes both $q$ and infinity with multiplier one. The representation descends to the actual filled group. Reversing the angular sign changes the parametrization of the meridian, not the orientation of the metric.

At an unfilled main cusp both multipliers are one. The same construction gives a translation-equivariant Euclidean link development, globally the plane by completeness of the compact link; $\xi_\rho = 0$. Its end contains a full horoball quotient, so it is complete and has finite volume. The remaining region is compact. Attaching the finitely many bounded-radius solid tori therefore gives a complete finite-volume hyperbolic metric on precisely the filled topology. Its complete universal developing map covers simply connected hyperbolic space, so the holonomy is discrete and faithful. This proof used one fixed framed neighborhood and no comparison between different slope sizes.

The representation volume $\operatorname{Vol}(\rho_\chi)$ in (D.6) equals the volume of this completed metric. Use the same finite boundary triangulation as in the regulator calculation. At each filled cusp, compare its conical ideal development with the equivariant map into the common peripheral axis, using one face-compatible homotopy on that boundary triangulation. For clarity, put the selected endpoint at infinity and the axis at horizontal coordinate zero. On a fixed fundamental cross section write the conical map as $(a(w), Yb(w))$ and the axis map as $(0, Ye^{\eta(w)})$, where $b > 0$ and all functions are piecewise smooth. A compatible homotopy is

$$H_s(w, Y) = \big(sa(w), Y\exp((1 - s)\eta(w) + s\log b(w))\big), \qquad 0 \le s \le 1.$$

The horizontal coordinates and their first derivatives are bounded on that cross section. The height is comparable to $Y$ and its first derivatives are $O(Y)$. The hyperbolic volume form $y^{-3}\,dx_1 \wedge dx_2 \wedge dy$ therefore bounds the volume of this boundary homotopy by $O(Y^{-2})$, which tends to zero. After this comparison, extend the same boundary assignment through the solid torus with all vertices on its core axis. Every added tetrahedron has zero volume. The unfilled horoball comparisons also have vanishing boundary volume. Thus the original oriented fundamental chain and the filled metric have the same absolute volume. This is the filling-chain comparison in the general source-regulator theorem, Section 6; it uses the actual primitive completion just proved.

### D.4.3 The source saddle and its absolute knot-complement volume

The full source filling transform selects a critical point of

$$S_{\varepsilon,\mathbf{p}}(\chi) = \Phi_\varepsilon(\chi) + \frac{\pi\mathrm{i}}{2}\sum_\ell \frac{(\chi_\ell - 1)^2}{p_\ell}.$$

Its equations are exactly $U_\ell + p_\ell V_\ell = -2\pi\mathrm{i}$. For existence set $r_\ell = 1/p_\ell$ and write them as $V_\ell + r_\ell U_\ell = -2\pi\mathrm{i} r_\ell$. At $r = 0$ their $\chi$-Jacobian is $-4\pi\mathrm{i}\,\mathrm{diag}(\tau_\ell)$, with $\Im\tau_\ell > 0$, by the source packet. It is invertible. The holomorphic implicit-function theorem thus gives one nearby solution for all $r$ in a fixed polydisk, independently of their relative sizes and signs. It lies in the framed neighborhood just constructed after that polydisk is shrunk once more. For independently sufficiently long fixed signed integral $p_\ell$, the marked geometric completion gives smooth angle $2\pi$ on these primitive filled curves, with the unfilled main cusp parabolic. The physical leaf power is $R^{\varepsilon_\ell - 2p_\ell}$, once, in its original disk framing. At this saddle, (D.6) is

$$\mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{F,G,\varepsilon}(\mathbf{p})) = 2\pi\,\mathrm{Re}\,S_{\varepsilon,\mathbf{p}}(\chi_*).$$

All auxiliary circles have been filled and the chosen main component is the knot. The knot cusp is unfilled. The separate full-source alias, complex-packet and entire Fourier-period arguments are what identify this geometric action with the original invariant's limiting rate.

# Appendix E

# The quantitative finite-sum estimate

This appendix proves the analytic part of Theorem 9.1. The finite ordered tree, the crossing power at every vertex, the strand orientations and the knot pairing are fixed throughout. The integer $N$ alone tends to infinity. The proof gives explicit estimates on the original finite invariant; Appendix F identifies the resulting critical action with the volume of the actual filled knot complement.

## E.1 Polynomial coordinates and the finite sum

We first specify the finite algebra used below, including the data at repeated roots. Put $d = N - 1$, $\theta = \pi/N$, and $q = e^{i\theta}$. The main meridian parameter is $M = q^s$, with $s$ in a fixed disk $|s| \le R < 1$. Let $\mathsf{T}_N$ be the normalized Chebyshev polynomial characterized by $\mathsf{T}_N(t + t^{-1}) = t^N + t^{-N}$. The polynomial relation for two strands with the same orientation is

$$P_s(z) = \mathsf{T}_N(z) + 2\cos(2\pi s).$$

For opposite orientations it is $P_0(z)$. A canonical polynomial means the representative of degree less than $N$ obtained by division by the appropriate monic relation. These two divisions are kept distinct. The fixed basis used to express both representatives is

$$S_k = \prod_{r=1}^{k} 2\sin(r\theta), \qquad c_j = 2\cos((2j+1)\theta), \qquad e_k(z) = S_k^{-2} \prod_{j=0}^{k-1} (c_j - z), \quad 0 \le k < N. \tag{E.1}$$

An empty product is one. The low indices are $0 \le k \le \lfloor d/2 \rfloor$; the remaining indices are high. These words describe a division of the fixed basis, rather than a change in the physical strand color.

The full norm of a canonical polynomial records its value at every distinct complete node and its first derivative at every double node:

$$\|F\|_{\mathrm{J}} = \max\{|F(c_j)| : \ 0 \le j \le \lfloor d/2 \rfloor; \ |F'(c_j)| : \ c_j \text{ is a double root of } P_0\}. \tag{E.2}$$

At odd levels the endpoint $-2$ is simple and has no derivative coordinate. The derivative coordinates are the first normal data referred to below. Hermite interpolation, which uses values and these derivatives together, makes this norm polynomially equivalent in $N$ to the

sup norm on $[-2,2]$ of the canonical polynomial and to its Chebyshev coefficient norm. A polynomial cost means a bound $CN^A$; $C, A$ can depend on the fixed diagram and on $R$.

The normalized closing functional on either algebra is

$$\phi_\sigma(F) = (-1)^d N^2 [z^d] \operatorname{rem}_{P_\sigma} F, \qquad \phi_\sigma(e_i e_j) = \mathbf{1}_{i+j=d}, \qquad \sigma = 0, s, -s. \tag{E.3}$$

Here $[z^d]$ extracts a monomial coefficient. To see that the pairing is unchanged when the relation moves, divide $e_i e_j = P_0 A + B$. Its degree is at most $2N-2$, so $\deg A \le N-2$. Since $P_s = P_0 + 2\cos(2\pi s) - 2$, its moving remainder is $B - (2\cos(2\pi s) - 2)A$, with exactly the same top coefficient. This calculation retains the repeated-root data.

An actual quarter-turn reverses the index $k \mapsto d-k$ and multiplies it by a specified scalar and a paired sine product. Set

$$W_k(s) = \prod_{r=1}^{k} \left(1 - \frac{\sin^2(\pi s/N)}{\sin^2(\pi r/N)}\right), \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin(\pi s)}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, \qquad W_k W_{d-k} = H_N^2. \tag{E.4}$$

The removable value is $H_N(0) = 1$. The prescribed orientation type supplies $\gamma_e(s) \in \{1, q^{-s^2/2}, q^{s^2/2}\}$. After lowering an index by the pairing in (E.3), a physical edge identifies equal indices and carries $\gamma_e(s) H_N(s)/W_k(s)$. Thus the edge factors are retained in the finite contraction, even when its tensor entries are compared with a positive reference. On every fixed disk $R < 1$, these factors and their inverses are bounded uniformly in $N$ and $k$. The exact orientation and framing products give the scalar $A_N(s)$ in (9.4); they are not replaced by their limits.

The finite sum over the internal edge indices is called the packet $B_N$. Its angular variables $\tau_v$ are the Fourier variables of the circle traces. A Fourier charge $\ell_v$ labels the frequency $N\ell_v$ produced by the translated root grid; it is not a new color or a new filling coefficient. The polynomial $U_j$ used for its coefficient satisfies $U_j(\cos t) = \sin((j+1)t)/\sin t$, with removable values at the endpoints. The fixed crossing operator $R_\sigma^{n_v}$ always includes its physical scalar, the specified strand order and the pivotal closing map. Negative powers mean its actual inverse.

For clarity, the interpolation used to move the finite index contour has a fixed normalization. The sine factorial $S_r$ is continued by

$$G_N(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{N}\right)^z \Gamma(z+1) \prod_{k \ge 1} \frac{\Gamma(Nk+z+1)}{\Gamma(Nk-z)(Nk)^{2z+1}}, \qquad -1 < \Re z < N. \tag{E.5}$$

The powers use positive-base logarithms. This function is nonzero on the strip, satisfies $G_N(0) = 1$, $G_N(r) = S_r$, and $G_N(z+1)/G_N(z) = 2\sin(\pi(z+1)/N)$. For $x = k/N$ and $u = Nt/(2\pi)$, the interpolant of $e_k(-2\cos t)$ is

$$\frac{G_N(d/2+u) G_N(d/2-u)}{G_N(d/2-Nx+u) G_N(d/2-Nx-u) G_N(Nx)^2}. \tag{E.6}$$

Gamma reflection gives $G_N(s) G_N(-s) = 1/H_N(s)$ and hence the exact analytic interpolation of the paired edge insertion is

$$\frac{H_N(s)}{W_{Nx}^{\mathrm{hol}}(s)} = \frac{G_N(Nx)^2}{G_N(Nx-s) G_N(Nx+s)}. \tag{E.7}$$

All $d/2$ offsets are retained. The product normalization, its complex bulk expansion and the finite cotangent interpolation are the ones proved in the exact factorial interpolation theorem and the regular crossing-circle calculation. A periodic factor would change the interpolation and is not allowed. The following estimates apply these fixed finite identities to the explicit angular domain required by the quantitative theorem.

## E.2 Finite sums under the degree and twist criterion

The separately available version of this section is finite sums under the degree and twist criterion. The proof is reproduced here in full.

The number of branches incident to a crossing circle can supply part of the estimate previously obtained by taking its twist number large. This section proves the finite-sum limit under an explicit inequality in those two integers. The volume theorem combines it with the ordered octahedral decomposition and positive filling path. The limiting action is therefore the volume of the original knot complement throughout the stated class, including the short coefficients permitted by the inequality.

### E.2.1 Assertion and scope

Consider an actual reduced Conway operation tree in which every product junction carries an original crossing-circle operator. Include ordinary terminal crossing circles as degree-one vertices. The resulting circle graph $\mathcal{T}$ is a finite tree, with physical quarter-turn edges and no bare junctions. Keep the ordered branches, orientations, knot pattern, primitive cut and zero framing. For the literal construction defined in the volume theorem, the strict angle condition follows inductively from the product intervals; it is not a further restriction on these trees.

Let $d_v \geq 1$ be the graph degree of circle $v$, and let $n_v \in \mathbb{Z}$ be its actual fixed crossing power. The graph degree $d_v$ is unrelated to the quantum degree $N-1$. Put

$$\mathfrak{S}(\mathcal{T}, \mathbf{n}) = \sum_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2}. \tag{E.8}$$

The following conservative sufficient condition will be proved:

$$\mathfrak{S} \leq 2^{-25}. \tag{E.9}$$

It implies a nonzero first joint Fourier charge and the actual reduced microscopic profile through both level parities, on every $|s| \leq R < 1$. The exponential rate is the real part of the explicitly continued first-charge action. Conditions (E.8)–(E.9) are quantitative finite-action conditions, not an assumption that this saddle dominates.

Short, even zero, crossing powers are permitted by this certificate. Section E.2.11 explains how the companion geometric proofs identify the action with the actual knot volume under the same bound. The graph and all powers are fixed before $N$ tends to infinity.

The invariant in the conclusion is the reduced, zero-framed ADO polynomial $F_N(M)$, normalized to one on the unknot. Its complete value is $F_N(1) = K_N(K)$. Set $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$ and $M = q_N^s$. The explicit elementary factors are

$$H_N(s) = \frac{\sin(\pi s)}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, \qquad A_N(s) = q_N^{a(D)s^2/2}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v.$$

Here $w(D)$ is the writhe of the fixed original diagram. The scalar calculation specifies the same framing convention, including all orientation types. The critical action in the limit is defined in Sections E.2.4 and E.2.7.

### E.2.2 Finite identities and the four uses of long twists

The finite identities used below have the following roles. Their separately available proofs are linked for reference:

- the exact crossing trace, Sections 2–4 and 7: exact translated-grid trace, full crossing scalar, Fourier coefficients, normal limits and fixed-power polynomial bounds;
- the finite sum over internal edge indices, Sections 2 and 4–8: primitive lattice, canonical $G_N$, finite cotangent currents and the saddle insertion rule;
- the joint Fourier calculation, Sections 3–5: real-spectator telescoping and the exact coefficient of charge one;
- bounds for the full polynomial traces, Sections 1–4, with its cited full spectral-jet and Chebyshev folding bounds;
- the crossing and framing scalar: the unchanged exact scalar identity for fixed integer powers.

These are mathematical inputs, not numerical diagnostics. The earlier source transfer theorem and the pretzel filling calculation use reciprocal-slope implicit functions; the geometric source-regulator theorem uses a neighborhood of the complete framed representation.

The long-twist hypothesis enters the joint Fourier argument in four analytic places: existence and charge ordering of a nearby critical branch; a nonempty finite charge cutoff with a fixed tail loss; the angular connectors; and comparison of the total critical drop with fixed discarded-source losses. The geometric completion is a separate fifth use. This proof replaces the four analytic uses in the all-circle class.

### E.2.3 A graph-independent discarded-source gap

Use the fixed complete Newton basis $e_k$, $0 \le k < N$, and write

$$J(x) = \int_0^x \log(2\sin \pi u)\, du, \quad g(x) = J(2x) - 4J(x), \quad G_0 = g(1/4). \tag{E.10}$$

The physical turn on a covariant edge retains equal indices and the actual factor $\gamma_e(s)H_N(s)/W_k(s)$. This factor and its inverse are bounded on any fixed $|s| \le R < 1$, including all indices. Reference, pivot, framing and the single reduced-cut scalar are kept.

At a circle vertex the actual typed tensor is the prescribed version of

$$\phi_\sigma\left(R_\sigma^{n_v} \prod_{e\sim v} e_{k_e}\right), \qquad \sigma = 0, s, -s. \tag{E.11}$$

The canonical polynomial of a fixed $R_\sigma^{n_v}$ has polynomial complete spectral-jet norm. Low $e_k$ have norm rate $g(k/N)$; high $e_k$ have polynomial norm, including their first normals.

Finite-degree Chebyshev folding and exact top-coefficient extraction therefore give rate at most the sum of $g$ over low incidences in (E.11). The polynomial exponent can depend on the fixed valence and power. This is the full carrier-normalized tensor, not a distinct-node trace. Opposite-color types retain their explicit outside scalar.

Each physical edge has two incidences. The whole absolute rate is at most $2\sum_{\text{low } e} g(k_e/N)$, and the positive complete action is

$$F_0 = 2|E(\mathcal{T})|G_0. \tag{E.12}$$

Retain the box $k_e/N \in I = [1/5, 3/10]$. Since

$$g'(1/4) = 0, \qquad g''(x) = -4\pi/\sin 2\pi x \le -4\pi, \qquad 2[G_0 - g(x)] \ge 4\pi(x - 1/4)^2, \tag{E.13}$$

one low edge outside $I$ loses at least $\pi/100$. A high edge loses $2G_0 \ge \pi/4$. Closed factorial bounds and polynomial state counting consequently give a grouped scalar error

$$N^{A_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}} e^{N(F_0-\eta_0)}, \qquad \eta_0 = \pi/200. \tag{E.14}$$

This loss is independent of the tree size and the fixed powers; prefactors and starting levels are not uniform in those data. There are no bare-tensor replacement errors. No generic conversion from a small spectral norm to a low/high coefficient cone is used: the physical vertex trace (E.11) is bounded directly.

### E.2.4 Exact edge action

The retained packet factorizes over physical edges. Apart from its edge scalar, each factor is

$$K_N(t, u; s) = \sum_{k/N \in I} e_k(-2\cos t) e_k(-2\cos u) \frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}. \tag{E.15}$$

The canonical interpolation has phase

$$b(x, t) = \int_0^x \log(2\cos 2\pi v + 2\cos t)\, dv - 2J(x), \qquad \psi(t, u) = \operatorname{stat}_x[b(x, t) + b(x, u)]. \tag{E.16}$$

All branches are continued from $x = 1/4, t = u = 0$. Writing $c = \cos 2\pi x$, the stationary equation gives exactly

$$c = \frac{1 - \cos t \cos u}{2 + \cos t + \cos u}, \qquad \tan^2 \pi x = \frac{1}{1 + \tan^2(t/2) + \tan^2(u/2)}. \tag{E.17}$$

Substitution $z = \tan \pi v$ in $b_t$ yields

$$\psi_t = -\pi^{-1} \operatorname{arsinh}(\tan(t/2)\cos(u/2)). \tag{E.18}$$

For $Q = \sqrt{1 - \sin^2(t/2)\sin^2(u/2)}$,

$$\psi_{tt} = -\frac{\cos(u/2)}{2\pi\cos(t/2)Q}, \qquad \psi_{tu} = \frac{\sin(t/2)\sin(u/2)}{2\pi Q}. \tag{E.19}$$

The Hessian determinant is exactly $1/(4\pi^2)$. Thus

$$\Psi(\boldsymbol{\tau}) = \sum_{\{v,w\} \in E} \psi(\tau_v, \tau_w) = F_0 - \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_v a_v \tau_v^2 + \mathcal{E}(\boldsymbol{\tau}), \qquad a_v = d_v/(2\pi). \tag{E.20}$$

In particular the diagonal curvature grows with graph degree.

### E.2.5 An available complex packet and nonlinear bounds

Take $r = 1/4$. Formula (E.17) gives $|x(t,u) - 1/4| < 0.003$ on $|t|, |u| \le r$: $|\tan(t/2)| < 0.128$, hence $|c| \le 2(0.128)^2/[2 - 2(0.128)^2] < 0.017$, and $x = 1/4 - \arcsin(c)/(2\pi)$.

Here the radius is valid for the finite packet, not only its formal action. Put $A = b(x,t) + b(x,u)$. On $\Re x \in I$, $|\Im x| \le 1/50$, $|t|, |u| \le 1/4$,

$$A_{xx} = \sum_{\xi = t,u} \left[ -\frac{2\pi \sin 2\pi x}{\cos 2\pi x + \cos \xi} - 2\pi \cot \pi x \right], \qquad |A_{xx}| < 44, \quad \Re A_{xx} < -12. \tag{E.21}$$

For completeness, $|\cos 2\pi x| < 0.338$, $|\cos \xi - 1| < 0.032$, $|\sin 2\pi x| < 1.009$. Also $\Re \cot \pi x > 0.72$, while the real part of the first fraction without $2\pi$ exceeds 0.328: its conjugated numerator is at least $0.95(0.655) - 0.040(0.159)$ and its squared denominator is at most $1.37^2$. These bounds imply (E.21).

Use a finite cotangent contour of height $h = 1/500$ for the original integer sum. With $X = \Re(x - x_*)$, $Y = \Im(x - x_*)$, Taylor's formula gives

$$\Re[A(x) - A(x_*)] \le -6X^2 + 44|XY| + 22Y^2. \tag{E.22}$$

On a vertical endpoint side, $|X| \ge 0.047$, $|Y| \le 0.005$; the right side is below $-0.002$. On a horizontal side its maximum in $X$ is at most $(308/3)Y^2 \le 77/30000$, below the nonconstant cotangent-mode loss $2\pi h = \pi/250$. The constant-mode integral translates to $x_*$ with the same endpoint loss, and (E.21) gives a nondegenerate Gaussian on its real tangent. All canonical $G_N$ arguments stay in regular bulk strips; no periodic normalization of the interpolation has been changed.

Thus each exact edge sum has a nonzero analytic amplitude and the usual uniform $O_R(N^{-1})$ relative expansion on this disk, with all midpoint offsets retained. Its leading factors and $-A_{xx}(x_*)$ never vanish. Multiplication gives the whole packet expansion with phase (E.20), uniformly for the fixed tree.

Useful explicit nonlinear constants follow from (E.19). Let $\sigma = \sinh(r/2)$, $k = \cosh(r/2) - 1$, $C = (1 - \sigma^4)^{-1/2}$. The normalized diagonal error is at most $2kC/(1-k) + C - 1 < 1/50$, and the off-diagonal bound is $\sigma^2 C$; their sum is below $1/25$. For example $k < 0.008$, $\sigma < 0.126$ prove these estimates. Set $\delta = 1/50$, $\varepsilon = 1/25$. Edgewise summation gives

$$|\mathcal{E}_v/\tau_v| \le \delta a_v, \qquad \sum_w |\mathcal{E}_{vw}| \le \varepsilon a_v, \qquad |\mathcal{E}(\boldsymbol{\tau})| \le \tfrac{\varepsilon}{2} \sum_v a_v |\tau_v|^2. \tag{E.23}$$

The quotient extends at $\tau_v = 0$. For the first bound integrate the diagonal Hessian error with other coordinates fixed. The last bound uses $2|zw| \le |z|^2 + |w|^2$ on each edge, not a dimension-dependent maximum-norm estimate.

### E.2.6 A uniform raw angular Gaussian

For $k/N \in I$ the exact product is

$$\frac{e_k(-2\cos t)}{e_k(-2)} = \prod_{j<k} \left( 1 - \frac{\sin^2(t/2)}{\cos^2((j+1/2)\pi/N)} \right). \tag{E.24}$$

Put $u = \sin^2(t/2)$ for real $t$. The first $\lfloor N/5 \rfloor$ factors have absolute value at most $1 - \alpha_1 u$, $\alpha_1 = 2\sqrt{5} - 4$; the remaining at most $N/10 + 1$ factors are bounded by $1 + \alpha_2 u$, $\alpha_2 = 2\sqrt{5}/5$. These

follow by checking the two linear pieces of $|1-u/c|$ with $c \ge \cos^2(\pi/5)$ and $c \ge \cos^2(3\pi/10)$, respectively. Therefore

$$\left|\frac{e_k(-2\cos t)}{e_k(-2)}\right| \le e^2 e^{-\alpha N \sin^2(t/2)}, \qquad \alpha = \frac{9\sqrt{5}-20}{25} > \frac{1}{250}. \tag{E.25}$$

For complex $t+iy$, $|y| \le 1$, one factor's squared modulus is at most its real squared value plus $18y^2$. Indeed its denominator $c > 1/3$, its real absolute value is below two, $\cosh y - 1 \le y^2$, and $|\sinh y| \le 2|y|$. The real linear majorants above are at least $1/2$; consequently the additional factor is at most $e^{36y^2}$. Since $k \le 3N/10$,

$$|e_k(-2\cos(t+iy))| \le e^2 e_k(-2) e^{N[-\alpha \sin^2(t/2)+11y^2]}. \tag{E.26}$$

Use $\sin^2(t/2) \ge t^2/\pi^2$ for $|t| \le \pi$. Summing the positive edge references and retaining the bounded edge insertions yields

$$|B_N(\mathbf{t}+i\mathbf{y}, s)| \le N^A \exp N \left[F_0 - \frac{1}{400}\sum_v a_v t_v^2 + 70 \sum_v a_v y_v^2\right]. \tag{E.27}$$

We used $2\alpha/\pi > 1/400$, $22\pi < 70$. Endpoint translations $O_R(N^{-1})$ affect only prefactors.

### E.2.7 Critical branches without reciprocal-slope smallness

Set

$$b_v = n_v/(2\pi), \quad D_v = a_v - ib_v, \quad t_0 = 1/16, \quad L_v = \lfloor t_0 |D_v| \rfloor. \tag{E.28}$$

Condition (E.9) implies $|D_v| > 32$ for all $v$, so $L_v \ge 1$. For real continuous $0 \le \ell_v \le L_v$, the critical equation is

$$D_v \tau_v = -i\ell_v + \mathcal{E}_v(\boldsymbol{\tau}). \tag{E.29}$$

The right-hand map after division by $D_v$ is a contraction on the radius-$1/4$ polydisk, with Lipschitz constant at most $\varepsilon$. Its image has radius at most $t_0 + \delta/4 < 1/4$. Thus there is one analytic critical branch, also when some $n_v = 0$.

Writing $Q_v = \mathcal{E}_v/\tau_v$, the exact identity is

$$\tau_v = -i\ell_v/(D_v - Q_v). \tag{E.30}$$

For positive $\ell_v$, $\Im \tau_v < 0$. With

$$\gamma_+ = \frac{1+\delta}{(1-\delta)^2} = \frac{2550}{2401}, \qquad \gamma_- = \frac{1-\delta}{(1+\delta)^2} = \frac{2450}{2601}, \tag{E.31}$$

one obtains

$$\gamma_- \frac{\ell_v a_v}{|D_v|^2} \le -\Im \tau_v \le \gamma_+ \frac{\ell_v a_v}{|D_v|^2}. \tag{E.32}$$

For $\Phi_\ell = \Psi + \frac{i}{2}\sum b_v \tau_v^2 - i\sum \ell_v \tau_v$ and its stationary value $\mathcal{C}(\ell)$, $\partial_{\ell_v} \Re \mathcal{C} = \Im \tau_v$. Integration in the independent charges proves

$$\Re \mathcal{C}(\ell) \le \Re \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1}) - \frac{\gamma_-}{2} \sum_v \frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2}(\ell_v^2 - 1), \quad \ell_v \ge 1, \tag{E.33}$$

$$F_0 - \beta \le \Re\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1}) \le F_0, \qquad \beta = \frac{\gamma_+}{2}\sum_v \frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2} = \pi\gamma_+\mathfrak{S}. \tag{E.34}$$

Each positive-charge coordinate is nonzero and has modulus below $t_0/(1-\delta) < \pi/2$, so the actual factor $\prod \sin\tau_v$ is nonzero. On a real tangent the Hessian has real part at most $-(1-\varepsilon)\,\mathrm{diag}(a_v)$. The Gaussian determinant is nonzero.

### E.2.8 Infinite tails and connectors

Keep the exact full-normal charge coefficients

$$c_{\ell,N}(\sigma) = (-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)}U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma), \qquad c_{1,N} = 1. \tag{E.35}$$

Initially use formal parameter circles avoiding their removable sine denominators, as in the joint Fourier transform. Let $A_0 = 1/400$ and choose

$$y_v = A_0 t_0 a_v/|D_v|. \tag{E.36}$$

With spectators real or on physical translated grids, the exponent for this coordinate is bounded by

$$F_0 - a_v t^2/400 + |b_v t y_v| - \ell y_v + 70 a_v y_v^2. \tag{E.37}$$

After maximizing $t$, the positive quadratic coefficient is $70a_v + 100b_v^2/a_v \le 100|D_v|^2/a_v$. Since $L_v + 1 > t_0|D_v|$, every omitted charge loses at least

$$\tfrac{1}{2}A_0 t_0^2 a_v \ge 1/(409600\pi). \tag{E.38}$$

Further charges carry $e^{-N(\ell-L_v-1)y_v}$. The coefficient bound $\ell e^{2\pi R'(\ell-1)}$ is absorbed for large $N$ at this fixed tree.

Original endpoint loss is $\pi^2 a_v/400$. The chirp, finite-charge connector and imaginary Gaussian costs are bounded respectively by $\pi A_0 t_0 a_v$, $A_0 t_0^2 a_v$, and $70A_0^2 t_0^2 a_v$, less than half that loss in total. The zero-mode current obeys the same estimate. Exact telescoping of physical functionals and finite real-integral approximants therefore gives the finite-charge formula with (E.38). No spectator uses another coordinate's complex filling contour.

Next restrict real angles to $[-\rho,\rho]^m$, $\rho = 1/8$. The complement loses $1/(51200\pi)$ by (E.27). Translate this box to the imaginary part of its critical point. On any connector write $\tau_v = t_v - iv_v$, with $0 \le v_v \le -\Im\tau_{\ell,v}$. These points stay in the radius-1/4 polydisk. From (E.23) and Young's inequality,

$$\Re\Phi_\ell(\mathbf{t} - i\mathbf{v}) \le F_0 - \tfrac{1}{8}\sum_v a_v t_v^2 + \sum_v \left[\tfrac{1+\varepsilon}{2}a_v + \frac{2b_v^2}{(3-4\varepsilon)a_v}\right] v_v^2 - \sum_v \ell_v v_v. \tag{E.39}$$

The last two sums are at most $-\frac{1}{4}\sum_v \ell_v v_v$, because

$$\gamma_+ \max\{(1+\varepsilon)/2,\ 2/(3-4\varepsilon)\} < 3/4. \tag{E.40}$$

A connector face has some $|t_v| = \rho$, and hence loss at least $1/(1024\pi)$. This retains the negative Fourier contributions of all spectator coordinates instead of adding their imaginary growth costs independently. The translated real box has uniformly negative Hessian. Its translated horizontal integral has a relative Gaussian expansion at its own critical point. After

the connectors are restored, the estimate for a nonminimal charge is its saddle term plus $O(\mathrm{poly}(N)e^{N(F_0-\eta)})$, with $\eta$ as chosen below. A connector need not be below that nonminimal charge's much smaller critical action. It is below the first-charge action, which is all that is required: (E.33) and this additive error give strict first-charge dominance. Only the first charge is asserted to have a relative asymptotic for the original contour.

### E.2.9 The actual analytic conclusion

Allowing polynomial prefactors, all source, real-box and charge-tail errors above have loss at least

$$\eta = 1/(819200\pi). \tag{E.41}$$

The finite-sum contour errors have larger fixed edge losses from Section E.2.5. Condition (E.9) gives

$$\beta \le \pi(2550/2401)2^{-25} < \eta/2. \tag{E.42}$$

Thus all discarded errors lie below the same nonzero first-charge action. Only these fixed losses are compared with the total drop. The charge-dependent gaps (E.33) are compared directly with that filled action, not with the augmented reference.

The first coefficient (E.35) is exactly one for both parities. The entire difference of physical traces and their finite-charge approximation is holomorphic through the collisions. The maximum principle gives the estimates on every $|s| \le R < 1$, including actual constant and moving types, without assuming separate removability of divided endpoint currents.

The unchanged primitive count gives final power $N^{3/2}$. All original crossing, mixed-reference, pivot and zero-framing factors are retained exactly. The resulting reduced invariant has

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)} = A_N(s)H_N(s)(1 + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-1})), \qquad \frac{2\pi}{N}\log|F_N(q_N^s)| \longrightarrow 2\pi\Re\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1}), \tag{E.43}$$

uniformly on the disk, and is nonzero there for sufficiently large levels. The edge insertion rule also gives its cotangent correction at this same continued wire saddle. Section E.2.11 supplies its geometric volume and cusp interpretation.

### E.2.10 Explicit analytic nonvacuity

For a star with center degree $B$, arbitrary fixed center power $n_0$, and leaf powers $|n_j| \ge B$,

$$\mathfrak{S} = \frac{B}{B^2 + n_0^2} + \sum_{j=1}^{B} \frac{1}{1 + n_j^2} < 2/B. \tag{E.44}$$

Thus $B \ge 2^{26}$ suffices, even for short or zero $n_0$. For two adjacent centers each of degree $B+1$, with $B$ leaves at each and every leaf power of magnitude at least $B$, both center powers may be arbitrary fixed short integers: $\mathfrak{S} < 4/B$, so $B \ge 2^{27}$ suffices. The large constants reflect deliberately coarse global estimates. The general quantity (E.8) allows any number and arrangement of short high-degree circles within the sum budget.

There is also an intrinsic interpretation at the original complete auxiliary cusps. The marked peripheral calculation gives $U = \epsilon v - 2\pi i t$, $V = -2v$, with $v = \log[\sin \pi(x-t)/\sin \pi(x+t)]$. At completeness, $v_t = -2\pi c$, where $c = \cot(\pi x)$. Consequently the primitive cusp shape is

$$\tau_{\mathrm{aux}} = \frac{dV}{dU} = \frac{2ic}{1 - i\epsilon c}.$$

The complete tree geometry, Section 5, gives $c_v = 1/d_v$ for the circle of degree $d_v$. For the original filling slope $\mu_v + p_v \lambda_v$, direct substitution now gives

$$\mathcal{L}_v^2 = \frac{|1 + p_v \tau_{\mathrm{aux},v}|^2}{\Im \tau_{\mathrm{aux},v}} = \frac{1 + n_v^2 c_v^2}{2c_v} = \frac{d_v^2 + n_v^2}{2d_v}, \qquad \mathfrak{S} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_v \mathcal{L}_v^{-2}. \tag{E.45}$$

Here $\mathcal{L}_v$ is the length of the actual primitive filling slope divided by the square root of cusp area; the retained half-twist is included through $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$. Thus (E.9) is equivalently $\sum_v \mathcal{L}_v^{-2} \le 2^{-24}$ for this class. This is a translation of the analytic hypothesis using the proved cusp shape, not an imported geometric filling criterion.

These examples retain the original knot/parity qualification. Some star presentations overlap the existing long-pretzel and fixed-outer-power belt-stack results; zero boxes may admit the already known topological reduction. The graph-wide analytic criterion does not use those reductions.

### E.2.11 Identification with the knot volume

Small angular variables do not imply that the primitive meridian logarithms are small: a high-degree circle collects contributions from many edges. The geometric proof therefore follows the entire path of filling equations, with its logarithm branches retained.

The ordered decomposition cuts the original augmented exterior into two octahedra per tree edge. Its literal strand matchings retain every face pairing, half twist and primitive peripheral path. The angular construction subdivides these octahedra into eight positive tetrahedra per edge on the chart $|\tau_v| < 10^{-2}$. Section E.2.7 places the whole path

$$\Psi_{\tau_v} + \frac{i n_v \tau_v}{2\pi} = ic, \qquad 0 \le c \le 1,$$

inside this chart. The completion proof computes the actual periods

$$U_v = -2\pi \Psi_{\tau_v} - i\epsilon_v \tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v, \qquad U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i c.$$

It verifies that the primitive slope bounds a tube of cone angle $2\pi c$. At $c = 1$ the tube is smooth, the auxiliary fillings are precisely the original surgeries, and the main knot cusp remains complete. The same proof fixes the additive volume constant at the complete augmented link and integrates the boundary-corrected action. It gives

$$2\pi \operatorname{Re} \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1}) = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K). \tag{E.46}$$

Thus the analytic conclusion above is an actual uniform volume theorem under (E.9). The preferred-cusp continuation also identifies the first correction geometrically. This establishes the summed criterion, not arbitrary short fillings or a criterion for graphs with cycles.

### E.2.12 Reproducing the edge calculations

The elementary Newton estimates give a second direct proof of the uniform discarded-state and complex-strip bounds. The exact edge equations and finite samples of that strip inequality can be checked with:

```
python3 repro/run_research_checks.py curvature-fillings
```

The script verifies four symbolic identities and samples the printed complex inequality at both even and odd levels. Its recorded output states that finite scope. The uniform inequalities, contour argument and asymptotic conclusion are proved above; the script does not establish geometric completion.

## E.3 Uniform Newton bounds with explicit constants

The separately available version of this section is uniform newton bounds with explicit constants. The proof is reproduced here in full.

This section proves two uniform estimates used in the quantitative filling limit. It does not identify a complex critical value with the volume of a filled complement. The latter still requires the original marked geometry and smooth completion.

Fix a finite ordered tree. Every vertex carries its actual crossing-circle operator, including the degree-one vertices. Write $d_v$ for a vertex degree and $a_v = d_v/(2\pi)$. All graph data and integer crossing powers are fixed before the level $N$ tends to infinity. Constants in polynomial prefactors may depend on these fixed data. The exponential constants below do not depend on the tree.

### E.3.1 A uniform loss outside the retained interval

Use the fixed complete Newton basis, the physical diagonal edge factors, the full value-and-first-derivative norm, and the fixed-power crossing bounds from the full polynomial trace bounds. A low basis element has norm at most a polynomial times $\exp(Ng(k/N))$; a high basis element has polynomial norm. Here

$$g(x) = J(2x) - 4J(x), \qquad J(x) = \int_0^x \log(2\sin \pi u)\, du,$$

$$g'(x) = 2\log\cot(\pi x), \qquad g''(x) = -\frac{4\pi}{\sin(2\pi x)} \le -4\pi.$$

Thus, with $G_0 = g(1/4)$,

$$g(x) \le G_0 - 2\pi(x - 1/4)^2.$$

Each physical edge index occurs at its two ends. Quotient multiplication, a fixed crossing power, and the trace cost only a polynomial in the full norm. Consequently the absolute scalar sum is bounded by a polynomial times the sum of the products of the squared basis bounds. There are only polynomially many edge-index assignments for a fixed tree. Its complete maximum is $F_0 = 2|E|G_0$.

Retain the interval $I = [1/5, 3/10]$ on every edge. A low edge outside $I$ loses at least $\pi/100$ in this rate. A high edge loses $2G_0$, which is larger. The sum of every discarded assignment therefore has upper rate at most

$$F_0 - \pi/100 + o(1).$$

Equivalently, any fixed loss strictly smaller than $\pi/100$, such as $\pi/200$, holds with a polynomial prefactor for all sufficiently large levels. This statement retains both level parities and every first normal. It uses no comparison with a complete tensor at the same high index.

### E.3.2 An elementary Gaussian bound on the complex angular strip

Let $N \geq 160$ and $k/N \in I$. Put

$$r_j = \cos \frac{(2j+1)\pi}{N}, \qquad Q_r(z) = \frac{r + \cos z}{1 + r}.$$

The exact normalized basis value is

$$\frac{e_k(-2\cos z)}{e_k(-2)} = \prod_{j=0}^{k-1} Q_{r_j}(z).$$

Although some individual factors have a negative constant Laurent coefficient, those factors can be paired before taking absolute values.

Reserve the first $m = \lfloor N/32 \rfloor$ factors. Their parameters satisfy $r_j \geq \cos(\pi/16) > 9/10$. There are at most $h \leq N/20 + 1$ negative parameters, all greater than $\cos(3\pi/5) > -2/5$. Pair each of these with a different parameter from the next $h$ positions after the reserved ones. These positions are disjoint from the negative ones and have parameter at least $\cos(\pi/4) > 7/10$, because $m + h \leq N/8$. Every remaining unpaired parameter is nonnegative.

For a pair $r > -2/5$, $s > 7/10$, the reciprocal polynomial

$$(u^2 + 2ru + 1)(u^2 + 2su + 1)$$

has coefficients $1, 2(r+s), 2+4rs, 2(r+s), 1$, all nonnegative. After division by its value at $u = 1$ and multiplication by $u^{-2}$, these are the weights of a symmetric probability measure supported on $\{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2\}$. A remaining single nonnegative factor has the analogous interpretation on $\{-1, 0, 1\}$. For such a factor of Laurent degree $b$,

$$|Q(t + iy)| \leq \cosh(by) \leq \exp(b^2 y^2/2).$$

The reserved factors supply the real angular decay. If $r \geq 9/10$ and $w = \sin^2(t/2)$, then

$$|Q_r(t)| = \left|1 - \frac{2w}{1 + r}\right| \leq 1 - w/2.$$

For $|y| \leq 1/4$, the identity

$$|r + \cos(t + iy)|^2 = (r + \cos t)^2 + 2r\cos t(\cosh y - 1) + \sinh^2 y$$

and $2(\cosh y - 1) + \sinh^2 y \leq 4y^2$ give

$$|Q_r(t + iy)|^2 \leq 1 - w/2 + 4y^2, \qquad |Q_r(t + iy)| \leq \exp(-w/4 + 2y^2).$$

Since $m \geq N/40$, multiplication gives the deliberately conservative bound

$$\boxed{\left|\frac{e_k(-2\cos(t+iy))}{e_k(-2)}\right| \leq \exp N\left\{-\frac{\sin^2(t/2)}{160}+4y^2\right\}.}$$

For $|t| \leq \pi$, use $\sin^2(t/2) \geq t^2/\pi^2$. Multiply the bound over the incidence factors of the original finite packet, retain the bounded physical edge factors, and sum its polynomially many indices. One obtains

$$|B_N(\mathbf{t}+i\mathbf{y},s)| \leq CN^A \exp N\left\{F_0 - \frac{1}{400}\sum_v a_v t_v^2 + 70\sum_v a_v y_v^2\right\}, \qquad |s| \leq R < 1.$$

Indeed the stronger constants from the preceding calculation are $1/(80\pi)$ and $8\pi$. The displayed constants leave room for the physical translated endpoints of size $O_R(N^{-1})$, which change the exponent by a bounded amount for a fixed graph and fixed strip. No assertion here concerns a growing graph as $N$ tends to infinity.

### E.3.3 The explicit action of one edge

The two-ended Newton action is the critical value in $x$ of

$$R(x,t)+R(x,u), \qquad R(x,t)=\int_0^x \log(2\cos(2\pi v)+2\cos t)\,dv - 2J(x).$$

The logarithm is continued from $(x,t,u)=(1/4,0,0)$. Put $p=\tan(t/2)$, $q=\tan(u/2)$. The wire critical equation gives

$$\tan^2(\pi x)=\frac{1}{1+p^2+q^2}.$$

If $\psi(t,u)$ denotes the selected critical value, direct differentiation of the integral yields

$$\psi_t = -\frac{1}{\pi}\operatorname{arsinh}\frac{p}{\sqrt{1+q^2}},$$

$$\psi''(t,u)=\frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{1+p^2+q^2}}\begin{pmatrix}-(1+p^2) & pq\\ pq & -(1+q^2)\end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det\psi''=\frac{1}{4\pi^2}.$$

All square roots and inverse functions use their branches at the origin. The full packet action is the sum over its physical edges. Its Hessian at zero is therefore $-\operatorname{diag}(d_v/(2\pi))$. On the real angular chamber the edge Hessian is strictly negative definite. For the complex contours, this real statement must be supplemented by an explicit holomorphic bound; it does not prove global complex nondegeneracy or the geometric filling assertion.

# Appendix F

# The ordered octahedral geometry and the filled cusp

This appendix supplies the geometric proof for Theorem 9.1. It starts with the actual ordered tangle diagram and identifies its projection cut, rather than recovering a manifold from a scalar identity. Section F.1 constructs the two-octahedron block at every physical tree edge and tracks the primitive peripheral curves. Section F.2 gives positive tetrahedral shapes and the complete face maps. Section F.3 completes the original fillings and calibrates their volume. Section F.4 follows the preferred main longitude.

An ideal vertex lies at the sphere at infinity of hyperbolic space. An ordered ideal tetrahedron is specified by its cross ratio; a positive shape has positive imaginary part in the chosen orientation. A logarithmic peripheral period records the full change of a continued logarithm along a marked cusp curve. It is not reduced modulo $2\pi i$. This distinction matters here: each local angular parameter remains small, but the primitive meridian collects contributions from all incident edge blocks. Its total logarithm reaches one full turn at the smooth filling endpoint.

The shaded faces below come from cutting the original twice-punctured crossing disks; the white faces come from the projection regions. Their labels determine the gluing maps and the original cyclic order. The word "pants" denotes the two-triangle thrice-punctured sphere obtained by joining the projection copies of a disk-side face. It always retains its three labeled punctures. The local Möbius maps $C$ and $T$ realize the closing and turn operations in the displayed coordinate charts. The symbol $R$ in those charts is a normalized ideal vertex parameter, distinguished from the crossing operator by its definition in Section F.2.1.

## F.1 The ordered octahedral decomposition

The separately available version of this section is the ordered octahedral decomposition. The proof is reproduced here in full.

A crossing circle surrounds two strands of a link and bounds a disk punctured by them. Cutting along the projection regions and these disks opens the augmented link exterior into two balls. For the ordered tangle constructions considered here, each ball can be assembled from octahedra, with one octahedron for each edge of the tangle-operation tree. The proof identifies every boundary vertex and face, so it also identifies the original meridians and disk

longitudes after the pieces are joined.

The tangles have two strings and four ordered endpoints. Their operations are vertical stacking, quarter-turns in the projection plane, and the specified cylindrical closure. Every product junction in the reduced operation tree carries an original crossing circle; there are no junctions without a circle. The tree, the order of its branches, and all endpoint frames are retained throughout. Faces created by opening crossing disks are called shaded faces; the pieces of the projection regions are called white faces.

This is the topological input for the quantitative volume theorem. The angular cell calculation provides positive shapes for its octahedra, and the completion theorem uses the path supplied by the analytic filling criterion. The present proof concerns the augmented exterior before filling.

### F.1.1 The actual ordered object and the statement

At each vertex $v$ of a finite tree put an original two-strand crossing-circle tangle $P_v$. It retains the crossing $R^{\epsilon_v}$, where $\epsilon_v \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$, and its auxiliary component bounds the original twice-punctured disk. Every edge is an actual quarter-turn between two ordered product junctions. There are no product junctions without their own original circle. Terminal circles are included as vertices of degree one. The tree has at least one edge. Write $T$ for the actual quarter-turn, $C$ for the cylindrical closure, and $R$ for one positive braid crossing in the original ordered terminal frame.

The product order, the four endpoint frames, every rotation of a child ball, and every original disk orientation are part of the data. A representative recursive description has

$$W_v = P_v \prod_{w \text{ child of } v} T(W_w). \tag{F.1}$$

The product here is in its specified order. At the closing sphere one may use the actual collar move to expose a root circle. A double turn then leaves its actual half-turn decoration on the affected subtree; it is not replaced by the scalar identity $T^2 = 1$. The relevant moves are the literal closed-turn and cyclic collar isotopies in the original ordered tangle moves, equations (14)–(18). Their four collar sectors, and any reversal of the child order, are retained. Thus (F.1), with those transported frames, describes the original all-circle ordered operation tree. It does not introduce a commutativity move on open two-tangles.

For clarity, the literal root adapter is

$$C(h_0 T(E)) = C((TP_0)T(E)) \simeq C\Big(P_0\, T^2(E)\Big) = C(P_0\, \tau(E))\,. \tag{F.2}$$

Here $\tau$ is the actual half-turn of the ball. If $E = L_1 \cdots L_k$, then $\tau(E) = \tau(L_k) \cdots \tau(L_1)$, and $\tau(TW) = T\tau(W)$. Thus the adapter reverses the displayed root order and transports every child frame; it does not suppress this rotation. The two-leaf case of (F.2) is the base used below.

More generally the original circle coupon can occur between two ordered lists of child factors in a nonroot junction. Keep that position:

$$W_v = \left(\prod_{w \in I_v^-} T(W_w)\right) P_v \left(\prod_{w \in I_v^+} T(W_w)\right). \tag{F.3}$$

The lists record the cut at the parent edge in the original cyclic order. The left-insertion version of the calculation below handles this form without moving $P_v$ through a child. Reassociation of a stack and transport of genuine turn-chain rotations put the literal circle-only tree in this form. At the root only the actual cyclic closed-collar move is used to choose its cutting position.

Write $E$ for the number of tree edges, $V = E + 1$ for the number of circles, and $d_v$ for the number of edges incident to circle $v$. The exterior admits the following labeled cut:

- There is one pair of octahedral balls per original tree edge.
- At a circle $v$, its incident edge blocks are joined in the original cyclic order. There are $d_v$ disk-side pages, and exactly one of their cyclic seams retains the original disk identification and its $\epsilon_v$ crossing. All other page seams are the untwisted labeled identity seams supplied by the ordered insertion.
- Cutting open those distinguished disk seams and the projection faces gives two balls. Each is a tree of $E$ octahedra attached along $E - 1$ triangular faces. Its remaining boundary has exactly the two original shaded triangles of every crossing circle and the original white face cycles.

Here an octahedron means the explicitly labeled topological cell. The angular charts give its positive shapes. The topological proof does not require the union of several cells to be convex.

### F.1.2 How endpoint pairings determine the cut

Use the closed-cut convention of the projection and crossing-disk cut, sections 2–4. For the turned elementary leaf $h_v = T(P_v)$, label its four physical half-segments

$$(v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3) = (\text{lower left}, \text{lower right}, \text{upper right}, \text{upper left}). \tag{F.4}$$

A quarter-turn cyclically shifts this tuple. A lower factor $F$ followed by an upper factor $G$ joins $F_2$ to $G_1$ and $F_3$ to $G_0$, leaving exposed $(F_0, F_1, G_2, G_3)$. Cylindrical closure joins positions 0 to 3 and 1 to 2. These are actual empty joining strips in the projection plane.

One ideal vertex is assigned to each paired main segment and one vertex $O_v$ to each original crossing-circle semicircle. The two shaded triangles of a leaf are

$$(O_v, v_1, v_2), \qquad (O_v, v_3, v_0), \tag{F.5}$$

where a half-segment in this display denotes the main-segment vertex containing it. Around $O_v$ the cyclic order is $(v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3)$. At a main-segment vertex the two shaded corner sectors concatenate in the order of the actual planar joining strip. These sectors determine all white face cycles by the usual boundary walk. In particular the full oriented boundary ribbon graph follows from the literal matching; matching only face or component counts would not suffice.

This endpoint construction records the reversible projection/disk cut. Drilling a boundary-parallel auxiliary semicircle and then opening its recorded half disk restores a ball. The disjoint leaf boxes permit this for all circles. White faces reglue by their actual projection labels. The two shaded faces reglue by the original disk map, including the retained half twist. The proof of that cut uses no quantum source identity.

For the next local calculation it is useful to use an inverse turn:

$$P_v = T^{-1}(h_v), \qquad \text{its exposed tuple is } (v_3, v_0, v_1, v_2). \tag{F.6}$$

This is an exact physical identity by the definition of $h_v$. It avoids using $T^2 = 1$ on an arbitrary physical tangle.

### F.1.3 One terminal insertion is exactly one octahedron

Suppose the unturned $P_v$ occurs at the beginning of its specified local stack. In the current full diagram, let $x_1$ and $x_2$ be the half-segments matched to $v_1$ and $v_2$ outside that box. Insert a new terminal child $h_w$ immediately after $P_v$. The literal product rule changes precisely the following two matches:

| before | after | |
|---|---|---|
| $v_1 - x_1$ | $v_1 - w_1,$ | $w_2 - x_1$ |
| $v_2 - x_2$ | $v_2 - w_0,$ | $w_3 - x_2.$ |

(F.7)

All other half-segment matches are unchanged. This remains true if $x_1$ or $x_2$ is in a nested factor or outside the local ball: the replacement only uses the two exposed output strips of $P_v$.

Name the old two vertices $C = (v_1, x_1)$, $B = (v_2, x_2)$, and name the new internal vertices $D = (v_1, w_1)$, $A = (v_2, w_0)$. The outside vertices $C$ and $B$ are now represented respectively by $(w_2, x_1)$ and $(w_3, x_2)$. Attach the octahedron with vertices

$$(O_v, O_w, A, B, C, D). \tag{F.8}$$

and equatorial cycle $(A, B, C, D)$. Its four shaded triangles are

$$(O_v, B, C), \quad (O_v, D, A), \quad (O_w, D, C), \quad (O_w, B, A). \tag{F.9}$$

Glue the first one to the old shaded face $(O_v, C, B)$. The two orientations are opposite, as required for joining oriented balls. The old face disappears. The second triangle in (F.9) is exactly the new $v$ face in (F.5), and the last two are exactly the new $w$ faces. The other shaded face of $v$ is untouched.

The four white triangles are the complementary octahedral faces. Along the three edges of the glued triangle, their unions with the old white pieces are precisely the new white regions. One can verify this directly: at each of $B, C, O_v$ remove the two glued shaded sectors and concatenate the remaining sectors; their order is exactly the planar strip substitution (F.7). The new vertices $A, D$ carry the new identity strips in that same order. Thus every remaining shaded sector and every cyclic vertex order agrees with the endpoint construction. Following these sectors around each white face therefore gives the same boundary cycle.

Perform the same attachment in the other projection copy. This adds exactly one two-octahedron edge block and introduces one new original circle. It neither identifies two old circles nor inserts a circle at the attachment seam.

The calculation also proves the inverse operation: remove a terminal edge block, restore the deleted triangular face, and undo (F.7). The original diagram loses that terminal child and otherwise retains its actual strand connections and order.

There is also an explicit left-insertion version, needed for (F.3). Inserting $h_w$ immediately before $P_v$ changes

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| $v_3 - x_3$ | $v_3 - w_3,$ | $w_0 - x_3$ |
| $v_0 - x_0$ | $v_0 - w_2,$ | $w_1 - x_0.$ |

(F.10)

This is the same octahedral attachment on the other shaded face $(O_v, v_3, v_0)$. The two formulas are direct applications of the same lower-output/upper-input stack rule. They retain the physical rotation of each tangle and all its endpoint labels.

### F.1.4 Why this covers every ordered tree

Start with one actual tree edge. The two-leaf matching gives exactly the octahedral boundary (F.9), in both projection copies. This is the labeled two-circle block, after the recorded endpoint-frame rotation. Its proof is a disk/projection cut, not an equality of two scalar sources.

For a general tree, choose a terminal vertex as root and start with its unique incident edge. Expose that root by the actual closed-collar moves from section F.1.1, retaining all transported frames and orders. The initial root then has no further children to insert; at the other endpoint the only existing edge is its parent edge. At each vertex add the children on the right of $P_v$ in reverse final order, always immediately after $P_v$. Add the children on its left in their final order, always immediately before $P_v$. This is a construction of the specified word, not a permutation of an existing word: successive insertions produce exactly the two ordered lists in (F.3), including the special case (F.1). A new child initially has only its own crossing-circle tangle; its children are subsequently inserted inside its own ball. Its actual quarter-turn carries the whole local insertion, including the two projection sides and all four endpoint labels. Any previously recorded half-turn or input/output reversal similarly carries the complete insertion and its order. It does not remove the frame decoration.

Induction now gives exactly the original recursive word and its full boundary ribbon graph. Every step glues a ball along a triangular disk, so each projection copy stays a ball. There are $E - 1$ attachments after the initial octahedron. The shaded face count is

$$4E - 2(E - 1) = 2V. \tag{F.11}$$

The count is only a consistency check: the insertion proof has already identified each of these two faces with its particular original circle and each main-segment vertex with its literal pair.

The equality of oriented ribbon graphs gives a label-preserving homeomorphism of the final boundary spheres. Extend it over the balls by a ball extension. All original white and disk-face pairing maps are matched, hence the quotient is the original link exterior. This is stronger than an identification of the unmarked manifold: the main arcs, individual auxiliary circles, disk sides, and their specified collar paths are preserved.

The extra triangular interfaces provide the promised pages. In the whole exterior an upper interface triangle and its lower partner form a two-triangle, thrice-punctured sphere. The ends are the same original circle and its two physical main punctures. Its compactification is a twice-punctured spanning disk for that circle. These pages are obtained from the explicit cell subdivision and the preceding homeomorphism; we did not assume that a single original disk cut somehow creates all $d_v$ pages. The insertion order places the pages consecutively in exactly the original cyclic order at that circle. There are $d_v - 1$ new seams there, plus the original distinguished disk seam.

### F.1.5 Retained half twists and reversed disk frames

First perform the projection construction with the disk cuts open. A retained crossing changes their regluing, not the half-segment compiler of the open cut. At each v keep its original

distinguished seam throughout all insertions. Its original disk map is used once, after the untwisted page attachments. Thus no crossing is distributed among several edges, and no crossing is silently added at a new seam.

For $\epsilon_v = 0$ the original pure disk map pairs the two sides within the same projection copy. For $\epsilon_v = +1$ or $-1$ use its actual odd pairings: the punctures exchange and the two projection copies are permuted as in the original A,B disk maps. The signs +1 and -1 have their distinct primitive meridian words even though their endpoint permutation has the same parity. The explicit collar permutation is also recorded in the original half-twist collar, section 3a. A full twist changes the peripheral marking and must not be discarded simply because its endpoint permutation is trivial.

A physical rotation or reflection of a disk frame transports its puncture labels, its two pages, and its chosen meridian and longitude together. Apply the insertion table in that transported frame. In particular a reversal that exchanges the projection copies is applied to both halves of every incident block. There is no use of an arbitrary puncture permutation justified only by the rigidity of an abstract thrice-punctured sphere.

These conventions cover the original signed and reversed diagrams. The local geometric block may be relabeled by these same actual rotations. Its shape formula is not used to determine the topology.

### F.1.6 Exact primitive peripheral concatenation

Fix one auxiliary circle $v$ and orient its original disk-framed longitude $\lambda_v$ and meridian $\mu_v$ as in the original marked leaf theorem. After the page cut, a small cusp torus of $v$ consists of $d_v$ annular sectors, one from each incident edge block. Every page boundary on this torus is the same primitive disk-longitude class. A small meridian crosses these sectors once in their cyclic order. The insertion (F.7) subdivides one such transverse passage into two consecutive passages; it neither winds the meridian a second time nor changes its longitude class.

This can also be read as a face-word statement. Each insertion replaces one original disk-face passage by two passages separated by the new triangular interface. In the final word all internal interface changes of coordinates occur in inverse consecutive pairs. After eliminating them, the retained word is the original disk meridian. Its ordered factors are one endpoint passage for each incident block, followed at the distinguished seam by the single original half-twist correction. This is a statement about the actual marked loop before evaluating its holonomy.

Use the local angular chart, with common oriented longitude variable $\tau_v$ at all pages of this circle. Its incoming/outgoing edge-ratio tables give exactly the inverse seam maps with the just-established puncture matching. In one edge block its small pure meridional increment is

$$u_{v,e} = -2\pi\,\partial_{\tau_v}\psi_e, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v. \tag{F.12}$$

This is the local primitive word, not an arbitrary logarithm of its multiplier. The longitude conjugates to the same element on all pages. Whenever it is loxodromic, its two fixed points are therefore carried to the same two marked points. In a coordinate with one at infinity and the other at $q$, integrate $d\log(z-q)$. The coordinate changes telescope in the concatenated path; the integral is the sum of the local increments (F.12). At the complete value it is the continuous limit of this equality.

The original disk words fix the half-twist correction unambiguously. In the notation of the marked-leaf theorem, the pure meridian has multiplier $\rho$, and the two odd primitive words have multipliers $\rho Q$ and $\rho/Q$. Write $\nu$ for the local leaf response, so $Q = e^{-\nu} = e^{i\tau_v}$ and $\nu = -i\tau_v$. The physical $R^{-1}$ tangle uses the first word and $R$ uses the second. Thus the single retained crossing contributes $\epsilon_v\nu = -i\epsilon_v\tau_v$, or equivalently $-\epsilon_v V_v/2$. Consequently the actual continued primitive logs are

$$U_v = -2\pi \sum_{e\sim v} \partial_{\tau_v}\psi_e - i\epsilon_v\tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v. \tag{F.13}$$

The original proof of these primitive words is the original marked face maps, sections 5–6, including its equations (15)–(18). The two-rectangle cusp lattice there certifies their primitivity. Our page insertion preserves those same paths; it does not choose a new rational meridian slope.

In particular the integral in (F.13) is not reset to a principal logarithm after several pages. Each summand follows its local small branch, and the actual concatenated loop retains their full sum. This is precisely where a large total logarithm can occur while every individual block stays in its small positive chart.

Along the continuous first-charge equations, with charge $c \in [0, 1]$,

$$\partial_{\tau_v}\Psi + \frac{in_v}{2\pi}\tau_v = ic, \qquad \Psi = \sum_e \psi_e, \qquad n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v, \tag{F.14}$$

(F.13) gives the exact original primitive filling word

$$U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi ic. \tag{F.15}$$

At $c = 1$ this is one primitive turn. This calculation identifies the word and its continued logarithm. The completion proof verifies the positive-cell and nonsingular cusp-link conditions along the path and deduces the smooth complete filling.

### F.1.7 From the cut to the geometric filling

This proof applies to the actual ordered circle-only tree, with all its inherited frames and disk collars. It does not assert such a cut for an arbitrary scalar tensor network, for arbitrary branching of six independent boundary slots, or for a graph with cycles. It uses neither commutativity of pair-algebra polynomials nor equality of source actions. No auxiliary component is filled or deleted in the topological identification.

The explicit terminal substitution (F.7), its ribbon-face realization (F.9), and the primitive path concatenation supply the ordered topological identification. The local angular charts give the positive cells and their full complex seam ratios. The analytic criterion constructs the charge path, and the geometric completion proves that its endpoint is a smooth complete metric on the stated filled topology.

## F.2 Positive angular coordinates on each edge block

The separately available version of this section is positive angular coordinates on each edge block. The proof is reproduced here in full.

Each edge in an ordered tree of crossing circles contributes two octahedra to the cut link exterior, one in each projection copy. This section gives their vertices and tetrahedron shapes as explicit functions of the two endpoint longitude parameters. The shapes remain positive on a fixed complex disk, independently of the size of the tree. The two-triangle disk boundaries depend only on their own circle parameter, which is what allows incident blocks with different other endpoints to be joined.

The ordered decomposition identifies these cells and all their labels with the original link exterior. The completion proof then follows their actual logarithmic periods to the smooth filling. These are the geometric inputs to the quantitative volume theorem, whose angular path is supplied by the analytic criterion.

### F.2.1 The actual two-leaf model

Start with the literal two-leaf closure $C(h_0T(h_1))$. At a pure leaf use the original coordinates below. Here $T$ is the quarter-turn, $C$ is the cylindrical closure, and $h_j$ is the turned two-strand piece with its original crossing circle.

$$Q = (0, \infty, 1, R), \qquad Z = \frac{1+E}{1+H}, \qquad E = e^{2\pi i x}, \quad H = e^{2\pi i t}, \quad R = \frac{H(1+E)^2}{E(1+H)^2}. \tag{F.16}$$

The parameter $R$ in this display is the fourth normalized ideal vertex of the quadrilateral. The second projection copy has apex $Z/E$, not a conjugation of the free parameters. The original turn and root closing maps are

$$T(z) = \frac{R_1 - 1}{z - 1}, \qquad C(z) = \frac{z - R}{z - 1}, \qquad R_1 = 1 - R. \tag{F.17}$$

These are the actual maps of the original marked face maps, equations (11), (14), and the original closed projection cut. In particular both maps must be used when placing the second leaf. Applying only the turn would put the two complete apices at the same point.

The complete two-leaf wire is $x = 1/4$. In each projection ball, the two ideal pyramids are joined along their ordered quadrilateral bases. Their six outer vertices form an octahedron. This is a literal local cut statement, not a deduction from its volume.

### F.2.2 Solving in the two angular longitude variables

Write $\tau_0 = \tau$, $\tau_1 = \upsilon$, and prescribe the actual disk longitude logarithms

$$V_j = 2i\tau_j. \tag{F.18}$$

The pure leaf relation gives $v_j = -i\tau_j$, where $v_j = \log[\sin \pi(x - t_j)/\sin \pi(x + t_j)]$. On the branch through completeness, put

$$y = \tan(\tau/2), \qquad z = \tan(\upsilon/2), \qquad k = (1 + y^2 + z^2)^{-1/2}, \qquad k(0,0) = 1. \tag{F.19}$$

Then the exact solution of the two-leaf stationarity equations is

$$\begin{aligned} \tan(\pi x) &= k, \\ \tan(\pi t_0) &= iky, \qquad & \tan(\pi t_1) &= ikz, \\ E &= \frac{1+ik}{1-ik}, \qquad & H_0 &= \frac{1-ky}{1+ky}, \quad H_1 = \frac{1-kz}{1+kz}, \\ R &= \frac{1+z^2}{2+y^2+z^2}, \qquad & R_1 &= 1-R, \\ Z_j &= \frac{1+E}{1+H_j}. \end{aligned} \tag{F.20}$$

Indeed the logarithmic ratio equation first gives $\tan \pi t_j = ik \tan(\tau_j/2)$. Its ordered metric is

$$\kappa_j = \frac{k^2(1+\tan^2(\tau_j/2))}{1-k^2\tan^2(\tau_j/2)}. \tag{F.21}$$

The wire equation is $\kappa_0\kappa_1 = 1$. With $a = y^2+z^2$, it factors as $(k^2+1)((1+a)k^2-1) = 0$; the complete branch is (F.19). Thus $\kappa_0 = (1+y^2)/(1+z^2)$, which yields (F.20). No meridian-color approximation was used.

The two octahedra have the same equator $q = (0, \infty, 1, R)$, and apices

| | $A$ | $B$ |
|---|---|---|
| $+$ | $Z_0$ | $\dfrac{RZ_1}{Z_1 - R_1}$ |
| $-$ | $Z_0/E$ | $\dfrac{RZ_1}{Z_1 - ER_1}$. |

(F.22)

For example, composing (F.17) gives $C(T(Z_1)) = RZ_1/(Z_1 - R_1)$. Replacing the second-copy apex by $Z_1/E$ gives the last entry. At zero the two rows are

$$(A_+, B_+) = ((1+i)/2, (1-i)/2), \qquad (A_-, B_-) = ((1-i)/2, (1+i)/2). \tag{F.23}$$

The corresponding complete cells are the regular octahedra in their opposite labeled orientations.

### F.2.3 Uniform positive tetrahedra on an explicit complex bidisk

Subdivide the plus octahedron into the four tetrahedra with ordered vertices $(A_+, B_+, q_j, q_{j+1})$, $j$ mod 4. Reverse the last two vertices in the minus copy. Use the cross ratio

$$[a, b, c, d] = \frac{(a-c)(b-d)}{(a-d)(b-c)}. \tag{F.24}$$

All eight complete shapes are $i$. This triangulates the actual two-pyramid union, with the internal diagonal joining its two apices.

There is a uniform positive chart on

$$|\tau|, |\upsilon| \le 10^{-2}. \tag{F.25}$$

Here are deliberately loose explicit bounds. The elementary sine and cosine series give $|y|, |z| < 0.005001$. Hence $|y^2 + z^2| < 0.000051$, $|k - 1| < 0.000026$, $|E - i| < 0.00006$, $|H_j - 1| < 0.0102$, and $|R - 1/2| < 0.000026$. Substitution in (F.20) gives $|Z_j - (1+i)/2| < 0.004$. In each denominator in the B column of (F.22), the complete modulus is $1/2$, and its perturbation is less than 0.0041. The quotient estimate therefore bounds the motion of each finite vertex in (F.22) by 0.02; the remaining finite equatorial vertices are fixed or move by less than 0.000026.

Every finite pair of distinct complete vertices occurring in (F.24) has separation at least $1/2$. Each difference factor therefore changes by relative size less than 0.08. Comparing both the numerator and denominator products with one bounds the cross-ratio quotient change by

$$\frac{4(0.08) + 2(0.08)^2}{(1 - 0.08)^2} < 0.4. \tag{F.26}$$

For a factor involving infinity there are fewer factors and the same bound suffices. Thus every ordered shape lies in $|w - i| < 0.4$, and in particular has positive imaginary part. All denominators and ideal vertices remain distinct. The internal diagonal has total angle $2\pi$: its product relation telescopes exactly, and its integer angle branch is fixed by (F.23).

This is positivity of the actual local geometric tetrahedra, not positivity of the original real $(x, t_j)$ angle chamber. For complex angular parameters the equatorial quadrilateral need not be planar. The triangular octahedral boundary and the positive tetrahedral subdivision are the retained geometric objects.

### F.2.4 The two disk-side pants depend only on their longitude

The local white matrices in a leaf frame are

$$\begin{aligned} W_0 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & E \end{pmatrix}, & W_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & E-1 \\ 0 & E \end{pmatrix}, \\ W_2 &= \begin{pmatrix} E-R & R(1-E) \\ E-1 & 1-ER \end{pmatrix}, & W_3 &= \begin{pmatrix} R & 0 \\ 1-E & ER \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \tag{F.27}$$

The relation $Z^2 - (1 + E)Z + ER = 0$ is retained. Put

$$Q = \frac{E - Z}{Z - 1} = e^{-v} = e^{i\tau}. \tag{F.28}$$

The incoming shaded triangle has cyclic vertices $(Z, \infty, 1)$, and the outgoing one has $(Z, R, 0)$. A disk cut doubles each of them across its adjacent white faces, producing the actual two-triangle pants boundary. In the plus chart, transport the opposite triangle through the appropriate $W_j^{-1}$.

If an oriented edge has endpoints $(a, b)$ and the third vertices on its two sides are $c, d$, measure its complex ratio by (F.24). Direct substitution gives the following cyclic tables:

| incoming edge | $(Z, \infty)$ | $(\infty, 1)$ | $(1, Z)$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| ratio | $-Q^{-1}$ | $-Q$ | $-Q^{-1}$ |
| outgoing edge | $(Z, R)$ | $(R, 0)$ | $(0, Z)$ |
| ratio | $-Q$ | $-Q^{-1}$ | $-Q$. |

(F.29)

For example the first incoming ratio is $(1-Z)/(E-Z) = -Q^{-1}$. Across its base edge, the opposite apex is $W_1^{-1}(Z/E) = Z - E + 1$, giving $-Q$. For the outgoing base, its opposite apex is $W_3^{-1}(Z/E) = ER/(2E-Z)$, giving $-Q^{-1}$. The remaining entries follow in the same way from (F.27).

This table removes the other endpoint's angular parameter completely. It also retains the shear, not just the plane angle. The two main puncture products are one; the third puncture product is $Q^{\pm 2}$, with the actual disk longitude having multiplier $Q^2 = e^{2i\tau}$. The sign of the oriented pants boundary is the inverse convention already recorded by the original marked disk word.

Consequently an outgoing disk-side boundary of one local block and an incoming boundary of another with the same $\tau$ have inverse edge ratios under the original puncture matching. Normalize one triangle by its three ordered vertices. The other triangle's position is then fixed by (F.29), so the whole two-triangle transition matches. Their edge shears cancel and their interior-angle branches, continued from $\pi$, sum to $2\pi$. This is the local geometric seam calculation required for joining edge blocks. It does not assert an arbitrary reordering of the three punctures.

### F.2.5 Local logarithmic increments and the edge action

Let $\psi(\tau, \upsilon)$ be the pure two-leaf action in the angular variables, retaining its complete constant. Its actual Legendre relation gives

$$\partial_\tau \psi = it_0 = -\frac{1}{\pi}\operatorname{arsinh}(\tan(\tau/2)\cos(\upsilon/2)), \tag{F.30}$$

with the branch through zero; interchange the endpoints for the other derivative. To verify the last equality, use $\operatorname{artanh}(ky) = \operatorname{arsinh}(y/\sqrt{1+z^2})$.

The local pure meridional increment is therefore

$$-2\pi i t_0 = -2\pi \partial_\tau \psi. \tag{F.31}$$

It is a small actual log-link increment in this fixed local chart. The ordered disk-page proof in Section F.1.6, concatenates these local paths in their original order. The total pure meridian period is therefore the sum of (F.31). A single retained half twist of sign $\epsilon_v$ adds $-\epsilon_v V_v/2$, in the original primitive basis. Consequently

$$U_v = -2\pi \sum_{e \sim v} \partial_{\tau_v} \psi_e - i\epsilon_v \tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v. \tag{F.32}$$

The direct first-charge saddle with $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$ makes (F.32) exactly $U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i$. The integer is fixed by concatenating the actual local increments and continuing the periods from the complete cusp, even when the total is no longer a small logarithm. Section F.3.4 establishes that period statement without resetting a principal log.

### F.2.6 Assembly in the original ordered exterior

The ordered decomposition constructs the following finite assembly. Associate the two octahedra above to each physical edge of the circle tree. At a circle vertex, list its incident edges in the actual cyclic order and join the corresponding outgoing and incoming disk-side pants

cyclically. Insert the prescribed retained half twist at its specified disk page. Table (F.29) supplies geometric seam matching for a common angular variable at that circle. The complete model has two octahedra per edge and $D$ meridional sectors at a degree-$D$ circle.

The topological proof cuts each original circle neighborhood into ordered disk pages and uses terminal-vertex insertion to identify the two-leaf block at each physical quarter-turn, including its four marked main segments. The two-circle endpoint pairs are interlaced by the actual quarter-turn. The proof retains that matching and every left or right insertion in the original product order. It also proves that the primitive meridian crosses the pages once in their cyclic order, with only the single recorded half-twist shear. These facts justify the actual paths used in (F.32).

At a distinguished odd seam one uses the original puncture-and-copy exchange, rather than an arbitrary permutation of the three pants punctures. The original matrices and their three full projective edge-return words are given in Section F.3.3. Table (F.29) transports that specified map between incident blocks with a common longitude parameter.

Together, (F.25), (F.29), and the actual period equations provide the positive cells and link data used by that completion. The analytic criterion keeps every angular parameter below 0.00111, within the radius 0.01 proved here. The complete conclusion and its precise class of diagrams are stated in the quantitative volume theorem.

## F.3 Completing the actual fillings and calibrating volume

The separately available version of this section is completing the actual fillings and calibrating volume. The proof is reproduced here in full.

The octahedral cells of an ordered tree of crossing circles stay positive while their angular longitude parameters vary in a fixed small disk. This section proves that the parameter path selected by the analytic filling equations completes those cells to the actual filled link exterior. It follows the full logarithmic period of each primitive filling curve, so the completed meridian makes exactly one turn at the endpoint. It then identifies the absolute volume with the continued critical action.

The ordered decomposition supplies the original topology and primitive curves. The angular charts supply the positive cells and their exact face maps. The analytic criterion supplies the path under the explicit bound in (F.36). Together these establish the geometric part of the quantitative volume theorem. Only the original crossing circles are filled; the main knot cusp remains complete and unfilled.

### F.3.1 Exact topological and local inputs

Fix a finite circle-only Conway tree with at least two circle vertices. Every edge is a physical quarter-turn and every vertex is an original crossing circle. Keep its actual ribbon orders, projection-copy labels, half twists and primitive disk curves.

The ordered cut theorem supplies three marked facts.

- The original projection and disk-page cuts give two octahedra per edge, with the six vertices and face maps of the literal two-leaf angular chart. Any transported corner permutations and projection-copy changes are retained.

- At each original circle, outgoing and incoming pages are joined in their actual cyclic order. The retained half twist occurs at its distinguished original seam. The face maps keep their full three-point labels.
- The disk longitude is the boundary loop with period $V_v = 2i\tau_v$. The original meridian concatenates the local meridional page paths, with the single half-longitude shear $-\epsilon_v V_v/2$. These are the original primitive curves.

Physical $T^{-1}$, $T$, and retained planar half-turns are not identified by source involutivity. Reversing a disk frame reverses both its paths and its peripheral coordinate. All formulas below use the fixed original disk basis.

The local positive eight-tetrahedron chart is valid on

$$|\tau_v|, |\tau_w| \le 10^{-2}. \tag{F.33}$$

Its incoming pants edge ratios are $(-Q^{-1}, -Q, -Q^{-1})$, and its outgoing ratios are their inverses, where $Q = e^{i\tau_v}$. Thus the marked seam cancels the full complex shears, and its two interior-angle branches sum to $2\pi$. This includes both projection copies. At zero these are the two regular octahedra in the actual two-leaf cut.

### F.3.2 The analytic path and the actual peripheral formulas

Let $F_0$ be the complete positive action, normalized so that $2\pi F_0$ is the volume of the original augmented exterior. There are two regular octahedra per tree edge at completeness. Let

$$\Psi(\boldsymbol{\tau}) = \sum_{\{v,w\}} \psi(\tau_v, \tau_w), \qquad \Psi(0) = F_0, \qquad \psi_{\tau_v} = -\frac{1}{\pi}\operatorname{arsinh}\big(\tan(\tau_v/2)\cos(\tau_w/2)\big). \tag{F.34}$$

The local action is separately even, with its complete branch and constant. Fix the original signs $\epsilon_v \in \{0, \pm 1\}$, integral fillings $p_v$, and powers $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$. The analytic criterion supplies an analytic first-charge path $\boldsymbol{\tau}(c)$, $0 \le c \le 1$, with

$$\Psi_{\tau_v} + \frac{in_v\tau_v}{2\pi} - ic = 0, \qquad \boldsymbol{\tau}(0) = 0, \qquad |\tau_v(c)| < 10^{-2}, \qquad \Im\tau_v(c) < 0 \quad (c > 0). \tag{F.35}$$

Write $D_v$ for the circle-tree degree. The sufficient condition and pointwise bound are

$$\sum_v \frac{D_v}{D_v^2 + n_v^2} \le 2^{-25}, \qquad |\tau_v(c)| \le \frac{2\pi c}{(1 - 1/50)\sqrt{D_v^2 + n_v^2}}, \tag{F.36}$$

The common bound is less than 0.00111, inside (F.33). The geometric proof only uses the explicit path properties (F.35).

In a pure local block the small meridional increment is $-2\pi\psi_{\tau_v}$. The ordered cut theorem consequently gives the original peripheral logarithms

$$U_v = -2\pi\Psi_{\tau_v} - i\epsilon_v\tau_v, \qquad V_v = 2i\tau_v. \tag{F.37}$$

Their exponentials are the actual holonomy multipliers. Section F.3.4 proves that the chosen lifts are also the actual log-link periods. The stationary equation gives

$$U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i c. \tag{F.38}$$

The primitive basis is not reset when $U_v$ approaches $-2\pi i$.

### F.3.3 Positive metric on the cut-and-glued exterior

Realize every local block by its positive tetrahedra and perform the original identifications in Section F.3.1. Within a block the rational face identities retain the full edge return map. At a page seam the inverse ratios give both zero shear and angle $2\pi$, not only equality of multiplier moduli. Their branches are continued from the complete cells.

At the distinguished odd seam use the original cross-copy maps, rather than the pure inverse-ratio identification. In the local leaf frame of the angular chart they are

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} R & -R \\ 1 & ER - 1 - E \end{pmatrix}, \qquad B = \begin{pmatrix} R/E - 1 - 1/E & R \\ -1 & R \end{pmatrix}. \tag{F.39}$$

They send respectively $(Z, \infty, 1)$ to $(Z/E, R, 0)$ and $(Z, R, 0)$ to $(Z/E, \infty, 1)$. Thus they specify all three ideal vertices and the actual exchange of projection copies. With the four original white maps $W_j$, direct multiplication gives the full projective edge returns

$$W_0^{-1} B W_2^{-1} A = I, \qquad W_2^{-1} B W_0^{-1} A = I, \qquad W_1^{-1} B W_3^{-1} A = I. \tag{F.40}$$

These are identities under $Z^2 - (1+E)Z + ER = 0$, not modulus comparisons. The incoming and outgoing marked pants structures depend only on their common $Q = e^{i\tau_v}$, by the local edge-ratio calculation. Transport each to the same ordered three-vertex pants chart. Equations (F.39)–(F.40) then give the same odd seam between any two incident blocks, even when their far-end parameters differ. The allowed puncture exchange is exactly the one in (F.39), not an arbitrary pants permutation. Every resulting edge has its complete angle branch $2\pi$, by positivity and continuation from zero. The two physical signs retain their distinct primitive words and the single correction in (F.37).

This gives a nonsingular local hyperbolic metric at every finite point of the original exterior. Face pairings are isometries, edge links have angle $2\pi$ and identity return, and a finite subdivision vertex has a nonsingular spherical metric on its topological sphere link. Its complete local spherical development is the ordinary sphere. No global injectivity of the developing map is assumed.

The actual horospherical triangles form a nonsingular similarity structure on each topological cusp torus. Main puncture holonomies are the nontrivial parabolics of the local pants and remain so in the fixed local charts. The actual primitive main meridian is one of these local words. Its commutant is the translation group at its flag. Hence each main torus has a complete Euclidean translation link.

For $c > 0$, (F.35) and (F.37) give

$$\Re V_v = -2\Im \tau_v > 0. \tag{F.41}$$

The auxiliary peripheral group has a nonunit dilation and a second common fixed point $q_v$. Its nonsingular similarity development misses $q_v$. Indeed $(z - q_v)\partial_z$ is a globally invariant vector field; each possible zero has index $+1$, whereas the total index on a torus is zero.

On the simply connected link cover put

$$f_v = \log(\mathrm{dev}_v - q_v). \tag{F.42}$$

Its real derivative is invertible. The metric $|df_v|^2$ descends to a nonsingular Euclidean metric on the compact torus, and is complete. Geodesic path lifting makes $f_v$ a covering of the Euclidean plane; since the plane is simply connected, it is a diffeomorphism. Its periods form an injective real rank-two lattice.

### F.3.4 The periods throughout the charge path

Let $P_{\mu_v}, P_{\lambda_v}$ be the actual periods of (F.42) on the retained primitive paths. Their exponentials are the actual peripheral multipliers, so

$$P_{\mu_v} - U_v, \quad P_{\lambda_v} - V_v \in 2\pi i\mathbb{Z}. \tag{F.43}$$

These differences are continuous for $0 < c \leq 1$. The link remains nonsingular, its development avoids the second fixed point, and the paths and flags are retained. Choose a logarithm at one basepoint and transport it continuously; rebasing adds a constant and does not change a period.

The initial integers can be fixed directly from the complete charts. Choose a peripheral frame depending continuously on the selected flag and sending it to infinity. Write the longitude as $z \mapsto a(c)z + b(c)$, with $a(c) = e^{V_v(c)}$. At completeness $a(0) = 1$ and $b(0) \neq 0$, since the original primitive longitude is a nonzero translation in the complete torus. For $c > 0$, (F.41) makes $a(c) \neq 1$, and its second fixed point is $q_v(c) = b(c)/(1 - a(c))$. Thus $|q_v(c)| \to \infty$.

For this fixed finite tree, the developed fixed-generator paths remain in one bounded region and have bounded Euclidean lengths as $c \downarrow 0$. They use finitely many actual triangles and transition maps, all continuous in the complete charts. If their images lie in $|z| \leq B$ and their lengths are at most $L$, their actual logarithmic increments obey

$$|P_\gamma(c)| \leq \frac{L}{|q_v(c)| - B} \longrightarrow 0. \tag{F.44}$$

Meanwhile (F.37) gives $U_v, V_v \to 0$. Each integer difference in (F.43) is therefore zero for sufficiently small $c$, and hence on all of $(0, 1]$. This fixes the winding without importing a small-neighborhood completion theorem or resetting principal logs at the endpoint.

Equivalently, each page increment in (F.37) is small in its local two-leaf chart. Changes of a pants frame add logarithmic constants at the ends of a page path; those constants telescope around the circle. Its meridian accumulates the sum of the actual increments, even when high degree makes that sum close to $-2\pi i$. The preceding continuity argument fixes the possible integer.

The actual slope period is thus $-2\pi ic$. Its complementary primitive curve is the original longitude: the determinant of $(\mu_v + p_v\lambda_v, \lambda_v)$ in the original basis is one. Its positive core translation length is

$$\ell_v = \Re V_v = -2\Im\tau_v. \tag{F.45}$$

### F.3.5 Cone completion and the smooth endpoint

The geometric end contains all sufficiently high vertical rays over its similarity triangles. Send its fixed points to zero and infinity, put $r = y/|z|$, and use

$$R = \operatorname{arsinh}(1/r), \quad \theta = \Im f_v, \quad X = \Re f_v + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(1 + r^2). \tag{F.46}$$

The metric is exactly

$$dR^2 + \cosh^2 R\, dX^2 + \sinh^2 R\, d\theta^2. \tag{F.47}$$

Compactness of the actual similarity link shows that the end contains a whole punctured tube $0 < R < R_0$. Its primitive meridian period is $-2\pi ic$, and its independent longitude has

positive real part (F.45). Adding the axis produces a cone solid torus of angle $2\pi c$, with the specified topological meridian. At $c = 1$ it is an ordinary smooth solid torus.

Main cusps remain complete horoball quotients, and the remaining middle is compact. Thus the $c = 1$ metric is complete and has finite volume on the original filled topology. The complete universal local development covers simply connected hyperbolic space, so the resulting representation is the geometric holonomy. When the original component test gives one main component, the metric is on that original knot complement. Its main cusp is unfilled.

The intermediate cone description makes no discreteness claim for $0 < c < 1$. It records the positive metric and its actual link completion; smoothness is asserted at $c = 1$.

### F.3.6 Absolute action and the primitive normalization

The calibration can be derived on this explicit geometric block family. It does not require choosing an unmarked character component by comparison of its derivatives at one point.

Put $U_v^0 = -2\pi\Psi_{\tau_v}$ and

$$G^0 = 2\pi i \left( \Psi - \sum_v \tau_v \Psi_{\tau_v} \right). \tag{F.48}$$

Direct differentiation gives

$$dG^0 = \tfrac{1}{2} \sum_v V_v \, dU_v^0. \tag{F.49}$$

The actual half twist changes $U_v^0$ to $U_v = U_v^0 - \epsilon_v V_v/2$. Its marked primitive is therefore

$$G = G^0 - \sum_v \frac{\epsilon_v V_v^2}{8} = 2\pi i \left( \Psi - \sum_v \tau_v \Psi_{\tau_v} \right) + \sum_v \frac{\epsilon_v \tau_v^2}{2}. \tag{F.50}$$

This is exactly the source Legendre transform with its complete constant. In particular $\Im G(0) = 2\pi F_0$.

The original boundary fundamental-chain differential, applied to these actual positive blocks and their marked paths, gives

$$\mathrm{Vol}(\rho) = \Im G - \tfrac{1}{2} \sum_v \Re U_v \Im V_v. \tag{F.51}$$

The constant is fixed at the complete assembly. Every local shape stays in a simply connected positive neighborhood of $i$, and Section F.3.4 retains the actual period lifts. No volume period is reset. The positive tetrahedral volume sum also shows directly that the volume tends to $2\pi F_0$ as $c \downarrow 0$.

We now compare the representation volume in (F.51) with the volume of the metric just constructed. Both are computed from the same oriented cell chain: the eight positive tetrahedra at each original tree edge, with the face identifications of Section F.1. To make the comparison at an auxiliary end explicit, use the same finite boundary triangulation and send its two fixed points to zero and infinity. Here $w$ ranges over a fixed fundamental cross section and $Y$ is a height parameter tending to infinity. Write the ideal conical map as $(a(w), Yb(w))$, where $a(w) \in \mathbb{C}$ and $b(w) > 0$. The logarithmic link coordinate (F.42) supplies a real function $\eta$ whose deck increments are the real peripheral periods, so $(0, Ye^{\eta(w)})$ is an equivariant axis-valued comparison map. The homotopy

$$H_s(w, Y) = \left(sa(w), Y \exp\big((1-s)\eta(w) + s \log b(w)\big)\right), \qquad 0 \le s \le 1,$$

uses one shared assignment on every boundary face. It is equivariant because $a, b, e^{\eta}$ transform respectively by the peripheral complex multiplier, its modulus, and its modulus. On the compact fundamental cross section its horizontal derivatives are bounded, its height is comparable to $Y$, and its height derivatives are $O(Y)$. Thus the hyperbolic volume form $y^{-3}dx_1 \wedge dx_2 \wedge dy$ bounds the volume of this boundary homotopy by $O(Y^{-2})$, which tends to zero.

For each fixed $0 < c \leq 1$, the same comparison applies to the cone tube of Section F.3.5. It compares the metric away from the axis, which contributes no three-dimensional volume; it does not assert smooth filling or descent to the filled group when $c < 1$. At $c = 1$, its meridian is the actual primitive curve $\mu_v + p_v\lambda_v$, with period $-2\pi i$. Its real period vanishes, so the axis assignment extends over that meridian disk; extend the same boundary triangulation through the solid torus with its added vertices on the axis. All added tetrahedra have zero volume. The main cusp is unchanged, and its horoball comparison also has vanishing boundary volume. Consequently the original representation chain and the completed metric have the same absolute volume:

$$\mathrm{Vol}(\rho) = \mathrm{Vol}_c\,. \tag{F.52}$$

This is the filling-chain comparison used in Appendix D; it requires the primitive completion and the nonsingular links already proved here, rather than a small bound on the total peripheral logarithms.

Define the stationary charge action

$$\mathcal{C}(c) = \operatorname*{stat}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \left[ \Psi + \frac{i}{4\pi} \sum_v n_v \tau_v^2 - ic \sum_v \tau_v \right]. \tag{F.53}$$

At its critical point, set $\Phi = G/(2\pi i)$. Substitution of (F.35) gives the exact cancellation

$$\Phi - \mathcal{C}(c) = -\frac{i}{2\pi} \sum_v p_v \tau_v^2, \qquad \tfrac{1}{2}\Re U_v \Im V_v = p_v \Im(\tau_v^2). \tag{F.54}$$

Consequently

$$\mathrm{Vol}_c = 2\pi \Re \mathcal{C}(c). \tag{F.55}$$

The primitive normalization has an independent differential check:

$$\frac{d}{dc}\, 2\pi \Re \mathcal{C}(c) = 2\pi \sum_v \Im \tau_v. \tag{F.56}$$

The core is represented by the complementary primitive curve $\lambda_v$, its length is (F.45), and its cone angle is $2\pi c$. The finite-cell Schläfli differential $-\frac{1}{2}\sum_v \ell_v\, d(2\pi c)$ gives (F.56). This checks the factor and sign; (F.55) already follows from the marked regulator and the complete anchor, without cone rigidity.

At $c = 1$, (F.55) identifies the actual analytic first-charge rate with the original smooth filled volume. The ordered topological theorem and the analytic criterion supply the topology and path (F.35) used in this proof. The finite-source dominance and its exact normalization are proved in the analytic theorem.

### F.3.7 Scope of the completion

The metric argument permits large global meridian logs while every edge block remains uniformly close to its regular geometry. It does not require a globally small framed-representation norm.

The conclusion applies to the ordered all-circle trees of Section F.3.1 under (F.36), or more generally whenever their actual analytic path satisfies (F.35). It does not assert that every bounded crossing power gives a hyperbolic filling. The degree-weighted bound permits some small powers because the resulting local angular changes remain small while the primitive meridian is assembled from many sectors.

The preferred-cusp continuation also follows the actual main longitude through this family. Its marking is established by the original face words and surgery homology. The complete geometric and analytic conclusions are collected in the quantitative volume theorem.

## F.4 The preferred cusp along the filling path

The separately available version of this section is the preferred cusp along the filling path. The proof is reproduced here in full.

A horospherical cross-section of the knot cusp is a Euclidean torus. Normalize the meridian's translation to one. The translation of the preferred longitude, which follows the knot once and has linking number zero with it, is its preferred cusp shape.

The ordered page decomposition and its positive angular realization construct a representation of the original augmented exterior. This section identifies its preferred main-cusp translation. The argument does not use a quantum asymptotic to identify a representation or a cusp. The small-neighborhood argument below is used only to establish an identity of holomorphic germs. The identity then continues along the entire positive angular chart, even when the original auxiliary meridian logarithms are no longer small.

The geometric inputs are the ordered decomposition, the positive angular charts, and their actual filling completion. The analytic criterion constructs the path used in the quantitative volume theorem. The original marked inputs are the face-map theorem the original marked face maps and the full rational translation proof the preferred-longitude translation proof.

### F.4.1 Statement

Fix an original ordered all-circle tree with at least one edge. Retain the original disk frames, half twists $\epsilon_v \in \{0, 1, -1\}$, and one main knot component. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be its physical quarter-turn edges. Set

$$y_v = \tan(\tau_v/2), \qquad k_e = (1 + y_v^2 + y_w^2)^{-1/2}, \qquad \tan(\pi x_e) = k_e, \qquad x_e(\mathbf{0}) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad e = vw. \tag{F.57}$$

All roots and inverse functions use their branches at zero. The local positive chart is $|\tau_v| < 10^{-2}$. The ordered page construction gives an actual marked representation there, with main meridian parabolic and primitive auxiliary longitude logarithm $V_v = 2i\tau_v$.

Let $L_{\mathrm{path}}$ be exactly the framed main path in Sections 2–6 of the preferred-longitude calculation. Let $\lambda_K$ be the preferred longitude in the augmented exterior. Write $w_\epsilon$ for the oriented writhe of its retained-half-twist diagram and $\ell_v$ for the linking number of crossing

circle $v$ with the main knot. In the coordinate where the main meridian translates by one, their translations in the angular representation are

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{trn}(L_{\text{path}}) &= 2i \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} \cot(\pi x_e) - \sum_v \epsilon_v, \\ \operatorname{trn}(\lambda_K) &= 2i \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} \cot(\pi x_e) - \sum_v \epsilon_v - w_\epsilon. \end{aligned} \tag{F.58}$$

Here trn denotes Euclidean translation, not matrix trace. The signs are those of the original positive checked crossing and the actual oriented writhe.

For fixed integers $p_v$, put $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$, and follow the positive charge path

$$U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i c, \qquad 0 \le c \le 1. \tag{F.59}$$

Assume the path stays in the chart and has $\operatorname{Im} \tau_v < 0$ for $c > 0$, as supplied by the curvature-supported certificate. The completion theorem gives a smooth actual filled knot complement at $c = 1$. Its preferred cusp is

$$\boxed{\tau_K = -w_{\mathbf{n}} - \sum_v n_v + 2i \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} \cot(\pi x_e(\boldsymbol{\tau}(1)))}. \tag{F.60}$$

Here $w_{\mathbf{n}}$ is the oriented writhe of the diagram with the filled powers $n_v$. Equivalently, the last sum is $2i \sum_{vw \in \mathcal{E}} \sqrt{1 + y_v^2 + y_w^2}$, with the same branches. There is no smallness condition on the total $U_v$ in this conclusion.

### F.4.2 Why actual representations can be compared near zero

There are two different geometric cell descriptions, so a source Hessian by itself does not identify their holonomies. We use the marked positive-gluing rigidity proved in the marked multicusp gluing theorem, Sections 2–3 and 5. It is also used in Section 2 of the original geometric deformation. Here are the precise parts needed.

The new complete triangulation consists of eight positive ideal tetrahedra per tree edge. Its face labels and peripheral paths are those of the original exterior, by the ordered page proof. The old complete construction gives that same marked exterior. Their complete holonomies are conjugate by an orientation-preserving marked isometry. This is the geometric uniqueness of the complete finite-volume metric. It can also be obtained from the existing maximal-volume conjugacy argument in the geometric conjugacy theorem, Section 1: the page representation is an actual representation of the original group and its positive complete tetrahedra have volume $2|\mathcal{E}|v_8 = 2\pi F_0$, the known complete volume. This use of rigidity is after the actual topological identification; an equality of cell volumes alone would not identify exteriors.

For completeness, the positive-gluing uniqueness argument applies with an auxiliary longitude rather than a meridian prescribed at each auxiliary cusp. If there are $t$ ideal tetrahedra and $q$ cusps, select $t - q$ independent edge equations and one primitive peripheral row at each cusp. The integral edge/peripheral identities identify the symplectic quotient of the edge row space with $H_1(\partial M; \mathbb{R})$. Thus these rows form a full-rank real Lagrangian matrix $(A\ B)$. Choose the main meridian row and all auxiliary longitude rows. They are independent and isotropic because they are one primitive nonzero class on each different torus.

In the positive local orders write

$$u_j = \log z_j, \qquad v_j = \log(1 - z_j^{-1}), \qquad D_j = \frac{dv_j}{du_j} = \frac{1}{z_j - 1}, \qquad \operatorname{Im} D_j < 0. \tag{F.61}$$

The Jacobian at fixed chosen peripheral logs is $A + B\,\mathrm{diag}(D_j)$. If it killed a nonzero vector $a$, then $(a, \mathrm{diag}(D_j)a)$ would lie in the complexification of a real Lagrangian subspace. Its symplectic pairing with its conjugate would vanish. The same pairing is, up to the fixed nonzero imaginary factor, $\sum_j \operatorname{Im} D_j |a_j|^2 < 0$, a contradiction. The implicit-function theorem therefore gives one decorated shape germ for the main meridian log zero and the auxiliary logs $V_v = 2i\tau_v$. The cited multicusp theorem proves the rank and decorated-representation statements for exactly these mixed peripheral coordinates. Its polarization is the all-cusp form of the proof in the polarized gluing argument, Section 1.

This is a statement about the entire nearby marked representation, not just a formal equality of its peripheral eigenvalues. To apply it to the old family, develop the vertices of the new ideal triangulation using the old representation and its recorded cusp flags. For a lifted ideal vertex $gP_v$, use $\rho(g)\xi_v$, where $\xi_v$ is the selected peripheral fixed point. This is independent of the coset representative. Every complete tetrahedron has four distinct vertices, so the resulting cross ratios are holomorphic nearby and remain positive. They obey all the same edge and peripheral equations, with the same log branches by continuity. This puts the old representation into the new shape chart and justifies applying its uniqueness. No individual tetrahedron or subtree is separately conjugated.

The old auxiliary longitude coordinates are valid near zero: the marked theorem gives a diagonal, nonzero derivative of $V$ with respect to the original auxiliary colors. Thus the old family can indeed be parametrized by these same $V_v = 2i\tau_v$. The preceding uniqueness identifies its representation, with all original paths, with the new page representation on a neighborhood of zero.

### F.4.3 Identification of the retained wire coordinates

Equality of representation germs must also use the same variables in the cotangent expression. Here that identification follows from the exact classical Legendre calculation, not a comparison of volumes.

In the original physical-edge variables the local angular action is

$$b(x, \theta) = \int_0^x \log(2\cos 2\pi u + 2\cos\theta)\, du - 2J(x), \qquad J(x) = \int_0^x \log(2\sin \pi u)\, du. \tag{F.62}$$

For a circle vertex, the analytic elimination of its original hidden variables gives

$$\mathrm{stat}_{\theta_v} \left[ \sum_{e \sim v} b(x_e, \theta_v) + \frac{i\epsilon_v \theta_v^2}{4\pi} + i\chi_v \theta_v \right]. \tag{F.63}$$

This is the original selected circle action, with its original physical-edge indices: the one-leaf identity is derived explicitly in the regular crossing-circle action, Section 7, its circle-junction extension is in Section 9, and the joint-wire Legendre identity is (38)–(39) of the joint filling transform. The nondegenerate hidden Hessian makes these analytic eliminations unique near the original complete state. The identity retains the physical-edge variables before eliminating them.

There are no bare junctions in the present tree. Set $\theta_v = -\tau_v$, so that the original relation $V_v = -2i\theta_v$ becomes the geometric convention $V_v = 2i\tau_v$. Separate evenness leaves $b$ unchanged. Every retained edge $vw$ therefore has the stationary equation

$$\partial_x\{b(x,\tau_v) + b(x,\tau_w)\} = 0. \tag{F.64}$$

Writing $c_e = \cos 2\pi x_e$, this is

$$(c_e + \cos\tau_v)(c_e + \cos\tau_w) = (1 - c_e)^2. \tag{F.65}$$

The branch through $x_e = 1/4$ gives

$$c_e = \frac{1 - \cos\tau_v \cos\tau_w}{2 + \cos\tau_v + \cos\tau_w}, \tag{F.66}$$

which is exactly (F.57). The derivative of (F.64) at zero is nonzero. Thus these are the retained old physical-turn labels as analytic germs, not merely variables with the same complete values.

The color itself also matches the primitive geometric meridian. Let $\Psi(\boldsymbol{\tau})$ be the sum of the stationary edge actions. The $\theta$-stationarity in (F.63) gives

$$\chi_v = -i\Psi_{\tau_v} + \frac{\epsilon_v\tau_v}{2\pi}, \qquad -2\pi i\chi_v = -2\pi\Psi_{\tau_v} - i\epsilon_v\tau_v = U_v. \tag{F.67}$$

The last expression is the actual page-by-page primitive word from the ordered decomposition. Near zero it has derivative $d_v - i\epsilon_v$ in $\tau_v$, where $d_v$ is the circle's degree. This is nonzero. Equation (F.67) is not used as a substitute for the representation comparison in Section F.4.2.

### F.4.4 Holomorphic continuation of the actual main translation

The old preferred-cusp proof establishes its rational identities before imposing any auxiliary filling equation. Its product potential, endpoint rebasing rule, actual quarter-turn maps, and pure and odd leaf words give

$$\operatorname{trn}(L_{\text{path}}) = 2i\sum_e \cot(\pi x_e) - \sum_v \epsilon_v. \tag{F.68}$$

on the old nearby marked family. By Sections F.4.2–F.4.3, (F.68) holds for the actual new page representation near zero.

Both sides are holomorphic on the connected angular chart. For the right side this follows directly from (F.57). For the left side, keep the actual based main meridian and longitudinal words. The meridian is nonidentity parabolic throughout the chart: it is conjugate to one of the nontrivial local pants meridians. Locally send its marked fixed point to infinity and normalize its translation to one. The commuting longitudinal holonomy is then a translation as well. Its coefficient is holomorphic and independent of the remaining translation in this normalization. These local functions agree on overlaps, so they define one holomorphic translation ratio on the entire chart.

Equivalently, choose the local trace-two unipotent lifts and write $M = I + N$, $L = I + \lambda N$. Since $N \neq 0$, the coefficient $\lambda$ is a holomorphic function on any open set where a chosen entry of $N$ is nonzero. The formulas agree on overlaps. This description uses no logarithm of the main longitude and therefore has no $2\pi i$ or integer translation ambiguity.

The identity theorem now extends (F.68) throughout that chart. A continuation along the positive charge path would suffice; no uniform neighborhood in the original summed meridian coordinates is required. The original endpoint-sign convention remains part of the word: when an arc is reversed, both its traversal and its unit-meridian orientation reverse. The affine multipliers $-1$ at odd seams are not replaced by $+1$.

The homological computation of the fixed word is independent of the representation. It is exactly

$$[L_{\mathrm{path}}] = w_\epsilon[\mu_K] + \sum_v \ell_v[\mu_v], \qquad \lambda_K = L_{\mathrm{path}}\mu_K^{-w_\epsilon}. \tag{F.69}$$

Hence the second identity in (F.58) continues with the first.

### F.4.5 The preferred longitude after the actual fillings

The original crossing circles are pairwise unlinked, and their primitive disk longitudes satisfy $[\lambda_v] = \ell_v[\mu_K]$. Filling the original slopes $\mu_v + p_v\lambda_v$ gives

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}} = \lambda_K \mu_K^{\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2}. \tag{F.70}$$

This remains a fixed word on the main boundary throughout the cone path. At $c = 1$ it is precisely the preferred zero-linking longitude of the smooth filled knot exterior. At intermediate $c$ its translation is simply the translation of that same boundary curve; no smooth filling at an intermediate nonintegral cone angle is asserted.

The disk orientations give $\ell_v^2 = 2(1 + o_v)$ with $o_v = 1$ for parallel strands and $o_v = -1$ for antiparallel strands, while $w_\epsilon = \sum_v o_v\epsilon_v$ and $w_{\mathbf{n}} = \sum_v o_v n_v$. Therefore

$$-\sum_v \epsilon_v - w_\epsilon + \sum_v p_v\ell_v^2 = -\sum_v n_v - w_{\mathbf{n}}. \tag{F.71}$$

Adding the meridian translations in (F.70) to (F.58) proves (F.60).

The new conclusion is a geometric identity on the positive angular continuation of this actual all-circle class. It does not extend the original real angle chamber, and it does not assert a formula on unrelated algebraic solutions. Its proof uses the exact marked representation, actual path words, local geometric uniqueness, and analytic continuation. The independent scalar calculation and the new source asymptotic may subsequently use (F.60), but neither was used to identify this cusp.

# Appendix G

# Exact subtree polynomials and local filling estimates

This appendix proves Theorem 10.1 and the separate metric criterion, Theorem 10.2. The tree, all cyclic orders, all strand frames, all signed powers and the knot pairing are fixed. Only the integer level $N$ tends to infinity. We use

$$\kappa = \max_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \le 2^{-120}$$

for the quantum induction. The last section replaces this condition by $\sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} \ge 630$ for geometric completion alone.

The exact finite coordinates, pairing, crossing polynomial and translated-grid trace are those of Section E.1. Their finite edge-sum expansion on a radius $1/4$ bidisk is proved in Section E.2.5; the global Newton product bounds are in Section E.3.2. In particular the input to the present proof is an asymptotic for an actual finite sum with its endpoint currents, not only a formal critical value.

We call the polynomial left on the unique boundary of an evaluated subtree its boundary message. Its value at zero will be factored out exactly. The proof first establishes a class of limiting phases, then closes an induction for the finite polynomials themselves. Each step keeps all Newton indices and all repeated-root derivative coordinates.

## G.1 The full finite kernel and exact recursion

Put $d = N - 1$, $c_j = 2\cos((2j+1)\pi/N)$, and

$$S_k = \prod_{r=1}^{k} 2\sin(\pi r/N), \qquad e_k(z) = S_k^{-2} \prod_{j<k} (c_j - z). \tag{G.1}$$

The fixed pairing is $\phi_\sigma(e_i e_j) = \mathbf{1}_{i+j=d}$. A physical turn, after lowering this pairing, identifies equal indices and retains $\gamma_e(s) H_N(s)/W_k(s)$. Thus define

$$K_N(t,u;s) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t) e_k(-2\cos u) \frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}. \tag{G.2}$$

This is the full kernel, not the regular-window truncation. It is an even trigonometric polynomial of degree at most $N-1$ in each variable. The paired factors and their inverses are bounded uniformly in $k, N$ on every fixed disk $R < 1$.

Choose a terminal root. For a nonroot vertex $v$, its message to the parent angle $u$ is the exact polynomial

$$M_{v,N}(u) = \gamma_{e_v}(s)\, \mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_v,\sigma_v,N}\left[K_N(t,u;s) \prod_{w \text{ child of } v} M_{w,N}(t)\right]. \tag{G.3}$$

The functional $\mathcal{D}_{n,\sigma,N}(F) = \phi_\sigma(R^n_\sigma F)$ uses the full physical crossing polynomial, including its Cartan scalar. The polynomial representative and the trace are defined by the exact quotient in Section E.1. The actual $\sigma_v$ is $s, -s$, or 0, according to the ordered pair. The reference monodromy factors remain outside in the same ledger as Theorem 9.1. Formula (G.3) follows by expanding the original covariant contraction and doing finite sums in a different order. It does not commute physical tangles.

At the root the final trace is

$$Z_N = \mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_0,\sigma_0,N}\left[\prod_{w \text{ child of } 0} M_{w,N}(t)\right]. \tag{G.4}$$

The original closing/framing factor, prescribed reference factors, and one reduced cut factor $H_N(s)$ multiply (G.4). There is no discarded-source remainder in (G.3)–(G.4). Every original normal channel and every $0 \le k < N$ is still present.

In particular $M_{v,N}$ is always an even trigonometric polynomial of degree at most $N-1$ in its parent variable, regardless of the size of the subtree. This is seen directly from (G.2): the trace and all child operations act only in $t$.

## G.2 Two full-kernel bounds

Use the following constants:

$$r = 2^{-12}, \quad c_K = 2^{-16}, \quad c = 2^{-18}, \quad y_0 = 2^{-56}, \quad \rho = 2^{-14}, \quad t_0 = 2^{-16}. \tag{G.5}$$

All bounds allow polynomial factors in $N$, depending on $R$. Let $G_0 = g(1/4)$, and let $\psi(t,u)$ be the edge action, with $\psi(0,0) = 2G_0$.

First, for real $t, u \in [-\pi, \pi]$,

$$|K_N(t,u;s)| \le C_R N^{A_R} \exp N\{2G_0 - c_K[(1-\cos t) + (1-\cos u)]\}. \tag{G.6}$$

To prove this, split (G.2) into $k/N \in I = [1/5, 3/10]$ and its complement. On $I$, the product bound in Section E.3.2 gives a factor $\exp[-\alpha N \sin^2(t/2)]$ at each end, with $\alpha > 1/250$. The positive endpoint sum has rate $2G_0$ and a polynomial prefactor. Outside $I$, full Hermite interpolation gives a real sup bound with the single-edge loss $\eta_K = \pi/200$, including high indices. Since $4c_K < \eta_K$ and $c_K < \alpha/2$, both pieces satisfy (G.6).

Second, for complex $|u| \le r$, real $|t| \le \pi$, and $|y| \le y_0$,

$$|K_N(t+iy,u;s)| \le C_R N^{A_R} \exp N\{\Re\psi(0,u) - c_K(1-\cos t) + 16y^2\}. \tag{G.7}$$

This conditional normalization is essential. Replacing $\Re\psi(0,u)$ by $2G_0+O(r^2)$ would introduce an unnecessary error larger than some of the later local tail losses.

Here are the details. The complementary kernel, by the polynomial ellipse bound at each end, is at most

$$C_R N^{A_R} \exp N\{2G_0 - \eta_K + |y| + |\Im u|\}. \tag{G.8}$$

Since $|\psi(0,u) - 2G_0| \le r^2$, its fixed gap absorbs the entire claimed angular loss in (G.7), uniformly in $t$. Indeed $r + r^2 + y_0 + 2c_K < \eta_K/2$.

For the retained kernel and $|t| \le 1/8$, the finite edge-sum saddle of Section E.2.5 is uniform on $|t+iy|, |u| \le 1/4$. The exact formula for $\psi_{tt}$ gives

$$|\psi_{tt} + 1/(2\pi)| \le \frac{1}{50}\frac{1}{2\pi}. \tag{G.9}$$

Separate evenness implies $\psi_t(0,u) = 0$. Integrating (G.9) on the segment from zero to $t+iy$ proves a stronger version of the exponent in (G.7). Its polynomial amplitude and its exponentially small lattice currents are retained. For $|t| \ge 1/8$, use the explicit global bound

$$|e_k(-2\cos(t+iy))| \le e^2 e_k(-2) e^{N[-\alpha \sin^2(t/2) + 11y^2]}. \tag{G.10}$$

The product at the other end satisfies $|e_k(-2\cos u)| \le e_k(-2)e^{Nr^2}$ on $I$: the normalized product factors have denominators $\cos^2((j+1/2)\pi/N) \ge 1/3$, and $|\sin(u/2)|^2 < r^2/3$. The additional change from $2G_0$ to $\Re\psi(0,u)$ costs at most another $r^2$. Now

$$2r^2 < \frac{\alpha}{2}\sin^2(1/16), \qquad c_K < \alpha/4. \tag{G.11}$$

These inequalities prove (G.7) on the remaining real angles. The first follows already from $\alpha > 1/250$, $\sin(1/16) > 1/(8\pi)$, and $\pi^2 < 10$. No quadratic complex bound for an individual high basis element has been used in this argument.

On the small bidisk $|t|, |u| \le r$, the full kernel also has the same nonzero analytic saddle expansion as its retained part. The complementary estimate (G.8) has a fixed gap there. In particular,

$$K_N(t,u;s) = N^{-3/2} a_e(t,u) e^{N\psi(t,u)}(1 + O_R(N^{-1})), \tag{G.12}$$

with the paired insertion included in the error and with the exact midpoint normalization of Section E.1. The leading $a_e$ is holomorphic and nonzero on a slightly larger disk. The outside $\gamma_e(s)$ in (G.3) is not included in $a_e$.

## G.3 A closed class of boundary phases

Write $a_0 = 1/(2\pi)$. A boundary phase $h(u)$ will satisfy

$$h(0) = h'(0) = 0, \qquad h(-u) = h(u), \qquad |h''(u) + a_0| \le a_0/20, \quad |u| \le r. \tag{G.13}$$

Assume the child phases have this property. At a nonroot vertex put

$$a_v = d_v/(2\pi), \quad b_v = n_v/(2\pi), \quad D_v = a_v - ib_v,$$
$$A_v(t,u) = \psi(t,u) + \sum_w h_w(t), \qquad C_{v,\ell}(u) = \operatorname{stat}_t\{A_v(t,u) + ib_v t^2/2 - i\ell t\}. \tag{G.14}$$

There are exactly $d_v$ incidences in the $t$ variable. Consequently

$$A_v(t,u) = \psi(0,u) - a_v t^2/2 + E_v(t,u), \qquad |E_{v,tt}| \le a_v/20, \quad |E_{v,t}/t| \le a_v/20. \tag{G.15}$$

The last quotient is removable at zero, by evenness in $t$. For $0 \le \ell \le L_v = \lfloor t_0|D_v| \rfloor$, the equation

$$D_v t = -i\ell + E_{v,t}(t,u) \tag{G.16}$$

is a contraction on $|t| \le r$. Its Lipschitz constant is at most $1/20$, and its image has radius $t_0 + r/20 < r$. The solution has

$$|t_\ell| \le \frac{\ell}{(1-1/20)|D_v|}, \qquad \frac{380}{441}\frac{\ell a_v}{|D_v|^2} \le -\Im t_\ell \le \frac{420}{361}\frac{\ell a_v}{|D_v|^2}. \tag{G.17}$$

These inequalities hold also for complex $u$. Indeed $t_\ell = -i\ell/(D_v - Q_v)$, where $|Q_v| \le a_v/20$; the real part of $D_v - Q_v$ is positive. No reality assertion about a child phase is needed.

The normalized outgoing phase is

$$h_v(u) = C_{v,1}(u) - C_{v,1}(0). \tag{G.18}$$

Stationarity gives the exact derivative

$$h_v'(u) = \psi_u(t_1(u),u), \qquad h_v''(u) = \psi_{uu} - \frac{\psi_{ut}^2}{A_{v,tt} + ib_v}. \tag{G.19}$$

The denominator has modulus at least $(19/20)|D_v|$. The explicit edge bounds on the radius $1/4$ disk give $|\psi_{uu} + a_0| \le a_0/50$ and $|\psi_{ut}| \le a_0/50$. Since $|D_v| \ge a_v \ge a_0$, the right side differs from $-a_0$ by at most

$$a_0\left(\frac{1}{50} + \frac{20}{19\cdot 2500}\right) < a_0/20. \tag{G.20}$$

Thus (G.13) closes without a depth or vertex-count constant. The same calculation starts the recursion when there are no children.

Charge ordering and the current vertex's action drop follow directly from $\partial_\ell \Re C_{v,\ell} = \Im t_\ell$:

$$\Re C_{v,\ell}(u) \le \Re C_{v,1}(u) - \frac{190}{441}\frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2}(\ell^2 - 1), \tag{G.21}$$

$$0 \le \Re\psi(0,u) - \Re C_{v,1}(u) \le \frac{210}{361}\frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2} = \frac{420\pi}{361}\frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} < 4\kappa. \tag{G.22}$$

There is no sum over descendants in (G.22).

## G.4 The exact finite-message induction

The inductive assertions are these, for all sufficiently large $N$ depending on the fixed subtree, uniformly on each fixed main-parameter disk $R < 1$.

1. $M_{v,N}(0) \ne 0$, and on $|u| \le r$,

$$\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)} = \frac{\alpha_v(u)}{\alpha_v(0)} e^{N h_v(u)}(1 + O(N^{-1})). \tag{G.23}$$

The amplitude is holomorphic and nonzero; (G.13) holds.

2. For real $|u| \le \pi$,
$$\left|\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)}\right| \le CN^A e^{-Nc(1-\cos u)}. \tag{G.24}$$

3. For real $|t| \le \pi$, $|y| \le y_0$,
$$\left|\frac{M_{v,N}(t+iy)}{M_{v,N}(0)}\right| \le CN^A e^{N[-(c/2)(1-\cos t)+y^2]}. \tag{G.25}$$

Only the phase bound and displayed exponential constants are uniform in the subtree. Amplitude bounds, polynomial powers and thresholds are allowed to depend on the fixed subtree.

In (G.23) the normalization is the exact value $M_{v,N}(0)$. It retains all $N$-dependent crossing, carrier and edge phases. More explicitly one may write
$$M_{v,N}(u) = \Omega_{v,N}(s,\boldsymbol{\sigma})\,\alpha_v(u)e^{N\mathcal{F}_v(u)}(1+O(N^{-1})). \tag{G.26}$$
Here $\Omega_{v,N}$ is the original nonzero scalar ledger for that subtree, including the full $q^{n_v(d^2/4-\sigma_v^2/2)}$ factors. It need not converge as $N$ varies. The ratio in (G.23) cancels it exactly. The leading normalized amplitude $\alpha_v(u)/\alpha_v(0)$ is independent of the microscopic parameters: the first charge coefficient is one and the paired edge insertion has leading value one. The next coefficients may depend on them. No oscillatory scalar has been hidden in a claimed $N$-independent amplitude.

To obtain (G.25) from (G.23)–(G.24), use the exact degree bound following (G.4). For a Laurent polynomial $f$ of degree at most $N-1$, the polynomial $z^{N-1}f(z)$, and its reciprocal, give the elementary Poisson bound
$$|f(t+iy)| \le CN^A e^{N[-c(1-\cos t)+(1+c)|y|]} \tag{G.27}$$
when its real bound is (G.24). Here are the details of the maximum-principle step. Write $f(t) = P(e^{it})$, where the Laurent polynomial $P$ has powers between $-m$ and $m$, with $m \le N-1$. On the unit circle the subharmonic function $\log|z^m P(z)|$ is bounded by the harmonic function
$$\log(CN^A) - Nc + Nc\Re z.$$
The same inequality holds inside the disk, including at zeros of the polynomial. For $y \ge 0$, substitute $z = e^{-y+it}$ and divide by $|z|^m$. This gives
$$|f(t+iy)| \le CN^A \exp\{-Nc(1-e^{-y}\cos t) + my\}.$$
For $y \le 0$, apply the same argument to $z^m P(z^{-1})$. Finally $1-e^{-|y|} \le |y|$ and $m \le N$ give (G.27). This argument needs no positivity or reality of the polynomial coefficients. For $|t| \ge r/2$, our $y_0$ satisfies
$$(1+c)y_0 < \frac{c}{2}(1-\cos(r/2)). \tag{G.28}$$
For $|t| < r/2$, use (G.23) and (G.13):
$$\Re h_v(t+iy) \le -\frac{19a_0}{40}t^2 + \frac{21a_0}{40}y^2. \tag{G.29}$$

Since $|t+iy|<r$, these two estimates prove (G.25). The amplitude costs only a fixed polynomial factor.

In applying the next trace, factor out the exact constants $\prod_w M_{w,N}(0)$. Do not replace them by absolute complete-source bounds. On the local disk, the exact normalized child message has a holomorphic logarithm. More explicitly, (G.23) implies, on any fixed smaller disk,

$$\frac{1}{N}\log\frac{M_{w,N}(t)}{M_{w,N}(0)} = h_w(t) + \frac{1}{N}\log\frac{\alpha_w(t)}{\alpha_w(0)} + O(N^{-2}). \tag{G.30}$$

The branches vanish at zero, and all fixed derivatives have the same orders by Cauchy. The thresholds in (G.30) may depend on the subtree. For a fixed vertex the sum of these corrections tends to zero. It therefore perturbs the local nondegenerate saddle by $O(N^{-1})$, or equivalently is retained in its analytic amplitude. This is why inherited errors do not spend another exponential gap at every ancestor.

## G.5 Conditional trace tails and connectors

After extracting the exact child constants, (G.7) and (G.25) give the global bound for the actual input of the next trace:

$$|K_N(t+iy,u)\prod_w M_{w,N}(t+iy)/M_{w,N}(0)| \le CN^A e^{N[\Re\psi(0,u)-2^{-20}a_v t^2+128a_v y^2]}. \tag{G.31}$$

Indeed $1-\cos t\ge 2t^2/\pi^2$, $d_v=2\pi a_v$, and $2\pi<8$. At a root with no outgoing edge, omit $K_N$, replace $\psi(0,u)$ by zero, and retain the same bound because there are $d_v$ incoming messages.

Set

$$A_0=2^{-41},\qquad y_v=A_0t_0a_v/|D_v|,\qquad L_v=\lfloor t_0|D_v|\rfloor. \tag{G.32}$$

Condition (10.2) gives $L_v\ge 1$, and $y_v\le 2^{-57}<y_0$. The exact trace formula retains

$$c_{\ell,N}(\sigma)=(-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)}U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma),\qquad c_{1,N}=1. \tag{G.33}$$

For a charge $\ell>L_v$, the chirp and (G.31), maximized in $t$, cost at most

$$\left(128a_v+\frac{b_v^2}{4\cdot 2^{-20}a_v}\right)y_v^2\le 2^{18}\frac{|D_v|^2}{a_v}y_v^2. \tag{G.34}$$

The negative Fourier term is at least $t_0|D_v|y_v$. Since $2^{18}A_0<1/2$, the omitted tail has loss at least

$$\frac{1}{2}A_0t_0^2a_v=2^{-74}a_v>2^{-77} \tag{G.35}$$

relative to $\Re\psi(0,u)$. Each additional charge contributes $e^{-N(\ell-L_v-1)y_v}$. For the fixed subtree, this dominates the exact coefficient growth $\ell e^{2\pi R'(\ell-1)}$ for all sufficiently large $N$.

At the original real endpoints the Gaussian loss is $2^{-20}\pi^2a_v$. The chirp and finite-charge connectors cost at most $\pi A_0t_0a_v+A_0t_0^2a_v+128A_0^2t_0^2a_v$. Their sum is less than half the endpoint loss. The exact zero-mode current obeys that endpoint bound. Thus the original finite functional, including its endpoints and normals, is its finite charge sum plus a conditional error with loss (G.35).

For each retained charge, restrict the real integral to $[-\rho,\rho]$. Its complement loses at least $2^{-20}a_v\rho^2 > 2^{-51}$. Translate the interval to $\Im t_\ell$; its endpoints remain in $|t| < r$. With $\delta = 1/20$, the same elementary Young inequality as in Section E.2.8 gives, along the connectors,

$$\Re\{A_v(t-iv,u)+ib_v(t-iv)^2/2-i\ell(t-iv)\} \le \Re\psi(0,u)-\frac{1}{8}a_vt^2+\left[\frac{1+\delta}{2}a_v+\frac{2b_v^2}{(3-4\delta)a_v}\right]v^2-\ell v. \tag{G.36}$$

For $0 \le v \le -\Im t_\ell$, the last two terms are at most $-\ell v/8$, since

$$\frac{420}{361}\max\left\{\frac{21}{40},\frac{2}{14/5}\right\} = \frac{300}{361} < \frac{7}{8}. \tag{G.37}$$

Thus each connector has loss at least $a_v\rho^2/8 > 2^{-34}$. The translated horizontal integral has a nondegenerate Gaussian with real quadratic part bounded above by $-(19/20)a_v$. Its leading amplitude is nonzero: the edge amplitude, the child amplitudes and the actual $\sin t_\ell$ are all nonzero.

Combining these estimates, choose

$$\eta = 2^{-80}. \tag{G.38}$$

Every nonminimal charge is its saddle term plus an absolute conditional error $CN^Ae^{N(\Re\psi(0,u)-\eta)}$. It need not have a relative expansion at its own much lower action. But (G.22) and (10.2) give $4\kappa < \eta/2$. Consequently these errors are below the first conditional charge. Equation (G.21) orders all retained charges relative to that same charge. Its coefficient in (G.33) is exactly one, for both parities. This proves (G.23), with a nonzero leading amplitude.

The argument initially takes the formal grid parameters on circles avoiding $\sin 2\pi\sigma = 0$. The entire physical trace and its first-charge approximation are holomorphic through all collisions inside $|\sigma| < 1$. Apply the maximum principle to their whole difference on a slightly larger parameter disk. The leading orientation/crossing factors are explicit and nonzero; no divided endpoint current is declared separately removable. This extends the estimate, and the eventual nonvanishing, to every actual $\sigma = 0, \pm s$ and both complete parity sequences.

Finally, prove (G.24) freshly from the exact trace rather than from its local approximation. This step can use polynomial norms directly, so colliding-grid derivatives cause no additional assumption. The real sup norm of each canonical child polynomial, divided by $|M_{w,N}(0)|$, is polynomial by (G.24). For fixed real $u$, (G.6) gives the real sup norm in $t$ of the canonical kernel polynomial, retaining its factor $\exp N[2G_0 - c_K(1-\cos u)]$. Real sup and Chebyshev coefficient norms are polynomially equivalent at degree less than $N$. The full crossing polynomial has polynomial norm. Multiply these polynomials, apply the exact Chebyshev folding bound in the correct $P_{\sigma_v}$ quotient, and then its top-coefficient functional (E.3). All these are full polynomial identities and retain every normal channel. They give

$$|M_{v,N}(u)| \le CN^A\left|\prod_w M_{w,N}(0)\right| e^{N[2G_0-c_K(1-\cos u)]}. \tag{G.39}$$

The nonzero value just proved at $u = 0$ has the exponent $2G_0 - \Delta_v$, with $0 \le \Delta_v < 4\kappa$. For $|u| \ge r/2$,

$$4\kappa < (c_K - c)(1 - \cos(r/2)); \tag{G.40}$$

for $|u| < r/2$, (G.23) and (G.29) give the stronger bound. Hence (G.24), and then (G.25), hold with the same constants for the outgoing message. This completes the induction. The proof is unchanged for a leaf, where the child product is empty.

## G.6 Root assembly and the original filled action

Apply the same local trace argument to (G.4). Its normalized input has $d_0$ incoming messages and no outgoing edge, so the only change to (G.14)–(G.39) is to omit $\psi(t,u)$ and its constant. The current-vertex drop, charge ordering, tails and connector estimates have the same constants.

Recover the subtree constants recursively rather than summing their upper bounds. The child envelope identity (G.19) shows that the selected angles satisfy, at every original vertex,

$$\sum_{e\sim v}\psi_{e,\tau_v}+\frac{in_v\tau_v}{2\pi}=i. \tag{G.41}$$

Their modulus is bounded by $2\pi/[(19/20)\sqrt{d_v^2+n_v^2}]$, which is much less than the geometric chart radius. Substituting the recursive critical values makes all child constants telescope. The root action is exactly

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1})=\operatorname{stat}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}\left[\sum_e\psi_e+\frac{i}{4\pi}\sum_v n_v\tau_v^2-i\sum_v\tau_v\right]. \tag{G.42}$$

It is the original filled action, not a sum of independently optimized cap actions. Its selected branch agrees with the unique small simultaneous solution, by the same weighted contraction used in (G.16).

For the geometric path replace the right side of (G.41) by $ic$, $0\le c\le 1$. The explicit edge Hessian estimates in Section E.2.5 give the simultaneous contraction on the radius $1/4$ polydisk, with diagonal nonlinear bound $a_v/50$ and row bound $a_v/25$. Condition (10.2) implies $\sqrt{d_v^2+n_v^2}\ge\kappa^{-1/2}$. Consequently that solution has

$$|\tau_v(c)|\le\frac{2\pi c}{(1-1/50)\sqrt{d_v^2+n_v^2}}<10^{-2},\qquad \Im\tau_v(c)<0\quad(c>0). \tag{G.43}$$

The same factorization of the nonlinear derivative by $\tau_v$ proves the sign, just as in (G.17). These are precisely the primitive-completion hypotheses of Section F.3. All original disk periods, half twists and the calibrated action are therefore retained along the actual positive path.

Each edge sum contributes $N^{-3/2}$; each actual circle trace contributes $N^2$ times one nondegenerate one-dimensional Gaussian, hence $N^{3/2}$. Since a tree has one more vertex than edge, the final power is $N^{3/2}$. All its leading amplitudes are nonzero. The exact first coefficient (G.33), rather than separate evenness alone, pairs the reflected Fourier modes.

The edge insertion is still $H_N/W_k$, with the original Gamma interpolation and physical offsets. Its leading value is one and its first correction is the same cotangent insertion as in Theorem 9.1. The exact scalar ledger is unchanged by finite summation order. Thus the complete result is (10.3)–(10.1), and the same first correction can be obtained by the normalized insertion rule if desired.

## G.7 A vertexwise geometric criterion

We now prove Theorem 10.2. All the original ordered cell maps and primitive markings remain those of Appendix F. This part of the argument does not assume the local quantum condition.

### G.7.1 Exact derivatives of the nonlinear error

On the branches through zero define

$$F(t,u) = 2\,\mathrm{arsinh}(\tan(t/2)\cos(u/2))\,, \qquad E(t,u) = F(t,u) - t. \tag{G.44}$$

The edge action satisfies $-2\pi\psi_t = F$. Put

$$Q(t,u) = \sqrt{1 - \sin^2(t/2)\sin^2(u/2)}, \qquad Q(0,0) = 1. \tag{G.45}$$

Differentiation gives exactly

$$F_t = \frac{\cos(u/2)}{\cos(t/2)Q(t,u)}, \qquad F_u = -\frac{\sin(t/2)\sin(u/2)}{Q(t,u)}. \tag{G.46}$$

Indeed $1 + \tan^2(t/2)\cos^2(u/2) = Q^2/\cos^2(t/2)$; the square roots agree at zero and hence throughout the small connected chart. This fixes the branches in (G.46).

For $|t|, |u| \le 10^{-2}$, let

$$a = \frac{1}{79000}, \qquad b = \frac{1}{199}, \qquad \omega = b^4, \qquad \delta = \frac{1}{39000}. \tag{G.47}$$

The elementary series bounds with $r = 1/200$ give

$$|\sin(t/2)| \le \frac{r}{1 - r^2/6} < b, \qquad |\cos(t/2) - 1| \le \frac{r^2}{2(1 - r^2/12)} < a, \tag{G.48}$$

and the same for $u$. Thus $|Q|^{-1} \le (1-\omega)^{-1}$ and $|Q - 1| \le \omega$. To see the latter estimate, use $(Q-1)(Q+1) = -\sin^2(t/2)\sin^2(u/2)$; the branch has $\mathrm{Re}\, Q > 0$, so $|Q + 1| \ge 1$. Equation (G.46) now yields

$$\begin{aligned} |E_t| &\le \frac{2a/(1-a) + \omega}{1 - \omega} < \delta, \\ |E_u| &\le \frac{b^2}{1 - \omega} < \delta. \end{aligned} \tag{G.49}$$

Both final inequalities are rational comparisons. In particular, $E(0,u) = 0$, and

$$E(t,u) = tH(t,u), \qquad H(t,u) = \int_0^1 E_t(\lambda t, u)\, d\lambda, \qquad |H(t,u)| \le \delta. \tag{G.50}$$

The function $H$ is holomorphic also at $t = 0$. No division by a possibly vanishing unknown is needed to define it.

### G.7.2 A contraction independent of the size of the tree

Write $L_v = \sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} = |d_v - i n_v|$. Multiplying (10.10) by $-2\pi$ and using (G.44) gives

$$(d_v - i n_v)\tau_v + \sum_{w \sim v} E(\tau_v, \tau_w) = -2\pi i c. \tag{G.51}$$

Define the fixed-point map

$$\mathcal{T}_{c,v}(\boldsymbol{\tau}) = -\frac{2\pi i c}{d_v - i n_v} - \frac{\sum_{w\sim v} E(\tau_v, \tau_w)}{d_v - i n_v}. \tag{G.52}$$

On the closed polydisk of radius $\rho = 10^{-2}$, (G.50) and $d_v/L_v \le 1$ give, uniformly for complex $|c| \le 1$,

$$|\mathcal{T}_{c,v}| \le \frac{2\pi}{630} + \delta\rho < \rho. \tag{G.53}$$

For example the last strict inequality already follows from $\pi < 22/7$. The total row derivative is at most

$$\frac{d_v\delta + d_v\delta}{L_v} \le 2\delta < 1. \tag{G.54}$$

Hence (G.52) is a strict contraction in the ordinary maximum norm, with a constant independent of the graph size. It has exactly one fixed point in the polydisk. Iteration from zero converges uniformly in $c$, so the fixed point is holomorphic for $|c| < 1$. The strict margin in (G.53) allows $|c| \le 1 + \varepsilon$ for some positive $\varepsilon$, proving the stated neighborhood assertion. The selected value at $c = 0$ is zero.

The sign needed for geometric completion is not inferred from smallness. Equation (G.50) rewrites (G.51) as

$$A_v(\boldsymbol{\tau})\tau_v = -2\pi i c, \qquad A_v = d_v - i n_v + \sum_{w\sim v} H(\tau_v, \tau_w). \tag{G.55}$$

For real $c > 0$,

$$\operatorname{Re} A_v \ge (1-\delta)d_v > 0, \qquad \operatorname{Im}\tau_v = -\frac{2\pi c \operatorname{Re} A_v}{|A_v|^2} < 0. \tag{G.56}$$

Moreover $|A_v| \ge L_v - \delta d_v$, which proves (10.11). Every $\tau_v$ is nonzero for $c > 0$.

This argument allows arbitrary signs of $n_v$, and $n_v = 0$. It makes no assumption that neighboring powers are comparable. The same sign proof works even when a large degree makes the total meridian logarithm in (10.12) close to $-2\pi i$.

### G.7.3 Actual metric and absolute volume

The octahedral chart depends only on the parameters at the ends of one physical edge. Conditions (10.11) and (G.53) keep every such pair in its proved positive disk. The actual ordered disk seams match their full complex ratios, including the single prescribed odd seam. The original cut proof retains every primitive meridian and longitude. Thus Section F.3 applies to the path just constructed, rather than to an unrelated solution of exponentiated gluing equations.

In particular, the actual logarithmic periods start at zero as $c \downarrow 0$: in a fixed complete peripheral frame the second fixed point escapes to infinity, and the increments of $\log(z - q_v)$ along the fixed generator paths tend to zero. Their differences from (10.12) are continuous integers times $2\pi i$, and hence vanish along the whole path. The slope in (10.12) makes one full primitive turn at $c = 1$. This is the winding information that exponentiated filling equations alone would not supply.

Let

$$\mathcal{C}(c) = \operatorname*{stat}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \left[ \Psi + \frac{i}{4\pi} \sum_v n_v \tau_v^2 - ic \sum_v \tau_v \right]. \tag{G.57}$$

The same actual fundamental chain and primitive period calibration as in Section F.3.6 give

$$\mathrm{Vol}_c = 2\pi \operatorname{Re} \mathcal{C}(c), \qquad \frac{d}{dc} \mathrm{Vol}_c = 2\pi \sum_v \operatorname{Im} \tau_v(c). \tag{G.58}$$

The complete anchor is the volume of two regular octahedra per tree edge. Every complementary primitive $\lambda_v$ represents the core, of length $\ell_v = -2 \operatorname{Im} \tau_v$. The estimates above give the explicit bounds

$$\frac{4\pi c(1-\delta) d_v}{(L_v + \delta d_v)^2} \le \ell_v(c) \le \frac{4\pi c(1+\delta) d_v}{(L_v - \delta d_v)^2}. \tag{G.59}$$

If $S = \sum_v d_v / L_v^2$, integration yields

$$\frac{2\pi^2(1-\delta)}{(1+\delta)^2} S \le \mathrm{Vol}_0 - \mathrm{Vol}_1 \le \frac{2\pi^2(1+\delta)}{(1-\delta)^2} S. \tag{G.60}$$

Here $S$ is a useful bound on the volume change, not a hypothesis for existence or completion.

When the main component is a knot, the geometric preferred-cusp continuation of Section F.4 also applies. With the original oriented writhe $w_{\mathbf{n}}$, it gives

$$\tau_K = -w_{\mathbf{n}} - \sum_v n_v + 2i \sum_{vw} \sqrt{1 + \tan^2(\tau_v(1)/2) + \tan^2(\tau_w(1)/2)}. \tag{G.61}$$

Its proof uses the actual marked representation and preferred longitude. Equation (G.61) is not inferred from a quantum correction.

### G.7.4 A finite criterion with different radii at different vertices

One can keep the local graph data instead of using the common threshold (10.9). Choose radii $0 < r_v \le 10^{-2}$. Set

$$s_v = \sinh(r_v/2), \qquad a_v = \cosh(r_v/2) - 1, \qquad \omega_{vw} = s_v^2 s_w^2. \tag{G.62}$$

The same derivative calculation gives

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha_{vw} &= \frac{a_v + a_w}{(1-a_v)\sqrt{1-\omega_{vw}}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-\omega_{vw}}} - 1, \\ \beta_{vw} &= \frac{s_v s_w}{\sqrt{1-\omega_{vw}}}, \end{aligned} \tag{G.63}$$

as bounds for $|E_t|$ and $|E_u|$ on the corresponding bidisk. Put $h_v = \sum_{w \sim v} \alpha_{vw}$. The following finite inequalities suffice:

$$\begin{aligned} &2\pi + h_v r_v < L_v r_v, \qquad h_v < d_v, \\ &\max_v \left[ \frac{h_v}{L_v} + \sum_{w \sim v} \frac{\beta_{vw} r_w}{L_v r_v} \right] < 1. \end{aligned} \tag{G.64}$$

The first line makes (G.52) preserve the product of the vertex disks and gives the sign in (G.56). The second is a contraction bound in the weighted norm $\max_v |\tau_v|/r_v$. The proof of Sections G.7.2–G.7.3 applies unchanged, with

$$|\tau_v(c)| \le \frac{2\pi c}{L_v - h_v}. \tag{G.65}$$

This is a finite numerical certificate in the integer degrees and powers and the chosen positive radii. All quantities can be bounded by rational Taylor enclosures; it does not assume the existence of a saddle or a geometric representation.

More generally, the second line of (G.64) can be replaced by a positive-vector certificate for the derivative matrix with diagonal entries $h_v/L_v$ and off-diagonal entries $\beta_{vw}/L_v$. If a positive vector $q$ and a number $\kappa < 1$ satisfy $Mq \le \kappa q$, contraction holds in the $q$-weighted norm. The invariant polydisk is still supplied separately by the first line of (G.64). Thus choosing the contraction norm does not change the geometric parameter region.

# Appendix H

# A classical characteristic selected by the microscopic meridian state

The reduced ADO invariant is a function of a marked meridian eigenvalue $M$. Its exact quantum recurrence compares the values at $M, qM, q^2M, \dots$. We prove that, for the knot classes specified below, the complete asymptotic expansion on the scale $M = q_N^s$ selects one analytic curve in the classical symbol of every such recurrence. The curve is determined by the actual finite invariant and its original normalization.

The selected curve passes through $(M, L) = (1, -1)$, has the preferred cusp shape as its logarithmic tangent, and is invariant under $(M, L) \mapsto (M^{-1}, L^{-1})$. We also give a rational formula for its longitude coordinate in the original internal variables. For the all-circle trees, the geometric longitude theorem now identifies this entire germ with the geometric meridian–longitude germ. Together with the proof below, it gives the selected geometric factor of every genuine classical symbol. Appendix J extends that identification to every covered strict presentation with unmarked product junctions.

Fix a knot admitting one of the following presentations, with its original endpoint orders, orientations and peripheral markings:

- a strict ordered Conway presentation with independently long fixed filling powers, under the hypotheses of the filled-meridian theorem;
- an ordered all-circle tree satisfying the summed degree-and-twist criterion, $\sum_v d_v/(d_v^2 + n_v^2) \le 2^{-25}$;
- an ordered all-circle tree satisfying the local degree-and-twist criterion, $\max_v d_v/(d_v^2 + n_v^2) \le 2^{-120}$.

In the last two cases $d_v$ is the number of edges incident to vertex $v$, and $n_v$ is its signed integer crossing power. The construction must give one knot, with no additional component closed inside a tangle. The diagram, powers and compact parameter sets are fixed before the level tends to infinity. Both level parities are retained.

Those theorems supply an actual finite-sum representation with a nonzero, nondegenerate joint first Fourier contribution and fixed exponential bounds for all discarded terms. The proof here extends that representation to the finitely many translated microscopic regions needed by an arbitrary fixed-order recurrence, then uses every order of its canonical factorial expansion.

A leading volume limit or a finite cusp jet alone would not suffice.

## H.1 Exact finite inputs and the meridian action

Write

$$q_N = e^{\pi i/N}, \qquad M = q_N^s, \qquad F_N(1) = K_N, \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}. \tag{H.1}$$

Here $F_N$ is the actual zero-framed reduced ADO state in the marked coordinate $M = -qx$, where $x$ is the raw highest-weight parameter. The normalization and pointing fix $K_N = F_N(1)$, the Kashaev value. The full modified-trace state is $d_N(M)F_N(M)$, with

$$d_N(M) = \eta_N \frac{M - M^{-1}}{M^N - M^{-N}}, \qquad d_N(1) = \frac{\eta_N}{N}. \tag{H.2}$$

Here $\eta_N = i^{N+3}$ in the fixed normalization. All these factors remain in the argument.

Let $E$ denote the set of original physical quarter-turn edges. The finite-source theorem, with the exact scalar calculation, gives a local integral or finite-contour expression whose main-parameter dependence, after the exponentially smaller errors have been removed, is exactly

$$A_N(s) \prod_{e \in E} \mathcal{I}_N(x_e, s), \qquad A_N(s) = \exp\left(\frac{\pi i\, a(D) s^2}{2N}\right), \quad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v, \tag{H.3}$$

$$\mathcal{I}_N(x, s) = \frac{G_N(Nx)^2}{G_N(Nx - s) G_N(Nx + s)}. \tag{H.4}$$

The integer $w(D)$ is the oriented writhe of the original filled diagram, and $n_v$ are its original signed crossing powers. The variables $x_e$ are the normalized Newton indices on its physical quarter-turn edges. They are internal summation variables, distinct from the raw color $x$ in $M = -qx$. The single reduced-cut factor $H_N(s)$ is outside this expression. The base phase and its exact interpolation do not depend on $s$. Hidden edges introduced solely to resolve a product into binary multiplications are not added to (H.3).

The function $G_N$ is the fixed interpolation of the sine factorial, not an arbitrary solution of its difference equation:

$$G_N(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{N}\right)^z \Gamma(z+1) \prod_{k \geq 1} \frac{\Gamma(Nk + z + 1)}{\Gamma(Nk - z)(Nk)^{2z+1}}, \qquad -1 < \Re z < N. \tag{H.5}$$

Positive-base powers have their real logarithms. The exact interpolation theorem, Sections 1–2, proves local convergence, nonvanishing, $G_N(0) = 1$, and $G_N(z+1)/G_N(z) = 2\sin(\pi(z+1)/N)$. Its exact reflection identity fixes every endpoint normalization.

Equations (H.3)–(H.4) are the grouped-wire identities, (25)–(27), (34a)–(36), together with the scalar theorem. The general component comparison supplies the discarded-source error on a fixed strict tree. The joint filling transform supplies the nonzero first joint charge and its fixed gap. For the quantitative all-circle classes, the summed estimate or the local tree recursion supplies the corresponding contour and nonzero-source bounds. The exact edge insertion is the same in all cases.

The published profile on $|s| < 1$ alone is not enough to insert an arbitrary order-$d$ operator: its equation uses $s, s+1, \ldots, s+d$. Section H.2 addresses those charts from the exact source. No principle of analytic continuation of an asymptotic expansion is substituted for that argument.

## H.2 Fixed translated charts away from the resonances

Let $K$ be a compact subset of the open upper half-plane. It may have arbitrarily large but fixed real extent. Actual orientation types use the moving parameters $s$ or $-s$, or the constant parameter zero. The moving compacts $K \cup (-K)$ avoid every real integer and half-integer collision. The constant type keeps its original derivative data at the repeated nodes. The following checks extend the actual source bounds to $K$, with constants depending on $K$. They do not extend a uniform theorem across an ordinary resonance.

First, the crossing interpolation in the source-bound theorem, equation (D14), is the exact rational expression

$$r_{N,s}^{[n]}(z) = -\frac{1}{N(U-U^{-1})} \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \lambda_j(s)^n (t_j - t_j^{-1}) \frac{P_s(z)}{z - c_j(s)}, \qquad U = e^{2\pi i s}. \tag{H.6}$$

Here $t_j = q_N^{-2j-1+2s}$, $c_j = t_j + t_j^{-1}$, and $P_s(z) = T_N(z) + 2\cos(2\pi s)$, where $T_0 = 2, T_1 = z, T_{k+1} = zT_k - T_{k-1}$. The number $\lambda_j(s)$ is the crossing eigenvalue with the common Cartan scalar removed, as in the displayed interpolation. The full scalar multiplying that polynomial remains in the original crossing operator. On $K$, $|U - U^{-1}|$ has a positive lower bound. The nodes remain in an ellipse of height $O_K(N^{-1})$, and the same divided-difference estimates give a polynomial bound for the canonical polynomial, including its values and first derivatives at the repeated complete nodes. This holds for every fixed positive or negative crossing power. The common full crossing scalar and mixed-order reference factors are bounded on $K$; their exact ratios are still retained. The removable-collision maximum principle used on the unit disk is unnecessary here.

Second, Euler's product writes

$$W_k(s) = \prod_{\substack{1 \le r \le k \\ j \in \mathbb{Z}}} \left(1 - \frac{s^2}{(r+jN)^2}\right), \qquad 0 \le k < N. \tag{H.7}$$

The indicated integers are distinct and nonzero. For $s \in K$, the product over the finitely many small integers stays uniformly away from zero. The product of $\min(1, |1 - s^2/m^2|)$ over the remaining integers is bounded below by a positive constant, because its logarithmic tail is bounded by $C_K \sum m^{-2}$. The corresponding product of maxima gives an upper bound. Every subset in (H.7) therefore has uniform upper and inverse bounds. The same is true of $H_N(s)$, which converges uniformly to the nonzero function $\sin(\pi s)/(\pi s)$ on $K$.

Third, the complete-basis Newton envelopes and Hermite interpolation bounds do not involve $s$. Chebyshev folding depends only on the bounded number $\cos(2\pi s)$ and the fixed raw polynomial degree divided by $N$. The all-parity whole-trace estimates and the reflected high-index difference use finitely many polynomials $U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi s)$ at each fixed-valence junction. Here $U_\ell$ is the Chebyshev polynomial defined by $U_0 = 1, U_1 = 2z, U_{\ell+1} = 2zU_\ell - U_{\ell-1}$. Their bounds remain uniform on $K$. The same complete geometric action and strict component gaps consequently give the grouped discarded-source estimates. This uses the whole trace comparison; it does not compare a separated additional coefficient with an old tensor.

The same point applies to the regular bare trace: its first Fourier alias has coefficient one, and every higher alias has a strict regular-window frequency gap. Replacing the unit disk by

$K$ changes only the bounded coefficients of these finitely many aliases. Its comparison to the complete bare tensor remains exponentially accurate.

Finally, use the exact translated grids in the direct crossing trace, Sections 2–4. A bounded $s$, regardless of its real part, changes their interval endpoints by $O_K(N^{-1})$. Use translated single-grid rectangles, retaining their endpoint currents. If a common paired rectangle is used instead, it can include or exclude a bounded number of periodic copies near the endpoints; their residues must be restored explicitly. Every such residue has angular position $\pm\pi + O_K(N^{-1})$, so the established endpoint estimate, with the other angular variables real, gives the same fixed exponential loss. This point matters because the chirp is not periodic.

In particular, for the only extension needed below, $s \mapsto s + j$ with a fixed integer $j$, the grid is shifted by exactly $j$ spacings and the Casimir relation is unchanged. Reindex its central $N - |j|$ entries and retain the at most $|j|$ wrapped entries at each endpoint. Their nonperiodic chirp factors are explicit and bounded on the fixed parameter compact; the raw Newton factor supplies the endpoint gap. Thus the local comparison is proved by finite reindexing and its retained endpoint residues, not by treating the two unwrapped grids as identical. The exact paired-grid Fourier coefficients are

$$(-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)} U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma), \qquad \sigma = s, -s, 0. \tag{H.8}$$

For the moving types on $K$, no division by a vanishing sine occurs. The constant type is the already proved full-normal limit. The coefficient bound

$$|U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma)| \le \ell e^{2\pi|\operatorname{Im}\sigma|(\ell-1)} \tag{H.9}$$

is absorbed by the same $e^{-N\ell y}$ tails for sufficiently large $N$. The real-spectator telescoping and the common joint angular saddle are unchanged. Fixed-power discarded errors are bounded before these angular contours, as required by the grouped-source interface.

Thus the original nonzero first-charge packet and its exact scalars hold uniformly on $K$, with the same action and fixed exponential gaps. For the local tree criterion the same checks apply at each normalized subtree; Section H.4.1 gives its all-order induction. The threshold on the fixed filling powers, or the stated quantitative criterion, is unchanged; constants and starting levels may depend on $K$. This extension is needed only on a finite union of small disks with positive imaginary part. It asserts no uniform result on a compact meeting a nonzero integer.

## H.3 All-order canonical interpolation

The exact factorial product admits, on any fixed complex bulk compact, its expansion to every prescribed order:

$$\log G_N(Nx) = NJ(x) + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(2N\sin\pi x) + \sum_{j=1}^{L} N^{-j} b_j(x) + O_L(N^{-L-1}). \tag{H.10}$$

The $b_j$ are holomorphic and have the original logarithm marks; some of them vanish. The expansion and every fixed derivative are uniform on a smaller compact.

This follows by repeating Section 4 of the exact factorial interpolation theorem with the finite Stirling expansion to the desired order. Its remainder follows from the finite periodic-Bernoulli integral formula. On a fixed complex bulk compact, the arguments $N(k + x)$ and

$N(k-x)$ stay in a common right-half-plane sector. Taking sufficiently many Stirling terms bounds the remainder in the $k$-th factor by $C_L N^{-L-1} k^{-L-1}$, with the first finitely many factors treated in the same sector. For a low requested order one may first take more terms so that the tail is summable. Summation preserves the desired uniform order, and Cauchy's estimate supplies fixed derivatives. The leading function remains the fixed primitive

$$J'(x) = \log(2 \sin \pi x), \tag{H.11}$$

and the half-logarithm in (H.10) is fixed by the exact lattice normalization. No periodic interpolation factor is introduced.

Set $\delta = N^{-1}$, $t = \delta s$, and define

$$K(x,t) = 2J(x) - J(x+t) - J(x-t). \tag{H.12}$$

Using (H.10) in (H.4), formally to any specified order, gives

$$\log \mathcal{I}_N(x,s) = \delta^{-1} K(x,t) + B_0(x,t) + \sum_{j \geq 1} \delta^j B_j(x,t). \tag{H.13}$$

Each $B_j$ is holomorphic near $t = 0$, even in $t$, and vanishes at $t = 0$. In particular the $\log N$ terms cancel. Equation (H.13) means a formal two-parameter construction whose substitution $t = \delta s$ agrees with the actual fixed-$s$ asymptotic expansion. It is not an assertion of a physical fixed-$t$ asymptotic theorem.

The complete bare factorials, the circle Newton factors and all Gaussian amplitudes have analogous all-order bulk expansions. Exact integer offsets remain in the calculation. If $x = \ell(X) + \delta c$, then expansion of $\delta^{-1} K(\ell + \delta c, t)$ contributes $c K_x(\ell, t)$ to $B_0$, and further holomorphic terms to the $B_j$. It changes no term of the leading phase. The same observation retains the midpoint offsets from $N - 1$. The finite lattice currents and the other Fourier charges have a fixed exponential loss, so they do not contribute to any coefficient of these expansions.

## H.4 The filtered action theorem

Let $X$ collect the original retained wire variables and the joint angular variables. Write $\Phi(X)$ for the original first-charge filled phase at $s = 0$. Its critical point $X_0$ is nondegenerate and has the original normalization. Define the analytic phase family

$$\Phi_t(X) = \Phi(X) + \sum_{e \in E} K(x_e, t) + \frac{\pi i \, a(D)}{2} t^2, \qquad S(t) = \Phi_t(X_*(t)), \tag{H.14}$$

where $X_*(t)$ is the analytic critical point through $X_0$. The implicit-function theorem supplies it on a fixed neighborhood of zero. This is a local analytic definition; its use does not require taking $s = Nt$ in the physical invariant.

Formal stationary phase with the all-order analytic amplitude of Section H.3 gives

$$\log \frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{K_N H_N(s)} \sim N\{S(t) - S(0)\} + \sum_{j \geq 0} N^{-j} \{C_j(t) - C_j(0)\}, \qquad t = s/N. \tag{H.15}$$

Here the $C_j$ are holomorphic germs. The leading amplitude is nonzero, so its logarithm is fixed by the ratio at $t = 0$. Possible residue-class dependence of lower amplitudes can be treated separately; the phase $S$ is the same. The original powers of $N$ and the scalar independent of $s$ cancel in the displayed ratio.

For an explicit justification, perform formal Gaussian expansion of the local phase $\Phi_t$, uniformly for small $t$. Every coefficient is a finite polynomial in derivatives of the phase and amplitude and in the inverse Hessian. These derivatives are holomorphic in $t$, and the Hessian stays invertible. Substitute $t = \delta s$, Taylor-expand the resulting analytic coefficient functions, and truncate at any chosen power of $\delta$. The uniform contour remainder and the exponentially small discarded terms prove the same fixed-$s$ asymptotic coefficient. This argument applies on the original disk and on the translated compacts of Section H.2.

Consequently, writing the logarithm as

$$\log \frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{K_N H_N(s)} \sim \sum_{r\geq 1} N^{-r} p_r(s), \tag{H.16}$$

each $p_r$ is a polynomial of degree at most $r+1$. More precisely, its coefficient of $s^{r+1}$ is exactly the coefficient of $t^{r+1}$ in $S(t) - S(0)$. Terms from the $C_j$ have degree at most $r$ and cannot contribute to this top diagonal. This proves the filtration, rather than inferring it from a few low-order coefficients.

The phase is even in $t$. At its base critical point the first mixed derivatives in $X, t$ vanish, so

$$S'(0) = 0, \qquad S''(0) = -2\pi \sum_e \cot(\pi x_e^{\mathrm{fill}}) + \pi i\, a(D) = \pi i\, \tau_K. \tag{H.17}$$

The last equality uses the preferred-cusp formula, with its all-circle continuation in the two quantitative classes. Higher derivatives of $S$ are fixed by (H.14), not by the cusp tangent alone.

### H.4.1 All orders for the local tree criterion

The local criterion requires a separate justification: its initial relative $O(N^{-1})$ theorem does not by itself supply all the coefficients above.

The local recursion, Sections 2–6, retains the exact full edge kernel and the exact polynomial passed from each subtree to its parent. Denote that polynomial by $M_{v,N}(z)$, where $z$ is the unevaluated parent angle. Its high-index estimate, real bound, finite-degree strip estimate and crossing-trace tail estimate depend exponentially only on the original complete kernel and the stated local criterion. On $K \cup (-K)$, Section H.2 changes only their prefactors. The constant orientation type retains its independent derivative limit. Thus the same fixed local exponential margins and nonzero conditional first charge remain available.

For any prescribed order $L$, strengthen the induction to

$$\frac{M_{v,N}(z)}{M_{v,N}(0)} = e^{N h_v(z)} \frac{\alpha_v(z)}{\alpha_v(0)} \left( 1 + \sum_{j=1}^{L} N^{-j} a_{v,j}(z,s) + O_K(N^{-L-1}) \right) \tag{H.18}$$

on a fixed smaller parent disk. Here $h_v(0) = 0$, the leading amplitude $\alpha_v$ is nonzero, and the coefficients and remainder are holomorphic in the parent variable. The exact scalar $M_{v,N}(0)$, independent of $z$, is divided out; no convergence of this unnormalized subtree scalar is assumed.

For a terminal subtree, the all-order factorial expansion and finite translated first-charge contour prove (H.18). Suppose it holds for the children of a vertex. Their finite product has an expansion to every prescribed relative order. Since its normalized leading amplitude has no zero, its logarithm with value zero at the parent origin has the same property. The exact logarithm differs from its truncation by $O_K(N^{-L-1})$, with fixed derivatives on a smaller disk.

Evaluate the next trace using the exact child polynomials. The original conditional real and strip estimates continue to bound its tails and connecting contours. On the first-charge contour its leading phase has a nondegenerate Gaussian and its amplitude is nonzero. The absolute local Gaussian integral is bounded by a constant times its leading magnitude, uniformly on a smaller parent disk. A holomorphic relative remainder of order $N^{-L-1}$ therefore stays of that order after integration. Any extra finite derivative orders are obtained by starting the child expansion at higher order. The nonminimal charges and endpoint errors remain exponentially smaller than this conditional first charge. This proves (H.18) at the next vertex.

The tree is fixed and finite, so this induction proves every order without claiming constants uniform in the tree's size or depth. In particular it does not compare an early local discard with the accumulated action decrease over the entire tree.

To identify the phase, perform the same induction on the auxiliary local integrals formed with the exact bulk arguments $N(x \pm t)$. Their stationary equations are the original wire and angular equations with $\sum_e K(x_e, t)$ added. Eliminating a child is ordinary stationary elimination with the invertible block Hessian supplied by the local proof. The resulting Schur complements give the same joint critical branch $X_*(t)$ in (H.14). Constants subtracted when normalizing a child are restored by its exact $M_{v,N}(0)$, so no action is discarded.

The formal Gaussian coefficients also compose in this order. Gaussian integration with an invertible block Hessian is associative, and expansion to a fixed order involves only finitely many Gaussian moments. Repeated integration therefore gives the same coefficients as the joint local integral. At the root restore the original single cut factor and scalar (H.3). This proves (H.15)–(H.17) for the local criterion, with exactly the original physical edge set.

## H.5 Exact operator compatibility on the shifted charts

Let

$$P(q, M, T) = \sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q, M) T^j, \qquad TM = qMT, \tag{H.19}$$

be any specified nonzero actual all-level reduced-state annihilator. The shift $T$ replaces $M$ by $qM$. This means that the displayed fixed rational-coefficient operator annihilates the whole meridian function $F_N(M)$ at every sufficiently large root level. Its existence is the separate finite-sum annihilator theorem, not a definition obtained by fitting the values in (H.1). Clear its fixed rational denominators and remove its common $q-1$ valuation. Denote its first nonzero classical symbol by $P_0(M, L)$. No geometric factor is appended.

The exact reduced/full ratio in (H.2) satisfies

$$\frac{d_N(q_N^j M)}{d_N(M)} = (-1)^j \frac{q_N^j M - q_N^{-j} M^{-1}}{M - M^{-1}}. \tag{H.20}$$

Thus, with $f(M) = M - M^{-1}$, the same normalized function on the left of (H.16) obeys the

actual root equation obtained from

$$\widetilde{P} = \sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q, M)(-1)^j \frac{f(M)}{f(q^j M)} T^j. \tag{H.21}$$

This is a fixed rational Ore operator. It retains the meridian divisor and sign character. Multiplying it on the left by $\prod_{j=1}^{d} f(q^j M)$ clears its additional denominators. Its first classical symbol is

$$f(M)^d P_0(M, -L). \tag{H.22}$$

The displayed meridian factor is recorded, not removed by a normalization convention.

Choose a small open disk $D$ in the upper half-plane and put $K = \bigcup_{j=0}^{d} (\overline{D} + j)$. Section H.2 supplies the same all-order expansion at every argument in this exact equation. Division by the nonzero normalized state at $s \in D$ and comparison of every asymptotic coefficient therefore gives its formal difference equation. All coefficient functions vanish on $D$, hence identically as their polynomial or meromorphic functions of $s$.

This is the required compatibility step. Exact ordinary-color values alone would not have supplied these shifted neighborhoods, and a formal expansion restricted to $|s| < 1$ would not have justified it for arbitrary operator order.

## H.6 Diagonal extraction forces a classical characteristic germ

Now write $h = \log q$, $u = \log M$, so $u = hs$, and put

$$\mathcal{S}(u) = \pi i \{S(u/(\pi i)) - S(0)\}. \tag{H.23}$$

The degree filtration in Section H.4 regrades the formal logarithm uniquely as

$$h^{-1}\mathcal{S}(u) + \sum_{j \geq 0} h^j A_j(u). \tag{H.24}$$

Indeed a monomial $h^r s^k$ becomes $h^{r-k} u^k$, and $k \leq r + 1$ permits only the single negative power $h^{-1}$. For each exponent of $h$, its coefficient is a formal series in $u$.

Under the $j$-fold shift $s \mapsto s + j$, the ratio of these formal periods belongs to $\mathbb{C}[[h, u]]$, with constant $h$-coefficient

$$e^{j\mathcal{S}'(u)}. \tag{H.25}$$

The $h^{-1}$ cancels in the finite difference $\mathcal{S}(u + jh) - \mathcal{S}(u)$. All the $A_j$ contribute zero to the constant coefficient of that difference.

The substitution $\mathbb{C}[[h, u]] \to \mathbb{C}[s][[h]]$, $u \mapsto hs$, is injective: distinct monomials $h^a u^b$ yield the distinct monomials $h^{a+b} s^b$. Consequently the formal compatibility from Section H.5 is an identity before this substitution. Taking its constant $h$-coefficient and using (H.22) gives

$$f(e^u)^d \, P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{H.26}$$

The first factor is a nonzero formal series. The formal series ring is a domain, so

$$P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{H.27}$$

This deduction retains the factor in the operator and cancels it only in a domain identity. It does not silently discard a peripheral component.

The analytic germ

$$M = e^{u}, \qquad L = -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)} \tag{H.28}$$

therefore lies on the first nonzero classical symbol of every actual all-level annihilator. Its $M$ coordinate is nonconstant, so the kernel of the map from the Laurent polynomial ring in $M, L$ to this analytic germ is a height-one prime. It is generated by an irreducible Laurent polynomial, and that polynomial divides every such $P_0$. The marked reduced sign is $L(0) = -1$, and

$$\left.\frac{d\log(-L)}{du}\right|_{u=0} = \mathcal{S}''(0) = \tau_K. \tag{H.29}$$

This is an actual source-selected characteristic, derived from the given operator and its selected microscopic family. A nonminimal left multiple does not create a choice in (H.28): the phase was fixed by the physical source, and (H.27) also applies to a minimal annihilator if one is specified.

### H.6.1 Reciprocity of the selected factor

Evenness of the phase in (H.14) and uniqueness of its critical point imply $S(-t) = S(t)$. Hence $\mathcal{S}$ is even and $\mathcal{S}'$ is odd. Formula (H.28) gives the exact germ identity

$$L_{\mathrm{eff}}(M^{-1}) = L_{\mathrm{eff}}(M)^{-1}. \tag{H.30}$$

The minus sign is consistent on both sides: the inverse of $-e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}$ is $-e^{-\mathcal{S}'(u)}$.

Let $Q_{\mathrm{sel}}(M, L)$ generate the height-one prime of this germ. Inversion preserves that prime by (H.30). The Laurent polynomial ring is a unique factorization domain, so its two irreducible generators are associates:

$$Q_{\mathrm{sel}}(M^{-1}, L^{-1}) = cM^{\alpha}L^{\beta}Q_{\mathrm{sel}}(M, L), \quad c \in \mathbb{C}^{\times}, \quad \alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{Z}. \tag{H.31}$$

This is reciprocity of the irreducible factor selected by the actual state. It does not identify it with a geometric factor by imposing reciprocity as an extra condition.

## H.7 Peripheral equations and their geometric interpretation

Equations (H.14), (H.23), and (H.28) construct a complete analytic germ. Identifying it with the preferred longitude requires the whole nonparabolic representation, rather than only its first cusp derivative. We give its rational peripheral equations below. Appendix I constructs and identifies that representation for circle trees, and Appendix J supplies the junction argument for the stated strict Conway class.

### H.7.1 A finite rational peripheral map for the new action

There is a concrete algebraic form of the peripheral comparison. Retain the original logarithm of each sine near the selected filled wire, and put

$$E_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}, \qquad M = e^{\pi i t}. \tag{H.32}$$

Every filled wire lies in its original regular complex chart. Thus the sines in (H.12) are nonzero for sufficiently small $t$, with their logarithms fixed by continuation from $t = 0$. Direct differentiation gives

$$\begin{aligned} K_x(x,t) &= \log \frac{\sin^2(\pi x)}{\sin(\pi(x+t))\sin(\pi(x-t))}, \\ K_t(x,t) &= \log \frac{\sin(\pi(x-t))}{\sin(\pi(x+t))}. \end{aligned} \tag{H.33}$$

Both logarithms vanish at $t = 0$. The elementary exponential formula for sine now yields the exact identities

$$\exp K_x = \frac{(1-E)^2}{(1-EM^2)(1-E/M^2)}, \qquad \exp K_t = \frac{M^2-E}{1-M^2E}. \tag{H.34}$$

For the second identity, for example, the factors $e^{-\pi i(x-t)}$ and $e^{-\pi i(x+t)}$ contribute $M^2$, which gives

$$M^2 \frac{E/M^2-1}{EM^2-1} = \frac{M^2-E}{1-M^2E}.$$

This calculation fixes the factors and the sign without taking an unmarked square root of a shape monomial. Although a ratio in (H.34) might have other logarithms away from the chosen chart, its logarithm here is exactly the one in (H.33), since both vanish at $t = 0$.

In coordinates where the physical edge $x_e$ is an independent primitive wire, its old logarithmic critical equation is therefore changed by adding $K_x(x_e, t)$; its exponentiated equation is multiplied by the first ratio in (H.34). Hidden resolution wires receive no such term. In another integral primitive coordinate system the chain rule gives the product of these ratios to the corresponding signed incidence powers. Angular critical equations receive no direct insertion, because the added $K$ terms depend only on their edge wires. They still change indirectly through the coupled solution $X_*(t)$. The original flattening integers and the original finite cover used for the exponential coordinates remain fixed.

The derivative of a critical value has no derivative-of-critical-point term. Equations (H.14), (H.23), and (H.33) thus imply

$$\begin{aligned} S'(t) &= \pi i\, a(D)t + \sum_e K_t(x_e(t), t), \\ L_{\mathrm{eff}}(M) &= -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e\in E} \frac{M^2 - E_e(M)}{1 - M^2 E_e(M)}. \end{aligned} \tag{H.35}$$

This is exactly the characteristic in (H.28), with the marked reduced-state sign retained. It is a finite rational peripheral expression on the modified critical scheme, not an expression inferred from a cusp approximation. All its denominators are units at the selected filled point. In particular $L_{\mathrm{eff}}(1) = -1$.

The inserted phase is even in $t$, so uniqueness of the critical point gives $X_*(t) = X_*(-t)$. Consequently the derivatives of the $E_e$ contribute nothing to the first derivative of (H.35) at $M = 1$. With $u = \log M$,

$$\frac{d}{du} \log \frac{e^{2u} - E_e(u)}{1 - e^{2u}E_e(u)}\bigg|_{u=0} = 2\frac{1+E_e(0)}{1-E_e(0)} = 2i\cot(\pi x_e^{\mathrm{fill}}). \tag{H.36}$$

Equation (H.36) recovers $a(D) + 2i\sum_e \cot(\pi x_e^{\mathrm{fill}}) = \tau_K$, and also checks the orientation of the longitude expression. Every higher derivative is specified by the coupled modified equations and (H.35); none is supplied by this first-derivative check.

### H.7.2 Explicit equations for an all-circle tree

For the all-circle construction, there are no bare product vertices to resolve, so the modified critical equations have a particularly short finite form. Let $e = vw$ be an original tree edge, with wire $x_e$, and let $\tau_v$ be the angular variable of the crossing trace at vertex $v$. Define

$$\begin{aligned} b(x,\tau) &= \int_0^x \log(2\cos(2\pi r) + 2\cos\tau)\, dr - 2J(x), \\ E_e &= e^{2\pi i x_e}, \qquad Q_v = e^{i\tau_v}. \end{aligned} \tag{H.37}$$

The logarithm is initially the real one for $0 < x < 1/2$, $\tau = 0$, and is continued on the selected regular chart. This is exactly the circle-incidence action from the grouped packet, (23)–(24), and the all-circle edge calculation, Section 4.

Up to a fixed additive constant independent of $t$, the first-charge phase before stationary elimination is

$$\Phi_t(\mathbf{x},\boldsymbol{\tau}) = \sum_{e=vw} \big[b(x_e,\tau_v) + b(x_e,\tau_w) + K(x_e,t)\big] + \sum_v \left(\frac{i n_v \tau_v^2}{4\pi} - i\tau_v\right) + \frac{\pi i\, a(D)}{2} t^2. \tag{H.38}$$

The linear term $-i\tau_v$ is the retained first Fourier charge. It must remain when selecting the logarithmic branch, although it will disappear from the exponentiated equations.

Differentiating (H.37) first in $x$ gives

$$\exp b_x = \frac{2\cos(2\pi x) + 2\cos\tau}{4\sin^2(\pi x)} = -\frac{(E+Q)(E+Q^{-1})}{(E-1)^2}. \tag{H.39}$$

For the angular derivative, the change of variable $y = \tan(\pi r)$ gives

$$b_\tau = -\frac{1}{\pi}\operatorname{artanh}\big(\tan(\tau/2)\tan(\pi x)\big), \qquad \exp(-2\pi b_\tau) = \frac{Q+E}{1+QE}. \tag{H.40}$$

The branch of artanh is zero at $\tau = 0$. To verify the second identity without a sign choice, substitute $\tan(\tau/2) = -i(Q-1)/(Q+1)$ and $\tan(\pi x) = -i(E-1)/(E+1)$ into $\exp(2\operatorname{artanh} z) = (1+z)/(1-z)$.

The wire equation is $b_x(x_e,\tau_v) + b_x(x_e,\tau_w) + K_x(x_e,t) = 0$. The two minus signs in (H.39) cancel. Using (H.34) therefore gives

$$\begin{aligned} &(E_e + Q_v)(E_e + Q_v^{-1})(E_e + Q_w)(E_e + Q_w^{-1}) \\ &\quad = (E_e - 1)^2(1 - E_e M^2)(1 - E_e/M^2). \end{aligned} \tag{H.41}$$

The edge equation is linear in the trace of its internal variable. Put

$$Z_e = E_e + E_e^{-1}, \qquad B_v = Q_v + Q_v^{-1}, \qquad D_M = M^2 + M^{-2}. \tag{H.42}$$

Dividing (H.41) by $E_e^2$ gives

$$(Z_e + B_v)(Z_e + B_w) = (Z_e - 2)(Z_e - D_M).$$

The quadratic terms cancel, leaving

$$Z_e = \frac{2D_M - B_v B_w}{B_v + B_w + D_M + 2}. \tag{H.43}$$

The denominator is eight at the complete point and remains nonzero on the selected small-filling chart. The equation $E_e^2 - Z_e E_e + 1 = 0$, with its chosen branch through $E_e = i$ at completeness, recovers the original edge variable. This determines the internal variable by a quadratic equation with its original branch retained.

The angular equation, with its first-charge mark, is

$$\sum_{e \ni v} b_\tau(x_e, \tau_v) + \frac{i n_v \tau_v}{2\pi} - i = 0. \tag{H.44}$$

Multiplication by $-2\pi$ and exponentiation give

$$\prod_{e \ni v} \frac{Q_v + E_e}{1 + Q_v E_e} = Q_v^{n_v}. \tag{H.45}$$

In obtaining (H.45), the additive term $-2\pi i$ has exponent one. Equation (H.44), rather than (H.45) alone, retains which Fourier charge was used.

Equations (H.41), (H.45), and the longitude expression (H.35) are a finite rational system with parameter $M$. Work on the original chart where their denominators are units, or equivalently clear denominators and saturate by those factors before taking the selected germ. The nondegenerate critical point and the continued logarithms choose one analytic solution through the original filled point. Exponentiation has other branches and cannot replace that choice. Eliminating the $E_e, Q_v$ on this chosen germ gives the same $L_{\text{eff}}$ as (H.28), not a separately normalized polynomial curve.

The geometric longitude theorem constructs those nonparabolic blocks, glues their ordered boundary representations, and proves that (H.35) is the preferred longitude. Its algebraic rigidity argument rules out a residual meridian factor beyond the stated framing monomial. The first-charge logarithms still select the filled geometric branch among the algebraic solutions.

### H.7.3 Scope of the geometric identification

The geometric identification uses the original meridian eigenvalue and the preferred longitude throughout. Appendix I constructs the nonparabolic representation of each circle-tree block, joins its ordered boundary groups, and identifies the rational expression (H.35) with that longitude. Agreement of the first derivative at completeness is a normalization check; the representation and algebraic rigidity argument prove the full identity.

Appendix J supplies the comparison at unmarked product junctions. It inserts a zero-crossing box with an auxiliary circle, proves stationary elimination including its constant, and checks the based boundary maps after meridian filling. The argument recovers the whole geometric representation, including possible half-angle folds; agreement of the cusp tangent alone would not suffice.

The argument also does not claim a physical asymptotic formula for fixed $M \neq 1$, or for $s$ growing with $N$. The variable $t$ in Section H.4 is an auxiliary analytic parameter used to organize all fixed-$s$ coefficients. The ordinary-color divisors remain in (H.2), (H.20)–(H.22).

The translated charts in Section H.2 stay away from those divisors; no uniform nonvanishing state across ordinary-color resonances has been asserted.

For every full-source class listed at the start, the selected curve is the geometric eigenvalue germ, and its irreducible Laurent factor divides the first nonzero classical symbol. Chapter 14 and Appendix M prove the required all-orders expansion on shifted charts for every directed certificate from Chapter 11; those additional cases therefore have the same factor conclusion. No equality with the full A-polynomial or with an entire annihilator ideal is claimed.

# Appendix I

# The geometric longitude of a tree of crossing circles

The edge equations of a tree of crossing circles determine a representation of its link exterior. They determine the auxiliary meridians and longitudes directly. This note identifies the main preferred longitude: its eigenvalue is the product of the edge factors, with the monomial prescribed by the original zero framing.

The construction retains the ordered tangles, crossing disks and their primitive peripheral curves. The half twist at a disk is inserted through its full two-generator boundary action. Merely exchanging three ideal vertices while retaining the old white-face maps would give a false gluing away from the parabolic main meridian.

This is a geometric and algebraic identification. It does not extend a quantum asymptotic theorem to arbitrary short fillings.

## I.1 The diagram and the longitude identity

Take a finite tree with at least one edge. At each vertex $v$, place one two-strand crossing-circle tangle, whose auxiliary circle bounds the specified twice-punctured disk. Retain a crossing $R^{\epsilon_v}$, with $\epsilon_v \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$. Every edge is an actual quarter-turn attachment between ordered stacks. The product order, rotations of the tangle balls, endpoint frames and cylindrical closing map are part of the diagram. There are no product junctions without their own crossing circle. Write $\mathcal{E}$ for its set of edges.

The ordered decomposition constructs two projection balls from this literal diagram. Each original edge contributes two octahedra. At each circle their disk-side pages are joined in the original cyclic order, with its retained half twist on one distinguished seam. Assume the main strands form one component, and orient that knot.

Let $\mu_K$ be its positive meridian and $\lambda_{\mathrm{aug}}$ its preferred longitude in the augmented exterior. Use the main eigenvalue parameter $M$. The source flag is the $M^{-1}$ eigenline; the longitude coordinate below is its inverse eigenvalue, equivalently the eigenvalue on the $M$ line. At auxiliary circle $v$, the selected eigenvalue of the original primitive disk longitude is $-Q_v$, so its projective similarity is $Q_v^2$. Write $U_v$ for the logarithm of its primitive meridian similarity at that auxiliary flag.

For each edge $e = vw$, introduce $X_e$ and impose

$$(X_e+Q_v)(X_e+Q_v^{-1})(X_e+Q_w)(X_e+Q_w^{-1})=(X_e-1)^2(1-X_eM^2)(1-X_e/M^2). \tag{I.1}$$

Choose the branch through $M=Q_v=1$, $X_e=i$. Set

$$\rho_{v,e}=\frac{Q_v+X_e}{1+Q_vX_e},\qquad f_e=\frac{M^2-X_e}{1-M^2X_e}. \tag{I.2}$$

All rational identities are read on their regular open sets and then continued on the same irreducible source variety. Clearing a denominator does not add a new geometric branch.

**Theorem.** Equations (I.1) give a representation of the original augmented exterior near its marked complete structure. Its primitive auxiliary similarities are

$$\exp U_v=Q_v^{-\epsilon_v}\prod_{e\ni v}\rho_{v,e}. \tag{I.3}$$

If $w_\epsilon$ is the oriented writhe of the retained crossings and $a_{\mathrm{aug}}=-w_\epsilon-\sum_v\epsilon_v$, then

$$L_{\mathrm{aug}}^2=M^{2a_{\mathrm{aug}}}\prod_e f_e^2. \tag{I.4}$$

Fill circle $v$ on its original primitive slope $\mu_v+p_v\lambda_v$, with $n_v=\epsilon_v-2p_v$. The exponentiated filling equations are

$$\prod_{e\ni v}\rho_{v,e}=Q_v^{n_v}. \tag{I.5}$$

Where $Q_v^2\neq1$ for every filled circle, these equations make each filling word projectively trivial, so the representation factors through the filled group. On that locus its preferred longitude satisfies

$$L_{\mathrm{fill}}^2=M^{2a(D)}\prod_e f_e^2,\qquad a(D)=-w(D)-\sum_v n_v. \tag{I.6}$$

Here $w(D)$ is the writhe of the original filled diagram. The squared formula is also an identity for the corresponding peripheral word on the augmented source variety. At $Q_v=\pm1$, equation (I.5) alone need not kill a nontrivial parabolic filling word, so that word identity does not by itself give a representation of the filled group.

On a connected germ anchored at a complete hyperbolic filled knot point supplied by the existing marked completion theorem, the determinant-one sign is fixed:

$$\boxed{L_{\mathrm{fill}}=-M^{a(D)}\prod_e\frac{M^2-X_e}{1-M^2X_e}.} \tag{I.7}$$

This is the geometric longitude of the original knot complement. It uses its preferred meridian and longitude; it is not a longitude of a different comparison diagram.

The complete anchor and the primitive logarithmic filling marks are retained in Section I.5. The proof first establishes the squared identity, without a choice of global determinant-one lift, and then fixes the sign by a Seifert-surface frame calculation in Section I.10. The algebraic constant-field lemma also holds for finite simple graphs; the geometric theorem here is restricted to the literal ordered trees.

## I.2 The local face maps

We first construct the two-octahedron piece with its original white and shaded face labels. In this section $E_0$ is a preliminary white-face coordinate, and $X$ is the edge variable in (I.1). Their distinction matters when $M \neq 1$.

### I.2.1 The parameters and the actual faces

Write $M$ for the main meridian eigenvalue parameter and set $m = M^2$. The symbols $Q$ and $P$ are the chosen square roots of the two auxiliary longitude similarities. All parameters are near $(m, Q, P) = (1, 1, 1)$. We use $E_0$ for a white-face coordinate, near $i$. The effective-action wire coordinate will be denoted $X$.

The two projection copies have six ideal vertices

| | equator | circle apices |
|---|---|---|
| $+$ | $(0, \infty, 1, R)$ | $(A, B)$ |
| $-$ | $(0, \infty, 1, S)$ | $(a, b)$. |

(I.8)

The four white identifications are the unique maps of the ordered triangles

$$\begin{aligned} W_0 &: (A, 0, \infty) \longmapsto (a, 0, \infty), \quad W_1 : (B, \infty, 1) \longmapsto (b, \infty, 1), \\ W_2 &: (A, 1, R) \longmapsto (a, 1, S), \quad W_3 : (B, R, 0) \longmapsto (b, S, 0). \end{aligned} \tag{I.9}$$

These are the face labels of the original two-leaf cut. Changing the minus equator from $R$ to $S$ is necessary: retaining the old four white matrices would keep all four main meridians parabolic.

Put $L = E_0^{-1}$, and define

$$\begin{aligned} S = \frac{m^2 R}{1 + (m^2 - 1)R}, \qquad \ell_1 = L/m, \quad \ell_2 = L/m^2, \quad \ell_3 = Lm, \\ c_2 = \frac{\ell_2(R-1)/(S-1) - 1}{R - 1}, \qquad c_3 = \frac{\ell_3 R/S - 1}{R}, \\ W_0 = \begin{pmatrix} L & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad W_1 = \begin{pmatrix} \ell_1 & 1 - \ell_1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \\ W_2 = \begin{pmatrix} c_2 + \ell_2 & 1 - c_2 - \ell_2 \\ c_2 & 1 - c_2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad W_3 = \begin{pmatrix} \ell_3 & 0 \\ c_3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.10}$$

Thus $W_2(z) = 1 + \ell_2(z-1)/(1 + c_2(z-1))$. Every map sends its two equatorial vertices in (I.9) correctly.

If $q = (0, \infty, 1, R)$, the native main corner word $W_{j-1}^{-1} W_j$ fixes $q_j$ and has local derivative

$$(m^{-1}, m, m^{-1}, m)_j. \tag{I.11}$$

At infinity the local coordinate is $1/z$. To derive (I.10), start with $W_0(z) = Lz$. The derivatives at infinity, 1 and 0 give respectively $\ell_1 = L/m, \ell_2 = L/m^2, \ell_3 = Lm$. The remaining derivative at $R$, on its branch through the complete chart, gives the displayed formula for $S$. This supplies the actual peripheral condition, not just equal traces.

### I.2.2 The auxiliary longitude equations and the local gluing locus

Take

$$A = \frac{mE_0 + Q}{m + Q}, \qquad B = \frac{P(1 - mE_0)}{P + m}, \qquad a = A/E_0, \qquad b = 1 + \frac{B - 1}{E_0 m} = -\frac{B}{E_0 P}. \tag{I.12}$$

There are two expressions for the equatorial coordinate:

$$\begin{aligned} R_v &= \frac{(mE_0 + Q)(mE_0 Q + 1)}{E_0 m(Q^2 + 1) + 2E_0 Q m^2 + Q(1 - m^2)}, \\ R_w &= -\frac{P(mE_0 - 1)^2}{E_0 m^2(P^2 + 1) + 2E_0 P m + P(m^2 - 1)}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.13}$$

The first is exactly $W_2(A) = a$; the second is exactly $W_3(B) = b$. Their common value is $R$.

For completeness, the longitude choices made here can be obtained before solving for the apices. The first longitude is $W_2^{-1}W_0$. Its similarity in the coordinate with $A$ at infinity is $W_2'(A)/L$, and is prescribed as $Q^2$. The chosen square-root branch is $1 + c_2(A - 1) = -1/(mQ)$. At the other circle the longitude is $W_1^{-1}W_3$, with similarity $\ell_1/W_3'(B) = P^2$, and the chosen branch is $1 + c_3 B = -mP$. Substitution gives (I.12)–(I.13). Both signs equal $-1$ at completeness.

Clearing the nonzero denominators of $R_v - R_w$, and removing the factor $E_0 m^2$, gives

$$\begin{aligned} G = {} & E_0^2 P^2 Q m^2 + E_0^2 P Q^2 m + 2E_0^2 P Q m^2 + 2E_0^2 P Q m + E_0^2 P m + E_0^2 Q m^2 \\ & + E_0 P^2 Q^2 m + E_0 P^2 m - 4E_0 P Q m + E_0 Q^2 m + E_0 m \\ & + P^2 Q + P Q^2 m + 2P Q m + 2P Q + P m + Q. \end{aligned} \tag{I.14}$$

The local gluing equation is $G = 0$. At $m = Q = P = 1$, $G = 8(E_0^2 + 1)$, so $G_{E_0}(i, 1, 1, 1) = 16i$. It follows that there is a unique holomorphic branch $E_0$ near $i$. Every denominator displayed above is nonzero on a sufficiently small neighborhood of this branch.

The pure shaded maps in the two plus-copy circle frames are

$$S_v(A, R) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & RA(1 - A) \\ A - R & R - A^2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad S_w(B, R) = \begin{pmatrix} B(B - 1) & -RB(B - 1) \\ B - R & R - B \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.15}$$

The first fixes $A$ and sends $\infty$ to 0 and 1 to $R$. The second fixes $B$ and sends $R$ to 0 and 1 to infinity. The minus maps are the same formulas with $(A, B, R)$ replaced by $(a, b, S)$; denote them by $S_v^-$ and $S_w^-$.

All the actual white/shaded edge returns hold projectively:

$$\begin{aligned} &W_0 S_v = S_v^- W_0, \quad W_2 S_v = S_v^- W_2, \quad W_3 S_v = S_v^- W_1, \\ &W_1 S_w = S_w^- W_1, \quad W_3 S_w = S_w^- W_3, \quad W_0 S_w = S_w^- W_2. \end{aligned} \tag{I.16}$$

The first row follows already on $R = R_v$, and the second on $R = R_w$. One can verify each equality by multiplying one side by the adjugate of the other: both off-diagonal entries and

the diagonal difference vanish. Consequently these are the face maps of the marked local representation of the original cut, rather than maps chosen solely to reproduce a character polynomial.

At completeness their apices are

$$(A, B) = ((1 + i)/2, (1 - i)/2), \quad (a, b) = ((1 - i)/2, (1 + i)/2), \quad R = S = 1/2. \tag{I.17}$$

The eight ordered tetrahedral shapes of the original apical subdivision are then $i$. Holomorphic continuity preserves their positive imaginary parts on a sufficiently small parameter neighborhood. This is a local incomplete hyperbolic structure with decorated main eigenflags; it does not assert completeness at a nonparabolic main cusp.

### I.2.3 The wire coordinate is determined by the actual meridian

The positively chosen auxiliary meridians are $S_v^{-1}$ and $S_w^{-1}$. Sending the corresponding apex to infinity changes their similarities into the ordinary derivatives of $S_v, S_w$ at those apices. Direct differentiation of (I.15) gives

$$\begin{aligned} U_v^{\exp} &= -\frac{A(A - R)}{R(1 - A)} = \frac{(E_0 m + Q)(Qm + 1)}{(Q + m)(E_0 Qm + 1)}, \\ U_w^{\exp} &= \frac{B(R - 1)}{(B - R)(B - 1)} = \frac{(E_0 + P)(P + m)}{(E_0 P + 1)(Pm + 1)}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.18}$$

These are similarities of the primitive words, not the squares of unrecorded primitive words. The actual longitude similarities are exactly $Q^2, P^2$, as established in Section I.2.2.

Solve $U_v^{\exp} = (Q + X)/(1 + QX)$ for $X$. Cancel the removable $Q = 1$ factor before taking that limit:

$$X = \frac{E_0 Q^2 m + E_0 Q m^2 + E_0 Q m + E_0 m - Qm + Q}{E_0 Q m^2 - E_0 Q m + Q^2 m + Qm + Q + m}. \tag{I.19}$$

The denominator is 4 at completeness. The second meridian similarly gives

$$X_w = -\frac{E_0 P^2 m + E_0 P m + E_0 P + E_0 m + Pm - P}{E_0 P m - E_0 P - P^2 - Pm - P - 1}. \tag{I.20}$$

Their difference is $(m - 1)G$ divided by the product of the two displayed denominators. Hence $X = X_w$ on the actual gluing locus. In particular

$$U_v^{\exp} = \frac{Q + X}{1 + QX}, \qquad U_w^{\exp} = \frac{P + X}{1 + PX}, \qquad X|_{m=1} = E_0. \tag{I.21}$$

Thus the same source wire variable is selected from both actual auxiliary meridians.

Substitution of (I.19) and (I.14) now gives

$$(X + Q)(X + Q^{-1})(X + P)(X + P^{-1}) = (X - 1)^2(1 - Xm)(1 - X/m). \tag{I.22}$$

For a direct polynomial check, after reducing the rational expression its numerator is $G$ times

$$(Q + 1)^2(Q + m)(Qm + 1)(E_0 Q^2 m + E_0 Q m^2 + E_0 Q m + E_0 m - Qm + Q).$$

Nonzero unit factors can differ if the common denominator is not reduced. Alternatively put $\mathcal{A} = X + X^{-1}$, $\mathcal{B} = Q + Q^{-1}$, $\mathcal{C} = P + P^{-1}$, $\mathcal{D} = m + m^{-1}$. Equation (I.22) is

$$(\mathcal{A}+\mathcal{B})(\mathcal{A}+\mathcal{C}) = (\mathcal{A}-2)(\mathcal{A}-\mathcal{D}), \qquad \mathcal{A} = \frac{2\mathcal{D}-\mathcal{B}\mathcal{C}}{\mathcal{B}+\mathcal{C}+\mathcal{D}+2}. \tag{I.23}$$

The denominator in the last expression is 8 at completeness. This is the effective edge equation with $m = M^2$.

### I.2.4 The full disk-side seam, including its main punctures

Use the ordered cross ratio $[a,b,c,d] = (a-c)(b-d)/((a-d)(b-c))$. The incoming plus-copy triangle at the first circle is $(A,\infty,1)$; the outgoing triangle is $(A,R,0)$. Develop the adjacent minus triangle back through its actual white map. The six neighboring third vertices are respectively

$$E_0, \quad W_1^{-1}(a), \quad W_2^{-1}(\infty), \qquad W_2^{-1}(0), \quad W_3^{-1}(a), \quad W_0^{-1}(S). \tag{I.24}$$

Substituting (I.10)–(I.13), with $R = R_v$, gives

| incoming edge | $(A,\infty)$ | $(\infty,1)$ | $(1,A)$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| ratio | $-m/Q$ | $-Q$ | $-1/(mQ)$ |
| outgoing edge | $(A,R)$ | $(R,0)$ | $(0,A)$ |
| ratio | $-mQ$ | $-1/Q$ | $-Q/m.$ |

(I.25)

For example, the first ratio is $(A-1)/(A-E_0) = -m/Q$. The other five reduce by the same single substitution. In particular the table is independent of the other circle parameter $P$ and of the preliminary wire coordinate $E_0$.

The original pure disk-side matching reverses the two main punctures: outgoing $(A,R,0)$ is identified with incoming $(A',1,\infty)$. Thus the outgoing entries are paired with the incoming entries in reverse order. Each resulting product is one, including its complex shear. A map of the three ordered vertices identifies the first triangles; the three ratios then identify the adjacent second triangles. This proves equality of the full marked two-triangle disk-side structures. It does not replace that matching by an arbitrary pants permutation.

The main puncture multipliers visible in the incoming table are $m, m^{-1}$, and the circle multiplier is $Q^{-2}$; the outgoing table reverses the boundary orientation. These multipliers explain why recording the puncture order is essential. Replacing $M$ by $M^{-1}$ exchanges eigenflags and is not an innocuous reset of the marked representation.

Consequently any chain of these *compatibly framed pure seams* can be sewn in its original cyclic order. The geometric seam at each step uses the same $m, Q$; it requires no parameter from the opposite end of an edge. Products of the auxiliary meridian increments are therefore products of the factors in (I.21). The actual main component and its globally positive meridian must still be traced through the endpoint frames, as explained in Section I.4 below.

## I.3 A regular character chart for the same piece

The face chart identifies the actual topology. The following rational matrix chart is useful both for its peripheral words and for continuation to generic auxiliary values over any fixed $M \neq 0$. Throughout this section use

$$\begin{aligned} t = M + M^{-1}, \quad D = M^2 + M^{-2} = t^2 - 2, \\ \beta = Q + Q^{-1}, \quad \gamma = P + P^{-1}, \\ A_0 = X + X^{-1}, \quad S = \beta + \gamma + t^2. \end{aligned} \tag{I.26}$$

Equation (I.1) is

$$(A_0 + \beta)(A_0 + \gamma) = (A_0 - 2)(A_0 - D), \qquad A_0 = \frac{2D - \beta\gamma}{S}. \tag{I.27}$$

The denominator is eight at completeness. In the following matrix formulas the internal mixed trace is denoted $\mathcal{X}$, so it is distinct from the source wire $X$.

### I.3.1 A four-puncture character and its explicit matrices

Put

$$p = -\beta, \qquad q = -\gamma, \qquad \mathcal{X} = 2 + SX, \qquad b = p - 2, \quad h = M - M^{-1}. \tag{I.28}$$

For the moment $p, q, \mathcal{X}$ may be arbitrary nearby parameters. Define

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} M & 1 \\ 0 & M^{-1} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad B = \begin{pmatrix} M^{-1} & 0 \\ b & M \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.29}$$

Both have determinant one and trace $t$, and $\operatorname{tr}(AB) = p$. Set

$$\begin{aligned} c = \frac{M\mathcal{X} + M^{-1}q - 2t}{D - p}, \qquad d = \frac{q - M^2 - 1 + hc}{p - 2}, \\ e = \mathcal{X} - 1 - M^{-2} - hc, \qquad C = \begin{pmatrix} c & d \\ e & t - c \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.30}$$

The denominators $p - 2 = -4$ and $D - p = 4$ at the complete point are nonzero. The construction does not divide by $M - M^{-1}$. Direct multiplication gives

$$\operatorname{tr} C = t, \qquad \operatorname{tr}(BC) = q, \qquad \operatorname{tr}(AC) = \mathcal{X}, \qquad \operatorname{tr}(ABC) = t. \tag{I.31}$$

For the last identity, the nonconstant part of the trace is $bc + Me + M^{-1}bd$, which vanishes by (I.30).

The determinant calculation is

$$\det C - 1 = \frac{\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{X}, p, q)}{(p - 2)(D - p)}, \tag{I.32}$$

where

$$\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{X}^2 + p^2 + q^2 + pq\mathcal{X} - 2t^2(p + q + \mathcal{X}) + 4t^2 + t^4 - 4. \tag{I.33}$$

This is the equal-boundary-trace four-punctured-sphere character equation, derived here from the matrices. For a direct verification of (I.32), substitute the three entries in (I.30), multiply by $(p - 2)(D - p)$, and collect the quadratic polynomial in $\mathcal{X}$. Its leading coefficient is one; the other two coefficients are those displayed in (I.33).

Now impose (I.28). A direct substitution gives the especially simple identity

$$\mathcal{F}(2+SX,-\beta,-\gamma)=XS\big[(A_0+\beta)(A_0+\gamma)-(A_0-2)(A_0-D)\big]. \tag{I.34}$$

Thus (I.1) is equivalent to $\det C=1$ on this regular chart. Put

$$D_0=(ABC)^{-1}. \tag{I.35}$$

Equations (I.31)–(I.35) give

$$ABCD_0=I,\qquad \det A=\det B=\det C=\det D_0=1,\qquad \operatorname{tr}A=\operatorname{tr}B=\operatorname{tr}C=\operatorname{tr}D_0=t. \tag{I.36}$$

These are literal matrices representing the four positively oriented boundary generators of a four-punctured sphere. Each puncture has eigenvalues $M, M^{-1}$. In particular, the source relation is not merely similar in degree to a character equation: (I.30), (I.34), and (I.35) realize it by actual matrices.

At the complete selected point,

$$A=\begin{pmatrix}1&1\\0&1\end{pmatrix},\quad B=\begin{pmatrix}1&0\\-4&1\end{pmatrix},\quad C=\begin{pmatrix}-1+2i&1\\8i&3-2i\end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.37}$$

All four punctures are noncentral parabolics. The pair $A, B$ has no common eigenline. The construction is therefore on a regular irreducible character chart through the complete point.

The alternative root of the quadratic (I.33) is $2+S/X$. Indeed its sum with $\mathcal{X}=2+SX$ is $2t^2-\beta\gamma$, by (I.27). For comparison, its discriminant factors as

$$(\beta+2)(\gamma+2)\big[\beta\gamma-2\beta-2\gamma-4D-4\big]=S^2(X-X^{-1})^2. \tag{I.38}$$

This verifies the two-sheeted parameter and its branch without assigning signs by a numerical square root.

### I.3.2 Auxiliary transport matrices with the actual source ratios

Define two invertible projective transport matrices

$$V=AB+z_vI,\qquad T=BC+z_wI,\qquad z_v=-\frac{1+X(\beta+1)}{1-X},\qquad z_w=\frac{X+\gamma+1}{1-X}. \tag{I.39}$$

Scalar multiples of $V, T$ give the same projective transports. Their determinant-one normalizations can be chosen on a local square-root cover; every commutator below is independent of that choice.

The following full matrix identities hold on (I.1):

$$\begin{aligned} VA&=D_0^{-1}V,\quad VB=C^{-1}V,\\ TB&=A^{-1}T,\quad TC=D_0^{-1}T. \end{aligned} \tag{I.40}$$

They are stronger than trace matching. Also $V$ commutes with $AB$, and $T$ commutes with $BC$, directly from (I.39).

Here is a rational way to verify (I.40), preserving the regular chart. Eliminate $\gamma$ using (I.27):

$$\gamma = \frac{2D - (X + X^{-1})(\beta + D + 2)}{X + X^{-1} + \beta}. \tag{I.41}$$

The denominator is two at the complete point. Substitute (I.41), (I.28), and (I.30) in (I.40). Every difference becomes a zero rational function of $M, \beta, X$. This is also a polynomial certificate after clearing the recorded denominators. For example, before substituting (I.28), the value of $z$ solving the lower-left entry of $(AB + zI)A = (ABC)(AB + zI)$ makes the remaining three entries scalar multiples of (I.33); after (I.28), that $z$ reduces to $z_v$. The other pair follows by cyclic permutation of the four punctures. No eigenline diagonalization at a repeated eigenvalue is used.

The two disk-longitude words and their selected eigenvalues are

$$\Lambda_v = AB, \quad \lambda_v = -Q; \qquad \Lambda_w = (BC)^{-1}, \quad \lambda_w = -P. \tag{I.42}$$

The inverse in the second word records the opposite boundary orientation. On the $-Q$ eigenline of $AB$, the projective eigenvalue ratio of $V$ is

$$\frac{z_v - Q}{z_v - Q^{-1}} = \frac{Q + X}{1 + QX}. \tag{I.43}$$

This identity follows by factoring the numerator as $-(1 + Q)(1 + X/Q)/(1 - X)$ and the denominator as $-(1 + Q^{-1})(1 + XQ)/(1 - X)$.

For $T$, note $z_w = z_v(P, X^{-1})$. Its ratio on the $-P$ eigenline of $BC$ is therefore the inverse of $(P + X)/(1 + PX)$. The selected eigenline of $\Lambda_w = (BC)^{-1}$ with eigenvalue $-P$ is instead the $-P^{-1}$ eigenline of $BC$. Thus its marked ratio is

$$\frac{z_w - P^{-1}}{z_w - P} = \frac{P + X}{1 + PX}. \tag{I.44}$$

Equations (I.43)–(I.44) are exactly the two source auxiliary ratios. Their extension to $Q = P = 1$ is the full matrix limit of (I.39), not a separate evaluation of two coalescing eigenvectors.

The determinants are nonzero nearby. More explicitly, after (I.41),

$$\begin{aligned} \det V &= \frac{(\beta + 2)(\beta X + X^2 + 1)}{(X - 1)^2}, \\ \det T &= -\frac{(X - 1)^2(X - M^2)(XM^2 - 1)(\beta M^2 + M^4 + 1)}{M^4(\beta X + X^2 + 1)^2}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.45}$$

Both equal $-4$ at the complete point. These formulas fix the regularity needed for the inverse transport matrices.

### I.3.3 The main commutator gives the source longitude factor

Consider the ordered commutator

$$\Lambda_K = TV^{-1}T^{-1}V. \tag{I.46}$$

It commutes with $A$. This also follows from the transport paths: its inverse $V^{-1}TVT^{-1}$ sends $A$ successively to $B^{-1}$, $C$, $D_0^{-1}$, and back to $A$, using (I.40).

Set

$$u = \frac{M^2 - X}{1 - M^2 X}. \tag{I.47}$$

The exact matrix is

$$\Lambda_K = \begin{pmatrix} -u & (u^{-1} - u)/(M - M^{-1}) \\ 0 & -u^{-1} \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.48}$$

The apparent quotient in its upper-right entry is removable at $M = 1$. A direct certificate, without multiplying four complicated inverse matrices, is

$$TV = V \begin{pmatrix} -u^{-1} & (u - u^{-1})/(M - M^{-1}) \\ 0 & -u \end{pmatrix} T. \tag{I.49}$$

Substitution of (I.30), (I.39), and (I.41) makes every entry of the difference zero. Multiplication by $V^{-1}$ and $T^{-1}$, which are legitimate by (I.45), gives (I.48). The expression for the upper-right entry is regular because $u = 1$ at $M = 1$.

The $M$ eigenline of the positively oriented puncture $A$ is the first coordinate line. Thus the eigenvalue of (I.46) on that line is $-u$, exactly the source factor for one edge. The original source cut selects the opposite $M^{-1}$ eigenline; its eigenvalue is $-u^{-1}$, retaining the required inverse-flag convention.

Write $X = e^{2\pi i x}$, using the logarithm selected by $x = 1/4$ at the complete edge. At $M = 1$, with $X$ kept on its continued branch,

$$\Lambda_K = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -2i\cot(\pi x) \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.50}$$

Since $A$ translates by one, (I.50) has projective translation $2i\cot(\pi x)$. At the complete edge $x = 1/4$, this is $2i$. The negative SL lift in (I.48) is therefore compatible with the complete preferred lift; it was not inserted by multiplying the commutator by a sign.

### I.3.4 Comparison with the explicit native pure block

The face construction in Section I.2 supplies the geometric marking for these character matrices. The comparison retains the original white-map order and all six white/shaded returns. Section I.4 then assembles the ordered tree and its odd seams.

Write its four actual white maps as $W_0, W_1, W_2, W_3$, and its two plus-copy shaded maps as $S_v, S_w$. The equatorial corners are $0, \infty, 1, R$. Put

$$N_j = W_{j-1}^{-1} W_j, \qquad j \bmod 4. \tag{I.51}$$

The native corner maps have derivatives $(M^{-2}, M^2, M^{-2}, M^2)$ in the finite local coordinates, with $1/z$ at infinity. They obey $N_0 N_1 N_2 N_3 = I$ by literal cancellation of the white maps.

In the matrix representatives fixed in that construction,

$$\det W_0 = L, \quad \det W_1 = L/M^2, \quad \det W_2 = L/M^4, \quad \det W_3 = LM^2. \tag{I.52}$$

The determinant-one puncture matrices to compare with (I.29)–(I.36) are therefore

$$A_{\mathrm{g}} = M^{-3}N_3, \quad B_{\mathrm{g}} = MN_0, \quad C_{\mathrm{g}} = MN_1, \quad D_{\mathrm{g}} = MN_2. \tag{I.53}$$

Their product is one, since the four displayed scalar powers multiply to one. Each trace is $M + M^{-1}$: its eigenvalue ratio is prescribed by the native corner derivative, its determinant is one, and its trace tends to 2 at completeness. Thus the sign is fixed by continuity, rather than reset on a puncture independently.

The two disk words now agree with their actual geometric words, including their determinant-one lifts:

$$A_{\mathrm{g}}B_{\mathrm{g}} = M^{-2}W_2^{-1}W_0, \qquad (B_{\mathrm{g}}C_{\mathrm{g}})^{-1} = M^{-2}W_1^{-1}W_3. \tag{I.54}$$

These are the native $v, w$ longitudes. Their selected eigenvalues are $-Q, -P$, with their actual apex flags. The inverse in the second abstract word is essential to (I.54).

**Actual auxiliary transports and character normalization**

The native shaded paths send the corners as follows:

$$S_v : \infty \mapsto 0, \quad 1 \mapsto R; \qquad S_w : R \mapsto 0, \quad 1 \mapsto \infty. \tag{I.55}$$

Their six white/shaded return identities imply, for the native punctures, that these paths reverse the oriented small boundary meridian at each endpoint. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} S_vC_{\mathrm{g}}S_v^{-1} &= B_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1}, \quad S_vD_{\mathrm{g}}S_v^{-1} = A_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1}, \\ S_wA_{\mathrm{g}}S_w^{-1} &= B_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1}, \quad S_wD_{\mathrm{g}}S_w^{-1} = C_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1}. \end{aligned} \tag{I.56}$$

For example, the projective relation $W_3S_v \sim S_v^-W_1$, together with $W_0S_v \sim S_v^-W_0$, gives

$$S_v(W_0^{-1}W_1)S_v^{-1} \sim W_0^{-1}W_3 = N_0^{-1}.$$

The native matrix representatives can differ by a nonconstant scalar in this calculation; those scalars are not set to one. Normalize the punctures using (I.53). The two sides now have determinant one and trace $t$, so their projective equality has scalar $+1$, since $t \neq 0$ near completeness. The remaining three identities follow from the other returns in the same way. This proves the literal determinant-one identities (I.56) without discarding a projective scalar.

Consequently

$$V_{\mathrm{g}} = S_v^{-1}, \qquad T_{\mathrm{g}} = S_w^{-1} \tag{I.57}$$

satisfy exactly (I.40). These are the actual positively marked auxiliary meridians of the native construction, not extra operators inserted into the tangle.

There is a regular marked conjugacy to the character coordinates. At completeness the selected $M$-eigenlines of $A_{\mathrm{g}}, B_{\mathrm{g}}$ are distinct. Their eigenlines vary holomorphically: the matrices minus their specified eigenvalue have rank one with a nonzero entry near the parabolic point. Send those two eigenlines to infinity and zero, then fix the residual diagonal conjugation by setting the upper-right entry of $A$ to one. This entry is a unit near completeness. The pair becomes exactly (I.29), since $\mathrm{tr}(AB) = -\beta$ fixes $b = -\beta - 2$.

The remaining matrix $C$ is then determined by its trace, the two mixed traces, and $\operatorname{tr}(ABC) = t$, giving (I.30). The common centralizer of this irreducible pair consists only of scalars. Hence a transport satisfying (I.40) is unique projectively: the ratio of two such transports commutes with both punctures. Its marked eigenvalue ratio is therefore (I.43), not a new free parameter.

The branch is fixed by the literal complete matrices. Substituting the complete native white maps gives $A_{\mathrm{g}} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 3-2i & -1+i \\ 4-4i & -1+2i \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ and $C_{\mathrm{g}} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & -1+i \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. Their product has trace $2+8i$. Since $S = 8$, the character coordinate $(\operatorname{tr}(A_{\mathrm{g}}C_{\mathrm{g}}) - 2)/S$ is $i$, not the inverse root.

Let $X_{\mathrm{g}}$ denote the native source wire extracted from its actual auxiliary meridian:

$$U_v^{\exp} = \frac{Q + X_{\mathrm{g}}}{1 + QX_{\mathrm{g}}}. \tag{I.58}$$

The character coordinate $X$ has the same ratio by (I.43). For $Q^2 \neq 1$, the fractional-linear map in (I.58) is injective, so $X = X_{\mathrm{g}}$. Holomorphic continuation establishes equality through $Q = 1$. Equivalently,

$$\operatorname{tr}(A_{\mathrm{g}}C_{\mathrm{g}}) = 2 + \left[\beta + \gamma + (M + M^{-1})^2\right]X_{\mathrm{g}}. \tag{I.59}$$

This proves the matching branch, rather than choosing the inverse root because the two have the same discriminant.

**Main basepoint, selected flag, and negative lift**

The native geometric longitude based at infinity is

$$\Lambda_\infty = S_w S_v^{-1} S_w^{-1} S_v. \tag{I.60}$$

Its positively oriented main meridian is $C_{\mathrm{g}} = MN_1$. In the native chart it is exactly

$$C_{\mathrm{g}} = \begin{pmatrix} M^{-1} & ME_0 - M^{-1} \\ 0 & M \end{pmatrix}, \tag{I.61}$$

where $E_0$ is the native white-face coordinate. Thus infinity is its actual $M^{-1}$ source flag. The white-face coordinate $E_0$ need not equal the source coordinate $X = X_{\mathrm{g}}$ away from $M = 1$.

Our abstract commutator is based at the corner $R$, whose positive meridian is $A_{\mathrm{g}}$. The actual path

$$U = S_w^{-1} S_v, \qquad \infty \longrightarrow 0 \longrightarrow R. \tag{I.62}$$

transports both the meridian and longitude:

$$UC_{\mathrm{g}}U^{-1} = A_{\mathrm{g}}, \qquad U\Lambda_\infty U^{-1} = S_w^{-1} S_v S_w S_v^{-1} = T_{\mathrm{g}} V_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1} T_{\mathrm{g}}^{-1} V_{\mathrm{g}}. \tag{I.63}$$

The first identity follows from (I.56), including its two inversions; the second is literal multiplication of the four words. The source $M^{-1}$ eigenflag is transported by this same path. It is not identified with infinity in the normalized matrix (I.29), where infinity is instead the $M$ eigenline.

Equations (I.48), (I.59), and (I.63) identify the native longitude eigenvalues exactly: on its source $M^{-1}$ eigenflag the value is $-u^{-1}$; on the preferred $M$ flag it is $-u$. The negative sign survives the basepoint change. At completeness the native matrix is

$$\Lambda_\infty = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 2+2i \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad C_{\mathrm{g}} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & i-1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.64}$$

Their projective translations have ratio $2i$, equal to (I.50). This checks the actual marked complete lift and scale; it is not the reason for the full rational identification above.

Thus the two independent constructions agree on the canonical pure block, its main eigenvalue, its two primitive auxiliary words, and its negative main-longitude lift. Sections I.4 and I.9 retain the ordered-tree assembly and preferred global framing.

## I.4 Ordered pages and the half-twist collar

At the second end of an edge, in the same native face notation, the incoming triangle is $(B, R, 1)$ and the outgoing triangle is $(B, \infty, 0)$. Their neighboring third vertices are

$$W_3^{-1}(1),\ W_2^{-1}(b),\ W_1^{-1}(S), \qquad W_1^{-1}(0),\ W_0^{-1}(b),\ W_3^{-1}(\infty). \tag{I.65}$$

Substitution gives the tables

$$I(m^{-1}, P) = (-1/(Pm), -P, -m/P), \qquad O(m^{-1}, P) = (-P/m, -1/P, -Pm). \tag{I.66}$$

At the first end use $I(m, Q), O(m, Q)$ from (I.25). The original reversed triangle matching pairs outgoing entries with the incoming entries in reverse order, and every product is one. Thus both the angles and the complex shears match.

### I.4.1 An arbitrary finite pure page tree

Let the original tree have no retained odd seam. Choose one bipartition sign $\sigma_v \in \{1, -1\}$, so adjacent vertices have opposite signs. At an edge with first endpoint $v$, use the local chart with $m_e = m^{\sigma_v}$. Its other endpoint then has parameter $m^{\sigma_w}$ by (I.66). Every incident page at a fixed vertex therefore has the same table $I(m^{\sigma_v}, Q_v), O(m^{\sigma_v}, Q_v)$.

For each circle, sew these pages in the original cyclic order, using the three ordered punctures in (I.25). Start with a terminal edge and use the literal left and right insertion operations of the ordered page decomposition, using its right and left attachment rules. Every insertion attaches the doubled two-triangle disk side just described. Formula (I.25) verifies the new seam, and no preceding seam is altered. The actual turns and any half-turn frame decoration carry all the labels and maps. No open-tangle commutativity is used.

This proves that the charts assemble on every finite pure ordered page tree. The endpoint-inverted parameter causes no ambiguity in the source wire: its equation depends on $m + m^{-1}$, and its branch through $X = i$ is unique. The same $X_e$ is therefore used at the two ends. The auxiliary meridian increment of edge $e$ at circle $v$ is

$$\frac{Q_v + X_e}{1 + Q_v X_e}, \tag{I.67}$$

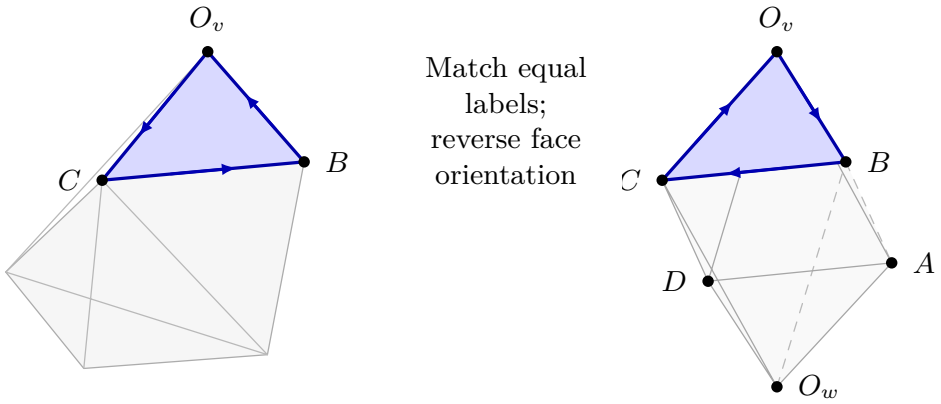



Figure I.1: One ordered page attachment glues an edge block along a shaded triangle, retaining circle v and introducing circle w.

and its disk longitude has similarity $Q_v^2$. Multiplication of the successive increments is in the original circle order. Since each is measured in that same eigenflag, their similarities multiply without an additional scalar.

The maps give an actual nearby representation of the original pure exterior. Indeed the face returns within every edge block are the six identities in the local chart, and the newly created page-edge returns are (I.25). These are precisely the relations obtained by the reversible projection/disk cut. Positive tetrahedral shapes persist for a sufficiently small neighborhood depending on the fixed tree.

The attachment follows the original order of the tangle factors. Its shaded triangle is glued to the designated disk page; the remaining faces carry the new circle and the continuing main strands.

### I.4.2 Positive main meridians and their flags

The bipartition signs describe native page coordinates. They are not extra choices of the knot orientation. At a main boundary vertex, take the actual small oriented meridian word supplied by the physical collar. Its local derivative at the displayed ideal point is $m$ or $m^{-1}$, depending on whether that native meridian is the positive one or its inverse. Transport the word and its eigenflag together through each face map.

For a main component, choose its orientation at one segment. The same oriented small meridian propagates by the actual annular collar conjugacies. The geometric ideal flag propagates by those same conjugacies, so its chosen eigenvalue stays fixed. There is no freedom to exchange it after returning around the component: for generic $M$, the peripheral longitude

commutes with a nonparabolic meridian and hence preserves both eigenlines. At $M = 1$ use the analytic limit of this transported flag. Thus one can record which global component orientation makes the displayed flag the $M^{-1}$ source flag. For a knot this is one global orientation choice, not a separate reset at each edge. A comparison with an already specified positive meridian must make this initial choice explicitly.

This argument identifies the local auxiliary products for the pure tree. Sections I.6–I.9 identify the preferred main longitude using the full boundary representation and its framing.

### I.4.3 The reference map at a parabolic main meridian

To fix the sign of the braid collar, we will compare it at $m = 1$ with the original marked three-point map. In the coordinates above, the map $(A, R, 0) \mapsto (a, \infty, 1)$ is represented by

$$B_{\mathrm{o}} = \begin{pmatrix} (a(A-R)+R)/A & -R \\ 1 & -R \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.68}$$

Direct substitution gives its three specified values. This reference map is used in (I.75) to calibrate the physical crossing at the parabolic main meridian. For the nonparabolic deformation we construct the braid action on the two puncture generators and transport their eigenflags and adjacent charts together.

### I.4.4 A regular matrix implementing the actual positive braid collar

Let $a, b \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ be the two ordered puncture meridians in the physical braid frame. They have the same trace $M + M^{-1}$. The original positive crossing convention is

$$(a, b) \longmapsto (a^{-1}ba, a), \qquad P = ba. \tag{I.69}$$

This is the literal Wirtinger rule of the marked braid calculation, section 5. In particular the preserved product is $ba$, not $ab$.

Put

$$H = P^{-1} - I. \tag{I.70}$$

Near the auxiliary complete lift $P$, whose trace is $-2$, $\det H = 2 - \operatorname{tr} P$ is near 4. There is no singular diagonalizing frame. The Cayley–Hamilton identities for $a, b$, with their equal traces, give

$$(P - I)a = b(P - I), \qquad (P - I)^2 = (\operatorname{tr} P - 2)P. \tag{I.71}$$

Consequently $H$ is projectively $(P - I)^{-1}$, it commutes with $P$, and

$$HaH^{-1} = a^{-1}ba, \qquad HbH^{-1} = a. \tag{I.72}$$

This is the exact positive collar rule (I.69). Its inverse realizes the negative crossing.

Suppose the selected auxiliary flag has $P$-eigenvalue $-Q$. The eigenvalue ratio of $H$ at that flag is

$$\frac{-Q^{-1} - 1}{-Q - 1} = Q^{-1}. \tag{I.73}$$

Thus composing a pure auxiliary meridian with $H^{\epsilon}$ changes its similarity by $Q^{-\epsilon}$. It keeps the disk longitude $P$ and its chosen flag.

There is an independent matrix calibration against the original geometric collar. In the local chart set

$$P = m^{-1} W_2^{-1} W_0. \tag{I.74}$$

This is the determinant-one disk word and has selected eigenvalue $-Q$. At $m = 1$, for all nearby $E_0, Q$, not just at the complete point,

$$S_v^{-1}(P^{-1} - I) = W_0^{-1} B_{\mathrm{o}} \quad \text{projectively.} \tag{I.75}$$

The right side is the original physical positive-$R$ meridian, by section 6 of the marked mask filling proof. The inverse crossing follows the oppositely signed half-twist path. Equations (I.69) and (I.75) fix both the braid sign and the actual copy/collar marking; the sign has not been chosen from a desired source formula.

### I.4.5 The full ordered boundary groups in the actual edge chart

Let $N_j = W_{j-1}^{-1} W_j$, with indices modulo four. Their determinant-one lifts, in the order of the original equatorial boundary, are

$$A_g = M^{-3} N_3, \qquad B_g = M N_0, \qquad C_g = M N_1, \qquad D_g = M N_2, \qquad A_g B_g C_g D_g = I. \tag{I.76}$$

Each trace is $M + M^{-1}$. These lifts follow from $\det W_0 = L, \det W_1 = L/m, \det W_2 = L/m^2, \det W_3 = Lm$. They include the native loop directions, which need not all be positive main meridians.

The pure edge returns give the following complete boundary intertwinings:

| circle | $(a, b)$ on the input side | $(a', b')$ on the output side | $C_0$ | $P = ba = b'a'$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $v$ | $(B_g, A_g)$ | $(C_g^{-1}, D_g^{-1})$ | $S_v^{-1}$ | $A_g B_g$ |
| $w$ | $(B_g^{-1}, C_g^{-1})$ | $(A_g, D_g)$ | $S_w^{-1}$ | $(B_g C_g)^{-1}$. |

(I.77)

Here $C_0 a C_0^{-1} = a'$ and $C_0 b C_0^{-1} = b'$. For example the first row is equivalent to

$$S_v C_g S_v^{-1} = B_g^{-1}, \qquad S_v D_g S_v^{-1} = A_g^{-1}. \tag{I.78}$$

The second is equivalently $S_w A_g S_w^{-1} = B_g^{-1}$ and $S_w D_g S_w^{-1} = C_g^{-1}$. These are consequences of the full white/shaded returns; they may also be checked by direct multiplication of the local matrices. The product columns agree because $D_g^{-1} C_g^{-1} = A_g B_g$ and $D_g A_g = (B_g C_g)^{-1}$.

The disk convention $P = ba$ is therefore explicit at both ends, including the inversions caused by the turned second circle. The same table transports under the actual conjugating frames in a tree; an orientation reversal transports the whole tuple and its disk word. It does not silently replace $P$ by a different boundary product.

For the positive braid put $H = P^{-1} - I$ in the input frame. Then $C_+ = C_0 H$ satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} C_+ a C_+^{-1} &= a'^{-1} b' a', \\ C_+ b C_+^{-1} &= a', \\ C_+ P C_+^{-1} &= P. \end{aligned} \tag{I.79}$$

For the negative braid use $H^{-1}$ and the inverse automorphism. Thus the construction checks both generators of the actual twice-punctured disk and its outer boundary word; it is stronger than checking a peripheral similarity or three traces. Formula (I.75) fixes the positive crossing in the original physical convention.

### I.4.6 The opposite-eigenflag qualification

Let $F_a, F_b$ be the two displayed puncture flags, with eigenvalues $\lambda_a, \lambda_b$. The natural braid output flags for (I.69) are

$$(a^{-1} F_b, F_a). \tag{I.80}$$

Their eigenvalues are $(\lambda_b, \lambda_a)$, since the strands have exchanged positions. By contrast, $(HF_a, HF_b)$ has eigenvalues $(\lambda_a, \lambda_b)$ on that same output tuple. If the selected eigenvalues agree, the two descriptions coincide by uniqueness of the relevant eigenline. If they differ, use $H$ on the opposite input eigenlines to obtain (I.80). At a native pure circle the geometric flags on its two main punctures have opposite selections $M^{-1}, M$. The qualification is therefore essential.

This identifies the error in an unqualified instruction to transport both displayed flags by $H$. The intertwiner is correct; the displayed decorated triangle needs the accompanying Weyl change. The two eigenlines coalesce at the parabolic point, so the complete figure alone cannot distinguish the operations.

### I.4.7 Representation gluing followed by global decoration

The following construction keeps that distinction explicit. First perform the actual collar gluing at the level of representations; then select the geometric eigenflags on the resulting original link group.

The half-twist is the actual mapping cylinder of the two-punctured disk, fixing its outer boundary. Its two boundary generator tuples are related by (I.69). If $C$ is the pure boundary intertwiner, replacing it by $CH^{\epsilon}$, with the side and composition order fixed by (I.75), supplies the new intertwiner. Equation (I.72) verifies the two puncture relations; $[H, P] = 0$ verifies the outer disk-boundary relation. These are the generators and relation of the twice-punctured disk. The van Kampen presentation of that actual cut therefore gives the representation of the reglued exterior. It uses the one distinguished disk seam at that circle, once.

Apply the operation in every original circle's transported puncture frame. The other cyclic page seams remain those of the pure-page construction above. At this stage no assertion is made that the old pure ideal vertices still provide the correct decoration.

For each resulting main component, choose its actual positive meridian and its $M^{-1}$ eigenflag. At a corner whose native loop is the inverse, take the corresponding $M$ eigenflag. Transport these choices by the original paths in the completed cut. Peripheral commutation

makes the choice independent of a peripheral path. Keep the already selected disk-longitude flag on each auxiliary circle.

These choices are holomorphic near the complete structure. For example, for a noncentral matrix $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ with $b \neq 0$, an eigenline with prescribed holomorphic eigenvalue $\lambda$ is represented by $(b, \lambda - a)$. The opposite eigenline is obtained by replacing $\lambda$ by $\lambda^{-1}$. Both approach the unique parabolic flag at the complete point. A change of coordinate handles a chart with $b = 0$. The same argument applies to the selected auxiliary eigenvalue $-Q$.

Develop the original topological ideal triangulation from these global flags and the constructed representation. The map of each triangle is the unique map of its transported ordered triple. The adjacent white maps are defined from these transported triples as well, so they carry the same eigenflag choices. Equivariance gives every edge return. At the complete parameter, (I.75) and the original collar convention identify the actual odd development. Its positively oriented tetrahedra therefore remain positive in a sufficiently small neighborhood of the fixed finite tree. This is a local decorated representation construction, not a global completeness assertion for a nonparabolic main cusp.

The tuple with $P = ba$ is exactly (I.77), transported in the original physical collar. The positive main loops are chosen in the completed cut. For the canonical four-segment traversal, they are $C_g, B_g^{-1}, A_g, D_g^{-1}$ at $\infty, 0, R, 1$, respectively; all four select their geometric corner with eigenvalue $M^{-1}$. A reversed physical route transports both its loop direction and its flag. The preceding opposite-eigenflag calculation describes the required Weyl change.

At representation level the primitive auxiliary increment is

$$U_v^{\exp} = Q_v^{-\epsilon_v} \prod_{e \ni v} \frac{Q_v + X_e}{1 + Q_v X_e}, \qquad V_v^{\exp} = Q_v^2. \tag{I.81}$$

It is unchanged by the main-flag redecoration. The exponentiated filling equation with $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$ is then

$$\prod_{e \ni v} \frac{Q_v + X_e}{1 + Q_v X_e} = Q_v^{n_v}. \tag{I.82}$$

The auxiliary formulas retain the original circle words. The main preferred longitude is determined in Sections I.6–I.9 using boundary isotropy, algebraic regularity and the independently marked cusp. The argument does not replace a boundary word by a scalar simply because the local representation has the correct traces.

## I.5 The complete anchor and the primitive filling equations

At $M = 1$, the local charts reduce to the angular octahedral charts. Their white/shaded words and primitive disk longitude agree with the ones above. Their complete flags and oriented tetrahedral shapes give the marked complete structure of the original augmented exterior. The multicusp gluing rigidity theorem identifies the nearby decorated representation with that marked geometric germ; this uses the full original peripheral rows, not only equality of their traces.

The pure meridian increments multiply around each circle in its actual cyclic order. The one retained half twist contributes $Q_v^{-\epsilon_v}$, with the sign calibrated in (I.75). Thus, on the continued marking,

$$U_v = \sum_{e \ni v} \log \rho_{v,e} - \epsilon_v \log Q_v, \qquad V_v = 2 \log Q_v. \tag{I.83}$$

These are logarithms of the squared eigenvalues of the original primitive auxiliary curves. No peripheral power is substituted.

For a branch supplied by the geometric completion theorem or the corresponding marked long-filling theorem, the original primitive logarithmic equation is

$$U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i. \tag{I.84}$$

Its continued mark selects the original first-charge geometric branch. More explicitly, let $\Psi(\tau)$ be the angular action obtained after the original wire variables have been made stationary, with $Q_v = e^{i\tau_v}$. The marked circle calculation gives $U_v = -2\pi\Psi_{\tau_v} - i\epsilon_v\tau_v$. The charge path is therefore exactly

$$\Psi_{\tau_v} + \frac{i n_v \tau_v}{2\pi} - ic = 0 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i c, \qquad 0 \le c \le 1. \tag{I.85}$$

The logarithms are continued from the complete point at $c = 0$; the constant $-ic$ is part of the primitive mark. Exponentiation at $c = 1$ gives (I.5), since $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$. The exponentiated equation alone does not select the logarithmic branch or prove smooth completion. At the selected filled point write $Q_v = e^{i\tau_v}$. The completion has $\operatorname{Im}\tau_v < 0$, hence $Q_v^2 \neq 1$. Its auxiliary longitude is therefore semisimple with distinct eigenlines. The filling word commutes with that longitude; equation (I.5) says that its eigenvalue ratio is one. A matrix commuting with a matrix having distinct eigenlines is diagonal in that eigenbasis, so ratio one makes it scalar. Thus the filling word is projectively identity, and this conclusion persists on a sufficiently small neighborhood of the selected filled point.

The marked charge path identifies the representation at $M = 1$, not only its peripheral eigenvalues. It begins with the original complete octahedral charts. Along the path the same labeled face maps, primitive disk curves and source $M^{-1}$ flag are retained. The positive-cell completion identifies its endpoint with the holonomy of the original complete filled knot. For the marked long-filling branch the same identification follows from its original Dehn-filling construction.

### I.5.1 Local rigidity on the retained augmented triangulation

The local uniqueness needed at this endpoint can be proved on the same augmented triangulation. Its auxiliary ends are incomplete, but its tetrahedra are still positive and every developed face triple is distinct. Thus no positive triangulation of the filled manifold is needed here.

Write $R$ for the number of auxiliary circles and $t$ for the number of tetrahedra. There are $\nu = R + 1$ cusps, including the main cusp. In positive quad orders put

$$u_j = \log z_j, \qquad v_j = -\log(1 - z_j), \qquad T_j = \frac{dv_j}{du_j} = \frac{z_j}{1 - z_j}, \qquad \operatorname{Im} T_j > 0. \tag{I.86}$$

Use the logarithms continued along the original charge path. Their constants need not be small. The edge-rank and peripheral-intersection identities proved in Sections 2–3 of the marked gluing theorem are combinatorial statements about this triangulation. They give an

isotropic edge-row space of dimension $t-\nu$, with symplectic quotient equal to the direct sum of the peripheral homology planes.

Choose the main meridian and, at each auxiliary torus, the original primitive slope $\sigma_v = \mu_v + p_v\lambda_v$. These are independent modulo the edge rows and pair to zero: each is one nonzero primitive class on a different torus. Append their rows to $t-\nu$ independent edge rows. The resulting real matrix $(A\ B)$ satisfies

$$\operatorname{rank}(A\ B) = t, \qquad AB^{\mathsf{T}} = BA^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad J = A + B\operatorname{diag}(T_j). \tag{I.87}$$

Use the symplectic form $\Omega((a,b),(a',b')) = a\cdot b' - b\cdot a'$ on $\mathbb{C}^t \oplus \mathbb{C}^t$. The kernel of $(A\ B)$ is spanned by the vectors $(-B^{\mathsf{T}}y, A^{\mathsf{T}}y)$, $y \in \mathbb{R}^t$; the rank and symmetry in (I.87) make it a real Lagrangian space. If $Jx = 0$, put $w = (x, \operatorname{diag}(T_j)x)$. Then $w$ and $\overline{w}$ belong to its complexification, so $\Omega(w,\overline{w}) = 0$. But directly

$$\frac{i}{2}\Omega(w,\overline{w}) = \sum_j \operatorname{Im} T_j\,|x_j|^2 > 0 \qquad (x \neq 0). \tag{I.88}$$

This proves that $J$ is invertible. All dependent edge equations have compatible affine logarithmic constants because the present positive endpoint satisfies them. The proof therefore applies at this incomplete augmented solution, not only at the complete augmented cusp. The implicit-function theorem makes the main meridian logarithm and the auxiliary slope logarithms local coordinates on the shape germ.

This is the whole local decorated representation germ. Normalize one ordered developed triple. Shapes reconstruct face maps by their ordered triples; each edge return fixes two distinct endpoints and has multiplier one, hence is identity. The actual dual two-skeleton then gives a representation of the original augmented group. Conversely, a nearby representation and its selected peripheral flags develop every ideal vertex $gP_v$ as $\rho(g)\xi_v$, where $P_v$ is the peripheral subgroup and $\xi_v$ its selected common fixed point. The distinct triples and quadruples at the endpoint stay distinct nearby, so their cross-ratios recover the shapes and original face maps. These constructions are inverse after the same normalization. Every denominator is a unit at the endpoint, so they remain inverse over local Artin algebras. Faithfulness of the augmented representation and parabolicity of its auxiliary ends are not used.

At the main cusp retain the prescribed eigenvalue and the source $M^{-1}$ eigenflag. Write $\mu = (\mu_{ij})$ for its chosen determinant-one matrix. When $\mu_{12} \neq 0$, that flag is represented by $(\mu_{12}, M^{-1} - \mu_{11})$, which remains nonzero at the parabolic point. At each auxiliary cusp the retained longitude has distinct eigenvalues. Its eigenspaces therefore split the rank-two module, also over a local Artin algebra, because their difference is a unit. To check strict commutation, choose a local representative of the slope whose residue is the identity. If its projective commutator with the longitude is the scalar $c_0$, determinants give $c_0^2 = 1$, while $c_0 \equiv 1$ at the residue point. Since $c_0 + 1$ is a unit, $c_0 = 1$, also over local Artin rings. This auxiliary scalar normalization does not reset the signs of a separately retained determinant-one group lift. In its eigenbasis a commuting slope matrix is diagonal. A slope eigenvalue ratio of one consequently makes the slope scalar and hence projectively identity.

It follows that imposing the retained equations $U_v + p_vV_v = -2\pi i$ is exactly imposing the filled-group relations near this endpoint, not merely their eigenvalue consequences. Conversely, a nearby filled representation pulls back to these equations on the continued logarithmic branch; its auxiliary eigenflags are uniquely selected by the longitude branches. Fixing the $R$

slope coordinates leaves a smooth one-dimensional decorated projective representation germ, modulo simultaneous conjugation, with $u = \log M$ as coordinate, since the ordered main eigenvalue-ratio logarithm on the source $M^{-1}$ line is $-2u$. Its basepoint is the complete filled holonomy already constructed by the positive-cell completion. This proves the required marked geometric meridian germ without changing the triangulation.

When the selected source critical point is nondegenerate, its implicit branch gives holomorphic $Q_v(M)$ and $X_e(M)$, retaining (I.84). The full ordered reconstruction places this branch in the just-proved filled representation germ, with the same coordinate $M$ and source eigenflag. Local uniqueness therefore identifies it with that geometric meridian germ. Only the smooth endpoint is used for this filled-group descent; intermediate nonintegral cone charges do not kill their slope words.

Every statement below about a filled geometric longitude retains this original complete/filling anchor. An exponentiated slope equation on a different algebraic branch is insufficient.

## I.6 Boundary isotropy and the edge differential

### I.6.1 The edge equation and a closed differential

For an edge with endpoint variables $Q, P$, let $X$ satisfy

$$(X+Q)(X+Q^{-1})(X+P)(X+P^{-1}) = (X-1)^2(1-XM^2)(1-X/M^2). \tag{I.89}$$

The variables are nonzero. We work first where all displayed factors are nonzero and the selected root is simple. Write

$$\begin{gathered} u = \log M, \quad q = \log Q, \quad p = \log P, \quad z = \log X, \\ f = \frac{M^2 - X}{1 - M^2 X}, \quad \rho_Q = \frac{Q + X}{1 + QX}, \quad \rho_P = \frac{P + X}{1 + PX}. \end{gathered} \tag{I.90}$$

Only the differentials of the logarithms will be used. Their branches therefore do not affect the identities below.

Let $F$ be the logarithm of the quotient of the two sides of (I.89), holding $z, q, p, u$ independent before differentiating. Direct differentiation gives

$$F_u = 2(\log f)_z, \qquad F_q = -(\log \rho_Q)_z, \qquad F_p = -(\log \rho_P)_z. \tag{I.91}$$

On the edge surface $dF = 0$. Moreover $f$ has no direct $q, p$ dependence, and each $\rho$ has no direct $u$ dependence or dependence on the other endpoint. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} &du \wedge d\log f + \tfrac{1}{2} d\log \rho_Q \wedge dq + \tfrac{1}{2} d\log \rho_P \wedge dp \\ &\quad = \tfrac{1}{2}(F_u\, du + F_q\, dq + F_p\, dp) \wedge dz = 0. \end{aligned} \tag{I.92}$$

This proof uses the rational equation itself. It does not identify a geometric volume by comparing numerical critical values. Since (I.92) is an identity of rational differential forms, it holds on every smooth part of the same algebraic component.

### I.6.2 The actual boundary pairing

Sections I.2–I.4 have assembled the ordered pieces into a representation of the original augmented link exterior. Let $L$ be the eigenvalue of its preferred main longitude on the main $M$-eigenline. At each auxiliary circle let $U_v$ be the logarithm of the primitive meridian similarity, and let the selected longitude eigenvalue be $-Q_v$. The exact local construction and the original half-twist convention give

$$U_v = \sum_{e \ni v} \log \rho_{v,e} - \epsilon_v \log Q_v, \qquad \epsilon_v \in \{-1, 0, 1\}, \tag{I.93}$$

up to locally constant logarithmic periods. The summands and the primitive word must be established by the actual boundary gluing.

The infinitesimal boundary pairing is

$$du \wedge d \log L + \tfrac{1}{2} \sum_v dU_v \wedge d \log Q_v = 0. \tag{I.94}$$

Here all tori use the meridian–longitude orientations induced by the same oriented exterior. The factor one half occurs because $U_v$ is a logarithm of an eigenvalue ratio, whereas $\log Q_v$ is a logarithm of a single determinant-one eigenvalue.

For completeness, (I.94) has a direct topological proof. Infinitesimal variations of a representation are one-cocycles with values in its adjoint local system. Pair two such cocycles by $\operatorname{tr}(XY)$ and take their cup product. The result is a closed ordinary two-cochain, because the trace pairing is invariant under conjugation. Its total evaluation on the boundary of a fundamental three-chain is zero by the cochain Stokes identity. On a torus with commuting diagonal holonomies, write their logarithms as $x \operatorname{diag}(1, -1)$ and $y \operatorname{diag}(1, -1)$. The alternating trace pairing is $2(dx \wedge dy)$. Summing over the boundary tori gives $\sum dx \wedge dy = 0$. Substitute $(x, y) = (u, \log L)$ at the main torus and $(x, y) = (U_v/2, \log Q_v)$ at the auxiliary tori. This proves (I.94) where the peripheral matrices are diagonalizable. The rational identity extends over the remaining points where its terms are defined.

Subtract the sum of (I.92) over all edges from (I.94). The half-twist term in (I.93) has zero wedge product with $d \log Q_v$. The result is

$$du \wedge d \log \left( \frac{L}{\prod_e f_e} \right) = 0. \tag{I.95}$$

In particular, the discrepancy has no infinitesimal dependence on any auxiliary variable. To avoid choosing determinant-one lifts globally, use the squared discrepancy

$$R = \frac{L^2}{\prod_e f_e^2}. \tag{I.96}$$

It is a rational function whenever the original projective peripheral representation is rational on the source variety: $L^2$ is the ratio of the two eigenvalues of the main longitude, with its ordered main flag retained.

## I.7 The constant field of the source equations

### I.7.1 Why the discrepancy is rational in the main meridian

Let $k = \mathbb{C}(M)$, and let the graph have distinct unordered edges. In particular this applies to a tree. The edge quadratic gives, on putting $Z = X + X^{-1}$:

$$Z = \frac{2(M^2 + M^{-2}) - (Q + Q^{-1})(P + P^{-1})}{Q + Q^{-1} + P + P^{-1} + M^2 + M^{-2} + 2}. \tag{I.97}$$

Work on the open set where these denominators are invertible; it contains the complete branch. The squareclass of $Z^2 - 4$ is

$$H_e = (Q_v - 1)^2(Q_w - 1)^2 - 4(M + M^{-1})^2 Q_v Q_w. \tag{I.98}$$

To see that the edge squareclasses are independent, extend the coefficient field to an algebraic closure $\overline{k}$. Put $t = (M + M^{-1})^2 \neq 0$ in this field. As a quadratic in $Y$, the polynomial $(X - 1)^2(Y - 1)^2 - 4tXY$ has discriminant

$$16tX[X^2 + (t - 2)X + 1]. \tag{I.99}$$

Its order of vanishing at $X = 0$ is one, so it is not a square in $\overline{k}(X)$. Its coefficients in $Y$ have no common factor: at $X = 1$ the middle coefficient is $-4t$. It is therefore irreducible in $\overline{k}[X, Y]$.

Different edges give different such prime polynomials, since they involve different pairs of independent vertex variables. The valuation at the prime $H_e$ is odd for its own squareclass and zero for every other edge. Hence every nonempty product of edge squareclasses is nonsquare. Adjoining their square roots has degree $2^{|\mathcal{E}|}$ even after extending $k$ to $\overline{k}$. This proves geometric integrality of the generic source fiber over $M$. In particular $k$ is algebraically closed in its function field $\mathcal{F}$.

The logarithmic derivatives in all the $Q_v$ extend uniquely to the finite separable field $\mathcal{F}$. If an element of $\mathcal{F}$ is killed by every such derivative, its relative differential over $k$ vanishes. In characteristic zero it is algebraic over $k$, and therefore belongs to $k$ by the preceding paragraph. Applying this to (I.95)–(I.96) gives

$$R \in \mathbb{C}(M)^*. \tag{I.100}$$

The specialization of (I.98) at $M = \pm i$ is a square. This does not invalidate the generic integrality proof; it does mean that those fibers need the separate check in Section I.8.

## I.8 Regular reconstruction at every nonzero main value

### I.8.1 A uniform algebraic open set in every fiber

For one edge write

$$m = M^2, \quad D = m + m^{-1}, \quad \beta = Q + Q^{-1}, \quad \gamma = P + P^{-1}, \quad S = \beta + \gamma + D + 2. \tag{I.101}$$

Use $X$ for the source wire coordinate. Its equation is the quadratic

$$F(X) = S(X^2 + 1) + (\beta\gamma - 2D)X = 0. \tag{I.102}$$

This is equivalent, on $X \neq 0$, to the original degree-four effective edge equation after its cancellation. Define

$$J = \beta\gamma - 2\beta - 2\gamma - 4D - 4. \tag{I.103}$$

The discriminant of (I.102) is

$$\Delta = (\beta + 2)(\gamma + 2)J. \tag{I.104}$$

Consider the open conditions

$$\begin{gathered} QP \neq 0, \qquad (\beta + 2)(\gamma + 2)(\beta + D)(\gamma + D) \neq 0, \\ S \neq 0, \qquad \Delta \neq 0. \end{gathered} \tag{I.105}$$

For every fixed $M_0 \in \mathbb{C}^*$, these conditions define a nonempty Zariski open subset of the $Q, P$ torus. Indeed each excluded expression is a nonzero polynomial in the independent variables $\beta, \gamma$. For a fixed finite tree the same conditions can be imposed simultaneously at every edge, since their product is again a nonzero Laurent polynomial in the vertex parameters $Q_v$.

On (I.105), both roots of (I.102) are finite, nonzero and distinct. Several useful evaluations are

$$\begin{aligned} F(1) &= (\beta + 2)(\gamma + 2), & F(-1) &= -J, \\ F(m) &= m(\beta + D)(\gamma + D), & F(m^{-1}) &= m^{-1}(\beta + D)(\gamma + D). \end{aligned} \tag{I.106}$$

Hence neither root is $1, -1, m, m^{-1}$. In particular

$$f = \frac{m - X}{1 - mX} \tag{I.107}$$

is a finite nonzero function at every point under consideration. The auxiliary factors $(Q + X)/(1 + QX)$ and $(P + X)/(1 + PX)$ are also finite and nonzero. To see this, substitute $X = -Q$ or $X = -Q^{-1}$ in the original edge equation. A zero can occur only when $Q = -1$ or $Q = -m^{\pm 1}$, excluded by (I.105); the other endpoint is identical.

### I.8.2 The actual character matrices remain regular

Put $t = M + M^{-1}$, $p = -\beta$, $q = -\gamma$, and $\mathcal{X} = 2 + SX$. The character adapter uses

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} M & 1 \\ 0 & M^{-1} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad B = \begin{pmatrix} M^{-1} & 0 \\ p - 2 & M \end{pmatrix}. \tag{I.108}$$

Its matrix $C$ is given by

$$h = M - M^{-1}, \qquad c = \frac{M\mathcal{X} + M^{-1}q - 2t}{D - p},$$
$$d = \frac{q - M^2 - 1 + hc}{p - 2}, \qquad e = \mathcal{X} - 1 - M^{-2} - hc, \qquad C = \begin{pmatrix} c & d \\ e & t - c \end{pmatrix}, \tag{I.109}$$
$$D_0 = (ABC)^{-1}.$$

The only denominators in (I.108)–(I.109), besides powers of $M$, are $p - 2 = -(\beta + 2)$ and $D - p = D + \beta$. They are units on (I.105). The four matrices have determinant one and trace $t$, with $\operatorname{tr}(AB) = -\beta$ and $\operatorname{tr}(BC) = -\gamma$, by (I.102). The formulas contain no division by $M - M^{-1}$ or by $t$.

The pure auxiliary transports are

$$V = AB - \frac{1 + X(\beta + 1)}{1 - X} I, \qquad T = BC + \frac{X + \gamma + 1}{1 - X} I. \tag{I.110}$$

They satisfy the full puncture conjugacies, not just the trace equations. Their determinants simplify on (I.102) to

$$\det V = \frac{X(\beta + 2)^2(\beta + D)}{S(X - 1)^2}, \qquad \det T = \frac{X(\gamma + 2)^2(\gamma + D)}{S(X - 1)^2}. \tag{I.111}$$

For example the first determinant before reduction is

$$\frac{(\beta + 2)(X^2 + \beta X + 1)}{(X - 1)^2}.$$

Equation (I.102) implies $X + X^{-1} + \beta = (\beta + 2)(\beta + D)/S$, giving (I.111). The second computation is the same with $\gamma$. Thus both full transport matrices and their inverses are regular on (I.105), on either root of the source equation.

Every disk boundary pair is irreducible there. For the first pair the standard direct trace calculation gives

$$\operatorname{tr}[A, B] - 2 = (\beta + 2)(\beta + D) \neq 0. \tag{I.112}$$

The second has the corresponding $\gamma$ formula. One can also derive (I.112) directly from the two matrices (I.108). For determinant-one two-generator representations this nonzero expression excludes a common invariant line. In particular neither generator is central.

The positive odd collar uses $H = P_{\mathrm{disk}}^{-1} - I$ with the original ordered disk product. Since $\operatorname{tr} P_{\mathrm{disk}} = -\beta$,

$$\det H = 2 + \beta \neq 0. \tag{I.113}$$

The same holds at the other endpoint. The actual positive and negative Hurwitz generators and all fixed powers remain invertible. Thus odd seams introduce no exceptional fixed value of $M$.

### I.8.3 Sewing finitely many blocks uses a rational finite atlas

The ordered page construction glues two boundary pairs whose matrices are explicit rational functions of the edge variables. Their identification is the actual one in the native table; where a loop is inverted or its order reversed, that operation is included before asking for an intertwiner.

After those marked identifications, the two ordered boundary pairs have the same three traces and are irreducible by (I.112). Their intertwiner is the solution line of

$$Ga = a'G, \qquad Gb = b'G. \tag{I.114}$$

The solution line is one-dimensional, and every nonzero solution is invertible. Indeed a nontrivial kernel or image would be an invariant line for one of the two irreducible pairs. Existence can be proved without using ideal vertices. For an irreducible pair the four matrices $I, a, b, ab$ span $\mathrm{Mat}_2$. Their multiplication table is determined by the common trace $t$ and product trace $p$:

$$a^2 = ta - I, \quad b^2 = tb - I, \quad ab + ba = t(a + b) + (p - t^2)I. \tag{I.115}$$

The same table for the primed pair gives an isomorphism of the two full matrix algebras, hence conjugation by an invertible matrix. Equivalently put both pairs in the explicit form (I.108); irreducibility ensures that the two selected generator flags are distinct and that the off-diagonal entry used to normalize the frame is nonzero. Either proof retains the ordered generators, not just the individual conjugacy classes.

Equation (I.114) is a finite linear system with rational entries. Choose a nonzero maximal minor and normalize one coordinate on its one-dimensional kernel. This gives a rational intertwiner regular in a neighborhood of that point. No single choice of minor has to work at all parameters. The finitely many choices form a rational atlas; the resulting representation and peripheral eigenvalue ratios are independent of the scalar normalization of an intertwiner.

Start with one edge block. The actual page insertion joins each new block to the preceding union along one marked disk side. Its attaching graph is a tree of blocks, so this inductively constructs a representation of the entire page-cut object with all matrices regular. The distinguished pure or odd seam at each circle is then installed using (I.110), (I.113), and the two full generator conjugacies of its actual mapping cylinder. Those formulas preserve its outer disk product. Van Kampen therefore gives the representation of the original augmented exterior. No arbitrary pants permutation or commutativity of tangles is used.

For any fixed finite tree, intersecting the finitely many necessary open charts gives a nonempty open set over the fixed $M_0$. Equivalently, at any good point one may choose each nonzero intertwiner minor in succession, obtaining a regular neighborhood of that point. This proves existence of the required actual rational $\mathrm{PGL}_2$ reconstruction at every nonzero main parameter.

This step requires the actual marked boundary conjugacies, not just a formal family of characters. They were identified with the original cut in the page/collar proof and remain rational identities on the present open sets.

### I.8.4 The exceptional-looking main parameters

At $M = \pm 1$, one has $D = 2$. Conditions (I.105) simply exclude $\beta = -2, \gamma = -2$, together with the stated nonzero discriminant and denominator. The main matrix in (I.108) is a noncentral parabolic. Nothing in (I.108)–(I.114) divides by its eigenvalue difference, so the reconstruction is regular.

At $M = \pm i$, one has $D = -2$. The source discriminant becomes

$$\Delta = (\beta^2 - 4)(\gamma^2 - 4). \tag{I.116}$$

With $\beta = Q + Q^{-1}$ and $\gamma = P + P^{-1}$, this is a square in $\mathbb{C}(Q, P)$. The fiber therefore splits; generic-fiber irreducibility must not be asserted at these two values. Nevertheless (I.105) gives two distinct simple roots at generic $Q, P$, and all matrices (I.108)–(I.114) are regular. The main punctures are semisimple, with eigenvalues $i, -i$ or $-i, i$, and remain noncentral. The two roots can be written explicitly as

$$X = -\frac{Q + P}{1 + QP}, \qquad X = -\frac{1 + QP}{Q + P}. \tag{I.117}$$

For generic $Q, P$ they differ and avoid $1, -1$. Fixing these auxiliary values, the implicit-function theorem for (I.102) therefore continues either root holomorphically in $M$ through $M_0 = i$ or $-i$.

The native ideal cell chart explains a possible false alarm. At $m = -1$, its preliminary white coordinate $E_0$ satisfies

$$(E_0P - E_0Q - PQ + 1)(E_0PQ - E_0 - P + Q) = 0. \tag{I.118}$$

On one branch the two minus-copy circle apices coincide; on the other the plus-copy apices coincide. Thus that particular eight-tetrahedron ideal subdivision degenerates. This does not make the actual group matrices singular: (I.108)–(I.114) are an explicit regular reconstruction at precisely those points. The rigidity argument needs the latter, not a positive triangulation at every complex value of $M$.

### I.8.5 A regular nonzero main eigenvalue ratio

Every main peripheral word is a fixed finite product of the regular invertible group matrices just constructed. Hence its matrix and inverse are regular at the chosen point. The main meridian is noncentral.

There is one important trace-zero detail. Commutation in $\mathrm{PGL}_2$ alone would allow a longitude to exchange the two eigenlines of a trace-zero meridian. Use the matrices on the local section through nearby $M$. Normalize the meridian $\mu$ to determinant one. Its projective commutation with a regular invertible longitude representative $L$ gives $L\mu L^{-1} = \kappa\mu$, where $\kappa^2 = 1$ by determinants. At the nearby parameters with $M + M^{-1} \neq 0$, taking traces gives $\kappa = 1$. Consequently the exact matrix identity

$$L\mu = \mu L. \tag{I.119}$$

extends to the trace-zero point. The undesired anticommuting component is not part of this continued representation. This also follows as a rational identity on the integral generic source family.

At $M_0 \neq \pm 1$, choose its specified eigenline locally; its eigenvalue on a commuting peripheral word is finite and nonzero. The ratio of the two peripheral eigenvalues is therefore a regular unit.

The same conclusion holds at $M_0 = \pm 1$, without diagonalizing the meridian. In a frame in which its upper-right entry is a unit, a commuting matrix $L$ has the form

$$L = aI + b\mu. \tag{I.120}$$

Here $b = L_{12}/\mu_{12}$ and $a = L_{11} - b\mu_{11}$ are regular. Its two selected eigenvalues are $a + bM$ and $a + bM^{-1}$. Both are nonzero at the point because $\det L \neq 0$. Their ratio is therefore regular and nonzero through the parabolic value. Scalar changes of the representative $L$ cancel from the ratio.

The selected meridian eigenline itself is regular as well: in this frame it is spanned by $(\mu_{12}, M - \mu_{11})$, or by $(\mu_{12}, M^{-1} - \mu_{11})$ for the other selection. The first coordinate is a unit, including at $M = \pm 1$. Thus coalescence of the two flags does not create a pole in the marked eigenvalue ratio.

This directly applies to the square of a determinant-one preferred-longitude eigenvalue, with the chosen inverse convention if necessary. It does not require choosing a global square root of a projective matrix determinant. Every factor (I.107), and every framing monomial in $M$, is likewise a unit at the point.

### I.8.6 Local sections and the integral total family

More concretely, fix generic numerical auxiliary values $Q_v = q_v$ satisfying all the open conditions at $M_0$, and choose a simple root of every edge equation. The implicit function theorem gives simultaneous holomorphic roots $X_e(M)$ near $M_0$. At the chosen point select a nonzero minor in each linear gluing system (I.114). Those same minors remain nonzero nearby. All actual group matrices, their inverses and the main eigenvalue ratio are then holomorphic along this local section. This is stronger than the existence of an isolated good point in a special fiber.

The split trace-zero fibers do not invalidate this argument. Let $B$ be the Laurent coordinate ring in $M, Q_v$, localized at all $S_e$. Dividing (I.102) by $S_e$ makes every edge polynomial monic with constant term one. The simultaneous source algebra is therefore free over $B$, with basis the products $\prod_e X_e^{\epsilon_e}$, $\epsilon_e \in \{0, 1\}$. The independent generic edge squareclasses imply that its generic localization is a single field of degree $2^{|\mathcal{E}|}$. Freeness embeds the source algebra into that field; in particular the total source variety is integral and has no additional vertical component. Its simple points at $M = \pm i$ belong to the closure of the same generic family. A rational identity proved there therefore holds on the regular local section just constructed.

## I.9 Determining the monomial and the preferred framing

By Section I.7 the discrepancy is a rational function of $M$. By Section I.8 its pullback is a regular unit along a local section through every $M_0 \neq 0$. If it had a zero or pole at $M_0$, that nonzero order would persist on the section. Therefore it has no zero or pole on $\mathbb{C}^*$, and

$$\frac{L_{\mathrm{aug}}^2}{\prod_e f_e^2} = cM^k, \qquad c \neq 0, \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}. \tag{I.121}$$

This is the elementary classification of units of $\mathbb{C}[M, M^{-1}]$. At the complete main cusp every $f_e = 1$ and $L_{\mathrm{aug}}^2 = 1$, so $c = 1$.

The preferred-cusp calculation is a marked face-word calculation on the same original exterior:

$$\tau_{\mathrm{main}} = a_{\mathrm{aug}} + 2i \sum_e \cot(\pi x_e), \qquad X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}, \qquad a_{\mathrm{aug}} = -w_\epsilon - \sum_v \epsilon_v. \tag{I.122}$$

The integer includes the retained half twists and the preferred zero-linking correction. It is not inferred from (I.121).

For completeness, the cusp shape equals the logarithmic slope of this geometric eigenvalue curve. Near a noncentral parabolic meridian write a commuting determinant-one longitude as $aI + b\mu$. Its eigenvalues are $a + bM^{\pm 1}$. At $M = 1$, its projective translation divided by the meridian translation is $b/(a + b)$. Differentiating the determinant-one relation shows that $d \log L / d \log M$ has the same value. Thus (I.122) computes this derivative with the specified marking.

Since $f_e(1, X) = 1$ for every $X$, its first derivative receives no contribution from the derivative of the wire:

$$\left.\frac{d \log f_e}{d \log M}\right|_{M=1} = 2\frac{1 + X_e}{1 - X_e} = 2i \cot(\pi x_e). \tag{I.123}$$

Equations (I.121)–(I.123) give $k = 2a_{\mathrm{aug}}$, proving (I.4). Tangent agreement fixes the exponent only after the preceding argument has excluded every other rational factor.

Now let $\ell_v = \mathrm{lk}(K, C_v)$. The crossing disk has exactly two main punctures, so $\ell_v = 0$ for opposite local strand directions and $\ell_v = \pm 2$ for parallel directions. In the augmented exterior,

$$[\lambda_{\mathrm{aug}}] = \sum_v \ell_v [\mu_v], \qquad [\lambda_v] = \ell_v [\mu_K]. \tag{I.124}$$

After filling $\mu_v + p_v \lambda_v$, its meridian has class $-p_v \ell_v [\mu_K]$. The original main-boundary word that becomes the preferred filled longitude is therefore

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}} = \lambda_{\mathrm{aug}} \, \mu_K^{\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2}. \tag{I.125}$$

This is a primitive integral basis change on the same main torus. It is not an assertion that the augmented longitude was already zero linking after surgery.

Here $\lambda_{\mathrm{aug}}$ means its image on the filled cusp. Both shaded parallelograms use the same meridian and the same lattice; the displayed example has $\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2 = 4$.

Write $o_v = 1$ for parallel and $o_v = -1$ for opposite strand directions in the fixed physical convention. Then

$$\ell_v^2 = 2(1 + o_v), \qquad w_\epsilon = \sum_v o_v \epsilon_v, \qquad w(D) = w_\epsilon - 2 \sum_v o_v p_v.$$

Consequently

$$\begin{aligned} a_{\mathrm{aug}} + \sum_v p_v \ell_v^2 &= -w_\epsilon - \sum_v \epsilon_v + 2 \sum_v p_v (1 + o_v) \\ &= -w(D) - \sum_v (\epsilon_v - 2p_v) = a(D). \end{aligned} \tag{I.126}$$

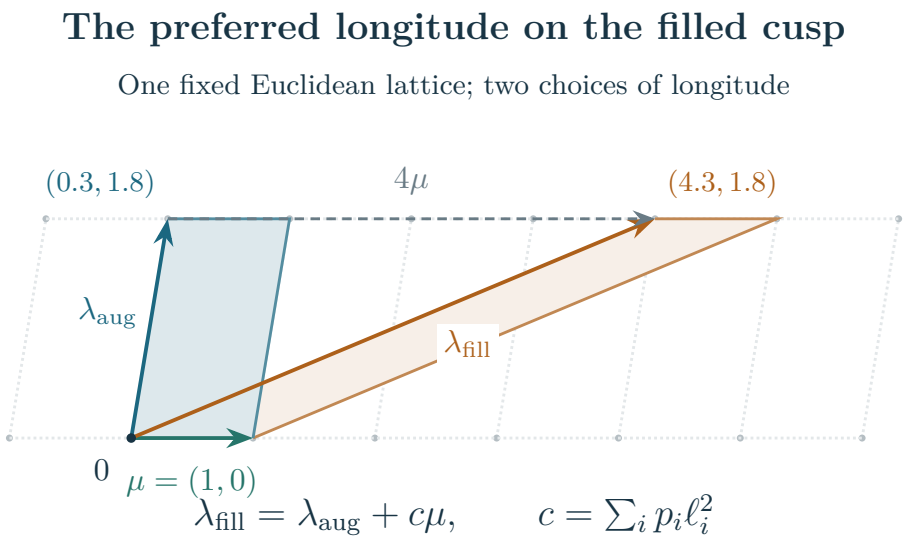



Figure I.2: The image of the augmented longitude and the preferred filled longitude differ by an integral meridian shear on the same filled cusp.

Combining (I.4) with (I.125)–(I.126) proves the squared filled identity (I.6), with the original primitive slopes and preferred longitude.

## I.10 The determinant-one sign at the complete filled knot

The squared identity leaves a two-valued ambiguity. Its sign is fixed at the actual complete filled knot, rather than chosen to fit the edge product.

The negative trace of a null-homologous peripheral curve is a known fact; see Menal-Ferrer and Porti, [11, Corollary 3.10]. The frame proof below includes the sign and its compatibility with the lifts used here.

### I.10.1 A frame calculation on a once-bordered surface

Let $S$ be a compact connected oriented surface of genus $g$ with one boundary component. Embed it in an oriented three-manifold which has a spin structure. Choose a smooth oriented tangent frame $(e_1, e_2)$ on $S$, and complete it by the positive unit normal $\nu$. Such a tangent frame exists because a surface with boundary has trivial tangent bundle.

Pulling back the ambient spin double cover along $(e_1, e_2, \nu)$ gives a double cover of $S$. Its monodromy is a homomorphism $H_1(S; \mathbb{Z}/2) \to \mathbb{Z}/2$. Since the single oriented boundary is zero in this homology, the lift of this chosen frame closes after one boundary circuit.

Now replace the first tangent vector on the boundary by its positive unit tangent $t$, and the second by the corresponding inward tangent normal $n$. Relative to $(e_1, e_2)$, the frame $(t, n)$ has winding number

$$\chi(S) = 1 - 2g. \tag{I.127}$$

This is the boundary form of the index formula: extend the outward boundary normal to a tangent vector field with isolated zeros. The sum of its indices is $\chi(S)$; measured in the global tangent frame, it is the degree of its boundary direction. The boundary tangent differs from that normal by a fixed quarter turn, which does not change the degree.

A full $2\pi$ rotation in the tangent plane is the nontrivial loop of the oriented three-dimensional frame group. It therefore changes the sign of a spin lift. Formula (I.127) is odd. It follows that the boundary-adapted frame

$$(t, n, \nu) \tag{I.128}$$

has an antiperiodic lift: after one boundary circuit its lift returns to the other sheet.

No choice of spin structure changes this conclusion. The only possible change was the monodromy of the first global frame, and that monodromy vanishes on the boundary.

### I.10.2 Application to a complete hyperbolic knot cusp

Let $Y$ be the oriented complete finite-volume hyperbolic complement of a knot in $S^3$. Take a sufficiently far cusp torus $T$. Its preferred longitude $\lambda$ is primitive and bounds a Seifert surface in the truncated complement. Arrange the boundary of the surface to be the straight Euclidean representative of $\lambda$ on $T$, and arrange its collar to meet $T$ orthogonally. These changes are made inside the ordinary product collar of the boundary torus.

Along that boundary, (I.128) is a translation-invariant horospherical frame, up to one constant rotation: $t$ is the constant longitude direction, $n$ is the radial direction, and $\nu$ is the constant perpendicular direction in the horosphere. Thus the preceding surface calculation says that the translation-invariant horospherical frame has antiperiodic spin holonomy along $\lambda$.

For precision, identify the oriented frame bundle of hyperbolic three-space with $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{C})$, and its spin cover with $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{C})$. Conjugate the cusp fixed point to infinity. If the longitude translation is $z_\lambda \neq 0$, the path of translation-invariant horospherical frames is represented by

$$U(t) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & tz_\lambda \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad 0 \le t \le 1. \tag{I.129}$$

This is the lift starting at the identity. Here translation-invariant refers to the cusp's Euclidean translation group; no assertion of Levi-Civita parallel transport along a horocycle in hyperbolic three-space is needed. For a determinant-one holonomy lift $\widetilde{\rho}$, the endpoint of (I.129) closes in the quotient spin bundle precisely when $\widetilde{\rho}(\lambda) = U(1)$. It returns to the opposite sheet precisely when $\widetilde{\rho}(\lambda) = -U(1)$. The antiperiodicity just proved therefore gives

$$\boxed{\widetilde{\rho}(\lambda) = -\begin{pmatrix} 1 & z_\lambda \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \operatorname{tr}\widetilde{\rho}(\lambda) = -2.} \tag{I.130}$$

Reversing the longitude replaces this matrix by its inverse and does not change the sign. Any two determinant-one lifts differ by a character to $\{\pm 1\}$, and the preferred longitude is zero in the knot complement's first homology, so (I.130) is independent of that choice as well.

Here spin existence needs no general three-manifold theorem. Remove a point of the knot from $S^3$; its complement is $\mathbb{R}^3$, whose standard tangent frame restricts to $Y$. Orthonormalizing for the hyperbolic metric gives a spin structure on its oriented frame bundle and hence a lift of its geometric holonomy. The sign calculation itself is the explicit surface-frame argument above.

### I.10.3 Compatibility with the original augmented representation

Return to the original all-circle construction. Write $\mu_K$ for its main meridian and $\mu_v$ for its original auxiliary meridians. The original circles are pairwise unlinked. If $\ell_v$ is the linking number of circle $v$ with the main knot and $p_v$ is its integral filling coefficient, the fixed main-boundary word which becomes the preferred filled longitude is

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}} = \lambda_K \mu_K^{\sum_v p_v \ell_v^2}. \tag{I.131}$$

In the augmented exterior its first homology class is

$$[\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}}] = \sum_v \ell_v [\mu_v] + \sum_v p_v \ell_v^2 [\mu_K]. \tag{I.132}$$

The original crossing disk is punctured by exactly two main strands, so

$$\ell_v \in \{0, 2, -2\}. \tag{I.133}$$

Consequently (I.132) vanishes modulo two.

At an actual complete filled knot point, pull back any determinant-one lift of its complete holonomy to the augmented group. Locally this lift continues through the augmented geometric family: lift the finitely many generator matrices holomorphically; the signs of the finitely many relations are discrete and remain their identity values at the initial point. If another local determinant-one lift is used for the face construction, its ratio with this lift is a $\{\pm 1\}$-valued character: both project to the same projective representation after one fixed conjugation. By (I.132)–(I.133), that character is one on $\lambda_{\mathrm{fill}}$. Thus any such local face-map lift has exactly the same longitude sign as the filled lift in (I.130). A globally rational determinant-one lift over the entire source variety is not assumed or needed.

This step is useful because the original matrices of an auxiliary filling slope may be $-I$ rather than $I$. One need not assume that the particular auxiliary lifts descend to the filled group. Their possible discrepancy is a character and cannot change (I.131).

### I.10.4 Fixing a holomorphic squared longitude identity

The squared identity proved above, on a connected geometric germ with the original selected main flag and fixed filling equations, is

$$L_{\mathrm{geom}}^2 = M^{2a(D)} \prod_e \left( \frac{M^2 - X_e}{1 - M^2 X_e} \right)^2 . \tag{I.134}$$

The factors are holomorphic units near its complete filled point. Define the longitude coordinate as the inverse eigenvalue on the source $M^{-1}$ meridian line. The ratio of the two sides before squaring is then a holomorphic function taking values in $\{1, -1\}$; it is constant on the connected germ.

At the actual complete filled point, $M = 1$. Each edge factor in (I.134) is one, since the geometric wire does not have $X_e = 1$. The inverse selected longitude eigenvalue is $-1$ by the preceding complete-cusp and lift comparison. Therefore the constant is negative:

$$\boxed{L_{\mathrm{geom}} = -M^{a(D)} \prod_e \frac{M^2 - X_e}{1 - M^2 X_e}.} \tag{I.135}$$

The conclusion requires the exact squared identity as input. The complete-value sign fixes only its remaining two-valued ambiguity; it is not being used to infer the dependence on $M$ or on any auxiliary parameter.

## I.11 The geometric factor of an actual quantum recurrence

The geometric identity now applies to the classical characteristic selected by the actual invariant. This step uses the separate all-order source theorem; the geometric construction by itself does not imply a quantum asymptotic estimate.

### I.11.1 The source hypotheses and the factor statement

Keep the original all-circle tree and knot qualifications of Section I.1. Fix the signed powers and the diagram before the level tends to infinity, and assume one of the following proved source hypotheses:

- the original strict presentation has independently sufficiently long fixed signed filling powers, as in the filled-meridian theorem;
- its degrees and powers satisfy the summed criterion, $\sum_v d_v/(d_v^2+n_v^2) \le 2^{-25}$;
- they satisfy the local criterion, $\max_v d_v/(d_v^2+n_v^2) \le 2^{-120}$.

Here $d_v$ is the number of edges incident to vertex $v$. The last two alternatives do not require every $n_v \neq 0$. All original knot-pattern qualifications remain; in particular the two-circle knot case excludes the two-odd link pattern. Both level parities are retained.

Let $F_N(M)$ be the actual zero-framed reduced ADO state, with

$$q_N = e^{\pi i/N}, \qquad M = -q_N x, \qquad F_N(1) = K_N. \tag{I.136}$$

The letter $x$ here is the raw highest-weight parameter, not the normalized internal index $x_e$ with $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$. Thus the marked complete meridian is $M = 1$. The ADO normalization and pointing fix the state and its complete value $K_N$.

Consider any specified nonzero fixed operator

$$P(q, M, T) = \sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q, M) T^j, \qquad a_j \in \mathbb{C}(q, M), \qquad TM = qMT, \tag{I.137}$$

which annihilates the whole function $F_N(M)$ at every sufficiently large level $q = q_N$. The shift $T$ replaces $M$ by $qM$. This is an actual all-level annihilator. Its existence is proved independently by the finite-sum annihilator theorem; it is not defined by fitting complete values or by adding a desired geometric factor.

Clear its fixed rational denominators to obtain Laurent-polynomial coefficients, and remove their common $q-1$ valuation. Let $P_0(M, L) \neq 0$ be the first classical symbol that remains. If the original operator has negative shift powers, first multiply by a power of $T$; this contributes only a Laurent unit to its classical symbol.

Let $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}(M, L)$ generate the Laurent prime of the actual oriented geometric eigenvalue germ through $(M, L) = (1, -1)$. The longitude is the preferred one in (I.7), on the $M$ line, equivalently the inverse eigenvalue on the source $M^{-1}$ line.

**Corollary.** Under the stated all-circle source hypotheses,

$$A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}(M, L) \mid P_0(M, L) \quad \text{in } \mathbb{C}[M^{\pm 1}, L^{\pm 1}]. \tag{I.138}$$

This is the selected irreducible geometric factor, defined up to a nonzero Laurent monomial. It is not a claim about its multiplicity, the other factors of the symbol, or the full classical A-polynomial. The rational-coefficient version is stated in Section I.11.4.

### I.11.2 The exact reduced/full conversion

The normalization factors must be retained before taking the classical symbol. Write

$$H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, \qquad d_N(M) = \eta_N \frac{M - M^{-1}}{M^N - M^{-N}}, \qquad d_N(1) = \frac{\eta_N}{N}, \quad \eta_N = i^{N+3}. \tag{I.139}$$

The full modified-trace state is $d_N(M)F_N(M)$. On $M = q_N^s$, the exact identity

$$\frac{d_N(q_N^s)}{d_N(1)} = H_N(s)^{-1} \tag{I.140}$$

shows that $\mathcal{Z}_N(s) = F_N(q_N^s)/(K_N H_N(s))$ is its normalized full value. The source theorem makes $K_N \neq 0$ at every sufficiently large level.

Put $f(M) = M - M^{-1}$, distinct from the edge factors $f_e$. For every integer shift used in (I.137),

$$\frac{d_N(q_N^j M)}{d_N(M)} = (-1)^j \frac{f(q_N^j M)}{f(M)}. \tag{I.141}$$

The normalized full state therefore satisfies the root equation of the fixed rational Ore operator

$$\widetilde{P} = \sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q, M)(-1)^j \frac{f(M)}{f(q^j M)} T^j. \tag{I.142}$$

Multiplying on the left by $\prod_{j=1}^{d} f(q^j M)$ clears these additional denominators. After the same common $q - 1$ valuation has been removed, its first classical symbol is

$$f(M)^d P_0(M, -L). \tag{I.143}$$

The meridian divisor and the sign character have both been recorded. Neither is deleted by redefining the state.

### I.11.3 All orders, shifted charts and the geometric branch

The all-order source theorem proves, for every prescribed finite order, an expansion

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) \sim \sum_{r \geq 1} N^{-r} p_r(s), \qquad \deg p_r \leq r + 1. \tag{I.144}$$

Its proof uses the exact finite source on translated microscopic charts, not analytic continuation of an asymptotic formula initially known only on $|s| < 1$. For a fixed operator order $d$, choose a small open disk in the upper half-plane and retain all its translates by $0, 1, \ldots, d$. Those compacts avoid ordinary-color resonances. The same all-order expansion, with its original normalization, holds at every shifted argument required by (I.142). If lower amplitudes depend on level parity, the argument is made on either parity subsequence; the leading action is the same.

The degree bound in (I.144) is supplied by the canonical sine-factorial interpolation and the original joint first-charge saddle. More precisely, let $\Phi$ be that joint phase at $s = 0$, including the linear angular terms in (I.85). With its continued logarithms, put

$$\begin{aligned} J'(x) &= \log(2 \sin \pi x), \\ \mathcal{K}(x, t) &= 2J(x) - J(x + t) - J(x - t), \\ \Phi_t &= \Phi + \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}} \mathcal{K}(x_e, t) + \frac{\pi i \, a(D)}{2} t^2, \qquad S(t) = \Phi_t(\text{its selected critical point}). \end{aligned} \tag{I.145}$$

The original Hessian is invertible, so the selected critical point and $S(t)$ are analytic near zero. The exact scalar in (I.145) is the original zero-framing factor; no extra geometric phase has been inserted.

The full stationary expansion has the form

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) \sim N\{S(t) - S(0)\} + \sum_{j\geq 0} N^{-j}\{C_j(t) - C_j(0)\}, \qquad t = s/N, \tag{I.146}$$

with holomorphic coefficient germs $C_j$. Consequently the coefficient of $s^{r+1}$ in $p_r(s)$ is exactly the coefficient of $t^{r+1}$ in $S(t) - S(0)$; lower amplitudes cannot contribute to that degree. This is the filtration needed for the operator argument. A leading profile or finitely many microscopic jets would not supply it.

Set $h = \log q$, $u = \log M = hs$, and define

$$\mathcal{S}(u) = \pi i\{S(u/(\pi i)) - S(0)\}. \tag{I.147}$$

Regrading (I.144) by $h^r s^k = h^{r-k}u^k$ gives

$$h^{-1}\mathcal{S}(u) + \sum_{j\geq 0} h^j A_j(u). \tag{I.148}$$

The degree bound permits only the displayed negative power of $h$. Under the $j$-fold shift, the ratio of the formal periods lies in $\mathbb{C}[[h, u]]$, and its constant $h$-coefficient is $e^{j\mathcal{S}'(u)}$: the negative power cancels in $h^{-1}[\mathcal{S}(u + jh) - \mathcal{S}(u)]$, while the other terms have zero constant coefficient in their finite difference.

Insert the actual expansions at the finitely many translated arguments into (I.142). Its exact equation makes every asymptotic coefficient vanish on the chosen open disk. Those coefficient identities are therefore formal identities in $s$. The substitution

$$\mathbb{C}[[h, u]] \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[s][[h]], \qquad u \mapsto hs. \tag{I.149}$$

is injective, since distinct monomials $h^a u^b$ have distinct images $h^{a+b}s^b$. Thus the equation holds before substitution. Its constant $h$-coefficient, using (I.143), is

$$f(e^u)^d P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{I.150}$$

The series $f(e^u)^d$ is nonzero, and the formal series ring is an integral domain. Cancellation in this identity gives $P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0$. This cancels a factor in a proved domain identity; it does not remove a peripheral component from the original operator.

The derivative of a critical value has no derivative-of-critical-point term. The exact sine identity in the source theorem gives

$$\exp \mathcal{K}_t(x_e, t) = \frac{M^2 - X_e}{1 - M^2 X_e}, \qquad M = e^{\pi i t}. \tag{I.151}$$

Its logarithm is fixed by its value zero at $t = 0$. Consequently (I.145)–(I.147) give

$$-e^{\mathcal{S}'(\log M)} = -M^{a(D)} \prod_e \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)} = L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M). \tag{I.152}$$

The last equality is (I.7) on the same branch. Section I.5 identifies the original first-charge point with the actual complete filled knot and proves that its continued source equations give the geometric meridian germ. Section I.10 fixes its negative lift at that filled point. Thus neither tangent agreement nor an unmarked choice among the exponentiated solutions is being used in (I.152). Equation (I.150) proves that $P_0$ vanishes on the full geometric eigenvalue germ.

### I.11.4 The irreducible factor and its field of definition

Evaluation on this germ defines a prime ideal of $\mathbb{C}[M^{\pm1}, L^{\pm1}]$. It is nonzero because it contains $P_0$, and it contains no nonzero polynomial in $M$ alone, since $M$ varies on an open disk. The prime therefore has height one. The Laurent polynomial ring is a unique factorization domain, so the prime is generated by one irreducible Laurent polynomial. The representation identification in Section I.5 makes it the selected geometric factor. Its membership statement for $P_0$ is precisely (I.138).

If $a_j \in \mathbb{Q}(q, M)$, perform the denominator clearing over $\mathbb{Q}$. Contract the same germ prime to $\mathbb{Q}[M^{\pm1}, L^{\pm1}]$. It is again nonzero, contains no polynomial in $M$ alone, and has height one. If $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{Q}}$ is its irreducible generator, then

$$A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{Q}} \mid P_0 \quad \text{over } \mathbb{Q}. \tag{I.153}$$

Its complex factorization contains the selected geometric factor and any conjugate components forced by the rational coefficient field. A particular complex component need not itself be defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

The conclusion applies to every specified genuine annihilator, including a minimal one if one is chosen. It does not identify the whole classical symbol with the full A-polynomial, compare entire operator ideals, or determine factor multiplicities. It also asserts no fixed-$M \neq 1$ quantum asymptotic by substituting $s$ of order $N$, and no uniform nonvanishing through ordinary resonances.

This appendix treats ordered circle trees. Appendix J handles product junctions without crossing circles by inserting a zero-crossing box and proving exact elimination after meridian filling. It extends the geometric-factor conclusion to every strict presentation in the full-source theorem and carries the intrinsic result through the covered net-twist and closure reductions. The additional volume cases of Chapter 11 still require their own all-orders shifted-chart argument before they can be added to this operator statement.

# Appendix J

# The geometric longitude for strict Conway trees

A product junction without a crossing circle can be treated geometrically by inserting a circle around a zero-crossing two-strand box. Filling that new circle along its meridian removes it and restores the same ordered tangle. The new circle supplies an angular variable whose stationary elimination recovers the original product action exactly.

This appendix uses that construction to identify the full preferred longitude selected by the strict-tree action, including junctions of arbitrary valence and adjacency. The proof keeps the original peripheral paths and also covers the possible physical edge label $x = 1/2$, where an individual edge quadratic has a double root.

## J.1 The theorem and its geometric conventions

Use a fixed strict ordered Conway construction from the strict-tree theorem. The elementary twist pieces are joined by their prescribed ordered products and physical quarter-turns, then closed by the original cylindrical matching. After the forced final product is removed, strictness means that the real angle domain contains a point with

$$0 < a_i < \tfrac{1}{2}, \qquad \max(u, v) < w < u + v < 1 \tag{J.1}$$

at each original leaf and each retained binary product. A *bare junction* is a maximal group of consecutive products that contains no crossing-circle operator. Any binary association used to calculate it is retained only as an internal resolution; it does not create additional physical turns.

Require the original strand pairing to give one knot, counting any circles already closed inside intermediate tangles. Keep all original parity qualifications. In the two-leaf case retain the original pure-leaf qualification; the two-odd pairing is a link and is excluded by the knot test. The construction and the independently signed twist powers $n_i$ are fixed before the quantum level varies. Assume those powers are sufficiently long for the existing marked strict-tree filling theorem.

A *meridian* goes once around a strand. The *preferred longitude* follows the knot once and has zero linking number with it. Holonomy assigns a Möbius transformation to each based closed path in the complement. We use determinant-one matrix lifts; $M$ is the eigenvalue of

the positively oriented main meridian, and $L$ is the eigenvalue of the preferred longitude on the same line. The source cut selects the other, $M^{-1}$, eigenline, so $L$ is the inverse longitude eigenvalue on that selected line.

Let $\mathcal{E}_T$ be the original physical quarter-turn edges of the reduced junction tree. On edge $e$, $x_e$ is the normalized polynomial index shared by its two ends after the trace pairing. When that incidence is exposed as the ordinary output of the rooted branch, the output angle is $1 - x_e$. The original ordered construction fixes this convention. Put $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$.

**Theorem.** For every such fixed construction, sufficiently long independent signed twists give the original complete hyperbolic knot complement and its regular geometric meridian germ. On that germ,

$$\boxed{L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M) = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_i n_i.} \tag{J.2}$$

Here $w(D)$ is the oriented writhe of the original filled diagram. The variables $x_e(M)$ are those of the original strict-tree stationary action, not those of a different knot presentation.

More precisely, write $M = e^{\pi i t}$ and let $\Phi$ be the original joint first-charge phase at $M = 1$. This is the limiting logarithmic action of the finite tangle evaluation, with all primitive filling logarithms retained. Its continued critical point is defined by

$$\Phi_t = \Phi + \sum_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \{2J(x_e) - J(x_e+t) - J(x_e-t)\} + \frac{\pi i\, a(D)}{2} t^2, \qquad J'(x) = \log(2\sin\pi x), \quad J(0) = 0. \tag{J.3}$$

The theorem identifies this critical branch with the geometric representation germ of the original filled knot. It identifies more than its cusp tangent.

At an auxiliary circle the primitive filling slope is $\mu_v + p_v\lambda_v$, with original signed crossing power $n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v$. The disk longitude has selected eigenvalue $-Q_v$, hence eigenvalue ratio $Q_v^2$. A retained half twist means $\epsilon_v \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$. These words and flags are kept in the proof. In particular, an eigenvalue-ratio equation at $Q_v = \pm 1$ is not used to discard a possibly nontrivial parabolic filling word.

The marked mask geometry supplies the original complete and long-filled holonomies. The all-circle longitude theorem supplies its full rational representation and longitude identity after circles have been inserted. The argument below connects the two at the level of ordered group words and of the filtered stationary action. It imposes no new restriction on bare-junction valence or adjacency and adds no short-filling quantum claim.

## J.2 The literal insertion

Use the reduced tree of original product junctions, with consecutive unturned products already grouped. A bare vertex has full valence at least three. Its incident edges are the original quarter-turns; a binary resolution used to describe its positive kernel does not add physical edges.

At a bare vertex insert the literal unturned box $R^0 = I$, at the distinguished position immediately before the original ordered child product. Encircle its two strands by a new crossing circle. Keep every child in its original order. Put

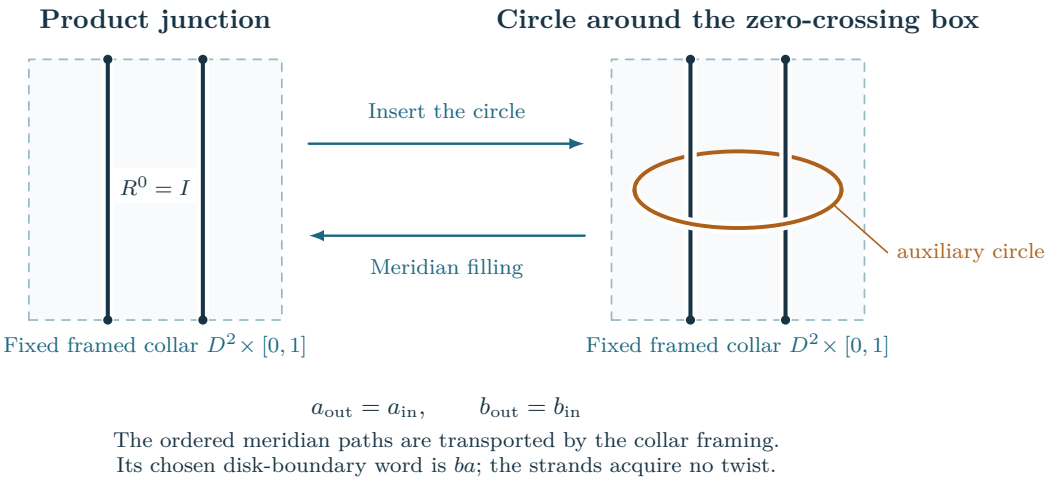



Figure J.1: A crossing circle is added around two straight strands in a fixed framed collar. Meridian filling removes it. The transported based meridians satisfy $a_{\text{out}} = a_{\text{in}}$ and $b_{\text{out}} = b_{\text{in}}$; their chosen disk-boundary word is $ba$.

$$\epsilon_v = p_v = n_v = 0 \tag{J.4}$$

at this new circle. Filling its original primitive meridian removes the auxiliary circle and restores the literal identity box. Thus the filled tangle, its endpoints, its framed main strands and its original peripheral curves are unchanged. No new quarter-turn is inserted. Repeating the operation at all bare vertices produces a literal all-circle tree on the same physical edge set.

The fixed access paths make these ordered equalities precise. They are constructed in Section J.6; the figure records the collar without choosing additional paths.

For a holonomy representation, the added meridian must be projectively identity: its matrix must be a scalar. An eigenvalue ratio of one would also permit a nontrivial parabolic matrix. Section J.3 excludes this ambiguity by exhibiting an auxiliary longitude with distinct eigenvalues.

The original crossing powers, writhe and integer

$$a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v. \tag{J.5}$$

are unchanged. The added circles have filling parameter zero, so their preferred-longitude surgery correction $p_v \ell_v^2$ also vanishes.

After the zero-power circles have been inserted, the ordered all-circle cut uses this attachment at every tree edge. The labels fix the page order. The representation comparison below also permits a flat added subdivision; it uses the original strict geometry to identify the knot holonomy.

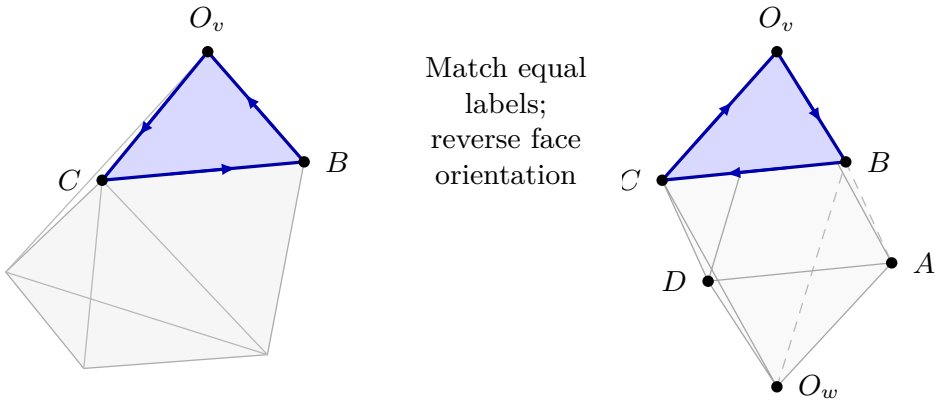



Figure J.2: An ordered page attachment glues an edge block along a shaded triangle, retaining circle v and introducing circle w.

## J.3 A unique regular zero-power angular saddle

Let a bare hub have $m \geq 3$ incident covariant labels $x_1, \ldots, x_m$, with

$$0 < x_j \leq \tfrac{1}{2}, \qquad \#\{j : x_j = \tfrac{1}{2}\} \leq 1, \qquad \sum_j x_j > 1. \tag{J.6}$$

The complete physical-edge theorem and the original wire-window argument give these conditions at the original complete strict optimizer. All physical labels are strictly below half except for the internal edge of the two-trivalent-hub component; that exception supplies at most one half label to either hub. Strict whole-hub support gives the final inequality. Hidden resolution labels are not included in (J.6).

The angular variable $\tau$ describes the auxiliary disk longitude by $Q = e^{i\tau}$. The circle-incidence action is

$$b(x, \tau) = \int_0^x \log(2\cos(2\pi r) + 2\cos\tau)\, dr - 2J(x), \qquad J'(x) = \log(2\sin \pi x). \tag{J.7}$$

Here $J(0) = 0$; its derivative specifies its continued branch. For $\tau = -iy$, $y > 0$, every logarithm in the integral is real and finite. Put $k = \tanh(y/2)$. Direct integration gives

$$b_\tau(x, -iy) = \frac{i}{\pi} \arctan\big(k \tan(\pi x)\big), \quad 0 < x < \tfrac{1}{2}, \tag{J.8}$$

with value $i/2$ at $x = 1/2$. Indeed

$$\int_0^x \frac{\sinh y}{\cosh y + \cos 2\pi r}\, dr = \frac{1}{\pi} \arctan\big(k \tan \pi x\big).$$

The zero-power first-charge equation is therefore

$$\sum_j b_\tau(x_j,\tau) - i = 0 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \sum_j \arctan(k\tan \pi x_j) = \pi. \tag{J.9}$$

A half label contributes $\pi/2$. The left side is strictly increasing for $0 < k < 1$, starts at zero or $\pi/2$, and tends to $\pi \sum_j x_j > \pi$. Thus (J.9) has exactly one solution $0 < k < 1$. Consequently

$$y = 2\,\mathrm{arctanh}\, k > 0, \qquad Q = e^{i\tau} = e^{y} = \frac{1+k}{1-k} > 1. \tag{J.10}$$

At least two labels are strictly below half. Differentiating (J.9) shows that its derivative is strictly positive, so the angular Hessian is nonzero. The saddle and its selected logarithms extend holomorphically to a complex neighborhood of the fixed label tuple. The half-label case causes no singularity: the integrand of (J.7) remains nonzero at $y > 0$, and (J.9)'s derivative still has the contributions of the other labels.

In particular the new auxiliary longitude has distinct eigenvalues. If its meridian has similarity one and commutes with that longitude, it is projectively identity. The possible unipotent ambiguity at $Q^2 = 1$ is absent.

## J.4 Exact elimination of the angular action

Let $V_m(\mathbf{x})$ be the complete positive action of the whole hub. It is defined by the ordered product kernel: resolve the original ordered product by any fixed binary association, sum its cubic gate actions, and optimize the hidden complementary labels. The conditional optimizer is strict and has negative definite Hessian on the strict whole-hub support.

Then on (J.6),

$$V_m(\mathbf{x}) = \operatorname*{stat}_\tau \left\{ \sum_j b(x_j,\tau) - i\tau \right\}, \qquad \tau = -iy \text{ from (6)}. \tag{J.11}$$

The equality includes its constant.

Here is one derivation retaining the exact complete normalization. The Newton factors are the finite polynomial basis used for the tangle evaluation. For a factor with normalized index $0 < x < 1/2$, the logarithm of its Laurent coefficient at normalized exponent $r$, divided by the level, has rate

$$B_x(r) = J(2x) - 2J(x) - J(x+r) - J(x-r), \qquad |r| \le x. \tag{J.12}$$

The complete trace of a product has first Fourier charge one with coefficient exactly one. Its higher charges have strictly smaller rate; this follows from strict concavity of the positive coefficient convolution, or directly from the regular bare-trace theorem. The same exact complete trace is the positive binary-resolution sum. Therefore its rate is both $V_m(\mathbf{x})$ and

$$\max_{\substack{\sum_j r_j = 1 \\ |r_j| \le x_j}} \sum_j B_{x_j}(r_j). \tag{J.13}$$

The two expressions evaluate the same finite polynomial trace. Their equality determines the local action with its constant and uses no global quantum-volume asymptotic.

For $0 < x < 1/2$,

$$B'_x(r) = \log \frac{\sin \pi(x - r)}{\sin \pi(x + r)}.$$

The unique maximizer of $B_x(r) + yr$ is

$$r = \frac{1}{\pi} \arctan\bigl(\tanh(y/2) \tan \pi x\bigr). \tag{J.14}$$

Moreover

$$b(x, -iy) = \max_{|r| \le x} \{B_x(r) + yr\}. \tag{J.15}$$

To verify the constant, at $y = 0$ both sides are $J(2x) - 4J(x)$. Their $y$-derivatives are the same $r$ by (J.8) and (J.14). The constrained maximizer (J.13) has common multiplier $y > 0$, determined by $\sum r_j = 1$. Equations (J.13)–(J.15) prove (J.11). A half label follows by continuity. Equivalently $B_{1/2}(r) = 0$, so its tilted maximum is $y/2$, as also follows directly from (J.7).

For a cubic vertex one can avoid the finite trace altogether. The old action is

$$t(x_1, x_2, x_3) = \sum_{i<j} J(x_i + x_j) - \sum_i J(x_i) - J(x_1 + x_2 + x_3 - 1). \tag{J.16}$$

Writing $a_j = \tan \pi x_j$, equation (J.9) gives $k^2 = (a_1 + a_2 + a_3)/(a_1 a_2 a_3)$. The derivative of the right side of (J.11) in $x_j$ is

$$\log \frac{\cosh y + \cos 2\pi x_j}{2 \sin^2 \pi x_j} = \log \frac{k^2 + \cot^2 \pi x_j}{1 - k^2}, \tag{J.17}$$

which is exactly $\partial_j t$. As $\sum x_j \downarrow 1$, $y \to \infty$, and both actions tend to $-2 \sum_j J(x_j)$. This proves the cubic identity with its absolute constant.

Both sides of (J.11) are holomorphic near the fixed strict tuple. Their equality on an open real set proves equality of the continued germs. At the possible half label, use their holomorphic continuation from labels below half; both Hessians remain invertible there.

## J.5 The actual added longitude in the old prism geometry

The previous section identifies actions. The following matrix calculation identifies the new circle inside the original marked geometry. A white map is the full Möbius transition between a white face in one projection copy and its partner in the other copy. Its translation as well as its fixed points is retained.

In an ordinary output port of the bare product write

$$E = e^{2\pi i b}, \qquad R = \frac{1}{1 + \kappa}, \qquad \kappa = e^{-f'(b)}.$$

The marked product construction gives the universal white maps

$$W_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & E-1 \\ 0 & E \end{pmatrix}, \qquad W_3 = \begin{pmatrix} R & 0 \\ 1-E & ER \end{pmatrix}. \tag{J.18}$$

They are the actual top and bottom white-face maps at an unmasked bare product. Through every original binary product, the full matrix identities give

$$W_{F,1} = W_{G,1} = W_{o,1}, \qquad W_{F,3} = W_{G,3} = W_{o,3} \tag{J.19}$$

in the original world frame. Consequently the same ordered side word is seen at every port of that hub.

Insert the zero-crossing box in the original disk frame. Its primitive disk-longitude path crosses these two white sides, giving $W_1^{-1}W_3$, up to the inversion required when the circle's orientation is reversed. The determinant-one normalization is

$$P = \frac{1}{R} W_1^{-1} W_3, \qquad \operatorname{tr} P = 2 - \frac{4\sin^2 \pi b}{R}. \tag{J.20}$$

This is the same $W_1^{-1}W_3$ disk word used at the corresponding end of an all-circle edge; it is not a trace chosen to fit (J.9).

The response metric records the ordered quadrilateral shape at a product boundary. Its coordinate $X_{\mathrm{met}}$ is distinct from the exponential wire variable $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$. It is

$$X_{\mathrm{met}}^2 = \frac{1 + \cot^2 \pi b}{1 + \kappa}.$$

Therefore

$$\operatorname{tr} P = 2 - \frac{4}{X_{\mathrm{met}}^2}. \tag{J.21}$$

At a boundary incidence with covariant label $x$, the ordinary output is $b = 1 - x$, and the conditional action satisfies $f'(b) = -\partial_x V_m$. Using (J.17), valid at any valence by the envelope identity (J.11), gives

$$X_{\mathrm{met}}^2 = \frac{1}{\sin^2 \pi x \, [1 + \exp(\partial_x V_m)]} = \operatorname{sech}^2(y/2) = 1 - k^2. \tag{J.22}$$

Thus

$$\operatorname{tr} P = -2\cosh y = -(Q + Q^{-1}). \tag{J.23}$$

This proves that the actual added longitude has the regular eigenvalues required by the angular saddle. The proof retains the old group word, and shows why a bare hub has a common $Q$ across all its pages.

When an incidence is viewed through its physical turn, the old identity $TW_{j+1}(E, R) = W_j(E^{-1}, 1 - R)T$ takes the $W_1^{-1}W_3$ word to the appropriate inverse of the $W_2^{-1}W_0$ word. Its trace is unchanged. The auxiliary flag may be selected on the eigenvalue $-Q$, $Q > 1$; the main meridian flags are not changed by this auxiliary choice.

## J.6 What the edge equations see at the complete bare representation

Pull the original complete holonomy back along the exact filling quotient obtained in Section J.2. This gives a representation of the enlarged augmented link with every newly added meridian equal to identity. It is a representation-theoretic pullback; no assertion that the drilled link carries this metric is needed.

### J.6.1 The marked zero-crossing collar

Choose the box in a framed ball $D^2 \times [0,1]$, with its two strands $\{p_1, p_2\} \times [0,1]$. Choose a basepoint $z_* \in \partial D^2$, an ordered pair of disjoint access paths from it to small circles around $p_1, p_2$, and transport that entire system by the product framing. Orient and name the resulting based puncture loops $a, b$ so that the oriented disk-boundary word is $ba$. The boundary basepath is $\{z_*\} \times [0,1]$. Transport across this literal zero-crossing box gives

$$a_{\text{out}} = a_{\text{in}}, \qquad b_{\text{out}} = b_{\text{in}}. \tag{J.24}$$

These are equalities in the based fundamental group, before taking any representation. No permutation of punctures, turn of an access path, or power of the disk-boundary curve is included.

Place the new auxiliary circle at the disk boundary in the middle of this collar, with the original disk framing. Its longitude is the parallel copy of that boundary and retains the based word $ba$. The meridian filling deletes the auxiliary circle and returns exactly the framed collar just described. Its quotient on fundamental groups fixes $a, b$, their access paths, and the boundary basepath. Thus it also fixes the ordered maps by which this collar is joined to all earlier and later product factors. This remains true when there are several child factors: transport the same system through them in their recorded order. It never requires the factors to commute.

For comparison with a pair of projection faces, transport the framed loops to the face basepoints along the original specified paths. If the old transport is $C_0$, (J.24) becomes the simultaneous conjugacy $C_0 a C_0^{-1} = a'$, $C_0 b C_0^{-1} = b'$. Reading the other side of a puncture changes the corresponding native generator to its inverse. Those inversions are recorded explicitly in (J.30) below; they do not change (J.24) into a braid. This is the marked van Kampen statement used at every added seam. Only a retained nonzero half twist changes (J.24), by the separately calibrated Hurwitz action.

A port here is the ordered quadrilateral chart supplied by the original cell construction. It is not assumed to be a new four-punctured topological boundary. On a physical turn edge use its original coordinate $(0, \infty, 1, R)$ and its phase $E = e^{2\pi i x}$. This is the transported physical-edge frame from the last paragraph of Section J.5; its phase is the reciprocal of the ordinary-output phase $e^{2\pi i b}$, with the corresponding change $R \mapsto 1 - R$. At $M = 1$ the four native all-circle white matrices are exactly the universal old $W_j(E, R)$, projectively. This follows by putting $m = 1$ in the explicit native chart, without specializing the auxiliary eigenvalues to one.

The two disk words have normalized traces $-\beta, -\gamma$, where

$$\beta = \frac{2R - (E + E^{-1})}{1 - R}, \qquad \gamma = \frac{2 - (E + E^{-1}) - 2R}{R}. \tag{J.25}$$

At an inserted hub these are supplied by (J.23); at an original circle they are its original marked longitude trace. Eliminating $R$ yields

$$A = \frac{4 - \beta\gamma}{\beta + \gamma + 4}, \qquad A = E + E^{-1}, \tag{J.26}$$

which is exactly the all-circle edge equation at $M = 1$. Thus the old phase is one of its two reciprocal roots. The native white maps retain $E$ itself, not just $E + E^{-1}$; the existing native/character comparison identifies the all-circle source variable with that $E$.

All character-chart denominators are units at this point: $\beta, \gamma \geq 2$, $E \neq 1$, and the displayed original port vertices are distinct. The allowed value $E = -1$ on the two-hub half edge does not cause a character-matrix singularity. In that case the edge quadratic may ramify over its endpoint parameters; one must use the full stationary branch or another local coordinate, not assert that $E$ is a simple quadratic root.

Indeed $E = -1$ gives

$$(\beta - 2)(\gamma - 2) = 16 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad X_{\mathrm{met},v}^2 + X_{\mathrm{met},w}^2 = 1, \tag{J.27}$$

by (J.21). This is the possible half-edge fold of the old geometry. The normalized matrices and the two irreducible puncture pairs below remain regular there.

Here is the boundary-group comparison, including the tuple that has to be retained. First choose the normalized native matrix representatives for the four old projective white maps. In terms of the raw universal representatives used in (J.18), their scalar factors are respectively

$$E^{-1}, \quad E^{-1}, \quad [E(1 - R)]^{-1}, \quad (ER)^{-1}. \tag{J.28}$$

Each normalized matrix has determinant $E^{-1}$ at $M = 1$. The raw universal representatives do not all have that determinant: in particular the factors involving $R$ and $1 - R$ cannot be discarded when taking an SL trace. With $W_j$ now denoting these normalized native representatives, put in each original edge frame

$$N_j = W_{j-1}^{-1} W_j, \qquad (A, B, C, D) = (N_3, N_0, N_1, N_2) \tag{J.29}$$

with the subsequent determinant-one puncture normalizations from the all-circle chart. These subsequent powers of $M$, not the scalar factors in (J.28), are one at $M = 1$. Thus every $N_j$ has determinant one and trace two. The actual page table is

| end | $(a, b)$ | $(a', b')$ | $ba = b'a'$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| $v$ | $(B, A)$ | $(C^{-1}, D^{-1})$ | $AB$ |
| $w$ | $(B^{-1}, C^{-1})$ | $(A, D)$ | $(BC)^{-1}$. |

(J.30)

The entries refer to paths, with the inverse on each puncture determined by its side of the disk. They are exactly the table of the literal all-circle cut, not a new identification of equal traces.

To apply that table to the old holonomy, first insert the zero-crossing box in the actual diagram, before assigning matrices. The main strands and their ordered endpoint paths are unchanged. Add the new circle and perform the literal projection/disk cut. The filling quotient takes every old main meridian and its old basepath to itself and kills the new circle meridian. In particular the four small corner paths reduce to the original consecutive-white words in

(J.29). A white face split by the added cut retains the same transport on both of its pieces: crossing the extra cut and returning differs by the new meridian, whose image is identity. This is also the full-map invariant (J.19) through every prism of the original product. Thus the developed four white transitions of the pulled-back representation are exactly the four $W_j$ already compared above.

The paths across the added disk pages are still the paths of this cut. By van Kampen they intertwine both generators in the appropriate row of (J.30), with precisely the displayed inversions; the product column is their original primitive disk boundary. The inserted box has no crossing, so no Hurwitz exchange is made at its distinguished seam. The old retained half twists keep their original exchanges.

At $M = 1$, either input pair in (J.30) is irreducible. Both punctures have trace two, and the products in the two rows have traces $-\beta$ and $-\gamma$, respectively, with $\beta, \gamma \geq 2$. Their irreducibility obstructions are $(\beta + 2)^2 \neq 0$ and $(\gamma + 2)^2 \neq 0$. Two intertwiners of either full ordered pair differ by its scalar centralizer. Therefore the pulled-back page transport equals the native pure transport in PGL. At an original odd seam the same argument is applied after the already calibrated full Hurwitz action. The corner flags on the main cusp are the old parabolic flags, and the extra auxiliary flags are chosen from (J.23); these choices do not alter a group generator.

All white and shaded generators of the cut now agree, in their original tree frames. This proves equality of the complete representations, not only of the local character triples or the main-cusp translation. It identifies the selected all-circle algebraic point with the pullback of the original bare-tree holonomy. The newly introduced ideal vertices need not form positive tetrahedra in this pulled-back representation. In particular an edge with $E = -1$ can make that added subdivision flat. No metric on the enlarged unfilled exterior is asserted or required.

## J.7 Stationary elimination at a nonparabolic main meridian

Let $t$ be the actual main deformation parameter, $M = e^{\pi i t}$. In the existing strict-tree filtered action it enters only through

$$\sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_T} \{2J(x_e) - J(x_e + t) - J(x_e - t)\} + \frac{\pi i a(D)}{2} t^2. \tag{J.31}$$

It does not enter the old bare tensor action or its hidden resolution wires.

The enlarged all-circle action replaces a bare hub by $\sum_j b(x_j, \tau_v) - i\tau_v$, with $n_v = 0$. Eliminating $\tau_v$ by (J.11) returns exactly the old whole-hub action, including its constant, for complex physical wires in the regular neighborhood. The edge set and (J.31) do not change, and neither does $a(D)$. Hence the two full critical-value germs are equal after stationary elimination.

The new angular Hessian at each bare hub is nonzero. To state the comparison precisely, first eliminate the old hidden binary-resolution variables. Their conditional Hessian is invertible by strictness. Let $z$ collect the remaining original variables and let $\tau_{\mathrm{new}}$ collect only the added angular variables. The enlarged Hessian has blocks

$$H_{\mathrm{new}} = \begin{pmatrix} H_{zz} & H_{z\tau} \\ H_{\tau z} & H_{\tau\tau} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad H_{\mathrm{old,red}} = H_{zz} - H_{z\tau} H_{\tau\tau}^{-1} H_{\tau z}. \tag{J.32}$$

The block $H_{\tau\tau}$ is diagonal over the added hubs, with nonzero entries from (J.9). Equality (J.11) identifies its Schur complement with the old reduced Hessian. The original full Hessian and its eliminated hidden block are invertible, so $\det H_{\mathrm{new}} = \det H_{\tau\tau} \det H_{\mathrm{old,red}} \neq 0$. No individual edge Hessian is inverted, including at (J.27).

The enlarged analytic branch therefore exists with all the original logarithms retained. Original sufficiently long fillings keep their auxiliary $Q_v^2 \neq 1$; every added zero-power circle has $Q_v^2 \neq 1$ by (J.10), and this persists near the complete branch.

By Section J.6 this branch reconstructs the original filled knot representation, rather than only an algebraic solution of the slope eigenvalue equations. Near the old augmented complete point the original auxiliary deformation is fixed by its primitive peripheral rows. Equality at completeness and the marked gluing/representation local inverse identify the two nearby deformations. The original sufficiently long filling point lies on that same small branch. There every original filled circle, as well as every added zero circle, has $Q_v^2 \neq 1$; the filling words are projectively identity by Section J.3. The nondegenerate main-meridian branch is then the geometric germ of the original filled knot.

The all-circle squared longitude identity is a rational identity on its integral source variety. It extends to this regular representation, including the half-edge fold, without solving for an individual edge root. The added zero fillings contribute no surgery exponent, the Seifert sign is that of the same original complete knot, and stationary elimination leaves the effective longitude unchanged. Consequently

$$L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M) = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e \in \mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)} \tag{J.33}$$

on the original strict-tree filled branch, with $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$.

This proves the theorem on the geometric germ of the original filled knot. The same physical edges occur before and after the zero-circle elimination, and the added circles contribute neither a crossing power nor a preferred-longitude shear.

The geometric identification uses the full ordered boundary-group comparison in Section J.6. The equality of actions in Section J.4 supplies the stationary branch, while the marked face maps identify its representation. These are distinct parts of the proof. The established strict-tree quantum estimates retain their existing long-filling hypotheses; this argument adds no estimate for short fillings.

## J.8 The geometric factor selected by the actual recurrence

The geometric theorem identifies the curve already selected by the full asymptotic expansion of the original strict-tree invariant. This extends the operator consequence beyond trees whose junctions all carry crossing circles. It requires no quantum estimate for the newly drilled diagram: the quantum source remains the original strict presentation.

Fix an oriented strict ordered Conway knot presentation $D$, with its original cut, endpoint orders, framing and signed integral crossing powers. Assume the powers are independently sufficiently long for the filled-meridian theorem and the geometric theorem above. The entire diagram and every power are fixed before $N$ tends to infinity. All original knot-pattern and absence-of-internal-component qualifications remain in force. Both level parities and all sufficiently large composite levels are included.

Write $F_N(M)$ for the actual zero-framed reduced ADO invariant, with

$$q_N = e^{\pi i/N}, \qquad M = -q_N x, \qquad F_N(1) = K_N(K). \tag{J.34}$$

Here $x$ is the raw highest-weight parameter, distinct from an internal normalized index $x_e$. The marked complete meridian is $M = 1$, and $X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}$ denotes the original physical-edge variable.

Let

$$P(q, M, T) = \sum_{j=0}^{d} a_j(q, M) T^j, \qquad a_j \in \mathbb{C}(q, M), \qquad TM = qMT, \tag{J.35}$$

be any specified nonzero fixed operator that annihilates the whole function $F_N(M)$ at every sufficiently large level. The shift $T$ replaces $M$ by $qM$. Such an actual all-level annihilator exists by the finite-sum construction; it is not defined by fitting the complete values or adjoining a desired factor. An operator with negative shift powers can first be multiplied by a power of $T$.

Clear fixed rational denominators, remove the common $q-1$ valuation of the coefficients, and denote the resulting first nonzero classical symbol by $P_0(M, L)$. Let $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}(M, L)$ generate the Laurent prime of the actual geometric eigenvalue germ through $(1, -1)$, in the preferred meridian and longitude of the original knot. The longitude coordinate is its eigenvalue on the $M$ line, equivalently the inverse eigenvalue on the source $M^{-1}$ line.

Then

$$\boxed{A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}(M, L) \mid P_0(M, L) \quad \text{in } \mathbb{C}[M^{\pm 1}, L^{\pm 1}].} \tag{J.36}$$

Thus every genuine all-level annihilator has the same selected irreducible geometric factor in its first classical symbol.

### J.8.1 Proof and normalization

The filtered characteristic theorem, Sections 2–6, already applies to the full strict long-filling class, including arbitrary bare components. It proves the complete microscopic expansion with its degree filtration on all the finitely many translated parameter charts needed by (J.35). This shifted-chart statement follows from the exact source and its endpoint estimates, not from continuation of an asymptotic formula on a single disk.

The normalized full state is

$$\mathcal{Z}_N(s) = \frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1) H_N(s)}, \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}. \tag{J.37}$$

It retains the exact modified-dimension gauge

$$d_N(M) = \eta_N \frac{M - M^{-1}}{M^N - M^{-N}}, \qquad d_N(1) = \eta_N/N, \qquad \frac{d_N(q_N^s)}{d_N(1)} = H_N(s)^{-1}. \tag{J.38}$$

Here $\eta_N = i^{N+3}$. Put $f(M) = M - M^{-1}$. The operator on the full state has shift coefficients

$$\widetilde{a}_j(q,M) = a_j(q,M)(-1)^j \frac{f(M)}{f(q^jM)}. \tag{J.39}$$

Multiplication on the left by $\prod_{j=1}^{d} f(q^jM)$ gives the first classical symbol $f(M)^d P_0(M,-L)$. The meridian divisor and shift sign are therefore retained before the formal cancellation.

The filtered theorem defines the selected critical value $S(t)$ using the original phase and the insertion

$$\sum_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} [2J(x_e) - J(x_e+t) - J(x_e-t)] + \frac{\pi i a(D)}{2} t^2. \tag{J.40}$$

Its expansion has coefficient of order $N^{-r}$ of degree at most $r+1$ in $s$. The top-degree coefficients come from $S$; lower Gaussian amplitudes cannot change them. With $\mathcal{S}(u) = \pi i[S(u/(\pi i)) - S(0)]$, the exact operator equation and this filtration give the formal domain identity

$$f(e^u)^d P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{J.41}$$

The full argument, including injectivity of the substitution $u = hs$, is in the all-circle operator proof, Section I.11.3. That argument depends on the filtered source expansion and the exact gauge, not on the absence of bare vertices. The nonzero series $f(e^u)^d$ can be cancelled in this proved integral domain identity.

The new geometric input identifies its entire selected germ:

$$-e^{\mathcal{S}'(\log M)} = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)} = L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M). \tag{J.42}$$

The zero-circle elimination above preserves the whole critical-value germ and the original physical-edge set. Its ordered boundary-group anchor identifies the original filled geometric representation. The preferred-longitude sign is fixed at that filled knot point. Thus (J.42) is not inferred from the cusp tangent or from a choice among unmarked exponentiated solutions.

It follows that $P_0$ vanishes on the geometric eigenvalue germ. Its Laurent evaluation kernel is a nonzero prime and contains no nonzero polynomial in $M$ alone, because $M$ varies. It is therefore a height-one prime in a Laurent polynomial unique factorization domain, proving (J.36).

If the operator coefficients lie in $\mathbb{Q}(q,M)$, contract that same germ prime to $\mathbb{Q}[M^{\pm1}, L^{\pm1}]$. Its irreducible generator divides the rational symbol. Its complex factorization contains the selected geometric factor and any conjugate factors required over $\mathbb{Q}$; an individual complex component need not itself be defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

## J.9 Transfer to presentations with net twists and arbitrary closures

The conclusion is intrinsic to the zero-framed knot with its marked peripheral curves. Suppose the ordered net-twist reduction gives an actual ambient isotopy from the input knot to a strict knot presentation covered by Section J.8. The isotopy carries the knot orientation, meridian,

preferred zero-linking longitude and cut mark. Correcting any transported ribbon framing to zero gives exactly the same reduced ADO function $F_N(M)$ at every level and every meridian value where it is defined. Its rational continuation is therefore the same function as well.

The geometric eigenvalue germ is also the same under this marked isotopy. An actual all-level operator for the input family thus satisfies the hypotheses of Section J.8 for that same intrinsic family. Its first classical symbol contains the selected geometric factor. This transfers the factor statement without identifying presentation-specific recurrence formulas or their unreduced polynomial representatives.

The same argument applies to the arbitrary-closure reduction when its hypotheses yield one covered strict knot factor and only unknot factors. In particular, under its long surviving-factor hypotheses, a hyperbolic knot input has exactly that form. Removing the exhibited unknot summands is an actual orientation-preserving ambient isotopy. The preferred peripheral pair is carried by the induced map of exteriors. No multiplicativity assertion for quantum growth over connected sums is required.

For a fixed original expression there are finitely many recorded reduction and parity branches. If a uniform net-weight statement is desired, take the maximum of the strict source and geometric thresholds over those finitely many possible strict outputs. The threshold concerns their surviving signed net powers. Large individual powers that cancel to a short surviving power do not satisfy it. This does not assert that an earlier, smaller complete-value threshold automatically supplies the stronger moving-meridian hypotheses.

The integer $a(D)$ and the individual edge factors in (J.42) are computed on the covered strict diagram. They are not claimed to equal those read from an unreduced input presentation term by term. The preferred geometric longitude and its selected irreducible factor are the intrinsic objects that transfer.

The conclusions concern one irreducible geometric factor, not the full A-polynomial, its multiplicity, or an equality of quantum operator ideals. They do not provide a fixed-$M$ large-level WKB theorem, nonvanishing through ordinary-color resonances, or a general short-twist theorem. The wider quantitative all-circle alternatives remain available under their own source and geometric hypotheses; this section neither narrows those results nor extends them to arbitrary short bare-junction fillings.

# Appendix K

# Volume limits from the degree and twist at each circle

Start with a fixed finite ordered tree of two-strand integer braids, with at least one edge and one crossing circle at every vertex. Turn each child tangle through its specified quarter-turn before stacking it at the parent, and use the original cylindrical closure. The literal construction and strand test retain the endpoint frames and require one closed main knot, with no component closed inside an intermediate tangle.

Write $d_v$ for the degree of vertex $v$, and $n_v$ for its signed number of half-twists. A sufficient condition for the volume limit is

$$\boxed{d_v \geq 2^{28} \quad \text{or} \quad |n_v| \geq 2^{27} \qquad \text{at every vertex.}}$$

The alternative can be chosen separately at each vertex. High-degree vertices may retain any fixed signed powers, including zero and small nonzero powers. If the strand test gives a knot $K$, its original complement is hyperbolic and

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K).$$

Both level parities are included. The tree, powers and degrees are fixed before $N$ tends to infinity. The constants are coarse sufficient bounds; they make no claim about the shortest possible twists.

The more general criterion below assigns a real-decay bound to each subtree polynomial. Dividing by that polynomial's exact value at zero retains its complex scalar and isolates the contribution of the next trace. Different edges may use different bounds. The final vertex has no outgoing polynomial, so it need not pay the extra loss needed to send one to a parent. This distinction also gives a short-power star outside both the earlier summed and uniform local tests.

Section K.8 explains how to retain arbitrarily many prescribed short powers: add an even stack of sufficiently long terminal tangles at every vertex of a fixed ordered knot core. Their endpoint pairing preserves the knot condition, although the resulting knot type can change. The proof estimates the actual finite invariant throughout; it does not assume that a proposed global critical point dominates.

## K.1 The directed criterion

Put

$$\begin{gathered} a_0 = \frac{1}{2\pi}, \qquad k_0 = 2^{-16}, \qquad R_0 = \frac{1}{8}, \qquad b_0 = 2^{-11}, \\ r_0 = \frac{1}{16}, \qquad t_0 = 2^{-14}, \qquad \chi = 1 - \cos r_0. \end{gathered} \tag{K.1}$$

The parent-variable rectangle is

$$\mathcal{R} = \{u : |\Re u| \le R_0,\ |\Im u| \le b_0\}. \tag{K.2}$$

Choose any vertex as root and direct all edges toward it. For every nonroot vertex choose a number

$$0 < c_v < k_0, \qquad \delta_v = \min\left\{\frac{b_0}{2}, \frac{c_v\chi}{4(1+c_v)}\right\}. \tag{K.3}$$

These are parameters of the criterion. They can differ at every edge. They are not asymptotic quantities to be inferred from the invariant.

Write $q_v = 1$ at a nonroot vertex and $q_v = 0$ at the root. If $\mathrm{Ch}(v)$ is the set of children, define

$$\begin{aligned} a_v &= \frac{d_v}{2\pi}, & b_v &= \frac{n_v}{2\pi}, & D_v &= a_v - ib_v, \\ A_v &= \frac{2}{\pi^2}\left(q_v k_0 + \frac{1}{2}\sum_{w\in\mathrm{Ch}(v)} c_w\right), & B_v &= 16q_v + |\mathrm{Ch}(v)|, & C_v &= B_v + \frac{b_v^2}{4A_v}. \end{aligned} \tag{K.4}$$

There is at least one incidence at every vertex, so $A_v, B_v$ are positive. Let

$$\delta_v^{\mathrm{in}} = \min\bigl(\{b_0\} \cup \{\delta_w : w \in \mathrm{Ch}(v)\}\bigr) \tag{K.5}$$

and set

$$y_v = \min\left\{\frac{\delta_v^{\mathrm{in}}}{2}, \frac{t_0|D_v|}{4C_v}, \frac{A_v\pi^2}{8(\pi|b_v| + t_0|D_v|)}, \sqrt{\frac{A_v\pi^2}{8B_v}}\right\}. \tag{K.6}$$

Finally define two action quantities

$$\beta_v = \frac{210}{361}\frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2}, \qquad \eta_v = \min\left\{\frac{1}{2}t_0|D_v|y_v, \frac{1}{2}A_v\pi^2, A_v r_0^2, \frac{1}{8}a_v r_0^2\right\}. \tag{K.7}$$

The criterion consists of the strict inequalities

$$\boxed{\ t_0|D_v| \ge 2, \qquad \beta_v < \frac{\eta_v}{2} \quad \text{at every vertex,}\ } \tag{K.8}$$

and, only at nonroot vertices,

$$\boxed{\ \beta_v < (k_0 - c_v)\chi.\ } \tag{K.9}$$

It is a finite elementary test in the degrees, signed powers, root and positive numbers $c_v$. It uses no value of an unknown quantum invariant and no assumed dominance of a global saddle. Its quantities are local: $A_v$ and the available strip depend on the child budgets, while the exact child scalar will be divided out rather than estimated.

Use the original reduced-state normalization $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$, $M = -q_N x = q_N^s$, and $F_N(1) = K_N$. The raw highest-weight parameter $x$ here is distinct from a normalized wire coordinate. The pointing theorem fixes this ADO invariant and its zero framing.

**Theorem.** If (K.3), (K.8), and (K.9) hold, the actual reduced state has

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{F_N(1)A_N(s)H_N(s)} = 1 + O_{\mathcal{T},\mathbf{n},R}(N^{-1}), \qquad |s| \le R < 1, \tag{K.10}$$

where

$$H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}, \qquad A_N(s) = q_N^{a(D)s^2/2}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v. \tag{K.11}$$

Its complete values are nonzero for all sufficiently large levels and

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K). \tag{K.12}$$

Both level parities and the original normal channels are retained. The proof identifies the same original filled critical value as the marked geometric completion. It does not use a sum of independent subtree volumes.

## K.2 An actual conditional kernel on a rectangle

The fixed Newton polynomials are

$$\begin{gathered} d = N-1, \qquad c_j = 2\cos((2j+1)\pi/N), \qquad S_k = \prod_{r=1}^{k} 2\sin(\pi r/N), \\ e_k(z) = S_k^{-2} \prod_{j<k} (c_j - z), \qquad 0 \le k < N. \end{gathered} \tag{K.13}$$

Let $\mathcal{T}_N(2\cos\theta) = 2\cos(N\theta)$, and put $P_\sigma(z) = \mathcal{T}_N(z) + 2\cos(2\pi\sigma)$. The normalized polynomial trace is

$$\phi_\sigma(F) = (-1)^d N^2 [z^d] \operatorname{rem}_{P_\sigma} F, \qquad \phi_\sigma(e_i e_j) = \mathbf{1}_{i+j=d}. \tag{K.14}$$

The remainder has degree less than $N$. This is the full polynomial functional, including its derivative values when roots coalesce. The typed turn theorem retains the paired factors

$$W_k(s) = \prod_{r=1}^{k} \left(1 - \frac{\sin^2(\pi s/N)}{\sin^2(\pi r/N)}\right). \tag{K.15}$$

After lowering the pairing (K.14), a physical turn gives the equal-index weight $\gamma_e(s)H_N(s)/W_k(s)$. The factor $\gamma_e$ is the original scalar prescribed by that edge's orientation type. It stays in the exact scalar ledger.

For the edge action write

$$\begin{aligned} J(x) &= \int_0^x \log(2\sin \pi v)\, dv, \qquad g(x) = J(2x) - 4J(x), \qquad G_0 = g(1/4), \\ b(x,t) &= \int_0^x \log(2\cos(2\pi v) + 2\cos t)\, dv - 2J(x), \\ \psi(t,u) &= \operatorname{stat}_x[b(x,t) + b(x,u)], \qquad \psi(0,0) = 2G_0. \end{aligned} \tag{K.16}$$

The logarithms and stationary branch are continued from $x = 1/4, t = u = 0$. The finite factorial interpolation, the actual edge contour and this phase are proved in the all-circle finite-sum theorem. Its polynomial estimates use the full Newton bounds. Use the exact full kernel

$$K_N(t,u;s) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t) e_k(-2\cos u) \frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}. \tag{K.17}$$

The definitions of $e_k, W_k$ and the fixed anti-diagonal trace metric are unchanged. It is a polynomial of degree at most $N-1$ in each of $-2\cos t$ and $-2\cos u$, hence has trigonometric degree at most $N-1$ in either angle. The paired factors and their inverses are bounded for fixed $|s| \le R < 1$. Every inequality below permits a polynomial factor in N.

The full-kernel real estimate is

$$|K_N(t,u;s)| \le C_R N^{A_R} e^{N\{2G_0 - k_0[(1-\cos t)+(1-\cos u)]\}}, \qquad t,u \in [-\pi,\pi]. \tag{K.18}$$

The new estimate needed here is

$$|K_N(t+iy,u;s)| \le C_R N^{A_R} e^{N\{\Re\psi(0,u) - k_0(1-\cos t) + 16y^2\}}, \quad u \in \mathcal{R}, \quad t \in [-\pi,\pi], \quad |y| \le b_0. \tag{K.19}$$

Thus the parent compact is a long, thin rectangle, rather than the old disk of radius $2^{-12}$. The constant term is the actual conditional phase $\psi(0,u)$, not its upper bound $2G_0 + O(|u|^2)$.

Here is a proof from the original finite kernel. Split the indices into $I = [1/5, 3/10]$ and its complement. The complementary full polynomial has the established single-edge loss $\eta_K = \pi/200$, including high indices and their complete derivatives. Its ellipse bound is

$$C_R N^{A_R} e^{N\{2G_0 - \eta_K + |y| + |\Im u|\}}. \tag{K.20}$$

The exact edge phase has, on the radius $1/4$ bidisk,

$$|\psi_{tt} + a_0| \le a_0/50, \quad |\psi_{uu} + a_0| \le a_0/50, \quad |\psi_{tu}| \le a_0/50, \quad \psi_t(0,u) = \psi_u(t,0) = 0. \tag{K.21}$$

In particular $|\psi(0,u) - 2G_0| \le |u|^2/10$. Hence (K.20) is smaller than (K.19): the sum $b_0 + b_0 + (R_0^2 + b_0^2)/10 + 2k_0$ is less than $\eta_K/2$. All these constants are independent of the tree.

For the retained indices write $u = a + ib$. Their factors at $a$ are positive. If $r_j = \cos(2\pi(j+1/2)/N)$, then $r_j > -1/3$ and $r_j + \cos a > 253/384$. Along $|a| \le 1/8$, $|b| \le 2^{-11}$, the denominator $r_j + \cos(a+ib)$ has modulus greater than $3/5$, and

$$\left|\frac{d^2}{du^2}\log(r_j+\cos u)\right| = \left|\frac{-r_j\cos u-1}{(r_j+\cos u)^2}\right| < 9. \tag{K.22}$$

The first derivative at real a is real. Integrating vertically therefore gives the actual finite-product estimate

$$|e_k(-2\cos(a+ib))| \le e_k(-2\cos a)e^{5Nb^2}, \qquad k/N \in I. \tag{K.23}$$

At the other end retain the original product bound

$$|e_k(-2\cos(t+iy))| \le e^2 e_k(-2)e^{N[-\alpha\sin^2(t/2)+11y^2]}, \qquad \alpha > 1/250. \tag{K.24}$$

The positive retained sum at $(0,a)$ is bounded by a polynomial times $\exp(N\psi(0,a))$, uniformly for real $|a| \le 1/8$. This is the original one-edge positive Laplace estimate: its unique critical wire is

$$\tan^2(\pi x) = \frac{1}{1+\tan^2(a/2)}, \tag{K.25}$$

which stays in the interior of $I$. Its second derivative stays negative on this fixed real compact. Equations (K.23)–(K.24), and the second bound in (K.21), consequently give

$$|K_{N,I}(t+iy,u;s)| \le C_R N^{A_R} e^{N\{\Re\psi(0,u)-\alpha\sin^2(t/2)+11y^2+6b^2\}}. \tag{K.26}$$

For $|t| \ge 1/8$,

$$6b_0^2 < \frac{\alpha}{2}\sin^2(1/16), \qquad 2k_0 < \alpha/2. \tag{K.27}$$

For example $\sin(1/16) > 1/(8\pi)$, $\pi^2 < 10$ and $\alpha > 1/250$ already prove the first inequality. This proves (K.19) in this range.

For $|t| \le 1/8$, the canonical wire contour gives the exact nonzero edge asymptotic on the $1/4$ bidisk. Both $u$ and $t+iy$ lie strictly inside that disk. Integrating the first bound of (K.21) gives (K.19) there. The original lattice currents and (K.20) are exponentially smaller. In particular the full kernel, uniformly on this smaller rectangle product, retains

$$K_N(t,u;s) = N^{-3/2}a_e(t,u)e^{N\psi(t,u)}(1+O_R(N^{-1})), \tag{K.28}$$

with the original nonzero holomorphic leading amplitude and midpoint normalization. The outside physical edge gamma is not included in $a_e$.

## K.3 The exact recursion may be rooted anywhere

Lower the fixed Frobenius pairing at every vertex of the original closed source. Every physical turn then identifies equal Newton indices and retains its factor $\gamma_e H_N/W_k$. The resulting finite scalar is a sum over the original edge indices of a product of the original vertex trace tensors. Choosing a root merely specifies the order of these finite contractions. It does not move a cut through a tangle, commute open operators or change a framing.

Consequently the exact recursions hold for any chosen root:

$$M_{v,N}(u) = \gamma_{e_v}(s)\,\mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_v,\sigma_v,N}\left[K_N(t,u;s)\prod_{w\in \mathrm{Ch}(v)} M_{w,N}(t)\right] \tag{K.29}$$

at a nonroot vertex, and

$$Z_N = \mathcal{D}^{(t)}_{n_o,\sigma_o,N}\left[\prod_{w\in \mathrm{Ch}(o)} M_{w,N}(t)\right] \tag{K.30}$$

at the root. The original global closing, framing and reference factors, and the original single reduced cut $H_N$, remain outside (K.30). Edge gammas are counted once. The exact normal value $\sigma_v = 0$ and the moving values $\pm s$ retain their actual orientation types.

Each message is an even trigonometric polynomial of degree at most $N-1$ in $u$, regardless of the subtree. There is no discarded-source error in (K.29)–(K.30).

## K.4 The phase class and the variable envelopes

The inductive analytic class is

$$h_v(0) = h_v'(0) = 0, \qquad h_v(-u) = h_v(u), \qquad |h_v''(u) + a_0| \le a_0/20, \quad u \in \mathcal{R}. \tag{K.31}$$

The leading normalized amplitude $\alpha_v(u)/\alpha_v(0)$ is holomorphic and nonzero on a neighborhood of the required smaller compact. Exact subtree constants are retained:

$$\frac{M_{v,N}(u)}{M_{v,N}(0)} = \frac{\alpha_v(u)}{\alpha_v(0)} e^{Nh_v(u)}(1 + O(N^{-1})), \quad u \in \mathcal{R}. \tag{K.32}$$

As usual a slightly smaller rectangle can be used for fixed derivative estimates; the strict margins permit an initially slightly larger one.

The global assertions attached to $c_v$ are

$$\left|\frac{M_{v,N}(t)}{M_{v,N}(0)}\right| \le CN^A e^{-Nc_v(1-\cos t)}, \quad t \in [-\pi,\pi], \tag{K.33}$$

$$\left|\frac{M_{v,N}(t+iy)}{M_{v,N}(0)}\right| \le CN^A e^{N[-(c_v/2)(1-\cos t)+y^2]}, \quad |y| \le \delta_v. \tag{K.34}$$

The real sup norm, full canonical polynomial norm and complete derivative norm differ by polynomial factors at the required fixed multiples of N. No estimate drops the repeated-root normal data.

For completeness, (K.34) follows from (K.32)–(K.33) and exact degree. The Poisson estimate for a Laurent polynomial of degree less than $N$ is

$$|M_{v,N}(t+iy)/M_{v,N}(0)| \le CN^A e^{N[-c_v(1-\cos t)+(1+c_v)|y|]}. \tag{K.35}$$

For $|t| \ge r_0$ use (K.3). For $|t| < r_0$ use the rectangle expansion and

$$\Re h_v(t+iy) \le -\frac{19a_0}{40}t^2 + \frac{21a_0}{40}y^2. \tag{K.36}$$

Both arguments give (K.34), without a conjectured quadratic estimate for an individual high Newton basis element.

Assume the children satisfy (K.31)–(K.34). At a nonroot vertex set

$$A_v^{\mathrm{loc}}(t,u)=\psi(t,u)+\sum_w h_w(t),\quad C_{v,\ell}(u)=\mathrm{stat}_t\{A_v^{\mathrm{loc}}(t,u)+ib_vt^2/2-i\ell t\}. \tag{K.37}$$

At the root omit $\psi$ and $u$. There are $d_v$ incidences in $t$. Hence

$$A_v^{\mathrm{loc}}(t,u)=\psi(0,u)-a_vt^2/2+E_v(t,u),\quad |E_{v,tt}|,\ |E_{v,t}/t|\le a_v/20. \tag{K.38}$$

The root constant in this formula is zero. For $0\le\ell\le L_v=\lfloor t_0|D_v|\rfloor$ the equation $D_vt=-i\ell+E_{v,t}$ contracts in $|t|\le b_0$. Indeed $t_0+b_0/20<b_0$. The actual solutions lie in the smaller disk $|t|\le t_0/(19/20)$, leaving room for the translated contours.

The same elementary calculation as in the original proof gives

$$\frac{380}{441}\frac{\ell a_v}{|D_v|^2}\le-\Im t_{v,\ell}\le\frac{420}{361}\frac{\ell a_v}{|D_v|^2}, \tag{K.39}$$

also for complex parent $u$. No child phase is asserted to be real on the real axis. Its nonlinear derivative is $t$ times a function bounded by $a_v/20$, so the real part of the denominator remains positive.

The normalized phase $h_v=C_{v,1}(u)-C_{v,1}(0)$ satisfies

$$h_v'=\psi_u(t_{v,1},u),\qquad h_v''=\psi_{uu}-\frac{\psi_{ut}^2}{A_{v,tt}^{\mathrm{loc}}+ib_v}. \tag{K.40}$$

Using (K.21) and $|A_{v,tt}^{\mathrm{loc}}+ib_v|\ge(19/20)|D_v|\ge(19/20)a_0$ proves (K.31), since $1/50+20/(19\cdot 2500)<1/20$. This is uniform on the rectangle. Charge ordering and the current-vertex drop are

$$\Re C_{v,\ell}(u)\le\Re C_{v,1}(u)-\frac{190}{441}\frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2}(\ell^2-1),\quad 0\le\Re\psi(0,u)-\Re C_{v,1}(u)\le\beta_v. \tag{K.41}$$

At the root again replace $\psi(0,u)$ by zero.

## K.5 Actual trace tails with the directed budgets

Divide every child by its exact nonzero value $M_{w,N}(0)$. The induction uses those complex constants exactly; it never estimates them by their complete-source magnitudes. Equations (K.19) and (K.34) imply

$$|\text{normalized trace input}(t+iy,u)|\le CN^Ae^{N[\Re\psi(0,u)-A_vt^2+B_vy^2]},\quad |y|\le\delta_v^{\mathrm{in}}. \tag{K.42}$$

The root constant is zero. The factor $2/\pi^2$ in (K.4) is exactly the inequality $1-\cos t\ge 2t^2/\pi^2$ on the original interval.

The exact finite translated-grid trace, with its endpoint currents, has charge coefficients

$$c_{\ell,N}(\sigma) = (-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)} U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma), \qquad c_{1,N} = 1. \tag{K.43}$$

For $\ell > L_v$, moving the single-grid rectangle by $y_v$ costs, after maximizing the chirp term in the real variable, at most $C_v y_v^2$. Since $\ell > L_v$ implies $\ell > t_0|D_v|$, (K.6) gives a tail loss at least

$$t_0|D_v|y_v - C_v y_v^2 \geq \frac{1}{2} t_0|D_v|y_v. \tag{K.44}$$

Successive charges have the additional factor $\exp(-Ny_v)$. The exact fixed-compact growth of (K.43) is absorbed for all sufficiently large N. This starting level may depend on the fixed vertex.

At an original endpoint $\pm\pi$, the chirp and finite-charge connectors cost at most

$$(\pi|b_v| + t_0|D_v|)y_v + B_v y_v^2 \leq A_v \pi^2/4. \tag{K.45}$$

Thus their loss is at least $A_v\pi^2/2$. This includes the original zero-mode current. Nothing is inferred by dropping the endpoint terms of the nonperiodic chirp.

For a retained charge, restrict its real integral to $[-r_0, r_0]$. Its complement loses $A_v r_0^2$ by (K.42). Translate the retained interval to $\Im t_{v,\ell}$. Its endpoints remain in the analytic rectangle. The original local Young inequality, now on this larger real interval, is

$$\begin{aligned} \Re\{A_v^{\mathrm{loc}}(t - iz, u) + ib_v(t - iz)^2/2 - i\ell(t - iz)\} \leq \Re\psi(0, u) - a_v t^2/8 \\ + \left[\frac{21}{40} a_v + \frac{2b_v^2}{(14/5)a_v}\right] z^2 - \ell z. \end{aligned} \tag{K.46}$$

For $0 \leq z \leq -\Im t_{v,\ell}$, the last line after its quadratic term is at most $-\ell z/8$, since $(420/361)\max(21/40, 5/7) = 300/361 < 7/8$. Every such connector therefore loses at least $a_v r_0^2/8$. The translated horizontal saddle has negative real quadratic part at most $-(19/20)a_v$. The physical sine factor is nonzero at $t_{v,\ell}$.

Equations (K.44)–(K.46) give an error of at most $CN^A \exp N[\Re\psi(0, u) - \eta_v]$. Nonminimal charges are their saddle terms plus this absolute error; no relative approximation is asserted at a much lower nonminimal action. Conditions (K.8) and (K.41) put the whole conditional error strictly below the first charge. Equation (K.43) gives its nonzero coefficient for both parities. This establishes (K.32) and nonvanishing of the exact $M_{v,N}(0)$.

For the child inputs, their exact analytic logarithms differ from the limiting phases by $O(N^{-1})$, with fixed derivatives on the required smaller compact. The finite product of those corrections is retained in the amplitude, or moves the saddle by $O(N^{-1})$. As the tree is fixed, it spends no new exponential budget. The leading amplitude is a product of nonzero edge, child and Gaussian factors. All N-dependent physical crossing and carrier phases remain in $M_{v,N}(0)$; its normalized leading amplitude does not conceal such phases.

The full physical trace and the first-charge approximation are holomorphic in the formal meridian variables. As in the original proof, first take parameter circles avoiding collisions and then apply the maximum principle to their whole difference. This covers every actual $\sigma_v = 0, \pm s$, including normal limits. No isolated divided current is declared removable without its companions.

## K.6 Regenerating the outgoing real bound

The canonical polynomial bounds, equations (D9)–(D14), retain the full source. For real $u$, (K.18), the polynomial real sup bounds of the normalized children, the actual fixed-power crossing polynomial, Chebyshev folding in the correct quotient, and the full top-coefficient functional give

$$|M_{v,N}(u)| \le CN^A \left| \prod_w M_{w,N}(0) \right| e^{N[2G_0 - k_0(1-\cos u)]}. \tag{K.47}$$

This retains repeated-root derivatives and all fixed normals. Dividing by the nonzero first-charge value at zero costs at most $\beta_v$. For $|u| \ge r_0$, (K.9) absorbs that cost and yields (K.33). For $|u| < r_0$, (K.32) and (K.36) give the stronger estimate, since $c_v < k_0 \ll 19a_0/20$. Equation (K.34) follows by Section K.4. Thus the induction closes with the selected directed budgets, rather than a common decay constant.

There is no outgoing real bound at the final root. Imposing (K.9) there would be an unnecessary restriction. Its only normalization comparison is the conditional trace estimate (K.8).

## K.7 Original action, geometry, and scope

Restore the exact subtree constants successively. Stationary elimination in (K.37) gives the original joint equations

$$\sum_{e \sim v} \psi_{e,\tau_v} + \frac{i n_v \tau_v}{2\pi} = i. \tag{K.48}$$

The constants telescope to the original critical value

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1}) = \operatorname{stat}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \left[ \sum_e \psi_e + \frac{i}{4\pi} \sum_v n_v \tau_v^2 - i \sum_v \tau_v \right]. \tag{K.49}$$

Back-substitute from the final root: its first-charge angle belongs to the rectangle, so each child's selected parent value does also, and the same statement continues down the finite tree. Every restored angle has modulus at most $1/[(19/20)|D_v|]$. Thus the vector satisfying (K.48) lies inside the full simultaneous small-angular uniqueness polydisk, not just the conditional disks used during elimination. The existing contraction identifies it with the same branch as the marked positive charge path. Indeed (K.8) implies

$$\sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} = 2\pi |D_v| \ge 2\pi\, 2^{15} > 630. \tag{K.50}$$

The vertexwise geometric theorem applies with no sum condition. Its original ordered two-octahedron cut, odd seam, primitive periods and calibrated action identify $2\pi \Re \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{1})$ with the volume of the actual filled knot complement. This is a geometric input, not a deduction from the quantum saddle alone.

There are $|E|$ edge Gaussians $N^{-3/2}$ and $|V|$ trace Gaussians $N^{3/2}$; $|V| = |E| + 1$ leaves the original $N^{3/2}$ power with nonzero amplitude. The exact first Fourier coefficient is one. The retained edge insertion has leading value one, and the scalar ledger remains precisely (K.11). This proves (K.10)–(K.12), with the original peripheral and framing factors.

The criterion allows different strip and real-decay budgets and a different choice of final vertex. It is not the assertion that arbitrary capped short-twist islands can be substituted as black-box messages. Such an island requires a multi-boundary version of the conditional normalization proved here for an actual edge. The pointwise source estimates on the older tiny disk alone do not supply that extension.

## K.8 A uniform twist corollary, with no degree sampling

The directed criterion has the following simple consequence:

$$|n_v| \geq 2^{27} \quad \text{at every vertex} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad (10)\text{–}(12). \tag{K.51}$$

This sufficient constant is independent of the number of vertices, their degrees and the choice of root. Here is a proof covering all degrees simultaneously. Choose $c_v = k_0/2$ at every nonroot vertex and write $\delta$ for their common value in (K.3). The elementary cosine estimate gives

$$\chi \geq \frac{r_0^2}{2} - \frac{r_0^4}{24} = 2^{-9}\frac{3071}{3072} > 2^{-10}, \qquad \delta > 2^{-30}. \tag{K.52}$$

At any vertex, including the root, put $\mathcal{R}_v = \sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2}$. Then

$$A_v \geq \frac{k_0 d_v}{2\pi^2}, \qquad B_v \leq 16 d_v, \qquad C_v \leq \frac{\mathcal{R}_v^2}{8 k_0 d_v}. \tag{K.53}$$

For the last inequality use $16 \leq 1/(8k_0)$. Each of the four branches of the minimum in (K.6) consequently has the following lower bound, respectively:

$$\frac{\delta}{2}, \qquad \frac{t_0 k_0 d_v}{\pi \mathcal{R}_v}, \qquad \frac{k_0 d_v}{16 \mathcal{R}_v}, \qquad 2^{-12}. \tag{K.54}$$

The second displayed quantity is smaller than the third and fourth. For the third bound, use $\pi|b_v| + t_0|D_v| \leq \mathcal{R}_v(1 + t_0/\pi)/2$. Thus every branch of (K.7), not just its tail branch, is bounded below by

$$\eta_v \geq \min\left\{ \frac{t_0 \mathcal{R}_v \delta}{8\pi}, \frac{t_0^2 k_0 d_v}{4\pi^2} \right\}. \tag{K.55}$$

Indeed the second entry here is smaller than each of the other three entries in (K.7), by their explicit values and $t_0 \ll r_0$. On the other hand

$$\beta_v = \frac{420\pi}{361}\frac{d_v}{\mathcal{R}_v^2} < \frac{4 d_v}{\mathcal{R}_v^2}. \tag{K.56}$$

For comparison with half the first entry of (K.55), it suffices that $\mathcal{R}_v^2 > 64\pi/(t_0\delta)$, since $d_v \leq \mathcal{R}_v$. The right side is less than $2^{52}$, using $\pi < 4$ and (K.52). For comparison with half the second entry it suffices that $\mathcal{R}_v^2 > 32\pi^2/(t_0^2 k_0)$, whose right side is less than $2^{53}$, since $\pi^2 < 10$. Both inequalities follow strictly from $\mathcal{R}_v^2 \geq n_v^2 \geq 2^{54}$. The charge-cut condition in (K.8) follows as well.

For the outgoing patch, the sharper elementary estimate is

$$\beta_v \le \frac{210\pi}{361|n_v|} \le \frac{330}{361}\,2^{-26} < \frac{3071}{3072}\,2^{-26} \le \frac{k_0}{2}\chi. \tag{K.57}$$

Here $\pi < 22/7$, $d_v/(d_v^2+n_v^2) \le 1/(2|n_v|)$, and the displayed rational comparison prove (K.9) for every degree. This completes the corollary without a numerical scan or a threshold depending on the tree.

The same proof gives a mixed condition, chosen independently at each vertex:

$$\boxed{d_v \ge 2^{28} \quad \text{or} \quad |n_v| \ge 2^{27} \qquad \text{for every } v.} \tag{K.58}$$

Under the degree alternative, $\mathcal{R}_v^2 \ge d_v^2 \ge 2^{56}$ proves the same two tail comparisons, while

$$\beta_v \le \frac{420\pi}{361 d_v} \le \frac{330}{361}\,2^{-26} < \frac{k_0}{2}\chi \tag{K.59}$$

is the same outgoing patch bound. Neither alternative needs to hold uniformly over all vertices. In particular, the high-degree vertices may retain any fixed signed powers, including zero and small nonzero powers. No sum over the number of such vertices occurs.

Here is a precise extension construction illustrating that freedom. Start with any fixed ordered circle-tree core whose original endpoint pairing closes to a knot and has no internal closed component. Retain all its fixed signed powers. At every core vertex choose one of its actual product slots next to its crossing box and insert a consecutive stack of an even number $B \ge 2^{28}$ of new terminal pieces. Every new leaf has a fixed odd power satisfying

$$|n_{\mathrm{leaf}}| \ge 2^{27} + 1. \tag{K.60}$$

The physical quarter-turn of an odd two-strand braid has diagonal pairing $X = \{02, 13\}$; this pairing is invariant under the quarter-turn. An even ordered stack of these leaves has the through pairing $I = \{03, 12\}$ and creates no internal circle. Inserting it in the specified slot therefore preserves the original local endpoint pairing in that actual frame. This is a pairing calculation, not an isotopy removing the new tangles. At the original closing box the same insertion takes place inside its local ball. An added terminal leaf may then be chosen as the recursive root using the original closed-collar move with its induced frame reversal and factor order retained.

Thus the resulting diagram is again a knot, while its knot type may change. Each old vertex now satisfies the degree alternative and each new leaf satisfies the twist alternative in (K.58). The resulting actual knot complement is hyperbolic and satisfies (K.10)–(K.12). The number and arrangement of prescribed short-power vertices are arbitrary but fixed; the number $B$ does not depend on their total count.

The upper drawing is a tree of tangle operations, not a knot projection. Only one added pair is drawn at each original vertex. The construction inserts $B/2$ consecutive pairs in one specified product slot, retaining the original cyclic order; $B \ge 2^{28}$ is even. Each added leaf has odd $|m| \ge 2^{27}+1$, and every tree edge applies the physical quarter-turn $T$. The lower drawing forgets crossings and shows the literal endpoint pairings: two diagonal pairings compose to the through pairing. It does not claim that the new braids can be removed by an isotopy.

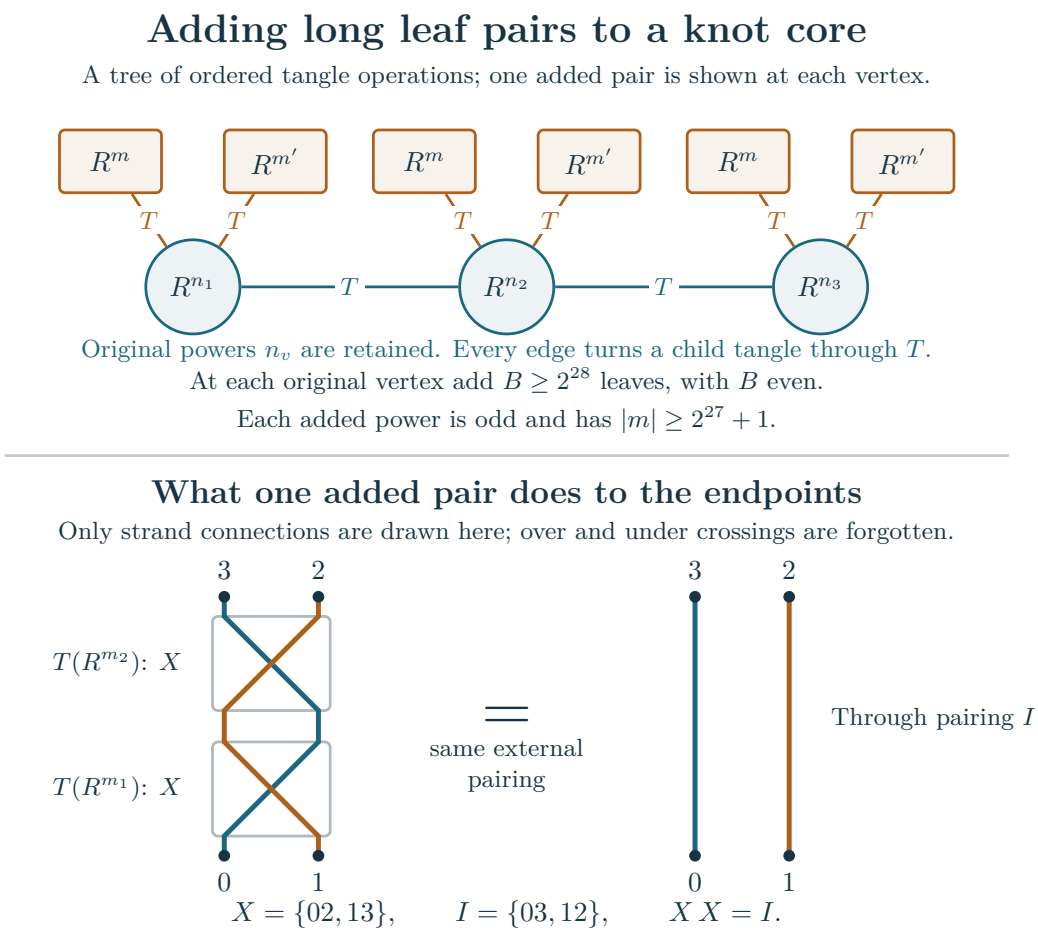



Figure K.1: An even stack of added odd terminal tangles preserves the core's endpoint pairing.

## K.9 A star beyond both previous quantitative tests

Consider an ordered star rooted at its central vertex, of odd degree $d = 30{,}000{,}001$. Set its power to 2 and every terminal power to the fixed odd integer $2^{60} + 1$. Choose $c_v = k_0/2$ on every leaf.

The knot pairing can be checked in the original terminal-root syntax, even though the finite contraction is evaluated from the center. Label the boundary points lower left, lower right, upper right, upper left by $0, 1, 2, 3$. The even and odd braid pairings are respectively

$$I = \{03, 12\}, \qquad X = \{02, 13\}; \qquad T(I) = H = \{01, 23\}, \quad T(X) = X. \tag{K.61}$$

At a terminal root there are $d - 1$ other leaves. Their turned odd braids have pairing $X$; their ordered product has pairing $I$ because $d - 1$ is even. The central power 2 preserves it. Its actual quarter-turn has pairing $H$, and stacking the root's odd braid against $H$ still gives $H$, with no internal closed arc. Cylindrical closure joins 03 and 12, so it closes $H$ into one component. All intermediate products before that last stack are two through-strand braids. There is no hidden internal component.

The criterion can be verified by rational enclosures without expanding this large tree. All leaves have the same data. The center has approximately

$$\beta_o = 1.219\,10^{-7}, \qquad \eta_o = 2.713\,10^{-7}, \qquad \frac{\beta_o}{\eta_o/2} < 0.9. \tag{K.62}$$

Every leaf has a much smaller ratio. The root does not satisfy the nonroot patch inequality for any $c > 0$, because $\beta_o > k_0\chi$. Nevertheless its exact final trace satisfies (K.8). Thus that outgoing patch must not be charged to a root that sends no message.

Moreover

$$\sum_v \frac{d_v}{d_v^2 + n_v^2} > \frac{30,000,001}{30,000,001^2 + 4} > 2^{-25}, \tag{K.63}$$

and its maximum is far above $2^{-120}$. The example therefore lies beyond both published quantitative alternatives. Its size and all its powers are fixed; it is not an N-growing family. The constant sizes are coarse, and no optimality assertion is intended.

Here are rational enclosures proving the inequalities rather than inferring them from those decimal values. Put

$$\pi_- = 3, \quad \pi_+ = 22/7, \quad c = k_0/2, \quad \chi_- = r_0^2/2 - r_0^4/24, \quad \delta_- = \frac{c\chi_-}{4(1+c)}. \tag{K.64}$$

At the central vertex use the conservative height $y_* = \delta_-/2$. It is at most each branch of (K.6). For example, with

$$D_- = \frac{d}{2\pi_+}, \quad D_+ = \frac{d+1}{2\pi_-}, \quad A_- = \frac{dc}{\pi_+^2}, \quad C_+ = d + \frac{\pi_-^{-2}}{4A_-}, \tag{K.65}$$

the three non-strip comparisons are

$$y_* < \frac{t_0 D_-}{4C_+}, \qquad y_* < \frac{dc}{8(1+t_0 D_+)}, \qquad y_*^2 < \frac{c}{8}. \tag{K.66}$$

The strip comparison follows from $\delta \geq \delta_-$. Every quantity in (K.64)–(K.66) is rational. Direct cross-multiplication also gives

$$\frac{2[420\pi_+ d/(361(d^2+4))]}{t_0 D_- y_*/2} < \frac{9}{10}, \qquad 2\frac{420\pi_+ d}{361(d^2+4)} < \min\left\{\frac{dc}{2},\ A_- r_0^2, \frac{D_- r_0^2}{8}\right\}. \tag{K.67}$$

These compare the upper bound for twice the first-charge drop with all four lower bounds for $\eta_o$. The charge cutoff is greater than two.

For a leaf with $n = 2^{60}+1$, take $y_* = t_0 k_0/(2n)$. The same direct rational comparisons, using $D_- = n/(2\pi_+)$, $D_+ = (n+1)/(2\pi_-)$, $A_- = 2k_0/\pi_+^2$, and $C_+ = 16 + [n/(2\pi_-)]^2/(4A_-)$, put this height below each branch of (K.6). They give a lower bound greater than $2^{-49}$ for every entry of (K.7), while $\beta_v < 2^{-117}$. The outgoing patch follows from $\beta_v < (k_0/2)\chi_-$. This proves the leaf inequalities.

## K.10 Reproducing the finite arithmetic and pairings

From the repository root run:

```
python3 experiments/audit_actual_all_circle_directed_volume.py
```

The script writes its results. An optional –output selects a different JSON file. It uses exact rational arithmetic for the constant inequalities, the all-degree corollaries and the star enclosures. It also constructs the literal four-endpoint pairings and checks the composition and closure identities used above.

Those are finite checks, not numerical evidence for the asymptotic theorem. The proof of the full invariant estimates is the conditional kernel and trace induction in sections K.2–K.7. The earlier exact tree-message reproduction independently compares canonical quotient contractions with root-grid and complete first-normal traces; the present argument retains those same finite identities.

# Appendix L

# Proof of balanced terminal decoration

A crossing circle surrounds two strands and bounds their twice-punctured disk. A terminal decoration inserts another such two-strand piece in an actual product collar on one side of an original crossing disk. The original diagram may have arbitrary cycles; it is not required to be built from a tree of two-strand products.

The starting condition is combinatorial: the actual connected augmented diagram has a simple triangulated white sphere, with its recorded crossing-disk matching and cyclic orders. The proof constructs its positive right-angled geometry, then adds the terminal pieces so that one shared complete circle packing controls every sector of the original quantum source. All data are fixed before the level tends to infinity.

## L.1 The theorem and its quantifiers

A strand edge is an edge of the white triangulation not used in its crossing-disk matching. Let $D$ be a fixed connected augmented link diagram with the following data.

- Its white triangulation is a simple triangulated sphere, with the original perfect matching of dual triangles and four distinct white vertices at each matched quadrilateral.
- Its simple white sphere has at least four vertices; the positive geometric certificate is constructed below, not imposed separately.
- A strand edge, is marked. The associated two protected white curvatures are zero in the actual marked complete packing.
- The cyclic order, original half-twist frame and disk-framed meridian/longitude at every crossing circle are fixed.
- A parity vector for the original boxes makes their filled main strands a knot, with no internally closed extra component.

There is a finite literal terminal decoration $\widehat{D}$ of this diagram with even numbers of new terminal pieces on both sides of each original box such that:

1. The original endpoint pairing and knot condition are preserved when each new terminal power is odd.

2. The refined white sphere is simple, has its actual positive cut certificate, and its one marked complete packing satisfies the strict complete-radius balance inequalities at every old and new crossing circle.

3. There is a threshold $T(\widehat{D})$ such that, for every fixed integer filling vector $p$ with all $|p_e| \geq T(\widehat{D})$, independently in sign and size, and the recorded retained half twists $\epsilon_e \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$, the actual powers $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$ produce a hyperbolic knot $K_p$ and

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |K_N(K_p)| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_p). \tag{L.1}$$

Here $K_N$ is the original zero-framed reduced complete-color invariant at $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$, with its recorded enhanced component convention. Both parities of $N$ occur. The same logarithmic conclusion holds in the specified full one-cut modified convention after retaining its known polynomial-level conversion.

The diagram, decorations and signed powers are fixed before $N$. The threshold may depend on the whole decorated diagram; there is no uniform bound over all cores or a growing-diagram limit. The core's original powers are also filled sufficiently long in this theorem. The result is not an assertion for arbitrary short fillings of the core. The decorated knot generally differs from the core knot.

## L.2 A simple sphere supplies the actual metric

### L.2.1 A combinatorial starting hypothesis

It is enough to start with an actual connected marked augmented diagram whose white cellulation is a simple triangulated sphere with at least four vertices. The matching pairs, cyclic orders and marked strand edge are those of its projection/crossing-disk cut. A positive geometric certificate need not be supplied independently.

The following construction gives the packing, embedding and supporting halfspaces explicitly, with the calibrated entropy of the simple-block capacity proof. Remove one triangular face $abc$, prescribe positive radii at its three vertices, and let $v$ be the number of remaining interior vertices. The disk has $2v + 1$ triangles. Give every interior vertex angle demand $2\pi$, and pool the three boundary vertices into one destination with demand $\pi$, retaining the separate boundary corners.

A nonempty interior subset $S$ touches at least $2|S| + 1$ disk triangles. To see this, puncture the sphere at a vertex of $S$. The complementary simple planar graph on the other interior vertices $T$ and $a, b, c$ has at most $2|T| + 1$ bounded triangular faces. One is the removed face, so at most $2|T|$ of the disk's triangles avoid $S$. A proper subset containing the pooled boundary destination has strict slack too: its complement consists only of interior vertices $T$, and at most $2|T| - 5$ triangles are wholly supported there when $|T| \geq 3$, with none when $|T| \leq 2$. The full set has equal supply and demand. The finite transport Hall inequalities are therefore strict for every nonempty proper destination subset. Subtracting a sufficiently small positive

allocation at every corner preserves feasibility of the remaining transport system. Thus a strictly positive angle assignment exists.

For an angle triple of sum $\pi$, use

$$\mathcal{V}(\theta) = 2\sum_{j=1}^{3}[\Lambda(\theta_j/2) + \Lambda((\pi-\theta_j)/2)], \qquad \Lambda(t) = -\int_0^t \log|2\sin u|\,du. \tag{L.2}$$

Its corner derivative is $-\log\tan(\theta_j/2)$, and its one-corner endpoint value is zero. Maximize the sum of these calibrated triangle entropies, with the fixed boundary linear terms $\theta_f \log(1/r_f)$. Their derivative $-\log\tan(\theta/2)$ diverges positively at a new zero corner. Moving toward the strictly positive assignment excludes a boundary maximum. Strict concavity gives one interior maximum. Its multipliers satisfy

$$\tan(\theta_{tf}/2) = k_t l_f, \qquad k_t = \left(\sum_{f<g\in t} l_f l_g\right)^{-1/2}, \qquad l_f = 1/r_f > 0. \tag{L.3}$$

The boundary multipliers are the prescribed inverse radii, up to the one common scale absorbed in the row multipliers. The three boundary angle sums are positive and total $\pi$, hence each is less than $\pi$.

For each triangle glue the Euclidean center triangle with side lengths $r_f + r_g$. Its angles are exactly (L.3). The total angle at every interior vertex is $2\pi$; continuation around that vertex fixes its center and rotates by $2\pi$, so has zero translational as well as rotational holonomy. These loops generate the punctured disk's holonomy. The development is therefore globally defined. Its boundary is the convex triangle with the prescribed three side lengths, traversed once. For a point away from the developed edges, the number of preimages is its boundary winding number: one inside and zero outside. Local injectivity extends this across edges and vertices. The development is an embedding.

Place the radius-$r_f$ disk at each developed center. In one center triangle the opposite center edge is covered by its two vertex disks, both disjoint from the third disk. Their mutual contact lies strictly outside the third disk, and its two contacts with those disks occur on the other two center edges. Thus the third disk's sector stops strictly before the opposite edge. The sectors assemble to full disks at interior vertices and to the prescribed boundary-disk sectors. This proves disjoint interiors and excludes unintended contacts, including across separating triangles.

The circle through a center triangle's three tangency points is its incircle: its contact distance along a center edge is exactly the corresponding radius. It is orthogonal to the three vertex circles. Its disk contains no other packing contact. On the omitted outer triangle choose the opposite side of its contact circle; all interior contacts lie in its bounded curvilinear gap. The resulting white and shaded supporting halfspaces contain every contact, strictly unless incident. Their exposed faces form the full closed labeled sphere, so the convex hull has exactly those facets and no additional face. Every ideal vertex has alternating white/shaded faces and successive right angles. This constructs the required convex ideal right-angled polyhedron. The proof did not use a height ordering or a flat plat.

Sending any chosen strand contact to infinity turns its adjacent white circles into two parallel marked lines. Every other disk is finite in their common strip. Thus the required marked complete packing follows from the finite combinatorial starting hypothesis.

## L.3 The original link and a knot parity

### L.3.1 From a matched sphere to an actual knot diagram

Conversely begin with any finite oriented simple triangulated sphere with at least four vertices and a chosen perfect matching of its cubic dual. Two matched triangles share one edge, have distinct third vertices, and form an embedded quadrilateral with four distinct boundary vertices. Choose disjoint small neighborhoods of the matched dual edges and their endpoints. Contracting these disks gives a connected planar four-valent graph. At each disk use the original ordered untwisted pairing $(0,1),(2,3)$; join the outside terminals by the embedded nonmatching dual edges. Put the standard perpendicular crossing circle in a disjoint three-ball neighborhood of each disk. This constructs an augmented link in $S^3$, with exactly the prescribed cut graph and disk frames.

Choose a regular height after straightening each local box in its orientation-preserving frame. The outside arcs give finitely many ordinary cups and caps and no new crossing. This is the literal general Morse diagram, not an assumed flat-plat presentation. A strand edge may be chosen for the original reduced mark.

The graph whose vertices are the untwisted main circles and whose edges are the crossing boxes is connected. Otherwise the union of boxes and outside arcs would split the connected planar graph. Choose a spanning tree of this graph and give exactly those boxes odd parity. Switching one tree edge to the odd pairing joins two different current circles. Induction along any order of the tree edges gives one main component, with no internal extra component. The odd signs are arbitrary. Subsequent full twists preserve this pairing, and the even terminal fans preserve it as well. This proves the combinatorial corollary without asserting that every arbitrary tensor graph is a knot diagram.

## L.4 The explicit two-sided fan construction

### L.4.1 Why any finite sequence of insertions remains convex

Fix an old shaded triangular face. Its three incident white disks are pairwise tangent. Apply an orientation-preserving Möbius map for this local verification that sends one of the three contacts to infinity. After a Euclidean similarity the incident disks are the halfplanes

$$\operatorname{Im} z \le 0, \qquad \operatorname{Im} z \ge 2,$$

and the unit disk centered at $i$. Choose the right-hand interstice. The old shaded outward disk is $\operatorname{Re} z > 0$. The new white disk is the unit disk centered at $2+i$. Its contacts with the old three white disks are $2$, $2+2i$, and $1+i$.

The three new shaded outward disks are exactly

$$|z-1|<1, \qquad |z-(1+2i)|<1, \qquad \operatorname{Re} z > 2. \tag{L.4}$$

They lie inside the old shaded outward disk. The six old/new contact points are the vertices of an ideal right-angled octahedron attached along the old face. Its three adjacent white planes coincide with the old white planes, so those seams disappear as flat seams.

There is no intersection with a remote part of the old polyhedron. Every bounded shaded disk lies inside its developed center triangle. Distinct center-triangle interiors are disjoint. A

nonincident white disk is covered, inside the carrier triangle, by the sectors of its own incident center triangles; its part outside the carrier triangle cannot meet a bounded shaded disk. For the omitted outer face, all other contacts and disks lie inside its contact circle and therefore miss its chosen exterior disk. These facts prove that the old shaded outward disk is disjoint from every other old shaded disk and every nonincident old white disk. Möbius normalization preserves this disjointness. The three incident white disks are already included in the local model. Consequently every new contact satisfies all retained old supporting inequalities, strictly when not incident. Conversely all old contacts outside the replaced face satisfy the new inequalities because the disks in (L.4), and the new white disk, occupy the old interstice side. The old attaching contacts have exactly their stated new incidences.

The retained and new exposed facets form the boundary of the union of the old ball and this octahedron along one disk. They make a closed labeled sphere of supporting faces. Therefore the union is the intersection of these inward halfspaces and is convex. This verifies the full certificate, not merely its local dihedral angles or volume.

The same argument applies to either shaded face of any original crossing circle and to any newly exposed face. A later insertion lies in a nested chosen interstice and leaves all preceding circles fixed. Disjoint triangles may be treated in either order. Only finitely many steps are used, so no limiting accumulation or degenerate face is being asserted. Cycles elsewhere in the original diagram do not enter this supporting-halfspace argument.

The normalization used to prove (L.4) need not preserve the global marked coordinate: it is one Möbius verification of a labeled local operation, then transported back. In the actual global marked coordinate the original protected lines remain fixed. This includes a triangle with one or two protected line faces; the parallel-line model above treats the latter directly. The positive Descartes formula for the newly inserted curvature is unchanged.

### L.4.2 Input and the local geometric operation

Start with a connected augmented diagram whose labeled white triangulation is a simple triangulated sphere and whose matching pairs are the original crossing circles. Retain the original marked strand edge and its two protected zero curvatures. Use the actual positive complete packing constructed above. An original crossing circle has ordered weights

$$(x, b, c, y), \qquad A = x + y > 0, \qquad P = xy, \qquad \delta = P/A^2 \in [0, 1/4]. \tag{L.5}$$

Its matching edge is $xy$, and its two shaded triangles are $(x, b, y)$ and $(x, c, y)$. The letters in (L.5) denote circle curvatures, not independent choices of radii for different source factors.

Stellarly subdivide the first triangle by its positive interstice circle

$$b_1 = A + b + 2\sqrt{Ab + P}. \tag{L.6}$$

Retain $xy$ as the old matching edge and match the other two new triangles along $bb_1$. Thus the two resulting crossing circles have unordered outer/middle pairs

| | outer pair | middle pair |
|---|---|---|
| retained crossing circle | $(x, y)$ | $(b_1, c)$ |
| new crossing circle | $(b, b_1)$ | $(x, y)$. |

(L.7)

Their oriented four-leg frames are inherited from the local disk insertion, rather than chosen afterwards from this table.

This is a literal terminal-tangle insertion. In the endpoint convention of all circle octahedral decomposition, take the unturned old box $P_v = T^{-1}h_v$, with exposed tuple $(v_3, v_0, v_1, v_2)$. If $x_1, x_2$ are its two current output neighbors, inserting $h_w$ immediately after $P_v$ replaces

$$\begin{array}{l|ll} v_1 - x_1 & v_1 - w_1, & w_2 - x_1 \\ v_2 - x_2 & v_2 - w_0, & w_3 - x_2. \end{array} \tag{L.8}$$

The endpoint calculation uses only this framed product collar. The outside arcs may belong to an arbitrary fixed diagram; they need not come from a tree. The left insertion replaces $v_3 - x_3$ by $v_3 - w_3, w_0 - x_3$, and $v_0 - x_0$ by $v_0 - w_2, w_1 - x_0$. It gives the second side without changing the inherited frame. The octahedron in that reference attaches to precisely the shaded face being subdivided. Its three other shaded faces give (L.7), with the old and new white boundary cycles fixed by (L.8).

All old circles remain fixed. The new disk lies in the chosen interstice, and the positive Descartes solution is (L.6). The supporting planes and opposite ideal vertices are those of the regular octahedron attached across the old ideal triangle; this is also the literal construction in smoothing fixed radius gap, Section 3. Consequently the same complete labeled certificate extends to the new diagram. This attaches one regular octahedron in each projection copy, so the augmented volume increases by $2v_{\mathrm{oct}}$ per insertion. This geometric statement uses the face attachment, not just its volume.

The protected zeros remain zero. Their marked strand edge is a boundary edge of every subdivision containing it and is not removed. The formulas include a zero middle and one zero outer curvature. In the case with two protected lines, (L.6) is the corresponding positive interstice disk between those lines. Since $A > 0$, no three-zero triangle occurs.

### L.4.3 Exact fan recurrence and even counts

Repeat the operation only at the retained crossing circle, on the same side. Put $t_j = \sqrt{Ab_j + P}$. Direct substitution into (L.6) gives

$$t_{j+1} = t_j + A, \qquad b_j = b + 2j\sqrt{Ab + P} + j^2 A. \tag{L.9}$$

The positive square root is essential here. Normalize

$$u = \sqrt{b/A + \delta}, \qquad v = \sqrt{c/A + \delta}.$$

After $j$ insertions on the first side and $k$ on the second,

$$b_j = A[(u + j)^2 - \delta], \qquad c_k = A[(v + k)^2 - \delta]. \tag{L.10}$$

There are even nonnegative integers $j, k$ with

$$U = u + j \geq 4, \qquad V = v + k \geq 4, \qquad |U - V| \leq 1. \tag{L.11}$$

Indeed choose an integer $m$ nearest $-(u - v)/2$. Then $|u - v + 2m| \leq 1$. Set $j = 2(L + m)$, $k = 2L$, and take the integer $L$ large enough to make both counts nonnegative and both

quantities in (L.11) at least four. Adding the same even count to both sides preserves the difference condition.

Give each inserted terminal an odd crossing power. Its turned four-terminal pairing is the crossing pairing, so an even stack has the identity pairing and creates no internal component. Hence these two even fans preserve the original box's four-endpoint pairing. In particular a specified knot parity pattern of the core remains a knot pattern. The new fillings may have independently chosen sufficiently large odd positive or negative powers. This preserves endpoint connectivity, not the isotopy type of the filled core knot.

### L.4.4 An exact integral for the source-normalized triangle action

Let $F(x,b,y)$ be the complete triangle action with the original determinant, beta and half-forced-product normalization. Its exact entropy definition is

$$F(x,b,y)=\max_{\alpha_x+\alpha_b+\alpha_y=1/2}\left\{\sum_j f(\alpha_j)+\alpha_x\log x+\alpha_b\log b+\alpha_y\log y\right\}, \tag{L.12}$$

where $f'(t)=\log\cot(\pi t)$, $f(0)=f(1/2)=0$, and zero weights force zero allocation. The complete stationary middle load is

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial\log b}=\frac{1}{\pi}\arctan\frac{b}{\sqrt{Ab+P}}. \tag{L.13}$$

These are the calibrated identities in triangle entropy algebraic balance and cross cofactor marked action; no additive entropy constant is available to change.

Homogeneity of (L.12) gives $F(x,b,y)-\frac{1}{2}\log b=F(x/b,1,y/b)\to 0$ as $b\to\infty$. For completeness, the vertex allocation to the middle has value zero. Any maximizing allocations along a sequence with the two outer weights tending to zero must have their outer allocations tending to zero: otherwise the bounded continuous entropy cannot offset the negative log-weight term. Their entropy then tends to zero, proving the upper limit as well. Integrating (L.13) from infinity therefore gives exactly

$$F(x,b,y)=\tfrac{1}{2}\log b+R(b),\qquad R(b)=\frac{1}{\pi}\int_b^\infty\arctan\frac{\sqrt{At+P}}{t}\,\frac{dt}{t}>0. \tag{L.14}$$

The integral converges by its $O(t^{-3/2})$ integrand. It is also valid when one outer curvature is zero.

Using $P\ge 0$, monotonicity of arctangent, and $\arctan z\ge z-z^3/3$ for $z\ge 0$, we obtain

$$R(b)\ge\frac{2}{\pi}\sqrt{A/b}-\frac{2}{9\pi}(A/b)^{3/2}. \tag{L.15}$$

### L.4.5 Strict balance at the retained crossing circle

Assume (L.11), and exchange the two sides if necessary so that $U\ge V$. Put $b'=A(U^2-\delta)$, $c'=A(V^2-\delta)$. They are positive. Since $w\mapsto 2w-2w^3/9$ is increasing on the range in use, (L.15) and $\delta\le 1/4$, $U,V\ge 4$, give

$$R(b')+R(c')\ge\frac{2}{\pi}\left(\frac{1}{U}+\frac{1}{V}\right)-\frac{2}{9\pi}\left(\frac{1}{U^3}+\frac{1}{V^3}\right)\ge\frac{643}{180\pi V}. \tag{L.16}$$

For the last inequality use $U \le V+1 \le 5V/4$ and $V^{-3} \le (16V)^{-1}$. On the other hand,

$$\frac{1}{2}\log(b'/c') = \int_V^U \frac{t}{t^2-\delta}\,dt \le \frac{64}{63V}. \tag{L.17}$$

The rational bound $\pi < 22/7$ proves

$$\frac{643}{180\pi} - \frac{64}{63} > \frac{3347}{27720} > 0. \tag{L.18}$$

It follows from (L.14)–(L.18) that the original retained crossing circle has

$$F(x,b',y) + F(x,c',y) - \max(\log b', \log c') > \frac{3347}{27720\min(U,V)} > 0. \tag{L.19}$$

Thus it satisfies the true complete-radius balance condition, including the source's exact absolute normalization. The simpler algebraic sufficient test need not hold here; using it instead of (L.14) would lose the construction.

### L.4.6 Every added crossing circle already balances

At an insertion with current middle $b$, the new crossing circle has outer sum $A' = b + b_1$ and middle pair $(x, y)$. From (L.6),

$$A' \ge A = x + y \ge \max(x, y).$$

Consequently

$$(A' + x)(A' + y) \ge \max(x^2, y^2). \tag{L.20}$$

The source-normalized entropy inequality $F(a,t,d) \ge \frac{1}{2}\log(a+t+d)$, strict when two weights are positive, shows that (L.20) implies the required strict balance for every positive middle. A zero middle needs no logarithm; its overloaded one-sided finite sector is absent. Since $A' > 0$, this covers all protected-zero cases too.

Later fan steps subdivide only the retained crossing circle's triangle. No previously added crossing circle changes again. Performing the construction at different original crossing circles likewise preserves their already fixed curvatures and all previously settled crossing circles. There are finitely many original crossing circles. Hence the procedure terminates with one actual marked complete packing in which every crossing circle balances strictly.

The construction therefore proves a geometric realization theorem: every fixed certified simple-white core has a finite two-sided terminal decoration, with even fan sizes, preserving its knot endpoint pairing and original marked edge, whose entire complete packing satisfies the true radius-balance inequalities. The sizes depend on the original packing; no uniform count or bridge-width assertion is made.

## L.5 The full finite source at both level parities

### L.5.1 The literal insertion

Start with a connected augmented diagram whose labeled white triangulation is a simple sphere and whose matched cubic dual is its actual projection/crossing-disk cut. At a matching

side $xy$, write the triangles as

$$(x, b, y), \qquad (y, c, x). \tag{L.21}$$

The old box has outer faces $x, y$, input middle $b$, and output middle $c$. A terminal insertion on the first shaded side gives

$$(x, b, y) \longmapsto (x, b, w),\ (b, y, w),\ (y, x, w). \tag{L.22}$$

The triples in (L.21)–(L.22) carry the orientation of the original projection sphere. Removing the common side $bw$ from the first two new triangles leaves the boundary walk $b \to y \to w \to x \to b$; hence its cyclic quartet is $(b, y, w, x)$. The triangle $(y, x, w)$ and the unchanged neighbor $(y, c, x)$, joined across $xy$, have boundary walk $x \to w \to y \to c \to x$. Thus their retained quartet is $(x, w, y, c)$. This derives both frames from their oriented boundaries, not from a reflection symmetry of the entropy.

The old matching side $xy$ now has input/output middles $w, c$. The new matching side $bw$ has the orientation-preserving cyclic quartet $(b, y, w, x)$: its outer faces are $b, w$, its input middle is $y$, and its output middle is $x$. Its signed crossing power is measured in precisely that frame. No reflection of the new coupon is used.

This is a physical insertion, not an arbitrary change of matching. Expose the old box as $P_v = T^{-1}h_v$, with half-segment tuple $(v_3, v_0, v_1, v_2)$. A terminal child on its right changes exactly

$$\begin{array}{l|ll} v_1 - x_1 & v_1 - w_1, & w_2 - x_1 \\ v_2 - x_2 & v_2 - w_0, & w_3 - x_2. \end{array} \tag{L.23}$$

On the other side the changes are

$$\begin{array}{l|ll} v_3 - x_3 & v_3 - w_3, & w_0 - x_3 \\ v_0 - x_0 & v_0 - w_2, & w_1 - x_0. \end{array} \tag{L.24}$$

These are the actual stack and inverse-turn formulas in the ordered disk decomposition, sections 2–3. The formulas use only the two specified strips, and explicitly allow their other ends to lie outside the local ball. They therefore apply inside a non-tree exterior. All other strips remain fixed. The accompanying shaded-sector boundary walk gives precisely (L.22). There is no use of $T^2 = 1$ on a labeled ball, no movement of a box through its neighbors, and no omission of an odd seam.

An odd two-strand braid has the diagonal pairing $X = \{(0, 2), (1, 3)\}$. Its physical quarter-turn preserves this pairing, so every inserted odd terminal still has $X$ in the exposed product frame used in (L.23) or (L.24). Two such consecutive factors compose to the through pairing, with no internal closed component: each of the two through arcs is concatenated once. Any even stack therefore preserves the original four external pairings. This argument uses rotations and the actual strip matches; it invokes neither a mirror reflection nor cancellation of the signed braid operators.

### L.5.2 Endpoint support and the new coefficient target

Fix $N \geq 3$, $d = N - 1$, $q = e^{\pi i/N}$, $Q = q^2$. Let $H_f(x, b, c, y)$ be the original homogeneous degree-$d$ face polynomial of an arbitrary full coupon $f(\Omega)$. This includes actual signed crossing powers and cleared resolvent numerators, with all repeated-node data.

The local adapter of actual homogeneous casimir face source, its equations (6)–(7a), is

$$f(\Omega)_{r,s;u,v} = N^{-1}q^{-d(r-u)}c^{-d}H_f(x,b,c,y) = N^{-1}\frac{H_f(x,b,c,y)}{(bc)^{d/2}}. \tag{L.25}$$

The last equality uses the coherent integer face-log lifts of that physical state. No head is independently reduced modulo $N$. The physical Casimir lowering arrows vanish at their genuine endpoints; hence a modular output with a wrong unwrapped total has zero coefficient before it is interpreted as a physical state. This is valid for every polynomial in the full Casimir, not only for the complete circle.

After (L.22), the two local factors in the numerator are exactly

$$H_f(x,w,c,y)\,H_g(b,y,x,w). \tag{L.26}$$

Here $g$ is the new coupon in its actual four-leg frame. Equation (L.26) identifies the refined source; it does not equate the old and new invariants or posit a multiplicative rule for quarter-turns.

Let $M_f$ count middle incidences at boxes and $T_f$ count outside minus inside Morse turns in face $f$, temporarily restoring the cap at the marked edge. The change of the two quartets gives

$$\delta M_b = -1, \qquad \delta M_x = \delta M_y = 1, \qquad M_w = 1, \qquad \delta M_c = 0. \tag{L.27}$$

Round the boxes in their actual frames. Each middle passage contributes $+\pi$ to boundary turning; the outer pair contributes zero. Inside and outside turns contribute respectively $+\pi$ and $-\pi$. The boundary winding is one in a bounded face and minus one in the exterior $a$. Thus

$$M_f - T_f = 2 \quad (f \neq a), \qquad M_a - T_a = -2. \tag{L.28}$$

This is the literal face-boundary turning calculation of research matched sphere morse source, section 5. It uses no flat-plat sweep or assumption of constant headcount.

Every old face retains its winding, while $w$ is a new bounded face. Subtracting (L.28), with (L.27), gives

$$\delta T_b = -1, \qquad \delta T_x = \delta T_y = 1, \qquad T_w = -1, \qquad \delta T_c = 0. \tag{L.29}$$

A local Morse drawing can have one extra cup and one extra cap; additional cancelling Morse pairs do not change (L.29). Therefore all old exponents are unchanged, and the new exponent is

$$\frac{d}{2}(T_w - M_w) = -d. \tag{L.30}$$

The new ordinary coefficient target is exactly $d$, rather than a free boundary condition.

For even $N$, the face parity cochain differs by one across strand edges and by zero across matching sides. Since $xy$ is matching, $t_x = t_y$, and the old triangle has $t_b = t_x + 1$. The unique local extension is

$$t_w = t_b, \qquad t_w - t_x = t_w - t_y = 1 \pmod 2. \tag{L.31}$$

Thus $bw$ has zero parity difference, every new strand side has difference one, and all old clocks are unchanged. Swapping the order in which the two new middle faces are read does not change these equations: in the actual frame the input is $y$, the output is $x$, and $t_x = t_y$. The original even-level coset is therefore still exactly (L.31).

### L.5.3 The physical mark, measure and normals

Keep a strand edge outside the insertion as the mark, with adjacent protected faces $a, b_*$. The spherical whole-source mark transport may expose it as a top cap; it does not replace an internal marked row by an ordinary cap. The regular generic pivot is $(-1)^H K$, specializing to the original $K^{1-N}$. Its self-duality and equal left/right traces are proved in research arbitrary main edge mark transport, sections 2–3, for arbitrary Morse presentations.

In literal left-to-right physical order the cup, cap and mark are

$$p_{ij} = Nq^{-d^2+di}\mathbf{1}_{i+j=d}, \qquad \ell_{ij} = N^{-1}q^{di}\mathbf{1}_{i+j=d}, \qquad m_{ij} = N^{-2}q^{dj}. \tag{L.32}$$

The marked row is initially unrestricted. The whole-network degree conservation, after the other actual caps act, forces its two heads to sum to $d$. Only then is its ratio to the ordinary cap

$$\frac{m}{\ell} = N^{-1}(L_{b_*}/L_a)^d. \tag{L.33}$$

The added cup and cap have cancelling powers of $N$ and cancelling fixed $q$-constants. If the refined diagram has $R'$ boxes, (L.25), (L.28) and (L.33) make its full marked summand

$$N^{-R'-1}\,\frac{\prod_{e=1}^{R'} H_{f_e}(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e})}{\prod_{f\neq a,b_*} L_f^d}. \tag{L.34}$$

The connected spherical graph has $R'+2$ faces. The conserved integer head lattice identifies primitively with face potentials modulo one common constant. This follows by integrating along dual paths; zero divergence gives independence of the path on the sphere. Bending a physical arc does not change that lattice. After fixing $L_a$, there are $R'+1$ independent $N$-point grids. Their count cancels the prefactor in (L.34). Thus one insertion gives one new coupon factor $N^{-1}$ and one new grid factor $N$, with no residual quantum dimension.

The numerator is homogeneous of degree $dR'$, with nonnegative exponents, though its coefficients can be complex. The grid requires exponent $d \bmod N$ at all $R'$ ordinary faces, and zero modulo $N$ at the other protected face. The ordinary minimum degrees already sum to $dR'$. Hence no higher alias is possible: every ordinary exponent is $d$, and both protected exponents are zero. At even levels the remaining coset character is one. The exact refined scalar is therefore

$$I_N = \left[\prod_{f\neq a,b_*} L_f^d\right] \prod_{e=1}^{R'} H_{f_e}(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e})\Bigg|_{L_a = L_{b_*} = 0}. \tag{L.35}$$

This holds for arbitrary local full polynomials and their spectral parameters. In particular use

$$V_N(\sigma;z)=\frac{\chi_N(\sigma)-\chi_N(z)}{\sigma-z},\qquad \chi_N(z)=\mathcal{T}_N(z)+2 \tag{L.36}$$

as a polynomial before setting $z=\Omega$. It is the actual cleared resolvent at the root and retains the first derivative at every double Casimir node. No value-only interpolation or paired-channel retraction is used.

If an ordinary generic closure is used instead, the full open regular network is a scalar endomorphism of the generic highest-weight object $V_d$. Its ordinary closure is $(-1)^d[N]_q$ times that scalar. The one genuine normal at the root recovers (L.35). No additional normal occurs at the inserted circle or at a separator. This uses the regular physical lift, not a derivative of an arbitrary fixed-root identity.

### L.5.4 The original signed Fourier/Hermite period

Put the literal nonzero fixed signed braid power $R^{n_e}$ at each refined box, with $n_e=\epsilon_e-2p_e$ in its own original disk framing. Define the whole spectral numerator

$$S_N(\boldsymbol{\sigma})=\left[\prod_{f\neq a,b_*}L_f^d\right]\prod_{e=1}^{R'}H_{V_N(\sigma_e)}\Bigg|_{L_a=L_{b_*}=0}. \tag{L.37}$$

Apply the source-independent local full-Hermite crossing functional separately to each box. Multilinearity of the original ordered contraction, not commutation of different boxes, gives

$$\begin{aligned}I_{N,\boldsymbol{n}}=q^{\frac{d^2}{4}\sum_e n_e}(-i)^{R'}&\sum_{\boldsymbol{\ell}\in(\mathbb{Z}\setminus\{0\})^{R'}}\left(\prod_e\ell_e\right)(-1)^{(N+1)\sum_e\ell_e}\\&\times\int_{[-1/2,1/2]^{R'}}\left(\prod_e\sin(2\pi\delta_e)\right)S_N(-2\cos(2\pi\boldsymbol{\delta}))\\&\times\exp\left\{N\sum_e[\pi i n_e\delta_e^2+2\pi i\ell_e\delta_e]\right\}d\boldsymbol{\delta}.\end{aligned} \tag{L.38}$$

This is research matched sphere morse source, section 6, now on the literal inserted network. The Cartan scalar, charge weights, parity and endpoint sine factors have not changed. The original matrix identity excludes charge zero. Three integrations by parts on whole intervals give absolute summability, retaining the second-derivative endpoint currents. No constant-headcount assumption occurs.

The exterior framing/component character remains separately recorded. At complete main color it has modulus one. The full one-cut modified convention also retains its specified polynomial-level factor. These source conversions do not change the exponential rate. The invariant in (L.38) belongs to the refined filled link, not to the original unrefined core.

## L.6 The calibrated complete action and all-central packet

In the analytic sections write $D=\widehat{D}$ for the fixed refined diagram and $R$ for its number of crossing circles (the $R'$ in (L.34)–(L.38)). Put $\Phi_D=\Phi=\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)/(2\pi)$. At a local crossing

circle write $Q_t(0) = F(x, t, y)$ for the calibrated triangle action; $Q_t(\delta)$ is its selected angular continuation from the original cofactor action. Let $C_N = C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}$ be the shared all-central coefficient, including its sign $(-1)^{dR}$. The central piece is selected by polynomial linearity after the full physical source has been identified; it is not declared to be an independent Hopf coupon.

At the actual marked complete packing, put

$$\Phi = \sum_e [F(x_e, b_e, y_e) + F(x_e, c_e, y_e)] - \sum_{f \neq u,v} \log L_f. \tag{L.39}$$

Every finite circle has total center angle $2\pi$. Hence it is a stationary point of (L.39). Its positive finite-face Hessian is nondegenerate after fixing the common scale: the local positive triangle Hessians identify adjacent finite-face variations, and the simple sphere remains connected after deleting $u, v$. The resulting one-dimensional kernel before scale fixing is exactly common scaling. This is the proof used in original boundary transverse rank; Morse cups/caps do not add a face variable or a Hessian equation.

The absolute constant comes from the actual polyhedron, not a local choice. For a shaded center triangle with angles $\theta_j$,

$$2\pi F - \sum_j \theta_j \log L_j = 2 \sum_j \left[\Lambda(\theta_j/2) + \Lambda((\pi - \theta_j)/2)\right]. \tag{L.40}$$

The constant is fixed by $F(x, 0, 0) = \frac{1}{2} \log x$. Cone the marked ideal vertex to the nonincident faces of the certified convex polyhedron. The white and shaded facet contributions are exactly the two Lobachevsky terms in (L.40); internal diagonals cancel. Summing the actual facets and their $2\pi$ angle sums proves

$$2\pi\Phi = 2\,\mathrm{Vol}(Q) = \mathrm{Vol}(Y). \tag{L.41}$$

The proof is the facet-coning argument in Section 6 of original boundary stationary character, which explicitly requires only the connected certificate and marked strand edge.

### L.6.1 The central local packet and global spectral gap

We prove the all-central estimates on the exact Morse source. The full one-sided remainder is restored separately below. The graph and its presentation are fixed before the level tends to infinity.

Write $C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}$ for the original all-central marked coefficient, including its sign $(-1)^{dR}$, where $d = N - 1$. This source has $R + 2$ faces and exactly $R$ original degree-$d$ ordinary targets. Simplicity and the protected strand edge imply that no matching edge has both protected endpoints. Hence every local outer sum $x + y$ is positive. The remaining zero patterns, including a one-variable triangle, are precisely those already treated in the actual local cofactor proofs.

The local interpolant rigidity theorem and its exactly anchored interpolation therefore apply to every unchanged local polynomial:

$$P_{\mathrm{cross},e} = N^2 \mathcal{B}_{e,N}\left(1 + O(e^{-\kappa N})\right). \tag{L.42}$$

This is uniform on a fixed small complex spectral and face neighborhood. The original maximal-fold anchor, beta factors, forced products, half-index, and even/odd central formulas are retained. These theorems are local finite recurrences and interpolation statements; they have no hypothesis about the number or order of global Morse events.

For the shared angular complement, deleting the two marked vertices from a simple triangulated sphere leaves a connected ordinary graph. The elementary link-rerouting argument in the original rank theorem proves this without a flat-plat assumption. Every surviving edge lies in an actual triangle with two nonzero face variables. The global cofactor angular theorem then detects every nonconstant ordinary phase. A one-variable triangle is retained as a monomial and contributes no false angular constraint. All other cofactors have their global polynomial endpoint majorant; the exact central sums cost only polynomial factors. After fixing one ordinary phase, the common-phase point is the only angular zero. The active edge rows are primitive $+1, -1$ differences, so no additional angular alias is introduced.

The positive coefficient saddle theorem, sections 2–4, uses this same ordinary graph, the exact determinant pair-trace bounds, and the complete circle angle-force equation. Its face Hessian is positive definite on the $R-1$ dimensional common-scale quotient. The complete exponent is $\Phi = \mathrm{Vol}(Y)/(2\pi)$, with the exact source anchor. No flat gap forest or constant intermediate headcount enters that proof.

Define the finite phase on that original quotient by

$$\Psi_N(z,\delta) = \frac{1}{N}\sum_e \mathrm{Log}\,\mathcal{B}_{e,N}(\delta_e; L(z)) - \frac{d}{N}\sum_{f\ \mathrm{ordinary}} \mathrm{Log}\,L_f(z). \tag{L.43}$$

Uniform local convergence and the positive complete Hessian give its holomorphic saddle, critical value $A_N$, and face Hessian $H_N$. The new finite compiler gives exactly the original Cauchy measure; the simultaneous phase integrates to one, leaving $(2\pi)^{-(R-1)}d\theta$. Deforming that actual torus in its annulus, with local side faces in the angular gap, gives

$$C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\delta) = \frac{(-1)^{dR}N^{2R}e^{NA_N(\delta)}}{(2\pi N)^{(R-1)/2}\sqrt{\det H_N(\delta)}}(1+O(N^{-1})). \tag{L.44}$$

This repeats only sections 1–3 of the original shared packet proof. All finite normalization factors remain in (L.43), and the determinant branch is continued from the positive real Hessian. The estimate is relative on one fixed complex polydisk and controls all fixed derivatives on smaller polydisks. It has a nonzero actual source amplitude.

The finite actions are separately even and real on the real chart. Their limit is the untwisted action $A_0$ of the original circle collars, with

$$A_0(0) = \Phi, \qquad A_0''(0) = -2\,\mathrm{diag}(C_e), \qquad C_e = \frac{\pi(T_{b_e}+T_{c_e})}{x_e+y_e} > 0. \tag{L.45}$$

Here $T_t = \sqrt{(x+y)t+xy}$, evaluated at the actual complete crossing circle. At least one triangle at every crossing circle is nonmonomial: either both outers are positive, or one protected outer leaves at least one positive middle. Thus (L.45) is strict at every crossing circle. Shrinking the fixed chart gives the uniform negative real Hessian required by the spectral Gaussian argument. Half twists are added only through the original $n = \epsilon - 2p$ functional (L.38).

For the global spectral bound, sections 1–3 of the global central theorem use the signed normalized transfer, all starting rows, and a uniform upper bound on the original unused logarithmic products. Their local upper action is $\max\{Q_b(\delta), \frac{1}{2}\log b\}$, omitting the second branch when $b = 0$. It decreases strictly away from $\delta = 0$ except for the stated exact monomial. Every separated spectral crossing circle therefore has a strict loss in the product of its two triangle cofactors. The even/odd central sums keep both triangles in each term.

Outside the common ordinary phase neighborhood, the global cofactor angular bound supplies a gap uniformly for all real spectra. Inside that neighborhood, the signed transfer proof supplies its fixed complex face extension: one separated crossing circle gives a strict loss, while all others stay below their endpoint rates plus arbitrarily small errors. The graph has finitely many crossing circles, so choose the errors and strip small enough that their total is less than that loss. This gives, for every $\eta > 0$, some $\tau, \gamma > 0$ such that

$$|C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\delta)| \le e^{N(\Phi-\gamma)} \quad \text{if} \quad \max_e |\operatorname{Re}\delta_e| \ge \eta, \qquad |\operatorname{Im}\delta_e| \le \tau, \tag{L.46}$$

on the centered real cube for all sufficiently large $N$. Every fixed derivative has the same strict rate on a smaller strip. This is the shared Cauchy sewing of the global central theorem, with one set of face radii and the original targets throughout.

Thus (L.44) and (L.46) hold for this actual simple-white Morse source. Constants depend on the fixed graph, complete radii, and zero patterns; no prescribed flat-plat width is required. For a full-source filling conclusion, the global one-sided gap proved below must restore the full numerator. No old Fejér smoothing, pure-middle forest, or flat full-packet restoration was used here.

## L.7 The finite first charge contributes

For a fixed closed local cube $K_b = [-b, b]^R$, define the integral before its outer charge and Cartan factors by

$$J_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} = \int_{K_b} \left(\prod_i \sin(2\pi\delta_i)\right) C_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) \exp\left\{N \sum_i [\pi i n_i \delta_i^2 + 2\pi i \ell_i \delta_i]\right\} d\boldsymbol{\delta}. \tag{L.47}$$

Only finitely many sharply restricted charge terms are summed in this section. The infinite charge tails will be kept on whole original intervals.

The packet retains its actual finite phase $A_N$, not only its limiting action. Its local interpolant and unique face saddle are real on the real chart and separately even. Consequently

$$\partial_i A_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = -2\delta_i B_{i,N}(\delta_1^2, \dots, \delta_R^2), \qquad B_{i,N} \longrightarrow B_i, \quad B_i(0) = C_i > 0. \tag{L.48}$$

After shrinking one fixed chart, $|B_{i,N} - C_i| \le C_i/8$ and $\Re A_N''$ is uniformly negative definite throughout that complex chart. The ordinary-face determinant branch is continued from the positive complete Hessian. The following proof keeps the actual boundary of a fixed real spectral cube.

### L.7.1 Finite-N filling saddles for independent signed twists

There are fixed $b, a, n_0 > 0$, with $a$ much smaller than $b$, such that the following holds for every fixed integer vector $\mathbf{n}$ with $|n_i| \geq n_0$. There is no condition on ratios $|n_i|/|n_j|$. For positive real charges satisfying $\ell_i/|n_i| \leq a$ define

$$\Phi_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = A_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) + \pi i \sum_i n_i \delta_i^2 + 2\pi i \sum_i \ell_i \delta_i. \tag{L.49}$$

It has a unique critical point $\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ in the chosen small polydisc. Indeed, writing $t_i = \ell_i/n_i$, its equations are precisely

$$\delta_i = -\frac{t_i}{1 + iB_{i,N}(\boldsymbol{\delta}^2)/(\pi n_i)}. \tag{L.50}$$

Uniform contraction proves existence, uniqueness and holomorphic parameter dependence, exactly as in the limiting charge lemma. Bounds on $B_{i,N}$ and their derivatives are uniform in N. Consequently

$$|\delta_i| \leq 2|t_i|, \qquad \operatorname{Im}\delta_i = \frac{\ell_i}{\pi n_i^2} \frac{\operatorname{Re} B_{i,N}(\boldsymbol{\delta}^2)}{\left|1 + iB_{i,N}(\boldsymbol{\delta}^2)/(\pi n_i)\right|^2} > 0. \tag{L.51}$$

In particular $\operatorname{Im}\delta_i \leq C\ell_i/n_i^2$. This sign holds for BOTH signs of $n_i$. All coordinates of the saddle are nonzero when all $\ell_i > 0$. Write $\boldsymbol{\delta}_* = x_* + iy_*$, with $y_* > 0$ componentwise, and put

$$S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} = \Phi_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}_*), \qquad Q_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} = -\Phi''_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}_*).$$

Since the Gaussian contributes a purely imaginary diagonal Hessian, $\operatorname{Re} Q_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ is positive definite. No real or complex eigenvalue of Q vanishes. The spectral determinant root used below is the unique Gaussian branch on the convex cone of complex symmetric matrices with positive real part, positive at a positive real matrix. Thus

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^R} e^{-\frac{1}{2}t^T Q t}\, dt = \frac{(2\pi)^{R/2}}{\sqrt{\det Q}}. \tag{L.52}$$

This fixes its phase even when the different $n_i$ have different signs.

For fixed $\mathbf{n}$ and $\boldsymbol{\ell}$, $\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ and $S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ converge to the corresponding limiting critical point and value. No convergence rate is needed and $A_N$ is not replaced by $A_0$ in a relative formula.

### L.7.2 Deformation of the actual restricted real contour

We prove the requisite contour coefficient, rather than postulate it. Translate $K_b$ coordinate by coordinate to $K_b + iy_*$. Cauchy's theorem on each rectangle gives equality with the translated integral plus its oriented side integrals. The exact integrand is entire in $\boldsymbol{\delta}$; the packet is only used to estimate it inside the common local chart. The side integrals are retained in this equality.

Here is a uniform exponential bound for every side. Its points have $z = x + iv$ with x in $K_b$, at least one $|x_j| = b$, and $0 \leq v_i \leq y_{*,i}$. Separate reality and the real Hessian bound give

$$\operatorname{Re} A_N(x + iv) \leq A_N(0) - c|x|^2 + C|v|^2. \tag{L.53}$$

To see the quadratic, rather than linear, error in v, Taylor-expand at the real point x: the first term $i\nabla A_N(x)\cdot v$ is imaginary. The remaining derivatives are uniformly bounded. The real Gaussian and charge contribution is

$$-2\pi\sum_i n_i x_i v_i - 2\pi\sum_i \ell_i v_i \le Cb\sum_i \frac{\ell_i}{|n_i|}. \tag{L.54}$$

The second term is nonpositive. Equation (L.51) bounds the first term, without using a common sign or a bound on slope ratios. Thus every side has real phase at most

$$A_N(0) - cb^2 + C|y_*|^2 + Cb\sum_i |t_i|. \tag{L.55}$$

The critical value satisfies the complementary estimate

$$\operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} \ge A_N(0) - C\sum_i |t_i|^2. \tag{L.56}$$

For completeness, $A_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}_*) - A_N(0) = O(\sum_i |t_i|^2)$. The critical equations imply $|n_i x_{*,i} + \ell_i| \le C|\delta_{*,i}|$; hence the real quadratic-plus-linear phase $-2\pi\sum_i (n_i x_{*,i} + \ell_i) y_{*,i}$ has the same bound (and in fact a smaller additional factor $n_{\min}^{-1}$). This proves (L.56) without bounding the large purely imaginary quantity $n_i\delta_i^2$ by its absolute value.

First fix b within the source chart, then choose a/b sufficiently small and $n_0$ sufficiently large. Equations (L.55)-(L.56) give a fixed $\kappa_b > 0$ such that all sides satisfy

$$\operatorname{Re}\Phi_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(z) \le \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} - \kappa_b. \tag{L.57}$$

All polynomial prefactors in the all-central packet, bounded sine factors and finite side volumes preserve this exponential loss. Thus the actual local real contour has coefficient +1 on its translated horizontal saddle plane, with only exponentially small side currents.

On that plane $\Phi'$ vanishes at $x_* + iy_*$, and for every real x in $K_b$

$$\operatorname{Re}\Phi_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(x + iy_*) \le \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} - c|x - x_*|^2. \tag{L.58}$$

Indeed the real part of its real-coordinate Hessian is $\operatorname{Re} A_N''$, which is uniformly negative definite along the entire segment. The critical point stays a fixed distance from the cube boundary because $|x_*| \le 2a$ much less than b. This proves the requisite local and nonlocal estimates on the translated restricted contour. It does not say anything about the original contour outside $K_b$.

### L.7.3 Relative asymptotic and its nonzero coefficient

Define

$$a_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = \frac{\prod_i \sin(2\pi\delta_i)}{\sqrt{\det H_N(\boldsymbol{\delta})}}.$$

The holomorphic Gaussian estimate on (L.58), using (L.52), yields

$$J_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} = (-1)^{dR}\sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2}\frac{a_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}})}{\sqrt{\det Q_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}}} e^{NS_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}}\left[1 + O_{\mathbf{n},\boldsymbol{\ell}}(N^{-1})\right]. \tag{L.59}$$

The error in the full packet is holomorphic and uniformly $O(N^{-1})$; Cauchy bounds, or direct Gaussian integration of that error, preserve (L.59). The ordinary Taylor Gaussian error is $O(N^{-1})$, since its odd first correction integrates to zero; replacing the cube by the full real Gaussian changes the answer exponentially. The exact side integrals in (L.57) are likewise exponentially small relative to (L.59). Constants may depend on the fixed slopes and charges. No joint large-twist/large-level error estimate is asserted.

The power and constant follow directly from the two actual integrals:

$$N^{2R}(2\pi N)^{-(R-1)/2}(2\pi/N)^{R/2} = \sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2}. \tag{L.60}$$

There is no undetermined stationary multiplier. Every sine in (L.59) is nonzero: $\delta_{*,i}$ is nonzero by (L.50) and lies in a small disk with no other zero of $\sin(2\pi\delta_i)$. Both determinant roots are units. For each fixed $\mathbf{n}$ and $\boldsymbol{\ell}$ the coefficient in (L.59) converges to a nonzero number. Therefore the local integral is nonzero for all sufficiently large N.

Let $U_{N,\mathbf{n};b}$ denote the sum of the original contributions in the original Fourier period with $\ell_i \in \{+1,-1\}$, each restricted to $K_b$. Reflection of one coordinate $\delta_i \mapsto -\delta_i$ changes $J_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ by a minus sign and also changes $\prod_i \ell_i$ by a minus sign. $S_N$ and the quadratic phase are separately even, and the parity character is unchanged. Thus all $2^R$ sign choices contribute exactly equally. With $S_{N,\mathbf{1}}$, $\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\mathbf{1}}$, $Q_{N,\mathbf{1}}$ defined above,

$$\begin{aligned} U_{N,\mathbf{n};b} = {} & q^{\frac{d^2}{4}\sum_i n_i}(-2i)^R\sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2} \\ & \times \frac{\prod_i \sin(2\pi\delta_{N,\mathbf{1},i})}{\sqrt{\det H_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\mathbf{1}})}\sqrt{\det Q_{N,\mathbf{1}}}} e^{NS_{N,\mathbf{1}}}\left[1+O_{\mathbf{n}}(N^{-1})\right]. \end{aligned} \tag{L.61}$$

The parity cancellation is literal:

$$(-1)^{(N+1)R}(-1)^{dR} = (-1)^{2NR} = 1.$$

Equation (L.61) holds through both level parities and arbitrary independent signs of the sufficiently long fixed $n_i$. The remaining $q$ scalar has modulus one and is kept exactly. This proves a nonzero contributing localized original unit-charge period, not merely the existence of the corresponding critical point.

### L.7.4 Enlargement to the finite local charge sector

For fixed $\mathbf{n}$ let $L_i = \lfloor a|n_i|\rfloor$, with $n_0$ enlarged so $L_i \geq 1$. Restrict the original period (L.38) to $K_b$ and to $0 < |\ell_i| \leq L_i$. This is a finite set after the twists are fixed. The exact finite version of the monotonicity calculation applies to $A_N$, because the even phase factorization and $\operatorname{Re} B_{i,N} > 0$ hold:

$$\partial_{\ell_i} \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} = -\frac{2\ell_i}{n_i^2}\frac{\operatorname{Re} B_{i,N}}{|1+iB_{i,N}/(\pi n_i)|^2}.$$

After the same fixed shrink, for every positive charge in this box,

$$\operatorname{Re} S_{N,\mathbf{1}} - \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} \geq \sum_i \frac{C_i}{2n_i^2}(\ell_i^2 - 1). \tag{L.62}$$

The harmless constants can be decreased if needed to make this inequality uniform in all large N. If any nonunit positive charge exists, the right side has a strictly positive minimum $\eta_{\mathbf{n}}$ over that finite set. Formula (L.59), the exact charge factors $\prod_i \ell_i$, and the independent sign symmetry imply that the entire restricted local charge sector equals (L.61) with an additional relative $O_{\mathbf{n}}(e^{-\eta_{\mathbf{n}} N})$ error (or after a smaller $\eta_{\mathbf{n}}$). If all $L_i = 1$, there are no extra local charges. There is no comparison of an infinite charge sum and no assertion about charges near an alias.

## L.8 Every other Fourier charge is controlled

### L.8.1 Basic bounds, endpoint identities, and parameter choices

The local packet and real concavity bound near zero, together with the shared global spectral gap outside a smaller fixed cube, imply

$$\sup_{\boldsymbol{\delta}\ \text{real}} |C_N(\boldsymbol{\delta})| \le e^{N(\Phi_D + e_N)}, \qquad e_N \longrightarrow 0. \tag{L.63}$$

Polynomial Bernstein on each cosine variable yields, for any fixed $T$,

$$|C_N(\boldsymbol{\delta})| \le \exp\left[ N(\Phi_D + e_N) + 2\pi d \sum_i |\operatorname{Im} \delta_i| \right], \qquad |\operatorname{Im} \delta_i| \le T. \tag{L.64}$$

This is a bound for the whole shared polynomial; no factorwise positive-radius majorant is used. For source derivatives, apply Cauchy to (L.64) in the required variables. Gaussian derivatives are evaluated separately on real spectator coordinates, avoiding any unwanted large-twist exponential cost.

If a source factor $Z$ is an arbitrary entire polynomial in the $\sigma_i$, its product with $\prod_i \sin(2\pi\delta_i)$ and the fixed Gaussian satisfies

$$B|_{\delta_j = \pm 1/2} = 0, \qquad \partial_j B|_{\delta_j = 1/2} = \partial_j B|_{\delta_j = -1/2}\,. \tag{L.65}$$

The first derivative is solely the derivative of the sine: the two cosines are both $-1$, the spectral argument is 2 at both ends, and the Gaussian endpoint value is $e^{\pi i N n_j/4}$. These facts remain true after arbitrary derivatives in other variables, including when one different coordinate is held complex. Thus three integrations by parts give exactly

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-1/2}^{1/2} B e^{2\pi i N \ell_j \delta_j}\, d\delta_j = (2\pi i N \ell_j)^{-3} \Big\{ & \left[ \partial_j^2 B e^{2\pi i N \ell_j \delta_j} \right]_{-1/2}^{1/2} \\ & - \int_{-1/2}^{1/2} \partial_j^3 B e^{2\pi i N \ell_j \delta_j}\, d\delta_j \Big\}. \end{aligned} \tag{L.66}$$

The second-derivative endpoint difference is retained. Repeating (L.66) over any spectator subset gives at most $3^{R-1}$ boundary/integral terms. Fixed source Cauchy bounds and real Gaussian derivatives cost at most $C_{\mathbf{n}} N^3$ per differentiated variable; these powers cancel the $N^3$ denominators. After the actual charge factors, every spectator coordinate supplies $|\ell_j|^{-2}$.

Choose a small fixed outer cube $K_B = [-B, B]^R$ inside the fixed local packet chart. Choose $a > 0$ much smaller than $B$ so the localized contribution theorem applies uniformly for all positive charges $\ell_i/|n_i| \le a$. Next choose $0 < b < a/4$, with $K_b$ inside the same chart. All these

constants depend only on $D$. Below $n_0$ will be enlarged finitely many times, independently of ratios among the $|n_i|$.

### L.8.2 The infinite far-charge union is exponentially small

Use (L.46) at $\eta = 1/4$. Choose $\tau > 0$ sufficiently small that the source and all required spectator derivatives have a strict bound $e^{N(\Phi_D-\gamma_e)}$ at

$$\delta_i = \pm\frac{1}{2} + iv, \qquad 0 \le v \le \tau.$$

with every other coordinate real or in a fixed Cauchy neighborhood of radius $\tau$. This uses the separated endpoint coordinate, regardless of the other real coordinates. Shrink $\tau$ and $\gamma_e$ once if needed.

For a positive far charge $\ell_i$, shift its whole interval upwards by $i\tau$, keeping all other integrations on their whole real intervals. Write

$$B_i(z;\boldsymbol{\delta}_{\text{other}}) = \sin(2\pi z)e^{\pi i n_i N z^2} C_N(z,\boldsymbol{\delta}_{\text{other}}).$$

The exact pair of endpoint currents is

$$\begin{aligned} B_i(1/2+iv) - B_i(-1/2+iv) = 2i\sinh(2\pi v)\sinh(\pi n_i N v) \\ \times e^{\pi i n_i N(1/4-v^2)} C_N(1/2+iv,\boldsymbol{\delta}_{\text{other}}). \end{aligned} \tag{L.67}$$

The other sine/Gaussian factors remain outside this equality. Multiplying the actual Fourier character leaves the endpoint parity $(-1)^{\ell_i}$. Its modulus is one. Both vertical sides were retained; the paired factor vanishes quadratically at $v = 0$.

For the paired vertical contribution, apply (L.66) in every spectator coordinate. The strict endpoint strip bound and source Cauchy estimates then give, after all original charge weights, an upper bound

$$C_{\mathbf{n}}|n_i|N\ell_i\, e^{N(\Phi_D-\gamma_e)} \left(\prod_{j\neq i}|\ell_j|^{-2}\right) \int_0^\tau v^2 e^{-2\pi N(\ell_i-|n_i|/2)v}\, dv. \tag{L.68}$$

Here $|\sinh(2\pi v)\sinh(\pi n_i N v)| \le C|n_i|Nv^2e^{\pi|n_i|Nv}$. No oscillatory-sine substitution is made. For $\ell_i > |n_i|/2 + D$, with $D \ge 1$, the integral is at most $C/[N^3(\ell_i - |n_i|/2)^3]$. Consequently summing (L.68) over this far coordinate and all nonzero spectator charges is bounded by a polynomial factor times $e^{N(\Phi_D-\gamma_e)}$. The exact estimate

$$\sum_{\ell>M} \frac{\ell}{(\ell-|n|/2)^3} \le C\left[D^{-1} + (|n|+1)D^{-2}\right]. \tag{L.69}$$

makes the summability explicit. Constants may depend on the fixed $\mathbf{n}$.

For the upper horizontal contribution, apply the same spectator integrations by parts. Source Cauchy from (L.64), in a fixed radius-$\tau$ neighborhood of the spectators, has exponential cost at most $2\pi R\tau N$. The shifted sine is bounded, while the bad-coordinate Gaussian and Fourier factors cost exactly at most

$$e^{\pi|n_i|N\tau-2\pi\ell_i N\tau}.$$

Thus the weighted horizontal contribution is bounded by

$$C_{\mathbf{n}}\ell_i\left(\prod_{j\neq i}|\ell_j|^{-2}\right)\exp\{N\left[\Phi_D+e_N+2\pi R\tau-2\pi\tau(\ell_i-|n_i|/2)\right]\}. \tag{L.70}$$

Choose a fixed $D$ large enough that $2\pi\tau D>2\pi R\tau+2\gamma_e$, and set

$$M_i=\left\lceil\frac{|n_i|}{2}+D\right\rceil. \tag{L.71}$$

The geometric tail of $\ell_i$ times (L.70) is exponentially bounded by $\Phi_D-\gamma_e$ after a harmless decrease of $\gamma_e$ and all large N. Both signs of the far charge obey the same estimate, either by downward shifts or the exact separate-evenness/reflection identity.

Therefore, for some fixed $\gamma_\infty>0$,

$$\sum_{\substack{\boldsymbol{\ell}\in(\mathbb{Z}\setminus\{0\})^R\\ \exists i:\ |\ell_i|>M_i}}\left|\mathcal{I}^{\mathrm{cross}}_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}\right|\leq C_{\mathbf{n}}\,\mathrm{poly}(N)e^{N(\Phi_D-\gamma_\infty)}. \tag{L.72}$$

Here $\mathcal{I}^{\mathrm{cross}}_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}$ denotes the full weighted charge term in (L.38). Use the union bound over $i$; multiple far coordinates cause no issue. Every other coordinate was summed on its whole original domain after (L.66). Finite-N absolute convergence and the displayed dominating series justify all summations. No partial-far exterior with uncontrolled $R$ powers appears: the hypothesis used is the shared all-central endpoint gap, valid for arbitrary real spectator spectra. This is the stronger input missing from the local operator-tail argument.

### L.8.3 The finite charges outside the local scaled box

The remaining set $0<|\ell_i|\leq M_i$ is finite after $\mathbf{n}$ is fixed. Suppose at least one coordinate $i$ has $|\ell_i|/|n_i|>a$. Reflect charge signs if necessary; the source is separately even, so absolute estimates are unchanged and assume $\ell_i>0$.

On the original real domain outside $K_b$, the shared global spectral gap gives rate $\Phi_D-\gamma_b$. The Gaussian and Fourier factors there have modulus one. No contour estimate is needed for this finite-charge portion.

Inside $K_b$, shift only coordinate $i$ upward by

$$t_i=\frac{b}{|n_i|}. \tag{L.73}$$

All actual side currents of this small rectangle are retained. The packet and its real-action Taylor bound give, uniformly for $x$ in $K_b$ and $0\leq v\leq t_i$,

$$\mathrm{Re}\,A_N(x+ive_i)\leq A_N(0)-c|x|^2+Cv^2. \tag{L.74}$$

Reality makes the first Taylor term purely imaginary. The Gaussian-plus-Fourier contribution in this coordinate is

$$-2\pi n_i x_i v - 2\pi \ell_i v \le -2\pi |n_i|(a-b)v \le 0. \tag{L.75}$$

On the horizontal translate, $v = t_i$, this costs at least $2\pi b(a-b)$, while the source error is at most $Cb^2/n_0^2$. On either vertical side $|x_i| = b$, (L.74) gives at least $cb^2$ loss, and (L.75) is nonpositive. Enlarge $n_0$ so $C/n_0^2$ is small. Then the horizontal and both sides have a fixed strict gap $\gamma_{\mathrm{bad}} > 0$ below $\Phi_D$, independently of slope ratios. The packet's amplitudes contribute only polynomial factors.

Together with the exterior $K_b$ bound, every such bounded bad charge is exponentially small. There are finitely many of them, so their whole sum obeys the same strict rate with a fixed-n prefactor. No infinite sharp-cube series has been split.

### L.8.4 Finite local charges and the actual unit contribution

It remains to consider the finite set with all $|\ell_i|/|n_i| \le a$. On the real domain outside the larger $K_B$, the shared global spectral gap gives a fixed loss $\gamma_B$. Inside $K_B$ apply the localized original contour theorem to the packet (L.44), using the preceding local argument with its cube parameter set to $B$. It retains the exact side currents, the finite action, the Gaussian determinant branch and all sine/charge/parity factors.

For positive charges the finite critical values satisfy

$$\operatorname{Re} S_{N,\mathbf{1}} - \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} \ge \sum_i \frac{C_i}{2n_i^2}(\ell_i^2 - 1). \tag{L.76}$$

All sign-unit choices contribute exactly equally. Every other charge in this finite local box has a positive fixed-n gap. The all-unit local contribution is precisely the first-charge formula above, with its $O_{\mathbf{n}}(N^{-1})$ relative error and nonzero limiting amplitude. The half twists are included once through $n_i = \epsilon_i - 2p_i$.

The limiting unit loss from $\Phi_D$ is $O_D(\sum_i |n_i|^{-2})$. Enlarge the diagram-dependent $n_0$ until this loss is less than one quarter of the minimum of $\gamma_\infty$, $\gamma_{\mathrm{bad}}$, $\gamma_b$ and $\gamma_B$. Also require $an_0 \ge 1$ so the unit charge lies in the local box. Since $S_{N,\mathbf{1}}$ tends to its limiting value, all complementary bounds above are then exponentially smaller than $e^{N \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\mathbf{1}}}$ for large N. The smallest nonunit gap in (L.76) may depend on the fixed vector $\mathbf{n}$, but remains positive. Combining the finite local sector, bounded bad charges and the absolutely bounded infinite union proves the first-charge asymptotic.

The exact critical volume identity identifies

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |I_{\mathrm{cross}}| = \mathrm{Vol}(\text{the actual smooth filled exterior}). \tag{L.77}$$

There is no uniform joint growing-twist/level error assertion: the twists are fixed first, while the threshold applies to arbitrary independent signs and magnitudes.

## L.9 Restoring the full invariant under balance

At every crossing circle put $X_e = Q_{b_e}(0) + Q_{c_e}(0)$. The fan proof established $X_e > \log b_e$ when $b_e > 0$ and $X_e > \log c_e$ when $c_e > 0$. It also gives $Q_t(0) > \frac{1}{2}\log t$ for each positive middle. These are inequalities at the one actual complete marked packing.

### L.9.1 Every sector containing a one-sided crossing circle has a global spectral gap

Write $j \to i$, with $0 \le i \le j \le d$, for a recurrence path whose middle-face powers are $b^i c^{d-j}$. The exact path partition is disjoint at both parities. For $N = 2m$, left has $j \le m-1$, central has $i \le m-1$ and $j \ge m$, and right has $i \ge m$. For $N = 2m+1$, left has $j \le m-1$, central has $i \le m \le j$, and right has $i \ge m+1$. The odd central zero-step path belongs to central exactly once.

At a fixed crossing circle, the global weighted left theorem bounds the actual absolute value, at arbitrary face phases and every real spectral value, by the rate

$$L_e = \max\left\{\log c, Q_b(0) + \frac{1}{2}\log c\right\}, \qquad c > 0. \tag{L.78}$$

If $c = 0$, the finite left polynomial vanishes identically because its $c$ exponent is at least $\lfloor N/2 \rfloor > 0$. Similarly, the right rate is

$$R_e = \max\left\{\log b, Q_c(0) + \frac{1}{2}\log b\right\}, \qquad b > 0, \tag{L.79}$$

and the right polynomial vanishes identically under the protected specialization $b = 0$. The strict balance inequality and $Q_t(0) > \frac{1}{2}\log t$ give $L_e < X_e$ and $R_e < X_e$ whenever the corresponding sector survives. This also resolves the protected monomial exception: if one triangle has $t = 0$ and $xy = 0$, the sector overloading that zero middle is absent, while the opposite surviving sector uses the strict triangle inequality for its positive middle. If both middles vanish, both one-sided sectors vanish exactly.

The global central coefficient comparison, Section 8, bounds its value on the same face torus by rate $X_e$, with only a polynomial or logarithmic prefactor. Thus the whole local full numerator is bounded by rate $X_e$, and any chosen left or right factor supplies a fixed strict loss. Since $D$ is fixed, the minimum of its finitely many surviving one-sided gaps is positive. If none survives, the remainder is identically zero and the subsequent conclusion is immediate.

Take any original path sector with at least one one-sided crossing circle and central, left or right assigned elsewhere. The value bounds are uniform over the original common face Cauchy torus. The same marked target extraction therefore gives, for some $\gamma > 0$ and all sufficiently large $N$,

$$|Z_{\text{sector}}(\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_R)| \le e^{N(\Phi_D - \gamma)}, \tag{L.80}$$

uniformly on the entire real spectral cube $[-2, 2]^R$, at both parities. Here $\sum_e X_e$ minus the original ordinary log-radius targets is exactly $\Phi_D = \mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)/(2\pi)$, by the calibrated complete source. The protected variables stay zero throughout. No infimum of a sum of local maxima or independent-radius capacity equality is used.

There are only $3^R - 1$ such sectors. Their sum is exactly the full shared numerator minus its all-central part. Thus (L.80) also holds for that remainder, after reducing $\gamma$. It is a polynomial of spectral degree at most $d$ in each variable. Multivariate cosine Bernstein extends (L.80) to a sufficiently thin fixed complex $\delta$ strip, at cost $\exp[2\pi d \sum_i |\operatorname{Im} \delta_i|]$. Reducing the strip height and $\gamma$ gives the same strict gap there.

### L.9.2 Entire original Fourier remainder and the full invariant

Apply the whole-domain three-integration-by-parts lemma, Section 4, to the remainder polynomial. The original sine factors vanish at both endpoints, first derivatives match, and the second-derivative endpoint current is retained. Source derivatives use the fixed strip; Gaussian derivatives are taken only on the real cube. Summing all nonzero original charges with their actual weights and parity gives

$$|I_{\text{full}} - I_{\text{cross}}| \le C_D \prod_i (1 + |n_i|)^3 e^{N(\Phi_D - \gamma')}, \tag{L.81}$$

for a fixed $\gamma' > 0$. No infinite sharp-cube charge series is split. All framing and component scalars remain the original ones.

The all-central argument in Sections L.7 and L.8, using the exact Morse source above, supplies a nonzero relative filling asymptotic for every fixed independently signed sufficiently long integer vector $n_i = \epsilon_i - 2p_i$. Appendix O gives the same argument for unchanged simple matched spheres without assuming balance; here balance is used only to restore the complementary source. Its unit critical rate tends to $\Phi_D$ as $\min_i |n_i|$ tends to infinity, with loss $O_D(\sum_i n_i^{-2})$. Choose a diagram-dependent threshold so this loss is less than $\gamma'/2$ and all existing geometric and analytic filling thresholds hold. Then (L.81) is exponentially smaller than the complete all-central asymptotic. Thus

$$\frac{I_{\text{full}}}{I_{\text{cross}}} = 1 + O_{\mathbf{n}}(e^{-c_{\mathbf{n}} N}), \tag{L.82}$$

and

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |I_{\text{full}}| = \text{Vol(the actual smooth filled exterior)}. \tag{L.83}$$

The same conclusion holds after multiplying by the separately recorded original normalization characters and nonzero polynomial-level factors. For the prescribed parity yielding a knot, this is the corresponding full original knot invariant, not a chosen spectral contribution. It does not assert that a given $2k$-plat has minimal bridge number $k$.

The quantifiers are: for this fixed decorated diagram satisfying the balance inequalities, there exists $T(D)$ such that every independently signed fixed filling vector with all $|p_i| \ge T(D)$, in the prescribed parity convention, has (L.82)–(L.83) as $N \to \infty$. No bound on ratios $|p_i|/|p_j|$ is needed. There is no joint growing-twist/level estimate or uniform threshold over different diagrams or widths.

## L.10 The original primitive geometric action

### L.10.1 Primitive geometry on the refined Morse diagram

The geometric verification also uses the actual Morse presentation, not a hidden flat-plat replacement. From the stationary radii, solve the marked line-circle equations with matching inversive distances $\cos(2\pi\delta_e)$. Their Jacobian is invertible by the same finite-face Hessian and elementary triangle motion argument. This gives one common nearby pattern with the original two marked lines.

For each white face let $\mathcal{R}_f^{\pm}$ be its two holomorphic reflection matrices, with $\mathcal{R}_f^{-}\mathcal{R}_f^{+} = I$. At an actual Morse slice with regions $F_0, \dots, F_k$, set

$$H_j = \mathcal{R}^{+}_{F_j}\mathcal{R}^{-}_{F_{j-1}}, \qquad H_j \cdots H_1 = \mathcal{R}^{+}_{F_j}\mathcal{R}^{-}_{F_0}. \tag{L.84}$$

Shared wire ends have the same regions and therefore the same based head. At cups/caps the first and last regions agree, giving the full inverse-pair relation. The prescribed shaded collar sends both ordered input puncture generators to their output generators, while preserving their product $P = BA$. The source-selected eigenvalue is $J = -e^{-2\pi i\delta}$, and the primitive collar ratio is

$$R_0 = E_b E_c / D, \qquad U = -\log R_0 - \epsilon \log(-J), \qquad V = 2\log(-J) = -4\pi i\delta. \tag{L.85}$$

The matrix collar is the regular full divided difference

$$C = I + \frac{R_0 - 1}{J - J^{-1}}(P - J^{-1}I). \tag{L.86}$$

Its value at the parabolic complete point is retained, not replaced by the scalar eigenratio one. The auxiliary meridian follows $C^{-1}$, and the original signed half twist is the full Hurwitz word with $P^{-1} - I$. The ordered contacts, not just traces, fix these choices. The common marked-line limit supplies every zero face case. These are the local identities in deformed circle primitive collar.

Equations (L.84)–(L.86) verify all shared wires, cups/caps, drilled threading and half-twist relations in the actual Morse van Kampen presentation, exactly as in complete core geometric deformation, Section 2. Matching graph cycles introduce no extra free conjugating frame because the reflections were chosen on one global pattern. At zero this is the complete representation of the refined link, from its own cut certificate. Marked positive-gluing rigidity identifies the nearby family as that same geometric germ.

For the ordinary-face stationary action

$$A_\epsilon(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = \operatorname{crit}_{\text{finite faces}} \left\{ \sum_e (Q_{b_e} + Q_{c_e}) - \sum_{f \neq u,v} \log L_f + \pi i \sum_e \epsilon_e \delta_e^2 \right\}, \tag{L.87}$$

the primitive identities give $\partial_e A_\epsilon = U_e$. The complete anchor is the actual augmented volume computed above. The same marked regulator calculation therefore gives

$$2\pi \operatorname{Re} A_\epsilon = \operatorname{Vol}(\rho) - \tfrac{1}{2} \sum_e \operatorname{Im} U_e \operatorname{Re} V_e. \tag{L.88}$$

At the first-charge critical point of the original period (L.38),

$$U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i. \tag{L.89}$$

For independently sufficiently long fixed fillings this is the primitive smooth-filling branch of the actual refined exterior. The boundary term in (L.88) cancels the original Gaussian/linear filling terms exactly. Hence the exponential rate is the volume of that actual filled complement. There is no comparison-diagram substitution and no inference from a formal critical value alone.

## L.11 Completing the actual filled metric

### L.11.1 The precise metric completion theorem used after filling

The authoritative general statement is source regulator hyperbolic equality, Sections 1–5. Let $Y$ be the actual complete finite-volume augmented exterior, with its actual primitive peripheral bases. There is one neighborhood of its complete framed representation such that every representation in that neighborhood with parabolic unfilled peripheral groups and actual small logarithms satisfying

$$U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i. \tag{L.90}$$

is the holonomy of a smooth complete hyperbolic metric on the specified filled exterior. The neighborhood is chosen before the slopes.

Here are the construction and the period check. On a compact truncated core choose a finite lifted partition of unity $\eta_{j,\gamma}$. In the future hyperboloid form

$$Y_\rho(x) = \sum_{j,\gamma} \eta_{j,\gamma}(x)\rho(\gamma)\rho_0(\gamma)^{-1}x, \qquad E_\rho(x) = \frac{Y_\rho(x)}{\sqrt{-\langle Y_\rho(x), Y_\rho(x)\rangle}}. \tag{L.91}$$

The sum is future timelike and equivariant. On a compact fundamental part it is $C^1$-close to the identity, hence an oriented local diffeomorphism for nearby representations.

In a cusp frame sending the selected flag to infinity, write the peripheral affine action as $A_\rho(\lambda)z = a_\lambda z + b_\lambda$ on the original translation lattice $\Lambda$. A smooth periodic partition of unity gives

$$d_\rho(w) = \sum_{\lambda\in\Lambda} \eta(w-\lambda)A_\rho(\lambda)(w-\lambda), \qquad F_\rho(w,t) = (d_\rho(w), e^{t+\chi_\rho(w)}), \tag{L.92}$$

where $\chi_\rho$ is the real-linear extension of $\log|a_\lambda|$. The first map is a positive local diffeomorphism and is exactly affine-equivariant; the second is an equivariant positive local diffeomorphism for the entire cusp tail. It is $C^1$-close to the old development on a compact collar. Geodesic interpolation with (L.91) gives a global developing local diffeomorphism on the original manifold with its ideal ends removed.

At a filled cusp, commuting nontrivial affine multipliers have a common finite fixed point $q = b/(1-a)$. Near the complete representation the original generator translations stay nonzero, so $|q| \to \infty$. The developed fundamental parallelogram and fixed generator paths of $d_\rho$ remain bounded. Hence they miss $q$, and equivariance makes the entire development miss it. On the simply connected link cover set $f = \log(d_\rho - q)$. Its invariant differential gives a complete nonsingular flat metric $|df|^2$ on the compact torus. The lifted local isometry is therefore a global Euclidean development, and its periods form an injective rank-two lattice.

If a fixed generator path has image length at most $L$ inside $|d| \le R$, its logarithmic increment is at most $L/(|q| - R)$, tending to zero. Its exponential is the corresponding peripheral multiplier. Both this increment and the prescribed small multiplier log tend to zero, so their difference, an integral multiple of $2\pi i$, is exactly zero in one fixed neighborhood. The periods are thus the actual $U, V$, before multiplication by any large slope coefficient. This excludes a hidden winding in (L.90).

Translate $q$ to zero. The tail contains an entire equivariant epigraph $y > A|d|$. Put

$$R = \operatorname{arsinh}(|d|/y), \qquad \theta = \operatorname{Im} f, \qquad X = \operatorname{Re} f + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(1 + y^2/|d|^2).$$

Direct substitution gives the hyperbolic tube metric

$$ds^2 = dR^2 + \cosh^2 R\, dX^2 + \sinh^2 R\, d\theta^2. \tag{L.93}$$

The tail contains a full punctured tube. Equation (L.90) gives angular period $-2\pi$ and zero longitudinal period on the primitive meridian. A complementary primitive curve has nonzero real log period, because the log lattice has real rank two. Adding $R = 0$ therefore gives a smooth solid torus, with exactly the original filling slope. Its affine meridian fixes both $q$ and infinity and has multiplier one, so the representation also descends to the filled group.

At an unfilled cusp both multipliers are one. Formula (L.92) then gives a translation-equivariant complete Euclidean link and a full horoball quotient. In our construction the main meridian is noncentral parabolic throughout; its commuting longitude has multiplier one as well. Thus the main cusp remains complete and unfilled. The remainder of the manifold is compact, so the completed metric is finite-volume and complete. Its universal developing local isometry covers $\mathbb{H}^3$, giving discrete faithful holonomy.

The selected first-charge source solution lies in this fixed framed neighborhood once all fixed powers are sufficiently long. The common circle pattern, full collar matrices and selected flags converge to their original complete values; this is stronger than convergence of peripheral traces. Consequently (L.90)–(L.93) identify the actual smooth filled $S^3$ knot complement. The regulator identity then calibrates the source action to that metric's volume. It does not replace the completion argument.

## L.12 Exact reproduction and limits

The script audit_actual_balanced_terminal_fans.py reproduces the polynomial recurrence, rational balance margin, oriented stellar matching and even coset, and literal quarter-turn/stack endpoint pairings. It uses integer and rational arithmetic. It does not test or replace the analytic asymptotic, full source identity or hyperbolic metric proof.

The old and new powers are all independently sufficiently long and fixed before the level. There is no claim for the undecorated core, short core powers, a growing family, or a uniform threshold over different diagrams. No restriction to arborescent cores or prescribed minimum bridge number is used. The actual refined complement is the volume target.

The cyclic matching-source channels remain in the shared coefficient. Their bound uses the true common-radius balance, not a scalar kernel product on a graph with cycles. No moving-main profile, shifted microscopic expansion or annihilator-factor statement is supplied.

# Appendix M

# All orders of the meridian profile under the directed criterion

The directed degree-and-twist criterion gives more than a leading volume limit. For every fixed knot presentation satisfying that criterion, the actual meridian state has an asymptotic expansion to every finite order on the microscopic scale $M = q_N^s$. Its coefficients have a precise polynomial degree bound. This bound allows an exact quantum recurrence to select the preferred geometric meridian–longitude curve of the original knot complement.

The proof expands the actual normalized subtree integrals, retaining their full normal data and endpoint terms. It also works on the fixed translated parameter regions used by the recurrence. These are separate estimates from the previously established first-order profile.

The extension has an operator consequence. For every knot satisfying the directed certificate, the first nonzero classical symbol of every genuine fixed all-level reduced ADO annihilator contains the selected complex geometric meridian–longitude factor. The statement is about that factor, not the full A-polynomial, its multiplicity, or the entire operator ideal.

## M.1 Fixed data and statement

Fix one literal ordered all-circle tree with at least one edge, the original endpoint and orientation types, and its fixed signed powers $n_v$. Its cylindrical closure is required to be one knot, with no component already closed inside a tangle. Fix a root and numbers $0 < c_v < 2^{-16}$ at nonroot vertices satisfying equations (K.3), (K.8), and (K.9) of Appendix K. All this data is independent of the level. There is no new smallness condition on these data in this appendix.

In particular the result covers the sufficient alternative

$$d_v \geq 2^{28} \quad \text{or} \quad |n_v| \geq 2^{27} \quad \text{separately at every vertex,} \tag{M.1}$$

and also the certificates allowed by the more general directed inequalities. The original knot and parity qualifications are unchanged. Both level parities are included.

Use the actual zero-framed reduced state and its pointing:

$$q_N = e^{\pi i/N}, \qquad M = -q_N x = q_N^s, \qquad K_N = F_N(1), \qquad H_N(s) = \frac{\sin \pi s}{N \sin(\pi s/N)}. \tag{M.2}$$

Here $x$ is the raw highest-weight parameter; internal wire variables will instead be denoted $x_e$. Define the normalized full state

$$\mathcal{Z}_N(s) = \frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{K_N H_N(s)}. \tag{M.3}$$

The directed theorem gives $K_N \neq 0$ for every sufficiently large level. The one factor $H_N$ is exactly the conversion between the reduced and full trace, not a freely chosen regularization.

**All-order statement.** Let $K$ be any compact subset of the open upper half-plane. It can have any fixed real extent and can be a finite union of compact disks. For every finite $L$,

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) = \sum_{r=1}^{L} N^{-r} p_r(s) + O_{K,L}(N^{-L-1}), \qquad \deg p_r \le r+1, \tag{M.4}$$

uniformly on $K$, with every prescribed finite number of derivatives on smaller compacts. The same polynomials occur on each original compact $|s| \le R < 1$. If a lower amplitude requires separating the two level parities, (M.4) is understood on each parity subsequence; its top diagonal is identical for both. The logarithm is the branch tending to zero, which is well defined for all sufficiently large levels on each such compact.

The polynomials are selected by the original joint phase, including its first-charge mark. Put

$$\begin{aligned} J'(x) &= \log(2\sin \pi x), \qquad J(0) = 0, \\ \mathcal{K}(x,t) &= 2J(x) - J(x+t) - J(x-t), \\ \Phi_t(X) &= \Phi(X) + \sum_{e \in \mathcal{E}_T} \mathcal{K}(x_e, t) + \frac{\pi i\, a(D)}{2} t^2, \\ a(D) &= -w(D) - \sum_v n_v, \qquad S(t) = \Phi_t(X_*(t)). \end{aligned} \tag{M.5}$$

The set $\mathcal{E}_T$ is the set of original physical quarter-turn edges, $X$ comprises their wire variables and the original circle angles, and $X_*(t)$ is the critical point continued from the selected filled point at $t = 0$. The base phase is

$$\Phi(X) = \sum_{e=vw} \{b(x_e, \tau_v) + b(x_e, \tau_w)\} + \frac{i}{4\pi} \sum_v n_v \tau_v^2 - i \sum_v \tau_v, \tag{M.6}$$

with the logarithms fixed by the original complete chart and first-charge continuation. The top coefficient of $p_r$ is precisely the coefficient of $t^{r+1}$ in $S(t) - S(0)$. The last term in (M.6) must not be omitted.

All constants and starting levels may depend on the fixed tree, signed powers, certificate, compact, derivative order and expansion order. This dependence does not change the finite directed certificate. No uniformity over an unbounded collection of diagrams is asserted.

## M.2 The strict margins that the higher-order proof uses

Retain the notation $a_v, b_v, D_v, A_v, B_v, C_v, y_v, \beta_v, \eta_v$ of equations (K.4)–(K.7) of Appendix K. Its proof supplies the following facts about the actual finite recurrence.

The full edge kernel, including high indices, is

$$\mathscr{K}_N(t,u;s)=\sum_{k=0}^{N-1} e_k(-2\cos t)e_k(-2\cos u)\frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)}. \tag{M.7}$$

It has exact trigonometric degree at most $N-1$ in either angle. There is no discarded term in this definition.

At a nonroot vertex the actual message is the full physical trace of the parent kernel times the child messages, with its original edge scalar. At the root the parent kernel is absent. These are equations (K.29)–(K.30), an ordering of a finite contraction, not a new topological rerooting.

The conditional first-charge saddle is nondegenerate on the parent rectangle. The local exponent has second derivative with real part at most $-(19/20)a_v$, and its complex second derivative has modulus at least $(19/20)|D_v|$. Its physical sine amplitude is nonzero.

Relative to the conditional first charge, all original tail, endpoint, truncation and connector errors have a positive margin at least $\eta_v-\beta_v>0$. Every retained charge $\ell\ge 2$ has the additional margin

$$\frac{190}{441}\frac{a_v}{|D_v|^2}(\ell^2-1)>0. \tag{M.8}$$

The first Fourier coefficient is exactly one, at both parities.

The outgoing real-envelope regeneration has the strictly positive margin $(2^{-16}-c_v)\chi-\beta_v$ whenever an outgoing edge exists. There is no such requirement at the root.

Here the complete basis is $e_k(z)=S_k^{-2}\prod_{j<k}(c_j-z)$, with $S_k=\prod_{r=1}^{k}2\sin(\pi r/N)$, $c_j=2\cos((2j+1)\pi/N)$, and $0\le k<N$. The paired factor is $W_k(s)=\prod_{r=1}^{k}[1-\sin^2(\pi s/N)/\sin^2(\pi r/N)]$. These are the physical fixed-basis coordinates, including their repeated-node data.

For the fixed finite tree, the minimum of any finite list of these positive margins and the one-edge wire-contour margins is positive. When necessary it may be reduced by a fixed factor, leaving room for the $O(N^{-1})$ shifts of endpoints and for slightly nested compact contours. Polynomial factors in $N$ do not use up that margin. The tail contains infinitely many Fourier charges, but its original estimate is a geometric series with ratio bounded by a constant times $e^{-Ny_v}$; it does not require taking a minimum over infinitely many unrelated errors.

The proof of these facts is in Sections K.2–K.6, from its actual full kernel, its normalized real and strip bounds, and the exact translated-grid trace. In particular it does not assume a relative estimate at a very small nonminimal saddle. Each such charge is its local saddle contribution plus an additive error already below the first charge. That distinction remains in the higher-order argument.

## M.3 The same margins on fixed translated charts

Fix a compact $K\subset\{\operatorname{Im} s>0\}$. The actual moving orientation types use $s$ or $-s$; the opposite-order constant type uses its original parameter zero and full normal functional. Only bounded prefactors change in passing from the original disk to these compacts.

### M.3.1 The paired turn factors

Euler's product gives the exact identity

$$W_k(s) = \prod_{\substack{1\le r\le k\\ j\in\mathbb{Z}}} \left(1 - \frac{s^2}{(r+jN)^2}\right), \qquad 0 \le k < N. \tag{M.9}$$

All integers in this product are distinct and nonzero. For bounded $s$, the logarithms of the factors with sufficiently large integer modulus are bounded in absolute value by $C_K/m^2$. The product over the finitely many remaining integers has a positive lower bound on $K \cup (-K)$, since no integer lies there. Consequently every subset product in (M.9), and its inverse, is bounded uniformly in $k, N$. Also $H_N$ and its inverse are bounded there for all sufficiently large $N$, since $H_N$ tends uniformly to the nonzero function $\sin(\pi s)/(\pi s)$.

The proof of the directed rectangle bound uses these factors only through their absolute bounds. Its positivity argument is applied to the complete Newton factors at real angles before this bounded multiplier is inserted. Thus no positivity in $s$ is required. The conditional constant remains the same $\operatorname{Re}\psi(0,u)$, and the real/angular losses and the high-index complement loss are unchanged.

### M.3.2 The actual fixed-power trace and its normal channels

The canonical stripped fixed-power crossing polynomial has the exact interpolation of source-bound (D14):

$$r^{[n]}_{N,\sigma}(z) = -\frac{1}{N(U-U^{-1})} \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \lambda_j(\sigma)^n (t_j - t_j^{-1}) \frac{P_\sigma(z)}{z - c_j(\sigma)}, \quad U = e^{2\pi i\sigma}. \tag{M.10}$$

Here $t_j = q_N^{-2j-1+2\sigma}$, $c_j(\sigma) = t_j + t_j^{-1}$, and $P_\sigma(z) = \mathcal{T}_N(z) + 2\cos(2\pi\sigma)$, where $\mathcal{T}_N(t+t^{-1}) = t^N + t^{-N}$. The quantity $\lambda_j(\sigma) = (-1)^j q_N^{j(j+1)} (q_N^2)^{-\sigma j}$ is the stripped spectral value. The full physical representative is $\kappa_\sigma^n r^{[n]}_{N,\sigma}$, where $\kappa_\sigma = q_N^{(N-1+\sigma)^2/2}$. This common Cartan scalar is retained in the exact ledger, together with the prescribed mixed references.

On $K \cup (-K)$, $|U - U^{-1}|$ has a positive lower bound. The nodes lie in an ellipse of height $O_K(N^{-1})$, and the divided-difference estimates used in the original full-polynomial norm proof are polynomial in $N$ there. The full eigenvalue and carrier scalars have bounded modulus for each fixed signed power, including negative powers. This proves the same polynomial norm bound used in outgoing-envelope regeneration, with its complete Hermite derivatives retained.

For the constant channel $\sigma = 0$, use its original full trace, rather than evaluating an isolated singular summand of (M.10). Equivalently carry a small independent formal $\sigma$ around zero, prove the estimate on a fixed parameter circle avoiding collisions, and apply the maximum principle to the **whole finite trace minus its first-charge expression**. All Fourier coefficients are entire in $\sigma$, and the original physical trace has the proved removable normal value. Cauchy's formula also retains any fixed normal derivative required by the actual channel. The edge parameter $s$ remains independent of this formal normal parameter during this argument. Nothing identifies a constant opposite-color channel with a moving same-color one.

The full complete Hermite norm is the maximum of the values at the distinct complete Casimir nodes and the first derivatives at their double nodes. At odd levels the final node $-2$ is simple and has no derivative coordinate. On canonical representatives of degree strictly less than $N$, this norm, the sup norm on $[-2,2]$ and the Chebyshev coefficient norm differ by polynomial factors. Higher-degree products are first reduced by exact Chebyshev folding. The number of folds at a vertex is fixed by the diagram, and $\cos(2\pi\sigma)$ is bounded on the chosen parameter compacts. Thus (K.47) and the real-envelope patch remain valid. Their powers of $N$ and constants can increase, but their exponential terms do not.

### M.3.3 Grid translations, endpoint currents and tails

Use the exact single-grid contour from the direct-crossing trace, not a periodic version of its chirp. A fixed $\sigma$ shifts the grid and its endpoint rectangle by $2\pi\sigma/N$. The latter displacement is $O_K(N^{-1})$. At a translated vertical side the exact grid kernel is the same elementary expression

$$\frac{iNe^{-Nv}}{1+e^{-Nv}}. \tag{M.11}$$

Thus the existing endpoint estimate applies there with at most a bounded exponential prefactor. The real interval and the retained local contours can be returned to the original ones with their connecting currents kept. Their locations are within $O_K(N^{-1})$ of the original endpoint or fixed local connector and hence retain a fixed part of the original gap.

For $s \mapsto s+j$, reindex the central entries and explicitly retain the bounded number of wrapped entries near $\pm\pi$. The chirp is not periodic; its wrapped values cannot be discarded by declaring the grids identical. Their exact factors are bounded on the fixed compact and the original endpoint action loss applies.

The paired charges have coefficients

$$c_{\ell,N}(\sigma) = (-1)^{(N-1)(\ell-1)} U_{\ell-1}(\cos 2\pi\sigma), \qquad c_{1,N}=1, \quad |c_{\ell,N}(\sigma)| \le \ell e^{2\pi|\operatorname{Im}\sigma|(\ell-1)}. \tag{M.12}$$

For each vertex, the extra fixed exponential in $\ell$ is absorbed in $e^{-N\ell y_v}$ once $N$ is large. The finite set of retained charges remains subject to (M.8). The endpoint and zero-mode currents are those of the original finite trace. All the bounds are conditional on the parent angle on its compact rectangle, not only at its eventual saddle.

It follows by the exact same normalized subtree induction that the directed first-order theorem, its nonzero conditional first charge, its real/strip envelopes and all the fixed exponential errors hold on $K$, with unchanged certificate. This statement follows from the finite source on $K$. It is not analytic continuation of an asymptotic estimate proved elsewhere.

## M.4 Arbitrary-order edge and conditional saddle expansions

The canonical interpolation is

$$G_N(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{N}\right)^z \Gamma(z+1) \prod_{j\ge 1} \frac{\Gamma(Nj+z+1)}{\Gamma(Nj-z)(Nj)^{2z+1}}. \tag{M.13}$$

It satisfies, with the fixed normalization,

$$G_N(k) = S_k, \qquad G_N(z)G_N(N-1-z) = N, \qquad G_N(s)G_N(-s) = H_N(s)^{-1}. \tag{M.14}$$

The midpoint $(N-1)/2$, rather than $N/2$, remains in the exact Newton interpolation. In the bulk, every prescribed finite Stirling expansion gives

$$\log G_N(Nx) = NJ(x) + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(2N\sin\pi x) + \sum_{j=1}^{L} N^{-j} b_j(x) + O(N^{-L-1}). \tag{M.15}$$

This holds with any fixed number of derivatives on smaller complex bulk compacts. To justify summation in (M.13), take sufficiently many terms in the finite periodic-Bernoulli remainder for the Gamma factors. On a fixed bulk compact their arguments remain in a common right-half-plane sector. The remainder of the $j$-th product factor is bounded by $C_L N^{-L-1} j^{-L-1}$, taking extra terms first when necessary for summability. The remaining finite number of factors is controlled in the same sector. Cauchy estimates give the derivatives. This proves every requested finite order; it assumes no convergence of the asymptotic series.

The exact circle Newton interpolant is

$$\mathcal{E}_N(x,\tau) = \frac{G_N(d/2+u)G_N(d/2-u)}{G_N(d/2-Nx+u)G_N(d/2-Nx-u)G_N(Nx)^2}, \qquad d = N-1, \quad u = \frac{N\tau}{2\pi}. \tag{M.16}$$

At $x = k/N$, this equals $e_k(-2\cos\tau)$. The exact edge multiplier is

$$\frac{H_N(s)}{W_k(s)} = \frac{G_N(k)^2}{G_N(k-s)G_N(k+s)}. \tag{M.17}$$

The reflection and the factor $H_N^{-1}$ in (M.14) fix the normalization in (M.17). Inverting that relation would insert an incorrect extra cut factor.

On the directed local angle rectangle the edge critical wire remains in a fixed complex neighborhood of the real interval $(1/5, 3/10)$, away from every factorial endpoint. Equations (M.15)–(M.17), the exact primitive wire contour and its endpoint currents therefore give an all-order version of (K.28):

$$\mathscr{K}_N(t,u;s) = N^{-3/2} e^{N\psi(t,u)} a_e(t,u) \left[1 + \sum_{j=1}^{L} N^{-j} k_{e,j}(t,u,s) + O_{K,L}(N^{-L-1})\right]. \tag{M.18}$$

The leading $a_e$ is the original nonzero amplitude and is independent of $s$. The coefficients and remainder are holomorphic in both angle variables and $s$, with fixed derivative estimates on smaller compacts. The complementary wires, finite lattice currents and local-contour endpoints have the same fixed exponential losses as before; they are smaller than every requested relative power after comparison with the local saddle.

For clarity, the all-order step in (M.18) can be carried out without citing a formal stationary-phase principle as an estimate. On the deformed local contour the real part of the exponent falls quadratically away from the selected saddle. Restrict to a fixed neighborhood, use the

analytic Taylor series of the phase and amplitude to any desired finite order, put the centered variable equal to $N^{-1/2}$ times a new variable, and integrate the resulting Gaussian moments. Split that neighborhood at a shrinking radius $N^{-\epsilon}$, choosing sufficiently many Taylor terms for the requested order. Outside the shrinking neighborhood the quadratic bound is exponentially small; inside, the analytic Taylor remainder is dominated by an integrable Gaussian times its required power. Odd Gaussian moments vanish and the common half-power is already displayed in $N^{-3/2}$. The same proof with the one-dimensional physical trace contour gives its $N^{3/2}$ factor and all relative orders. All these estimates are uniform on the fixed parameter compacts, because the saddle, inverse Hessian and nonzero leading amplitude remain on compact sets.

The integral of the absolute local Gaussian amplitude divided by the absolute value of its leading complex Gaussian integral is bounded uniformly on such compacts. The bound can depend on the fixed degree and signed twist. It is not asserted to be a universal constant across all trees. This is sufficient to integrate a uniform relative remainder without amplifying it by an exponential factor.

## M.5 All-order normalized message induction

We strengthen (K.32), keeping the same limiting phase and leading amplitude. For every requested $L$, at every nonroot vertex,

$$\frac{M_{v,N}(u;s)}{M_{v,N}(0;s)} = e^{Nh_v(u)}\frac{\alpha_v(u)}{\alpha_v(0)}\left[1+\sum_{j=1}^{L} N^{-j}a_{v,j}(u,s)+O_{K,L}(N^{-L-1})\right]. \tag{M.19}$$

The coefficients may and do have zero normalized value at $u=0$. The remainder and any prescribed finite derivative are uniform on smaller parent compacts. The exact complex denominator is retained; it is not replaced by an absolute estimate or by a presumed asymptotic scalar. The leading amplitude is nonzero and independent of $s$ after the exact outside physical scalars have been separated.

For a terminal vertex, insert (M.18) into its exact full trace. The first charge has coefficient one by (M.12); its sine and Gaussian factors are nonzero. Expand that conditional first-charge integral to the requested order. The estimates in Sections M.2–M.3 bound the entire remainder of the trace below the first charge by a fixed exponential factor. Evaluating also at $u=0$ and dividing the two expansions proves (M.19), and proves nonvanishing of the exact denominator for sufficiently large levels.

Suppose (M.19) holds for the children of $v$. Divide each exact child by its exact value at zero in the actual recurrence before making any approximation. The finite product of their expansions has every prescribed relative order. Its normalized leading amplitude has no zero, so the logarithm of this product, with the normalization fixed at zero, has an expansion of the same order. This is an ordinary finite algebraic operation on asymptotic series with a uniformly invertible leading term.

In the conditional first-charge integral retain the limiting child phases in $A_v^{\mathrm{loc}}$; place all higher logarithmic terms in the analytic amplitude. Equivalently one can perturb the conditional saddle by $O(N^{-1})$, but no such perturbation is needed to estimate the remainder. The local absolute-to-leading Gaussian bound proved above shows that a uniform relative $O(N^{-L-1})$ input error contributes a relative $O(N^{-L-1})$ output error. Expand the new local

amplitude and phase to a sufficiently high finite order and integrate. Division by the expansion at parent angle zero gives (M.19) at $v$.

Outside that conditional saddle, do not insert a truncated child expansion. Use the exact normalized real and strip estimates already proved on $K$ in §3. They are precisely what controls the full charge tail, original endpoint currents and complementary contour portions. This prevents a local asymptotic remainder from being used as a global source bound. The finitely many nonminimal charges need only their existing bound below the first charge; expanding them to every order is unnecessary.

All fixed derivatives are obtained on nested rectangles by Cauchy estimates, or by starting with sufficiently many orders and differentiating the local integral. Since the tree is fixed and every inequality has a strict margin, a finite nested system of slightly larger local compacts can be chosen. The real/strip bounds used for tails are those of the exact messages; they do not shrink with the order. Possible large constants in the coefficients only increase the level from which the estimate holds. They do not change any certificate inequality.

At the root the same induction applies with no parent kernel and no outgoing envelope. Restore the exact child values at zero recursively. Their actions add at their selected conditional saddles, giving the original joint action (M.6); they are not separately replaced by subtree volumes. The scalar restoration is the original exact ledger

$$A_N(s) = q_N^{a(D)s^2/2}, \qquad a(D) = -w(D) - \sum_v n_v, \tag{M.20}$$

with the single reduced cut $H_N$ left outside. Same-color chirps, opposite-order references, turn gammas, closing and writhe factors are each counted once, as in the exact-scalar theorem. All $s$-independent phases and powers of $N$ cancel in the ratio (M.3). In particular there is no unspecified $s$-dependent oscillating subtree constant in (M.19).

Every complete edge contributes $N^{-3/2}$ and every trace contributes $N^{3/2}$; the tree relation leaves the same total $N^{3/2}$. The leading coefficient is nonzero. Thus the actual normalized whole source has an all-order expansion on the original disk and on $K$. This proves existence and uniform remainder estimates; the next section identifies the polynomial degree filtration, which does not follow merely from existence.

## M.6 Why the coefficients have the required degree filtration

At a retained physical edge the only remaining microscopic dependence, apart from (M.20), is the exact factor (M.17). Put $\delta = N^{-1}$ and introduce an auxiliary independent parameter $t$. Applying (M.15) to (M.17), before substituting $t = \delta s$, gives

$$\log \mathcal{I}_N(x,s) = \delta^{-1}\mathcal{K}(x,t) + B_0(x,t) + \sum_{j=1}^{L} \delta^j B_j(x,t) + O(\delta^{L+1}), \qquad t = \delta s. \tag{M.21}$$

The $B_j$ are holomorphic near $t = 0$, are even in $t$, and vanish there. Terms in $\log N$ cancel. An original offset $x = \ell(X) + \delta c$, including the midpoint offsets from $d = N - 1$, contributes $c\mathcal{K}_x$ to $B_0$ and holomorphic further terms to the lower amplitudes; it does not change the leading phase in (M.5).

To organize all orders, replace (M.17) in the **local first-charge integral** by its canonical interpolation with $s = Nt$, for sufficiently small independent $t$. All its factorial arguments then remain in the same complex bulk domain. This defines a local analytic family whose phase is exactly $\Phi_t$ in (M.5). It is not an assertion about the physical source with $s$ growing like $N$: no global or tail estimate for that regime is used. Global errors have already been controlled for bounded physical $s$. The auxiliary family organizes the local coefficients, and its restriction $t = s/N$ reproduces the actual local source exactly.

The full Hessian of $\Phi$ is invertible. Indeed the wire Hessians in each edge contour are invertible. After eliminating them, each successive angular conditional Hessian is invertible by the bound in §2. The determinant identity for a block Schur complement therefore gives invertibility of the original joint Hessian. This also identifies the joint critical point and the phase independently of the order of finite contractions. The analytic implicit-function theorem gives $X_*(t)$ for small $t$, with all logarithms and first-charge marks retained.

Expansion of this local analytic family to arbitrary finite order gives holomorphic coefficient germs $C_j(t)$ such that

$$\log \mathcal{Z}_N(s) \sim N\{S(s/N) - S(0)\} + \sum_{j\geq 0} N^{-j}\{C_j(s/N) - C_j(0)\}. \tag{M.22}$$

One may perform the Gaussian expansions edge by edge and vertex by vertex, as in Section M.5, or jointly. These are the same coefficients: at any finite order they are finite Gaussian moments of the same Taylor polynomial; iterated Gaussian integration and Schur complementation give the same moments. Absolute Gaussian domination justifies the uniform remainders in either computation. Thus (M.22) identifies the coefficients of the actual normalized induction, not those of an independently postulated effective phase.

For each fixed truncation order, Taylor-expand the holomorphic functions in (M.22) in $t$, then put $t = s/N$. Terms from $N(S - S(0))$ have degree $r + 1$ at order $N^{-r}$; terms from all $C_j - C_j(0)$ have degree at most $r$. The even phase has $S'(0) = 0$, so no order-zero nonconstant term occurs. This proves (M.4) and its top-diagonal assertion, with uniform remainders on every fixed $K$. Since every discarded term has a fixed exponential gap, its polynomial prefactor and any fixed derivative are smaller than the requested $N^{-L-1}$ order.

This argument also shows that the expansions on the disk and on all translated compacts have the same coefficients. They come from the same canonical local family and original scalar, not from continuing an asymptotic estimate across the resonances. Since $\mathcal{Z}_N(s) \to 1$ uniformly on each compact, its logarithm tending to zero is uniquely fixed for large $N$.

## M.7 The actual marked geometric germ for the new certificates

The analytic extension does not replace the geometric part of the directed theorem. Its certificate gives

$$\sqrt{d_v^2 + n_v^2} = 2\pi|D_v| \geq 2\pi\, 2^{15} > 630 \tag{M.23}$$

at every vertex. The vertexwise geometric theorem supplies the positive ordered charge path with the original odd seams, primitive disk curves and the original main cusp unfilled. Back-substitution of the conditional first-charge roots places every angle in the common small-angular uniqueness polydisk; it is therefore the same path's endpoint, not merely a

solution of exponentiated equations. This is Section K.7, including its explicit backwards restoration.

With $Q_v = e^{i\tau_v}$, the primitive equations are

$$U_v + p_v V_v = -2\pi i, \qquad V_v = 2\log Q_v, \qquad n_v = \epsilon_v - 2p_v. \tag{M.24}$$

Along the continued charge path the constant on the right is $-2\pi ic$. It is the linear term in (M.6). The positive endpoint has $\operatorname{Im}\tau_v < 0$, so $Q_v^2 \neq 1$. A filling word commutes with this semisimple longitude; its eigenvalue ratio is one by (M.24), so it is projectively the identity. The representation therefore factors through the actual filled knot group on a neighborhood of the selected point.

The local rational reconstruction and longitude theorem are algebraic statements on the full source branch; they do not require the old summed or maximum-based analytic inequality. The new directed case supplies exactly their required anchor: the actual positive filled holonomy at $M = 1$, the continued primitive logarithms, and the nondegenerate source critical point. The implicit branch of (M.5) consequently reconstructs a meridian-varying branch of representations of the filled group. Section I.5.1 proves the required local uniqueness on the retained positive augmented triangulation, using the main meridian and the original primitive filling slopes as peripheral coordinates. Its shape–representation inverse and the distinct auxiliary longitude eigenvalues identify the constrained germ with the actual filled-group germ. This identifies the source branch with the geometric meridian germ without a new triangulation of the filled manifold. The negative longitude lift at its complete point is fixed by the once-bordered Seifert-frame calculation, not by a cusp tangent or a quantum normalization guess.

For this branch the exact identity is

$$L_{\mathrm{geom}}(M) = -M^{a(D)} \prod_{e\in\mathcal{E}_T} \frac{M^2 - X_e(M)}{1 - M^2 X_e(M)}, \qquad X_e = e^{2\pi i x_e}, \tag{M.25}$$

on the preferred longitude and the declared $M$ eigenline, equivalently the inverse value on the source $M^{-1}$ line. This is the geometric theorem's complete filled-germ statement; it does not require extending positive ideal tetrahedra through every algebraic value of $M$.

Differentiating a stationary value differentiates only the explicit parameter. The sine identity in (M.5), with its logarithm zero at $t = 0$, gives

$$e^{\mathcal{K}_t(x,t)} = \frac{M^2 - X}{1 - M^2 X}, \qquad M = e^{\pi i t}. \tag{M.26}$$

Set $h = \log q$, $u = \log M$, and

$$\mathcal{S}(u) = \pi i\{S(u/(\pi i)) - S(0)\}. \tag{M.27}$$

Then (M.25)–(M.26) give $-e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)} = L_{\mathrm{geom}}(e^u)$ as an identity of holomorphic germs, not just to second order. The original first-charge and filling mark select this germ among the solutions of the rational edge and vertex equations.

### M.7.1 The preferred-cusp first correction

The analytic family in (M.5) is even in $t$. Its selected critical point is therefore even, by uniqueness of the analytic implicit branch. The exact interpolated edge amplitude and scalar

are even as well. Every stationary coefficient $C_j(t)$ can consequently be chosen even. At order $N^{-1}$, (M.22) has only

$$p_1(s) = \tfrac{1}{2}S''(0)s^2 : \tag{M.28}$$

normalization eliminates a constant, the evenness eliminates the possible linear contribution $C_0'(0)s$, and all other lower amplitudes begin at order $N^{-2}$. Thus this coefficient is not identified merely by its highest polynomial degree.

On the preferred geometric germ, the cusp shape is $\tau_K = \frac{d}{du}\log[-L_{\mathrm{geom}}(e^u)]\Big|_{u=0}$. Equations (M.25)–(M.27) give $S''(0) = \pi i \tau_K$. Restoring the exact original framing, already included in $a(D)$, yields for every directed case

$$\frac{F_N(q_N^s)}{K_N H_N(s)} = 1 + \frac{\pi i\, \tau_K s^2}{2N} + O_K(N^{-2}). \tag{M.29}$$

This is uniform on each fixed compact used above and on each $|s| \le R < 1$, with the same geometric cusp shape of the original filled knot complement. In particular no additional unrecorded linear or constant scalar is left in the first correction. The exponential passage from the logarithm changes only order $N^{-2}$ and higher.

## M.8 Consequence for every genuine all-level annihilator

Let $r_P$ be a fixed nonnegative integer, independent of $N$, and let

$$P(q, M, T) = \sum_{j=0}^{r_P} a_j(q, M) T^j, \qquad TM = qMT, \tag{M.30}$$

be a specified nonzero fixed operator with coefficients in $\mathbb{C}(q, M)$ which annihilates the actual whole reduced function $F_N(M)$ at every sufficiently large level. Negative shifts can first be removed by multiplying by a power of $T$. Clear fixed rational denominators and remove the common $q-1$ valuation. Let $P_0(M, L) \neq 0$ be the resulting first classical symbol. This hypothesis is the genuine all-level source equation; an equation fitted to complete values or to finitely many jets is not enough. The existence of such fixed operators is proved by the finite-sum annihilator theorem, with its boundary terms retained.

The full modified dimension is

$$d_N(M) = \eta_N \frac{M - M^{-1}}{M^N - M^{-N}}, \qquad d_N(1) = \eta_N/N, \qquad \eta_N = i^{N+3}. \tag{M.31}$$

It satisfies $d_N(q_N^s)/d_N(1) = H_N(s)^{-1}$. For $f(M) = M - M^{-1}$, the exact reduced-to-full gauge is

$$\widetilde{P} = \sum_{j=0}^{r_P} a_j(q, M)(-1)^j \frac{f(M)}{f(q^j M)} T^j. \tag{M.32}$$

Indeed $H_N(s+j)/H_N(s) = (-1)^j f(M)/f(q_N^j M)$. After multiplying on the left by $\prod_{j=1}^{r_P} f(q^j M)$, its first classical symbol is

$$f(M)^{r_P} P_0(M, -L). \tag{M.33}$$

The meridian divisor and sign character remain in the calculation.

Choose a small upper-half-plane disk $D$ and apply (M.4) to the compact union of the required translates $D, D+1, \dots, D+r_P$, slightly enlarged for coefficient estimates. The exact root equation (M.32), after division by the nonzero $\mathcal{Z}_N$, makes every coefficient of its asymptotic expansion vanish on $D$. Clearing denominators as above makes these coefficient identities polynomial in $s$; they therefore hold identically.

Regrade the filtered series using $u = hs$. The inequality $\deg p_r \le r + 1$ gives exactly

$$\log \mathcal{Z} \iff h^{-1}\mathcal{S}(u) + \sum_{j \ge 0} h^j A_j(u), \tag{M.34}$$

with no other negative power of $h$. The finite difference under $u \mapsto u + jh$ has no negative power; its constant coefficient is $j\mathcal{S}'(u)$. Thus the formal shift ratio has constant term $e^{j\mathcal{S}'(u)}$.

Here this change of variables is a statement about formal coefficients, not an asymptotic estimate for an unbounded physical parameter. If $B(h,u) = \sum_{a,b\ge 0} B_{a,b} h^a u^b$, then

$$[h^n s^b] B(h, hs) = \begin{cases} B_{n-b,b}, & 0 \le b \le n, \\ 0, & b > n. \end{cases}$$

For each $n$ only finitely many pairs $(a,b)$ occur. Moreover, $B_{a,b} = [h^{a+b}s^b]B(h,hs)$, so substitution is injective.

This recovery uses every order. More precisely, two substituted series agree through order $h^L$ if and only if their original coefficients agree for every pair $a, b$ with $a + b \le L$. The forward implication reads the coefficient of $h^{a+b}s^b$; the reverse implication uses the displayed formula. For example, the nonzero series $h^{L+1}$ is invisible through order $h^L$. Thus no fixed finite jet would justify the following argument. The coefficient recovery, its injectivity, and this finite-order distinction are checked in `formal/VolumeLogic/FormalRegrading.lean`.

Apply this to the denominator-cleared operator expression built from (M.34) and its finite shift ratios. That expression belongs to $\mathbb{C}[[h,u]]$, and its substitution is exactly the already vanishing coefficient series. It therefore vanishes before substitution. Taking its constant $h$-coefficient gives

$$f(e^u)^{r_P} P_0(e^u, -e^{\mathcal{S}'(u)}) = 0. \tag{M.35}$$

The formal series ring is a domain and $f(e^u)^{r_P}$ is nonzero, so it can be canceled in this proved identity. This does not discard a peripheral component from the original operator. Equations (M.25)–(M.27) identify the remaining germ as the actual geometric eigenvalue germ.

Evaluation on that germ defines a nonzero prime in $\mathbb{C}[M^{\pm 1}, L^{\pm 1}]$, since it contains $P_0$. It contains no nonzero polynomial in $M$ alone because the meridian varies on an open disk. Hence it has height one and is generated by one irreducible Laurent polynomial $A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}$. Consequently

$$A_{\mathrm{geom},\mathbb{C}}(M,L) \mid P_0(M,L). \tag{M.36}$$

For an operator over $\mathbb{Q}(q,M)$, contract the same prime to $\mathbb{Q}[M^{\pm 1}, L^{\pm 1}]$. It is again a nonzero height-one prime, with an irreducible generator dividing $P_0$ over $\mathbb{Q}$. Its complex

factorization contains the selected component and whatever conjugate components the rational field requires. This does not assert that the selected complex component is itself defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

The evenness of the selected phase also gives the same reciprocal selected germ as in the existing filtered theorem. No new statement about multiplicities, equality with the full A-polynomial, or equality of operator ideals follows. There is no uniform nonvanishing claim across ordinary resonances and no physical fixed-$M \neq 1$ quantum asymptotic obtained by replacing bounded $s$ by a quantity of order $N$.

## M.9 Proof dependencies and scope

The directed finite-source theorem supplies the following inputs:

1. Equations (K.13)–(K.16), (K.17), (K.29)–(K.30): actual basis, full Frobenius functional, complete metric, physical turn, and exact finite recurrence. These fix types, normals and the outside scalar.

2. Equations (K.18)–(K.28): full edge complement, conditional rectangle estimate, actual local wire contour and nonzero leading edge amplitude. Extending the compact changes only bounded $H/W$ factors.

3. Equations (K.31)–(K.41): normalized conditional phase, its Hessian and Schur complement, first-charge drop and strict separation of retained charges.

4. Equations (K.42)–(K.47): actual full-input strip estimate, exact charge coefficient, tail/endpoint/current bounds, and outgoing-envelope regeneration. These estimates are applied to exact messages outside the local saddle at every asymptotic order.

5. Equations (K.48)–(K.50): backward restoration of the same joint critical point, common small-angular charge-path anchor and actual filled geometry.

The exact interpolation theorem and regular-circle calculation, Section 10 of that source, fix (M.13)–(M.17), including all midpoint and reflection factors. The direct-crossing trace, Sections 2–4 of that source, fixes the finite translated grids and their endpoint currents. The full source bounds, (D9)–(D14), supply the full polynomial norm used in regeneration, including constant normal channels; the extension to compact nonreal parameters is checked in Section M.3 above. The exact scalar calculation fixes (M.20) and the one reduced cut.

The filtered characteristic theorem supplies the algebraic organization of the canonical insertion and the Ore gauge. Its analytic hypotheses for the directed certificate are proved here: Sections M.3–M.5 give every finite asymptotic order on the required charts with a uniform remainder, and Section M.6 identifies those actual coefficients with the joint two-parameter insertion. The published first-order profile alone is not used as a substitute for either step.

Finally the geometric-characteristic theorem, Sections 5–10 of that source, supplies the marked reconstructed branch and the preferred longitude, with its Section 5 complete filled-point anchor checked in Section M.7 above for the new certificate. The positive geometric path depends on (M.23), not on the older summed or maximum-based source criterion. Thus no old analytic class restriction is silently used to identify the new source branch.

All work in this appendix is for the actual fixed finite tree. It does not give a multi-boundary replacement theorem for arbitrary short-power islands, nor an automatic result for a graph with cycles. Those would require their own conditional source estimates.

# Appendix N

# Uniform bounds for inserting twist powers

The finite formula for a diagram can be organized in two steps. First, take the prescribed coefficient in its shared face variables. This gives a polynomial $S_N$ in one spectral variable for each crossing region. Then apply a linear functional in each spectral variable to insert the chosen signed twist power.

This appendix bounds the second step. Inserting $n$ crossings costs at most $1 + |n|/2$ in the supremum norm on the real spectral interval, independently of the quantum level $N$. There is a stronger estimate for the two one-sided pieces of the local polynomial: their values vanish at all spectral nodes, and the cost is then at most $(N-1)/N$, independently of $n$ as well. The derivatives at repeated nodes remain in the calculation.

The estimate applies after the face coefficient has been taken. All crossing regions therefore retain their common face constraints. To obtain a volume theorem from it, one must still bound this shared polynomial and prove that the geometric contribution survives.

Here is the precise statement. Let $N \geq 2$, $d = N - 1$, $q = e^{\pi i/N}$, and let $\mathcal{L}_N^n$ be the full-Hermite functional for the actual crossing power $R^n$, with $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, defined below. For a polynomial $H$ of degree at most $d$,

$$|\mathcal{L}_N^n H| \leq \left(1 + \frac{|n|}{2}\right) \|H\|_{[-2,2]}. \tag{N.1}$$

If $H$ vanishes at every root of $\chi_N(z) = 2T_N(z/2) + 2$, including the simple root $-2$ when $N$ is odd, the stronger bound is

$$|\mathcal{L}_N^n H| \leq \frac{d}{N} \|H\|_{[-2,2]}. \tag{N.2}$$

Vanishing means values only; the derivatives at double roots are retained.

For $r$ crossing regions, let $S(\sigma_1, \ldots, \sigma_r)$ have degree at most $d$ in each variable. Suppose that for every $e$ in a set $J$, $S$ vanishes whenever $\sigma_e$ is a spectral node, with its other variables arbitrary. Then

$$\left| \left( \bigotimes_{e=1}^{r} \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e} \right) S \right| \leq \left(\frac{d}{N}\right)^{|J|} \prod_{e \notin J} \left(1 + \frac{|n_e|}{2}\right) \|S\|_{[-2,2]^r}. \tag{N.3}$$

In particular this applies to each term containing a specified lower or upper one-sided factor, with $J$ its one-sided crossing regions. The case $J = \varnothing$ is the full-source bound.

There is also a bound for the whole complementary source without expanding it into sectors. Let $\mathcal{D}(\sigma_1,\dots,\sigma_r)$ have degree at most $d = N-1$ in each variable. If $\mathcal{D}$ vanishes on the Cartesian product of all spectral node sets, then

$$\left|\left(\bigotimes_{e=1}^{r}\mathcal{L}_N^{n_e}\right)\mathcal{D}\right| \le \left\{\prod_e\left(1+\frac{|n_e|}{2}\right)-\prod_e\left(\frac{1}{N}+\frac{|n_e|}{2}\right)\right\}\|\mathcal{D}\|_{[-2,2]^r}. \tag{N.4}$$

For the actual numerator one may take $\mathcal{D} = S_{\mathrm{full}} - S_{\mathrm{C}}$, where $S_{\mathrm{C}}$ retains the central piece at every crossing region (defined in Section O.1.1). The coefficient in braces has degree at most $r-1$ in the quantities $|n_e|$: the highest product cancels exactly. None of (N.1)–(N.4) assumes positivity of spectral coefficients, asymptotic localization, or dominance of a Fourier charge.

## N.1 The exact source and its normalization

Use the original pair Casimir $\Omega$, not an operator reconstructed from its spectral values. It satisfies $\chi_N(\Omega) = 0$, and polynomial division gives the degree-$d$ resolvent numerator

$$V_N(z;\Omega) = \chi_N(z)(z-\Omega)^{-1}. \tag{N.5}$$

The right side means the resulting matrix polynomial, including at every spectral node. It is not the determinant adjugate of the full $N^2$-dimensional matrix.

The original homogeneous face source associates to (N.5) a four-face polynomial $H_V(x,b,c,y;z)$, with literal input/output middle faces $b,c$. Fix a connected original diagram at $N \ge 3$, with its actual cups, caps, unrestricted marked cap, protected face targets, and every ordered box. The applications include connected flat plats and the connected matched simple-sphere Morse diagrams of the general Morse source theorem, §§1,5–6, and the terminal-fan source proof, §§5–7. For the latter, the actual cyclic orders and crossing-disk frames are retained, and the marked main edge determines the two protected faces. The exact coefficient identity is the only input here: no complete-radius balance or geometric certificate is required for this finite norm estimate. The shared spectral polynomial is

$$S_N(\boldsymbol{\sigma}) = \left[\textstyle\prod_{f\ \text{ordinary}} L_f^{d}\right]\prod_{e=1}^{r} H_V(L_{x_e},L_{b_e},L_{c_e},L_{y_e};\sigma_e), \tag{N.6}$$

with the two protected face exponents zero. Every variable $\sigma_e$ has degree at most $d$. The original marked source after inserting the signed powers is exactly

$$Z_N(\boldsymbol{n}) = \left(\bigotimes_{e=1}^{r}\mathcal{L}_N^{n_e}\right)S_N. \tag{N.7}$$

The face-grid factors, cup/cap factors and the original $N^{-1}$ marked scalar have already canceled as in those source theorems; there is no additional $N^r$ in (N.7). Thus $Z_N$ is the original reduced ribbon contraction. Conversion to the prescribed zero-framed enhanced Kashaev convention uses the recorded framing/component character, of modulus one at complete color; for a knot the enhanced component sign is one. In the specified full one-cut modified convention, retain the additional factor $i^{N+3}/N$. Original exterior Cartan and framing factors remain in their prescribed locations throughout. These are the physical normalization choices; no new quantum dimension or color average is introduced by the norm theorem.

The polynomial degree and the identities (N.5)–(N.7), rather than a hypothesis about arbitrary polynomial solutions of a recurrence, are the source assumptions used here. The scalar inequalities (N.1)–(N.4) themselves hold for every polynomial of the indicated degree and every $N \geq 2$.

## N.2 Why the polynomial reduction is well defined

Before using the particular spectral roots, we record the algebraic fact behind reduction at repeated roots. It explains which parts of the calculation depend only on the polynomial and which still require the original crossing operator.

Let $R$ be a commutative ring with identity, and let $r_1, \dots, r_m \in R$, with $m \geq 1$. Repetitions are allowed. Put $p(X) = \prod_{j=1}^{m}(X - r_j)$. Given $f \in R[X]$, define $f_0 = f$ and successively define $f_j$ by

$$f_{j-1}(X) = f_{j-1}(r_j) + (X - r_j)f_j(X), \qquad 1 \leq j \leq m.$$

Each $f_j$ is obtained by synthetic division. This is a polynomial operation: it uses no inverse in $R$, even if two roots coincide. Define

$$\mathcal{R}_p f(X) = \sum_{j=1}^{m} f_{j-1}(r_j) \prod_{i<j}(X - r_i), \qquad \ell_p(f) = [X^{m-1}]\mathcal{R}_p f.$$

Here $[X^k]$ means the coefficient of $X^k$, and an empty product is one.

**Proposition N.1** (Canonical polynomial remainder)**.** *The polynomial $\mathcal{R}_p f$ is the unique polynomial of degree less than $m$ for which $f - \mathcal{R}_p f$ is a multiple of $p$. Consequently it is independent of the ordering of the root list, including repeated entries. Both $\mathcal{R}_p$ and $\ell_p$ are $R$-linear, and adding a multiple of $p$ to their input leaves their values unchanged. Moreover,*

$$\ell_p(f) = f_{m-1}(r_m).$$

*Among additive functionals on $R[X]$, $\ell_p$ is uniquely specified by the two requirements*

$$F(pq) = 0 \quad \textit{for every } q \in R[X], \qquad F(r) = [X^{m-1}]r \quad \textit{whenever } \deg r < m.$$

*Proof.* Substituting each synthetic-division identity into the preceding one gives $f = pf_m + \mathcal{R}_p f$. Every summand in the displayed remainder has degree at most $m - 1$. If two such remainders existed, their difference would have degree less than $m$ and would be a multiple of the monic polynomial $p$. A nonzero multiple $pq$ has degree $m + \deg q$: its leading coefficient is the leading coefficient of $q$, because that of $p$ is one. This argument works even when $R$ has zero divisors. The difference must therefore vanish.

Uniqueness proves independence of root order, linearity and invariance under adding a multiple of $p$. In the Newton expression for the remainder, only the last summand can contribute to $X^{m-1}$; its product of linear factors is monic. This proves the formula for $\ell_p$. Finally, any additive $F$ with the two stated properties satisfies

$$F(f) = F(pf_m) + F(\mathcal{R}_p f) = [X^{m-1}]\mathcal{R}_p f = \ell_p(f).$$

□

For two equal roots this construction gives

$$\mathcal{R}_{(X-r)^2} f(X) = f(r) + f'(r)(X-r), \qquad \ell_{(X-r)^2}(f) = f'(r).$$

The derivative is the formal polynomial derivative. Thus repeated roots retain derivative information; replacing them by a single evaluation changes the operation.

**Proposition N.2** (Products and repeated-root derivatives)**.** *For any $f, g \in R[X]$,*

$$\mathcal{R}_p(fg) = \mathcal{R}_p\big((\mathcal{R}_p f)(\mathcal{R}_p g)\big), \qquad \ell_p(fg) = \ell_p\big((\mathcal{R}_p f)(\mathcal{R}_p g)\big).$$

*Consequently a finite product may be reduced after each multiplication, with the same final remainder and coefficient functional. This reduced multiplication is associative. If $r$ occurs at least twice among the roots of $p$, the final remainder retains both $(fg)(r)$ and*

$$(fg)'(r) = f'(r)g(r) + f(r)g'(r).$$

*For the modulus $(X-r)^2$ its full expression is*

$$\mathcal{R}_{(X-r)^2}(fg) = f(r)g(r) + \big(f'(r)g(r) + f(r)g'(r)\big)(X-r).$$

*No degree bound on the unreduced factors or their product is required.*

*Proof.* Write $f = \mathcal{R}_p f + pa$ and $g = \mathcal{R}_p g + pb$ using synthetic division. Their product differs from $(\mathcal{R}_p f)(\mathcal{R}_p g)$ by $p\{a\mathcal{R}_p g + b\mathcal{R}_p f + pab\}$. Uniqueness of the remainder proves the first equality; taking its top coefficient proves the second. Repeating the equality proves the finite-product statement. Either parenthesization of a product of three factors reduces the same polynomial $fgh$, which proves associativity.

When $(X-r)^2$ divides $p$, the difference between any polynomial and its remainder has both value and formal derivative zero at $r$. The formal product rule gives the displayed derivative. The explicit degree-one remainder then follows from the double-root formula above. □

The coefficient functional is linear, but it is generally not multiplicative: $\ell_p(fg)$ need not equal $\ell_p(f)\ell_p(g)$. The product must be formed and reduced before its coefficient is taken. At a repeated spectral root the product rule also retains the first derivative of either factor; a list of values alone cannot replace it. This is the algebra needed when a product initially exceeds the canonical degree in Appendix M.

These polynomial statements are checked in the Lean files described in Chapter 15. The implementation uses coefficient lists and also proves invariance under arbitrary trailing zeros. The characterization of $\ell_p$ states sufficient conditions for identifying another functional with it; those conditions must still be proved for that functional. In this appendix the application requires the actual factorization of $\chi_N$, the original Casimir relation, and the crossing values and derivatives. The next section supplies the root data and the corresponding explicit formula.

## N.3 Repeated roots, the odd simple root, and the midpoint identity

Write

$$c_a = 2\cos\frac{(2a+1)\pi}{N}, \qquad 0 \le a < \lfloor N/2 \rfloor. \tag{N.8}$$

These are the distinct double roots. The only remaining root is $-2$, simple, when $N$ is odd. At a double root $c$, put $h(z) = \chi_N(z)/(z-c)^2$. The Chebyshev differential equation gives

$$h(c) = \frac{N^2}{4-c^2}, \qquad \frac{h'(c)}{h(c)} = \frac{c}{4-c^2}; \qquad \chi_N'(-2) = N^2 \quad (N \text{ odd}). \tag{N.9}$$

Indeed $(4-z^2)\chi_N'' - z\chi_N' + N^2(\chi_N - 2) = 0$. Evaluate it and its derivative at $c$, using $\chi_N(c) = \chi_N'(c) = 0$, to obtain (N.9).

If the resolvent at $c$ is $P_c/(z-c) + Q_c/(z-c)^2$, then $V_N(c) = h(c)Q_c$ and $V_N'(c) = h(c)P_c + h'(c)Q_c$. Consequently the original spectral derivative functional, on any scalar entry $H$, is

$$\mathcal{L}_N^f H = \sum_a \frac{(4-c_a^2)(fH)'(c_a) - c_a f(c_a)H(c_a)}{N^2} + \mathbf{1}_{N \text{ odd}} \frac{f(-2)H(-2)}{N^2}. \tag{N.10}$$

It sends $V_N$ to $f(\Omega)$, with $f'(c)Q_c$ included. The prime in (N.10) is a derivative in $z$.

Let

$$\phi_k = \frac{(2k+1)\pi}{N}, \quad 0 \le k < N, \qquad P(\phi) = H(2\cos\phi). \tag{N.11}$$

Each double root appears twice in this grid. At the odd simple root, $\phi = \pi$ occurs once, and differentiating the sine supplies exactly its weight in (N.10). Thus (N.10) is equivalently

$$\mathcal{L}_N^f H = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \frac{d}{d\phi} \frac{2\sin\phi\, f(2\cos\phi)H(2\cos\phi)}{N^2}\bigg|_{\phi=\phi_k}. \tag{N.12}$$

There is no omission or doubling of the odd simple node.

For the actual positive or negative integral crossing power, the full-Hermite Gaussian is

$$f_n(2\cos\phi) = q^{nd^2/4} \exp\left(\frac{inN(\phi-\pi)^2}{4\pi}\right), \qquad 0 \le \phi \le 2\pi. \tag{N.13}$$

Here $q^a$ means $e^{\pi i a/N}$, fixing the original square-root lift even for nonintegral $a$. In particular

$$|f_n| = 1, \qquad |\partial_\phi f_n| \le \frac{|n|N}{2}, \qquad f_n(c_a) = q^{nd^2/2}(-1)^{an} q^{na(a+1)}. \tag{N.14}$$

The nodal phase is the actual crossing phase, not its absolute value substituted into the source. Formula (N.13) is symmetric about $\pi$; it has the required holomorphic germ at the odd simple node. The possible endpoint cut at $z = 2$ does not occur at a spectral node and does not enter the finite identity (N.12).

Expanding (N.12), with primes now in $\phi$, gives

$$\mathcal{L}_N^n H = -\frac{1}{N^2} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} (\cos\phi_k f_k P_k + \sin\phi_k f_k' P_k + \sin\phi_k f_k P_k'). \tag{N.15}$$

This finite formula is sufficient for every norm below; no interchange of an infinite Fourier series or a contour limit is needed.

## N.4 An elementary exact derivative inequality

For every complex trigonometric polynomial $P$ of degree at most $d \geq 1$, set $\theta_j = (2j-1)\pi/(2d)$, $1 \leq j \leq 2d$. The finite Riesz interpolation identity is

$$P'(x) = \sum_{j=1}^{2d} \frac{(-1)^{j+1}}{4d \sin^2(\theta_j/2)} P(x+\theta_j). \tag{N.16}$$

For completeness, invert the finite Fourier matrix on modes $-d+1, \dots, d$. If $z = e^{-i\theta_j}$, so $z^{2d} = -1$, differentiating the finite geometric sum gives its weight

$$\frac{1}{2d} \sum_{\ell=-d+1}^{d} i\ell e^{-i\ell\theta_j} = \frac{iz^{-d+1}}{d(1-z)^2} = \frac{(-1)^{j+1}}{4d \sin^2(\theta_j/2)}. \tag{N.17}$$

The extra mode $-d$ has samples opposite to those of $d$, and its derivative at zero is opposite too. Thus (N.16) holds on all modes $-d, \dots, d$; translation gives arbitrary $x$.

The elementary sine product $\prod_{j=0}^{2d-1} \sin(x + j\pi/(2d)) = C_d \sin(2dx)$, with $C_d \neq 0$, yields after two logarithmic derivatives and substitution $x = \pi/(4d)$

$$\sum_{j=1}^{2d} \frac{1}{4d \sin^2(\theta_j/2)} = d. \tag{N.18}$$

Taking absolute values in (N.16) therefore proves

$$\|P'\|_{\mathbb{R}} \leq d \|P\|_{\mathbb{R}}. \tag{N.19}$$

The argument works without real coefficients or positivity.

The same finite identity and triangle inequality hold when the coefficients lie in any finite-dimensional normed space. Thus (N.19), and consequently (N.1)–(N.4), hold for such vector-valued polynomials without a dimension factor. The intended application here remains the original shared scalar coefficient (N.6); no change of the source norm is required.

## N.5 Full and vanishing-node bounds

Since $H$ has degree at most $d$, $P(\phi) = H(2\cos\phi)$ has trigonometric degree at most $d$, and its supremum is exactly $\|H\|_{[-2,2]}$. Equations (N.14), (N.15), and (N.19) give

$$|\mathcal{L}_N^n H| \leq \frac{N}{N^2} \left(1 + \frac{|n|N}{2} + d\right) \|H\| = \left(1 + \frac{|n|}{2}\right) \|H\|, \tag{N.20}$$

because $d + 1 = N$. This proves (N.1).

If $H$ vanishes at every node, the first two terms of (N.15) vanish exactly. Only the derivative of the original numerator remains. Applying (N.19) to that term gives (N.2), uniformly in every signed $n$, including zero.

Here is why the original lower and upper one-sided numerators satisfy this hypothesis. Put $D_-(z) = \prod_{a=0}^{\lfloor N/2 \rfloor - 1} (z - c_a)$. The exact lower-row restriction leaves the factor

$$\frac{\chi_N(z)}{D_-(z)} = \begin{cases} D_-(z), & N \text{ even}, \\ (z+2) D_-(z), & N \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \tag{N.21}$$

Every lower one-sided entry is divisible by (N.21); literal row reflection gives the same statement for the upper piece. Thus values vanish at all nodes. On the lower invariant block $\Omega_-$, whose eigenvalues $c_a$ are distinct, (N.10) reduces exactly to

$$\mathcal{L}_N^n H_{V,\mathrm{L}} = \sum_a f_n(c_a) \frac{4 - c_a^2}{N^2} H'_{V,\mathrm{L}}(c_a). \tag{N.22}$$

These numerator derivatives are the original lower-block spectral projectors. The derivative of $f_n$ disappears, but the semisimple source is not zero. For example the literal local diagonal coefficient obeys

$$[c^d] H_{V,\mathrm{L}}(z) = \frac{\chi_N(z)}{z - c_0}, \qquad [c^d] H_{R^n,\mathrm{L}} = q^{nd^2/2}. \tag{N.23}$$

Its modulus is one. This is an actual local coefficient, not a claim that the same boundary can maximize a closed source.

## N.6 Shared polynomials and the unsplit complementary source

The other finite functionals preserve each partial node-vanishing condition. Applying (N.1) and (N.2) successively to the original shared polynomial proves (N.3). Coefficient extraction in (N.6) is performed first and is never replaced by independent local maximization.

For clarity, (N.4) needs only joint grid vanishing, not vanishing on every node hyperplane. In each coordinate (N.15) is a sum of an evaluation term and a term differentiating $P$. Before summing its $N$ grid entries, the two coefficient bounds are $1 + |n_e|N/2$ and 1, respectively. For a subset $A$ of differentiated variables, iterating (N.19) gives

$$\|\partial_A \mathcal{D}(2\cos\boldsymbol{\phi})\| \le d^{|A|} \|\mathcal{D}\|_{[-2,2]^r}. \tag{N.24}$$

The term $A = \varnothing$ vanishes pointwise at the tensor grid. Every other term is bounded by $\prod_{e\in A}(d/N) \prod_{e\notin A}(1/N + |n_e|/2)\|\mathcal{D}\|$. Adding the nonempty subsets proves (N.4).

In the original central-cut decomposition, the lower and upper pieces have the factor (N.21). The full numerator is the sum of those pieces and the central piece defined by the endpoint conditions in Section O.1.1. At odd levels the central row belongs to that crossing piece. Hence every local full numerator agrees with its central piece at every spectral node. Multiplication and the one original shared coefficient extraction show

$$(S_{\mathrm{full}} - S_{\mathrm{C}})(c_{a_1}, \dots, c_{a_r}) = 0 \tag{N.25}$$

for all choices of nodes, including odd simple nodes. Applying (N.4) to this unsplit difference avoids summing the absolute values of exponentially many path terms. The statement is finite and exact even though its remaining shared supremum can be large.

## N.7 What the norm theorem does and does not supply

There is already a level-independent dual filling cost in the positive Fourier–Hermite Gram construction: its squared Hilbert dual norm is exactly $1 + n^2(N^2 - 1)/(12N^2)$. That theorem uses a specified positive energy of the entire mixed-color packet. The present bounds use instead

the supremum of the original shared resolvent numerator. The additional statements here are the twist-independent vanishing-node estimate and the unsplit product-grid cancellation. Neither construction by itself supplies the geometric exponential bound for its remaining source norm.

For a fixed diagram and fixed powers, all constants in (N.1)–(N.4) are independent of $N$. Thus any sharp exponential estimate for the same shared spectral supremum passes to its actual filled source without a new exponential cost. The theorem also shows precisely where a derivative of the crossing phase drops out and why this saves one or more twist factors.

It does not prove that $\|S_N\|$, or the complementary norm in (N.4), grows at the geometric volume rate. Neither node vanishing nor the uniform functional norm controls this remaining between-node polynomial. Separate absolute local envelopes may exceed that rate, and (N.23) prevents an argument that every one-sided channel is identically killed. The theorem asserts no new saddle dominance, peripheral representation, or knot-volume equality.

The finite reproduction program takes `--repo` pointing to the research checkout. It checks the Chebyshev double/simple-root identities at levels 2–12 and the Riesz formula at degrees 1–12 exactly in cyclotomic fields. It also compares the midpoint reconstruction with independently built original coproduct/Casimir and signed braid matrices at levels 3–8, for powers $\pm1, \dots, \pm5$, and checks the lower-block compression including its normal data. The JSON output distinguishes the exact rational cyclotomic calculations from exact finite-field matrix checks. These finite cases check algebraic identities; the all-level inequalities follow from the proofs above, not from sampled norm ratios.

## N.8 The estimate needed for long fillings

It is useful to state the remaining comparison with its quantifiers. Fix the diagram, and write

$$\mathcal{D}_N = S_{N,\mathrm{full}} - S_{N,\mathrm{C}}.$$

This polynomial does not depend on the twist powers. Suppose one proves, for some fixed $\eta > 0$,

$$\|\mathcal{D}_N\|_{[-2,2]^r} \le \exp\bigl(N(\Phi - \eta) + o(N)\bigr). \tag{N.26}$$

Here $\Phi$ is the complete augmented action in the normalization of the source. When it is identified geometrically, $\Phi = \mathrm{Vol}(M_{\mathrm{aug}})/(2\pi)$.

For each fixed tuple $\boldsymbol{n}$, equation (N.4) then gives

$$\left| \left( \bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e} \right) \mathcal{D}_N \right| \le \exp\bigl(N(\Phi - \eta) + o(N)\bigr). \tag{N.27}$$

The finite factor in (N.4) is absorbed in $o(N)$; this argument does not claim uniformity in twist powers growing with $N$.

Suppose separately that the crossing contribution has a nonzero asymptotic

$$Z_{N,\mathrm{C}}(\boldsymbol{n}) = a_N \exp(N\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}}), \qquad N^{-1}\log|a_N| \longrightarrow 0, \tag{N.28}$$

where $\Re\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}} > \Phi - \eta$. Equations (N.27) and (N.28) show that the complementary contribution divided by the crossing contribution tends to zero exponentially. Consequently

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} N^{-1}\log|Z_N(\boldsymbol{n})| = \Re\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}}. \tag{N.29}$$

The subexponential normalization factors in section 1 preserve this limit. Identifying $2\pi\Re\mathcal{A}_n$ with the hyperbolic volume still requires the geometric filling argument for that diagram.

This implication explains why a strict gap in (N.26) is useful for sufficiently long fixed fillings. The desired filled action approaches the augmented action as the auxiliary fillings become long. A bound for the full twist-independent polynomial at the augmented rate alone would give only that larger rate; it would not prove the smaller filled volume. The norm theorem proves the passage from (N.26) to (N.27). It does not prove (N.26) or supply (N.28) for a new diagram.

# Appendix O

# The geometric contribution for matched spherical diagrams

This appendix proves a nonzero asymptotic for the geometric contribution selected from the exact finite source, and identifies its rate with the volume of the original filled complement. It does not assert that the complementary contribution is smaller for every undecorated diagram. The first part supplies the analytic estimate for the entire Fourier period; the second supplies the original topology, peripheral words, and metric completion. Both parts retain the finite normalization.

## O.1 The geometric contribution and all Fourier charges

For a fixed link diagram, the exact finite formula is a coefficient in face variables followed by a linear functional in each crossing variable. Its local polynomial splits into three specified pieces. The central piece is defined by the two endpoint indices of each finite recurrence path. The other two pieces contain paths restricted to one side. The precise degree conditions are given below. Selecting the central piece at every crossing region gives a contribution to the original invariant; it does not define another topological invariant.

This part proves a nonzero asymptotic for that entire geometric contribution, including all Fourier charges, both level parities, the derivatives at repeated spectral nodes, and the original scalar factors. The diagram may have cups and caps between crossing regions: it need not be a flat plat. Its white triangulation must be a simple sphere with the specified matching and marked strand edge. The local balance inequalities used to bound the other two pieces are not needed here.

The geometric companion constructs the actual complement and identifies the selected action with its hyperbolic volume after sufficiently long fixed signed fillings. A strict estimate for the full contribution minus this geometric term remains a separate requirement for a full-invariant volume theorem.

### O.1.1 Exact assumptions and statement

Fix a finite connected Morse diagram whose actual white triangulation is a simple sphere, with its actual matching, cyclic orders, crossing-disk frames and marked main edge. Let the marked

edge join the two protected white faces $u, v$. The diagram has $R$ matching edges, $R+2$ white faces, and $R$ ordinary face targets. Assume the labeled positive convex right-angled certificate and its marked complete packing are supplied. Set the protected curvatures to zero and retain the same positive finite curvatures $\rho_f$ at every occurrence of each other face. The geometric existence of this certificate is a separate input to the present analytic argument.

The exact general Morse source identity is the one in A matched spherical triangulation has the original general Morse source, §§5–6, equivalently the finite-source part of Balanced terminal decorations and volume limits beyond tangle-operation trees, §5. In particular all physical cups, caps, the unrestricted marked row, the integrated even-level coset and the original component/framing factors are retained. Put $N \geq 3$, $d = N-1$, $q = e^{\pi i/N}$, and $h = \lfloor d/2 \rfloor$. At a crossing region, write the homogeneous local numerator as

$$H_{V_N}(x, b, c, y; \sigma) = \sum_{i+k+\ell+t=d} a_{i,k,\ell,t}(\sigma) b^i x^k y^\ell c^t.$$

Here $x, b, c, y$ are the four adjacent face variables, and $\sigma$ is the spectral parameter. The coefficients $a_{i,k,\ell,t}$ are the matrix coefficients prescribed by the finite source identity. Define $H_{V_N,\mathrm{C}}$ by retaining precisely the terms with $i \leq h$ and $t \leq h$. The left piece retains $t > h$; the right piece retains $i > h$. These three supports are disjoint and exhaustive, since $i + t \leq d$. More explicitly, a recurrence path from index $j$ to index $i$, with $0 \leq i \leq j \leq d$, contributes middle powers $b^i c^{d-j}$. It belongs to the central piece when $i \leq h$ and $d - j \leq h$. The word central describes these endpoint conditions: a two-step path may skip the intervening row and still belong to this piece. At odd levels the central zero-step path is also included, exactly once.

Selecting the central piece at every crossing gives

$$\begin{aligned} C_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) &= \left[ \prod_{f \neq u,v} L_f^d \right] \prod_{e=1}^{R} H_{V_N,\mathrm{C}}(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e}; \sigma_e) \Big|_{L_u = L_v = 0}, \\ \sigma_e &= -2\cos(2\pi\delta_e). \end{aligned} \tag{O.1}$$

The brackets extract the displayed coefficient in the ordinary face variables. The protected variables $L_u, L_v$ are set to zero before extraction. Thus the definition uses the same face demands and reduced mark as the full invariant. This is a projection of the known local polynomial, not a new topological evaluation. Write $P_{\mathrm{C}} = (-1)^d H_{V_N,\mathrm{C}}$ for the positive endpoint convention. Thus (O.1) is the raw coefficient and contains $(-1)^{dR}$.

For fixed nonzero signed crossing powers $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$, its exact all-central period is

$$\begin{aligned} I^{\mathrm{C}}_{N,\mathbf{n}} = q^{d^2 \sum_e n_e/4} (-i)^R \sum_{\boldsymbol{\ell} \in (\mathbb{Z}\setminus\{0\})^R} \left( \prod_e \ell_e \right) (-1)^{(N+1)\sum_e \ell_e} \\ \times \int_{[-1/2,1/2]^R} C_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) \prod_e \sin(2\pi\delta_e) \exp\left\{ N \sum_e (\pi i n_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \ell_e \delta_e) \right\} d\boldsymbol{\delta}. \end{aligned} \tag{O.2}$$

No additional power of $N$, modified dimension, or spectral square-root Jacobian appears. The displayed $q$ power is the original unwrapped scalar $\exp(\pi i d^2 \sum n_e/(4N))$. An exterior framing/component character multiplies the raw contraction when converting to the specified invariant convention; it has modulus one at complete color. The full one-cut modified

convention additionally retains its stated $i^{N+3}/N$. These conventions are not changed by a central projection.

There is a fixed small complex polydisk and finite holomorphic actions $A_N$, face Hessians $H_N$, such that the following two source estimates hold:

$$C_N(\delta) = \frac{(-1)^{dR} N^{2R} e^{N A_N(\delta)}}{(2\pi N)^{(R-1)/2} \sqrt{\det H_N(\delta)}} (1 + O(N^{-1})), \tag{O.3}$$

uniformly and holomorphically on that polydisk, and, for every $\eta > 0$,

$$|C_N(\delta)| \le e^{N(\Phi - \gamma_\eta)} \quad \text{if } \max_e |\operatorname{Re} \delta_e| \ge \eta, \quad \operatorname{Re} \delta_e \in [-1/2, 1/2], \quad |\operatorname{Im} \delta_e| \le \tau_\eta, \tag{O.4}$$

for some $\gamma_\eta, \tau_\eta > 0$ and all sufficiently large $N$. All fixed derivatives satisfy the corresponding bound on smaller domains. Here

$$A_N \longrightarrow A_0, \qquad A_0(0) = \Phi, \qquad A_0''(0) = -2 \operatorname{diag}(C_e), \quad C_e > 0, \tag{O.5}$$

with every fixed derivative; $A_N$ is separately even and real on the real chart. The marked complete action satisfies $2\pi\Phi = \operatorname{Vol}(Y_D)$ under the supplied geometric certificate and its calibrated source action.

There is a diagram-dependent $n_0$ such that, for every fixed independently signed vector with $|n_e| \ge n_0$, the entire period (O.2) has the relative asymptotic

$$\begin{aligned} I^{\mathrm{C}}_{N,\mathbf{n}} &= q^{d^2 \sum_e n_e/4} (-2i)^R \sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2} \\ &\quad \times \frac{\prod_e \sin(2\pi \delta_{N,\mathbf{1},e})}{\sqrt{\det H_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\mathbf{1}})} \sqrt{\det Q_{N,\mathbf{1}}}} e^{N S_{N,\mathbf{1}}} \left(1 + O_{\mathbf{n}}(N^{-1}) + O_{\mathbf{n}}(e^{-\kappa_{\mathbf{n}} N})\right). \end{aligned} \tag{O.6}$$

The quantities in (O.6) are the finite critical point, critical value and negative Hessian of

$$\Phi_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}}(\delta) = A_N(\delta) + \pi i \sum_e n_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \sum_e \ell_e \delta_e. \tag{O.7}$$

The face determinant root is continued from the positive complete Hessian. The spectral root is the Gaussian branch on matrices with positive real part. The coefficient in (O.6) tends to a nonzero number after the explicit level factors and action are removed. In particular the period is nonzero for all sufficiently large levels of either parity, and

$$\lim_{N \to \infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |I^{\mathrm{C}}_{N,\mathbf{n}}| = 2\pi \operatorname{Re} S_{0,\mathbf{1}}. \tag{O.8}$$

All powers are fixed before $N \to \infty$; no bound on their ratios is required. There is no assertion here that the full invariant differs from (O.2) by a smaller term.

### O.1.2 The graph facts replacing a flat-plat assumption

Deleting $u, v$ from a simple triangulated sphere leaves a connected ordinary graph. Indeed reroute a path around the first deleted vertex along its cyclic link, then around the second along its link with the first vertex removed. That remaining link is connected. Every surviving edge belongs to an original shaded triangle with two positive finite-face variables.

No matching edge can have the protected pair as its endpoints: their unique sphere edge is the marked main edge. Consequently every crossing circle has $x + y > 0$. At least one of its two triangles is nonmonomial. If both outers are positive, $xy > 0$; if one outer is protected, at most one middle can be the other protected face, so the other middle is positive. These facts also cover the smallest simple sphere. They require neither complete-radius balance nor a tree in the ordinary graph.

At the actual complete packing, the circle-center angle sums make the common face action stationary. Its Hessian is positive on the common-scale quotient: each nonmonomial triangle detects the differences of its finite logarithmic face radii, and the connected ordinary graph leaves only common scaling in the kernel. The active rows are literal $+1, -1$ differences. Thus the quotient lattice is primitive, has dimension $R - 1$, and has no additional angular aliases.

This is the content needed from The positive face coefficient has one global saddle, §§2–4, and The original boundary source has exactly two flat face directions, §2. Their proofs use the actual triangle graph and finite determinant matrices. Morse bends introduce no new face coordinate, while the exact source identity has already dealt with their cup/cap and mark factors. The old global theorem's phrase "flat plat" is therefore removed at this specific interface, rather than by an unproved equivalence of presentations.

### O.1.3 Local analytic inputs, including the odd normal

At each original crossing region let $\mathcal{B}_{e,N}(\delta_e; L)$ be the exactly anchored even fold interpolation. It retains the actual maximal-channel factor, beta factors, forced products and half-index. In particular its anchor is at $\delta_{\min} = 0$ for odd levels and $\delta_{\min} = 1/(2N)$ for even levels. The local rigidity theorem gives

$$P_{\mathrm{C},e}(\delta_e; L) = N^2 \mathcal{B}_{e,N}(\delta_e; L)(1 + O(e^{-cN})) \tag{O.9}$$

on a fixed complex spectral and face neighborhood, with protected variables still exactly zero. This is Actual all-central cofactors and the complete-fold interpolant, §§1–4, based on An exponentially accurate analytic interpolation of the actual fold factors and the independent complex packets of the actual cofactors.

For precision, the odd central formula has the form

$$P_{\mathrm{C}} = G_b G_c + \omega s_m s_{m+1} xy D_b D_c, \qquad \omega = -4 \sin^2(\pi\delta). \tag{O.10}$$

The second term in (O.10), including its derivative at $\omega = 0$, is retained. The even formula is its original sum of three central-cut products. Their central factors are analytic units near completeness. The proof of (O.9) uses the independently bounded complex cofactor ratios and a finite Cauchy–Lagrange formula on both parity grids; it does not differentiate a value-only interpolation. Thus all repeated-node normals and the odd simple node are already in (O.9). There is no odd regularized surrogate in (O.1).

The local global-angular theorem applies to each terminal cofactor with row $N/2 + O(1)$. Two positive faces with separated circular phases give a fixed exponential loss, uniformly over the entire real spectral interval and a sufficiently thin complex strip. Its proof retains the exact original node adapter, positive nodal tails, all start rows and the polynomial cost of the finitely omitted terminal nodes. One-variable triangles are exact monomials and impose no angular condition. This local theorem has no global topology or Morse-order hypothesis.

Every summand of the even or odd central formula contains a cofactor from both original triangles. Outside the common ordinary-face phase, a bounded-length path in the connected ordinary graph has a separated edge; one triangle at that edge supplies the exponential loss in every central summand at its crossing region. Every other cofactor has its polynomial endpoint majorant and the fixed strip growth $e^{O(N|\operatorname{Im}\delta|)}$. There are finitely many crossing regions, so shrink the common strip to absorb the sum of those growth costs. This proves the shared angular complement bound, on the original common radii and with every central prefactor retained.

### O.1.4 The local asymptotic from the actual face torus

Fix one ordinary face as the scale reference, and write $L_f = \rho_f e^{z_f}$ for the others. Define the finite phase

$$\Psi_N(z,\delta) = \frac{1}{N}\sum_e \operatorname{Log}\mathcal{B}_{e,N}(\delta_e; L(z)) - \frac{d}{N}\sum_{f\neq u,v}\operatorname{Log}L_f(z). \tag{O.11}$$

Every finite anchor and any $O(\log N)/N$ term remains in (O.11); only the explicit $N^{2R}$ in (O.9) lies outside. The local theorems give uniform convergence with derivatives to

$$\Psi(z,\delta) = \sum_e \big[Q_{b_e}(\delta_e; L) + Q_{c_e}(\delta_e; L)\big] - \sum_{f\neq u,v}\operatorname{Log}L_f. \tag{O.12}$$

The logarithms are real on the positive complete chart. The positive face Hessian and the holomorphic implicit function theorem give the actual nearby finite saddle $z_N(\delta)$, uniformly on one fixed polydisk. Put $A_N = \Psi_N(z_N,\delta)$ and $H_N = \partial_z^2\Psi_N(z_N,\delta)$.

The exact homogeneous numerator degree is $dR$, equal to the total ordinary target. Hence the common angular variable integrates to one, and the actual Cauchy measure on the quotient is $(2\pi)^{-(R-1)}d\theta$. The integration lattice is primitive by the general Morse face-potential identity; no additional multiplicity is chosen here.

Use (O.9) near the saddle and the preceding angular gap on its complement. Translating the original Cauchy torus by the small vector $z_N(\delta)$ crosses no pole: all finite faces remain in their annuli, the numerator is polynomial and the target is its original Laurent monomial. If the translation is localized, its side faces are retained in the fixed angular gap. Uniform positive real Hessian and bounded higher derivatives then give the Gaussian with coefficient one and the determinant in (O.3). Shrinking the spectral polydisk makes the absolute cost of its complex perturbation smaller than the exponential precision in (O.9), so the relative error remains $O(N^{-1})$, holomorphic with fixed derivative bounds.

Uniqueness of this finite face saddle preserves separate evenness and reality. At zero, the mixed $z,\delta$ derivatives vanish by evenness, so eliminating $z$ does not change the diagonal spectral second derivative. Explicitly

$$C_e = \frac{\pi(T_{b_e}+T_{c_e})}{x_e+y_e} > 0, \qquad T_t = \sqrt{(x_e+y_e)t + x_e y_e}, \tag{O.13}$$

at the actual complete packing. Section O.1.2 ensures that at least one summand is positive. Thus (O.5) holds, and on a smaller fixed complex chart $\operatorname{Re}A_N''$ is uniformly negative definite. This proves (O.3) directly for the central piece. The full-numerator restoration in §4 of The original full spectral numerator has the marked geometric packet is not used.

### O.1.5 The gap on the entire spectral cube

The needed real-spectral estimate is a value bound, not coefficientwise domination at arbitrary spectral parameters. The exact cleared cofactor has the original start decomposition

$$R_j(b,\delta)=\sum_{i=0}^{j} b^i \prod_{r<i} \alpha_r(\delta) K_{i,j}, \qquad \alpha_r = 4\cos^2\frac{(r+1/2)\pi}{N} - 4\sin^2(\pi\delta). \tag{O.14}$$

The normalized two-step tail transfer has limiting spectral radius

$$\rho(t,\delta)=(x+y)\sin(\pi t)+\sqrt{4xy\cos^2(\pi\delta)+(x-y)^2\sin^2(\pi t)}, \qquad \Lambda = 2\sin(\pi t)\rho. \tag{O.15}$$

The proof in Global real-spectral gap of the actual all-central source, §§1–2, handles the possible repeated transfer root by its Cayley–Hamilton power formula. It uses fixed finite blocks away from $t=0$, a uniform $O(\eta\log(1/\eta))$ endpoint allowance, and uniformly integrable truncated logarithms for the exact prefix. It therefore gives a uniform upper bound for every starting row, including in small fixed complex face neighborhoods and a thin spectral strip. No ill-conditioned eigenbasis or lower bound on distance to a physical node is assumed.

The exact maximization of the resulting start action is

$$\limsup \frac{1}{N}\log|R_j(b,\delta)| \le \max\{Q_b(\delta), \tfrac{1}{2}\log b\}; \tag{O.16}$$

for $b=0$, only the first branch is present. This comes from its unique pre-sign-change maximum and the final start endpoint; the entire prefix integral is zero. For a nonmonomial triangle, $Q_b(0) > \frac{1}{2}\log b$ when that branch is present, and $Q_b(\delta) < Q_b(0)$ for $0 < |\delta| \le 1/2$. The derivative formula is strictly negative whenever $b>0$ or $xy>0$. The sole exception is the exact one-variable monomial, already excluded from any asserted local gap.

Every crossing region has at least one nonmonomial triangle. Thus a separated $\delta_e$ supplies a strict loss relative to that crossing region's complete rate; all other crossing regions have their complete upper rates with arbitrarily small prescribed errors. On the small common-face-phase region this estimate and its complex face extension control the original integrand. On the complementary face torus use the angular gap of Section O.1.3, which is uniform for all real spectral parameters. Combining the two regions on the same original radii proves (O.4). To make endpoint neighborhoods precise, first use separation $\eta/2$, then shrink the strip. Cauchy's estimate gives the fixed derivative version. Neither the inequality comparing left/right rates with complete radii nor a choice of different radii at separate crossing regions occurs in this proof.

### O.1.6 The first packet, its phase, and charge comparison

Write, by evenness,

$$\partial_e A_N(\delta) = -2\delta_e B_{e,N}(\delta_1^2,\dots,\delta_R^2), \qquad B_{e,N} \longrightarrow B_e, \quad B_e(0)=C_e. \tag{O.17}$$

Shrink the chart until $|B_{e,N}-C_e| \le C_e/8$. Choose first a fixed outer real cube $K_B=[-B,B]^R$ inside that chart. Choose the scaled charge cutoff $a>0$ sufficiently small relative to $B$. Finally choose a separate inner radius $0<b<a/4$, to be used only for the bounded bad charges in

Section O.1.7. All three constants are fixed from the source before the powers are chosen. For positive real charges with $\ell_e/|n_e| \le a$, the critical equation is exactly

$$\delta_e = -\frac{\ell_e/n_e}{1 + iB_{e,N}(\delta^2)/(\pi n_e)}. \tag{O.18}$$

Uniform contraction on a small polydisk gives its unique solution for all independent signed $|n_e| \ge n_0$. In particular

$$|\delta_e| \le 2\ell_e/|n_e|, \qquad \operatorname{Im}\delta_e = \frac{\ell_e}{\pi n_e^2}\frac{\operatorname{Re} B_{e,N}}{|1 + iB_{e,N}/(\pi n_e)|^2} > 0. \tag{O.19}$$

The imaginary part is positive for either sign of $n_e$; all coordinates and all sine factors are nonzero.

Translate the outer cube $K_B$ to the horizontal plane through this critical point. Reality on the real chart gives $\operatorname{Re} A_N(x+iv) \le A_N(0) - c|x|^2 + C|v|^2$, with no linear imaginary cost. On each actual side face, one $|x_j| = B$, while $0 \le v_e \le \operatorname{Im}\delta_e$. The quadratic chirps cost at most $CB\sum_e \ell_e/|n_e|$, and the charge terms have nonpositive real part. The critical real value is at least $A_N(0) - C\sum_e(\ell_e/|n_e|)^2$. The already chosen $a \ll B$, followed by sufficiently large $n_0$, therefore puts every side strictly below that value. Thus the original local contour on $K_B$ has saddle coefficient $+1$, with its side currents explicitly smaller. The inner radius $b$ is not used for this local saddle contour.

On the translated horizontal plane the real Hessian is $\operatorname{Re} A_N'' < 0$. Hence the negative spectral Hessian $Q_{N,\ell}$ has positive real part. The Gaussian determinant branch is fixed even for mixed signs. Applying the spectral Gaussian to (O.3) contributes $(2\pi/N)^{R/2}$, and the two measures combine exactly as

$$N^{2R}(2\pi N)^{-(R-1)/2}(2\pi/N)^{R/2} = \sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2}. \tag{O.20}$$

The holomorphic relative (O.3) error remains $O(N^{-1})$; the ordinary cubic Gaussian term integrates to zero, while its square and the quartic term have this same order. Constants may depend on the fixed charges and powers. The limiting prefactor is nonzero by (O.19) and the determinant units.

Differentiation of the critical value, rather than comparison of independent saddle remainders, gives

$$\partial_{\ell_e} \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\ell} = -\frac{2\ell_e}{n_e^2}\frac{\operatorname{Re} B_{e,N}}{|1 + iB_{e,N}/(\pi n_e)|^2}. \tag{O.21}$$

Therefore, throughout the positive local charge box,

$$\operatorname{Re} S_{N,\mathbf{1}} - \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\ell} \ge \sum_e \frac{C_e}{2n_e^2}(\ell_e^2 - 1). \tag{O.22}$$

This comparison is valid for arbitrarily unbalanced fixed powers. Separate evenness makes every sign choice of the same positive charge magnitudes contribute equally: reflecting a coordinate reverses both its sine integral and its charge factor. For the unit charges the raw sign cancels the parity character, $(-1)^{dR}(-1)^{(N+1)R} = 1$, leaving the exact factor $(-2i)^R$ in (O.6).

### O.1.7 Whole-domain currents and every other charge

For any entire polynomial in the $\sigma_e$, multiply it by the original sines and quadratic chirps. In each variable the resulting $B$ has zero endpoint values and equal first derivatives at $\pm 1/2$. This remains true after spectator derivatives. Three integrations by parts give exactly

$$\int_{-1/2}^{1/2} B(t) e^{2\pi i N \ell t}\, dt = (2\pi i N \ell)^{-3} \left\{ [B''(t) e^{2\pi i N \ell t}]_{-1/2}^{1/2} - \int_{-1/2}^{1/2} B'''(t) e^{2\pi i N \ell t}\, dt \right\}. \tag{O.23}$$

The second-derivative current is retained. With the original charge weight this yields summable $|\ell|^{-2}$ at fixed $N, \mathbf{n}$. Nothing about this step assumes a plat.

(O.3) and (O.4) first imply the shared real supremum $e^{N(\Phi + o(1))}$. Since the degree in each cosine variable is at most $d$, the elementary polynomial exterior bound gives

$$|C_N(\delta)| \le e^{N(\Phi + o(1)) + 2\pi d \sum_e |\operatorname{Im} \delta_e|}. \tag{O.24}$$

This is a bound for the whole shared coefficient. Source derivatives are estimated by Cauchy, while spectator chirps are differentiated on their real intervals, so no exponentially large spectator-slope cost is inserted.

For a positive far charge in coordinate $i$, shift its whole interval upward by a fixed small height $\tau$. Both endpoint sides are kept together. Their exact difference, with spectator factors suppressed, is

$$\begin{aligned} B_i(1/2 + iv) - B_i(-1/2 + iv) = {} & 2i \sinh(2\pi v) \sinh(\pi n_i N v) \\ & \times e^{\pi i n_i N (1/4 - v^2)} C_N(1/2 + iv, \delta_{\text{other}}). \end{aligned} \tag{O.25}$$

The endpoint Fourier phase combined with the original parity is $(-1)^{\ell_i}$, of modulus one. (O.4) gives a fixed gap at these separated endpoints. Applying (O.23) in all spectator coordinates bounds the weighted vertical term by

$$C_{\mathbf{n}} |n_i| N \ell_i\, e^{N(\Phi - \gamma_e)} \prod_{j \ne i} |\ell_j|^{-2} \int_0^\tau v^2 e^{-2\pi N (\ell_i - |n_i|/2) v}\, dv. \tag{O.26}$$

For $\ell_i > |n_i|/2 + D$, its integral is bounded by $C/[N^3(\ell_i - |n_i|/2)^3]$, and the resulting sum converges. The horizontal interval uses (O.24) and has exponential rate at most $\Phi + o(1) + 2\pi R\tau - 2\pi\tau(\ell_i - |n_i|/2)$. Choose fixed $D$ large enough to make this uniformly smaller than $\Phi$. The union over any far coordinate, summed with all spectators on their entire real intervals, has a fixed exponential gap. Negative charges obey the same bound by reflection. No infinite series restricted to a sharp small cube has been introduced.

The remaining charges satisfy $|\ell_i| \le \lceil |n_i|/2 + D \rceil$, a finite set after the powers are fixed. Consider first a bounded bad charge for which one ratio $|\ell_i|/|n_i| > a$. Outside the inner cube $K_b$, (O.4) supplies a fixed gap. Inside $K_b$, reflect the chosen charge to positive sign and shift only that coordinate by $ib/|n_i|$. Since $0 < b < a/4$, the horizontal charge loss is at least $2\pi b(a - b) > 0$; the complex-source error is $O(b^2/n_i^2)$. On each actual vertical side $|x_i| = b$, the fixed real quadratic loss persists, and the chirp plus charge has nonpositive real part. This proves a fixed gap for these bounded bad charges, independently of power ratios.

For the remaining finite local charge box, with all ratios at most $a$, use (O.4) outside the outer cube $K_B$, and the actual translated $K_B$ contour and comparison (O.22) inside. Every

nonunit magnitude has a positive fixed-$\mathbf{n}$ gap. The unit drop from $\Phi$ is $O_D(\sum_e n_e^{-2})$. Enlarge the common diagram-dependent threshold until this drop is smaller than the previously fixed endpoint, far-charge, bounded-bad and outer-cube-complement gaps. Also ensure $an_0 \geq 1$. All complementary contributions are then exponentially smaller than the nonzero unit packet. This proves (O.6)–(O.8) for the whole all-central period.

### O.1.8 The geometric interface and the precise remaining problem

The analytic proof retains the untwisted selected action $A_0$ and the original half twists exactly once. Put

$$A_\epsilon = A_0 + \pi i \sum_e \epsilon_e \delta_e^2, \qquad U_{\epsilon,e} = \partial_{\delta_e} A_\epsilon, \qquad V_e = -4\pi i \delta_e. \tag{O.27}$$

The actual stationary equation of (O.7), with $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$, is

$$U_{\epsilon,e} + p_e V_e = -2\pi i \ell_e. \tag{O.28}$$

Once the original ordered Morse diagram has the marked action/primitive collar adapter and smooth long-filling completion, its regulator boundary term cancels the Gaussian terms at $\ell_e = 1$. Then $2\pi \operatorname{Re} S_{0,\mathbf{1}}$ is the actual filled exterior's hyperbolic volume. This identifies the asymptotic of the sector (O.2), not automatically that of the full invariant.

The independent issue remains a bound or cancellation statement for the entire original left/right remainder. Complete-radius balance is one sufficient mechanism in the terminal-fan theorem. The present proof does not assume it and supplies no replacement. In particular a nonzero sector with the correct geometric rate can still be canceled by another sector unless that remainder is controlled.

### O.1.9 Proof dependencies and scope

The following table records the inputs and the hypotheses used in each part of the proof.

| Input | Part used here | Dependence on a flat plat or balance |
|---|---|---|
| A matched spherical triangulation has the original general Morse source §§5–6 | Exact coefficient, primitive integer face grid, both parity cosets, mark and whole Hermite functional | Proved for the actual general Morse construction; no balance |
| An exponentially accurate analytic interpolation of the actual fold factors §§1–6 | Exact finite anchor and exponential interpolation in fixed complex face neighborhoods | Local actual triangles and protected-zero patterns only |
| Actual all-central cofactors and the complete-fold interpolant §§1–4 | Actual off-node central polynomial, including odd derivative term | Independent actual cofactor growth plus interpolation; local only |

| Input | Part used here | Dependence on a flat plat or balance |
|---|---|---|
| A global angular gap for the actual cleared cross cofactors §§1–4 | Whole real-spectral angular gap and omitted-terminal-node interpolation | Local positive finite matrices and physical recurrences only |
| The positive face coefficient has one global saddle §§2–4 | Positive Hessian, primitive phase constraints and coefficient Gaussian | Actual connected ordinary triangle graph; no flat gap forest |
| The original boundary source has exactly two flat face directions §2 | Ordinary graph connectivity after the protected pair is removed | Simple sphere and marked main edge |
| Global real-spectral gap of the actual all-central source §§1–4 | Uniform start-row/tail estimates, strict real-spectral decrease and shared strip gap | Local recurrences plus the same ordinary graph and complete radii |
| The original full spectral numerator has the marked geometric packet §§1–3 | Finite phase, exact quotient measure and actual Cauchy contour | Reproved above with the Morse source; its full restoration §4 is unused |
| The original localized spectral period has a nonzero unit-charge filling contribution §§2–5 | Fixed independent signed saddle, actual side currents, nonzero first packet | H1 and exact scalar/evenness only; the old flat-plat opening is not used |
| The entire original all-central Fourier period from its local packet and global spectral gap §§2–5 | Whole-domain charge tails and finite bad-charge separation | H1, H2 and entire polynomial degree only |
| Balanced terminal decorations and volume limits beyond tangle-operation trees §§6–8 | Explicit existing Morse version of these same analytic steps | Balance is used in §9 for the omitted full remainder, not in §§6–8 |

No new analytic hypothesis is imposed on a certified simple-sphere Morse source beyond these literal inputs. The original presentation's physical normalization and its marked geometric applicability must still be supplied, as stated in Section O.1.1. There is no full-invariant volume theorem for general unchanged matched spheres in this appendix.

## O.2 The original complement and its geometric contribution

A simple triangulated sphere with a perfect matching of its cubic dual determines an actual augmented link diagram when the cyclic orders, strand pairings and crossing disks are retained. This section follows that diagram through its exact finite source, its geometric critical point, and the filling of its original auxiliary cusps.

For independently sufficiently long fixed signed twists, the geometric contribution to the original invariant is nonzero and has the exponential rate of the actual filled hyperbolic volume. The proof keeps the primitive peripheral words, the finite scalar factors and both parities

of the quantum level. No terminal tangles are inserted, and no local balance assumption is imposed.

The central piece is the part of each local numerator defined by the degree conditions in Section O.1.1. Equivalently, it consists of the central recurrence paths of each original homogeneous numerator. Selecting it at every crossing region is an algebraic decomposition of the original evaluation, not a new invariant. The analytic companion proves its full Fourier asymptotic. To conclude the same limit for the full invariant of an undecorated diagram, one must additionally control the remaining pieces.

### O.2.1 Precise diagram and filling scope

Let $\mathcal{T}$ be a finite simple triangulated oriented sphere with at least four vertices. Choose a perfect matching of its cubic dual. The two triangles in each matched pair form a quadrilateral with four distinct white vertices. Record a cyclic order $(x_e, b_e, y_e, c_e)$; its common diagonal is $x_e y_e$, its input middle is $b_e$, and its output middle is $c_e$. There are $R$ matched pairs and $R+2$ white vertices. Mark a nonmatching edge $uv$. It is a strand edge in the link diagram.

There are two equivalent permitted inputs:

- an actual connected augmented diagram in $S^3$, whose projection and crossing-disk cut has exactly these labels and orders; or
- the literal inverse-cut construction in section O.2.2 below.

Fix the retained half twist $\epsilon_e \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$ and its sign at every disk. Its auxiliary peripheral basis $(\mu_e, \lambda_e)$ is the original disk-framed primitive basis. The longitude $\lambda_e$ is represented by the ordered two-head product $P_e = B_e A_e$. Integer filling coordinate $p_e$ means filling the slope $\mu_e + p_e \lambda_e$; the main crossing power is

$$n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e. \tag{O.29}$$

The original outside terminal matching and the even/odd pairing at each disk determine the main components. When their terminal graph is connected, denote the filled knot by $K_{\boldsymbol{p}}$. We keep this original parity test. We do not change the parity vector to obtain a different knot.

A supplied labeled positive right-angled cut certificate is sufficient for everything below. In this simple-sphere class such a certificate also follows from the constructive packing theorem in the balanced-fan note, section 2. That section constructs the packing **before any fan is inserted**. Only that initial geometric construction is used here.

**Theorem.** For each fixed diagram and the recorded choices above there is a number $T_D$ such that, for every fixed integer vector $\boldsymbol{p}$ with $\min_e |n_e| > T_D$, independently in sign and relative size, the following assertions hold.

1. Filling the specified auxiliary components gives a complete finite-volume hyperbolic metric on the original filled link exterior, with every main cusp unfilled. If the recorded component test is a knot, it is $S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}$.
2. The all-central term of the original complete-color Morse contraction has a nonzero relative first-charge asymptotic, at both parities of the level $N$. Its selected critical action $S_{\mathbf{1}}$ satisfies

$$2\pi \operatorname{Re} S_{\mathbf{1}} = \operatorname{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}) \tag{O.30}$$

in the knot case, and the analogous original link-complement identity otherwise.

3. In particular, for that all-central contraction $\mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{C}}$,

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{C}}| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}). \tag{O.31}$$

The exact raw phase is retained in section O.2.3. An ordinary zero-framing phase does not change (O.31).

The diagram, its matching, its signs, and all powers are fixed before $N$. The threshold can depend on this entire finite diagram. There is no short-filling assertion and no uniformity in a growing sphere. The theorem does not assert (O.31) for the full invariant: that requires a bound on the remaining sectors.

### O.2.2 Why the manifold and its complete anchor are the original ones

Take disjoint small neighborhoods of the matched edges of the cubic dual. Each is a four-terminal disk. In cyclic terminal order $0, 1, 2, 3$, the two shaded halves group $(1, 2)$ and $(3, 0)$. Draw the physical untwisted strands instead with pairs $(0, 1), (2, 3)$, and connect outside terminals along the nonmatching dual edges. In the corresponding disjoint three-balls put the perpendicular crossing circles and their twice-punctured disks. This constructs a link in $S^3$, not a manifold assigned to an abstract tensor graph. Retained odd half twists use the physical pairing $(0, 2), (1, 3)$, with their original signed collar paths.

The two main pairings and the shaded grouping must not be confused. The graph of main components is the union of the outside terminal matching and these physical pairings. Every terminal has degree two. Its connectedness is exactly the knot test, and adding full twists does not change it.

Cut along the projection sphere. In each projection ball a crossing circle semicircle is boundary parallel by its original half disk. Drilling that semicircle and opening that same half disk cancels the introduced handle. These operations occur in disjoint collars, so opening all of them leaves one ball in each projection copy. The boundary cellulation is the prescribed medial sphere. Thus cycles in the matched graph create no unidentified handle or extra gluing.

Let $Q$ be its positive ideal right-angled cut polyhedron. The even shaded pairing fixes the crossing-circle vertex and sends $C_1 \mapsto C_0,\ C_2 \mapsto C_3$. An odd pairing exchanges the projection copies and the two punctures, using the literal signed half-twist collar. The two odd signs have the same corner permutation but different primitive paths. White faces pair by their original projection labels.

At every ideal vertex, the link of $Q$ is a rectangle. Normalize its opposite shaded sides to length one. Each shaded triangle map then preserves the canonical horocycles at all three corners, including the odd corner permutation. Each alternating white/shaded edge cycle has four right-angle pieces. It fixes both ideal endpoints, preserves the chosen horospheres there, and rotates by $2\pi$, so its whole holonomy is the identity. The ideal links are the actual link's torus links and have no cone or dilation defect. Their horoball ends are complete. Hence

$$\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D) = 2\,\mathrm{Vol}(Q), \qquad \Phi_D = \frac{\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)}{2\pi}. \tag{O.32}$$

Here $Y_D$ is the same augmented exterior, with the recorded half twists and peripheral bases.

These are the local cut and gluing arguments in the matching-geometry proof, sections 4–6. They use a sphere projection, disjoint half disks, and the prescribed corner maps. Moving cups and caps to a flat plat is not a premise. The inverse construction and its general Morse realization are spelled out in the matched-sphere source, sections 1–4.

For completeness, the initial simple-sphere packing theorem does not require the absence of separating triangles. Remove one triangular face and pool its three boundary angle demands. Strict Hall inequalities for every nonempty proper destination subset give a positive allocation of angles. The strictly concave calibrated triangle entropy has an interior maximizer, whose multipliers give positive radii. The center triangles have zero interior rotational and translational holonomy. Their boundary develops once around a convex triangle, so the degree argument makes the development injective. Vertex-disk sectors stop before opposite center edges; this proves disjointness, including across separating triangles. The contact circles and outward halfspaces therefore give the labeled strict support certificate. Sending the marked contact to infinity gives the two protected parallel lines. No radius-balance inequality enters this construction.

### O.2.3 The exact source and the phases which remain outside the action

Put $d = N-1$, $q = e^{\pi i/N}$. In the recorded four-leg order the full local homogeneous numerator is $H_e(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e})$. The original reduced Morse contraction is

$$[\prod_{f\neq u,v} L_f^d] \prod_e H_e(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e})\big|_{L_u=L_v=0}. \tag{O.33}$$

This statement includes the complete root Hermite normals and the unrestricted physical mark.

Here is the part of its proof that matters for changing the Morse height function. Each full coupon contributes $N^{-1}H_e/(b_e c_e)^{d/2}$. If $M_f$ counts middle passages and $T_f$ counts outside minus inside turns, the actual boundary turning number gives

$$M_f - T_f = 2 \quad (f \neq u), \qquad M_u - T_u = -2. \tag{O.34}$$

The ordinary caps and cups give the same powers as these winding numbers; replacing the exposed cap by the original reduced mark contributes $N^{-1}(L_v/L_u)^d$. Thus the full summand is $N^{-R-1}\prod H_e/\prod_{f\neq u,v} L_f^d$. The primitive face-potential lattice has $R+1$ independent $N$-point grids after the exterior gauge is fixed. Their count cancels $N^{-R-1}$. Exact endpoint support is imposed before the root reduction, so no coefficient is aliased into a wrong endpoint. This proves (O.33) with its original phases at arbitrary Morse height and both level parities.

Replace each homogeneous factor in (O.33) by its central cofactor factor and retain the physical spectral trace. Write $C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\boldsymbol{\delta})$ for the resulting entire spectral numerator, with each node $-2\cos(2\pi\delta_e)$. It is even separately in every coordinate, has degree at most $d$ in each node, and satisfies $C_N^{\mathrm{raw}} = (-1)^{dR} C_N^{+}$ in the positive cofactor normalization. The exact original filling period is

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{C}} = q^{d^2\sum_e n_e/4}(-i)^R \sum_{\boldsymbol{\ell}\in(\mathbb{Z}\setminus\{0\})^R} \Big(\prod_e \ell_e\Big)(-1)^{(N+1)\sum_e \ell_e} \\ \cdot \int_{[-1/2,1/2]^R} \Big(\prod_e \sin(2\pi\delta_e)\Big) C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}) \exp\Big[N\sum_e \{\pi i n_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \ell_e \delta_e\}\Big]\, d\boldsymbol{\delta}.\end{aligned} \tag{O.35}$$

The sum is the original trace identity with its endpoint currents; it is not defined by an unqualified termwise Poisson rearrangement. The odd-level simple node and the double-node normals are included. The same finite proof is the matched-sphere source, sections 5–7.

No operation in (O.33)–(O.35) changes a disk, a strand pairing, or a peripheral curve. In particular the all-central source for the original sphere exists before a fan construction, and its ordinary-face targets are still $d$.

### O.2.4 One marked circle pattern on the whole sphere

Normalize the complete protected white disks to $\operatorname{Im} z \le 0$ and $\operatorname{Im} z \ge 1$. For each finite face use center $(X_f, Y_f)$ and radius $r_f$. At a strand edge set $I_{fg} = 1$; at matching edge $e$ set $I_{fg} = \cos(2\pi\delta_e)$. The equations are

$$\begin{aligned} (X_f - X_g)^2 + (Y_f - Y_g)^2 &= r_f^2 + r_g^2 + 2I_{fg} r_f r_g, \\ Y_f = r_f I_{fu}, \qquad & 1 - Y_f = r_f I_{fv}, \end{aligned} \tag{O.36}$$

where the last two equations are imposed at the appropriate marked line incidences. Fix one horizontal translation. The marked line-line edge is automatic; the remaining system has $3R - 1$ equations and variables.

Its complete Jacobian is invertible. The infinitesimal angle sums and the positive finite-face source Hessian first force all logarithmic radius variations to be one common scale. Each of the two triangles adjacent to $uv$ contains a finite circle tangent to both fixed lines. Its radius is $1/2$, so its scale variation is zero. All radius variations are therefore zero.

With radii fixed, each finite center triangle has one infinitesimal Euclidean motion. A one-line triangle has only a horizontal translation. Removing the two triangles at $uv$ leaves a triangulated disk with connected triangle adjacency, containing all finite vertices and at least one one-line triangle. Two adjacent finite triangles agree at two distinct centers; two adjacent one-line triangles agree at their finite center. These comparisons propagate one horizontal translation through the disk, and the normalization removes it. The kernel is zero.

The holomorphic implicit-function theorem now gives one circle pattern on a fixed polydisk in all $\delta_e$. The variables $X, Y, r$ are complexified independently, without conjugating parameters. The solution is real on real parameters and even in each $\delta_e$.

For one source triangle put $x = 1/r_x,\ b = 1/r_b,\ y = 1/r_y$,

$$\begin{aligned} A &= x + y, & s &= \sin(\pi\delta), \\ D &= A^2 - 4xys^2, & T_b &= \sqrt{bA + xy + b^2 s^2}, \\ E_b &= A + 2bs^2 + 2sT_b. \end{aligned} \tag{O.37}$$

Use positive complete roots and their analytic continuations. The original determinant, beta, and forced-product rate $Q_b$ obeys

$$\partial_\delta Q_b = -\operatorname{Log}(E_b/\sqrt{D}), \qquad \partial_{\log L_f} Q_b = \frac{\theta_f}{2\pi}, \qquad Q_b(0) = F(x, b, y). \tag{O.38}$$

The angles are those of (O.36), with their marked-line limits. Thus the developed angles sum to $2\pi$ exactly when the finite-face source is stationary. Uniqueness of the finite-face critical point identifies these curvatures with the limiting source saddle.

The common strip also handles a triangle containing both protected lines. If its finite radius is $r$, its strip width is $r(1+\cos(2\pi\delta))$. This shared width cannot be chosen independently at two triangles. The corresponding repeated scalar root does not remove the selected eigenflag: the noncentral complete parabolic has a nonzero off-diagonal matrix entry, and its eigenline for

$$J = -e^{-2\pi i\delta} \tag{O.39}$$

continues holomorphically, including its collision at zero.

This is the complete rank and face-identification mechanism in the marked-pattern proof. No part of it refers to the number of strands at a Morse slice. Simplicity is important: in particular a matching edge cannot join the two protected faces, since their unique common edge is the marked strand edge. Hence $A > 0$ in every local formula.

### O.2.5 Full group relations and the original primitive peripheral words

Choose the two holomorphic white-reflection matrices $\mathcal{R}_f^{\pm}$, with $\mathcal{R}_f^{-}\mathcal{R}_f^{+} = I$, from the one pattern. At a regular Morse slice with regions $F_0, \dots, F_k$, the original heads and prefixes are

$$H_j = \mathcal{R}^{+}_{F_j}\mathcal{R}^{-}_{F_{j-1}}, \qquad H_j \cdots H_1 = \mathcal{R}^{+}_{F_j}\mathcal{R}^{-}_{F_0}. \tag{O.40}$$

Their marked lifts give the original parabolic main meridians. Shared physical wire ends have the same adjacent region labels. At a cup or cap the consecutive regions are $F, G, F$, so the inserted ordered pair has product $I$, and all later prefixes are unchanged. This proves the relations also when $k$ changes.

At one crossing disk the ordered input pair is

$$A_{\mathrm{in}} = \mathcal{R}_b\mathcal{R}_x, \qquad B_{\mathrm{in}} = \mathcal{R}_y\mathcal{R}_b, \qquad P = B_{\mathrm{in}}A_{\mathrm{in}} = \mathcal{R}_y\mathcal{R}_x, \tag{O.41}$$

and the output pair replaces $b$ by $c$. The labeled contact map of the disk, taking $C_1 \mapsto C_0$, $C_2 \mapsto C_3$, is

$$R_0 = \frac{E_bE_c}{D}, \qquad C = I + \frac{R_0 - 1}{J - J^{-1}}(P - J^{-1}I). \tag{O.42}$$

It sends both input generators to their respective output generators by simultaneous conjugation and commutes with $P$.

The primitive normalization in (O.42) is geometric. Sending the two outer intersection points to $0, \infty$ makes the two shaded contact circles concentric, with radii $\sqrt{D}/E_b$ and $E_c/\sqrt{D}$. Their ordered corner map is multiplication by $R_0$; the product of their reflections would instead give $R_0^2$. The original threading word $[2,1,1,2]$ follows the inverse of the first map. At zero, (O.42) retains the nontrivial parabolic divided-difference limit. Setting $C = I$ merely because its eigenratio is one would give the wrong group representation.

Marked lines are treated by one common Möbius regularization of the whole pattern. The input/output side signs are calibrated by the same complete cusp rectangle. Nonvanishing middle contributions have the original opposite signs; an exceptional two-line triangle has $T_b = 0$ and contributes ratio one. Its actual eigenflag still comes from (O.36). This proves (O.42) with the correct labels at every zero pattern, not just at positive local curvatures.

The positive crossing acts by $(A, B) \mapsto (A^{-1}BA, A)$, represented by $P^{-1} - I$. For $\epsilon$ equal to $0, 1, -1$, put

$$\begin{aligned} U &= -\operatorname{Log} R_0 - \epsilon \operatorname{Log}(-J), \\ V &= 2\operatorname{Log}(-J) = -4\pi i\delta, \qquad m = e^{U/2}. \end{aligned} \tag{O.43}$$

All logarithms are the germs vanishing at the complete point. The actual determinant-one auxiliary meridian is

$$\mathsf{M} = mR_0(J^{-1}-1)^{-\epsilon}C^{-1}(P^{-1}-I)^{\epsilon}. \tag{O.44}$$

Its selected eigenvalue is $m$, and $\det \mathsf{M} = m^2R_0(-J)^{\epsilon} = 1$. The factor $J^{-1}-1$ is a unit near completeness, including for negative $\epsilon$. Formula (O.44), not just (O.43), verifies the original threading and signed Hurwitz relations.

Equations (O.40)–(O.44) cover every shared wire, cup, cap, drilled box, and half twist in the actual Morse van Kampen presentation. There is no extra consistency equation at a cycle of the matched graph: all heads came from the same global reflections and all ordered box maps use those heads. The resulting family $\rho_{\boldsymbol{\delta}}$ is an actual framed representation of $\pi_1(Y_D)$. At zero it is the complete cut representation. Every main meridian remains noncentral parabolic; its commuting longitude has multiplier one. Thus every unfilled main peripheral group is parabolic.

These are full matrix and based-word assertions from the primitive collar proof and the global assembly, section 2. The latter's displayed $2k$ head count is replaced event by event by the actual $k(t)$ in (O.40). No other part of its proof changes.

### O.2.6 Absolute action and the first-charge filling equations

Let $A_0$ be the pure limiting face-critical value

$$A_0(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = \operatorname{crit}_L \left\{ \sum_e (Q_{b_e} + Q_{c_e}) - \sum_{f \neq u,v} \operatorname{Log} L_f \right\}. \tag{O.45}$$

It is separately even, real on real parameters, and anchored by $A_0(0) = \Phi_D$. Put

$$A_\epsilon = A_0 + \pi i \sum_e \epsilon_e \delta_e^2.$$

Envelope differentiation of (O.38), retaining (O.43), gives

$$dA_\epsilon = \sum_e U_e \, d\delta_e, \qquad d(2\pi i A_\epsilon) = -\frac{1}{2}\sum_e U_e \, dV_e. \tag{O.46}$$

This derivative identifies the actual primitive variables, including the half-twist shear; it is stronger than a cusp-Hessian match.

The marked regulator boundary formula, in squared multiplier logs, is

$$d\operatorname{Vol}(\rho) = \frac{1}{2}\sum_e \{\operatorname{Re} V_e \, d \operatorname{Im} U_e - \operatorname{Re} U_e \, d \operatorname{Im} V_e\}. \tag{O.47}$$

The main terms vanish. Equations (O.46),(O.47) have the same differential after the boundary correction, and (O.32) fixes the real constant. Therefore on this one selected branch

$$2\pi \operatorname{Re} A_\epsilon = \operatorname{Vol}(\rho) - \frac{1}{2}\sum_e \operatorname{Im} U_e \, \operatorname{Re} V_e. \tag{O.48}$$

The logarithms are not reset during continuation.

For the positive unit charge in (O.35), the limiting phase is

$$S_{\mathbf{1}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = A_0(\boldsymbol{\delta}) + \pi i \sum_e n_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \sum_e \delta_e = A_\epsilon - 2\pi i \sum_e p_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \sum_e \delta_e. \tag{O.49}$$

Its stationarity equation is exactly

$$U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i. \tag{O.50}$$

For each fixed diagram, existence and uniqueness near zero hold for all independently long signed powers. Indeed

$$A_0''(0) = -2\,\mathrm{diag}(C_e), \qquad C_e = \frac{\pi(T_{b_e}(0) + T_{c_e}(0))}{x_e + y_e} > 0, \tag{O.51}$$

and separate evenness makes $\partial_e A_0 = \delta_e B_e$. After multiplying the critical equations by $1/n_e$, the derivative in $\boldsymbol{\delta}$ at reciprocal slopes zero is the invertible diagonal $2\pi i I$. The several-parameter implicit-function theorem gives $\delta_e = O_D(1/|n_e|)$. It allows independently unbalanced signed $n_e$; it does not compare a minimum error rate with a sum of unrelated filling losses.

At a critical point, substitute (O.50) into (O.48). Since $V = -4\pi i\delta$, the real part of the two explicit added terms in (O.49) is

$$\mathrm{Re}(-2\pi i p\delta^2 + 2\pi i\delta) = \frac{1}{4\pi}\,\mathrm{Im}\,U\ \mathrm{Re}\,V. \tag{O.52}$$

The boundary corrections cancel exactly:

$$2\pi\,\mathrm{Re}\,S_{\mathbf{1}} = \mathrm{Vol}(\rho). \tag{O.53}$$

There is no omitted complex endpoint term. To replace the right side by the hyperbolic volume of the filled topology one still needs the following metric argument.

### O.2.7 Completing the specified hyperbolic filling

The construction in the general metric completion theorem, sections 1–5 applies to any complete finite-volume exterior. Its neighborhood is a neighborhood of the **framed representation**, not only of the peripheral traces. We recall the points preventing an exponentiated filling equation from being mistaken for a metric.

On a compact truncated core choose a finite lifted partition of unity $\eta_{j,\gamma}$. In the future unit hyperboloid form

$$Y_\rho(x) = \sum_{j,\gamma} \eta_{j,\gamma}(x)\rho(\gamma)\rho_0(\gamma)^{-1}x, \qquad E_\rho(x) = \frac{Y_\rho(x)}{\sqrt{-\langle Y_\rho(x), Y_\rho(x)\rangle}}. \tag{O.54}$$

The future cone is convex; this is defined and equivariant. On a compact fundamental part it is $C^1$-close to the identity, so is a positive local diffeomorphism.

In a selected cusp frame the peripheral transformations are affine: $A_\rho(\lambda)z = a_\lambda z + b_\lambda$, on the original translation lattice $\Lambda$. A periodic partition of unity gives

$$\begin{aligned} d_\rho(w) &= \sum_{\lambda\in\Lambda} \eta(w-\lambda)A_\rho(\lambda)(w-\lambda), \\ F_\rho(w,t) &= (d_\rho(w), e^{t+\chi_\rho(w)}), \end{aligned} \tag{O.55}$$

where $\chi_\rho$ is the real-linear extension of $\lambda \mapsto \log|a_\lambda|$. These maps are exactly equivariant. The first is a positive local diffeomorphism on a compact fundamental parallelogram, and by equivariance everywhere. The second has positive triangular differential on the entire tail. It can be joined to (O.54) by a $C^1$-small equivariant interpolation on a fixed compact collar.

At the selected unit-charge critical point, the limiting version of (O.61) gives $\operatorname{Im}\delta_e > 0$ for either sign of $n_e$, since the limiting $B_{e,N}$ in (O.61) has positive real part. Consequently $\operatorname{Re} V_e = 4\pi \operatorname{Im}\delta_e > 0$, so the longitude multiplier has $|e^{V_e}| > 1$. This is a nonunit **modulus**, not merely the weaker assertion $e^{V_e} \neq 1$. The commuting affine maps therefore have a second common fixed point $q = b/(1-a)$, using $a = e^{V_e}$ for the longitude. As $\rho \to \rho_0$, $q$ escapes to infinity, whereas the developed fundamental parallelogram and its fixed generator paths remain bounded. They miss $q$; equivariance makes the entire development miss it. On its simply connected cover set $f = \log(d_\rho - q)$. The nonsingular invariant metric $|df|^2$ descends to a compact flat torus and is complete. Consequently its development is the plane and its log periods are an injective rank-two lattice.

For each fixed generator path of image length at most $L$, in $|d_\rho| \le R$, its logarithmic increment is at most $L/(|q| - R)$, hence tends to zero. Its exponential is the corresponding similarity multiplier. The difference from the small prescribed log $U$ or $V$ is a multiple of $2\pi i$ tending to zero, so is exactly zero. This proves the actual log periods **before** multiplying them by $p_e$. One neighborhood works for all slopes.

After moving $q$ to zero, the tail contains a full epigraph $y > A|d_\rho|$. With

$$R_{\text{tube}} = \operatorname{arsinh}(|d_\rho|/y), \quad \vartheta = \operatorname{Im} f, \quad X = \operatorname{Re} f + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(1 + y^2/|d_\rho|^2),$$

its metric becomes

$$dR_{\text{tube}}^2 + \cosh^2(R_{\text{tube}})\, dX^2 + \sinh^2(R_{\text{tube}})\, d\vartheta^2. \tag{O.56}$$

The primitive slope in (O.50) has angle $-2\pi$ and zero axial period. A complementary primitive period has nonzero real part, because the lattice has rank two. Adding $R_{\text{tube}} = 0$ therefore adds a smooth solid torus with precisely that meridian. Its holonomy fixes both $q, \infty$ and has multiplier one, so is the identity; the representation descends to the filled group. This excludes the parabolic-slope defect which a bare equation $\exp(U + pV) = 1$ would permit.

At every main cusp all multipliers are one, so (O.55) gives a complete Euclidean torus link and a full horoball quotient. The resulting metric is complete and finite-volume. Its universal developing local isometry covers $\mathbb{H}^3$, proving discrete faithful holonomy.

The representation volume agrees with this filled metric's volume using the same finite boundary triangulation: compare its cusp map with the axis-valued map by the common conical boundary homotopy, whose volume tends to zero, and extend that triangulation through the solid torus with all vertices on the core axis, so every added tetrahedron has zero volume. This is the filling-chain comparison in the general regulator theorem, section 6; it retains the same oriented fundamental class.

Our family satisfies the neighborhood hypothesis: (O.36), (O.42), (O.44), and their chosen flags are holomorphic at zero and converge to their original complete matrices as all $|n_e| \to \infty$. The first-charge solution above therefore lies in this fixed neighborhood after one diagram-dependent threshold. Inserting (O.53) now gives the volume of the actual filled manifold.

Finally, filling a crossing circle along its recorded $\mu_e + p_e\lambda_e$ is the local surgery in the original twice-punctured disk collar which inserts $-2p_e$ crossings. The disks and collars are those constructed in $S^3$ in section O.2.2. Thus the filled topology is the original diagram with

powers (O.29), not a comparison diagram, a tree replacement, or an unnamed representation component.

### O.2.8 Analytic interface and the remaining full-source problem

The independent analytic verification is recorded in the analytic packet and whole-period proof. Its inputs are the exact source (O.33)–(O.35), the positive complete radii and the original primitive face lattice. The relevant graph facts hold here: deleting the protected adjacent vertices from a simple triangulated sphere leaves its surviving ordinary graph connected; a matching outer pair is not the protected pair; every matching factor has $x + y > 0$ and at least one nonmonomial triangle. These give the ordinary Hessian rank and primitive angular differences used by the complex coefficient saddle. They do not require a flat gap forest.

The companion proof establishes the local holomorphic packet and global complex-strip spectral gap, including all odd simple-node normals. It then applies the original contour proof to (O.35), with real spectators during infinite-tail removal, exact endpoint currents, and independent signed reciprocal slopes. That proof returns the nonzero first-charge asymptotic, not just an upper bound on its action. Section O.2.9 records its exact normalization.

For an unchanged opposite-offset even bipyramid, its displayed circle packing is a positive certificate and its oriented top and bottom quartets are exactly the general Morse source (O.33). Consequently this theorem applies to its all-central term at every fixed size, with the original parity/knot qualification. No Conway-tree decomposition or new plat presentation is required.

What remains for its **full** invariant is a strict estimate of the signed contribution outside central, for example

$$|\mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{full}} - \mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{C}}| \le \exp\left[N\left\{\frac{\mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}})}{2\pi} - \eta\right\} + o(N)\right]. \tag{O.57}$$

Failure of complete-radius balance at every mark neither invalidates the all-central theorem nor proves (O.57) false. It removes one known sufficient method of proving (O.57). The present result makes no claim of cancellation or domination for those remaining sectors.

### O.2.9 The nonzero asymptotic with its finite normalization

Here is the analytic statement actually joined to the geometry, with the finite quantities retained. On one fixed complex polydisk there are even holomorphic face-critical actions $A_N$ and face Hessians $H_N$, converging with every fixed derivative to their limiting quantities, such that

$$C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\boldsymbol{\delta}) = \frac{(-1)^{dR} N^{2R} \exp(N A_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}))}{(2\pi N)^{(R-1)/2}\sqrt{\det H_N(\boldsymbol{\delta})}}(1 + O(N^{-1})). \tag{O.58}$$

The action includes all finite anchors, sine and beta terms and any $(\log N)/N$ terms; only the displayed $N^{2R}$ was removed. Its limit is (O.45). The square root in (O.58) is continued from the positive complete face Hessian.

For every fixed $\eta > 0$, there are $\gamma_\eta, \tau_\eta > 0$ such that, on the entire real spectral cube and the indicated thin strip,

$$\begin{gathered} |C_N^{\mathrm{raw}}(\boldsymbol{\delta})| \le e^{N(\Phi_D - \gamma_\eta)}, \\ \max_e |\operatorname{Re}\delta_e| \ge \eta, \quad \operatorname{Re}\delta_e \in [-1/2, 1/2], \quad |\operatorname{Im}\delta_e| \le \tau_\eta. \end{gathered} \tag{O.59}$$

Fixed derivatives satisfy the same type of bound on smaller domains. The local cofactor interpolation retains the odd simple-node derivative, while the shared angular estimate uses the connected ordinary graph and its primitive face-difference rows. The separated real-spectral estimate comes from the exact cofactor starting-row maximum. Its only monomial exception is harmless because every crossing factor has a nonmonomial triangle. These prove (O.58),(O.59) for the all-central projection of the exact coefficient (O.33); they are not inferred from a value-only local recurrence.

Let $\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\mathbf{1}}$ be the finite critical point of

$$A_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}) + \pi i \sum_e n_e \delta_e^2 + 2\pi i \sum_e \delta_e,$$

let $S_{N,\mathbf{1}}$ be its critical value, and let $Q_{N,\mathbf{1}}$ be its negative spectral Hessian. Then the **entire** period (O.35) is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{I}_{N,\mathrm{C}} = q^{d^2 \sum_e n_e/4} (-2i)^R \sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2} \\ \cdot \frac{\prod_e \sin(2\pi \delta_{N,\mathbf{1},e})}{\sqrt{\det H_N(\boldsymbol{\delta}_{N,\mathbf{1}})}\sqrt{\det Q_{N,\mathbf{1}}}} \exp(N S_{N,\mathbf{1}}) \\ \cdot \left(1 + O_{\boldsymbol{n}}(N^{-1}) + O_{\boldsymbol{n}}(e^{-\kappa_{\boldsymbol{n}} N})\right). \end{aligned} \tag{O.60}$$

The spectral determinant uses the Gaussian branch on the cone with positive real part. The sine and both determinant factors have a nonzero limiting product for fixed sufficiently long powers.

For clarity, the charge proof has four logically separate parts. Separate evenness writes $\partial_e A_N = -2\delta_e B_{e,N}(\boldsymbol{\delta}^2)$, where $B_{e,N} \to B_{e,0}$ holomorphically and $B_{e,0}(0) = C_e > 0$. By shrinking the fixed complex chart and then increasing the starting level, we have $\operatorname{Re} B_{e,N} > 0$ throughout that chart. The limit at a nonzero argument need not be the constant $C_e$. The critical equations for positive charge magnitudes give

$$\delta_e = -\frac{\ell_e/n_e}{1 + iB_{e,N}(\boldsymbol{\delta}^2)/(\pi n_e)}, \qquad \operatorname{Im} \delta_e = \frac{\ell_e}{\pi n_e^2} \frac{\operatorname{Re} B_{e,N}}{|1 + iB_{e,N}/(\pi n_e)|^2} > 0. \tag{O.61}$$

An actual outer local cube is shifted to this saddle, with every side current retained below the saddle value. Its negative Hessian has positive real part and its Gaussian coefficient is one. The face and spectral Gaussian powers combine to

$$N^{2R}(2\pi N)^{-(R-1)/2}(2\pi/N)^{R/2} = \sqrt{2\pi}\, N^{R+1/2}. \tag{O.62}$$

Next, differentiating the critical value gives the joint comparison

$$\operatorname{Re} S_{N,\mathbf{1}} - \operatorname{Re} S_{N,\boldsymbol{\ell}} \geq \sum_e \frac{C_e}{2n_e^2}(\ell_e^2 - 1) \tag{O.63}$$

on a fixed scaled local charge box. This is why unequal slopes cause no loss of the theorem: it compares the critical values in one joint family, rather than discarding local errors independently.

Third, infinite far charges are removed on whole real intervals, with the other coordinates kept as real spectators. The sine factor gives zero endpoint values and equal first derivatives; three integrations by parts retain the second-derivative endpoint current. On the shifted

contour the two vertical endpoints are paired before estimation. Their hyperbolic-sine difference and (O.59) give a summable strict gap. The degree-$d$ cosine bound controls the remaining horizontal interval. Only then is the remaining finite charge set divided into local and bounded-bad charges. A separate smaller cube, not the outer saddle cube, controls the latter by a one-coordinate shift. All connectors and all original endpoints are included.

Finally, reflecting any charge sign changes both its sine integral and its charge weight, so all $2^R$ unit signs agree. The raw parity sign cancels exactly:

$$(-1)^{dR}(-1)^{(N+1)R} = 1. \tag{O.64}$$

This leaves the original $q$ phase and the factor $(-2i)^R$ in (O.60). Neither the sign choice of a power nor the parity of $N$ can force cancellation of that leading coefficient.

Equations (O.58)–(O.64) give the nonzero lower as well as the upper asymptotic. Taking its logarithm and using (O.53) and the metric construction proves (O.30),(O.31). Thus the flat-plat wording in the older all-central theorem is a limitation of its stated input, not a remaining mathematical restriction after these separate Morse source, analytic, and geometric arguments.

# Appendix P

# Weak balance in the complete circle packing

The strict balance condition in Appendix L is sufficient to control the complementary part of the invariant. We now allow equality in that condition. The change is useful because the face weights used in a coefficient estimate need not remain the curvatures of a circle packing. Moving them a small distance from the complete packing creates a first-order local gain. Stationarity makes the cost to the complete action only second order. We account for both changes on the same shared face variables.

## P.1 The unchanged diagram and the volume statement

Fix a finite simple triangulation of the sphere with at least four vertices, a perfect matching of its cubic dual, and one nonmatching edge as the reduced mark. Use the augmented diagram and its labeled crossing disks constructed in Appendix O. There are $R$ matched pairs of triangles and $R+2$ white vertices. The marked edge joins the protected vertices $u, v$; let $V$ be the set of the $R$ ordinary vertices. The complete packing has curvatures $w_u^* = w_v^* = 0$ and $w_f^* > 0$ for $f \in V$. Curvature is the reciprocal radius of a finite circle. Write

$$q_f = \log w_f^*, \qquad \Phi = \frac{\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)}{2\pi},$$

where $Y_D$ is the actual augmented link complement.

At a crossing region the cyclic face order is $(x, b, y, c)$ and the matched diagonal is $xy$. The polynomial arguments are ordered $(x, b, c, y)$. To state the condition, define

$$\Lambda(s) = -\int_0^s \log|2\sin z|\,\mathrm{d}z, \qquad f(a) = \frac{\Lambda(\pi a) + \Lambda(\pi/2 - \pi a)}{\pi} \quad (0 \le a \le \tfrac{1}{2}).$$

For a triple of nonnegative weights $w = (w_1, w_2, w_3)$ with at least one positive entry, its triangle potential is

$$Q(w) = \max_{\substack{a_i \ge 0 \ (w_i>0) \\ \sum_{i:w_i>0} a_i = 1/2}} \sum_{i:w_i>0} \{f(a_i) + a_i \log w_i\}.$$

The zero-weight corners are omitted from this maximization. If only $w_i$ is positive, then $Q(w) = \frac{1}{2}\log w_i$. These conventions avoid taking a logarithm of a protected zero. Put

$$X_e = Q(w_x^*, w_b^*, w_y^*) + Q(w_x^*, w_c^*, w_y^*).$$

Only positive middle curvatures occur inside logarithms below.

**Theorem P.1** (Volume limit under weak balance)**.** *Suppose the actual complete packing satisfies*

$$X_e \geq \log w_b^* \quad (w_b^* > 0), \qquad X_e \geq \log w_c^* \quad (w_c^* > 0) \tag{P.1}$$

*at every crossing region. Fix retained half twists $\epsilon_e \in \{0, \pm 1\}$ whose original strand connections give one knot, with no additional closed main component. There is a threshold $T$, depending on these fixed data, such that independently chosen fixed integers $p_e$ with $|p_e| > T$ give a hyperbolic knot $K_{\boldsymbol{p}}$ and*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\langle K_{\boldsymbol{p}} \rangle_N| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}).$$

*The crossing powers are $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$. The invariant is the original reduced, zero-framed Kashaev invariant with unknot value one, and the limit includes both parities and composite levels. The diagram, its mark, and all powers are fixed before $N$ varies.*

No terminal tangles are inserted in this theorem. Its restriction is the packing inequality (P.1); it is not a theorem for all unchanged matched spheres. A quantified extension below permits some positive defects in that inequality. The proof uses the full geometric contribution of Appendix O and the finite norm bound of Appendix N.

## P.2 Triangle entropy, its Hessian, and the complete action

For an original triangle $t$, let $I_t \subset V$ be its ordinary corners. This set is nonempty. Put

$$\begin{aligned} f(a) &= \frac{\Lambda(\pi a) + \Lambda(\pi/2 - \pi a)}{\pi}, \qquad 0 \leq a \leq \tfrac{1}{2}, \\ Q_t(q') &= \max_{\substack{a_i \geq 0 \ (i\in I_t) \\ \sum_{i\in I_t} a_i = 1/2}} \sum_{i\in I_t} \bigl(f(a_i) + a_i q_i'\bigr), \end{aligned} \tag{P.2}$$

where $\Lambda(s) = -\int_0^s \log|2\sin z|\,\mathrm{d}z$. Protected corners are deleted from the supported simplex; their weights remain exactly zero. The notation $Q(w_x, w_b, w_y)$ means this function with $q_i' = \log w_i$ at the positive coordinates. This is the absolute normalization of the cofactor action, including the determinant, beta and half-index factors. In particular a singleton row has $Q_t(q') = q_i'/2$.

Direct differentiation gives

$$f(0) = f(1/2) = 0, \qquad f'(a) = \log\cot(\pi a), \qquad f''(a) = -\frac{2\pi}{\sin(2\pi a)} < 0.$$

Thus $f(a) > 0$ for $0 < a < 1/2$. If two or three weights are positive, write $w_i = e^{q_i'}$ and

$$D_t^2 = \sum_{\{i,j\}\subset I_t} w_i w_j, \qquad a_{ti} = \frac{1}{\pi}\arctan\frac{w_i}{D_t}. \tag{P.3}$$

These loads sum to 1/2. For three weights this follows from $D_t^2 - w_i w_j = w_k(w_i + w_j)$ and the addition formula for tangent; for two weights the two tangent ratios are reciprocal. Moreover, $f'(a_{ti}) + q'_i = \log D_t$. Strict concavity proves that these are the unique maximizing loads in (P.2). Consequently

$$\partial_{q'_i} Q_t = a_{ti}, \qquad E_t(q') := Q_t(q') - q' \cdot \nabla Q_t(q') = \sum_{i \in I_t} f(a_{ti}).$$

The row entropy $E_t$ is positive on a nonsingleton row and zero on a singleton row.

For distinct ordinary corners, differentiating (P.3) gives

$$\partial_{q'_i q'_j} Q_t = -\kappa_{ij}^t, \qquad \kappa_{ij}^t = \frac{w_i w_j}{2\pi D_t (w_i + w_j)} \le \frac{1}{4\pi}. \tag{P.4}$$

For three corners, the cancellation uses $D_t^2 + w_i^2 = (w_i + w_j)(w_i + w_k)$. The upper bound follows from $D_t \ge \sqrt{w_i w_j}$ and $w_i + w_j \ge 2\sqrt{w_i w_j}$. Homogeneity gives zero row sums in the Hessian. Its quadratic form is therefore

$$h^{\mathsf{t}} \nabla^2 Q_t(q') h = \sum_{\{i,j\} \subset I_t} \kappa_{ij}^t (h_i - h_j)^2.$$

This also proves positive semidefiniteness directly.

Set

$$P(q') = \sum_t Q_t(q') - \sum_{f \in V} q'_f. \tag{P.5}$$

At the complete packing $q$, the face-star equations and calibrated geometric action of Appendix O give

$$\sum_{t \ni f} a_{tf} = 1, \qquad \nabla P(q) = 0, \qquad P(q) = \Phi. \tag{P.6}$$

These are statements about the complete geometric contribution. They do not assume a bound for the complementary part of the invariant.

## P.3 Changing the common weights

For $0 < t < 1$, replace every ordinary weight by

$$w_f(t) = (w_f^*)^{1-t}.$$

Keep the two protected weights zero. These numbers specify one valid Cauchy coefficient torus. They need not describe another packing. Define

$$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \sum_t \sum_{\{i,j\} \subset I_t} (q_i - q_j)^2 = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sum_{\substack{ij \text{ a white edge} \\ i,j \in V}} (q_i - q_j)^2. \tag{P.7}$$

The second expression counts the two triangles incident to each ordinary white edge. Taylor's formula, (P.4), and (P.6) give the entire action cost

$$0 \le P((1-t)q) - \Phi = \int_0^t (t-s) q^{\mathsf{t}} \nabla^2 P((1-s)q) q \, \mathrm{d}s \le \tfrac{1}{2} t^2 \mathcal{E}. \tag{P.8}$$

The local gain is first order. Put $E_t(\beta) = Q_t(\beta q) - \beta q \cdot \nabla Q_t(\beta q)$ for $0 < \beta \le 1$. Differentiation gives

$$E_t'(\beta) = -\beta q^{\mathsf{t}} \nabla^2 Q_t(\beta q) q \le 0.$$

Integrating the derivative of $Q_t(\beta q)/\beta$ yields

$$Q_t(\beta q) = \beta Q_t(q) + \beta \int_\beta^1 \frac{E_t(s)}{s^2}\, \mathrm{d}s \ge \beta Q_t(q) + (1-\beta) E_t(q). \tag{P.9}$$

Singleton rows satisfy the same identity, with zero entropy.

At a crossing region, abbreviate $Q_b = Q(x, b, y)$ and $Q_c = Q(x, c, y)$. The three local rates, uniform in face phases and throughout the real spectral interval, are

$$A_C = X = Q_b + Q_c, \quad A_L = \max(\log c, Q_b + \tfrac{1}{2}\log c), \quad A_R = \max(\log b, Q_c + \tfrac{1}{2}\log b). \tag{P.10}$$

A left or right label with protected overloaded middle is omitted: its finite polynomial is identically zero. The source estimates behind (P.10) are the coefficient bound for the central cofactor and the complete unused-prefix and unused-suffix estimate for a one-sided path, as used in Section L.9.1. They hold at arbitrary fixed positive ordinary weights. Their derivation precedes any use of complete balance.

For a surviving side $(e, s)$, let $z$ be its overloaded middle and let $t(e, s)$ be the triangle containing $z$. Define, at the complete packing,

$$\epsilon_{e,s} = \max(0, q_z - X_e(q)), \qquad h_{e,s} = E_{t(e,s)}(q) > 0. \tag{P.11}$$

The strict positivity needs a geometric incidence observation. The outer edge is matched, whereas the protected edge is nonmatching. Since the sphere is simple, the outer pair cannot be precisely the two protected vertices. Hence the triangle containing a positive overloaded middle has another ordinary corner.

For the left side the exact loss is

$$X - A_L = \min(X - \log c, Q_c - \tfrac{1}{2}\log c).$$

At completeness the second expression is positive: the pure-middle simplex vertex has value $\frac{1}{2}\log c$, while the unique maximizer has positive load at every allowed corner. Apply (P.9) to both expressions and put $\beta = 1 - t$. The first receives the entropy of both triangles, while the second receives that of the overloaded triangle. This proves, for either side,

$$(X_e - A_s)((1-t)q) \ge t h_{e,s} - (1-t)\epsilon_{e,s}. \tag{P.12}$$

All weights in this comparison belong to the same global vector.

## P.4 A quantitative criterion and the full complementary sum

Suppose for some $0 < t < 1$ that

$$\gamma_0 := \min_{(e,s)\ \text{surviving}} \{t h_{e,s} - (1-t)\epsilon_{e,s}\} - \tfrac{1}{2} t^2 \mathcal{E} > 0. \tag{P.13}$$

This is a sufficient condition even when weak balance fails. If no one-sided label survives, the complement is exactly zero and the criterion is unnecessary. Otherwise put $h_* = \min h_{e,s} > 0$. Under weak balance all defects vanish. Choose

$$t_0 = \begin{cases} \min(1/2, h_*/\mathcal{E}), & \mathcal{E} > 0, \\ 1/2, & \mathcal{E} = 0. \end{cases} \tag{P.14}$$

Then $\gamma_0 \geq t_0 h_*/2 > 0$; when $\mathcal{E} = 0$ the stronger value is $h_*/2$. This proves that any number of equalities in (P.1) cause no exceptional sector. More generally, $\max \epsilon_{e,s} < t_0 h_*/2$ suffices, with gap at least $t_0 h_*/2 - \max \epsilon_{e,s}$.

Here is the passage from these real functions to the original invariant. Put $d = N - 1$ and write $S_N(\boldsymbol{\sigma})$ for the exact shared spectral polynomial of the Morse source. Its local numerator is

$$V_N(\sigma; \Omega) = \frac{\chi_N(\sigma) - \chi_N(\Omega)}{\sigma - \Omega}, \qquad \chi_N(z) = 2T_N(z/2) + 2,$$

where division is polynomial division and $T_N(\cos\theta) = \cos(N\theta)$. Thus each spectral degree is at most $d$, including the derivative data at repeated roots. The shared polynomial is

$$S_N = [\prod_{f \in V} L_f^d] \prod_e H_{V_N}(L_{x_e}, L_{b_e}, L_{c_e}, L_{y_e}; \sigma_e)\Big|_{L_u = L_v = 0}.$$

The original marked cut, face measure and even-level coset are included in this identity. No further factor $N^R$ is inserted.

Let $C_N$ select the central path sector at every crossing region, with the odd central row included once, and let $D_N = S_N - C_N$. A genuine label string in $D_N$ contains at least one left or right choice. Denote its one-sided positions by $J$. Cauchy's coefficient inequality on the single torus $|L_f| = (w_f^*)^{1-t}$, together with (P.8) and (P.12), bounds its logarithmic rate by

$$\Phi + \tfrac{1}{2} t^2 \mathcal{E} - \sum_{(e,s) \in J} \{t h_{e,s} - (1-t)\epsilon_{e,s}\} \leq \Phi - \gamma_0.$$

Condition (P.13) makes every summand in braces positive, so other one-sided choices cannot undo the loss. The local bounds are uniform in all face phases and real spectral values. The original target is $d$, and $d/N = 1 - 1/N$ changes the normalized logarithm by only $O(1/N)$ at these fixed weights. There are at most $3^R - 1$ strings, a number independent of $N$. Hence

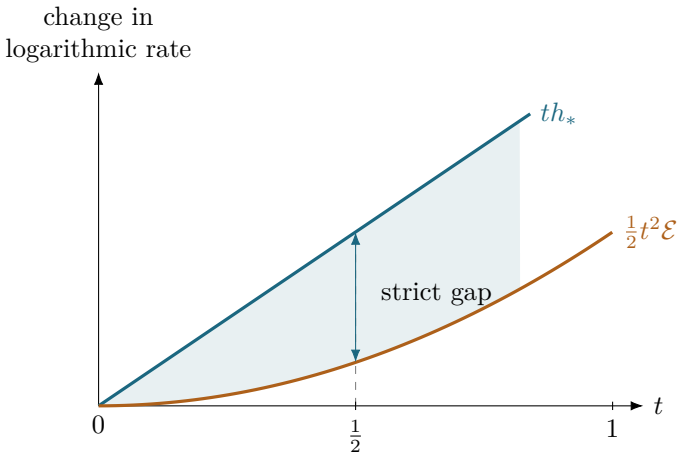
$$\limsup_{N \to \infty} \frac{1}{N} \log \|D_N\|_{[-2,2]^R} \leq \Phi - \gamma_0. \tag{P.15}$$

The statement includes both level parities and retains all shared face targets.

## P.5 The original filling and the actual hyperbolic volume

The finite norm theorem of Appendix N applies because $D_N$ has degree at most $d$ in each spectral variable. For the original filling functionals it gives

$$\left| \left( \bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e} \right) D_N \right| \leq \prod_e (1 + |n_e|/2)\, \|D_N\|_{[-2,2]^R}. \tag{P.16}$$




The linear entropy gain exceeds the quadratic action cost for a sufficiently small positive $t$.

Figure P.1: The estimates used to create a strict remainder bound. The plot uses $h_* = \mathcal{E} = 1$ to illustrate their different orders in $t$. For an actual packing, both constants are defined from its original triangles. The difference between the upper line and lower curve is $th_* - t^2\mathcal{E}/2$.

The twists are fixed, so this costs no exponential rate. The exact finite identity also gives $Z_N = (\bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e})S_N$ and $Z_{N,C} = (\bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e})C_N$.

Appendix O supplies, for independently sufficiently long fixed signed powers,

$$Z_{N,C} = a_{N,\boldsymbol{n}} e^{N\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}}}, \qquad \frac{1}{N}\log|a_{N,\boldsymbol{n}}| \longrightarrow 0,$$

with nonzero amplitude for all sufficiently large levels, and

$$\Re\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}} = \Phi - O_D\left(\sum_e n_e^{-2}\right), \qquad 2\pi\Re\mathcal{A}_{\boldsymbol{n}} = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}). \tag{P.17}$$

The second identity uses the original primitive peripheral basis. The actual periods satisfy the filling equation for $\mu_e + p_e\lambda_e$, and the completed auxiliary end is a smooth solid torus with cone angle $2\pi$. The main knot cusp stays complete. The regulator's boundary correction cancels the filling correction in the critical action. These are the geometric completion steps proved there, not a new identification inferred from a shared stationary equation.

Choose $0 < \eta < \gamma_0$ and increase the common twist threshold until the drop in (P.17) is less than $\eta/2$. Equations (P.15)–(P.16) then give

$$\frac{Z_N}{Z_{N,C}} = 1 + O_{\boldsymbol{n}}(e^{-cN})$$

for some $c > 0$. The prescribed complete-color framing and component factors have modulus one. In the full one-cut modified convention the additional factor is $i^{N+3}/N$, which also has zero exponential rate. Thus the same limit holds for the normalized invariant in Theorem P.1, proving it. The argument also proves its extension under (P.13).

The theorem supplies an unchanged-diagram sufficient condition of arbitrary finite size. It does not impose a tree or bridge-width restriction. Whether a diagram satisfies the condition is a separate geometric question; the theorem supplies neither a universal balance claim nor a filling threshold uniform over growing diagrams.

# Appendix Q

# Protected triangular sums of certified diagrams

This appendix proves a constructive closure theorem for full source certificates. The inputs are actual marked simple-sphere diagrams whose phase-uniform local envelopes admit an unabridged finite shared-radius certificate. The output is their literal protected triangular sum. Its full source has a strict complementary gap at both level parities, and its independently sufficiently long fixed signed fillings satisfy the volume limit for the actual new knot.

A shared-radius certificate uses one positive weight for each ordinary white face, with the same weight at every occurrence of that face. The join below identifies one ordinary face of each input. Homogeneity lets us normalize both input certificates at that face, while an exact local inequality accounts for its single output coefficient target. If the inputs satisfy weak balance, the output does too. The more general certificate hypothesis also yields marked examples outside weak balance.

**Theorem Q.1** (Closure under protected triangular sums)**.** *Let $D_1, \dots, D_k$, $k \geq 2$, be marked matched spheres as defined in Section Q.1. Suppose each satisfies the certificate hypothesis* (Q.5)*, with gap $\gamma_j > 0$. Any fixed finite assembly using the operation of Section Q.2 has such a certificate with gap at least $\min_j \gamma_j$.*

*Fix a half-twist pattern whose strand connections in the assembled diagram form one knot, with no additional closed main component. All independently sufficiently long fixed signed primitive fillings then satisfy the full reduced-invariant volume limit* (Q.24)*. The threshold may depend on this entire fixed diagram and pattern. Section Q.7 gives arbitrarily large examples whose marked complete packings fail weak balance, starting from a seventeen-region finite-cover certificate.*

## Q.1 The diagrams, local envelopes, and exact certificate hypothesis

An input $D$ is a fixed connected oriented simple triangulated white sphere, a perfect matching of its dual triangles, the literal inverse-cut diagram in $S^3$, its cyclic crossing orders and disk framings, and a marked nonmatching edge $uv$. The two protected face variables are exactly $L_u = L_v = 0$. Every other vertex has the original target $d = N - 1$. Write $R_D$ for their

number, which is also the number of matching regions.

The white sphere is the combinatorial record of the two reflected polyhedral pieces obtained by cutting the augmented diagram. A matched pair of white triangles records one crossing circle and its twice-punctured disk. The inverse-cut construction retains the order of the four adjacent white faces and the disk framing; these are part of the data, not choices made after the gluing. Let $Y_D$ denote the complete augmented exterior in $S^3$, before filling its crossing-circle cusps and with the main strand components retained. Its positive convex cell realization is supplied by the simple-sphere construction in Appendix L, equivalently the terminal-fan theorem, §§2–4. The literal diagram realization and primitive disk curves are those of the general Morse geometric theorem, §§1–2, also given in Appendix O.

Use the source-normalized complete triangle potential

$$Q(w_1,w_2,w_3)=\max_{\substack{\alpha_i\ge 0\\ \sum\alpha_i=1/2\\ \alpha_i=0 \text{ if } w_i=0}}\left\{\sum_i f(\alpha_i)+\sum_{w_i>0}\alpha_i\log w_i\right\},\qquad f(t)=\frac{\Lambda(\pi t)+\Lambda(\pi/2-\pi t)}{\pi}. \tag{Q.1}$$

Here $\Lambda(s)=-\int_0^s\log|2\sin t|\,dt$ is the Lobachevsky function; only $0\le t\le 1/2$ occurs in $f(t)$. Zero coordinates are deleted from the supported simplex. Thus, for example, $Q(0,0,B)=\frac{1}{2}\log B$ exactly. At an ordered quartet $(x,b,c,y)$, the input and output triangles are $(x,b,y)$ and $(x,y,c)$. Put

$$\begin{aligned}A_C&=Q(x,b,y)+Q(x,c,y),\\ A_L&=\max\{\log c,Q(x,b,y)+\tfrac{1}{2}\log c\},\\ A_R&=\max\{\log b,Q(x,c,y)+\tfrac{1}{2}\log b\}.\end{aligned} \tag{Q.2}$$

left is absent when $c$ is protected; right is absent when $b$ is protected. These are the proved bounds for the actual local path pieces, uniform in their real spectral parameter and all face phases. central includes its original odd central row. The physical reflected order, rather than an arbitrary relabeling of a matrix, supplies right.

For each locally allowed label string $\omega$, define

$$G_{D,\omega}(q)=\sum_e A_{e,\omega_e}(e^q)-\sum_{f\ne u,v}q_f,\qquad \mathcal{C}_{D,\omega}=\inf_{q\in\mathbb{R}^{R_D}}G_{D,\omega}(q). \tag{Q.3}$$

Protected coordinates are kept zero in this notation. Complete simple-sphere geometry gives a finite positive stationary vector, modulo a common scale, and

$$\mathcal{C}_{D,C}=\Phi_D=\frac{\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)}{2\pi}. \tag{Q.4}$$

**Certificate hypothesis.** There is $\gamma_D>0$ such that for every locally allowed string $\omega\ne C$, a positive shared ordinary vector $L^{D,\omega}$ satisfies

$$G_{D,\omega}(\log L^{D,\omega})\le\Phi_D-\gamma_D. \tag{Q.5}$$

Different strings may use different vectors. Each vector is shared by all incidences of its face; there is no independently chosen weight for a triangle corner or crossing incidence.

A finite branch cover using maxima of the allowed local rates is sufficient for (Q.5), by assigning each string to a branch that covers it. There are finitely many strings for a fixed input. Conversely, one witness per string is a finite cover. This is a hypothesis about the original phase-uniform envelopes, not merely a bound for a signed coefficient at a selected spectrum.

The cover must be unabridged: it covers every locally allowed noncentral string, including one whose final shared coefficient might vanish identically for a separate reason. A certificate that omits strings by a global support or cancellation argument is not automatically an input to this theorem. No transfer of such an omission is assumed. Protected-overloaded labels are the only automatic omissions used here.

Multiplying all ordinary weights by $t > 0$ increases each triangle potential by $\frac{1}{2}\log t$, and each local rate by $\log t$. Since there are $R_D$ rates and $R_D$ ordinary targets, every $G_{D,\omega}$ is invariant under $q \mapsto q + t\mathbf{1}$. Thus a whole witness may always be normalized at any specified ordinary face.

## Q.2 The oriented protected triangular sum

Choose a triangle incident to the marked edge in each of two inputs. Identify their three boundary vertices so that the protected pair is $u, v$, the ordinary third vertex is $B$, and their matched boundary sides agree. Record the orientations as

| | removed triangle | original quartet |
|---|---|---|
| $D_1$ | $(u, v, B)$ | $(u, v, c, B)$ |
| $D_2$ | $(u, B, v)$ | $(u, a, v, B)$. |

(Q.6)

The two removed faces have opposite orientations. The ordinary vertices $a, c$ are distinct after relabeling the interiors. If a reflection of an entire input is needed to achieve these conventions, transport its complete cyclic orders, source labels and crossing signs with that reflection. The envelope functions and absolute volume are unchanged.

Delete the two faces, glue their boundary triangles, remove their two matching pairs, and pair their former partners. The retained triangles are

$$(u, a, B), \qquad (u, B, c),$$

so the merged crossing has the exact quartet

$$(u, a, c, B). \tag{Q.7}$$

Keep every other oriented face, matching edge and local order.

The two punctured spheres are triangulated disks with disjoint interiors and no additional common vertices. Their union is a simple oriented triangulated sphere. The merged matching edge $uB$ has four distinct incident vertices; all remaining matching pairs were already valid. The edge $uv$ is retained and remains nonmatching. Every triangle is paired once. The count is

$$R = R_1 + R_2 - 1, \qquad |V| = R + 2, \quad |F| = 2R, \quad |E| = 3R. \tag{Q.8}$$

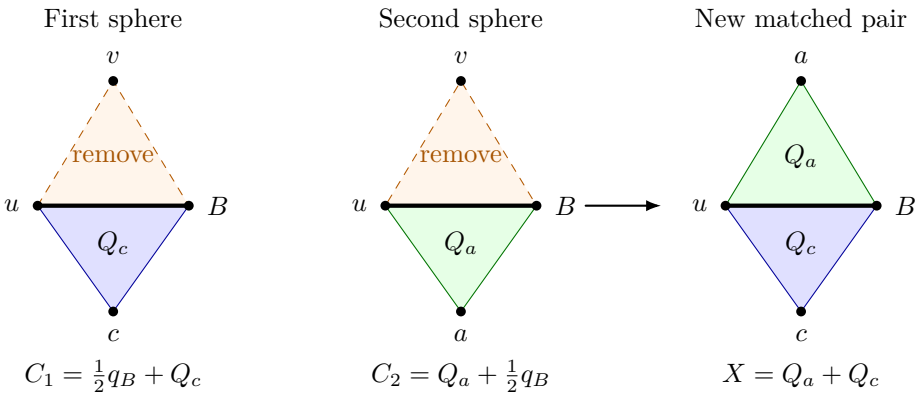
Only $u, v, B$ are identified; every other ordinary coordinate in one input is distinct from every such coordinate in the other.

The original inverse-cut construction therefore realizes the new data as an augmented link in $S^3$, with its own primitive disk curves. This is an operation on recorded diagrams, not only an abstract tensor contraction. A knot-producing pattern can be obtained directly. The untwisted physical strands form projection circles, and a box joins the two circles that pass through its disk. Their adjacency graph is connected because the original four-valent diagram is connected. Choose a spanning tree, switch precisely its boxes to the odd terminal pairing, and leave all others even. Each tree edge joins two distinct current components; induction leaves a single main component. Either odd sign is allowed. This is the marked construction of the inverse-cut source theorem, §3. The theorem permits any parity choice passing the new diagram's original one-component test, with no internally closed extra main component. It does not assert that arbitrary old parity choices can be merged without that test.

## Q.3 The complete action and the original target correction

Put $q_B = \log B$, $Q_a = Q(0, a, B)$, and $Q_c = Q(0, c, B)$. The two old complete bridge rates and the new one are

$$C_1 = \tfrac{1}{2}q_B + Q_c, \qquad C_2 = Q_a + \tfrac{1}{2}q_B, \qquad X = Q_a + Q_c = C_1 + C_2 - q_B. \tag{Q.9}$$




The boundary triangles are identified with opposite orientations.
The thick edge $uB$ pairs the two retained triangles.

Figure Q.1: The local protected triangular sum. The vertices $u, v$ are protected; $B, a, c$ are ordinary. Only the two dashed triangle faces are removed: their boundary vertices and edges are identified, and $v$ remains elsewhere in the assembled sphere. The thick side $uB$ pairs the retained triangles. Here $q_B = \log B$, $Q_a = Q(0, a, B)$, and $Q_c = Q(0, c, B)$. The local complete rate loses $q_B$, exactly compensating for counting the ordinary $B$-target once rather than twice.

Every other complete triangle rate is retained. On the other hand, the combined ordinary target at $B$ is counted once, rather than once in each input. Write $P_i = G_{D_i,C}$ and $P_{\text{new}} = G_{\text{new},C}$. Thus

$$P_{\text{new}}(q_1, q_2) = P_1(q_1) + P_2(q_2) \tag{Q.10}$$

whenever the two displayed vectors agree at $B$. This is an identity of the full shared functions, not an inequality between separately optimized local terms.

Normalize both complete minimizers by $q_B = 0$. They then combine to a minimizer of (Q.10); conversely (Q.10) is bounded below by the sum of their minima. Hence

$$\Phi = \Phi_1 + \Phi_2. \tag{Q.11}$$

This also proves that the original complete curvatures on each piece are unchanged after their common rescaling. The complete simple-sphere theorem identifies $2\pi\Phi$ with the actual new augmented volume. It does not identify independently filled input manifolds with the filled output manifold.

## Q.4 Every genuine sector at the merged crossing

The variational formula (Q.1), using the simplex vertex at $B$, gives

$$Q_a, Q_c \geq \tfrac{1}{2} q_B. \tag{Q.12}$$

They are strictly larger because $a, c, B$ are ordinary and positive. No positivity of $q_B$ itself is needed.

At the old first crossing only left survives among the one-sided labels, and at the old second only right survives among them:

$$L_1 = \max\{q_c, \tfrac{1}{2} q_B + \tfrac{1}{2} q_c\}, \qquad R_2 = \max\{q_a, \tfrac{1}{2} q_B + \tfrac{1}{2} q_a\}. \tag{Q.13}$$

The new local rates are

$$L = \max\{q_c, Q_a + \tfrac{1}{2} q_c\}, \qquad R = \max\{q_a, Q_c + \tfrac{1}{2} q_a\}. \tag{Q.14}$$

Together (Q.9) and (Q.12) give all three required cases:

| new label | input labels | rate comparison |
|---|---|---|
| $C$ | $(C, C)$ | $X = C_1 + C_2 - q_B$ |
| $L$ | $(L, C)$ | $L \leq L_1 + C_2 - q_B$ |
| $R$ | $(C, R)$ | $R \leq C_1 + R_2 - q_B$. |

(Q.15)

For example

$$L_1 + C_2 - q_B = \max\{q_c + Q_a - \tfrac{1}{2} q_B,\ Q_a + \tfrac{1}{2} q_c\} \geq \max\{q_c, Q_a + \tfrac{1}{2} q_c\} = L.$$

The right case is identical with $a, c$ exchanged. The inequality retains the mixed branch of the genuine one-sided rate; it is not a replacement by a pure-middle monomial.

For a whole output string $\omega$, leave every other local label on its original input and use (Q.15) at the merged crossing. This defines input strings $\omega_1, \omega_2$. They are locally allowed; no protected-overloaded side was introduced. If the output is noncentral, at least one input string is noncentral. The one target correction in (Q.10) now gives

$$G_{\mathrm{new},\omega}(q_1, q_2) \leq G_{1,\omega_1}(q_1) + G_{2,\omega_2}(q_2), \qquad (q_1)_B = (q_2)_B. \tag{Q.16}$$

For a noncentral input choose its witness (Q.5); for a central input choose its complete minimizer. Rescale each whole vector to $B = 1$. Homogeneity changes none of these actions.

The vectors now agree on every shared coordinate: $u, v$ are zero and $B = 1$. Hence they form one legal shared Cauchy vector for the new source. Equations (Q.11) and (Q.16) prove

$$G_{\mathrm{new},\omega} \le \Phi - \min(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) \qquad (\omega \ne C). \tag{Q.17}$$

If both input strings are noncentral their losses add. Per-sector witnesses are essential to this simple statement: the other input can use its complete minimizer when its induced string is central. There is no claim that one input witness vector works for every case simultaneously.

Equivalently, taking infima after the $B = 1$ normalization gives

$$\mathcal{C}_{\mathrm{new},\omega} \le \mathcal{C}_{1,\omega_1} + \mathcal{C}_{2,\omega_2}. \tag{Q.18}$$

No existence of a noncentral capacity minimizer is needed.

## Q.5 The full finite source and the volume limit

Set $q_N = e^{\pi i/N}$, $d = N - 1$. The local polynomial $H_{V_N}$ is the original homogeneous face numerator of

$$V_N(\sigma; \Omega) = \chi_N(\sigma)(\sigma - \Omega)^{-1}, \qquad \chi_N(\sigma) = 2T_N(\sigma/2) + 2, \tag{Q.19}$$

where $\Omega$ is the original two-strand Casimir and the right side denotes its degree-$d$ polynomial numerator, including at the repeated roots. $T_N$ is the Chebyshev polynomial. In its face expansion, a recurrence path from index $j$ to $i$ has middle powers $b^i c^{d-j}$. If $h = \lfloor d/2 \rfloor$, central means $i \le h$ and $d - j \le h$, left means $d - j > h$, and right means $i > h$. These supports are disjoint and exhaustive. This fixes the source normalization and the meaning of every label used above.

The original full numerator is

$$S_{N,\mathrm{full}}(\boldsymbol{\sigma}) = [\prod_{f \ne u,v} L_f^{N-1}] \prod_e H_{V_N}(L_x, L_b, L_c, L_y; \sigma_e)\Big|_{L_u = L_v = 0}. \tag{Q.20}$$

The actual Morse identity includes the unrestricted physical mark, all cup and cap factors, the even coset and the face measure. No additional mark or factor $N$ is introduced at the triangular sum. Each local polynomial has degree at most $N - 1$ in its spectral variable. The C/L/R partition and rates (Q.2) are valid at both parities and uniformly over all face phases and $\sigma_e \in [-2, 2]$. The literal coefficient identity is the general Morse source theorem, §§5–6; the phase-uniform estimates (Q.2) are the cofactor bounds used in the finite-cover theorem and weak balance, §§4–6.

Use the vector supplied by (Q.17) for each genuine noncentral string. Cauchy's coefficient inequality, with the original targets $N-1$, gives its rate at most $\Phi - \gamma$, where $\gamma = \min(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) > 0$. Replacing the normalized targets by one costs only a fixed logarithmic term divided by $N$. The finite number of factors, polynomial prefactors and local uniform errors contribute $o(N)$ for the fixed new diagram. There are only finitely many strings. Therefore

$$\limsup_{N \to \infty} \frac{1}{N} \log \|S_{N,\mathrm{full}} - S_{N,C}\|_{[-2,2]^R} \le \Phi - \gamma. \tag{Q.21}$$

The limit superior includes even, odd and composite levels. This proves a bound for the entire complementary polynomial, not merely a fixed endpoint slice.

Apply the finite Hermite functional of Appendix N, equivalently the uniform filling bound, to (Q.21). It inserts the original power $R^{n_e}$, including the normal data at double spectral roots. More precisely, the original reduced ribbon contraction is

$$Z_N(\boldsymbol{n}) = \left(\bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e}\right) S_{N,\mathrm{full}}, \qquad \left\|\bigotimes_e \mathcal{L}_N^{n_e}\right\| \le \prod_e (1 + |n_e|/2). \tag{Q.22}$$

For fixed integer powers this bound has zero exponential rate, so the complementary filled contribution has rate at most $\Phi - \gamma$.

Appendix O, equivalently the Morse period theorem and its geometric identification, supplies the nonzero full all-central period for this original matched sphere. Its selected action $S_{\boldsymbol{p}}$ obeys

$$\Re S_{\boldsymbol{p}} \longrightarrow \Phi \quad \text{as every } |p_e| \longrightarrow \infty \quad \text{independently}, \qquad 2\pi \Re S_{\boldsymbol{p}} = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}). \tag{Q.23}$$

The latter equality uses the new diagram's complete positive cells, its original meridians and longitudes, the primitive equations $U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i$, the main cusp left complete, and the same-chain volume calibration. It is not inferred from (Q.11) or from a formal critical value.

Choose the independent long-filling threshold so that the selected real action is larger than $\Phi - \gamma/2$, and so that the original primitive completion and nonzero all-charge asymptotic apply. The complementary contribution is then exponentially smaller. The full reduced zero-framed invariant satisfies

$$\boxed{\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\langle K_{\boldsymbol{p}} \rangle_N| = \mathrm{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{p}}).} \tag{Q.24}$$

Here $\langle K \rangle_N$ is the original reduced, zero-framed complete-color Kashaev invariant, with unknot value one. Conversion from $Z_N$ retains the original framing/component character, which has modulus one at complete color; for a knot its enhanced component sign is one. The full one-cut modified convention retains its additional factor $i^{N+3}/N$, whose exponential rate is zero. The knot pattern and every signed integer $p_e$, with $n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e$, are fixed before $N$ tends to infinity. No ratio bound between the large fillings or uniform threshold over growing diagrams is asserted.

## Q.6 Arbitrarily many blocks and weak balance as an input

Take any finite number $k \ge 2$ of certified marked inputs. Repeatedly perform the operation of Section Q.2 at the retained common marked edge $uv$, identifying the chosen ordinary third vertex of the next block with the ordinary third vertex on the selected incident triangle of the current sphere. The previous ordinary coordinates are retained; only the two chosen third vertices are identified. At each step use fresh interior vertices.

After every step the sphere is simple and $uv$ is still nonmatching, so it has two incident triangles available for the next step. Thus the construction has no upper bound on $k$. Induction on (Q.8), (Q.11) and (Q.17) gives

$$R_{\mathrm{new}} = \sum_{j=1}^{k} R_j - (k-1), \qquad \Phi_{\mathrm{new}} = \sum_{j=1}^{k} \Phi_j, \qquad \gamma_{\mathrm{new}} \ge \min_{1\le j\le k} \gamma_j. \tag{Q.25}$$

The exact witnesses are obtained recursively. At the next attachment one may rescale the entire previous witness to normalize its new joining face; protected zeros remain zero and all existing incidence identifications remain intact. One does not normalize already shared faces independently. The limiting statement always fixes this finite assembled diagram first.

If each input packing is weak-balanced, the new complete packing retains all their unmerged local comparisons. At the new crossing,

$$X = Q_a + Q_c \geq C_1 \geq \log c, \qquad X \geq C_2 \geq \log a, \tag{Q.26}$$

where the first comparisons use (Q.12). They are in fact strict at this merged crossing. Thus protected triangular sums of weak-balanced inputs are themselves weak-balanced. The existing power-flattening theorem supplies their unabridged certificates. This gives a direct constructive family, with unrestricted finite numbers of certified pieces and arbitrary cycles already present inside those pieces.

More generally the theorem uses (Q.5), which includes refined per-sector or finite-branch shared-radius certificates. It does not assert that the result lies outside all previously known knot presentations. Its contribution is the closure proof retaining the literal matching and the single original target at every face.

## Q.7 Arbitrarily large certified marked diagrams outside weak balance

The closure is not confined to weak-balanced inputs. This statement concerns the recorded diagram and mark: a knot might have another presentation or mark satisfying a different criterion.

First recall why weak balance implies an anchored witness at the same mark. At the complete vector $q^*$, let $P(q) = \sum_e X_e(q) - \sum_f q_f$, where $X_e = A_C$, and put

$$H_e = \max\{X_e, q_b, q_c\}, \tag{Q.27}$$

omitting protected logarithms. The entropy proof of weak balance, §§3–5 gives $h_* > 0$, a finite $\mathcal{E} \geq 0$, and, for $q(t) = (1-t)q^*$, $0 < t < 1$,

$$P(q(t)) \leq \Phi + \tfrac{1}{2}t^2\mathcal{E}, \qquad X_e(q(t)) - A_s(q(t)) \geq th_* \quad \text{for every surviving side } s. \tag{Q.28}$$

The positivity of $h_*$ uses the overloaded triangle, which has at least two ordinary corners: the matched outer edge cannot be the protected nonmatching edge. Since $A_L \geq q_c$ and $A_R \geq q_b$, (Q.28) implies $H_e(q(t)) = X_e(q(t))$. Thus every fixed surviving anchor satisfies

$$A_{a,s}(q(t)) + \sum_{e \neq a} H_e(q(t)) - \sum_f q_f(t) \leq \Phi + \tfrac{1}{2}t^2\mathcal{E} - th_* < \Phi \tag{Q.29}$$

for a sufficiently small positive $t$. This proves the anchored implication without treating equality in the original balance test as a strict loss.

Now take the original width-three source with word

$$(1,3,0,2,4,1,3,0,2,4,1,3,0,2,4,1,3), \qquad \{u,v\} = \{0,16\}. \tag{Q.30}$$

Its construction and rational certificates are given in the separation theorem. The exact data are the forty-branch certificate and the anchor certificate; their verifiers are the cover verifier and the anchor verifier. They retain the original compiler, mark, local orders, and all ordinary targets.

There are seventeen matching regions. Put $J = \{2, 4, 7, 12\}$. The first fifteen cover branches prescribe right on a nonempty subset of $J$, allow central/left on its complement in $J$, and allow all surviving labels elsewhere. In the remaining case no region in $J$ is right; choose any surviving one-sided anchor, allow central/left at the other regions of $J$, and all surviving labels elsewhere. There are twenty-five such anchor branches. Every locally allowed noncentral string is covered by this combinatorial division, whether or not its global coefficient vanishes. Thus this is exactly the unabridged hypothesis (Q.5). The rational bounds prove a uniform gap greater than 0.04.

The same data locate a weak-balance failure away from a usable joining triangle. The obstructed anchor is right at crossing 12, whose quartet is $(0, 11, 16, 14)$. Its dual rational flow mixes the complete and pure-middle rows only at spectators $2, 4, 7$; all other spectators use their complete triangle rows. Consequently that very flow bounds the smaller function

$$\widetilde{G}(q) = A_{12,R}(q) + \sum_{e\in\{2,4,7\}} H_e(q) + \sum_{e\notin J} X_e(q) - \sum_f q_f > \Phi_{17} + 0.025 \quad \text{for every ordinary } q. \tag{Q.31}$$

Indeed the recorded rational row loads cancel every ordinary target. The mixed rows are bounded by $H_e$, while each unmixed row is already bounded by $X_e$; no replacement by $H_e$ at an unmixed spectator is required. The certificate gives the flow entropy greater than 19.95975965735 and a complete-action upper bound less than 19.92324700353, which imply (Q.31).

If all four crossings in $J$ were weak-balanced at the complete vector, then $H_e = X_e$ at $2, 4, 7$, and $A_{12,R} \le X_{12}$. The latter follows from $X_{12} \ge q_{11}$ and $Q(0, e^{q_{11}}, e^{q_{14}}) \ge q_{11}/2$. Here 11 and 14 are face labels, while $e^{q_{11}}$ and $e^{q_{14}}$ are their positive coefficient weights. The last inequality tests the simplex vertex at the weight $e^{q_{11}}$ in (Q.1). It would give $\widetilde{G}(q^*) \le P(q^*) = \Phi_{17}$, contradicting (Q.31). Thus at least one crossing in $J$ fails weak balance. This localization only needs the non-strict comparison at completeness; the flattening in (Q.28)–(Q.29) explains the broader anchored implication.

The two marked-edge triangles belong to crossings 12 and 15. At crossing 15 the quartet and its marked output triangle are

$$(16, 14, 0, 17), \qquad (16, 17, 0). \tag{Q.32}$$

Choose this latter triangle for the first sum. In (Q.6) the seventeen-region input is $D_2$, with $(u, v, B, a) = (16, 0, 17, 14)$. None of the four crossings in $J$ is removed or merged. Equation (Q.10) preserves their complete curvatures up to a common scale on that input. Each difference $X_e - q_b$ or $X_e - q_c$ is invariant under this scale, so the failed comparison survives.

For an explicit repeatable input take the tetrahedral sphere with oriented faces

$$(u, v, B),\ (u, B, C),\ (B, v, C),\ (v, u, C) \tag{Q.33}$$

and matching edges $uB, vC$, with $uv$ protected and nonmatching. Its two quartets are $(u, v, C, B)$ and $(v, u, B, C)$. At $B = C = 1$, each ordinary face receives load $1/2$ from one

singleton triangle and $1/4$ from each of the other two triangles. This is the complete stationary vector. Each local complete rate is $2f(1/4) > 0$, whereas its positive middle logarithm is zero. This input is strictly balanced and therefore has an unabridged certificate.

Attach any fixed number $r \geq 1$ of these tetrahedral inputs, always continuing on the newly attached side of the retained marked edge. The matching side can be aligned by the recorded whole-input orientation choice in (Q.6). No later step touches the four original crossings in $J$. The resulting sphere has

$$R_r = 17 + r, \qquad \Phi_r = \Phi_{17} + 4rf(1/4). \tag{Q.34}$$

It satisfies (Q.5) by the closure theorem and fails weak balance at its retained mark by (Q.31)–(Q.32). Choose any knot-producing terminal parity pattern for this new sphere. For all independently sufficiently long fixed signed fillings, (Q.24) is the volume limit for that new knot. This gives arbitrary finite sizes of certified marked diagrams outside weak balance at that mark; it does not classify their unmarked knots or their other possible presentations.

## Q.8 Scope and related constructions

Belted sums and their volume behavior form part of the geometric background. Morgan and collaborators [12] study the geometric, combinatorial and diagrammatic classification of these decompositions. Van der Veen [17] proves the volume conjecture for the infinite family of Whitehead chains. No identification of the present ordered protected operation with those marked constructions is used here. In particular classical volume additivity itself is not claimed as a new phenomenon. The statement proved here is closure of the original phase-uniform source certificates, with every shared target retained, and its consequence for independently long fixed fillings of the recorded diagrams.

An arbitrary block need not satisfy (Q.5): the fifty-four-region example has a genuine fixed-sector envelope capacity exceeding its complete action by more than $1/5$. The present proof does not assert an exact scalar factorization of finite spectral kernels. It proves an inequality for every genuine sector with its full real spectrum and all face phases, and therefore retains the normal data required by the finite filling functional.

The certificate hypothesis cannot be weakened here to an arbitrary closed-source cancellation estimate, or to a cap estimate with other spectra fixed. Such estimates need not provide witnesses for (Q.16). Likewise globally omitted strings require an independent support transfer argument. The theorem changes diagrams by an explicit operation; it is not a claim that the original input knot type is preserved.

## Q.9 Reproduction and formal scope

The following command replays the two rational interval certificates used in Section Q.7 and constructs eight exact tetrahedral attachments:

```
python3 repro/check_protected_sums.py --output repro/results/protected-sums
```

It requires Python with `python-flint`. The finite checks verify the original branch cover, triangle loads, strict interval bounds, and the new complexes' vertex links, matching and

target counts. They check that all four possible failed balance regions remain unchanged. The induction in Section Q.6, rather than the number of examples tested, proves the assertion for any fixed finite assembly.

The module `formal/VolumeLogic/ProtectedSum.lean` proves (Q.15) and the target cancellation as ordered-ring identities and inequalities after doubling every rate. It constructs the sector map and proves the positive-gap implication from the selected input bounds. The simplex inequalities, the existence and rescaling of the witnesses, the topological construction, and the analytic and geometric inputs remain the written arguments above. The formal check does not assert a formalization of the volume limit.

# Appendix R

# Certified insertion at ordinary triangular boundaries

An ordinary triangular face has three positive coefficient weights. It need not contain either protected face of the marked source. This appendix proves that a diagram already controlled at a protected edge can be inserted at such an ordinary face when two boundary curvatures are sufficiently small relative to the third. The coefficient demands on the old boundary vertices remain the original core demands.

The mechanism has two parts. The complete packing inside a triangular boundary contributes exactly the old triangle potential plus a constant. For complementary sectors, the old protected certificate extends to small positive boundary weights. Any local comparison error is absorbed by the same boundary correction. Explicit strictly balanced cores supply arbitrarily thin ordinary faces, so the theorem applies to any fixed finite collection of certified inputs.

**Theorem R.1** (Ordinary triangular insertion)**.** *Let $B_1, \dots, B_s$, $s \geq 1$, be fixed marked simple-sphere diagrams satisfying the unabridged certificate (R.6). Choose a marked boundary triangle in each input. There are positive boundary thresholds $\eta_j$ such that the following holds.*

*Let $D$ be a fixed certified core, with chosen witnesses for every locally allowed noncentral string and its complete vector. Select $s$ distinct matching pairs and one all-ordinary triangle in each, with no pair used twice. At the $j$-th triangle, write its weights as $(u_j, v_j, b_j)$. Suppose every chosen core vector satisfies*

$$u_j/b_j \leq \eta_j, \qquad v_j/b_j \leq \eta_j. \tag{R.1}$$

*Insert the rooted disks of the $B_j$'s by the oriented operation in Section R.5. The resulting marked simple sphere has an unabridged full-source certificate with gap at least*

$$\min\{\gamma_D, \gamma_{B_1}/2, \dots, \gamma_{B_s}/2\}. \tag{R.2}$$

*Its complete action is $\Phi_D + \sum_j \Phi_{B_j}$.*

*Such cores exist explicitly for every fixed finite list of inputs: the even zigzag chains of Section R.8 have terminal boundary ratios tending to zero, and their complete vector is a witness for every noncentral string. Choose any retained half-twist pattern whose final strand connections form one knot. All independently sufficiently long fixed signed primitive fillings of*

*the final crossing circles satisfy the full volume limit* (R.34)*, at both parities and composite levels.*

*The construction may change knot type. The filling threshold depends on the entire fixed assembled diagram and its retained pattern. No growing-diagram or level-dependent-twist limit is asserted.*

## R.1 The original source and the disk action

An input is a finite simple oriented triangulated white sphere with at least four vertices, a perfect matching of its dual triangles, and a marked nonmatching edge. The literal inverse cut of Appendix O supplies its augmented link in $S^3$, with the cyclic crossing orders and the original twice-punctured crossing disks retained. A matched pair is one crossing-circle region. The two endpoints of the mark are the protected zero variables; every other white vertex has coefficient target $d = N - 1$. There are $R$ ordinary vertices and $R$ matched pairs.

For a nonnegative curvature vector $w$, with at least one positive weight in each triangle, put

$$Q(w_1, w_2, w_3) = \max_{\substack{\alpha_i \geq 0 \\ \alpha_1+\alpha_2+\alpha_3=1/2}} \left\{ \sum_i f(\alpha_i) + \sum_{w_i>0} \alpha_i \log w_i \right\}, \qquad f(t) = \frac{\Lambda(\pi t) + \Lambda(\pi/2 - \pi t)}{\pi}, \tag{R.3}$$

where loads at a zero weight are required to vanish and $\Lambda(s) = -\int_0^s \log(2 \sin r)\, dr$. In particular $f(0) = f(1/2) = 0$, $f \geq 0$, and $f$ is strictly concave on $(0, 1/2)$.

For an ordered polynomial quartet $(x, b, c, y)$, the input and output triangles are $(x, b, y)$ and $(x, c, y)$. The complete and one-sided rate functions are

$$\begin{aligned} X &= Q(x, b, y) + Q(x, c, y), \\ A_L &= \max\{\log c, Q(x, b, y) + \tfrac{1}{2} \log c\}, \\ A_R &= \max\{\log b, Q(x, c, y) + \tfrac{1}{2} \log b\}. \end{aligned} \tag{R.4}$$

The label $L$ overloads the middle $c$, and $R$ overloads $b$. A label overloaded at a protected zero is absent from the finite source. These are the phase-uniform bounds on the whole real spectral interval from Appendices L and P; both level parities and the original unused recurrence factors are included.

For a whole string $\omega$ of locally allowed labels $C, L, R$, put $A_{e,C} = X_e$, $q_f = \log w_f$, and

$$G_{D,\omega}(q) = \sum_e A_{e,\omega_e}(q) - \sum_{f \in \mathcal{O}_D} q_f, \qquad P_D = G_{D,C}, \qquad \Phi_D = \min P_D = \frac{\mathrm{Vol}(Y_D)}{2\pi}. \tag{R.5}$$

Here $Y_D$ is the original augmented exterior before crossing-circle filling. A finite unabridged certificate means that there is $\gamma_D > 0$ and, for every locally allowed $\omega \neq C$, a real log-weight vector $q^\omega$ with

$$G_{D,\omega}(q^\omega) \leq \Phi_D - \gamma_D. \tag{R.6}$$

The same face weight is used at every occurrence within a string. Different strings may use different witnesses. Strings whose global coefficient happens to vanish are still included. Only

local protected-overload zeros are omitted. There are finitely many strings because the diagram is fixed.

Weak balance supplies such a certificate by Appendix P; the forty-branch seventeen-region example in Appendix Q supplies another. The input hypothesis is strictly about these actual rate functions and original demands. It does not assume the desired gap for an assembled diagram.

Let $B$ be a simple triangulated oriented sphere with at least four vertices. Remove one face $f = (u, b, v)$, leaving a triangular disk $P$. Let $I$ be its $k$ interior vertices. The disk has $2k + 1$ triangles. The boundary-dependent disk action is

$$J_{u,v,b}(q_I) = \sum_{t \subset P} Q_t(w) - \sum_{i \in I} q_i, \qquad w_i = e^{q_i}, \qquad \mathcal{J}_P(u, v, b) = \inf_{q_I} J_{u,v,b}(q_I). \tag{R.7}$$

Only interior targets are subtracted here. The three boundary loads are free; their total is $1/2$. The claim is

$$\boxed{\mathcal{J}_P(u, v, b) = Q(u, v, b) + C_P} \qquad (u, v, b > 0). \tag{R.8}$$

The constant is determined below. This is an identity of classical source actions with their absolute normalization.

For a triangle with positive supported weights, its unique maximizing loads are

$$\alpha_i = \frac{1}{\pi} \arctan \frac{w_i}{D_t}, \qquad D_t = \sqrt{w_1 w_2 + w_2 w_3 + w_3 w_1}. \tag{R.9}$$

For two positive weights this is interpreted on those two corners; a singleton has load $1/2$. The Hessian in supported log weights is a Laplacian, with off-diagonal entries

$$-\kappa_{ij}, \qquad \kappa_{ij} = \frac{w_i w_j}{2\pi D_t (w_i + w_j)} > 0. \tag{R.10}$$

Singletons contribute no Hessian. Thus a connected supported graph has only the common-scale kernel.

## R.2 Existence for every positive boundary triple

Here is the finite feasibility and coercivity argument, separate from the subsequent development.

Each triangle supplies $1/2$; every interior vertex demands one. Pool the three boundary destinations into one destination of demand $1/2$, retaining their separate corners. A strictly positive transport table exists.

For a nonempty set $S$ of interior destinations, put $T = I \setminus S$. Puncture the capped sphere at a vertex of $S$. The triangles supported on $T \cup \{u, v, b\}$ are bounded faces of a simple planar graph on $|T| + 3$ vertices. There are at most $2|T| + 1$ bounded triangular faces; one is the removed face. Thus at most $2|T|$ disk triangles miss $S$, so at least $2|S| + 1$ touch it. Their supply is strictly greater than $|S|$.

A proper destination set containing the boundary pool has nonempty complement $T \subset I$. Triangles wholly on $T$ number at most $2|T| - 5$ for $|T| \geq 3$, and none for $|T| \leq 2$. The touching supply therefore strictly exceeds that set's demand. The full destination set has equality of totals. These are the strict finite transport Hall inequalities. Subtracting one sufficiently small

positive amount from every allowed corner preserves feasibility; restoring those amounts gives a table $\alpha^0_{ti} > 0$ on every corner.

Fix positive boundary weights. For an interior direction $h$, extend $h$ by zero on the boundary. The recession of (R.7) is

$$\mathcal{R}(h) = \frac{1}{2}\sum_t \max_{i\in t} h_i - \sum_{i\in I} h_i = \sum_t \sum_{i\in t} \alpha^0_{ti}\left(\max_{j\in t} h_j - h_i\right). \tag{R.11}$$

It is nonnegative. Equality forces $h$ to be constant on every triangle. The disk graph is connected and the boundary is grounded, so equality forces $h = 0$. Compactness of the unit sphere gives a positive recession margin.

More explicitly, $Q_t(q) \geq \frac{1}{2}\max_{i\in t} q_i$, while its difference from that maximum is bounded above by the finite maximum of $\sum f$. Fixed boundary logarithms alter these estimates only by a bounded constant. Consequently

$$J_{u,v,b}(q_I) \geq c\|q_I\| - C. \tag{R.12}$$

for constants $c > 0, C < \infty$. This proves coercivity, not merely strict convexity. The grounded Hessian (R.10) is positive definite, so the minimizer exists, is finite, and is unique. Its loads satisfy each interior demand exactly.

The resulting minimizer depends smoothly on the positive boundary log weights by the implicit function theorem and the positive definite interior Hessian.

## R.3 Development and proof of the fixed-boundary identity

Set radii $r_i = 1/w_i$. For each triangle, the three lengths $r_i + r_j$ form a nondegenerate triangle. Its center angle at $i$ is $2\pi\alpha_{ti}$, by the tangent-circle half-angle formula (R.9).

At the minimizer every interior vertex has total angle $2\pi$. All boundary corner angles are positive; their sum over the three boundary vertices is $\pi$, because there are $2k + 1$ triangles and $k$ interior vertices. In particular every boundary angle sum is less than $\pi$.

Develop the triangles with their given orientation. Continuation around an interior vertex has rotation $2\pi$ and zero translation. Such loops generate the holonomy of the punctured disk, so the development is single-valued. Its boundary consists of three straight segments of lengths $r_u + r_v, r_v + r_b, r_b + r_u$, traversing the prescribed convex center triangle once.

This development is injective. For a point outside the finite developed edges, each preimage is orientation preserving, so the number of preimages equals the boundary winding number: one inside the boundary triangle and zero outside. Local injectivity at edges and interior vertices, followed by continuity, extends this to the whole disk. Separating triangles inside $P$ cause no change in this degree argument.

It follows that the total developed angle $\Theta_u$ at the boundary vertex $u$ is exactly the angle of the unrefined center triangle. Differentiating the optimized action gives

$$\partial_{\log u}\mathcal{J}_P = \frac{\Theta_u}{2\pi} = \frac{1}{\pi}\arctan\frac{u}{\sqrt{uv + ub + vb}} = \partial_{\log u} Q(u, v, b). \tag{R.13}$$

The same holds at $v, b$. Hence the difference in (R.8) has zero differential throughout the connected positive octant and is constant. There is no extra boundary-linear term. Its logarithmic homogeneity is $1/2$, since the disk has half-supply $k + 1/2$ and interior demand $k$.

The developed disks have disjoint interiors and only the prescribed contacts: each disk sector lies inside its incident center triangle and stops before the opposite center edge. The contact-circle halfspaces give the original convex right-angled ideal piece. This identifies the variational development with the fixed-boundary packing, rather than just an abstract flat metric.

## R.4 Two zero boundary weights: coercivity, uniqueness and the limit

Now take $u = v = 0, b = 1$. Every triangle of $B$ has an ordinary supported corner. Write $O = I \cup \{b\}$. On the full sphere assign demand one to every member of $O$, and supply $1/2$ to each triangle.

This supported transport has a strictly positive table on every allowed corner. For a nonempty proper $S \subset O$, put $T = O \setminus S$. Puncture at a vertex of $S$. Triangles missing $S$ are bounded triangular faces of a simple planar graph on $|T| + 2$ vertices, at most $2|T| - 1$. Thus at least $2|S| + 1$ sphere triangles touch $S$. The full destination set has equality of totals. Subtracting a small positive corner amount yields strict relative feasibility, with singleton rows fixed at their forced $1/2$ load.

The removed face $(u, b, v)$ is such a singleton. Removing its load leaves interior demands one and $b$-demand $1/2$ in the disk. Let $\alpha^0$ be the resulting strictly supported table.

Deleting $u, v$ from a simple triangulated sphere leaves a connected graph. One direct proof deletes $u$ by rerouting a path through its cyclic link, then deletes $v$ by rerouting through its link with $u$ removed, which is still connected. Removing the face $(u, b, v)$ removes no edge between two ordinary vertices. Therefore the supported co-occurrence graph of the disk is connected to $b$.

For $h_b = 0$, the same formula as (R.11), now using only supported corners, gives

$$\mathcal{R}_0(h) = \sum_t \sum_{i \in \mathrm{supp}(t)} \alpha^0_{ti} \left( \max_{j \in \mathrm{supp}(t)} h_j - h_i \right) > 0 \quad (h \neq 0). \tag{R.14}$$

It proves $J_{0,0,1}(q) \geq c_0 \|q\|$ up to a harmless constant. Formula (R.10) grounds the only kernel. There is consequently a unique finite minimizer $q^0$.

The full protected-sphere action is exactly $J_{0,0,1}$: restoring the removed singleton contributes $\frac{1}{2} \log b$, and subtracting its ordinary target contributes $-\log b$, both zero at $b = 1$. Hence

$$\min J_{0,0,1} = \Phi_B. \tag{R.15}$$

The original simple-sphere calibration identifies $2\pi\Phi_B$ with the augmented volume of $B$. No full-source estimate is needed for (R.15).

For $u, v \geq 0$, monotonicity of $Q$ gives $J_{u,v,1} \geq J_{0,0,1}$. Its interior Hessian retains that same connected positive support and it remains coercive; no Loewner comparison of the old and new Hessians is required. Its unique minimizer $q^{u,v}$ satisfies

$$J_{0,0,1}(q^{u,v}) \leq J_{u,v,1}(q^{u,v}) \leq J_{u,v,1}(q^0) \longrightarrow J_{0,0,1}(q^0). \tag{R.16}$$

Here $Q$ is continuous as supported weights tend to zero: maximizing loads at the disappearing corners tend to zero, their entropy tends to zero, and their logarithmic terms are nonpositive;

the reverse inequality comes from the old supported maximizing load. Coercivity confines $q^{u,v}$ to a compact set, and uniqueness implies

$$q^{u,v} \longrightarrow q^0 \qquad (u, v \to 0). \tag{R.17}$$

The convergence is joint and uniform on sufficiently small boundary squares: the upper bound in (R.16) is at most $J_{\eta,\eta,1}(q^0)$ when $u, v \le \eta$.

Taking this limit in (R.8), with $Q(u, v, 1) \to 0$, identifies its constant:

$$C_P = \Phi_B. \tag{R.18}$$

Equations (R.8) and (R.18) extend to the closed boundary square with $b > 0$ by the same monotonicity argument. In particular, for the closed expression with no $u, v$ targets,

$$\widehat{P}_B = \sum_{t \subset B} Q_t - \sum_{i \in I} q_i - \log b, \qquad \inf \widehat{P}_B = \Phi_B + \Delta, \quad \Delta = 2Q(u, v, b) - \log b \ge 0. \tag{R.19}$$

For positive boundaries, every interior packing disk has curvature at least

$$u + v + b + 2\sqrt{uv + ub + vb} > \max(u, v, b). \tag{R.20}$$

Indeed, let the three boundary centers and radii be $p_i, r_i$. On their center triangle maximize $r(z) = \min_i(|z - p_i| - r_i)$. It is nonpositive on the boundary, whose sides are covered by the two incident tangent disks, and positive in the interstice. At a positive interior maximum there cannot be just one active distance. With two active distances, their gradients either admit a common increasing direction, or are opposite; in the latter case the center lies between tangent boundary centers and the common empty radius is nonpositive. Thus all three distances are active. Eliminating the center from the three tangency equations gives $(k - u - v - b)^2 = 4(uv + ub + vb)$. At equal boundary curvatures the bounded-interstice disk takes the plus sign. The maximum empty radius varies continuously with the three positive boundary radii (maximize the continuous distance function on their continuously varying compact center triangle), and the two algebraic roots never meet on the positive octant. The plus sign therefore holds throughout that connected octant, proving (R.20). Every interior packing disk is contained in this interstice, so its radius cannot exceed that maximum. In particular the central conditional root always has $a > v$ for positive boundary data.

The root middle $a \in I$ has $e^{q_a^{u,v}} \to e^{q_a^0} > 0$. Thus $a \ge v$ for all sufficiently small $u/b, v/b$, after common scaling.

An equivalent boundary-load statement is available. Maximizing entropy subject to the interior demands and a boundary vector $\beta$ of total $1/2$ gives a closed concave function. Its conjugate is (R.8). Closed concave duality therefore identifies that function with $\sum f(\beta_i) + \Phi_B$ on the whole closed half-simplex. This preserves aggregate boundary loads, including zero loads; it does not add boundary coefficient demands.

## R.5 Oriented sewing and exact target allocation

Let the fixed core have its own protected nonmatching edge, away from the selected all-ordinary faces. At one selected core region and one block root use the polynomial argument orders

$$e_D = (u, v, c, b), \quad f_D = (u, v, b); \qquad e_B = (u, a, v, b), \quad f_B = (u, b, v). \tag{R.21}$$

The removed triangles have opposite orientations. Their common matching side is $ub$, and their retained partners are $(u, b, c)$ and $(u, a, b)$. After gluing, those partners form the new region

$$e_{\text{new}} = (u, a, c, b). \tag{R.22}$$

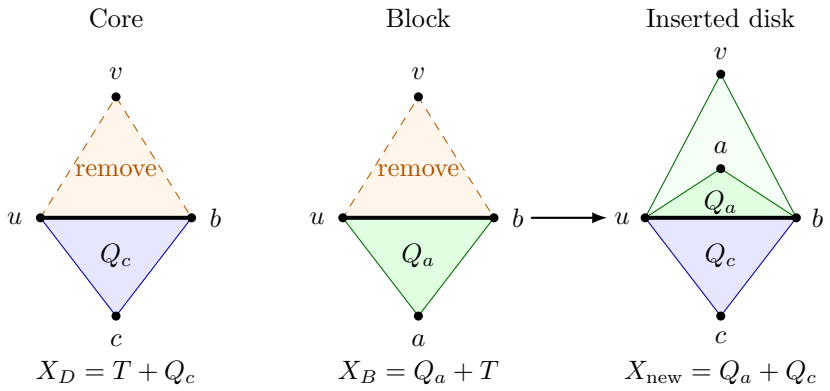



Figure R.1: Insertion at an ordinary triangular face. The dashed faces are identified with opposite orientations and removed; all three boundary vertices remain. The thick side $ub$ matches the two retained triangles. In the inserted disk, the triangles above $(u, a, b)$ are left unexpanded; the vertex $v$ remains on their boundary. Here $T = Q(u, v, b)$, $Q_a = Q(u, a, b)$, and $Q_c = Q(u, c, b)$. The old core supplies the sole targets at $u, v$. Only the $b$-target is duplicated in the comparison, giving $\Delta = 2T - \log b$.

Every other matching pair and cyclic order is retained. The four vertices of (R.22) are distinct because block interiors are fresh and $a$ is an interior vertex.

Each boundary identification glues two punctured spheres along an embedded three-cycle. Fresh interiors give no loops or duplicate edges other than the boundary edges deliberately identified. The result is again a simple oriented triangulated sphere. The old common matching side is retained once and all other matching pairs are untouched. The core mark remains nonmatching.

If $B$ has $R_B = k+1$ regions, the insertion adds precisely $k$ ordinary vertices and $k$ matching regions. Its target count is

$$\mathcal{O}_{\text{new}} = \mathcal{O}_D \sqcup I, \qquad R_{\text{new}} = R_D + R_B - 1. \tag{R.23}$$

In particular, ordinary $u, v$ retain their single core targets. They acquire no second targets from the block.

Put $T = Q(u, v, b)$, $Q_a = Q(u, a, b)$, $Q_c = Q(u, c, b)$. Then

$$X_D = T + Q_c, \quad X_B = Q_a + T, \quad X_{\text{new}} = Q_a + Q_c. \tag{R.24}$$

The block comparison expression subtracts its interior targets and one $b$-target, but none at $u, v$. Combining it with the core therefore duplicates only $b$. The exact complete action identity and a general sector inequality are

$$P_{\text{new}} = P_D + \widehat{P}_B - \Delta, \qquad G_{\text{new},\omega} \le G_{D,\omega_D} + \widehat{G}_{B,\omega_B} - \Delta + \varepsilon_e, \quad \Delta = 2T - \log b. \tag{R.25}$$

The local sector map is

$$C \mapsto (C, C), \qquad L \mapsto (L, C), \qquad R \mapsto (C, R). \tag{R.26}$$

Its defects may be taken to be

$$\varepsilon_C = 0, \qquad \varepsilon_L = (T - Q_a)_+, \qquad \varepsilon_R = (T - Q_c)_+, \qquad 0 \le \varepsilon_e \le \Delta/2. \tag{R.27}$$

For example the old left expression after subtracting $2T$ is $\max(q_c + Q_a - T, Q_a + q_c/2)$; adding $(T - Q_a)_+$ bounds the new left rate $\max(q_c, Q_a + q_c/2)$. The right calculation interchanges $a, c$. Finally $Q_a, Q_c \ge \frac{1}{2}\log b$, proving the last bound without any middle-order assumption.

Eliminating the block variables in the first equality of (R.25) using (R.19) gives, for every core vector, exactly $P_D + \Phi_B$. Therefore

$$\Phi_{\text{new}} = \Phi_D + \Phi_B. \tag{R.28}$$

All original core face derivatives and target demands are unchanged.

For finitely many attachments choose distinct core matching pairs; no removed face or its partner is used twice. Boundary vertices may coincide. Their weights remain the same core coordinates, and each retains one core target. Every block expression duplicates its own $b$-target once, and its own correction in (R.25) cancels that duplication, even when several such $b$'s are the same core vertex. Fresh interiors remain disjoint. Thus

$$R_{\text{new}} = R_D + \sum_j (R_{B_j} - 1), \qquad \Phi_{\text{new}} = \Phi_D + \sum_j \Phi_{B_j}. \tag{R.29}$$

## R.6 From protected certificates to a full source estimate

Assume each block has a finite unabridged certificate at its standalone protected mark $uv$, with gap $\gamma_B > 0$. It covers every locally allowed noncentral string, including old strings whose global extraction happened to vanish.

Choose one positive interior witness per old string at $u = v = 0, b = 1$. Their rates are continuous when $u, v \to 0$, because every triangle contains a positive ordinary corner. Finiteness preserves half the gap on one common small square. A newly allowed side overloaded at $u$ or $v$ has rate

$$\max\{\log u,\ Q_{\text{retained}} + \tfrac{1}{2}\log u\}$$

or its $v$-analogue. At one fixed positive interior vector it tends uniformly to $-\infty$; all other local factors are bounded above. This treats every newly allowed string. At an exactly zero overloaded weight the term is absent.

Combining these finite choices with (R.17), there is $\eta_B > 0$ such that $u/b, v/b \le \eta_B$ permits a central conditional minimizer of value $\Phi_B + \Delta$, or a noncentral witness of value at most $\Phi_B - \gamma_B/2$. The central conditional root satisfies $a > v$ by (R.20); no ordering is required of noncentral witnesses.

Suppose the core has an unabridged certificate whose finitely many witnesses, together with its complete vector, meet the selected thin-boundary conditions. There is no required inequality between core middles. Choose one induced core witness, then classify each induced **whole block string**:

- If the entire block is central, use its conditional packing minimizer. Its root is central, so the new bridge can only be central or left. A central bridge is exact, and a left bridge has zero defect because (R.20) gives $a > v$ and hence $Q_a \geq T$. Its value $\Phi_B + \Delta$ cancels the $-\Delta$ in (R.25).
- If the block has any noncentral label, use the finite extended certificate. Its value is at most $\Phi_B - \gamma_B/2$, while its bridge defect is at most $\Delta/2$. It therefore contributes at most $\Phi_B - \gamma_B/2 - \Delta/2$ after the correction.

The locally central root alone does not imply that the whole block is central. The split above uses every label of that block. At least one induced input is noncentral when the output is noncentral. For any fixed finite number of blocks this proves

$$\gamma_{\mathrm{new}} \geq \min\{\gamma_D, \gamma_{B_1}/2, \dots, \gamma_{B_s}/2\} > 0. \tag{R.30}$$

All boundary incidences use the actual core weights. No summed defect budget is needed: each block absorbs its own defect.

The local bounds (R.4) are uniform in phases and all real spectral variables at both parities. The number of sector strings is finite for the fixed assembly. Hence (R.30) bounds the entire complementary source polynomial on its original full real spectral cube. It is not an estimate for independent local radii or for a changed collection of face targets.

## R.7 Original primitive fillings and the actual volume conclusion

The new sphere and matching are fed into the original Morse inverse-cut construction. This constructs the augmented link $Y_{\mathrm{new}}$ in $S^3$, its crossing-circle balls, local signed half twists, outside strands and disk-framed primitive bases. It is not necessary to interpret the operation as a preexisting named topological sum.

There is one new crossing circle at each merged pair. Its primitive word is the ordered two-head product from its new quartet. The two input crossing circles do not survive as two independently fillable cusps. The independent integers in the conclusion belong to the **final** regions. Choose a retained parity pattern passing the final one-component test; such a pattern exists by the original spanning-tree pairing argument. No old knot parity or knot type is silently transported.

The simple-sphere packing theorem of Appendix L applies to the final sphere and fixes its positive complete cells. Equations (R.28)–(R.29) identify its actual augmented action:

$$2\pi\Phi_{\mathrm{new}} = \mathrm{Vol}(Y_{\mathrm{new}}). \tag{R.31}$$

This is not a claim that filled volumes add.

Appendix N and Appendix O now apply to the final original Morse source. The exact scalar is retained; every final ordinary face has target $d = N - 1$, and each final spectral variable has degree at most $d$. The full filling norm costs at most $\prod_e (1 + |n_e|/2)$. The entire central period is nonzero at both parities for independently sufficiently long fixed signed powers.

The representation constructed from the final original circles has

$$U_e + p_e V_e = -2\pi i, \qquad n_e = \epsilon_e - 2p_e. \tag{R.32}$$

The small individual-generator logarithms, nonunit auxiliary holonomy and primitive logarithmic period give smooth solid-torus completion. The main cusp remains complete. The original disk surgery is in $S^3$, so the metric is on the final knot complement. The same boundary triangulation and relative fundamental chain supply the absolute regulator comparison

$$2\pi \operatorname{Re} S_{\boldsymbol{n}} = \operatorname{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{n}}). \tag{R.33}$$

No comparison manifold or only exponentiated filling equation is substituted.

Finally choose the fixed long-filling threshold so that $\Phi_{\mathrm{new}} - \operatorname{Re} S_{\boldsymbol{n}} < \gamma_{\mathrm{new}}/2$. The full complementary contribution then has smaller exponential rate. For the original reduced, zero-framed invariant normalized by the unknot,

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{2\pi}{N} \log |\langle K_{\boldsymbol{n}} \rangle_N| = \operatorname{Vol}(S^3 \setminus K_{\boldsymbol{n}}). \tag{R.34}$$

Every block, core length, retained parity and final integer is fixed first. The threshold may depend on the entire finite assembly; there is no claim uniform in growing assemblies or quantum-level-dependent powers.

## R.8 Explicit cores with arbitrarily thin ordinary faces

Start with the octahedral white sphere. Its poles are $P, S$, its rim is $v_0, v_1, v_2, v_3$, and the global protected mark is $v_0v_1$. Orient the faces by

$$T_j = (P, v_{j+1}, v_j), \qquad Z_j = (S, v_j, v_{j+1}) \quad (j \bmod 4). \tag{R.35}$$

Match $T_0, T_1$, match $Z_0, Z_1$, and match $T_2, Z_2$ and $T_3, Z_3$. The marked complete curvatures are

$$P = S = 1, \qquad v_2 = v_3 = 2, \qquad v_0 = v_1 = 0. \tag{R.36}$$

The original angle equations verify this directly. At a pole the loads are one singleton $1/2$, two copies of $\pi^{-1}\arctan(1/\sqrt{2})$, and one copy of $\pi^{-1}\arctan(1/(2\sqrt{2}))$; they sum to one. The ordinary rim equations follow from the complementary two-angle identities. Uniqueness of the marked complete solution then gives (R.36).

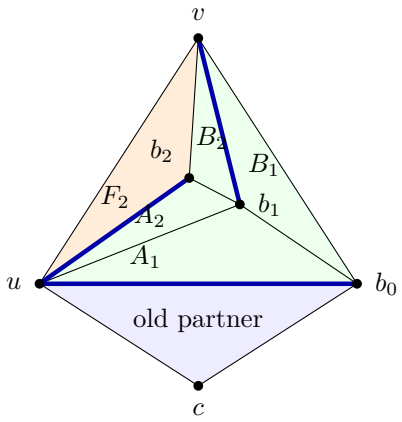
Put $u = v_2,\ v = P,\ b_0 = v_3,\ c = S$. The chosen all-ordinary face $F_0 = (u, v, b_0)$ is matched to $(u, b_0, c)$. Insert $b_j$ into $F_{j-1}$, replacing it by the three oriented triangles

$$F_j = (u, v, b_j), \qquad A_j = (u, b_j, b_{j-1}), \qquad B_j = (v, b_{j-1}, b_j). \tag{R.37}$$

Each is a genuine stellar subdivision in the bounded interstice. The exterior disks do not move. The positive Soddy recurrence and its exact solution are

$$\begin{aligned} b_{j+1} &= b_j + 3 + 2\sqrt{3b_j + 2}, \\ b_j &= 3j^2 + 4\sqrt{2}\, j + 2 = 3(j + \sqrt{2})(j + \sqrt{2}/3), \qquad \sqrt{3b_j + 2} = 3j + 2\sqrt{2}. \end{aligned} \tag{R.38}$$

For any positive even $n$, pair $A_1$ with the old exterior partner, pair $F_n, A_n$, and for $1 \le j < n$ pair $B_j, B_{j+1}$ when $j$ is odd and $A_j, A_{j+1}$ when $j$ is even. Every new triangle is used once.




The thick edges are the three matching edges.

The highlighted face $F_2 = (u, v, b_2)$ has three ordinary vertices.

The protected mark is outside this disk.

Figure R.2: The ordinary-face construction with $n = 2$. The pairs are $A_1$ with the old partner across $ub_0$, $B_1$ with $B_2$ across $vb_1$, and $F_2$ with $A_2$ across $ub_2$. All displayed vertices are ordinary. For general even $n$, successive subdivisions remain inside the ordinary face and alternate the matching as stated in the proof. The drawing records incidence and matching; the curvature values are given by (R.38).

The matching sides are $ub_0$, $ub_n$, and $s_jb_j$, with $s_j = v$ for odd $j$ and $s_j = u$ for even $j$. They are the actual common edges with opposite face orientations in (R.37).

All these matching regions are strictly balanced. Here are the inequalities, including the finite constants. Write $g = f(1/4)$, $b_1 = 5+4\sqrt{2}$, $b_2 = 14+8\sqrt{2}$. For each unchanged protected cap, the singleton at the pole and a quarter-quarter allocation at the pole and rim give

$$X - \log 2 \geq 2g - \frac{3}{4}\log 2 > \frac{3}{50}. \tag{R.39}$$

The other unchanged region has positive outer weights and middle weights one, so $X > 0$.

At the root region the outer weights are $2, 2$, the middles $b_1, 1$. Choose loads $(1/12, 1/3, 1/12)$ in the first triangle and $(1/5, 1/10, 1/5)$ in the second. Then

$$X - \log b_1 \geq 2f(1/12) + f(1/3) + 2f(1/5) + f(1/10) + \frac{17}{30}\log 2 - \frac{2}{3}\log b_1 > \frac{1}{4}. \tag{R.40}$$

At each internal matched pair, put quarter loads at $b_j, b_{j-1}$ in one triangle and at $b_j, b_{j+1}$ in the other, with zero at $s_j$. This gives

$$\begin{aligned} X - \log b_{j+1} &\geq 4g - \frac{1}{4}\log\frac{b_{j+1}^3}{b_j^2 b_{j-1}} \\ &\geq 4g - \frac{1}{4}\log\frac{b_2^3}{2b_1^2} > \frac{9}{100}. \end{aligned} \tag{R.41}$$

The ratios $b_j/b_{j-1}$ decrease by the factorization in (R.38), and the expression in the first logarithm is $(b_{j+1}/b_j)^3(b_j/b_{j-1})$. This proves the second inequality for every $j$, not just for bounded chain length.

The three strict constants can be checked with explicit interval arithmetic: use

$$\Lambda(x) = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{r=1}^{K}\frac{\sin(2rx)}{r^2} + E_K(x), \qquad |E_K(x)| \leq \frac{1}{2K}, \qquad K = 2048. \tag{R.42}$$

The resulting intervals for the three expressions in (R.39)–(R.41) lie respectively in $(0.0629504, 0.0635723)$, $(0.2543075, 0.2561727)$, and $(0.0985006, 0.0997441)$. Only these fixed elementary constants use interval evaluation; the all-length comparison is the exact ratio argument above.

At the final pair the outer weights are $2, b_n$, and the middles $1, b_{n-1}$. A vertex allocation at $b_n$ and a quarter-quarter allocation at $b_n, b_{n-1}$ give

$$X - \log b_{n-1} \geq 2g + \frac{3}{4}\log(b_n/b_{n-1}) > 0. \tag{R.43}$$

This also bounds the smaller middle. The mixed-branch differences are bounded below by one of

$$2g - \frac{1}{4}\log 2, \quad 2g + \frac{1}{4}\log(2/b_1), \quad 2g - \frac{1}{4}\log(b_2/b_1), \quad \frac{1}{2}\log 2, \quad 2g. \tag{R.44}$$

These follow by a quarter-quarter allocation at the overloaded middle and one outer weight, or a vertex allocation at an outer weight. The two cases for an internal middle use the decreasing ratios in (R.38); the tip uses $b_n > b_{n-1}$. All five bounds exceed $3/50$: use (R.39), $b_1 < 16$, $b_2 < 8b_1$, and $\log 2 > 1/2$. Together with the pure-middle bounds above, this gives a uniform core certificate gap greater than $3/50$ for every positive even chain length. Its complete vector is the witness for every noncentral string. Here $n$ is the chain length; $n_e$ denotes a final signed crossing power.

The terminal ordinary face satisfies

$$u/b_n = 2/b_n \longrightarrow 0, \qquad v/b_n = 1/b_n \longrightarrow 0. \tag{R.45}$$

Choose an even $n$ large enough for the prescribed block threshold $\eta_B$. This meets (R.1) with the same complete vector for all core strings.

For finitely many inputs, first form a protected sum of finitely many octahedral cores, as in Appendix Q, leaving their $T_2, Z_2$ pairs untouched. The complete vectors agree after the common joining weight is fixed, and strict balance is retained: the new complete bridge exceeds each old complete rate by a strictly positive triangle contribution. Build one chain in each selected disk. The old joined comparisons are unchanged, and (R.39)–(R.43) control every new region. Choosing the finite list of even chain lengths separately gives (R.1) at every interface. Shared boundary vertices still carry the same core weight and one original target.

### R.8.1 Separation from protected sums and weak balance

For one octahedral core, every subdivision and final block lies inside the all-ordinary disk $(v_2, P, v_3)$. The octahedron has no separating three-cycle. No new interior vertex is adjacent to either global protected vertex $v_0, v_1$, so any three-cycle containing both protected vertices is unchanged and still bounds an original face.

Every nontrivial protected triangular sum at that mark creates a separating three-cycle containing the two protected vertices, with interior vertices on both sides. Therefore these one-core ordinary-face assemblies cannot be decomposed as a nontrivial protected sum at their recorded mark. This is a precise distinction of marked presentations, not a claim about all presentations of the resulting knot.

An explicit certified input also produces examples failing weak balance. Use the seventeen-region input of Appendix Q and attach at its crossing-15 face. Its restricted anchor-12 dual has

zero loads at the protected vertices and mixes spectator rows only at $2, 4, 7$. After assigning positive boundary weights the same rational table remains feasible, because it still assigns zero load to those two boundary variables. With $b = 1$, it gives

$$\widehat{G}_{\text{restricted}}(u, v; q_I) > \Phi_B + \frac{1}{40} \quad \text{for every positive interior vector.} \tag{R.46}$$

If all four candidate regions $2, 4, 7, 12$ were weak-balanced at the conditional complete vector, their mixed spectators would equal their complete rates and the anchor would be at most its complete rate. Thus

$$\widehat{G}_{\text{restricted}} \le \widehat{P}_B = \Phi_B + \Delta. \tag{R.47}$$

Consequently $\Delta < 1/40$ forces at least one failure, and crossing 15 leaves all four candidates unchanged.

There is an elementary bound on this geometric correction. For $A = u + v,\ P = uv$,

$$\frac{d}{dt} Q(tu, tv, 1) = \frac{\arctan \sqrt{tA + t^2 P}}{\pi t} \le \frac{\sqrt{A}}{\pi\sqrt{t}} + \frac{\sqrt{P}}{\pi}. \tag{R.48}$$

Integrating from zero gives

$$\Delta = 2Q(u, v, 1) \le \frac{4}{\pi}\sqrt{u + v} + \frac{2}{\pi}\sqrt{uv}. \tag{R.49}$$

At the boundary in (R.45), since $b_n \ge 3n^2$, $\pi > 3$ and $2\sqrt{2} < \pi$,

$$\Delta \le \frac{4}{\pi}\sqrt{\frac{3}{b_n}} + \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{\pi b_n} \le \frac{4}{3n} + \frac{1}{3n^2} < \frac{1}{40} \qquad (n \ge 64). \tag{R.50}$$

This is a threshold for persistence of the balance failure only. The certificate extension may require a larger even $n$, as determined by its finite witnesses. Taking both requirements gives arbitrarily large marked diagrams with the full invariant volume limit and a complete-packing balance failure.

### R.8.2 A fully specified infinite sequence

The original seventeen-region certificate gives a concrete threshold, with no search over knot invariants. Normalize each of its forty old witnesses at face 17. At chain length

$$n_0 = 2^{20}, \qquad w_{16} = 2/b_{n_0}, \quad w_0 = 1/b_{n_0}, \quad w_{17} = 1, \tag{R.51}$$

retain their other ordinary weights. Outward interval evaluation of the original rates proves a gap greater than $1/50$ for all forty branches. The only newly allowed overloads are

$$(0, R, 0),\ (1, R, 0),\ (12, L, 16),\ (15, L, 0),\ (16, L, 0), \tag{R.52}$$

where each triple lists the region, side, and overloaded face. For each, take that anchored side and all genuine spectator labels at one fixed old witness. The same evaluation gives a gap greater than $1/50$ for these five branches. The forty old branches and five new anchors cover every locally allowed noncentral string, including any previously globally zero string.

The portable runner check_triangular_boundary_certificate.py checks the original Morse incidence and forty-branch division, the rational complete-flow demands, the five new anchors, and all forty-five rate inequalities with the Fourier tail in (R.42). It also replays the restricted dual used in (R.46). These finite interval inequalities concern the source weights; they do not replace the all-length geometric or asymptotic proof.

Every selected rate is nondecreasing in $w_0, w_{16}$, and the block comparison subtracts no target at these boundary vertices. Since $b_n$ increases, the same forty-five witnesses work for every even $n \geq n_0$. The correction $\Delta$ also decreases. Combining their gap with the core gap $> 3/50$ and the whole-block comparison gives an assembled source gap at least $1/50$.

**Corollary R.2** (Explicit ordinary-face sequence)**.** *For every even $n \geq 2^{20}$, attach the seventeen-region block at crossing 15 to the terminal face of the length-$n$ octahedral chain. The resulting original marked sphere has $n + 20$ regions, an unabridged full-source gap of at least $1/50$, and a complete weak-balance failure among the retained regions $2, 4, 7, 12$. It has no separating three-cycle containing both protected endpoints. After choosing any final knot-producing parity, independently sufficiently long fixed signed primitive fillings satisfy (R.34). Any fixed finite number of these blocks can similarly be attached to the multi-core construction, with the same source-gap lower bound. The filling threshold still depends on the entire fixed final diagram.*

## R.9 What is used from the earlier volume theorems

Variational approaches to Euclidean surface structures and circle patterns were developed by Rivin [16] and Bobenko and Springborn [1]. The argument above proves the required fixed-boundary existence and uniqueness directly, and fixes the disk action in the normalization of the original source. The source-certificate transport uses that explicit identity and the retained coefficient demands.

The complete disk identity is classical variational elimination with the original triangle normalization. It gives neither an equality of finite spectral polynomials nor an independent-radius source bound. The complementary estimates here use the actual phase-uniform rates (R.4), a shared torus for each string, and every original coefficient target.

Appendix L supplies the simple-sphere packing and the local spectral bounds. Appendix N supplies the exact finite filling-functional norm with its degree restrictions and scalar. Appendix O supplies the whole nonzero central period, its primitive metric completion and absolute action calibration for the final diagram. The full complementary estimate (R.30) is the additional input that allows the elementary rate transfer to the full invariant. No open general matched-sphere source estimate is used.

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